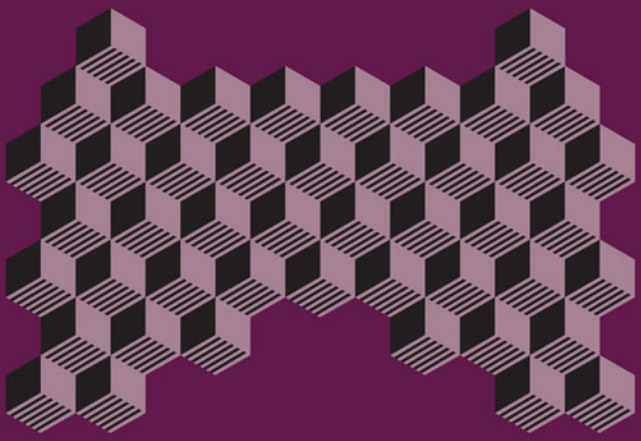
The Reception of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in Avicenna's *Kitāb al-Šifāʾ*

A MILESTONE OF WESTERN METAPHYSICAL THOUGHT



BY

AMOS BERTOLACCI

ISLAMIC PHILOSOPHY, THEOLOGY AND SCIENCE. *TEXTS AND STUDIES*

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AMOS BERTOLACCI



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INTRODUCTION

> "[. . .] there is as yet no metaphysics at all.
> [. . .] a complete reform or rather a rebirth of metaphysics [. . .] is inevitably approaching"
> (I. Kant, *Prolegomena to Any Future Metaphysics*, Preface, transl. G. Hatfield, pp. 6–7)

> "Insofar as a thinking devotes itself to the path of experiencing the foundation of metaphysics [. . .] in a certain way it has abandoned metaphysics"
> (M. Heidegger, *What is Metaphysics?*, Introduction)

The history of the reception of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* can be portrayed as a sequence of "reforms", ending in its definitive "abandonment". The "reforms" started from the very beginning, with the first "edition" of the *Metaphysics* by Andronicus of Rhodes in the I century BC (a collection of scattered Aristotelian material on metaphysics), and were mainly performed by the commentators (Greek, Arab and Latin) of Late Antiquity and the Middle Ages. Its "abandonment", on the other hand, can be ascribed to the original thinkers on metaphysics of the Modern Era. The reforms by commentators aimed at improving the Aristotelian account of this discipline (as in Andronicus' edition), by either clarifying its content, or elucidating its articulation, or refining its method, or enlarging its scope to encompass other perspectives on metaphysics, like those of Neoplatonic philosophy and Christian or Islamic faith. These efforts of amelioration and expansion, however, conveyed a progressive departure from the *Metaphysics*, thus preparing the ground for the subsequent dismissal of this work together with the type of metaphysics it expressed. In accordance with the spirit of the "scientific revolution", the main concern about metaphysics in Modern times was to provide a radical foundation of this discipline as a science: once scholars realized that this goal could not be attained by means of partial adjustments of Aristotle's dictate, but required a complete revision of traditional metaphysics, they abandoned the *Metaphysics* in its entirety as the normative text on metaphysics, and explored new directions of research. The "post-Aristotelian" stage of metaphysics, starting with

Descartes, followed two distinct paths: either the complete neglect of this discipline as inevitably non-scientific (as in Hume), or the attempt to reconstruct it as a rigorous science on a totally different basis (as in Kant), relegating the Aristotelian heritage to a function little more than terminological.

Avicenna (Ibn Sīnā, 980 ca.–1037 AD) plays a key-role in this overall process. His attitude towards Aristotle's *Metaphysics* marks the transition from the stage of exegetical "reform" to that of self-assertive "abandonment". On the one hand, Avicenna's metaphysical *oeuvre* is the last and widest of a series of transformations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* that took place during the Middle Ages. On the other hand, within the Peripatetic tradition it constitutes the first concrete replacement of this work with an original treatment on metaphysics, thus allowing metaphysics the possibility of an autonomous progress. In so far as Avicenna's most important works on metaphysics are constitutively linked with the *Metaphysics*, take into account all the previous reflection on this work, and keep the non-Aristotelian components of metaphysics (Neoplatonic and theological) within the boundaries of Aristotle's original framework, they are an expression of the Medieval Peripatetic tradition. But in so far as they are not commentaries on the *Metaphysics* (neither literal exegeses nor paraphrases), but original reworkings of it, and display epistemological concerns about metaphysics that are largely foreign to Aristotle, they anticipate the Modern approach to metaphysics. The impact of Avicenna's thought on Descartes (the "father" of Modern metaphysics), recently pointed out by scholars, cannot be coincidental.[1] Whereas in the East the substantial progress represented by Avicenna's metaphysics in comparison to Aristotle's homonymous writing was immediately perceived, and the former somehow substituted the latter (either to be accepted and commented upon, or to be criticized), in the West Aristotle's *Metaphysics* kept on being the textbook on metaphysics for a few centuries, and Avicenna's point of view was inserted in the commentaries on the *Metaphysics*, in different amounts and degrees, until the definitive abandonment of this work, as described above.

In sum: Avicenna's metaphysics is both continuous and discontinuous with Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. While being Aristotelian in its guidelines, it goes far beyond Aristotle in its overall purport. As a

[1] See Druart [1988]; Mc Tighe [1988]; Hasnawi [1997b]; Jolivet [1997].

synthesis of both respects, it is unprecedented in the history of the reception of the *Metaphysics*, and can be compared to Proclus' metaphysics with regard to the previous Platonic tradition. In this perspective, it is not exaggerated to regard Avicenna as the second authority on metaphysics, after Aristotle himself, within the Aristotelian school, and the initiator of a new phase of the history of this discipline.

Reform and abandonment, continuity and rupture, tradition and innovation: this two-fold attitude of Avicenna towards Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is the essence of his "interpretation" of this work. Avicenna's interpretation of the *Metaphysics* in his most important work on metaphysics—the *Ilāhiyyāt* ([*Science of*] *Divine Things*) of the *Kītāb al-Šifā'* (*Book of the Cure*)—is the object of the present study.

* * *

The imperfect state of Aristotle's writings—a situation poignantly described by contemporary Aristotelian scholars as a contrast between "ideal" and "achievement" in Aristotle's philosophical system[2]—has not escaped Aristotelian interpreters throughout history. In the Introduction of one of his philosophical *summae*, the *Mašriqiyyūn* (*Easterners*), Avicenna states that the Aristotelian *corpus* presents "loose ends", "breaches", "imperfections" and "defective theories", and is in need of "addition", "correction", and "revision"; the required restoration—he continues—was not accomplished by previous Aristotelian scholars, and only Avicenna himself "perfected" what Aristotle and his successors "meant to say but fell short of doing, never reaching their aim in it".[3]

The defects of Aristotle's writings, of which Avicenna shows a keen perception, are especially puzzling in the case of the *Metaphysics*. This work elicits two main categories of problems. The first regards what we can call the "form" of the *Metaphysics*, namely the scientific profile of the discipline it contains. To this rubric belong issues such as what the metaphysics deals with, how it is structured, what method it follows, how it relates to the other sciences of the Aristotelian *corpus* etc. What Aristotle says in all these regards is often either elliptical, or ambiguous, or, even worse, inconsistent. The second category

[2] Barnes [2000], pp. 59–63.

[3] *Mašriqiyyūn*, pp. 2, 14–3, 5; pp. 3, 13–14. English translation in Gutas [1988], pp. 45–47.

of problems regards, on the other hand, the "content" of the *Metaphysics*, namely its various doctrines. Gaps in exposition, ambiguities and inconsistencies are frequent also in this case. A prime example in this regard is the doctrine of substance, which is surely not less cryptic, and whose implications are not less far-reaching, than the well-known case of the doctrine of intellect in the *De anima*. The problematic character of the doctrine of substance in the *Metaphysics* is made evident by the repeated scholarly attempts to provide a coherent interpretation of Aristotle's ambivalent and somewhat contradictory statements in its regard.

The present study takes into account the way according to which Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt* solves the problems concerning the form of the *Metaphysics*, and reworks coherently the content of this work. In general terms, it can be said that Avicenna's solution of the problems concerning the form of the *Metaphysics* consists in a reshaping of this work according to the epistemological canons established by Aristotle himself in the *Posterior Analytics*: metaphysics has its own subject-matter ("existent *qua* existent"), a precise structure (given by the species, properties and principles of "existent *qua* existent"), a rigorous method (apodictic and analytical, rather than dialectical), and a preeminent position in the system of sciences (it is the discipline that provides the foundation of all the others).

The content of the *Metaphysics*, on the other hand, is reorganized by Avicenna around some fundamental doctrinal cores (substance and accidents; unity and multiplicity; universals; causes; philosophical theology), is reworked according to a rigorous method, and is joined with some original theories (first among all, the famous distinction of essence and existence) capable of interconnecting and bringing to unity these distinct themes. Within philosophical theology, in the last part of the work, Aristotle's point of view in the *Metaphysics* is integrated with that of the Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics* translated into Arabic, of the Neoplatonic metaphysical writings attributed to Aristotle in the Arabic tradition (the *Theologia Aristotelis* and the *Liber de Causis*), and of Islamic theology.

* * *

That Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* is related to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is well known. Avicenna himself states this relationship in the Prologue of the *Šifā'*, and scholars have accepted and repeated Avicenna's statement, to the effect of transforming this relationship into a sort of

topos. But, as often happens with a *locus communis*, the scholarly agreement on the *that* has not been accompanied by an adequate examination of the *what* and *how*. In other words, the relation of the *Ilāhiyyāt* with the *Metaphysics* has been *presupposed*, rather than *investigated*, in Avicennian studies.

The link between these two works has been specifically taken into account only once in the twentieth century, more than ninety years ago, in Constantin Sauter's pioneering monograph *Avicennas Bearbeitung der aristotelischen Metaphysik*, published in 1912 and outdated now.[4] Thereafter, for several decades, the extent and modality of Avicenna's reception of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* has remained uninvestigated, at least on a large scale.[5] A fundamental step towards a precise assessment of Avicenna's debt towards Aristotle on the subject of metaphysics—as in all the other relevant philosophical areas—has been made by Dimitri Gutas in his 1988 monograph on Avicenna (*Avicenna and the Aristotelian Tradition*).[6] The merits of Gutas' book in this respect are two. First, by refuting the scholarly position that regards a fictitious "Oriental" (i.e. mystical and non-Aristotelian) wisdom as Avicenna's true philosophy, he has redirected the attention of scholars towards the "Western" (namely Aristotelian) works by Avicenna. Second, in his treatment of Avicenna's metaphysics, Gutas has posited the methodological principles and raised the basic issues that have oriented subsequent research in general, and the present work in particular. A remarkable example of how Gutas' monograph has broken the ground for a deeper and more detailed investigation of the Aristotelian background of Avicenna's metaphysics is given by the recent book by Robert Wisnovsky (*Avicenna's Metaphysics in Context*, 2003), which provides a comprehensive account of the Peripatetic sources—*in primis* Aristotle's *Metaphysics*—of Avicenna's doctrine of causality in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[7]

Sauter's aforementioned book was published five years after the first modern translation of the *Ilāhiyyāt* into a Western language, the one by Max Horten in 1907.[8] In the footnotes of Horten's German

[4] Sauter [1912].
[5] Articles like Fakhry [1984] represent the exception to the rule.
[6] Gutas [1988], especially pp. 238–267.
[7] Wisnovsky [2003].
[8] Horten [1907].

translation, many references to the *Metaphysics* are provided.[9] The presence of numerous and extensive quotations of the *Metaphysics* in Horten's translation strikingly contrasts with the total absence of an *apparatus fontium* in the critical edition of the *Ilāhiyyāt* published in Cairo in 1960.[10] This defect (unfortunately not the only one) of the Cairo edition is mirrored by the discontinuous attention paid to sources both in the subsequent translations of the *Ilāhiyyāt* into modern languages,[11] and in the otherwise excellent critical edition of the Latin Medieval translation of this work by Simone Van Riet.[12]

The present work aims at providing an account, as much as possible *complete*, of the use of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*. From the perspective of the *Metaphysics*, the present investigation can be regarded as a study of its influence on one of the most important Arab philosophers. From the perspective of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, on the other hand, it is rather an analysis of its main source (the *Metaphysics*), and of the changes that this latter underwent in order to be adjusted to Avicenna's metaphysical agenda. In the case of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, as in that of the other Avicennian writings, the study of sources is intimately connected with the appreciation of Avicenna's originality.

The exposition consists of three parts. Part I ("The Arabic reception of the *Metaphysics* before Avicenna") is preliminary to the following two, and sets the background of the investigation: it surveys the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* (Chapter 1), determines Avicenna's debt towards the two most important previous interpreters of the *Metaphysics* in the Arab world (al-Kindī and al-Fārābī, Chapter 2), and focuses on the treatise of al-Fārābī that has played a decisive role in Avicenna's understanding of the *Metaphysics* (Chapter 3). Part II ("The scientific profile of the *Metaphysics* according to Avicenna") describes the way according to which, in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, Avicenna faces the issues concerning the "form" of the *Metaphysics*, namely his views on this discipline's theme (Chapter 4), its structure (Chapter 5), its method (Chapter 6), and its relationship with the other philosophical sciences (Chapter 7). Part III ("The content of the *Metaphysics*

[9] According to Anawati [1978], p. 27, these references are 129.
[10] Avicenna [1960].
[11] Anawati [1978]; Anawati [1985]; Lizzini [2002]; Marmura [2005].
[12] Avicenna Satinus [1977]; Avicenna Satinus [1980]; Avicenna Satinus [1983].

according to Avicenna") focuses on Avicenna's use of the various books of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. This part provides, first, an annotated list of all the quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, arranged according to the book to which they refer, and collectively overviewed (Chapter 8). Then, it offers a closer analysis of Avicenna's reworking of two among these books, namely Γ (Chapter 9) and B (Chapter 10): Γ is chosen because of its decisive impact on Avicenna's view of all the aspects of the "form" of the *Metaphysics*; B is selected as an example of the non-dialectical method that Avicenna regards as proper of metaphysics. Part III ends with a survey of the non-Aristotelian sources of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Chapter 11).

Six appendices complement the exposition. Appendix A provides a list of textual emendations of the Cairo edition of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, on the basis of its systematic comparison with four further manuscript and the Latin medieval translation. Appendix B is an index of authors and works quoted in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Avicenna's major works on metaphysics are surveyed in Appendix C. In Appendix D, the various names of the *Metaphysics* and metaphysics as a discipline in Avicenna's works are classified. Appendix E enucleates the main features of the style of the *Šifā'*. A list of the different terms by means of which Avicenna expresses the notion of "property" in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is provided in Appendix F.

* * *

This book is the revised version of my Ph.D. dissertation ("The Reception of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in Avicenna's *Kitāb al-Šifā'*: Textual and Doctrinal Analysis", Yale University, May 2005). I wish to express my sincere gratitude to Professor Dimitri Gutas for the constant attention, outstanding competence and friendly support with which he has supervised my research. I am also indebted to (in alphabetical order) Prof. Cristina D'Ancona (University of Pisa), Prof. Hans Daiber (J.W. Goethe-Universität Frankfurt), Prof. Gerhard Endress (Ruhr-Universität Bochum), Dr. Ahmad Hasnaw (C.N.R.S.), Dr. Concetta Luna (Scuola Normale Superiore of Pisa), Dr. Stephen P. Menn (McGill University Montreal), Prof. David C. Reisman (University of Illinois at Chicago), and Alexander Treiger (Yale University), for their enlightening comments on earlier versions of parts of the present work. I wish to thank also Jennifer Bryson for having kindly put at my disposal her unpublished paper "'The View

of Plato' in Šahrastānī's *Al-Milal wa-l-Niḥal*" (Yale University, Spring 1996), from which I have taken valuable information. I am particularly grateful to Prof. Francesco Del Punta (Scuola Nomale Superiore of Pisa), who first encouraged me to pursue the path of Greco-Arabic studies.

During my first academic year at Yale University as a graduate student, my beloved grandmother, Zoe Rossi Bertolacci, passed away. This work is dedicated to her memory.

ABBREVIATIONS

Afʿāl = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Ṭabīʿiyyāt, al-Afʿāl wa-l-Infiʿālāt*, Avicenna [1969], pp. 201–267.
Aǧrām = *Risāla fī l-Aǧrām al-ʿulwiyya*, Avicenna [1986], pp. 39–54.
Aqsām = *Risāla fī Aqsām al-ʿulūm al-ʿaqliyya*, Avicenna [1986], pp. 83–94.
Autobiography = Avicenna [1974b].
Burhān = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Burhān*, Avicenna [1956].
Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī = *Al-Asʾila wa-l-awǧiba*, Avicenna [1974c].
Dānešnāme = *Dānešnāme-ye ʿAlāʾī*, Avicenna [1951].
Ǧadal = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Ǧadal*, Avicenna [1965].
Ḥāl al-Nafs = *Ḥāl al-Nafs al-insāniyya*, Avicenna [1952b], pp. 45–142.
Handasa = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Riyāḍiyyāt, Uṣūl al-Handasa*, Avicenna [1976].
Ḥawāšī Kitāb al-nafs = *Al-Taʿlīqāt ʿalā ḥawāšī Kitāb al-nafs*, Avicenna [1947c].
Hayʾa = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Riyāḍiyyāt, ʿIlm al-Hayʾa*, Avicenna [1980].
Hidāya = *Kitāb al-Hidāya*, Avicenna [1974].
Ḥisāb = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Riyāḍiyyāt, al-Ḥisāb*, Avicenna [1975].
ʿIbāra = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-ʿIbāra*, Avicenna [1970].
Ilāhiyyāt = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Ilāhiyyāt*, Avicenna [1885], [1960], [1997–8].
Inṣāf = *Kitāb al-Inṣāf*, Avicenna [1947], [1947b].
Išārāt = *Al-Išārāt wa-l-tanbīhāt*, Avicenna [1892], Avicenna [1957–1960].
Kawn wa-Fasād = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Ṭabīʿiyyāt, al-Kawn wa-l-Fasād*, Avicenna [1969], pp. 77–200.
Letter to Abū Saʿd = *Risāla ilā l-Wizir Abū Saʿd*, Avicenna [2000].
Letter to Kiyā = *Risāla ilā Abī Ǧaʿfar Ibn al-Marzabān al-Kiyā*, Avicenna [1947d]; Avicenna [1992], pp. 371–375.
Mabdaʾ = *Al-Mabdaʾ wa-l-maʿād*, Avicenna [1984].
Madḫal = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Madḫal*, Avicenna [1952].
Maǧmūʿ = *Al-Maǧmūʿ* or *Al-Ḥikma al-ʿArūḍīya*.
Maqūlāt = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Maqūlāt*, Avicenna [1959].
Mašriqiyyūn = *Al-Ḥikma al-mašriqiyya* or *Al-Mašriqiyyūn*, Avicenna [1910] (see Gutas [2000]).
Mūsīqā = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Riyāḍiyyāt, Ǧawāmiʿ ʿilm al-mūsīqā*, Avicenna [1956b].
Memoirs = *Memoirs of a Disciple from Rayy*, Mahdavī [1954], pp. 206–210.

Mubāḥaṯāt = *Kitāb al-Mubāḥaṯāt*, Avicenna [1947e], Avicenna [1992].
Nafs = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Ṭabīʿiyyāt, al-Nafs*, Avicenna [1959b].
Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār = *Maqāla fī l-Nafs ʿalā sunnat al-iḫtiṣār*, Avicenna [1875].
Naǧāt = *Kitāb al-Naǧāt, Ilāhiyyāt*, Avicenna [1985].
Prologue of the *Šifāʾ* = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Madḫal*, chapter I, 1, Avicenna [1952], pp. 9–11.
Qiyās = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Qiyās*, Avicenna [1964].
Saṭsaṭa = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Saṭsaṭa*, Avicenna [1958].
Samāʿ = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Ṭabīʿiyyāt, al-Samāʿ al-ṭabīʿī*, Avicenna [1983].
Samāʾ wa-ʿĀlam = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Ṭabīʿiyyāt, al-Samāʾ wa-l-ʿĀlam*, Avicenna [1969], pp. 1–76.
Šarḥ Lām = *Šarḥ Ḥarf al-Lām li-Ibn Sīnā*, Avicenna [1947].
Šarḥ/Tafsīr Uṯūlūǧiyā = *Šarḥ Kitāb Uṯūlūǧiyā al-mansūb ilā Arisṭū*, Avicenna [1947b].
Šiʿr = *Al-Šifāʾ, al-Manṭiq, al-Šiʿr*, Avicenna [1966].
Taʿlīqāt = Avicenna [1973].
ʿUyūn = *ʿUyūn al-Ḥikma*, Avicenna [1954].

Alfāẓ = Al-Fārābī, *Kitāb al-Ālfāẓ al-mustaʿmala fī l-manṭiq*, Al-Fārābī [1968].
Fī Aġrāḍ = Al-Fārābī, *Maqāla [. . .] fī aġrāḍ al-ḥakīm fī kulli maqāla min al-Kitāb al-mawsūm bi-l-ḥurūf*, Al-Fārābī [1890], pp. 34–38.
Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull = *Maqāla al-Iskandar al-Afrūdīsī fī l-qawl fī mabādiʾ al-kull bi-ḥasab raʾy Arisṭāṭālis al-faylasūf*, Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001].
Fihrist = Ibn al-Nadīm, *Kitāb al-Fihrist*, Ibn al-Nadīm [1871–2].
Falsafa Ūlā = *Kitāb al-Kindī ilā l-Muʿtaṣim bi-llāh fī l-falsafa al-ūlā*, al-Kindī [1998].
Ǧamʿ = Al-Fārābī, *Kitāb al-Ǧamʿ bayna raʾyay al-ḥakīmayn Aflāṭūn al-ilāhī wa-Arisṭūṭālīs*, al-Fārābī [1999].
Iḥṣāʾ = Al-Fārābī, *Iḥṣāʾ al-ʿulūm*, Al-Fārābī [1949].
In *Metaph.* = Commentary on the *Metaphysics*, Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891].
Mabādiʾ = Al-Fārābī, *Mabādiʾ Ārāʾ Ahl al-Madīna al-Fāḍila*, Al-Fārābī [1985].
Milal = Al-Šahrastānī, *Kitāb al-milal wa-l-niḥal*, Al-Šahrastānī [1842–6], [1951–5], [1994].
Tafsīr = Averroes, *Tafsīr li-Mā baʿda al-ṭabīʿa*, Averroes [1938–1948].
Theologia Aristotelis = *Uṯūlūǧiyā Arisṭāṭālīs*, Theologia Aristotelis [1955].

Unless otherwise noticed, the work referred to is the *Ilāhiyyāt*. In the references to the *Ilāhiyyāt*, *Samāʿ* and *Nafs* the number of pages and lines of the standard editions of the Arabic (Avicenna [1960], Avicenna [1983], Avicenna [1959b]), is followed, between square brackets, by the number of pages and lines of the critical edition of its Latin medieval translation (Avicenna Latinus [1977]–[1980], Avicenna Latinus [1992], Avicenna Latinus [1968]–[1972]). Unless otherwise noticed, English translations of Arabic texts are my own. English translations of Aristotle's works are taken from Barnes [1984].

PART ONE

THE ARABIC RECEPTION OF THE *METAPHYSICS* BEFORE AVICENNA

INTRODUCTION

Aristotle's *Metaphysics* was part of the imponent translation movement from Greek into Arabic that took place between the VIII and the X century AD. Chapter 1 provides a comprehensive survey of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*, by reconsidering the testimonia available in the bibliographical sources and in the manuscript tradition, inspecting the extant translations, and examining their indirect tradition. Avicenna's quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* shed new light on the extent of some of the extant translations, witness the circulation of some versions that are attested but not preserved, and indicate the existence of some translations previously unknown. The scrutiny accomplished in Chapter 1, on the basis of all the historical data presently available and the information that can be gathered from Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*, allows a division of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* into three phases, and an indication of the main features of each one of these three stages.

In Chapter 2 the two main "paradigms" of the pre-Avicennian Arabic reception of the *Metaphysics* are enucleated: they are, basically, al-Kindī's way of reading this work, with its one-sided emphasis on the theological aspect of the *Metaphysics*, and its focus on books α (*Alpha Elatton*) and Λ (*Lambda*); and al-Fārābī's approach, in which both components, theological and ontological, of the *Metaphysics*, and all the books of this work, are taken into due account. As the autobiography witnesses, Avicenna got first acquainted with the *Metaphysics* according to the "Kindian" paradigm, and knew only the "essential parts" of this works (namely chapters α, 1–2, and Λ, 6–10), together with some commentaries thereupon. The subsequent encounter with the *Metaphysics* in its entirety puzzled the young Avicenna, revealed the shortcomings of his previous approach, and imposed a new understanding of Aristotle's work. The required exegetical guide was found in al-Fārābī's treatise *On the Goals of Aristotle's Metaphysics* (*Fī Aġrāḍ*), in which the "Farabian" paradigm of interpretation of the *Metaphysics* is best outlined.

This treatise by al-Fārābī is the object of Chapter 3. This chapter provides the first integral English translation of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*, and investigates its content and sources, showing its probable

dependence on a lost introduction to the Aristotelian *corpus* by Ammonius Son of Hermeias. The impact of al-Fārābī's treatise on Avicenna's metaphysical works is then taken into account, and a survey of the other Farabian works dealing with metaphysics is conclusively provided.

CHAPTER ONE

THE ARABIC TRANSLATIONS OF THE *METAPHYSICS*: A NEW ASSESSMENT ON ACCOUNT OF THE EVIDENCE PROVIDED BY AVICENNA*

The scrutiny of Avicenna's reworking of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* allows a clearer and broader view of the Arabic translations of this work of Aristotle. The contribution of the *Ilāhiyyāt* in this respect is three-fold. First, with regard to the two main Arabic versions of the *Metaphysics*, Avicenna's work confirms the importance and wide diffusion of the former, and helps to determine more precisely the extent of the latter, which is attested as extensive in the historical sources, but covers in its extant form only a book of the *Metaphysics* (α). Second, it shows that the translations of the last two books of the *Metaphysics* (M-N), attested but not preserved, did actually exist and circulate. Third, it provides evidence for the existence and circulation of an unknown translation of the first book of the *Metaphysics* according to the Greek numeration (A). The present chapter aims at providing an overall assessment of the extent, nature and chronology of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*, taking into account the important witness represented by Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*.

The starting-point and, at the same time, the foundation of recent scholarship on the Arabic translations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* are Maurice Bouyges' excellent critical edition of the work in which the extant translations of the *Metaphysics* are preserved—i.e. Averroes' *Tafsīr* (the so-called "Long Commentary") of the *Metaphysics*[1]—and his comprehensive account of the Arabic translations and translators of the *Metaphysics* in the introductory volume.[2] The last volume of Bouyges' edition of Averroes' *Tafsīr* appeared almost sixty years ago, in 1948 (the introductory volume was published posthumously in

* This chapter is a revised version of Bertolacci [2005c].

[1] Averroes [1938–48].

[2] Bouyges [1952]. Valuable comprehensive surveys have been later provided by Peters [1968], pp. 49–52; Genequand [1984], pp. 5–11; Martin [1989]; D'Ancona [1996], pp. 57–65; Martini [2003b]; D'Ancona [2005c], pp. 203–204.

1952). The progress of research since then makes now possible a closer scrutiny and a more comprehensive evaluation of the Arabic translations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Relying on the texts made available by Bouyges and the impressive amount of philological information conveyed in his edition, subsequent scholars have been able to select and focus on more specific topics, providing, for example, a closer inspection of the Arabic translations of the single books of the *Metaphysics* (books A, α, and Λ in particular),[3] a detailed comparison of some of these translations with the original text of the *Metaphysics*,[4] and a careful study of their impact on particular aspects of the Arabic philosophical terminology.[5] A new trend of research in recent times has been the study of these versions as part of the wider context of the Graeco-Arabic translation movement.[6]

Our sources of information on the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* can be divided into three main categories. First, there are the *testimonia* on the translations and the translators of the *Metaphysics* that can be found in the Arabic bio-bibliographical literature, especially in Ibn-al-Nadīm's *Kītāb al-Fihrist* (*Book of the Index*). Second, there are the extant translations themselves, which are either quoted by Averroes in the *Tafsīr*, or reported in the margins of the manuscript of this work. Third, there is the so-called "indirect tradition" of the *Metaphysics* in Arabic, namely the writings by philosophers dealing in different ways with Aristotle's work and thus complementing the information provided by the previous two sources. The

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[3] See Thillet [1960]; Walzer [1962]; Walzer [1962b]; Badawī [1968], pp. 82–83; Neuwirth [1976], pp. 166–177; Neuwirth [1977–8]; Bertolacci [1999]; Martini [2001]; Martini [2002]; Thillet [2003]; Geoffroy [2003]; Martini [2004].

[4] The first attempt to compare two different Arabic translations of the same text with the original has been made by Mattock [1989], pp. 73–102 (Mattock compares Usṭāṯ's and Isḥāq's translations of the second part of chapter α, 1 [993 b 7–31]; the relation he establishes between the two translations is questioned by Martini [2002], pp. 98–110). Bauloye [1996] underscores the importance of the earliest Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics* (by Usṭāṯ) for choosing among the variants of the Greek manuscripts (the examples that Bauloye provides regard books B and Z). Usṭāṯ's translation has been studied by G. Endress in the context of the translations from Greek accomplished by the group of scholars to which he belonged (Endress [1997]).

[5] Wisnovsky [2003], pp. 99–112, 269–275.

[6] On the overall translation movement from Greek into Arabic, see Endress [1987–92]; Gutas [1998], Gutas [2000b], D'Ancona [2005b], D'Ancona [2005c]. See also Goodman [1990].

data that can be gathered from Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* belong to the third rubric: they substantiate some of the *testimonia*'s statements about the translations of the *Metaphysics*; they indicate that some of the versions that are only attested were actually used; and they point at the existence of translations that are neither attested nor extant.

In the first three sections of the present chapter, each of the aforementioned three sources will be taken into account. In section §1, a new interpretation of the available *testimonia* will be provided, and the original extent of the two major Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* will be more precisely determined. Section §2 presents a comprehensive survey of the extant translations. In the third section (§3), the indirect tradition regarding book A will be considered, and the existence of an Arabic translation of A different from the extant one will be argued for. Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* will shed new light on all these three contexts. In the last section (§4), finally, the data gathered in the previous three sections will be reconsidered; their scrutiny will allow a division of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* into three phases, and an indication of the main features of each of these phases.

1 The *Testimonia*

1.1 *The* Fihrist

Ibn-al-Nadīm completed the *Fihrist* in 377/988. The earliest translation mentioned in the entry on Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (by Usṭāṯ, in the first half of the IX c.) antedates Ibn al-Nadīm's lifetime by about a century. Due to its chronological proximity, I take the *Fihrist* as a faithful witness of the initial phase of the translation activity regarding the *Metaphysics*. The *Fihrist* had an immense impact on subsequent literature, and many derivatives of its entry on the *Metaphysics* can be found in later authors.[7]

[7] The *Fihrist*'s account is reproduced, almost *verbatim*, in Ibn al-Qifṭī's (1172–1248) *Ta'rīḫ al-ḥukamā'* (Ibn al-Qifṭī [1903], pp. 41–42) and Ḥāğğī Ḫalīfa's (1609–1657) *Kašf al-zunūn* (Ḥāğğī Ḫalīfa [1835–58], #10448).

Text 1: *Fihrist*, vol. I, pp. 251, 25–252, 1

Account of the "Book of Letters", known as "Divine [Matters]" [= Aristotle's *Metaphysics*].

[a] This book is arranged according to the Greek letters. Its beginning is "A Minor", which was translated by Isḥāq [b. Ḥunayn]. What can be found of it [i.e. of the *Metaphysics* in Arabic translation by anybody] [goes up] to letter "M". This letter [i.e. "M"] was translated by Abū-Zakariyā' Yaḥyā b. 'Adī. Letter "N" does exist, but in Greek with Alexander [of Aphrodisias]'s commentary. These letters [i.e. "A Minor"-"M"] were translated by Usṭāṯ for al-Kindī, and he [i.e. al-Kindī] wrote a notice on it.

[b] Abū-Bišr Mattā translated treatise "L"—namely the eleventh letter—with Alexander's commentary into Arabic. Ḥunayn b. Isḥāq translated this treatise into Syriac. Themistius commented on treatise "L" Abū-Bišr Mattā translated it with Themistius' commentary. Šamlī [also] translated it.

[c] Isḥāq b. Ḥunayn translated a number of the treatises [of this work]. Syrianus commented on treatise "B". It [i.e. treatise "B" together with Syrianus' commentary] was translated into Arabic. I saw it written in Yaḥyā b. 'Adī's own hand in the list of his books.[8]

Section [a] provides a general description of the arrangement of the *Metaphysics* in Greek; the extent of its Arabic translations, and the authors of the Arabic version of the first and last book that have been translated; the most complete Arabic translation of this work. Section [b] deals in particular with the translations of book Λ and related Greek commentaries. Section [c], finally, offers additional information on other translators/translations.

Text 1 informs us of the following translations (in chronological order):

Outline 1: Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* according to the *Fihrist*

Usṭāṯ (IX c.) for al-Kindī (d. shortly after 256/870):[9] books α-M

Šamlī (IX c.): book Λ

Ḥunayn ibn-Isḥāq (808–873): Syriac translation of Λ

Isḥāq ibn-Ḥunayn (d. 910): book α and some other books

Abū-Bišr Mattā (d. 328/940): book Λ (twice, once with the com-

[8] The same text is reported in Bouyges [1952], pp. CXVII; Engl. transl. in Peters [1968], p. 49, Dodge [1970], vol. II, pp. 606–607 (Dodge does not signal any variant in the further manuscripts of the *Fihrist* which he takes into account in his translation).

[9] See Endress [1997], pp. 52–53.

mentary by Alexander of Aphrodisias, a second time with the commentary by Themistius)[10]

Abū-Zakariyā' Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī (d. 363/974): book M[11]

In Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī (d. 363/974): book B (with the commentary by Syrianus)[12]

From the point of view of extent, the main translations of the *Metaphysics* appear to be two: Usṭāṯ's and Isḥāq's. Both are extensively employed—and therefore confirmed in their status of main Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*—in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*.[13]

About Usṭāṯ's translation Text 1 asserts basically two things: (i) that it started with book α, and (ii) that it ended with book M. For the expression "these letters", in the sentence "these letters were translated by Usṭāṯ" in section [a], refers to books α-M. Let us see the implications of (i) and (ii) more in detail.

(i) The fact that Usṭāṯ's translation started with book α—the second book of the *Metaphysics* according to the Greek numeration—implies that in this translation the first book of the Greek *Metaphysics*,

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[10] Taken literally, Text 1 would imply that Abū-Bišr Mattā accomplished two distinct translations of book Λ. As M. Geoffroy notices (Geoffroy [2003]), however, it is not clear how these two translations relate to one another (i.e. whether they are identical or different), and how the latter relates to the commentary by Themistius. For, whereas the commentary by Alexander of Aphrodisias is a literal commentary—and Mattā's translation of Λ accompanying it is, in all likelihood, the Arabic version of the lemmata of Λ contained in Alexander's commentary—the commentary by Themistius is a paraphrase and does not include in any way the text of Λ. Mattā might have attached a translation of Λ to his version of Themistius' paraphrase. This translation might be the Arabic version of the Syriac translation of Λ by Ḥunayn ibn Isḥāq, which is mentioned in Text 1 [b] immediately before Themistius' commentary and its Arabic translation by Mattā. This would be in accordance with the fact that Mattā translated from Syriac, but remains, in lack of further evidence, a matter of speculation.

[11] See Endress [1977], pp. 27–28.

[12] The list of the books of Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī, to which the translation of book B with the commentary by Syrianus belongs, is the catalogue of his library, not the inventory of his own works (see Endress [1977], pp. 6–7). It cannot be excluded that the pronoun "it" (*-hā*) in "I saw it" (*ra'aytuhā*) refers to "a number of the treatises" (*ʿiddat maqālāt*) at the beginning of [c], rather than to "treatise B" (*maqālat al-bā'*) in what follows (I thank Cristina D'Ancona for having brought this possibility to my attention); it is more likely, however, that the reference regards the element syntactically closer to "I saw it", i.e. "treatise B". It is also possible that "It was translated" (*ḫuriğat*) refers only to "treatise B", not to Syrianus' commentary on this treatise (I am indebted to Cristina D'Ancona also on this point); but, in this case, Ibn al-Nadīm's mention of an Arabic translation of *Metaphysics* B would be pointless, since he has already stated in [a] that books α-M (B included) are available in Arabic. On the very limited circulation and impact of Syrianus commentary in Arabic, see Chapter 2, §5.

[13] See Chapter 8, §§1.1–2.

namely A, was either postponed to α, or missing. The latter alternative can be argued for in three ways. First, A is omitted by al-Fārābī, a few decades after Usṭāṯ's lifetime, in his description of the *Metaphysics* in the *Maqāla . . . fī Aġrāḍ al-ḥakīm fī kull maqāla min al-kitāb al-mawsūm bi-l-ḥurūf* (*Treatise . . . on the goals of the Sage* [= Aristotle] *in each treatise of the book named by means of letters* [= the *Metaphysics*]). A and N are the only books of the *Metaphysics* that he does not take into account in this treatise, whereas he does mention all the other books, even the less relevant ones, like K.[14] Judging from the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, therefore, al-Fārābī was not acquainted with any Arabic translation of A. Since he probably had at his disposal Usṭāṯ's translation, this latter lacked in all likelihood book A. Second, the only book of the *Metaphysics* for which Averroes in the *Tafsīr* does not use Usṭāṯ's translation in any way (neither as main translation, nor as secondary translation) is A (see below, §2). Third, book A is also probably missing in the copy of Usṭāṯ's translation owned by the copyist of the manuscript of the *Tafsīr*: for this copyist reproduces Usṭāṯ's translation in the margin of the manuscript whenever Averroes does not use this translation as his main translation, but he omits doing that in the case of book A (see below, §2).

Therefore—if we exclude the unlikely possibility that al-Fārābī, Averroes and the copyist of the *Tafsīr* all had access to an incomplete copy of Usṭāṯ's translation—book A was probably missing in this translation.[15] Many explanations for the absence of A in Usṭāṯ's translation have been advanced.[16]

(ii) Furthermore, Usṭāṯ's translation did not encompass the last book of the *Metaphysics*. It is evident from section [a] itself that, at the time of Ibn-al-Nadīm, the Arabic *Metaphysics* ended with book M ("What can be found of it [goes up] to letter M"), and did not

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[14] See below, n. 60.

[15] In Text 1[b], the reference to book Λ as the "eleventh letter" regards the Greek alphabet (in which Λ is actually the eleventh letter) rather than the order of books within the *Metaphysics* (I wish to thank Dimitri Gutas for having brought this point to my attention). Ibn al-Nadīm, however, does not warn the reader that the eleventh letter of the Greek alphabet corresponds to the twelfth book of the *Metaphysics*, rather than to the eleventh. This could suggest—*e silentio*—that one of the eleven books of the *Metaphysics* preceding Λ was not translated into Arabic at the time of Ibn al-Nadīm—a situation compatible with the supposed absence of A from Usṭāṯ's translation.

[16] See the survey by Martini [2001], pp. 181–183, Martini [2002], pp. 80–97.

include book N, which is mentioned as extant in Greek—i.e. *only* in Greek. Moreover, book N is absent in al-Fārābī's account of the *Metaphysics* in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* (see below, §3) and, together with book M, in Averroes' *Tafsīr* (see below, §2). Thus, in all likelihood Usṭāṯ's translation lacked also book N.

On the basis of this evidence, it is safe to assume that Usṭāṯ's translation was not an integral translation: it originally encompassed only books α-M (with the exclusion of A and N).[17] Together with the *absence* of books A and N, the *presence* of book M in Usṭāṯ's translation has to be underscored.[18]

The incomplete character of the other major translation mentioned in Text 1 (Isḥāq's translation) is evident from section [c]. Text 1, however, does not provide any information on the exact identity of the books that this translation actually encompassed. Their number can be assessed on the basis of the extant translations and the indirect tradition. Among the extant translations, Isḥāq's version of book α is preserved almost in full, and fragments of what is likely his version of books Γ, Θ, I and (possibly) Λ are extant as well (see below, §2). The indirect tradition allows us to extend further the range of books probably belonging to Isḥāq's translation. For Avicenna's paraphrases of some passages of books B, Γ and Δ in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are based on a translation different from Usṭāṯ's;[19] this translation is probably Isḥāq's, whose version of the *Metaphysics* Avicenna uses in his paraphrase of book α.[20] Therefore, Isḥāq's translation encompassed (at least) seven books: α, B-Δ, Θ-I, Λ.

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[17] Despite Bouyges' remarks (Bouyges [1952], pp. cxxviii–cxxix, cxlix), in recent scholarship the *Fihrist* is often taken as attesting that this translation was, originally, complete (see Peters [1968], p. 50; Martin [1989], p. 531). It cannot be excluded, of course, that Usṭāṯ's translation was originally complete, and that, for some accident of the manuscript tradition, two of its books (A, N) remained unknown to Ibn al-Nadīm, al-Fārābī and subsequent Arab philosophers. This scenario, however, appears unlikely.

[18] The presence of book M in Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics* excludes, for example, the possibility of invoking the "Platonism" of al-Kindī's circle (to which Usṭāṯ belonged) in order to explain the fact that this translation did not include book A (this line of interpretation is suggested by Martini [2001], pp. 182–183, Martini [2002], p. 112). Since book M (present in Usṭāṯ's translation) is not less anti-Platonic than book A, the anti-Platonic character of A appears to be unrelated to its absence from Usṭāṯ's translation.

[19] See Chapter 8, §1.1, Table 1.

[20] See Chapter 8, §1.2.

1.2 *A marginal annotation in Averroes'* Tafsīr

For some other translations undertaken in the second half of the X century, Text 1 is complemented by an annotation in the manuscript of Averroes' *Tafsīr*.

> Text 2: Annotation in the manuscript of Averroes' *Tafsīr* of the *Metaphysics*
>
> [a] The twelfth [treatise of the *Metaphysics* = M] was translated by Ibn-Zurʿa. The thirteenth [= N] by Naẓīf b. Yumn.
>
> [b] As for the group of [treatises] commented upon by the Judge [i.e. Averroes], they are [in] the translation by Usṭāṯ, except for the treatise designated as "A Major". The last treatise that happens to be [translated] by Usṭāṯ [in Averroes' *Tafsīr*] is "L". [The translation of] treatise "A Major" is due to Naẓīf b. Yumn.[21]

The twelfth and thirteenth books of the *Metaphysics* mentioned in section [a] are, respectively, M and N (not Λ and M), due to the lack of K among the books commented upon by Averroes.[22] Thus, section [a] deals with the Arabic translations of the last two books of the *Metaphysics* (M and N), not commented upon by Averroes. Section [b], on the other hand, takes into account the Arabic translations of the books commented upon by Averroes.

Text 2, despite some slight imprecision,[23] is an important document in as much as it informs us of two more translators and their translations:

> Outline 2: Additional Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*
>
> ʿĪsā ibn-Zurʿa (943–1008): book M
>
> Naẓīf ibn-Yumn (or: Ayman) al-Rūmī (second half of X c.):[24] books A and N

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[21] Text in Bouyges [1952], p. lvi (= Annotation 2); cp. p. cxviii.

[22] Book Λ, M and N are numbered, respectively, as eleventh, twelfth and thirteenth, due to the absence of K, also in another annotation of the manuscript of Averroes' *Tafsīr* (see Bouyges [1952], p. lv, Annotation 1). As to books M and N, the same happens in Averroes' proemium to Z (*Tafsīr*, p. 745, 4–6).

[23] The information that section [b] provides on Usṭāṯ's translation is not completely correct. For, as will be seen in the next section, Averroes uses a translation different from Usṭāṯ's in his commentary not only of book A, but also of most of book α and of the first part of book Λ. Usṭāṯ's translation of α and Λ, however, is reported in the margins of Averroes' *Tafsīr*, whenever Averroes does not comment on it. Text 2 is not totally unreliable, therefore, in connecting all of Averroes' *Tafsīr* (except book A) with Usṭāṯ's translation.

[24] On this translator, see Bouyges [1952], pp. cxxii, lvi; Endress [1987–92], vol. II, p. 443, n. 103; Kraemer [1986], pp. 132–134; Gutas [1998], p. 151, n. 1.

It is noteworthy that, according to Text 2, Naẓīf translated the two books of the *Metaphysics* probably missing in Usṭāṯ's translation, according to the reconstruction proposed here. In this regard, Naẓīf's translation appears as the completion of Usṭāṯ's.

To summarize: a careful inspection of the most important document at our disposal on the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*—the relevant passage of the *Fihrist* (Text 1)—shows that the first and most extensive of these translations (Usṭāṯ's) originally encompassed books α-M, omitting books A and N. As for the second major translation (Isḥāq's), the evidence offered by the indirect tradition (Avicenna's probable recourse to this version) complements the information provided by the *Fihrist*, and indicates that this translation comprised (at least) seven books (α, B-Δ, Θ-I, Λ). A second *testimonium* (Text 2) informs us of some late X century translations not mentioned in the *Fihrist*.

2 The Extant Translations

Some of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* mentioned in Texts 1–2 are extant. Most of the extant translations are preserved in Averroes' *Tafsīr* of the *Metaphysics*.

Averroes' *Tafsīr* is a fundamental witness to the different versions of the Arabic *Metaphysics* in three distinct ways. (i) The translations upon which Averroes mainly relies for commenting on each book of the *Metaphysics* are quoted in portions of variable length (Textus) at the beginning of the single units of the *Tafsīr*. Each of the Textus, in its turn, is further divided into sentences (Lemmata), which are quoted a second time and commented upon by Averroes one after the other. (ii) In the explanations of the Lemmata (Commenta), Averroes occasionally quotes alternative translations of the passages he is commenting upon. (iii) Other translations have been reported by later copyists in the margins of the manuscript (Leiden, Universiteitsbibliotheek, *Or.* 2074) preserving the *Tafsīr*.

An overview of the versions of the *Metaphysics* available in the *Tafsīr* as (i) main translations in Textus/Lemmata, (ii) additional translations in the Commenta, (iii) marginal translations, is provided in the following table.

Table 1: The Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* in Averroes' *Tafsīr*

Books	Translations in the Textus and Lemmata	Translations occasionally referred to in the Commenta	Translations copied in the margins of the manuscript
α	Isḥāq (until 995a17) Usṭāṯ (995a17–20)	Usṭāṯ	Usṭāṯ (until 995a17)
A	from 987a6: Naẓīf		
B	Usṭāṯ		
Γ	Usṭāṯ	Isḥāq (?)	
Δ	Usṭāṯ		
E	Usṭāṯ		
Z	Usṭāṯ		
H	Usṭāṯ		
Θ	Usṭāṯ	Isḥāq (?)	
I	Usṭāṯ	Isḥāq (?)	
K	–		
Λ	Mattā (until 1072b16) Usṭāṯ (1072b16–1073a13) Mattā (from 1073a14)	Usṭaṯ; Yaḥyā; Šamlī or Isḥāq	Usṭāṯ (until 1072b16) Yaḥyā (1070a5–7)
M	–		
N	–		

Averroes comments on book α before commenting on book A. Since, as we have seen, book A was lacking in the first (Usṭāṯ's) translation of the *Metaphysics*, α was regarded by the Arabs, from the very beginning, as the opening book of this work. The belief that α was the first book of the *Metaphysics* persisted even when book A was later translated.

As for book α, the translation in the Textus and Lemmata is Isḥāq's, as indicated by a marginal annotation.[25] The final lines (995a17–20), however, according to the same marginal annotation, are taken from "another translation" (*tarǧama uḫrā*).[26] Since these lines are missing in the translation copied in the margins of the manuscript of the *Tafsīr*,[27] which is there attributed to Usṭāṯ,[28] the translation of 995a17–20 quoted and commented upon by Averroes is, in all likelihood, Usṭāṯ's. In the Commentum, Averroes refers to "another translation" (= Usṭāṯ's translation copied in the margin) of 994b25–27.[29]

[25] *Tafsīr*, vol. I, p. 50, 5–6.
[26] *Tafsīr*, vol. I, p. 50, 8–10.
[27] *Tafsīr*, vol. I, p. 50, 1 (bottom of page).
[28] *Tafsīr*, vol. I, p. 3, 1 (bottom of page), p. 49, 1, n. 1 (bottom of page).
[29] *Tafsīr*, vol. I, p. 40, 10–12.

Isḥaq's translation of α is also extant independently of Averroes' *Tafsīr*. It is the version quoted and commented upon by Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī in his commentary on *Metaphysics* α.[30] It is also probably the version used by Avicenna in his paraphrase of this book within the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[31] Furthermore, an abridged version of Isḥaq's translation of α, 1–2 (993a30–994b31) is preserved in the Ms. Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 6, in which texts originally belonging to Avicenna's library have been copied.[32]

As for book A, the translation in the Textus and the Lemmata is ascribed to Naẓīf in Text 2 [b], as we have seen. Averroes comments only on the second part of this book (from A, 5, 987a6 until the end), and in the Commenta does not refer to any other translation.

Usṭāṯ's translation is the translation used in the Textus and Lemmata of books B-I.[33] In the Commenta on books Γ, Θ and I, Averroes often quotes "another translation" beside Usṭāṯ's.[34] This translation

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[30] Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī [1973], pp. 168–203; Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī [1988], pp. 220–262. See Kraemer [1986b], p. 210 and n. 169; Martini [2002], pp. 98–99 and n. 64; Martini [2003]; Martini [forthcoming]. In the aforementioned studies (see especially Martini [2003], p. 71, n. 9), Martini shows that Isḥāq' translation of α is preserved more fully in Yaḥyā's commentary than in Averroes' *Tafsīr*. She also points out (p. 91) that Yaḥyā had at his disposal Arabic translation(s) of α other than Isḥāq's (see also Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī [1973], p. 202, 9–11; Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī [1988], p. 262, 7–9).

[31] See Chapter 8, §1.2.

[32] See Gutas [1987c], p. 13b–14a, #11. Gutas maintains that this abridgement "contains a number of readings better than those in the Leiden Averroes manuscript used by Bouyges, and it should be consulted in a future edition".

[33] Pp. 413, 9–437, 8 of Averroes' *Tafsīr*—regarding the end of chapter Γ, 5 (1009b25–1011a2)—are missing in Arabic. The Arabic translation of these lines in Averroes' Textus is Bouyges' retroversion into Arabic of the later Hebrew and Latin versions of the *Tafsīr* (the original Arabic translation of lines 1010b23–1011a2, however, can be gathered from Averroes' lemmata after p. 437, 8). The translation of Γ that Averroes uses in the Textus and Lemmata presents some omissions (see *Tafsīr*, vol. I, pp. [21]–[23]): 1003b25–26; 1004a21–22; 1010b11 (in the retroversion); 1011a30; 1011b13; 1012a13–15; 1012a32; 1012b14–15; 1012b31.

[34] As for book Γ, Averroes quotes an additional translation of Γ, 6, 1011b18–19; Γ, 6, 1011b20–22; Γ, 7, 1012a8; Γ, 7, 1012a12–13; Γ, 8, 1012a33 (see *Tafsīr*, vol. I, pp. [20]–[23]). An additional translation of Γ, 8, 1012b16–30, is quoted in the Textus, before Usṭāṯ's translation, but only this latter is then divided into Lemmata and commented upon. As for book Θ, Averroes quotes an additional translation of Θ, 1, 1046a31–35; Θ, 2, 1046b16–17; Θ, 2, 1046b17–19; Θ, 2, 1046b20; Θ, 2, 1046b21–22; Θ, 2, 1046b22–24; Θ, 2, 1046b24; Θ, 3, 1047a20–22; Θ, 7, 1049a1–2; Θ, 8, 1050a6; Θ, 8, 1050a6–7; Θ, 8, 1050a9; Θ, 8, 1050a13; Θ, 8, 1050a13–14; Θ, 8, 1050b4–5; Θ, 8, 1050b6–8; Θ, 8, 1050b33–34; Θ, 8, 1050b34–1051a2; Θ, 10, 1051b2–4 (see *Tafsīr*, vol. II, pp. [51]-[56]). As for book I, Averroes quotes an additional translation of I, 1, 1052b27–31; I, 1, 1052b32–34; I, 1, 1053b2–6; I, 1, 1053b7–8; I, 2, 1053b18–20; I, 3, 1054a32–35; I, 3, 1054b5–6; I, 3, 1054b13–18;

is probably Isḥāq's. For Isḥāq's is the only translation of the *Metaphysics* that, according to the information at our disposal, possibly included these books.[35]

Λ is the book for which Averroes uses the highest number of translations. Two different translations are used in the Textus and Lemmata. The former is the version of Λ that accompanies Mattā's translation of Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on this book. It is used by Averroes, with some exceptions,[36] for Textus 1–39 (from the beginning until Λ, 7, 1072b16) and Textus 42–58 (from Λ, 8, 1073a14 until the end).[37] The latter translation is Usṭāṯ's. It is used for some passages of Λ preceding 1072b16,[38] and for the Textus and Lemmata corresponding to Λ, 7, 1072b16–1073a13 (Textus 40–41). Usṭāṯ's translation of Λ, 1–7 (until 1072b16) is copied in the margins of the manuscript of Averroes' *Tafsīr*.[39] Further light on Usṭāṯ's translation

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I, 4, 1055a25–26; I, 8, 1058a8–9; I, 8, 1058a11–13; I, 8, 1058a15–16; I, 10, 1058b26–29; I, 10, 1058b29–30 (see *Tafsīr*, vol. III, pp. [60]–[65], bottom of pages).

[35] This is Bouyges' view (Bouyges [1952], p. cxxix).

[36] See below, n. 38, cases (1), (3) and (4).

[37] Geoffroy [2003] has convincingly shown that not only Textus 1–39, as maintained by Bouyges [1952], p. cxxxi, but also Textus 42 and following are taken from Mattā's translation. The translation of the end of Λ (Λ, 9, 1075b20–1076a4, Textus 57–58)—like Averroes' commentary thereupon—are Bouyges' retroversion into Arabic of the Hebrew translation (*Tafsīr*, vol. III, pp. 1728–1736).

[38] (1) The translation of Λ, 1–2, 1069b1–9 in Textus 6 (*Tafsīr*, vol. III, p. 1428, 3–8) and related Lemmata (p. 1429, 14–15; p. 1430, 4–5; p. 1431, 9) is identical to the marginal translation (p. 1428, 2–5, bottom of page), and belongs, in all likelihood, not to Mattā's, but to Usṭāṯ's translation (see Bouyges [1952], p. cxxxi). (2) In *Tafsīr*, vol. III, pp. 1536, 12–1537, 11, Averroes reports in Textus 26 (Λ, 5, 1071a3–17), besides Mattā's, "another translation" of the text. This translation is probably Usṭāṯ's, since the corresponding marginal translation is absent (the marginal annotator apparently regarded it as superfluous to report a second time in the margin the translation quoted by Averroes himself in the Textus). (3) As Averroes himself remarks (*Tafsīr*, vol. III, p. 1545, 12–13), the translation of Λ, 5, 1071a23–29 in Textus 27 (pp. 1542, 2–1543, 2; Lemmata: p. 1546, 1–4; p. 1547, 1; p. 1548, 2; p. 1548, 6–7) is not taken from Alexander's commentary, but from the "second translation" (*al-tarǧama al-ṯāniya*), which is almost identical to the marginal translation (p. 1542, 2–4, bottom of page), and is probably Usṭāṯ's translation. (4) Mattā's translation of Λ, 6–7, 1072a9–23, as reported by Averroes in the Textus 33 (*Tafsīr*, vol. III, p. 1578, 7–8), is incomplete, and Averroes quotes in the Commentum "another translation" of the same passage (pp. 1580, 9–1582, 5), which Bouyges regards as a Textus on its own (Textus 34); also in this case the additional translation is identical to the marginal one (pp. 1580, 1–1582, 4, bottom of page), and is probably Usṭāṯ's.

[39] Except for 1071a3–17 (see above, n. 38). An excellent reconstruction of Usṭāṯ's translation of Λ, 6 is available in Geoffroy [2003].

of book Λ can be gained from the inspection of Avicenna's commentary on Λ, 6–10 (1071b5–1075a27) that is part of his *Kitāb al-Inṣāf* (*Book of the Fair Judgement*).[40] For in this commentary Avicenna quotes Λ according to Usṭāṯ's translation.[41]

In the Commenta of Λ, Averroes often quotes excerpts from additional translations, different from the ones he uses in the Textus and the Lemmata.[42] At least three of these translations can be identified. One is Usṭāṯ's translation, to which Averroes refers as additional translation in the first half of the commentary (where Mattā's translation is used in the Textus and the Lemmata). That some of the passages quoted by Averroes belong to Usṭāṯ's translation can be determined by their identity, or strong similarity, with the corresponding passages in the marginal translation.[43] A passage of another translation, rendering Λ, 3, 1070a2–7, is ascribed by Averroes himself to Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī.[44] Part of the same passage (1070a5–7) is reproduced in the margins of the manuscript of the *Tafsīr* (together with Usṭāṯ's translation), where it is also ascribed to Yaḥyā.[45] Thus, Averroes' *Tafsīr* informs us of a translation of the *Metaphysics* unaccounted for in Texts 1–2:

> Abū-Zakariyāʾ Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī (d. 363/974): book Λ.[46]

All the other pericopes of additional translations quoted by Averroes in the Commenta—in so far as they are different from the marginal translation and are not ascribed to Yaḥyā—apparently belong to yet

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[40] See Appendix C, Work 12.

[41] See Janssens [2003]; Geoffroy [2003].

[42] The complete list is provided by Bouyges in *Tafsīr*, vol. III, pp. [70]–[77], bottom of pages.

[43] *Tafsīr*, vol. III, p. 1462, 9–12 (= 1070a4–7), "other translation" (cp. the marginal translation at p. 1456, 1–3, bottom of page); p. 1533, 11–12 (= 1071a1–2), "second translation" (cp. the marginal translation at p. 1531, 2, bottom of page); p. 1552, 9–13 (= 1071a32–34), "second translation" (cp. the marginal translation at p. 1549, 3–4, bottom of page); p. 1553, 2–4 (= 1071a34–35), "second translation" (cp. the marginal translation at p. 1549, 5, bottom of page); p. 1554, 6–8, p. 1555, 3 (= 1071a36–b1), "other translation" (cp. the marginal translation at pp. 1549, 5–1550, 2, bottom of page). Also the passage of the "third translation" that Averroes quotes at pp. 1525, 10–1526, 1 (= 1070b24–25) is significantly similar to the corresponding *locus* in the marginal translation (p. 1523, 1, bottom of page); Bouyges [1952], p. cxxxi, however, regards this passage as part of a translation different from Usṭāṯ's.

[44] *Tafsīr*, vol. III, p. 1463, 3–8 (see Bouyges [1952], p. cxxxi).

[45] *Tafsīr*, vol. III, p. 1456, 5–7 (bottom of page).

[46] See Endress [1977], p. 28.

another translation. The authorship of this translation is uncertain. On the basis of Text 1, it can be attributed either to Šamlī or to Isḥāq.[47]

Averroes' commentary on books K, M and N—of whose existence, however, he was aware—and on the first part of book A (from the beginning until A, 5, 987a6) is not extant.[48] The Arabic translations of these parts of the *Metaphysics* are known only by means of the indirect tradition: in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, for example, Avicenna quotes some passages of A, 2[49] and of books M and N;[50] a quotation of M occurs also in al-Šahrastānī's (1086/7ca.–1153) *Kitāb al-milal wa-l-niḥal* (see below, §3, Table 2.2).

An anonymous shortened paraphrase of Λ, 6–10 (1071b3–1076a4) is also often recorded among the extant Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*. This paraphrase is preserved in the already mentioned "Avicennian" manuscript Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 6, and has been published twice.[51] Already present in Avicenna's library, it had a

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[47] Bouyges [1952], p. cxxxii, regards Isḥāq's autorship of this translation as unlikely; but the argument *e silentio* he advances (the fact that in Text 1 no translation of Λ is explicitly ascribed to Isḥāq) is not conclusive.

[48] In the introduction to his commentary on Λ, Averroes provides an accurate description of book K, which he designates by means of the Arabic letter *Yā'* (*Tafsīr*, p. 1404, 1–8). Immediately afterwards (p. 1404, 9–11), before the description of book Λ (*Lām*), he states: "This is what we find concerning the order of the books which have come down to us and which come before *Lām*, but we do not find book *Kāf* in the order of letters, nor has it come down to us" (Engl. transl. in Genequand [1984], p. 64). This statement, isolated from the context, has been taken as indicating that Averroes did not know book K at all (see Bouyges [1952], p. cli). On the contrary, it only attests that he did not know this book *as book Kāf*, but *as book Yā'* (on the different designations of the books of the *Metaphysics* in Arabic, see Bouyges [1952], pp. xix–xx, cliii–clv). Likewise, Averroes appears to be familiar also with books M (*Mīm*) and N (*Nūn*), of which he provides a brief description in the same introduction (p. 1405, 1–3; cp. p. 1398, 5–7). D. Gutas has shown that the description of the books of the *Metaphysics* in Averroes' introduction to Λ is distinct from Averroes' account of the proem of Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on the same book (Gutas [1987d], p. 124). Hence Averroes might have been directly acquainted with these three books (books K and M by means of Usṭāṯ's translation, book N by means of Naẓīf's translation; see above, §1). That Averroes did not originally include in the *Tafsīr* a commentary on K, M and N appears less certain than it is portrayed by Bouyges [1952], pp. xviii, cli.

[49] See Chapter 8, §5.1. Avicenna seems to have had access to an Arabic translation of A different from Naẓīf's (see below, §3).

[50] See Chapter 8, §§5.13–14. The translation of M used by Avicenna was possibly Usṭāṯ's (see Chapter 8, §1.4), whereas that of N was possibly Naẓīf's (see Chapter 8, §1.4).

[51] See Gutas [1987c], p. 13b, #8. The published versions are Aristotle [1937] and Aristotle [1947].

considerable diffusion, since it was used, for example, by al-Šahrastānī in the *Milal*.[52] The authorship and date of this paraphrase are uncertain, and none of the different hypotheses advanced in this regard appears to be conclusive.[53] In addition to being selective, it differs from Aristotle's original text in two other important respects: first, it omits some passages of the part of text which it reproduces;[54] second, it displays interpretations of Aristotle's doctrine that scholars regard as "Neoplatonic".[55] For these reasons, this paraphrase can be considered a "translation" of the *Metaphysics* only improperly, and will not be taken into account in what follows.

To summarize: some of the translations of the *Metaphysics* mentioned by the *testimonia* (Texts 1 and 2) are actually extant and preserved in Averroes' *Tafsīr*. In chronological order, they are the translations by Usṭāṯ (α, Β-Ι, Λ), Isḥāq (α), Mattā (Λ with Alexander's commentary), and Naẓīf (Α). Other fragments quoted by Averroes might belong to the translations of book Λ by Šamlī and of books Γ, Θ-Ι, Λ by Isḥāq. Averroes' *Tafsīr* also contains references to a translation otherwise unknown: that of book Λ by Yaḥyā. Some of the translations not preserved in Averroes' *Tafsīr* (those of the first part of book Α, and of books Μ-Ν) are indirectly known through the quotations by Avicenna and other Arab authors.

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[52] See below, n. 76.

[53] ʿAfīfī, the curator of the first printed version of this paraphrase (Aristotle [1937]), regards Abū Bišr Mattā as its author (see Bouyges [1952], p. 140, n. 3). Badawī [1947], pp. xii–xv, ascribes it to Isḥāq Ibn-Ḥunayn. Thillet [1960], p. 121, suggests that the paraphrase might depend on Aristotle's original text through a Syriac intermediary, and that its translation from Syriac into Arabic might have been the work of ʿAbd al-Massīḥ b. ʿAbd Allāh b. Nāʿima al-Himsī (first half of the IX c.), to whom also the translation from Syriac into Arabic of the *Theologia Aristotelis* is ascribed. Establishing the autorship of this paraphrase is made difficult by the cross-contamination—noticed by Geoffroy [2003]—of all the extant Arabic translations of book Λ.

[54] A list of the most significant omissions is provided by Thillet [1960], p. 120, n. 2.

[55] The example provided by Pines [1956], p. 18, n. 3, i.e. the fact that the author of the paraphrase calls God "First Cause" (*al-ʿilla al-ūlā*), is regarded by Thillet [1960], p. 120, n. 3, as one of the many Neoplatonic interpretations present in this paraphrase ("le traducteur, familier avec les thèmes néo-platoniciens de la *Théologie* [d'Aristote] . . . interprète souvent, glose parfois, en termes néo-platoniciens"; Thillet does not mention any other example, though); these Neoplatonic features are the reason why Thillet suggests that the paraphrase and the *Theology of Aristotle* might be by the same author (p. 121). The presence of many Neoplatonic interpretations in the paraphrase is maintained also by Neuwirth [1976], p. 167, n. 20 (who quotes Pines and Thillet).

3 The Indirect Tradition concerning Book A

Important information about the Arabic translations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* can be gained from the references to this work in Arabic writings. An exhaustive survey of this topic exceeds both the limits of the present investigation and the actual state of scholarship. Future editions of still unpublished works, and careful studies of already published writings, hopefully will make a comprehensive account of this subject possible. In the present section, I will focus, in a preliminary way and as an example, on the reception of book A, taking into account the information on this book provided by al-Kindī (d. shortly after 870), al-Fārābī (d. 950), Abū-Zakariyāʾ Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī (d. 974), Avicenna (d. 1037), al-Šahrastānī (d. 1153) and ʿAbd al-Laṭīf al-Baġdādī (d. 1231).

With the progress of research, the number of references to book A that can be found, according to scholars, in al-Kindī's most important metaphysical work, the *Kītāb fī l-Falsafa al-Ūlā* (*Book on First Philosophy*), has drastically diminished. While A. L. Ivry records eight references to book A in the commentary to his 1974 English translation,[56] R. Rashed and J. Jolivet's new edition (1998) omits entirely any reference to this book.[57] As a matter of fact, the references to A detected by Ivry are quite vague and regard general *topoi*; they might be taken either from other books of the *Metaphysics*, or from other Aristotelian works, or from the tradition of the commentaries on Aristotle, as Ivry himself convincingly documents.[58] Even treated cumulatively, they do not prove that the author was directly acquainted with this book of the *Metaphysics*.

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[56] Ivry [1974], p. 206 ("Index of Aristotelian sources", to which the reference to A, 2, 981b27ff., occurring at p. 122 of the commentary, has to be added).

[57] Al-Kindī [1998] (first edition: Al-Kindī [1950]). In A. Neuwirth's review of Ivry's translation (Neuwirth [1977–8], pp. 91–95), the references to A detected by Ivry are reduced to two main ones (A, 2, 982a21–b10; A, 3, 983a24–31), regarding, respectively, the features of wisdom and the wise man, and the four types of causes. See the detailed discussion of these two references in Martini [2002], pp. 85–90.

[58] Ivry [1974], pp. 121–122, 122–123; at p. 134, Ivry states: "It is likely that he [i.e. al-Kindī] was helped to this eclectic approach by some commentary to one or more of these books [i.e. *Posterior Analytics*, *Physics*, *De Anima* and *Metaphysics* A], rather than by direct familiarity with them all".

One of the most important witnesses of the Arabic tradition of the *Metaphysics* is al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*,[59] in which books α-M (K included) are mentioned, but books A and N are not.[60] In other words, judging from this essay, al-Fārābī was acquainted with a version of the *Metaphysics* that did not exceed the boundaries of Usṭāṯ's translation.[61] The fact that in other works, like the *Kitāb al-Ǧamʿ bayna raʾyay al-ḥakīmayn Aflāṭūn al-ilāhī wa-Aristūṭālīs* (*Book on the Agreement of the opinions of the two sages, the divine Plato and Aristotle*) and the *Kitāb al-Alfāẓ l-mustaʿmala fī l-manṭiq* (*Book of the Utterances Employed in Logic*),[62] al-Fārābī refers to Aristotle's criticism of Plato in the *Metaphysics* might give the impression of a certain knowledge of book A. These references, however—if they are directly taken from the *Metaphysics*—can be explained on account of the *loci paralleli* of A in other books of this work, especially in book M.[63]

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[59] On this work, see Chapter 3.

[60] Contrary to Druart's assertion (Druart [1982], p. 39), in this work by al-Fārābī books A and N are not grouped together with, respectively, books α and M, but rather omitted (cp. Bouyges [1952], p. cxxix; Gutas [1988], p. 242; Ramón Guerrero [1983], p. 234). The description of the first book of the *Metaphysics* refers clearly only to book α (see Chapter 3, §1, [3.1]), whereas the content of book A (wisdom as the knowledge of the first causes, and the views of previous thinkers on the number of causes) is not mentioned. The description of the last book of the *Metaphysics* is more vague (see Chapter 3, §1, [3.12]), but there is no reason to regard it as referring to two books together (M and N), instead of one (M). Al-Fārābī did probably known the existence and content of books A and N indirectly, through their description in Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on Λ (see Chapter 5, §6.4, Text 19 [f]), which he quotes in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* (see Chapter 3, §1, [1.3]), but, in all likelihood, he chose to take into account only the books of the *Metaphysics* he was directly acquainted with.

[61] Further evidence of al-Fārābī's reliance on Usṭāṯ's translation in this treatise is provided by his use of the term *huwiyya* in the meaning of "being", typical of Usṭāṯ's translation, within the description of books E and Z (see Chapter 3, §1, [3.5–6]; cp. *Tafsīr*, p. 552, 3, p. 555, 2, p. 746, 17). Al-Fārābī's employment of Usṭāṯ's translation in other works is witnessed, for example, by *Ālfāẓ*, pp. 91, 15–92, 3, in which a quotation of the *Metaphysics* (Al-Fārābī [1968], pp. 91, 15–92, 3) corresponds to Usṭāṯ's translation of *Metaph.* B, 4, 1000a9–11, 13–15, 18–19 (*Tafsīr*, p. 247, 3–4, 6–8, 10–12). Another quotation of the *Metaphysics* in the *Alfāẓ* (pp. 109, 14–110, 1; cp. *Metaph.* H, 3, 1043a21–22), on the contrary, is taken from a translation different from Usṭāṯ's. See Chapter 3, §5, n. 60.

[62] See below Chapter 3, §5.

[63] The most significant passage is Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 143, 1–10 (cp. Al-Fārābī

Abū-Zakariyā' Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī, in his commentary on *Metaphysics* α, is aware of the existence and content of book A, which he mentions explicitly as the book of the *Metaphysics* following the one he is commenting upon.[64] He knew this book probably through the coeval translation by Naẓīf, even though his acquaintance with a different translation cannot be excluded. In any case, Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī represents our first sure witness of the circulation and use of a translation of A in the Arabic philosophical *milieu*.

In the *Ilāhiyyāt*, Avicenna refers to some passages of *Metaphysics* A preserved in Naẓīf's translation. These references occurs in Avicenna's exposition and rejection of Plato and the Pythagoreans in *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 2–3, which is similar in many respects Aristotle's account and criticism of these thinkers in A, 5–6, 8–9.[65] For the most part, these references are brief and paraphrastic, do not respect the order of Aristotle's text, and are interwoven with other doxographic material. Thus, even though almost all the passages of A to which Avicenna refers are extant in Naẓīf's translation, the very nature of Avicenna's references makes any textual comparison difficult. Nonetheless, even

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[1890], p. 27, 11–20, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 100, 6–15): "Dans ses livres sur la *Métaphysique* (i.e. in the treatises [of the book] regarding metaphysics, *fī ḥurūfihī fīmā baʿda l-ṭabīʿati*), Aristote argumente pour critiquer les partisans des modèles et des formes dont on dit qu'ils existent, qu'ils se tiennent, incorruptibles, dans le monde de la divinité. Il explique quelles absurdités s'ensuivent; ainsi il faudrait qu'il y ait là des lignes, des surfaces, des corps, des étoiles et des sphères, qu'existent des mouvements de ces sphères et des cercles, qu'existent là des sciences, comme l'astronomie et la science de la musique, des tons harmonieux et d'autres discordants, des mesures droites, d'autres courbes, des choses chaudes et d'autre froides, en somme, des manières d'être actives et passives, des universaux et des particuliers, des matières et des formes et d'autres absurdités qu l'on profère dans ces affirmations et dont la mention prolongerait à l'excès le présent propos. Nous nous dispensons, en raison de leur célébrité, de les répéter ici-même, ainsi que nous l'avons fait des autres discours quand nous les avons évoqués, avons indiqué leur place et avons laissé le soin de les mentionner à qui les cherchera où ils se trouvent afin de se consacrer à leur étude et à leur interprétation" (French transl. in Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], p. 142; cp. Mallet [1989], p. 90). As sources of this passage, Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], n. 1, p. 187, refer cumulatively to *Metaph.* A, 9, Z, 14, M-N (cp. Mallet [1989], n. 108, p. 113). A passage of the *Alfāẓ* ("Likewise, it has been clarified with regard to a group of other [philosophers] that they engaged in discussing things belonging to this discipline, like division and definitions, like what has been clarified about the view of Socrates and, even more, Plato", Al-Fārābī [1968], p. 110, 1–4) might vaguely refer to *Metaph.* A, 6, 987a32–b7 = M, 4, 1078b12–32.

[64] Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī [1973], p. 202, 11–12; Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī [1988], p. 262, 9–10. See Martini [2002], p. 92.

[65] See Chapter 8, §5.1.

on the basis of this fluid evidence, we can assume that Avicenna's references to A in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are taken from a translation of this book other than Naẓīf's. For in the only reference that resembles a literal quotation, Avicenna's reworking of the original text of Aristotle (A, 6, 987b14–16) is closer to this latter than Naẓīf's translation is. The relevant passage of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is compared with Aristotle's original text and Naẓīf's Arabic translation in the following table.

Table 2.1: Quotation of *Metaph.* A, 6, 987b14–16 in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Naẓīf's Arabic translation of *Metaphysics* A in Averroes' *Tafsīr*
(VII, 2, p. 311, 14–15 [p. 360, 25–26]) As for the mathematicals, in his [= Plato's] opinion they are entities [that exist] between the forms (*ṣuwar*) and the material things.[66]	(A, 6, 987b14–16) Further, besides sensible things and Forms (εἴδη) he says there are the objects of mathematics, which occupy an intermediate position.[67]	(pp. 65, 14–66, 1) But they only disputed about the sensibles and the mathematical species (*anwāʿ taʿālīmiyyāt*), saying of the latter that they are intermediate between [the classes of existing] realities.[68]

It is evident from Table 2.1 that Avicenna's quotation conveys precisely the point that Aristotle is establishing—namely the intermediate character of mathematicals between Forms and sensibles—whereas Naẓīf's translation, at least in the form in which it is extant, reproduces this doctrine obscurely, in so far as it conflates mathematicals and Forms into the "mathematical species", and does not specify the identity of the realities to which the mathematical species are intermediate. Therefore, a dependence of Avicenna on Naẓīf's translation, at least in this case, appears unlikely. From the terminological

[66] fa-ammā l-taʿlīmiyyātu fa-innahā ʿindahū maʿānin bayna l-ṣuwari wa-l-māddiyyāti.

[67] ἔτι δὲ παρὰ τὰ αἰσθητὰ καὶ τὰ εἴδη τὰ μαθηματικὰ τῶν πραγμάτων εἶναί φησι μεταξύ.

[68] wa-innamā ʿānadū fī l-maḥsūsāti wa-l-anwāʿi l-taʿālīmiyyāti llatī yaqūlūna innahā mutawassiṭatun fīmā bayna l-umūri. I wish to thank Gerhard Endress for his help in the interpretation of this passage.

point of view, it is noteworthy that in Avicenna's quotation the Arabic term "form" (*ṣūra*, pl. *ṣuwar*) corresponds to the Greek term "form" or "species" (εἶδος, pl. εἴδη), whereas in Naẓīf's translation this latter is rendered as "species" (*nawʿ*, pl. *anwāʿ*). The significance of this aspect will soon become clear.

The partial evidence, provided by Avicenna, of the existence of a translation of A different from Naẓīf's is corroborated by al-Šahrastānī's *Kitāb al-milal wa-l-niḥal* (*Books of Religions and Arbitrary Creeds*). For this work contains, in the section dealing with Plato, an explicit and lengthy reference to book A of the *Metaphysics* (A, 6, 987a32–b10.18),[69] which does not correspond to Naẓīf's translation of A, as it is pointed out in the French translation of the second part of the *Milal*.[70] A comparison of the relevant passage of the *Milal* with the original text of the *Metaphysics* and Naẓīf's translation of A is provided in the following table. On close inspection, the quotation of *Metaphysics* A, 6, 987a32–b10.18, in the *Milal* appears to be followed by a reference to a passage of *Metaphysics* M, unnoticed so far, which is equally noteworthy.[71]

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[69] Al-Šahrastānī [1994], Second Part, p. 79, 5–12 (= Al-Šahrastānī [1842–6], p. 288; Al-Šahrastānī [1951–5], pp. 891–892); French transl. in Jolivet-Monnot [1993], p. 229 ("Aristote, dans le livre A de la *Métaphysique*, raconte que dans sa jeunesse Platon fréquenta Cratyle et en retint [la thèse] qu'on rapporte d'Héraclite: «toutes les choses se corrompent et la science ne peut les embrasser»; puis qu'il fréquenta après lui Socrate, dont la doctrine comportait la recherche des définitions mais non pas l'étude des natures des choses, sensibles et autres. Ainsi Platon crut que l'étude de Socrate [s'attachait] à d'autres choses que les sensibles, car les définitions ne concernent pas les sensibles puisqu'elles ne portent que sur des choses perpétuelles et universelles, je veux dire les genres et les espèces. Cela étant, Platon n'appela pas les choses universelles, des formes, parce que [ces choses] sont uniques, tout en pensant que les choses sensibles n'existent que parce qu'elles participent des formes, puisque les formes sont pour elles des épures et des modèles et leur sont antérieures"). The quotation of A that Bouyges [1952], p. cxciv (see Martini [2002], p. 97) has detected in Ṣadr al-Dīn Muḥammad al-Šīrāzī's (= Mullā Ṣadrā, d. 1640) *Al-Ḥikma al-mutaʿāliya fī l-asfār al-ʿaqliyya al-arbaʿa* (*Transcendent Wisdom on the Four Intellectual Journeys*) is almost *verbatim* identical to this passage of the *Milal* (see Mullā Ṣadrā [1981], vol. 6, pp. 218, 21–219, 7). For the dependence of Mullā Ṣadrā's *Al-Ḥikma al-mutaʿāliya* and other works of his on al-Šahrastānī's *Milal*, see Rudolph [1989], pp. 24, 26–32.

[70] See Jolivet-Monnot [1993], pp. 229–230, n. 34.

[71] Al-Šahrastānī [1994], p. 79, 5–12.

Table 2.2: Quotation of *Metaph.* A, 6, 987a32–b10.18 in Šahrastānī's *Milal*

Šahrastānī, *Milal*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Naẓīf's Arabic translation of *Metaphysics* A in Averroes' *Tafsīr*
[1] (p. 79, 5–6) Aristotle, in the treatise "A Major" of the book *Metaphysics*, reports that		
[2] (p. 79, 6–7) *Plato frequented Cratylus during his youth*, and wrote down at his dictation what he related from Heraclitus,	(A, 6, 987a32–33) For, *having in his youth first become familiar with Cratylus* and with the Heraclitean doctrines	(p. 63, 1–2) *The first thing that occurred after Democritus* were the views of the Heracliteans,
[3] (p. 79, 7) namely that all *the sensible things* are corruptible, and knowledge does not embrace them.	(987a33–34) (that *all sensible things* are ever in a state of flux and there is no knowledge about them),	(p. 63, 2) about the fact that *all the other things* have a constant flux, and there is no knowledge of them.
[4]	(987a34–b1) these views he held even in later years.	(p. 62, 3) He kept these views, in this way, for ever.
[5] (p. 79, 7–8) Then, after him, he frequented Socrates,		
[6] (p. 79, 8–9) whose doctrine was to seek definitions without investigating the nature of sensible and other things.	(987b1–4) Socrates, however, was busying himself about ethical matters and neglecting the world of nature as a whole but seeking the universal in these ethical matters, and fixed thought for the first time on definitions;	(p. 63, 3–4) Socrates discussed only ethical things, not something belonging to the universal nature . . . (lac.)
[7] (p. 79, 9) Plato thought that Socrates' investigation regarded *things other than the sensible ones*.	(987b4–6) Plato accepted his teaching, but held that the problem applied not to any sensible thing but to *entities of another kind*—	(p. 65, 6–7) [Plato] accepted that [doctrine], since he regarded the being of this after the model of the being of *permanent things*, whereas in sensible things there is nothing stable.

Table 2.2 (*cont.*)

Šahrastānī, *Milal*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Naẓīf's Arabic translation of *Metaphysics* A in Averroes' *Tafsīr*
[8] (p. 79, 9–11) For definitions do not belong to sensible things, since they apply to things that are lasting and universal, namely genera and species.	(987b6–7) for this reason, that the common definition could not be a definition of any sensible things, as they were always changing.	(p. 65, 7–8) It is also impossible that sensible things have a certain definition, which they share, since they are constantly in change.
[9] (p. 79, 11a) Therefore, [there was] Plato's calling the universal things "forms" (*ṣuwar*),[72]	(987b7–8) Things of this other sort, then, he called Ideas (ἰδέας),	(p. 65, 8–9) [Plato] called "forms" (*ṣuwar*) those [things], the same [i.e. unchangeable], that belong to the existents.[73]
[10] (p. 79, 11b) since *they are unique*,	(987b18) . . . while *the Form* (τὸ εἶδος) itself *is* in each case *unique*.	(p. 66, 3) *The species* (*al-nawʿ*) *is the same thing* that exists in each one.[74]
[11] (p. 79, 11–12a) and his thinking that the sensible things do not exist except by participation in the forms (*al-ṣuwar*).	(987b8–10) . . . and sensible things, he said, were apart from these, and were all called after these; for the multitude of things which have the same name as the Form (τοῖς εἴδεσιν) exist by participation in it [i.e. in the Form].	(p. 65, 9–11) As for all the sensibles, they are said in virtue of [the forms] and for the sake of them; the multiplicity that agrees in the name participates in the species (*al-nawʿ*).

[72] wa-ʿinda ḏālika <mā> sammā aflāṭūnu l-ašyāʾa l-kulliyyata ṣuwaran. The *lectio difficilior mā sammā* (in which *mā* is not a negative particle but a *mā māṣdariyya*) is adopted in Al-Šahrastānī [1842–6], attested by the majority of textual witnesses of Al-Šahrastānī [1951–5], and supported also by the MS. Yale University, Beinecke Library, Landberg Collection #615. It occurs also in Mullā Ṣadrā's version of al-Šahrastānī's quotation (Mullā Ṣadrā [1981], p. 219, 5), and is retained in the French translation of the *Milal* (Jolivet-Monnot [1993], p. 229, n. 34, where it is regarded, however, as a negative particle). I wish to thank Gerhard Endress for his help in the interpretation of this passage.

[73] wa-sammā allātī hiya li-l-mawǧūdāti wāḥidatun bi-ʿaynihā ṣuwaran. The Arabic corresponds *grosso modo* to the Greek (οὗτος οὖν τὰ μὲν τοιαῦτα τῶν ὄντων ἰδέας προσηγόρευσε), if we suppose a (mis)reading of τοιαῦτα as *τὰ αὐτά. I am indebted to Dimitri Gutas and Gerhard Endress for the interpretation of this passage.

[74] wa-l-nawʿu fa-huwa huwa l-šayʾu l-mawǧūdu li-kulli wāḥidin. Naẓīf appears to have (mis)read ἓν ἑκαστον in the Greek (τὸ δὲ εἶδος αὐτὸ ἓν ἕκαστον μόνον) as *ἐν ἑκάστῳ ("in each one", *li-kulli wāḥidin*).

Table 2.2 (*cont.*)

Šahrastānī, *Milal*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Naẓīf's Arabic translation of *Metaphysics* A in Averroes' *Tafsīr*
[12] (p. 79, 12b–13a) The forms, therefore, are drawings and models of them [i.e. of the sensible things], being anterior to them.		
[13] (p. 79, 13b–14) Socrates posited the definitions only in absolute terms, without considering the sensible and the non-sensible; Plato, on the contrary, believed that he had assigned them to the non-sensible, and therefore he established them as common models.	(M, 4, 1078b30–32) But Socrates did not make the universals or the definitions exist apart; his successors, however, gave them separate existence, and this was the kind of thing they called Ideas.	

Four aspects of Table 2.2 are noteworthy. First, sections [2], [3], [7] and [10] of al-Šahrastānī's quotation are remarkably closer to Aristotle's original text than Naẓīf's translation is (the relevant sentences in this regard are underlined in the table). Second, in section [11] of al-Šahrastānī's quotation the Arabic term "form" (*ṣūra*, pl. *ṣuwar*) corresponds to "form" or "species" (εἶδος), that Naẓīf renders by means of another Arabic word, i.e. "species" (*nawʿ*, pl. *anwāʿ*).[75] Third, the quotation of line 987b18 in section [10] precedes, instead of following, the quotation of lines 987b8–10 in section [11]. Fourth, the quotation of A, 6, 987a32–b10.18, in sections [1]–[11] is followed by a quotation of M, 4, 1078b30–32, in section [13]. The first aspect (greater similarity to the Greek original) shows clearly that al-Šahrastānī's quotation does not depend on Naẓīf's translation. The

[75] Naẓīf's use of *nawʿ* to translate εἶδος is confirmed by section [10]. In section [9], both the translation used by al-Šahrastānī and Naẓīf render with *ṣūra* the Greek term "idea" (ἰδέα).

second aspect (rendering of εἶδος as *ṣūra*) is a terminological feature that we have already noticed in Avicenna's quotation of A (see above, Table 2.1). The significance of the third and the fourth aspect (the restructuring of the original text, and the connection between the quotation of A and a quotation of M) has to be properly evaluated, since it entails some kind of intervention by al-Šahrastānī (or his source) on the original text. These two features, as we have seen, were also typical of Avicenna's approach to A.

It is evident that some kind of textual knowledge of book A, not deriving from Naẓīf's translation of this book, was accessible to al-Šahrastānī. It is difficult, however, to determine the source of this knowledge, i.e. to assess whether the text he quotes was taken from an overall translation of book A that he had at his disposal, or rather circulated autonomously in some kind of intermediate source on account of its doxographical or biographical interest. The other quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Milal* provide contrasting indications in this regard, since they are both direct and indirect.[76]

While the evidence provided by Avicenna and al-Šahrastānī is not conclusive when treated individually, considered jointly it points toward the existence of a second Arabic translation of A besides Naẓīf's. There are basically two reasons for this assumption. First, Avicenna, on the one hand, and al-Šahrastānī, on the other, refer to *distinct* passages of A independently of Naẓīf's translation. Second, they refer to the key-concept of the texts they are quoting (Platonic "forms" or "species") by means of a term that is not only different from the one used by Naẓīf, but is also *the same* in both of them. Despite the fact that the texts taken into account in Tables 2.1 and 2.2 regard a single chapter of A (A, 6), and that the similarity in terminology between Avicenna and al-Šahrastānī can be tested only

[76] The quotation of Λ, 6, 1071b3–5, in Al-Šahrastānī [1994], p. 103, 5–7 (qāla fī kitābi uṯūlūǧiyā min ḥarfi l-lāmi inna al-ǧawhara yuqālu ʿalā ṯalāṯati aḍrābin iṯnāni ṭabīʿiyyāni wa-wāḥidun ġayru mutaḥarrikin; "Aristote dit, dans le livre de la *Théologie*, à la lettre Lambda: «substance se dit de trois sortes [d'êtres], deux naturelles et une immobile», Jolivet-Monnot [1993], p. 283, nn. 2–3), is taken *verbatim* from the anonymous paraphrase of Λ (Aristotle [1947], p. 3, 4–5; cp. *Tafsīr*, vol. III, pp. 1555, 9–1556, 1; pp. 1555, 1–1556, 1 at the bottom of page). The reworking of Λ, 6, 1071b12–20, immediately following (p. 103, 7–17), appears to be based on the same paraphrase (see Jolivet-Monnot [1993], p. 283, n. 6). A further quotation of Λ Jolivet-Monnot [1993], p. 132, 3–5) is indirect, being taken from Themistius' commentary on Λ.

in the case of a single word, these two features appear to imply the existence of a larger and common source which these two authors are quoting. On account of this evidence, therefore, I tentatively assume that Avicenna's quotation of A, 6, 987b14–16, and al-Šahrastānī's quotation of A, 6, 987a32–b10.18, depend on one and the same source, namely a translation of A which was different from—and closer to the Greek than—Naẓīf's, and in which εἶδος was rendered as *ṣūra*. Future research will corroborate, I hope, this provisional hypothesis.

If we regard the better rendering of the original text as a sign of improvement and, consequently, of later composition, we can imagine that this supposed second translation of A was later than Naẓīf's. In this case, it would have been accomplished sometime between the second half of the X century (when Naẓīf was active) and 1020–1027 (the probable date of composition of the *Šifāʾ*). But its language and terminology might indicate also an earlier date of composition.[77]

ʿAbd al-Laṭīf al-Baġdādī's *Kitāb fī ʿIlm mā baʿd al-ṭabīʿa (Book on the Science of Metaphysics)* contains, in chapters 1–16, a summary of books α and A (intermingled) and B-Λ of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*.[78] The relation of ʿAbd al-Laṭīf's compendium with the extant Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* has still to be ascertained.[79] As for book A, according to Angelika Neuwirth's analysis, ʿAbd al-Laṭīf refers to scattered passages of the book (from its beginning until the very first lines of chapter 9). ʿAbd al-Laṭīf's compendium and the extant translation of A by Naẓīf, however, cannot be compared, since the two overlap only in two brief passages (A, 8, 989b29–32; A, 9, 990a34–b1), and in both cases ʿAbd al-Laṭīf refers to Aristotle's text quite vaguely.[80]

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[77] In early translations, like those by Ibn al-Biṭrīq, *ṣūra* is employed indiscriminately for εἶδος and ἰδέα, as it happens in the translation of A used by al-Šahrastānī (see above, Table 2.2, [9], [11]; I owe this information to Gerhard Endress). We cannot either exclude, of course, the possibility that this translation and the one by Naẓīf are coeval and independent from each other.

[78] The edition of chapters 1 (books A and α) and 13–16 (book Λ) is available in Neuwirth [1977–8], and Neuwirth [1976] (see the latter's review by Gutas [1980]). On ʿAbd al-Laṭīf's reception of book A, see Martini [2003], pp. 93–97.

[79] ". . . das genaue Abhängigkeitsverhältnis zu den einzelnen arabischen Versionen der verschiedenen Metaphysik-Bücher noch im einzelnen zu untersuchen ist", Neuwirth [1977–8], p. 92.

[80] Also the second reference ("Likewise, who postulates the models which are known as Platonic forms [*suwar*] . . ."), which Neuwirth includes between square brackets designating, in her notation system, the "faithful paraphrases" ("getreue

The passages of A quoted by Avicenna and al-Šahrastānī are not taken into account in ʿAbd al-Laṭīf's compendium. What we can conclude from the inspection of ʿAbd al-Laṭīf's compendium, therefore, is that the translation of A he was using (either Naẓīf's or another one) was an integral version of this book.[81]

The indirect tradition of book A in Arabic witnesses the progressive assimilation of this book. Absent in Usṭāṯ's translation, referred to indirectly by al-Kindī and probably unknown to al-Fārābī, from the second half of the X century it was translated at least once (by Naẓīf), possibly also a second time. In this way, it was mentioned by Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī (X c.), quoted by Avicenna (XI c.) and al-Ṣahrastānī (XII c.), and extensively paraphrased by ʿAbd al-Laṭīf al-Baġdādī (XIII c.).

4 The Available Data and their Interpretation

The data presented in the previous sections can be now arranged in chronological order in the following table:

Table 3: Overall conspectus of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*

books	translations								
	Usṭāṯ (IXc.)	Šamlī (IXc.)	Isḥāq (d.910)	Mattā (d.940)	Yaḥyā (d.974)	in Yaḥyā	Naẓīf (2nd half Xc.)	ʿĪsā (d.1008)	in Avicenna (d. 1037) and Šahrastānī (d. 1153) [?]
A							e		f
α	e		e						
B	e		Avic.?			Sy.: a			
Γ	e		f?						
Δ	e		Avic.?						
E	e								
Z	e								
H	e								
Θ	e		f?						

Paraphrasen", p. 93), is, in fact, only very loosely related to the passage of A that Neuwirth associates with it.

[81] An Arabic version of A, 1 is also attested by the Latin translation of this chapter that is preserved in the Ms. Bibl. Apostolica Vaticana, Ott. Lat. 2048; Martini [2001] has shown that this translation was made from Arabic.

Table 3 (*cont.*)

books	translations								
	Usṭāṯ (IXc.)	Šamlī (IXc.)	Isḥāq (d.910)	Mattā (d.940)	Yaḥyā (d.974)	in Yaḥyā	Naẓīf (2nd half Xc.)	ʿĪsā (d.1008)	in Avicenna (d. 1037) and Šahrastānī (d. 1153) [?]
I	e		f?						
K	a								
Λ	e	f?	f?	Al.: e Th.: a	f				
M	a				a			a	
N							a		

legenda:
a = attested
e = extant
f = fragments
Al. = with Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary
Avic. = quoted by Avicenna
Sy. = with Syrianus' commentary
Th. = with Themistius' commentary

The two most salient features of the translation activity regarding Aristotle's *Metaphysics* emerging from Table 3 are, first, the high number of translations of this work, and, second, the long period of time during which they were accomplished. As for the first point, the available sources inform us of seven, possibly eight, distinct scholars, with different philosophical backgrounds and affiliations, who engaged in rendering (larger or smaller) portions of the *Metaphysics* into Arabic. Few other Greek philosophical works have been translated into Arabic so many times and by so many authors. As for the second point, the translation activity regarding the *Metaphysics* lasted for two centuries: translations started in the IX century (Usṭāṯ) and ceased—as far as we know—around the end of the X (ʿĪsā). Also in this regard the *Metaphysics* represents a prime case in the Graeco-Arabic translation movement. In other words, the *Metaphysics* was repeatedly translated into Arabic during the last two of the three centuries of the Graeco-Arabic translation movement (VIII–X cc.). All this attests to the great and persistent importance of this work in the Arab world.

In a diachronic perspective, the translation activity related to the *Metaphysics* can be divided into three distinct phases. The first phase

encompasses the first three translations (by Usṭāṯ, Šamlī and Isḥāq). It is marked by the rendering of the main bulk of the work (the two most extensive translations, by Usṭāṯ and Isḥāq, belong to this initial period), and by the focus on book Λ (probably all three translators rendered this book into Arabic, and one of them—Šamlī—translated it independently of the rest of the work). The second phase comprehends the four subsequent translations (two by Mattā, one by Yaḥyā, one known to Yaḥyā). It is characterized by new versions of certain previously translated books of the *Metaphysics*, in so far as they are integral parts, or useful complements, of some Greek commentaries thereupon. Thus book Λ is translated twice by Mattā together with the commentaries, respectively, by Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius, and the translation of book B together with Syrianus' commentary is reportedly known to Yaḥyā. The importance still assigned to book Λ is witnessed, besides Mattā's translations, by Yaḥyā's version of this book together with the following one (M). The third phase, finally, encompasses the last three translations (those by Naẓīf and ʿĪsā, and the one witnessed by Avicenna and Šahrastānī). Its main feature is the rendering into Arabic of the books of the *Metaphysics* that were still untranslated, i.e. of book A (by Naẓīf and in Avicenna/Šahrastānī) and book N (by Naẓīf). Among the already translated books, the focus gradually shifts from Λ to M, as the independent translation of this latter by ʿĪsā seems to attest.

The three phases just outlined reflect, roughly speaking, three different approaches to the *Metaphysics*: (i) the transmission of the work on a large scale (first phase); (ii) the closer inspection and deeper analysis of some of its known parts (second phase); (iii) the shift of attention towards the parts still unknown (third phase). In general terms, it is as though, after the initial period of "exposition" to most of the *Metaphysics* (first phase), Arab philosophers focused on what they regarded as its most important portion, i.e. book Λ (second phase); then, once the "core" of the *Metaphysics* was discovered, and the importance of the work in its entirety fully appreciated, the need was felt to fill in the gaps, i.e. to translate the parts of the Greek original still missing in Arabic (third phase). This process is not very different from our ordinary way of reading a book with which we are unfamiliar: first, we glance over its chapters; then, we discover something deep or original in some of its part, and regard the book as worthy to be read; finally, we go back to it and read carefully what we have overlooked before. It has to be noticed, however, that

the limits between the aforementioned three phases of the Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics* are—as it should be expected—fluid: each phase both prepares and somehow continues in the following. Thus, Šamlī's translation of book Λ in the first phase anticipates the big amount of philological effort directed towards this book in the second phase. Likewise, Yaḥyā's translation of book M in the second phase is in continuity with ʿĪsā's version of this same book in the third phase.[82]

The first two phases mirror two significant stages of the history of early Arabic philosophy, for they are linked, respectively, with two of the most important schools of the Arabic *falsafa*. The first phase can be associated with the circle of al-Kindī, to which the main translator of this phase (Usṭāṯ) belonged. The theological emphasis typical of al-Kindī's approach to the *Metaphysics* is congruent with the focus on book Λ which we have seen to mark this initial phase. The entire second phase, on the other hand, is the expression of the group of Aristotelian scholars working in Baġdād, whose first master (Mattā) and most significant exponent (Yaḥyā) were the two translators of this phase. The kind of exegesis of Aristotle's *corpus* inspired by the Peripatetic tradition, typical of the Baġdādī school, is evident in the translations of the commentaries on the *Metaphysics* by Alexander of Aphrodisias, Themistius and Syrianus, that Mattā and Yaḥyā joined to their Arabic version of the corresponding books of Aristotle's work. The diachronic overview of the Arabic translations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, therefore, sheds further light on the history of Arabic philosophy, in so far as it is the reflex of the different trends and sensibilities that were at work in the Arab philosophical *milieu* when these translations were accomplished.

From a synchronic point of view, the core of the translation activity concerning the *Metaphysics* is constituted by book Λ, i.e. by Aristotle's

[82] In the Arabic translation of Paul the Persian's essay on the classification of the parts of Aristotle's philosophy, preserved in Ibn Miskawayh's *Tartīb al-saʿādāt* and tentatively ascribed by D. Gutas to Abū-Bišr Mattā b. Yūnus, we find the following statement that Gutas regards as a comment by the translator: "Some of the books of the *Metaphysics* were [= have been] translated into Arabic, others were not" (Ibn Miskawayh [1917], p. 69, 16; see Gutas [1983], pp. 231–267, p. 235). If Gutas' hypothesis about the identity of the translator of Paul the Persian's treatise is correct, the initiator of the second phase of translations of the *Metaphysics* (Mattā) was well aware that the Arabic *Metaphysics* was incomplete, and somehow prefigured the direction that the next phase of translations would have taken.

natural theology. According to our sources, this book was translated into Arabic six times (by Usṭāṯ, Isḥāq, Šamlī, Yaḥyā and—possibly twice—by Mattā). Two Greek commentaries (by Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius) on this book were translated as well (by Mattā). Both the first and the second phase of the translation process, as we have seen, are centered around Λ. But also the third phase is somehow related to Λ, in so far as it focuses on books like M and N, which are the continuation and the complement of Λ.[83] It is thus clear that all the translation activity concerning Aristotle's *Metaphysics* was motivated by a strong theological interest. This is not surprising, in the light of the theological motivations lying behind the Arabic translations of other parts of the Aristotelian corpus, like the *Topics* and the *Physics*, as D. Gutas has well documented.[84] In more general terms, in the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* can be detected, at its germinal stage, one of the main features of the Arab metaphysical speculation, namely the emphasis on, and the expansion of, the theological side of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. This privileged attention to natural theology within metaphysics characterizes, in different respects, the metaphysical *oeuvre* of al-Kindī, al-Fārābī and Avicenna.

The second most important book of the *Metaphysics*, after Λ, is apparently M, of which three translations, one in each of the three phases of the process outlined above, are attested (by Usṭāṯ, Yaḥyā and ʿĪsā). Since book M is entirely devoted to the exposition and criticism of the doctrine of the ideas and of other tenets of Plato's philosophy, the translations of this book necessarily conveyed a better knowledge both of Plato's philosophy in itself and of Aristotle's polemical attitude towards it. The implications of this fact are two. First, the Arabic translations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* ought to be included among the textual sources by means of which Plato was known in the Medieval Arab world.[85] Second, the anti-Platonic bias that Aristotle displays, *inter alia*, in *Metaphysics* M calls into question the originally Porphyrian and later Farabian idea of the harmony

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[83] The importance of Λ is also attested by the circulation of an anonymous paraphrase of this book (see above, §2).

[84] Gutas [1998], chapter 3.

[85] A statement like "The Plato to whom al-Fārābī . . . Ibn Sīnā, Ibn Bādjdja and Ibn Rushd refer is, whether explicitly or implicitly, always the Plato of Plotinus and his followers" (Walzer [1960], p. 234b) requires qualifications: at least in Avicenna's case, he is also the Plato of Aristotle.

and complementarity of Plato's and Aristotle's philosophies. The translation movement regarding the *Metaphysics*—some of whose aspects have occasionally been interpreted in the light of such a "concordistic" view[86]—appears to be alien to this idea and, on the contrary, to operate against it. Whether the translations of the *Metaphysics* simply prevented this idea from spreading, or might have fostered it, by making the contrast between Plato and Aristotle striking and a conciliation of it even more desirable, is a question worth further investigation. In any case, a new scenario on the reception of Plato's philosophy in the Arab world, and on the relationship between his philosophy and its Aristotelian counterpart, emerges from the study of the Arabic translations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Future research will hopefully elucidate this topic in greater detail.

By reflecting the succession of different philosophical schools, pointing at some basic features of the Arab metaphysical thought, and opening new perspectives on the Plato Arabus, the Arabic translations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* are a significant event not only in the context of the translation movement from Greek into Arabic, but also as a chapter of the early history of Arabic philosophy.

[86] See above, n. 18. We may wonder, though, whether the idea of an inner congruence between the philosophy of Plato and that of Aristotle can account, if not for the original extent, at least for the subsequent reception of the translations, i.e. for the actual loss, or the incomplete transmission, of the versions of those books (A, M and N) in which Aristotle more openly criticizes Plato.

CHAPTER TWO

BEYOND AL-KINDĪ AND AL-FĀRĀBĪ: AVICENNA'S POSITION IN THE HISTORY OF THE ARAB RECEPTION OF THE *METAPHYSICS**

Avicenna's autobiography can rightly be called an "amazing text".[1] It is difficult to overemphasize the importance and interest of this work, which portrays, in general, Avicenna's life from his birth (ca. 370/980) until his encounter (ca. 404/1014) with the disciple Abū-ʿUbayd ʿAbd-al-Wāḥid al-Ǧūzǧānī, with particular attention to his elementary instruction and subsequent philosophical training (from about the age of 6 until the age of 18). The autobiography ends with the description of the circumstances surrounding the genesis of Avicenna's first philosophical writings, and with his departure from Buḫārā and arrival, after many peregrinations, to Ǧurǧān, where he met al-Ǧūzǧānī. Al-Ǧūzǧānī undertook the editing of the autobiography (either from dictation or from an original draft by Avicenna) sometime between 418/1027 and 421/1030,[2] and added to it, after Avicenna's death (428/1037), the account of the rest of the master's life and works, namely the biography. The autobiography and the biography represent, therefore, two parts of the same textual unit, which has been called the "autobiography/biography complex".[3]

Avicenna's education, as portrayed in the autobiography, can be divided into four stages. For the sake of brevity, I call them, respectively, "elementary", "secondary", "undergraduate" and "graduate education",

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* This chapter is a revised version of Bertolacci [2001].

[1] The expression is by Gutas [1988], p. 22. The autobiography has been edited by W. E. Gohlman (Avicenna [1974b]; see the review by Ullmann [1975], and the observations in Gutas [1988], p. 22, n. a) and extensively investigated by Gutas [1988], pp. 22–30, 149–198. For a survey of other editions, translations and studies, see Janssens [1991], pp. 41–43; Janssens [1999], pp. 22–23; Daiber [1999], vol. II, pp. 269–270.

[2] Gutas [1988], p. 145, pp. 194–198. Marmura [1991], p. 336, rejects the dating of the autobiography proposed by Gutas, and asserts that "the date of its writing remains uncertain". The question of chronology does not affect the interpretation of the autobiography I propose in the present chapter.

[3] Gutas [1987]. On Avicenna's life, as it can be reconstructed on the basis of the autobiography and al-Ǧūzǧānī's biography, see Bertolacci [2005].

adopting D. Gutas' identification of these stages with the modern Western curriculum of studies.[4] Avicenna's secondary, undergraduate and graduate education proceeded according to the Aristotelian curriculum, and consisted, in each phase, of the study of logic, mathematics, physics and metaphysics. Two explicit mentions of metaphysics as a discipline (*ʿilm ilāhī* or *ilāhiyyāt*) occur in the autobiography, the one in the description of the secondary education, the other in the account of the undergraduate education. Metaphysics had a role also in Avicenna's graduate education, but it is not explicitly referred to in that context. The first mention of metaphysics is very brief (it occupies two lines of the edition) and has received scarce attention. The second mention, instead, constitutes the well-known anecdote, in which Avicenna relates his problems in understanding Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (*Kītāb Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*) and his fortuitous—almost providential—encounter with a treatise by al-Fārābī dealing with this work, which clarified to him the issue.

My aim in this chapter is to emphasize the significance of the first mention of metaphysics in Avicenna's autobiography, despite its brevity. As we shall see, it attests to the fact that Avicenna, during his secondary studies, did not read Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in its entirety, but, rather, knew only the essential parts of it (roughly speaking, its philosophical theology, as represented by books α and Λ) and consulted some commentaries on these parts (surely Themistius' paraphrase of Λ, possibly also Alexander of Aphrodisias' reworking or commentary of this book). Later on, during his undergraduate education, he faced the entire *Metaphysics* and was puzzled by the extent and complexity of the work. In other words, on closer inspection we detect in the autobiography an evolution in Avicenna's knowledge of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Doctrinally, this evolution reflects the twofold nature of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, which is both a philosophical theology (an account of the First Being as primary cause, or *metaphysica specialis*), and an ontology (a theory of being-qua-being, or *metaphysica generalis*).[5] Historically, it portrays Avicenna's passage from al-Kindī's way of reading Aristotle's work, with its one-sided emphasis on the theological part of the *Metaphysics* as represented by books α and Λ, to al-Fārābī's approach, where both components—theologi-

[4] Gutas [1988], pp. 152–154.
[5] See Chapter 4.

cal and ontological—of the *Metaphysics* and all the books of this work are taken into due account. The significance of this process, in either respect, does not need to be stressed.

The present chapter consists of seven sections. In the first, the analysis of the first mention of metaphysics in Avicenna's autobiography shows that Avicenna at this early stage did not read the entire text of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, but only its "essential parts" (*fuṣūṣ*). In the following two sections (§§2–3), two additional pieces of evidence in favor of this thesis (taken, respectively, from the second mention of metaphysics in the autobiography, and from a passage of Avicenna's *Letter to Kīyā*) are adduced. The fourth section is devoted to establishing the identity of such essential parts of the *Metaphysics*: they are, in all likelihood, chapters 1–2 of book α and chapters 6–10 of book Λ. The commentaries on the *Metaphysics* that Avicenna, according to the first mention of metaphysics in the autobiography, read during his secondary education—i.e. the exegesis of Λ by Themistius and, possibly, by Alexander of Aphrodisias—confirm the presence of Λ, 6–10 among the essential parts of the *Metaphysics* (§5). In the sixth section, the way in which Avicenna connected α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 at the time of his secondary studies is described. The seventh section, finally, provides a sketch of Avicenna's evolving knowledge of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* during his philosophical education.

1 The first mention of metaphysics in the autobiography

The first mention of metaphysics in Avicenna's autobiography, the one occurring in the context of his secondary education, is very brief. It occurs between the detailed description of his first acquaintance with jurisprudence (under the guidance of Ismāʿīl al-Zāhid) and the first two theoretical disciplines (logic and mathematics, under the guidance of Abū-ʿAbdallāh al-Nātilī), on the one hand,[6] and his subsequent study and practice of medicine and jurisprudence, on the other.[7] The two remaining theoretical disciplines, namely natural philosophy and metaphysics, are the object of the following short remark:

[6] Avicenna [1974b], pp. 20, 4–24, 4.
[7] Avicenna [1974b], pp. 24, 7–26, 4.

Text 1: Autobiography, p. 24, 4–7

Then al-Nātilī took leave of me, heading for Gurgānǧ, and I occupied myself on my own with determining the validity of books (*kutub*), both essential parts (*fuṣūṣ*) and commentaries (*šurūḥ*), on natural things and divine things (*ilāhiyyāt*), and the gates of knowledge began opening for me.[8]

As the second mention of metaphysics in the autobiography will clarify, the "books" (*kutub*) referred to in Text 1 without any further qualification are mainly, if not exclusively, Aristotle's books (in our case his writings on natural philosophy and the *Metaphysics*).[9] In Text 1, the object of metaphysics is called *ilāhiyyāt* ("divine things"): even though this is one of the names of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in the earlier Arabic tradition,[10] by means of the cognate expression *ʿilm ilāhī*—which occurs in the second mention of metaphysics in the autobiography—Avicenna refers sometimes to the theological part of metaphysics in particular.[11] In the light of what will emerge from §6 below, it might not be accidental that Avicenna in Text 1 refers to metaphysics through a term that he uses on occasion to express the theological portion of this discipline.

The most important and controversial aspect of Text 1 is the occurrence in it of the term *fuṣūṣ* in connection with *šurūḥ* ("commentaries").[12] I reject the usual translation of this term ("texts"), and I propose a new one ("essential parts"). Almost all the modern translations of the autobiography, which are based either on Gohlman's edition or on one of its sources, have rendered *fuṣūṣ* as "texts";[13]

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[8] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 27 (slightly modified). As Gutas [1988], p. 27, n. j, notices, *šurūʿ* in the edited text is a misprint for *šurūḥ*.

[9] See below, §2. We cannot *a priori* exclude that the *Theologia Aristotelis* (the Arabic paraphrase of Plotinus' *Enneads* IV–VI) was one of the metaphysical books Avicenna read during his secondary education and in the subsequent stages of his philosophical training, especially in the light of the importance he attached later to this writing (see below, §3). In the autobiography, however, there is no mention or allusion to the *Theologia* or other pseudo-Aristotelian writings dealing with metaphysics and stemming from the Neoplatonic tradition.

[10] See Appendix D, I.5.

[11] See Appendix D, III.i.2.

[12] For the translation of *šarḥ* as "commentary", see Gutas [1993], pp. 33–35.

[13] See Kraus [1932], p. 1881b (translation based on Ibn-Abī-Uṣaybiʿa's *ʿUyūn al-anbāʾ fī ṭabaqāt al-aṭibbāʾ*): "Danach verließ mich Nātilī und ging nach Kurkānağ. Ich aber beschäftigte mich damit, mit die Bücher über Physik und Metaphysik in Texten und Kommentaren anzueignen. Dabei öffneten sich mir die Tore der Wissenschaft"; Arberry [1979], p. 10 (translation based on Ibn-al-Qifṭī's *Taʾrīḫ al-ḥukamāʾ* and Ibn-Abī-Uṣaybiʿa's *ʿUyūn al-anbāʾ fī ṭabaqāt al-aṭibbāʾ*): "Then al-Nātilī

they appear to have treated *fuṣūṣ* as if it were *nuṣūṣ* (which indeed means "texts"), on account of the close similarity between these two terms, joined to the fact that the presence of the term *šurūḥ* (commentaries) in Text 1 implies the existence of some texts to be commented upon. But the possibility of substituting *nuṣūṣ* for *fuṣūṣ* is excluded, since the reading *fuṣūṣ* is unanimously transmitted by all the witnesses Gohlman takes into account in his critical edition of Avicenna's autobiography,[14] and is also attested in some retellings of

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took leave of me, setting out for Gurganj. I now occupied myself with mastering the various texts and commentaries on natural science and metaphysics, until all the gates of knowledge were open to me"; Gohlman's translation in Avicenna [1974b], p. 25: "Then al-Nātilī left me, going on to Gurgānj. I devoted myself to studying the texts—the original and commentaries—in the natural sciences and metaphysics"; Gutas [1988], p. 27 (translation based on Gohlman's edition): "Then al-Nātilī took leave of me, heading for Gurgānğ, and I occupied myself on my own with Determining the Validity of books, both original texts and commentaries, on Physics and Metaphysics"; Cruz Hernández [1997], p. 25 (translation based on Gohlman's edition): "Más tarde, el-Nātalī me dejó, marchando a Gorgānğ, dedicándome a comprobar por mí mismo la validez de los libros de *Física* y *Metafísica*, tanto las obras originales come los commentarios". The only exception to the rendering of *fuṣūṣ* as "texts" in Text 1 is represented by the French translation by M. Achena and H. Massé, based on Ibn-al-Qifṭī's *Ta'rīḫ al-ḥukamā'*: "Ensuite, Nātili me quitta, s'en allant à Gorgāndj. Quant à moi, je m'appliquai à lire et à étudier les *Foçouç-al'hikam* (de Fârâbi) et d'autres commentaires sur la physique et la métaphysique; et de jour en jour, les portes de la science s'ouvraient devant moi", in Achena-Massé [1955–8], p. 7. In this translation *fuṣūṣ* is not taken as a generic term, but rather as the title of a specific work, namely the *Fuṣūṣ al-ḥikma*, which—according to a title slightly different and the traditional view about its autorship (see below, n. 38)—Achena and Massé call *Fuṣūṣ al-Ḥikam* and ascribe to al-Fārābī. This interpretation is implausible, since the term *fuṣūṣ* in Text 1 is tightly joined with the term *šurūḥ*, which obviously is not a title. Achena and Massé's translation, albeit incorrect, points, however, in the right direction. Also in the Russian translation of Avicenna's Autobiography (Ibn Sīnā, *Izbrannye filosofskie proizvedenija* [Selected Philosophical Works], Nauka, Moscow, 1980, p. 524, n. 26) the term *fuṣūṣ*, rather than *nuṣūṣ*, in Ibn-al-Qifṭī's *Ta'rīḫ al-ḥukamā'* is noticed and rendered as "sections" (I owe this information to Alexander Treiger).

[14] The autobiography/biography complex exists in at least two recensions (see Gutas [1987], p. 67). One is preserved in Ibn-al-Qifṭī's *Ta'rīḫ al-ḥukamā'* (= Q in Gohlman's edition) and in Ibn-Abī-Uṣaybiʿa's (d. 1270) *ʿUyūn al-anbā' fī ṭabaqāt al-aṭibbā'* (= IAU). The other is transmitted by several manuscripts, among which Gohlman selects: Istanbul, Aya Sofya 4852 (= A), Istanbul, Üniversite 4755 (= B), Istanbul, Ahmet III 3447 (= J), and the version of the autobiography/biography written by Yaḥyā ibn-Aḥmad al-Kāšī (d. after 754/1353) in the margin of a manuscript of al-Šahrazūrī's (13th c.) *Nuzhat al-arwāḥ* (= N). For Text 1 in Q, IAU, B and N, see, respectively, Ibn al-Qifṭī [1903], p. 414, 16–18; Ibn-Abī-Uṣaybiʿa [1882–4], vol. 2, p. 3, 11–12; Avicenna [1952c], p. 2, 15–17; Avicenna [1952d], p. 12, 1–3. As far as Text 1 is concerned, the only difference between the two recensions is given by the singular masculine *mina l-ṭabīʿiyyi wa l-ilāhiyyi* in Q and IAU, instead of the plural feminine *mina l-ṭabīʿiyyāti wa l-ilāhiyyāti* (accepted by Gohlman) in A, B, J and N.

al-Ǧūzǧānī's edition of the autobiography/biography;[15] the *lectio facilior nuṣūṣ* ("texts") appears only in some derivatives of these retellings.[16] Also the supposed connection between *šurūḥ* and *nuṣūṣ* in Text 1 is far from being necessary: had Avicenna simply intended to refer to the texts of natural philosophy and metaphysics and to the commentaries thereupon, he would have not needed to mention the *nuṣūṣ* beside the *kutub*, since this latter term would have sufficed to convey the meaning of "texts".[17]

For these reasons, I keep the term *fuṣūṣ* in Text 1, and translate it not as "texts", but as "essential parts". The Arabic lexicographical tradition records such a meaning,[18] and the rest of Text 1, espe-

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[15] See Ẓahīr-al-dīn Abū-l-Ḥasan al-Bayhaqī (d. 565/1169–1170), *Tatimmat Ṣiwān al-ḥikma*, al-Bayhaqī [1939], p. 40, 7–11. In the less reliable edition of this same work, under a different title, by M. Kurd ʿAlī (al-Bayhaqī [1946]), the reading *nuṣūṣ* is accepted without indication of any variant. Also in the Persian translation of Bayhaqī's *Tatimma*, edited by M. Šafīʿ together with the Arabic original, *fuṣūṣ* is found (al-Bayhaqī [1939], p. 30, 13; I owe this information to D. C. Reisman).

[16] See Šams-al-Dīn Muḥammad b. Muḥammad al-Šahrazūrī (13th c.), *Nuzhat al-arwāḥ wa-rawḍat al-afrāḥ*, Al-Šahrazūrī [1993], p. 589, 5–7. In the introduction to his edition of Avicenna's *Išārāt* (Avicenna [1957–60], p. 127), S. Dunyā corrects *fuṣūṣ* in Text 1 (which he reads in IAU) in *nuṣūṣ* (I owe this information to one of the two anonymous reviewers of Bertolacci [2001]). The possibility of regarding *fuṣūṣ* as a corruption of *nuṣūṣ* appears, however, unlikely, since both the primary and the secondary witnesses of the autobiography agree on it.

[17] In another passage of the autobiography (the description of Avicenna's study of logic and mathematics during his secondary education, immediately before Text 1) Avicenna speaks of texts and commentaries, without using the term *nuṣūṣ*: Avicenna states there that he read, as far as logic is concerned, the "book (*kitāb*) of the *Isagoge*" (namely Porphyry's introduction to Aristotle's *Categories*, p. 20, 7) and the "books (*kutub*)" without further qualification (that is Aristotle's *Organon*, p. 22, 6; cp. Gutas [1988], p. 26); as to mathematics, he read "Euclid's book (*kitāb*)" (i.e. the *Elements*, p. 22, 7) and Ptolemy's *Almagest* (p. 24, 1). The works of logic and mathematics mentioned in this passage are clearly the *texts* that Avicenna consulted. But they are called *kutub*, not *nuṣūṣ*. The case of Aristotle's *Organon* is particularly significant, since in this case Avicenna says that he read not only the "books" but also the "commentaries" (*šurūḥ*, p. 22, 6); the denomination *kutub*, however, is preserved even in this case.

[18] According to this tradition, among the literal meanings of *faṣṣ* (the singular of *fuṣūṣ*), the main one is the "stone or gem or what is set in a ring or a signet" (Lane [1863–93], vol. I, 6, p. 2403a–b). Abū-l-Qāsim Maḥmūd b. ʿUmar al-Zamaḫšarī (d. 538/1144) in the *Asās al-balāġa* (Al-Zamaḫšarī [1998], p. 619b) and Abū-l-Fayḍ Muḥammad Murtaḍā al-Zabīdī (d. 1205/1791) in the *Tāǧ al-ʿarūs min jawāhir al-qāmūs* (Al-Zabīdī [1979], p. 73a) record, in the context of the metaphorical meanings of this term, the sentence *qara'tu fī faṣṣi l-kitābi kaḏā*, which E. W. Lane translates as "I read, in the most essential part of the book or writing, such a thing". Al-Zamaḫšarī, in connection with this sentence, reports an expression in which *fuṣūṣ* occurs, namely *fuṣūṣ al-aḫbār* ("The most essential parts or particulars of narrations",

cially the mention of the "commentaries" (*šurūḥ*), does not exclude it: the term *šurūḥ* presupposes, of course, the existence of some writings commented upon, but these writings are not necessarily "texts" in the sense of *integral* texts; they can also be "essential parts", in the sense of *partial* texts. The scope of the commentaries themselves, in this case, will be narrower; as we will see in §5, the commentaries Avicenna consulted during his secondary education, had exactly this character. Two further decisive reasons can be invoked in support of the translation of *fuṣūṣ* as "essential parts": first, a reading of the "essential parts" of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* during Avicenna's secondary education is implied by the second mention of metaphysics in the autobiography (§2); second, this same term *fuṣūṣ*, in the sense of "essential parts", occurs elsewhere in Avicenna's works (§3).

2 The second mention of metaphysics in the autobiography

If my hypothesis about the *fuṣūṣ* in Text 1 is correct, Avicenna's approach to logic and mathematics, on the one hand, and natural philosophy and metaphysics, on the other, at the time of his secondary education, was not the same. In the former case, he read the texts (*kutub*) and, for Aristotle's *Organon*, the commentaries as well.[19] In the latter case, he read only the essential parts (*fuṣūṣ*) and the commentaries thereupon.

This original diversity in approach is confirmed by the subsequent study of these two groups of disciplines in Avicenna's undergraduate education: according to the autobiography they had a very different fate. Thus, as far as logic and mathematics are concerned, Avicenna does not mention any special difficulty he had to face in the context of his undergraduate education; logic in particular, far from being a source of problems, constituted, on the contrary, the methodological corner-stone of Avicenna's undergraduate education, which mainly consisted in applying the syllogistic method to the other

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according to Lane). Al-Zabīdī, on the other hand, mentions two writings, whose title is or contains the term *fuṣūṣ*, taken in its metaphorical meaning: the *Fuṣūṣ fī l-ādāb wa l-aš'ār wa l-aḫbār* of Abū-l-'Alā' Ṣā'id al-Baġdādī (ca. 339/950–417/1026) and the *Fuṣūṣ al-ḥikam* (of Ibn-al-'Arabī [560/1165–638/1240]?), which he ascribes to al-Suhrawardī (539/1145–632/1234).

[19] See above, n. 17.

philosophical disciplines.[20] The situation is totally different with metaphysics: according to the autobiography, Avicenna not only met serious difficulties, but also deemed these difficulties so deep and radical that he concluded that metaphysics as a discipline was useless. There are signs that these overwhelming problems about metaphysics arose at the time of Avicenna's undergraduate education just because he had not read Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in its entirety before, namely during his secondary education.

> Text 2: Autobiography, pp. 30, 7–34, 4
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> Having mastered logic, natural philosophy and mathematics, I had now reached metaphysics (*al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*). I read the *Metaphysics* (*Kitāb Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*) but did not understand what it contained and was confused about the author's purpose to the point that I reread it forty times and consequently memorized it. In spite of this I still did not understand it or what was intended by it, and I said, despairing of myself: "There is no way to understand this book (*kitāb*)!". One afternoon I was at the booksellers' quarter when a crier came up holding a volume which he was hawking for sale. He offered it to me but I refused in vexation, believing that there was no use in this particular science. But he said to me: "Buy it; its owner needs the money and it's cheap; I'll sell it to you for three dirhams". So I bought it and it turned out to be Abū-Naṣr al-Fārābī's book *On the Goals of Metaphysics* (*Fī Aġrāḍ Kitāb Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*). I returned home and hastened to read it, and at once the purposes of that book (*kitāb*) were disclosed to me because I had learned it by heart. I rejoiced at this and the next day I gave much in alms to the poor in gratitude to God Exalted.[21]

Text 2 is reported or quoted very often in works dealing with Avicenna's life and thought. Having become a sort of *topos* about the influence of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* on Avicenna, it has been the object of superficial, if not distorting, readings.[22] Three aspects of this text, which shed light on Text 1, are noteworthy. First, Text 2 shows that, since he could not understand Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, Avicenna believed that "there was no use in this particular science" (*lā fāʾida fī hāḏā l-ʿilm*), namely in metaphysics as a discipline. This

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[20] Gutas [1988], pp. 177–181.

[21] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 28 (modified).

[22] Al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* has already been taken into account in Chapter 1, §1.1, §3, and will be the specific object of Chapter 3. The scholarly misconceptions regarding Text 2 as historical evidence of both Avicenna's degree of comprehension of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, and the influence that al-Fārābī's treatise exerted on him, have been underscored by Gutas [1988], pp. 237–242.

definitively clarifies a point made above, namely that Aristotle's *Metaphysics* was for Avicenna, if not the only, at least the main text dealing with metaphysics, and, therefore, that the *fuṣūṣ* and the *šurūḥ* mentioned in Text 1 are, as far as metaphysics is concerned, *fuṣūṣ* and *šurūḥ* of the *Metaphysics*.

Second, there is no doubt that Text 2 describes Avicenna's reading of the *Metaphysics* in its entirety. This is proved by the mention of the title of Aristotle's work (*Kitāb Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*), the two additional references to it by means of the term *kitāb* (the same term employed to designate the texts of logic and mathematics in the description of Avicenna's secondary education), and the allusions to Avicenna's reading, re-reading and memorizing of it. Thus, the main point of Text 2 is that, when reading Aristotle's work in its entirety, Avicenna encountered some serious problems. But this situation is better explained if we assume that Avicenna was reading *for the first time* the *Metaphysics* in its entirety, by means of one of the two comprehensive Arabic translations of the *Metaphsyics* analyzed in Chapter 1 (Usṭāṯ, Isḥāq);[23] the emergence of these problems at this stage cannot be reasonably accounted for, unless we suppose that Avicenna was having his first acquaintance with the full text of Aristotle's work. This implies that Avicenna did *not* read the *Metaphysics* in its entirety before this stage, namely during his secondary education.

Third, as Gutas has convincingly demonstrated, the problems that Avicenna, according to Text 2, encountered in reading the *Metaphysics* did not concern the discrete contents of this work, but its overall purpose, i.e. its arrangement and concatenation of parts. This implies that the sources of Avicenna's previous knowledge of the *Metaphysics*—i.e. the *fuṣūṣ* and *šurūḥ* of Text 1—did not sufficiently elucidate the general framework of this work; this further entails that these sources did not encompass all the *Metaphysics*, but only some parts of it. Text 2 excludes, therefore, not only Avicenna's acquaintance with the integral text of the *Metaphysics* during his secondary education, but also his use of something like a summary of it. The most reasonable possibility is that, during his secondary instruction, Avicenna read only some parts of the *Metaphysics*.

All this corroborates the translation of *fuṣūṣ* in Text 1 as "essential parts".

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[23] See Chapter 1, §1.1; Chapter 8, §§1.1–2. The possibility that Avicenna read and memorized the *Metaphysics* according to both translations cannot be excluded.

3 *Fuṣūṣ* in Avicenna's *Letter to Kiyā*

An inventory of the occurrences of *faṣṣ, fuṣūṣ* in Avicenna's writings lies outside the scope of the present investigation.[24] If we agree with S. Pines that the *Risālat al-Fuṣūṣ fī l-ḥikma*, despite its traditional attribution to al-Fārābī, is in fact a work by Avicenna,[25] the title of this work would constitute one of the occurrences of the term *fuṣūṣ* in Avicenna's œuvre.[26]

A more interesting—and surely Avicennian—*locus* where the term *fuṣūṣ* occurs is the *Letter to Kiyā*, a late writing by Avicenna, dealing with questions about philosophical method.[27] The mention of the *fuṣūṣ* in the *Letter* is particularly relevant for our purposes, since in it, as in Text 1, this term seems to have the meaning of "essential

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[24] This term is not recorded in Goichon [1938], nor does it appear in the Arabic-Latin lexica of the *Avicenna Latinus* series. It occurs twice in Avicenna's *Al-Taʿlīqāt ʿalā ḥawāšī Kitāb al-Nafs* (Marginal Notes on the *De Anima*), according to the ms. Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 6, f. 162b2, f. 164a3 (I wish to thank Prof. Dimitri Gutas for having brought these occurrences to my attention). In the second case, *faṣṣ* fits the context perfectly well (*qawluhū fī l-faṣṣi: fa-takūnu hāḏihī laysa lahā ʿaqlun, yaḥtamilu maʿnayayni*, "His [i.e. Aristotle's] statement in the pericope «These things do not have intellect» bears two meanings"), and is retained by ʿA. Badawī in his printed version of Avicenna's work (Avicenna [1947c], p. 103, 23). In the first case, on the contrary, its presence is more problematic: *wa-lam yubayyin ḏālika lā ṣāḥibu l-faṣṣi wa-lā l-mufassirūna*, "Neither the author of the *faṣṣ* nor the commentators clarify that". Badawī (Avicenna [1947c], p. 99, 13) emends the manuscript reading—without reporting the emendation in the apparatus—in *ṣāḥibu l-naṣṣ*, "the author of the text" (for the expression *aṣḥābu l-naṣṣ*, see Ibn al-Nadīm [1871–2], vol. II, p. 114 [n. 1 ad pag. 249], where the occurrences of *faṣṣ* in the *Fihrist* are taken into account). *Faṣṣ* occurs also in a gloss in the upper margin of f. 166a of the aforementioned manuscript (*nusḫatu l-faṣṣi kāna ilā hāhunā naqla Isḥāqa ibni Ḥunayni*, "The copy of the *faṣṣ* is, until here, Isḥāq Ibn Ḥunayn's translation" (Avicenna [1947c], p. 109, n. 1; I wish to thank Alexander Treiger for having brought this occurrence to my attention). Also in this case the meaning of *faṣṣ* seems to be "commented text", rather than "essential part".

[25] See Pines [1951]. This work has been edited twice under al-Fārābī's name: Dieterici [1890c]; Horten [1904–14]. Druart [1992], p. 127, follows Pines in discarding al-Fārābī's authorship. Janssens [1991], p. 70, regards the attribution to Avicenna as an "important, but very delicate topic".

[26] *Fuṣūṣ* in the title of the *Risāla* is usually translated in its literal sense as "seals" (Druart [1992], p. 127; *Petschafte*, Dieterici [1892b]) or "stones of rings" (*Ringsteine*, Horten [1906]). It might, however, equally well signify "essential parts", as in the works cited by al-Zabīdī (see above, n. 18). This would fit the actual content of the work, which is an outline of the main points of metaphysics and psychology.

[27] The *Letter* was discovered by Kraus [1940–1] and first edited by ʿA. Badawī (Avicenna [1947d]); its importance has been emphasized more recently by Pines [1952]. See Gutas [1988], pp. 60–64.

parts" of books. Also in this case the books in question are Aristotle's works, to which a Ps.-Aristotelian writing is now added: the *Theologia Aristotelis* (*Uṯūlūǧiyā*), the famous Arabic abstract of Plotinus' *Enneads* IV–VI falsely attributed to Aristotle, whose title is mentioned by Avicenna only in this case.[28]

> Text 3: *Letter to Kīyā*, Avicenna [1947d] p. 121, 16–22; Avicenna [1992], p. 375, 2–9
>
> You asked to find out how I proceed in such matters [i.e. in the problems of psychology and cosmology mentioned in the previous part of the letter]. I will tell you: I had composed a book which I called *Fair Judgment* (*Kītāb al-Inṣāf*). [. . .] I commented clearly (*awḍaḥtu šarḥ*) on the difficult passages (*mawāḍiʿ muškila*) in the essential parts (*fuṣūṣ*) [of Aristotle's books] up to the end of the *Theology* (*Uṯūlūǧiyā*), despite the presence in the *Theology* of things whose authenticity can be suspected (*ʿalā mā fī Uṯūlūǧiyā min al-maṭʿan*),[29] and I talked about the oversights of the commentators (*mufassirīn*). [. . .] Then it was lost in the course of some rout, since there was only the first draft.[30]

From Text 3 we get an interesting clue about the method of the *Inṣāf*. All the information at our disposal concerning this work (statements by Avicenna himself and others) concur in depicting it as a voluminous commentary on the Aristotelian *corpus*.[31] This does not mean, however, that the work was an exhaustive and running commentary. Text 3 indicates, on the contrary, that the *Kītāb al-Inṣāf* was a selective exegesis, both in the sense that it did not range across the books commented upon in their entirety, but only on their essential parts (*fuṣūṣ*), and in the sense that it focused on the difficult passages (*mawāḍiʿ muškila*) within these essential parts.[32]

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[28] On this work, see Adamson [2003]; Plotinus [2003]. On Avicenna's approach to the *Theologia Aristotelis* and its influence on the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see Chapter 11, §2.2; on Avicenna's commentary on the *Theologia Aristotelis* in the *Inṣāf (šarḥ/tafsīr Uṯūlūǧiyā)*, see Appendix C, Work 12.2.

[29] On the various interpretations of this phrase, see Plotinus [2003], p. 103, n. 269. Kraus [1940–1] was right in detecting the exact meaning of the verb *ṭaʿana* ("to suspect the authencity"; see Dozy [1881], vol. II, p. 46a–b, s.v.), but wrong in applying it to the entire work, rather than to something that can be found in it (*mā fī Uṯūlūǧiyā*). Avicenna appears to be questioning either certain particular doctrines of the *Theologia Aristotelis* that he might have found conflicting with Aristotelian tenets or, alternatively, its style. The different authorship of a writing like the *Metaphysics* (not to say the *Organon*) and the *Theologia Aristotelis* could not escape a profound knower of Aristotle like Avicenna.

[30] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 63–64 (modified).

[31] See Appendix C, Work 12.

[32] Pines [1952], p. 9, translates the term *fuṣūṣ* in Text 3 as "texts" (*textes*), Gutas

This interpretation of Text 3 is supported by the inspection of the actual contents of the *Inṣāf*. Unfortunately, this originally massive writing is extant only partially and indirectly, in the form of disciples' *reportationes*, in the MS. *ḥikma* 6 of the *Dār al-Kutub* Library in Cairo and in other manuscripts transcribed from, or depending on, this.[33] The parts of the *Inṣāf* that have been preserved in the Cairo manuscript are a commentary (*šarḥ*) on book Λ of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*,[34] and two different recensions of the explanation of the *Theologia Aristotelis*, called respectively "commentary" (*šarḥ*) and "interpretation" (*tafsīr*).[35] The commentary on *Metaphysics* Λ is an exegesis of chapters 6–10 of this book. The text, as we now have it, is a copy of an extract made by a disciple. This latter has introduced stylistic changes (the text is reported in the third person), but has apparently preserved the original extent of the commentary. The preference accorded to chapters 6–10 within Λ, if by Avicenna, would be significant, since it would show that these chapters were for him the essential parts of the book commented upon. Also Avicenna's *šarḥ* and *tafsīr* of the *Theologia Aristotelis*, as we have them, are disciples' copies, ultimately deriving from the text itself of Avicenna. It is not completely clear which portion of the *Theologia* Avicenna explained in the *šarḥ*. Only a part of this latter has been published by ʿA. Badawī.[36] The French translator is probably right in describing Avicenna's *šarḥ* as a "commentary on chosen passages" of the *Theologia*.[37] The exact identity of these "chosen passages", however, has still to be ascertained. The *tafsīr* of the *Theologia Aristotelis*, on the other hand, can be more easily connected with the text commented upon. Its editor and French translator agree in considering it a dis-

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[1988], p. 63, as "original texts". In the summary of Text 3 by Kraus [1940–1], p. 272, n. 3, *fuṣūṣ* has no exact French equivalent.

[33] See Gutas [1987]; Gutas [1988], pp. 136–140; Gutas [2000], p. 166, n. 25. Reisman [2002], p. 203, n. 125, maintains that the extant portions of the *Inṣāf* are, most likely, notes on, or summaries of, original parts of Avicenna's work by Abū-Manṣūr b. Zayla (d. 440/1048), a first generation student of Avicenna.

[34] Avicenna [1947].

[35] Avicenna [1947b]. For the translation of *tafsīr* as "interpretation", see Gutas [1993], pp. 32–33.

[36] Badawī associates this part with the fifth *mīmar* (chapter) of the *Theologia* according to the version edited by F. Dieterici in 1882 (Avicenna [1947b], p. 59, 12 and n. 8).

[37] Vajda [1951], p. 383, n. 1: ". . . ces pages représentent en somme une rédaction du commentaire sur des passages choisis de la ThA (i.e. *Theologia Aristotelis*)".

continous exegesis of five of the ten *mīmars* of the *Theologia* (1–2, 4, 7–8). Also in this case, therefore, some sections of the text commented upon might have played the role of essential parts.

It is difficult to establish whether the selectiveness of the surviving parts of the *Inṣāf* mirrors the character of Avicenna's original, or is rather something introduced later by the disciples who copied it. The fact that Avicenna in Text 3 states that he commented on the *Theologia Aristotelis* "up to the end", whereas the second, most extensive, recension of his explanation does not contain any commentary on the last two *mīmars* of the pseudo-Aristotelian work, might suggest the second alternative. However, even though the version of the *Theologia* upon which Avicenna commented has been identified,[38] it is not easy to ascertain in which form Avicenna knew this version—whether he had access to the same text as that of our modern edition or to a text qualitatively and quantitatively different.

Despite this uncertainty, which only future research may clarify, the fact remains that Avicenna's commentaries on *Metaphysics* Λ and the *Theologia Aristotelis* in the *Inṣāf*, as they have been preserved, are not integral commentaries, but selective explanations of some parts of these two works. If we take these two cases as an example of the method that Avicenna followed also in the rest of the *Inṣāf*, it follows that in this work he did not comment on the Aristotelian (and pseudo-Aristotelian) books in their entirety, but only on their essential parts or *fuṣūṣ*, as Text 3, according to the interpretation proposed, suggests.

The extant portions of the *Inṣāf* attest also—this time clearly—to the second aspect of Avicenna's method as stated in Text 3, namely the special attention he paid to the "difficult passages" (*mawāḍiʿ muškila*) within the *fuṣūṣ*. In the commentary on *Metaph.* Λ, 6–10, as it appears in the Cairo manuscript, not all the parts of these five chapters are explained: the doxographic sections in Λ, 6, 1071b31–1072a9, and Λ, 10 (1075a28–1076a4), for example, are not commented upon. The exegesis of the *Theologia Aristotelis*—especially the *tafsīr*—has this same character, and is consequently described by G. Vajda as selective exegesis.[39]

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[38] It is the so-called "short" or "shorter version", available in Dieterici's edition (see F. Zimmermann [1986], p. 183, n. 287).

[39] Vajda [1951], p. 346: "Il s'agit en fait non pas d'un commentaire suivi sur la fameuse «Théologie d'Aristote», mais de notes détachées sur des passages choisis".

From the analysis of Text 3 and the information at our disposal on Avicenna's *Inṣāf*, two main conclusions can be drawn. First, the term *fuṣūṣ* means, in Text 3 as in Text 1, the essential parts of some Aristotelian writings. These writings are the works on natural philosophy and the *Metaphysics* in Text 1, all the Aristotelian *corpus* plus the *Theologia Aristotelis* in Text 3. Second, the essential part of book Λ of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is represented, for Avicenna, by chapters 6–10.

In the following two sections (§§4–5), I will show that chapters 6–10 are for Avicenna the essential parts not only of book Λ, but also, together with chapters 1–2 of book α, of all the *Metaphysics*. First, Avicenna seems actually to have regarded these two *loci* of the *Metaphysics* as fundamental and more relevant than the others (§4). Second, the only identifiable commentary among the *šurūḥ* of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* mentioned in Text 1 is Themistius' paraphrase of Λ. Avicenna was particularly interested in the part of Themistius' paraphrase dealing with chapters 6–10 (§5).

4 *Metaph.* α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 among the *Fuṣūṣ* of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*

The present section aims at establishing the identity of the "essential parts" of Aristotle's natural philosophy and metaphysics, and of the "commentaries" thereupon, named, respectively, *fuṣūṣ* and *šurūḥ* in Text 1. The issue is addressed here only with regard to metaphysics: a similar investigation concerning Aristotelian natural philosophy lies outside the boundaries of the present contribution.[40]

What Avicenna in Text 1 calls the "essential parts" of the *Metaphysics* appear to have included chapters 1–2 of book α—the first treatise of the *Metaphysics* in the Arab tradition—and chapters 6–10 of book Λ—the theological treatise of Aristotle's work, even though it is difficult to say whether these were the only two essential parts of the *Metaphysics* according to Avicenna, or rather two elements of a

[40] Since the first philosophical work by Avicenna (*Maqāla fī l-nafs ʿalā sunnat al-iḫtiṣār*, "Compendium on the Soul") deals with psychology (see Gutas [1988], pp. 82–87), we can assume that Avicenna regarded the *De Anima* as one of the essential parts of Aristotle's natural philosophy. For the reception of Aristotle's *De Anima* in the Arab world, see Arnzen [1998].

larger complex. My assumption about the presence of α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 among the *fuṣūṣ* of the *Metaphysics* is supported by three main pieces of evidence which bear witness to the privileged attention that Avicenna always devoted to these two *loci*.

First, α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 are the only parts of the *Metaphysics* that, as far as we know, were part of Avicenna's library. This is attested by the already mentioned ms. *ḥikma* 6 of the *Dār al-Kutub* Library in Cairo, which, as D. Gutas has shown, was copied by ʿAbd-al-Razzāq al-Ṣiġnāḫī, a third generation student of Avicenna, from texts originally belonging to the master's library.[41] Now, this manuscript contains not only several Avicennian works, but also some translations of Greek texts, which "would seem to have been transcribed . . . from volumes owned by Avicenna".[42] The *Metaphysics* is the only work by Aristotle which appears in this manuscript. Not all the treatises of the *Metaphysics*, however, are preserved; those preserved are evidently the ones to which Avicenna attached a particular importance. Significantly for our purposes, the Cairo manuscript contains an abridged version of the Arabic translation of book α, chapters 1–2 (993a30–994b31) attributed to Isḥāq b. Ḥunayn,[43] and a slightly paraphrastic version of book Λ, chapters 6–10 (1071b3–1076a4),[44] as we have seen in Chapter 1.[45] The fact that, in Avicenna's library, the *Metaphysics* might have been represented only by α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 implies that these two *loci* were regarded by Avicenna as the essential parts of Aristotle's work.

The second piece of evidence is provided by the quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. In this work, all the explicit determinate quotations of the *Metaphysics* are taken from α, 2 and Λ, 7–8.[46] If we regard this type of quotation as a sign of distinctive importance,

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[41] Gutas [1987c], p. 9a–b. ʿAbd-al-Razzāq's master, Abū-l-ʿAbbās al-Lawkarī, was a student of Bahmanyār, one of the prominent disciples of Avicenna.

[42] Gutas [1987c], p. 9b.

[43] Gutas [1987c], p. 13b–14a, notices that in the Cairo manuscript this abridged version and the following translation of Themistius' paraphrase of Λ, 6–10 (see below, §5) might also be regarded as parts of the work immediately preceding, namely of Ibn-Zayla's *Ǧumlat al-maǧmūʿ fī l-ilāhiyyāt* (*Compilation on Metaphysics*). If true, this would imply that also Ibn-Zayla considered α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 essential parts of the *Metaphysics*; since he was a first-generation student of Avicenna, he was probably endorsing, in this regard, his teacher's position.

[44] See Gutas [1987c], p. 13a.

[45] See Chapter 1, §2.

[46] See Chapter 8, §3.

then α, 2 and Λ, 7–8 result the most important parts of the *Metaphysics* in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*. The emphasis placed on these two *loci* has, obviosuly, important doctrinal consequences, especially for Avicenna's theory of causation, that have still to be fully investigated.[47]

Third, α in its entirety and chapters 6–10 of Λ have had an unparalleled relevance not only in Avicenna's own reworkings of the *Metaphysics*, but also in his commentaries on this work. The most important of these commentaries are those that were parts, respectively, of the lost *Al-Ḥāṣil wa-l-maḥṣūl* (*The Available and the Valid*),[48] and of the already mentioned *Inṣāf*. The author of the letter translated by D. Gutas as "Memoirs of a disciple from Rayy" mentions a commentary by Avicenna on the *Metaphysics*, which probably corresponds to the former: it is noteworthy that, in his description, the disciple focuses in particular on the part of Avicenna's commentary dealing with α, saying that it was as comprehensive as the overall commentary of Abū-l-Faraǧ Ibn-al-Ṭayyib (d. 435/1043) on the *Metaphysics*.[49] As to Avicenna's commentary on the *Metaphysics* in the *Inṣāf*, we have already seen that his exegesis of Λ, 6–10 is extant thanks to the special interest of his disciples (in the specific case, the author of the extract of the commentary on Λ, 6–10, and ʿAbd-al-Razzāq al-Ṣiġnāḫī, who copied this extract in the MS. *ḥikma* 6). In both cases, the particular importance that the disciples attached to the commentary on α and Λ, 6–10 probably reflects the special role that Avicenna himself assigned to these two *loci* within the *Metaphysics*.

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[47] In α, 1, 993b29–30, for example, Aristotle contends that the principles of eternal things "are not merely sometimes true, nor is there any cause of their being (τοῦ εἶναι), but they themselves are the cause of the being of other things" (οὐ γάρ ποτε ἀληθεῖς, οὐδ' ἐκείναις αἴτιόν τί ἐστι τοῦ εἶναι, ἀλλ' ἐκεῖναι τοῖς ἄλλοις). This is one of the few passages of Aristotle's *corpus* where "being" is said to be the effect of causation, and where the causal power with respect to "being" is attributed to the first principles. This passage of α, 1 might have influenced Avicenna's doctrine of efficient causality, meant as cause of existence rather than moving cause, and his view of the emanation of existence from the Necessary Existent to all other beings.

[48] On this work, see Appendix 3, Work 3.

[49] This commentary on α is possibly the *tafsīr* to which Avicenna himself refers in the *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī* (see Gutas [1988], pp. 97–98). According to his disciple Ibn Buṭlān, Abū-l-Farāǧ Ibn-al-Ṭayyib devoted twenty years of his life to the composition of the commentary on the *Metaphysics*, until he became ill and almost died because of too much study (Pines [1952], p. 17, n. 5; cp. Gutas [1988], p. 68, n. 10).

They belonged to Avicenna's library, were explicitly quoted in his most important metaphysical work, and were commented upon in such a way that impressed the disciples: for all these reasons chapters α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 emerge as central in Avicenna's understanding of the *Metaphysics*. It seems reasonable to assume, therefore, that the *fuṣūṣ* of the *Metaphysics* in Text 1 are primarily, if not exclusively, α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10.

5 Themistius' paraphrase of book Λ as one of the *Šurūḥ*

The investigation of the *šurūḥ* mentioned in Text 1 confirms that Λ, 6–10 is one of the *fuṣūṣ* of the *Metaphysics*: most of the Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics* available to Avicenna in Arabic translation, if not all, were commentaries on book Λ. Among them, Avicenna very likely used Themistius' paraphrase of this book, of which he might have owned the part dealing with chapters 6–10.

As the "books" on natural philosophy and metaphysics in Text 1 indicate the books *par excellence*, namely Aristotle's writings on these two disciplines, likewise the "commentaries", referred to in the same text without any further qualification, designate very probably the "canonical" commentaries, namely the Greek commentaries translated into Arabic. This being the case, the range of possibilities about the identity of the commentaries on Aristotle's *Metaphysics* that Avicenna used during his secondary education seems to be restricted to Alexander of Aphrodisias' (II c.) literal commentary on Λ, and to Themistius' (IV c.) paraphrase of the same treatise.

Of the three Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics* whose Arabic translations are recorded in the *Fihrist* (Alexander of Aphrodisias on Λ, Themistius on Λ and Syrianus on B, each of them named—explicitly or by implication—*tafsīr*),[50] only the first two appear to have circulated in Arabic. A reliable witness of this situation is al-Fārābī, who, in a passage of the already mentioned *Fī Aġrāḍ*, states that the only Greek commentaries (instances of *kalām fī šarḥ*, "discussion aimed at explaining") on Aristotle's *Metaphysics* of which he is aware are those of Alexander and Themistius on Λ.[51] The situation described

[50] See Chapter 1, §1.1, Text 1.
[51] See Chapter 3, §1, [1.3].

by al-Fārābī is confirmed more than two centuries later by Averroes, who states that no other commentary (*tafsīr*) or compendium (*talḫīṣ ʿalā l-maʿnā*) on the *Metaphysics* besides those, respectively, by Alexander and Themisitius is available.[52]

As far as Alexander of Aphrodisias is concerned, it is difficult to establish whether Avicenna had access to, or actually used, the Arabic translation of his literal commentary on Λ, both at the time of his secondary education and later in his life. He never mentions it, at least explicitly, in his works.[53] He surely knew and was deeply influenced by another writing of Alexander of Aphrodisias translated into Arabic, namely the famous *Maqāla fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* (*Treatise on the Principles of the Universe*).[54] Even though this work is a "medium-sized independent treatise",[55] and as such, rather than as a "commentary" (*šarḥ*) on *Metaphysics* Λ, might have been regarded by Avicenna, this latter possibility is not excluded. First, the full title of the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* contains an allusion to Alexander as interpreter of Aristotle's opinion: "Treatise by Alexander of Aphrodisias on the discourse about the principles of the universe according to the opinion of Aristotle (*bi-ḥasab raʾy Arisṭāṭālis*) the philosopher". Second, three of the four explicit quotations of this work in the *Ilāhiyyāt* occur in connection with, and as an explanation of, doctrines of *Metaphysics* Λ.[56] Third, Avicenna sometimes applies the term *šarḥ* to writings that are not commentaries in the proper sense of the word.[57] If Avicenna deemed the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* a *šarḥ* on *Metaphysics* Λ, then this work would certainly be one of the *šurūḥ* mentioned in Text 1.

It is almost certain, on the other hand, that Themistius' paraphrase on *Metaphysics* Λ is one of the commentaries mentioned in Text 1.[58] This is attested by the *Kitāb fī Aṣnāf al-ʿulūm al-ḥikmiyya* (*The*

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[52] *Tafsīr*, p. 1393, 4–7: "I say: no commentary by Alexander or by the commentators who came after him has been found on the books of this science, nor any compendium, except on this book; we have found a commentary (*tafsīr*) by Alexander on about two thirds of the book and by Themistius a complete compendium on it according to the sense (*talḫīṣ ʿalā l-maʿnā*)", Engl. transl. in Genequand [1984], p. 59.

[53] See Chapter 11, §1.1.

[54] See Chapter 11, §1.1.

[55] See Genequand's Introduction in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], p. 3.

[56] See Chapter 11, §1.1, Outline 1.

[57] Sometimes Avicenna calls *šarḥ* the *Šifāʾ* itself and its various sections. See Appendix E, (i).

[58] See Chapter 11, §1.2.

Categories of the Philosophical Sciences) of Abū-Sahl al-Masīḥī (a contemporary and companion of Avicenna), in which Themistius' paraphrase of Λ is the only Greek commentary on Aristotle's *Metaphysics* to be recorded,[59] and by the constant attention that Avicenna paid to Themistius' paraphrase throughout his philosophical career. Two main signs of the importance that Avicenna accorded to Themistius' paraphrase are remarkable. First, the Cairo manuscript *ḥikma* 6, already mentioned as a witness of the *Kitāb al-Inṣāf* and of Avicenna's library, contains, in an abbreviated form, the Arabic translation of Themistius' exegesis of chapters 6–10 of Λ, significantly called *šarḥ*.[60] Second, Themistius' paraphrase is the only proper commentary on the *Metaphysics* quoted by Avicenna (both explicitly and implicitly) in the *Ilāhiyyāt* and in his own commentaries on the *Metaphysics*.[61]

The presence of Arabic commentaries on the *Metaphysics* among the *šurūḥ* in Text 1 cannot be excluded. Three of the Arabic commentaries on the *Metaphyiscs* antedating Avicenna deserve a special mention. Both in the *Fihrist* and in al-Masīḥī's *Kitāb fī Aṣnāf al-ʿulūm al-ḥikmiyya*, al-Kindī is credited with a "notice" (*ḫabar*) on the *Metaphysics*, that appears to be an exegetical work of some sort.[62] In the light of al-Kindī's influence on Avicenna's understanding of the *Metaphysics* during his secondary education (something I will try to show in §7), this work might have been one of the *šurūḥ* in Text 1. Unfortunately, however, this work is not preserved. Ṯābit b. Qurra (d. 901) wrote

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[59] MS Leiden Acad. 44, ff. 2v–12r; summary in Gutas [1988], pp. 149–152. Because of the chronological, geographical and personal connection between Al-Masīḥī and Avicenna, the presence of Themistius' paraphrase in al-Masīḥī's inventory can be taken as an indication of the availability of this paraphrase to Avicenna as well.

[60] Gutas [1987c], p. 14a.

[61] See Chapter 11, §1.2, Outline 2, Texts 1–2.

[62] *Fihrist*, vol. I, p. 251, 28 (see Chapter 1, §1.1, Text 1); cp. Ibn al-Nadīm [1988], p. 312, 14; see Gutas [1988], p. 152. Peters [1968], p. 49, translates *ḫabar* as "notation", Dodge [1970], vol. II, p. 606, as "information". Al-Masīḥī mentions, in connection with Aristotle's *Metaphysics* and Themistius' paraphrase of book Λ, al-Kindī's *Al-Falsafa al-dāḫila* (*The Inclusive Philosophy*), which he describes—in Gutas' words—as "a short exegesis" of the *Metaphysics*. This same work appears among al-Kindī's philosophical books in another passage of the *Fihrist* (vol. I, p. 255, 27–28; cp. Ibn al-Nadīm [1988], pp. 315, 29–316, 1; Gutas [1988], p. 152, n. 10), where it is connected rather obscurely with "metaphysics" (*mā fawqa l-ṭabīʿiyyāt*). In the light of al-Masīḥī's testimony, al-Kindī's *Al-Falsafa al-dāḫila* might represent the *ḫabar* of the *Metaphysics* mentioned in the *Fihrist*; it cannot be excluded, however, that Ibn-al-Nadīm refers to al-Kindī's *Falsafa Ūlā* (see below, §7).

a "concise exposition" (*talḫīṣ*) on the *Metaphysics* dealing in particular with book Λ.[63] Apart from focusing on one of the *fuṣūṣ* of the *Metaphysics*,[64] Ṯābit's *talḫīṣ* might have been part of Avicenna's library, if we give credit to a note in the title-page of one of the manuscripts of this work (Ayasofya 4832), according to which "this book belonged to Avicenna". Finally, among the Arabic commentaries on the *Metaphysics* that Avicenna, at the time of his secondary education, might have known and used, the commentary (*tafsīr*) on α by Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī, based on Isḥaq ibn-Ḥunayn's translation of this book,[65] deserves special attention, since is the only attested Arabic commentary dealing with the other identifiable *faṣṣ* (α) of the *Metaphysics* mentioned in Text 1. Yaḥyā's commentary is published, but its diffusion and impact on subsequent authors has still to be investigated.[66]

Only future research will clarify what kind of influence, if any, the commentaries of Kindī, Ṯābit b. Qurra and Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī exerted on Avicenna, and whether there is any reason to include them among the *šurūḥ* of Text 1. For the time being, it seems safer to assume that the term *šurūḥ* in Text 1 refers primarily, if not exclusively, to Themistius' paraphrase of Λ.

To summarize: none of the Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics* available in Arabic translation during Avicenna's lifetime covered the entire work, but all dealt specifically with only one of its books (Λ). The Arabic commentaries had a different scope, but their possible influence on Avicenna, both at the time of the events described in Text 1 and later, is still to be ascertained. Among the Greek commentaries translated into Arabic, Themistius' paraphrase on Λ, possibly only the part dealing with chapters 6–10, was very likely read

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[63] Critical edition, translation and commentary by D. C. Reisman and A. Bertolacci in Ṯābit Ibn Qurra [forthcoming]. Ṯābit's *talḫīṣ*, which was glossed by Ibn-Taymiyya in *Darʾ Taʿāruḍ al-ʿaql wa-l-naql* (Ibn-Taymiyya [s. d.], vol. IX, pp. 272–321), is preserved in two manuscripts, Aya Sofia 4832, ff. 60v–62r (see Peters [1968], p. 50, n. 12), and Osmania University Library acq. 1408, ff. 4v–7r (see Daiber [1986], p. 34).

[64] It is remarkable (see Peters [1968], p. 52) that, according to a note of the MS Munich 108 of the Hebrew translation, Ṯābit revised the Arabic translation of Themistius' paraphrase of *Metaphysics* Λ. Furthermore, traces of the use of Themistius' paraphrase are detectable in Ṯābit's *talḫīṣ*. In other words, Ṯābit appears to have commented on *Metaphysics* Λ using Themistius' paraphrase (which possible he revised) as an interpretive tool—something Avicenna himself did.

[65] See Chapter 1, §2.

[66] See Chapter 1, §2; Chapter 11, §3.4.

by Avicenna during his secondary education. All this confirms that Λ, 6–10 was for Avicenna one of the "essential parts" of Aristotle's work.

6 The Relationship between α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10

The inspection of the *Ilāhiyyāt* reveals not only the importance of *Metaph.* α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10, but also the particular way in which Avicenna reproduces these two *loci* of the *Metaphysics* in his work: first, the doctrines of α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 are somehow interconnected in the final section of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, the one dealing with philosophical theology (VIII, 1–X, 3);[67] second, within this section the doctrine of α, 1–2 is placed before that of Λ, 6–10, and constitutes a sort of introduction to philosophical theology. It is possible that Avicenna read α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 during his secondary education according to this same pattern.

In α, 2, Aristotle proves that the connection between causes and effects within each of the four types of causes is finite, and that the types of causes cannot be more than four. After proving the existence of the Unmoved Mover in Λ, 6–7, in Λ, 7–8 he elucidates Its nature and discusses the question of how many the unmovable movers are. Now, Avicenna combines these two Aristotelian *loci*, placing the former before the latter in the theological part of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: in *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1–3 he uses the aitiology of α, 1–2 as a basis for demonstrating the First Principle's existence and elucidating Its features (VIII, 3–7); then in IX, 1–3 he addresses the topic of the heavenly motion. It is reasonable to suppose that the presence of the doctrine of both α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 in the theological part of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, and the precedence of the former over the latter in this context, is a remnant of Avicenna's original way of approaching Aristotle's *Metaphysics* during his secondary education.

Even though the inclusion of α within philosophical theology as an introduction to Λ has some basis in the text itself of the *Metaphysics*,[68]

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[67] See OntologyC/Theology in Chapter 5, §4.4 [4].

[68] The reference to "the principles of eternal things" (τὰς τῶν ἀεὶ ὄντων ἀρχὰς) at the end of α, 1 (993b28) foreshadows the discussion of Λ, 6–7. In Λ, 7, conversely, the existence of the mover of the "eternal" first heaven is proved by a statement reflecting the causal doctrine of α, 2: "that which is moved and moves is intermediate" (τὸ κινούμενον καὶ κινοῦν [καὶ] μέσον, 1072a24; the seclusion of the

in the Arabic *Metaphysics* α is the opening book of the work, separated from Λ by a long series of other books dealing with ontology. The fact that Avicenna during his secondary education did not read α, 1–2 as an introduction to the *Metaphysics* in its entirety, but, in all likelihood, as an introduction to Λ, 6–10 in particular, suggests that, at that stage, he ignored the books of the *Metaphysics* (A, B-K) that lie between α and Λ.

In sum, Avicenna's approach to the *Metaphysics* at the time of his secondary instruction had three main features: (i) it was not an extensive reading of this work in its entirety, but only of the essential parts of it, namely—on the basis of the evidence at our disposal—α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10; (ii) these two *loci* were read in connection with one another, as elements of the theological part of the *Metaphysics*, in disregard of the ontological part of it; (iii) α was read as an introduction to Λ, 6–10, whereas books A, B-K of Aristotle's work were probably neglected.

7 From al-Kindī's to al-Fārābī's way of reading Aristotle's *Metaphysics*

The results of the analysis of Text 1 in the previous sections have a threefold significance. First, they witness that during his secondary education Avicenna understood metaphysics and read Aristotle's *Metaphysics* according to the pattern established by al-Kindī almost two centuries before, namely by identifying metaphysics with philosophical theology and privileging books α and Λ within Aristotle's work. Second, they help to explain why Avicenna was so baffled when he read the entire text of the *Metaphysics* at the time of his undergradute education, and realized that the main theme of Aristotle's work was by no means philosophical theology, but ontology, and that within the *Metaphysics* book α did not count as an introduction to book Λ. Third, they imply that not only the first, but also the second difficulty was solved by Avicenna's "encounter" with al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*.

As far as the doctrinal issue of the relationship between philosophical theology and ontology within metaphysics is concerned, the

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second καὶ, proposed by Ross in Aristotle [1924], is retained in Barnes [1984], p. 1694; in Aristotle [1957], on the other hand, Jaeger posits a lacuna after μέσον).

presence of the aforementioned process ("Kindian" phase, "aporetic" phase, "Farabian" phase) in the autobiography has already been described by D. Gutas.[69] In this last section I wish to corroborate Gutas' perspective, showing that this same evolution can be detected also in Avicenna's way of reading the *Metaphysics*, from his initial focusing on books α and Λ to his later consideration of the entire work, through an intermediate phase of acquaintance (and hardship) with the overall text of this writing.

Among the extant works of al-Kindī, dealing directly or indirectly with Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, the *Kītāb al-Falsafa al-Ūlā* (*Book on First Philosophy*) is surely the most significant.[70] Aristotle's *Metaphysics* has, as it can be expected, an outstanding place among the Aristotelian sources of this work. Within the *Metaphysics*, book α in particular plays a privileged and propaedeutic role: the only explicit quotations of Aristotle are taken from it.[71] Moreover, whereas implicit quotations of other books of the *Metaphysics* are occasional, those regarding α are frequent and systematic: they concentrate in the first chapter and half of the work, in a section that has clearly the character of an introduction.[72]

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[69] On the problem of the relationship between philosophical theology and ontology, Gutas states that "Avicenna was born and raised in the Eastern parts of the Islamic Empire where Kindī's tradition was most flourishing" (Gutas [1988], p. 250), that "[t]he autodidact Avicenna could not help but approach the book with the misconceptions" proper to this tradition "and be duly perplexed" (*ibid.*), and that "[t]he effect of Fārābī's essays on the philosophy of Avicenna was . . . decisive" (*ibid.*, p. 252).

[70] For editions and translations of this work, see Chapter 1, §3. Among recent studies, see Janssens [1994]; D'Ancona [1998].

[71] At p. 13, 11–14, al-Kindī mentions "Aristotle, the most distinguished of the Greeks in philosophy" (cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 103, 1–3; Ivry [1974], p. 58; the reference is to α, 1, 993b15–16). At p. 11, 20–21, Aristotle is referred to with the expression "the distinguished philosophers before us who are not our co-linguists" (cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 102, 5; Ivry [1974], p. 57; the reference is to α, 1, 993a31–b4). These and all the following passages of al-Kindī's *Falsafa Ūlā* are rendered according to Ivry's translation, unless otherwise noted.

[72] The end of this section is marked by the following sentence: "Inasmuch as these admonitions have now preceded (*fa-iḏā taqaddamat hāḏihī l-waṣāyā*), we ought to set forth beforehand the canons the employment of which we require in this craft, and we accordingly say . . ." (p. 26, 7–8; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 112, 19–20; Ivry [1974], pp. 66–67). In it, the main bulk of chapters α, 1 and α, 3 is paraphrased (see Neuwirth [1977–8]), but also the doctrine of α, 2 is reproduced: I am inclined to see an influence of α, 2 in the passages in which al-Kindī states that every cause must be one or another of the four Aristotelian causes (p. 11, 3–4; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 101, 3–4; Ivry [1974], p. 56). For another instance of a doctrine taken from α, see Ivry [1974], p. 18, n. 46.

Whereas the influence of book α is clear and circumscribed, the impact of the other books of the *Metaphysics* in *Falsafa Ūlā* is difficult to evaluate: al-Kindī's work, as it survives, appears to be the first part of a treatise that originally was more comprehensive and included a second part;[73] thus, even though a certain book of the *Metaphysics* is actually disregarded in the extant part of the work, it might have played a much more substantial role in the second part. As to book Λ in particular, three considerations are in order. First, on account of al-Kindī's insistence in *Falsafa Ūlā* on the identity between first philosophy and philosophical theology,[74] we expect Aristotle's account of philosophical theology in the *Metaphysics*, i.e. book Λ, to have a key function in *Falsafa Ūlā*. Second, some signs of a *positive* impact of Λ, even though less strong than in the case of α, can be seen in the extant part of al-Kindī's work.[75] Third, the attention paid to *Metaphysics* Λ in *Falsafa Ūlā* is revealed not only by al-Kindī agreement, but also by his disagreement towards the tenets of this book: the cases in which al-Kindī consciously departs from, and stands in

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[73] The main pieces of evidence in this respect are the colophon of the extant text, which qualifies it as "first part" of the work (p. 99, 4; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 162, 17; Ivry [1974], p. 114), and a quotation by Ibn-Ḥazm with no equivalent in the surviving part of the work (Al-Kindī [1998], pp. 113–117; see Daiber [1986]).

[74] In *Falsafa Ūlā*, first philosophy is called "knowledge of the First True Who is the cause of every true" (p. 9, 14; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 98, 1–2; Ivry [1974], p. 56), and "knowledge of the first Cause" (pp. 11, 13; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 101, 15–17; Ivry [1974], p. 56). It is also called *ʿilm ilāhī*, a term analogous to that designating metaphysics in Text 1, and bearing the literal meaning of "divine knowledge" or "theology" (p. 27, 2; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 112, 15; Ivry [1974], p. 66, translates this expression as "the science of the metaphysical"), and *ʿilm mā fawqa l-ṭabīʿiyyāt*, literally "knowledge of what is above physical objects" (p. 25, 9–10; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 111, 13; Ivry [1974], p. 65). The identity between first philosophy and philosophical theology in *Falsafa Ūlā* is remarked by scholars ("By hailing knowledge of the "First Truth" and the "First Cause" as "First Philosophy", al-Kindī . . . is within the Aristotelian θεολογική tradition", Ivry [1974], p. 17; ". . . the Kindi circle . . . made theology the ultimate object of metaphysics", F. Zimmermann [1986], p. 137; "The extant portion of *On First Philosophy* . . . deals with the theological part of metaphysics", Gutas [1988], p. 245; see also Adamson [2005b], pp. 34–39) and confirmed by a passage of another work by al-Kindī, the *Risāla fī Kammiyyat kutub Arisṭāṭālīs* (*Treatise on the number of Aristotle's Books*), where Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is described along theological lines (Al-Kindī [1940], p. 403, 8–11; Al-Kindī [1950b], p. 384, 7–10; see Gutas [1988], pp. 243–249; Jolivet [1996], pp. 1009–1011). Al-Kindī indentifies first philosophy with philosophical theology in order to show the congruence between Greek thought and Islamic religion (see Gutas [1988], pp. 243–244; Endress [1991]; Endress [1991b]; Endress [1997b]).

[75] D'Ancona [1992] highlights the reception of some passages of book Λ in the surviving part of *Falsafa Ūlā*.

opposition to, doctrines of *Metaphysics* Λ may be considered a sort of *negative* reception of this book.

One such case of open (though silent) dissent towards book Λ in *Falsafa Ūlā* is particularly significant, since it shows that al-Kindī regarded α as preliminary to Λ, 6. As we have seen, the introduction of al-Kindī's work is shaped according to α. The following exposition starts with a discussion of the "eternal" (*al-azalī*),[76] a topic which appears to correspond to the mention of the "eternal unmovable substance" (ἀΐδιόν τινα οὐσίαν ἀκίνητον) at the beginning of Λ, 6 (1071b4–5). The correspondence is made clear by the fact that al-Kindī, after describing the features of the "eternal", passes to demonstrating that body, time and movement cannot be infinite.[77] Now, as far as time and movement are concerned, his position is opposite to Aristotle's thesis in the lines of Λ, 6 immediately following the mention of the eternal unmovable substance (1071b6–7), where Aristotle states that movement and time are ingenerable and incorruptible; the eternity of movement and time certifies, in Aristotle's opinion, the existence of an eternal unmovable substance, namely the Unmoved Mover. Thus, the part of *Falsafa Ūlā* following the introduction has two main characters: it comes after a section of the work which depends on α; it is related to Λ, 6, 1071b3–11, being a sort of rebuttal of the proof of the Unmoved Mover's existence provided therein. In other words, in *Falsafa Ūlā* book α of the *Metaphysics* appears to introduce al-Kindī's critical reworking of the doctrine of *Metaph.* Λ, 6.

In sum, in *Falsafa Ūlā*, al-Kindī privileged the two books of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* that also Avicenna, during his secondary education, read as its "essential parts", namely α and Λ. Moreover, in this work he connected α and Λ with one another within a context in which first philosophy was assimilated to philosophical theology. Finally, within this theologizing context al-Kindī assigned to α an introductory role with respect to the core of Λ (the discussion of the Unmoved Mover and related issues beginning with chapter 6). This is what Avicenna himself apparently did during his secondary education. The analysis of al-Kindī's *Falsafa Ūlā* attests, therefore, that,

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[76] *Falsafa Ūlā*, pp. 27, 8–29, 5; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], pp. 113, 1–114, 9; Ivry [1974], pp. 67–68.

[77] *Falsafa Ūlā*, pp. 29, 6–39, 22; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], pp. 114, 10–122, 21; Ivry [1974], pp. 68–75.

in all likelihood, Avicenna's approach to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* during his secondary education took its inspiration from al-Kindī and the philosophical tradition stemming from his circle.[78]

The analysis of Text 1 proposed in this chapter allows a broader view of the problems Avicenna met when he read Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in its entirety during his undergraduate education. For, if we suppose that Avicenna, at the time of his secondary education, read basically only two books of the *Metaphysics* (α and Λ), in close connection with one another, within a conception of metaphysics as philosophical theology (*ʿilm ilāhī* or *ilāhiyyāt*), we understand better why he was so puzzled by Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (*Kitāb Mā baʿd al-ṭabīʿa*) when he later faced this work in its entirety, as witnessed by Text 2. His difficulty was due not only to discovering that Aristotle's *Metaphysics* contained more than a philosophical theology, but also to realizing that α and Λ were not the only parts of this work and were not contiguous to each other, as he was accustomed to read them. Books α and Λ appeared to him now as two elements of a larger complex, of which the former was the introduction and the latter the conclusion. Besides the doctrinal gap separating these two books from the rest of the *Metaphysics* (the existence of an ontological dimension of metaphysics, besides the theological one), the textual gap separating these two books from each other (the presence of many interposed books between them) also required an explanation.

Finally, the proposed interpretation of the *fuṣūṣ* of the *Metaphysics* in Text 1 places in the right perspective al-Fārābī's influence on Avicenna at the time of his undergraduate education. Avicenna found in al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* the solution of the two problems that he encountered when he read the *Metaphysics* in its entirety, after having known only some parts of it. He learnt in al-Fārābī's essay, first of all, that metaphysics (*ʿilm mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*) is a universal science (*ʿilm kullī*) that encompasses philosophical theology (*ʿilm ilāhī*) as a part, but is not confined to it, since—besides the study of God as the principle of "existent *qua* existent", i.e. philosophical theology—it includes also an investigation of the species and properties of "exis-

[78] In the preface of the *Theologia Aristotelis*, a work associated in the Arabic tradition with the name of al-Kindī, the causal doctrine of α introduces the subsequent treatment of philosophical theology. This point, first noticed by Ivry [1974], p. 15, n. 33, has been further developed by F. Zimmermann [1986], pp. 121–122, 137–138, and D'Ancona [1998], p. 846.

tent *qua* existent", i.e. an ontology.[79] But Avicenna found in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* not only an account of the overall goal of the *Metaphysics*, but also a description of the specific goal and content of each of the books of this work.[80] In this way, due to al-Fārābī's essay, Avicenna understood how the link between α and Λ was indirect, passing through a continuous series of intermediate books.

Conclusion

At the end of the description of his studies in the autobiography, Avicenna states that his knowledge of the philosophical sciences remained substantially the same afterwards, "nothing new—he says—having come to me since".[81] Before the completion of his studies, however, Avicenna's understanding of the philosophical science of metaphysics and his knowledge of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* evolved significantly, according to the autobiography. This evolution consisted of three stages: the first one occurred in his secondary education, the other two during his undergraduate education.

Avicenna himself speaks openly of the second and third stage of this evolution. He connects the second stage with his reading of the integral text of the *Metaphysics*, and links the third stage (corresponding to the discovery of the ontological dimension of the *Metaphysics*, and the interconnection of its books) with the name of al-Fārābī. The first stage, on the contrary, is less perspicuous, both because it is mentioned very briefly in the autobiography, and because the key-term (*fuṣūṣ*) of Avicenna's account is not immediately clear. The endeavour of this chapter has been to demonstrate the existence and nature of this initial stage, corresponding to Avicenna's study of metaphysics during his secondary education, and its relation with the subsequent two stages. During his secondary education Avicenna read only the essential parts of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (§§1–3), substantially corresponding to α, 1–2 and Λ, 6–10 (§§4–5), within a theological framework in which the former was connected with, and served as an introductory to, the latter (§6). In doing so, Avicenna initially

[79] See Chapter 3, §1, [2.4].
[80] See Chapter 3, §1, [3].
[81] Avicenna [1974b], pp. 36, 8–38, 2; Gutas [1988], p. 29. See also Avicenna [1974b], p. 30, 5–6; Gutas [1988], p. 28.

adopted a partial reading of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, inspired by al-Kindī's way of understanding metaphysics and of approaching Aristotle's work; then, when he read the integral text of the *Metaphysics*, he realized the inadequacy of this approach and its exegetical shortcomings; finally he passed to al-Fārābī's mode of envisaging Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, in which all the books of this work and both its dimensions, ontological and teological, are taken in due consideration (§7).

In undergoing this evolution from a Kindian phase to a Farabian phase, Avicenna, in the course of the few years of his education, followed the same path that the interpretation of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* went through in the Arab world from the first appearance of the earliest translations of this work until Avicenna's times.

CHAPTER THREE

BETWEEN AMMONIUS AND AVICENNA: AL-FĀRĀBĪ'S TREATISE *ON THE GOALS OF ARISTOTLE'S* METAPHYSICS*

The doctrinal influence of Ammonius Son of Hermeias, active in Alexandria between the V and the VI c. AD, on the metaphysical system of Avicenna is one of the main tenets of R. Wisnovsky's recent monograph on Avicenna's metaphysics.[1] As portrayed by Wisnowsky, the influence of Ammonius' metaphysics on Avicenna's thought in particular, and on Arabic philosophy in general, is indirect in a double respect. First, it is not exerted by Ammonius himself, but rather by Aristotelian commentators that were his disciples, like Philoponus. Second, it does not stem from works on metaphysics by these commentators, but rather from works on natural philosophy and psychology (i.e. their commentaries on Aristotle's *Physics* and *De Anima*).

In the present chapter, I wish to provide evidence for a direct influence of Ammonius' metaphysics in Arabic philosophy. As I am going to argue, this influence is direct in both the aforementioned respects: it comes directly from Ammonius and originates from some works of his on metaphysics. I am going to argue that the first recipient and witness of this influence is al-Fārābī's treatise *Fī Aġrāḍ*, whose impact on Avicenna's understanding of the *Metaphysics* has been pointed out in Chapter 2. Thus, if my analysis is correct, to Wisnovsky's view of the relationship of Avicenna's metaphysics with Ammonius' metaphysical thought a further, complementary, aspect can be added: Avicenna is connected with Ammonius' metaphysics not only through commentaries on natural philosophy and psychology by later Greek commentators, but also by means of a treatise on metaphysics by his closest predecessor in Arabic philosophy,

* This chapter is a revised and enlarged version of Bertolacci [2005d].

[1] Wisnovsky [2003a] (see my forthcoming reviews of this book in *Journal of Near Eastern Studies* and *Historia Philosophica*). On Ammonius Son of Hermeias and the Arabic tradition related to him, see Hein [1985], pp. 13–14; Saffrey—Mahé [1989];

al-Fārābī. If my perspective is sound, a fundamental joint connecting the Greek metaphysics of Late Antiquity with the early phase of Arabic metaphysics is now available for further investigation.

Al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* has already attracted the attention of scholars.[2] Previous studies have remarked the importance of this treatise both in itself and in its subsequent reception. The treatise is important in itself, in so far as it shows that in Aristotle's *Metaphysics* philosophical theology is part of a broader doctrine of being, or ontology, and keeps Aristotelian philosophical theology distinct from Islamic revealed theology. The importance of the treatise in its subsequent reception is mainly due to the deep influence it exerted, above all, on Avicenna. In the present chapter I am going to articulate more in detail these two points and to show the importance of this treatise also with regard to its sources.

I divide the exposition into five sections. In the first (§1), I provide an integral translation of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*.[3] In the second section (§2), I analyze the content of this treatise. In the third section (§3), I point at Ammonius as the main source of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* and tentatively identify the work of Ammonius which al-Fārābī might have taken as model. In the fourth section (§4), I document Avicenna's reception of al-Fārābī's treatise. In the fifth section (§5), finally, I survey the accounts of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* and metaphysics as a discipline that occur in the other works by al-Fārābī and compare them with the *Fī Aġrāḍ*.

1 The *Fī Aġrāḍ*: Translation

[*Title (p. 34, 1–5)*]

> Treatise . . . on the goals of the Sage [i.e. Aristotle] in each treatise of the book named by means of letters [i.e. the *Metaphysics*], namely the determination of Aristotle's goal in the book *Metaphysics*.[4]

Rudolph [1989], pp. 210–211.

[2] Editions: Al-Fārābī [1890b]; Al-Fārābī [1930]. Translations: Dieterici [1892b]; Druart [1982] (Druart bases her translation on Al-Fārābī [1890b], Al-Fārābī [1930] and two further mss.); Ramón Guerrero [1983]; partial English translation (corresponding to Al-Fārābī [1890b], pp. 34, 6–36, 20) in Gutas [1988], pp. 240–242 (Gutas bases his translation on Al-Fārābī [1890b] and Al-Fārābī [1930], independently from Druart [1982]). Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 238–254; Druart [1999], p. 216a.

[3] The translation of parts [1] and [2] is a reproduction of Gutas' translation (see previous footnote), with few minor changes. Part [3] has never been translated into English before.

[4] In Avicenna's *Autobiography* (Chapter 2, Text 2) and in Al-Fārābī [1930] the

[*1. Introduction (p. 34, 6–20)*]

[*1.1 Presentation of parts 2 and 3 (p. 34, 6–8)*]
He [i.e. al-Fārābī] says: Our aim in this treatise is to indicate the goal that Aristotle's book known as *Metaphysics* contains, and the primary divisions of it.

[*1.2 Importance of part 2 (p. 34, 8–13)*]
[a] For many people have the preconceived notion that the import and contents of this book consist of a discussion of the Creator—He is praiseworthy and most high—the Intellect, the Soul, and other related topics, and that the science of metaphysics and the science of the profession of God's oneness are one and the same thing.

[b] For this reason we find most of those who examine it [i.e. the *Metaphysics*] perplexed and astray, since we find most of the discussion in it [i.e. in the *Metaphysics*] devoid of this goal [i.e. the treatment of theological matters], or, rather, we do not find in it any specific discussion of this goal, except [the discussion] that takes place in the eleventh treatise, the one designated as "L".

[*1.3 Importance of part 3 (p. 34, 14–18)*]
Furthermore, the Ancients do not have any discussion aimed at explaining this book [i.e. the *Metaphysics*] as it is, contrarily to what happens with the other books [by Aristotle]. If such a discussion can be found, it is the incomplete one concerning treatise "L" by Alexander [of Aphrodisias], and the complete one [concerning the same treatise] by Themistius. As to the other treatises, either they have not been explained, or [their explanation] has not been preserved, as one might think by seeing in the books (*kutub*) of the Posterior Peripatetics that Alexander had commented upon the book [i.e. the *Metaphysics*] in its entirety.

[*1.4 Topics dealt with in parts 2 and 3 (p. 34, 19–20)*]
We want to indicate the goal that is present in it [i.e. in the entire *Metaphysics*] and that which each of its treatises contains.

[*2 Goal of the* Metaphysics *(pp. 34, 21–36, 20)*]

[*2.1 The particular sciences (pp. 34, 21–35, 7)*]
We say that some sciences are particular and others universal. Particular sciences are those whose subject-matters are some existents or some imaginary objects, and whose investigation regards specifically the accidents that are proper to them. For example, the science of nature investigates one of the existents, namely body, in so far as it moves,

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title is shorter: "Treatise on the Goals of the *Metaphysics*" (*Maqāla fī Aġrāḍ Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*).

changes and rests from movement, and in so far as it possesses principles and attributes of that [i.e. the fact of being in movement, change and rest]. Geometry investigates extensions in so far as they admit the qualities that are proper to them and the relations that occur in them, and the principles and attributes of extension in so far as it [i.e. extension] is in this way [i.e. having qualities and relations].[5] The same happens in arithmetic with regard to number, medicine with regard to human bodies in so far as they are healthy or ill, and the other particular sciences [with regard to their own subject-matters]. None of them investigates what is common to all existents.

[*2.2 The universal science (p. 35, 8–12)*]
Universal science, on the other hand, investigates the thing that is common to all existents (like existence and oneness), its species and attributes, the things which are not proper accidents of any of the subject-matters of the particular sciences (like priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfect and deficient, and similar things) and the common Principle of all existents, namely the thing that ought to be called by the name of God—may His glory be exalted.

[*2.3 There is only one universal science (p. 35, 13–16)*]
The universal science ought to be only one. For if there were two, then each one of them would have a subject-matter proper to it. But the science which has a subject-matter proper to it and which does not include the subject-matter of another science is a particular science. Therefore both sciences would be particular. But this is contradictory. Therefore the universal science is one.

[*2.4 The divine science is part of the universal science (p. 35, 16–19)*]
The divine science ought to belong to this [universal] science, because God is a principle of the absolute existent, not of one existent to the exclusion of another. That division [of the universal science], then, which contains providing the principle of the existent ought to be the divine science.

[*2.5 The universal science's name is "metaphysics" (pp. 35, 19–36, 9)*]
Since[6] these things [i.e. the things mentioned in 2.2] are not proper to natural objects but are loftier than them in universality, then this science is loftier than the science of nature and [comes] after the science of nature. Therefore it should be called "metaphysics".

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[5] Reading *wa-fī mabādi'ihī wa-lawāḥiqihī min ǧihati mā huwa ka-ḏālika* instead of *fī mabādi'ihī wa-lawāḥiqihī wa-min ǧihati mā huwa ka-ḏālika.*

[6] Reading *wa-li-anna*, as in Gutas [1988], p. 241, n. h; Druart [1982], p. 41, n. 26, instead of *li-anna.*

Although mathematics is loftier than the science of nature—since its subject-matters are abstracted from matter—it ought not to be called "metaphysics". For its subject-matters are abstracted from matter in imagination [only], not in existence. As to existence, they do not exist except in natural things.

Of the subject-matters of this science, on the other hand, some have no existence at all (be it imaginary or real) in natural things. It is not that imagination has abstracted them from natural things; rather, their existence and nature [itself] is abstracted [i.e. immaterial]. Others exist in natural things, even though they are imagined as abstracted from them. However, they do not exist in natural things essentially, i.e. in such a way that their existence is not independent from these and they are things whose subsistence is due to natural things. Rather, they exist both in natural things and in non-natural things (these latter being separate either really or in imagination).

Therefore the science which deserves to be called by this name is [only] the present one. It alone, all other sciences excluded, is "metaphysics".

[*2.6. Contents of universal science/metaphysics (p. 36, 9–20)*]

[a] The primary subject-matter of this science is the absolute existent[7] and what is equivalent to it in universality, namely the one. But since the knowledge of opposite correlatives is one, the investigation of non-existence and multiplicity is also included in this science.

[b] Then, after these subject-matters and their verification, it investigates the things which are like species to them, like the ten categories of the existent, the species of the one (like the individual one, the one by species, the one by genus, the one by analogy, and the divisions of each one of these), and similarly the species of non-existence and many.

[c] Then [it investigates] into the attributes of existent (like potency and act, perfect and deficient, cause and effect), the attributes of unity (like sameness,[8] similarity, equality, coincidence, parallelism, analogy etc.), and the attributes of non-existence and multiplicity.

[d] Then [it investigates] into the principles of each one of these [i.e. of existent, one, non-existence and multiplicity].

[e] [Each one of these] is branched out and divided, until the subject-matters of the particular sciences are reached and [consequently] this

[7] Reading *al-mawǧūd al-muṭlaq* instead of *al-wuǧūd al-muṭlaq*. The same expression occurs in [2.4], p. 35, 17, and fits better the mention of "the one" (*al-wāḥid*)—not of "unity" (*al-waḥda*)—as its equivalent immediately afterwards (p. 36, 10). See also the occurrence of *al-mawǧūd* in [2.6b], p. 36, 13.

[8] Reading *huwahuwiyya* instead of *huwiyya*. See the use of *huwiyya* in the meaning of "being", not of "identity", below [3.5] and [3.6], and in the meaning of "existence", below [3.11].

science ends. In it the principles of all the particular sciences and the definitions of their subject-matters are clarified.

These are all the things investigated in this science.

[*3. Goals of the single treatises of the* Metaphysics *(pp. 36, 21–38, 5)*]

[*3.1 Alpha Elatton (p. 36, 21–22)*]
The first treatise of this book contains a sort of introduction and preface to it, in so far as it shows that all the types of causes end in a first cause [cp. α, 2].

[*3.2 Beta (p. 37, 1–3)*]
The second treatise contains the enumeration of the difficult questions concerning these things [i.e. the things mentioned in 2.2 and 2.6; cp. B, 1, 995b4–996a17], the clarification of the type of difficulty that is present in them, and the setting up of opposite proofs for them [cp. B, 2–6], so that the mind may get an indication of what the method of research is.

[*3.3 Gamma (p. 37, 4–5)*]
The third treatise contains the enumeration of the subject-matters of this science, namely the things about which and about whose proper accidents[9] it investigates. These are [the things] that we have enumerated [cp. Γ, 1–2].

[*3.4 Delta (p. 37, 6–8)*]
The fourth treatise contains the distinction of what is meant by each of the expressions indicating the subject-matters of this science, the species of its subject-matters and the attributes of them, either by univocity, or gradation of meaning, or true equivocity.

[*3.5 Epsilon (p. 37, 9–13)*]
The fifth treatise contains the clarification of the essential distinctions [occurring] between the three theoretical sciences—i.e. the natural, the mathematical and the divine—and of the fact that they are only three. [It also contains] the determination of the state of the divine science, namely the fact that it belongs to this science, or better that it is this science in a certain way [cp. E, 1]. [It also contains the clarification] of the fact that[10] to this science belongs the investigation of being (*huwiyya*) said *per se*, not of being (*huwiyya*) said *per accidens* [cp. E, 2], and [the clarification of] how it shares [certain features] with dialectic and sophistic [cp. E, 2, 1026b14–16].

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[9] Reading *wa-fī l-aʿrāḍi l-ḫāṣṣati bi-hā*, as in Druart [1982], instead of *wa-fī l-aʿrāḍi l-ḫāṣṣati bi-hī*.

[10] Reading *wa-anna* instead of *fa-inna*.

[*3.6 Zeta (p. 37, 14–18)*]
The sixth treatise contains a verified discussion of being (*huwiyya*) said *per se*, with special regard to substance and the distinction of its types, namely hyle, form and compound [cp. Z, 1–3]; if true definition belongs to the existents, to what of them it belongs; if it belongs to substance, to what substance it belongs; how the compounds[11] are defined [cp. Z, 4–6]; which parts [of the things that are defined] are found in the definitions [cp. Z, 10–12]; what forms are separate [from matter] and what are not [cp. Z, 13]; that the [Platonic] Ideas do not exist [cp. Z, 14–16].

[*3.7 Eta (p. 37, 19–21)*]
The seventh treatise contains a summary of the previous treatise; the completion of the discussion of the Platonic forms and of the fact that generated things do not require them for being generated; a verified discussion of the definitions of separate things, whether they exist, and of the fact that their definitions are these things themselves.

[*3.8 Theta (p. 37, 22)*]
The eighth treatise deals with potentiality and actuality and with their [respective] priority and posteriority.

[*3.9 Iota (p. 37, 23)*]
The ninth treatise deals with "one", "many", "other", "different" and "contrary".

[*3.10 Kappa [?] (p. 38, 1)*]
The tenth treatise deals with the distinction between the principles of this science and its accidents.

[*3.11 Lambda (p. 38, 2–4)*]
The eleventh treatise deals with the Principle (*mabda'*) of all substance and existence, with establishing His existence (*huwiyya*), with the fact that He knows by essence and is true by essence, with the existents separate [from matter] that come after Him, and with the way according to which the existence of the existents [that have their origin] from Him is ordered [cp. Λ, 6–10].

[*3.12 Mi [?] (p. 38, 5)*]
The twelfth treatise deals with the principles (*mabādi'*) of natural and mathematical things.

[11] Reading *al-murakkabāt* instead of *bi-l-murakkabāt*.

[4. *Conclusion (p. 38, 6)*]

This is the clarification of the goal of this book and [the clarification] of its divisions.

2 The *Fī Aġrāḍ*: Analysis of Contents

The *Fī Aġrāḍ* consists of three main parts. The first ([1]) is an Introduction: it indicates the content of the following two parts and explains their importance. The second part ([2]) takes into account the goal of the *Metaphysics*. The third part ([3]) deals with the single treatises of this work and their specific goals.

Part [1] presents briefly the content of the following two parts in [1.1] and [1.4], and shows their importance in [1.2] and [1.3] respectively. Section [1.2] shows the necessity of discussing the goal of the *Metaphysics* in part [2]. This necessity arises from the conflict between the common expectations about the *Metaphysics* ([1.2a]) and its actual content ([1.2b]). Whereas people expect the *Metaphysics* to be fully devoted to the investigation of theological matters, and metaphysics as a discipline to coincide with Islamic theology, such an investigation is in fact available only in one of its treatises (Λ). Al-Fārābī's way of describing the misconception regarding the *Metaphysics* in [1.2a] is revealing. On the one hand, the content of the *Metaphysics* is misconceived as amounting to the study of "the Creator, the Intellect, the Soul" (*al-bārī . . . wa-l-ʿaql wa-l-nafs*) and other related topics. On the other hand, the science of metaphysics is misconceived as identical with "the science of the profession of God's oneness" (*ʿilm al-tawḥīd*). The former misconception makes possible the latter, and in fact is the only one that will be taken into account and refuted by al-Fārābī in part [2]. The Neoplatonic background of the triad Creator-Intellect-Soul is evident, whereas *ʿilm al-tawḥīd* is an expression designating Islamic theology.[12] Thus, al-Fārābī is

[12] Hein [1985], pp. 310–312, remarks the Neoplatonic overtones of al-Fārābī's account, even though she overemphasizes the point, regarding not only the mention of the Creator, the Intellect and the Soul as a reference to the *Theologia Aristotelis*, but also the mention of the *ʿilm al-tawḥīd* as a reference to the *Liber de Causis*. Gutas [1988], p. 240, n. 4, clarifies that the expression *ʿilm al-tawḥīd* refers properly to Islamic theology. The Creator is mentioned together with the Intellect and the Soul in *Theologia Aristotelis*, cap. 1, Plotinus [2003], p. 237, 4–8; cap. 7, Plotinus

dealing with an attempt at isolating the theological content of the *Metaphysics* from the rest of the work, at interpreting it in a Neoplatonic perspective, and at stressing its congruence with Islamic theology. This way of reading the *Metaphysics* is the one proper to al-Kindī. For al-Kindī gives special importance to books α and Λ of the *Metaphysics*, inserts the *Metaphysics* in a canon of metaphysical works to which also the *Theologia Aristotelis*, the *Liber de Causis* and other Neoplatonic writings belong, and emphasizes the affinity between Greek metaphysics and Islamic theology in order to "legitimize" the former (and philosophy in general) in the Muslim cultural environment.[13] As an answer to the Kindian way of reading the *Metaphysics*, in part [2] al-Fārābī will show that the investigation of theological matters is one of the main topics of the *Metaphyiscs*, but not the only one.[14]

Section [1.3] shows the necessity of discussing the goals of the single books of the *Metaphysics* in part [3]. This necessity, al-Fārābī says, is due to the fact that no commentary on these books is available in Arabic, with the only exception of book Λ and the commentaries on it by Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius. In part [3], therefore, al-Fārābī will provide the Arabic reader with a first acquaintance with the contents and goals of the books of the *Metaphysics* other than Λ.

Part [2] constitutes the doctrinal core of the treatise. In it al-Fārābī deals with the science contained in Aristotle's *Metaphysics* more than with the *Metaphysics* as such. The *leit-motiv* of this part is the status of metaphysics as universal science (*'ilm kullī*), something that distinguishes it from particular sciences like natural philosophy, geometry, arithmetic and medicine ([2.1]–[2.2]). The universality of metaphysics entails that it is one ([2.3]), that it encompasses philosophical theology as one of its parts ([2.4]), that it is more general than natural philosophy, i.e. higher than and posterior to it, and that, accordingly, it is named "metaphysics" ([2.5]). Part [2] ends

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[2003], p. 249, 3–10. The triad Creator-Intellect-Soul apperas, in the reverse order, in Avicenna's refutation of Platonic philosophy in *Ilāhiyyāt*, VII, 3, p. 318, 15 [p. 369, 18].

[13] See Chapter 2, §7.

[14] In so far as the *Metaphysics* is not reducible to the theological investigation, but rather encompasses it, al-Fārābī appears to point not only to a distinction between metaphysics (and philosophy in general) and Islamic theology, but also to a certain superiority of the former over the latter.

with an ordered list of the topics dealt with by metaphysics, which amounts to a description of its ideal structure ([2.6]). As we will see more in detail in Chapter 5, in this list al-Fārābī first mentions the primary concern of metaphysics, i.e. the investigation of "existent", "one", non-existence and multiplicity ([2.6a]); then he assigns to metaphysics the study of their species ([2.6b]), properties ([2.6c]), and principles ([2.6d]); finally he maintains that metaphysics clarifies the principles and definitions of the other disciplines ([2.6e]).

The universality of metaphysics is the result of the universal character of the things it takes into account.

> Text 1: al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, pp. 35, 8–12, 19–20; 36, 9–10
>
> [2.2] Universal science (*al-ʿilm al-kullī*), on the other hand, investigates the thing that is common (*al-šayʾ al-ʿāmm*) to all existents (like existence and oneness), its species and attributes, the things which are not proper accidents of any of the subject-matters of the particular science (like priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfect and deficient, and similar things) and the common Principle (*al-mabdaʾ al-muštarak*) of all existents, namely the thing that ought to be called by the name of God.
>
> [2.5] Since these things [i.e. the things mentioned in 2.2] are not proper to natural objects but are loftier than them in universality (*ʿumūman*), etc.
>
> [2.6a] The primary subject-matter of this science is the absolute existent (*al-mawǧūd al-muṭlaq*) and what is equivalent to it in universality (*al-ʿumūm*), namely the one. [. . .]

Al-Fārābī insists on the universality of "existent" and "one" in [2.2] and [2.6a]. The expression "absolute existent" (*al-mawǧūd al-muṭlaq*) in [2.6a] (cp. [2.4]) means in fact "existent in so far as it is existent", i.e. universal existent. But in [2.2] and [2.5] the same universality is ascribed also to the species, properties and principles of "existent" and "one". In section [2.2], by saying that the properties of "existent" and "one" taken into account by metaphysics are not properties of the subject-matters of the particular sciences, al-Fārābī entails that they are more general than these latter. Likewise, the principle of all existents that is investigated by metaphysics is portrayed in [2.2] as "common" (lit.: "shared", *muštarak*).

Among the things investigated by metaphysics, al-Fārābī isolates a group of items which he calls "subject-matters" (*mawḍūʿāt*) of this discipline.[15] Among the subject-matters of metaphysics, some possess the status of "primary subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ awwal*).

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[15] In [2.5], p. 35, 22, al-Fārābī mentions the subject-matters of mathematics,

Text 2: al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, pp. 36, 2–5, 9–11, 11–12; 37, 4–5, 6–8

[2.5] [. . .] Of the subject-matters (*mawḍūʿāt*) of this science, some have no existence at all in natural things [. . .]. Others exist in natural things, even though they are imagined as abstracted from them [. . .].

[2.6a] The primary subject-matter (*al-mawḍūʿ al-awwal*) of this science is the absolute existent and what is equivalent to it in universality, namely the one. But since the knowledge of opposite correlatives is one, the investigation of non-existence (*al-ʿadam*) and multiplicity (*al-kaṯra*) is also included in this science.

[2.6b] Then, after these subject-matters (*mawḍūʿāt*) and their verification, it investigates the things which are as species to them etc.

[3.3] The third treatise contains the enumeration of the subject-matters (*mawḍūʿāt*) of this science, namely the things about which and about whose proper accidents it investigates. These are [the things] that we have enumerated.

[3.4] The fourth treatise contains the distinction of what is meant by each of the expressions indicating the subject-matters (*mawḍūʿāt*) of this science, the species of its subject-matters (*mawḍūʿātihī*) and the attributes of them, either by univocity, or gradation of meaning, or true equivocity.

In [2.5] the identity of the subject-matters of metaphysics is not specified; we only guess from the plural of the term designating them that they are more than one. Their identity and number become clear in [2.6a], where "existent" and "one" are qualified as primary subject-matters. However, the expression "subject-matters" in [2.6b] appears to refer not only to "existent" and "one", but also to non-existence and multiplicity: al-Fārābī probably regards these latter as secondary subject-matters, in so far as they are opposite to "existent" and "one". A point implicit in [2.6b] is made clear in [3.3] and [3.4], namely that the subject-matters of metaphysics have species and proper accidents or attributes, i.e. properties. Species and properties of the subject-matter, together with its principles, are the main elements of a science according to the epistemology of Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics*, as we will see more in detail in Chapter 5.

Of the two misconceptions affecting the *Metaphysics* expounded in section [1.2], al-Fārābī discusses only the former, namely the supposed identity between metaphysics and philosophical theology. He shows that this conception is false in the following way:

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meaning in all likelihood discrete quantity as the subject-matter of arithmetic and continuous quantity as the subject-matter of geometry (cp. [2.1]). The subject-matters of the particular sciences are mentioned in [2.1], p. 34, 22, and [2.6e], p. 36, 18–19.

Text 3: al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, pp. 35, 8–12, 16–19; 36, 17–18; 38, 2

[2.2] Universal science (*al-ʿilm al-kullī*), on the other hand, investigates what is common to all existents (like existence and oneness), its species and attributes, the things which are not proper accidents of any of the subject-matters of the particular science (like priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfect and deficient, and similar things), and the common Principle (*al-mabdaʾ al-muštarak*) of all existents, namely the thing that ought to be called by the name of God.

[2.4] The divine science (*al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*) ought to belong to this [universal] science, because God is a principle (*mabdaʾ*) of the absolute existent, not of one existent to the exclusion of another. That division (*qism*) [of the universal science], then, which contains providing the principle (*al-mabdaʾ*) of the existent ought to be the divine science.

[2.6d] Then [it investigates] into the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of each one of these [i.e. of existent, one, non-existence and multiplicity]. [. . .]

[3.11] The eleventh treatise deals with the Principle (*mabdaʾ*) of all substance and existence etc.

In Text 3 al-Fārābī establishes three main points. First, God belongs to the rubric "principle of all the existents" or "principle of existent" (explicitly in [2.2] and [2.4], implicitly in [2.6d] and [3.11]). Second, the principle of "existent" is only one of the items taken into account by metaphysics, together with "existent" itself and the other subject-matters, their species and their properties ([2.2] and [2.6d]). Third, the science of God, i.e. the "divine science" (*al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*) or philosophical theology, is consequently only a "part" (*qism*) of metaphysics ([2.4]).[16] On account of these three points, Al-Fārābī shows that philosophical theology does not coincide with metaphyscs—as wrongly assumed—but represents a branch of it.

To sum up: part [2] establishes that metaphysics is the only universal science and the only science worthy to be called "metaphysics"; that it has some subject-matters, primary among which are "existent" and "one", and deals with their species, properties and principles; that philosophical theology, meant as the investigation of the principle of "existent" in so far as it is existent, is only a part of metaphysics.

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[16] The term al-Fārābī uses here (*qism*) is the same he uses elsewhere in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* to refer to the single books of the *Metaphysics* (see Text 1, [1.1] and [4]). Possibly, therefore, he means not only that the divine science is a part of metaphysics, but also that it is contained in a single book of the *Metaphysics*, namely Λ. When, within the description of *Metaphysics* E (§1, [3.5]), al-Fārābī says that "divine science" is "this science (i.e. metaphysics) in a certain way", he is reporting Aristotle's doctrine in E, 1, rather than expressing his own point of view.

Part [3], finally, provides the description of twelve of the fourteen books of the *Metaphysics*. The missing books are A and—in all likelihood—N.[17] The description of some books is rather vague. This happens in the case of the tenth ([3.10]) and twelfth book ([3.12]), even though there is no reason to assume that these descriptions do not refer to books K and M respectively.[18] It has to be noticed that al-Fārābī's description of the single books of the *Metaphysics* is frequently selective, i.e. he does not describe their entire content, but focuses on the main theme or themes in them.

The *Fī Aġrāḍ* is neither a commentary on the *Metaphysics*, nor a reworking of it, but rather an introduction. Thus, al-Fārābī deals with certain issues—like the "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) of the *Metaphysics*,[19] the "name" (*ism*) of the science contained in it,[20] and the "divisions" (*aqsām*) of this work[21]—that correspond to some of the preliminary questions discussed by the Neoplatonic commentators of Aristotle at the beginning of their exegesis of the single Aristotelian works, namely the question of the "goal" (σκοπός), "title" (ἐπιγραφή) and "division into chapters" (εἰς τὰ κεφάλαια διαίρεσις) of the work commented upon.[22]

Among these issues, the "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) is no doubt the most important, as the title of al-Fārābī's essay makes clear. Since al-Fārābī speaks of the goal of the *Metaphysics* in different ways and contexts, it is convenient to examine preliminarily all his relevant statements in this regard.

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[17] As to the fact that the descriptions of the first [3.1] and twelfth book ([3.12]) probably refer to α and M, see Chapter 1, n. 60.

[18] In the former case, al-Fārābī points to the intermediate function of K, i.e. its representing the passage from the discussion of the properties of the subject-matters of the metaphysics in the previous books to the investigation of their principles in book Λ, along the guidelines of [2.2] and [2.6]. In the latter case, what al-Fārābī says about book M corresponds to his description of the last part of metaphysics in [2.6d]. In both cases, the sketch of metaphysics as a discipline provided in part [2] appears to influence the description of the *Metaphysics* as a work in part [3].

[19] See below, Text 4.

[20] See [2.5].

[21] See [1.1] and [4] in text 4 below. For a survey of the topics and the rhetorical devices of the general introductions of al-Fārābī's works, see Harvey [2004], pp. 21–26 (Harvey does not take into account the *Fī Aġrāḍ*).

[22] See Chapter 5, §4.2.

Text 4: al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, pp. 34, 1–5, 6–8, 11–13, 19–20; 38, 6

[Title] Treatise . . . on the goals (*aġrāḍ*) of the Sage [i.e. Aristotle] in each treatise of the book named by means of letters [i.e. the *Metaphysics*], namely (*wa-huwa*) the determination of Aristotle's goal (*ġaraḍ*) in the book *Metaphysics*.

[1.1] He [i.e. al-Fārābī] says: Our aim in this treatise is to indicate the goal (*ġaraḍ*) that Aristotle's book known as *Metaphysics* contains, and the primary divisions (*aqsām*) of it.

[1.2] [. . .] since we find most of the discussion in it [i.e. in the *Metaphysics*] devoid of this goal (*hāḏā l-ġaraḍ*) [i.e. the treatment of theological matters], or, rather, we do not find in it any specific discussion of this goal (*hāḏā l-ġaraḍ*), except [the discussion] that takes place in the eleventh treatise, the one designated as "L" [i.e. Λ].

[1.4] We want to indicate the goal (*ġaraḍ*) that is present in it [i.e. in the entire *Metaphysics*] and that which each of its treatises contains.

[4] This is the clarification of the goal (*ġaraḍ*) of this book and [the clarification] of its divisions (*aqsām*).

In Text 4, al-Fārābī mentions both the specific goals of the single books ("divisions", *aqsām*)[23] of the *Metaphysics* (in [Title] and [1.4]),[24] and the overall goal of the entire *Metaphysics*. In part [3] of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, devoted to discussing the goals of the single books, al-Fārābī provides an account of their content, focusing either on one or several of their themes. Thus, it appears that the specific goals of the single books of the *Metaphysics* are their prime topics. As to the overall goal of the *Metaphysics*, it is always referred to in the singular. Furthermore, the goal of the *Metaphysics* mentioned in [1.1] is identified in [1.2] with the theological investigation performed by Aristotle in book Λ. Thus, according to al-Fārābī the single goal of the entire *Metaphysics* is the theological investigation. In other words: according to al-Fārābī, the *Metaphysics* has both a primary goal, i.e. the theological investigation, and several secondary goals, corresponding to the main topics of its single books.

This explains why, in the part of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* devoted to discussing the general goal of the *Metaphysics* (part [2]), al-Fārābī, as

[23] The term *qism*, *aqsām* is used also in [2.4], p. 35, 18.

[24] In [Title], he refers to these goals collectively in the plural; in [1.4], on the other hand, he refers to each of them distributively in the singular. Whereas in [Title] the goals of the single books appear to coincide with the goal of the entire *Metaphysics*, in [1.4] the former are distinct from the latter. Due to the distinction that al-Fārābī draws, in [1.1] and [4], between the *Metaphysics* in its entirety and its single books, it is safe to assume that he has in mind two distinct types of goals.

we have seen, deals primarily with the theological investigation, but takes into account also several other themes, roughly corresponding to the topics of the single books, without assigning specifically to any of them the role of goal of the *Metaphysics* or regarding any of them as more important than the others. Significantly, in light of what we are going to see, among these themes (i.e. secondary goals) there are the investigation of existent *qua* existent (see [2.2], [2.6a] and, more in general, the entire part [2]) and the metaphysical proof of the principles of the other sciences (see [2.6e]).

3 The *Fī Aġrāḍ*: Sources

A work like the *Fī Aġrāḍ* is unprecedented in Arabic philosophy: it is reasonable to look for its source in Greek metaphysics. In fact, it appears to be connected with the commentatorial tradition of Late Antiquity, in general, and with Ammonius' school in VI c. Alexandria, in particular. The dependence of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* on Ammonius' metaphysics is shown by the similarities with Ammonius' commentary on the *Metaphysics*—preserved in Greek in the *reportatio* by the disciple Asclepius[25]—even though this commentary, as we are going to see, is not the direct source of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*. The relevant indications are the following.

First, as I have already remarked, the *Fī Aġrāḍ* inherits from the commentatorial tradition of Late Antiquity the character of *prolegomenon*. Now, Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary on the *Metaphysics* is the only Greek commentary on this work which includes the discussion of *prolegomena*. Thus, even though the propaedeutic issues discussed by Ammonius/Asclepius in the commentary on the *Metaphysics* are more numerous than, and partially different from, those dealt with in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*,[26] and even though al-Fārābī is not the first

[25] Asclepius [1888]. On Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary, see Luna [2003].

[26] In Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary there are two distinct Prolegomena, both belonging to the theory of the first praxis (Asclepius [1888], pp. 1, 4–5, 32): the former occurs in the commentary on the first lemma of the theory (pp. 1, 4–2, 3), the latter in the commentary on the second lemma of the theory (pp. 2, 4–5, 32). In the first Prolegomenon, three topics are first mentioned (p. 1, 6–7) and then discussed (p. 1, 7–22): (i) the goal of the *Metaphysics* (σκοπός, p. 1, 7–8); (ii) its position within Aristotle's *corpus* of works (τάξις, p. 1, 8–19); (iii) the reason of its title (ἡ αἰτία τῆς ἐπιγραφῆς, p. 1, 19–22). In the remainder of the commentary on the

Arab philosopher to discuss these issues with regard to the *Metaphysics*,[27] the common application to the *Metaphysics* of the explicative tool of the *prolegomena* represents a first significant similarity between Ammonius and al-Fārābī.

Second, the specific description of the goal of the *Metaphysics* is remarkably similar in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* and in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary on the *Metaphysics*. As already pointed out (see above, Text 4), the goal of the *Metaphysics* in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* is identified primarily with the investigation of theological matters, but also, in a secondary way, with the group of topics mentioned in the outline of metaphysics in part [2]. A similar approach can be found in the *prolegomena* of Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary on the *Metaphysics*.

Text 5: Ammonius/Asclepius, *In Metaph.*, pp. 1, 7–8; 2, 9–20

[a] (p. 1, 7–8) Goal (σκοπός) of the present investigation [i.e. of the *Metaphysics*] is to theologize. For in it Aristotle theologizes.

[b1] (p. 2, 9–15) The goal (ὁ σκοπός) of the present book is to speak about beings and [to speak about them] *qua* beings, and to discuss about all beings in absolute terms, in so far as they are beings. Hence we have proposed the following definition of philosophy: "Knowledge of beings *qua* beings". For here the discussion regards neither particulars, like comets, as in the *Meteorologica*, nor universals, as in the *De Caelo*. Rather, it regards all beings universally.

[b2] (p. 2, 15–16) For theologizing is incumbent upon him [i.e. Aristotle] in the present book.

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first lemma (pp. 1, 22–2, 3), it is shown that Aristotle "theologizes", i.e. speaks about God, not only in the *Metaphysics*, but also in his works of natural philosophy (*De Generatione et Corruptione*, *Physics* and *De Anima* are mentioned). In the second Prolegomenon, four general topics are mentioned (p. 2, 5–7) and discussed (pp. 2, 9–4, 3): (i) the goal of the *Metaphysics* (σκοπός, p. 2, 9–20); (ii) its utility (τὸ χρήσιμον, pp. 2, 20–3, 20); (iii) its position within Aristotle's *corpus* of works (τάξις, p. 3, 21–27); (iv) the reason of its title (ἡ αἰτία τῆς ἐπιγραφῆς, pp. 3, 27–4, 3). A fifth topic follows: (v) the way according to which the *Metaphysics* is organized (ὁ τρόπος τῆς συντάξεως, p. 4, 4–16). Two more specific topics (mentioned at p. 2, 7–9) are added, as a way of introducing the exegesis of book A: the relationship between books A and α (p. 4, 17–35); Aristotle's starting-point in conveying the knowledge of first philosophy (pp. 4, 36–5, 32). Only topics (i) and (iii) in the first Prolegomenon and topics (i) and (iv) in the second have a parallel in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*. Nowhere in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary we find a division of the *Metaphysics* similar to the one that al-Fārābī provides in part [3].

[27] The issues of the title and of the "intention" (*qaṣd*) of the *Metaphysics* are briefly discussed in Ṯābit Ibn Qurra's *Talḫīṣ* of this work (Ṯābit Ibn Qurra [forthcoming]); see Chapter 5, §4.2, n. 54.

[b3] (p. 2, 16–20) By all means, [it is incumbent upon him] also to discuss about elements and principles, for only first philosophy is charged with proving the principles of all the sciences. For the other sciences do not prove the[ir] proper principles, but only first philosophy proves the principles of all the sciences.

This [has to be said] about the goal (τοῦ σκοποῦ).

The idea that the theological discussion is the goal of the *Metaphysics* occurs in two places of Ammonius/Asclepius' *prolegomena* ([a] and [b2]).[28] Even though this idea is present *in nuce* in Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on *Metaphysics* Λ, as reported by Averroes,[29] it is strongly emphasized in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary: besides being repeated twice in Text 5, it also recurs elsewhere in the commentary.[30] This corresponds to the primacy that al-Fārābī assigns to the theological investigation among the goals of the *Metaphysics* (see above, Text 4, [1.2]). In sections [b1] and [b3] of Ammonius/Asclepius' *prolegomena*, the goal of the *Metaphysics* is portrayed differently. In [b1], it is the universal investigation of being *qua* being.[31] This is the same as one of the secondary goals of the *Metaphysics* according to the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, as we have seen. In section [b3] of Ammonius/Asclepius' *prolegomena*, finally, the goal of the *Metaphysics* coincides with a further notion, i.e. the proof provided by metaphysics (called "first philosophy") of the principles of the other sciences.[32] This corresponds to another of the secondary goals of the *Metaphysics* in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, as we have seen. To explain how these different characterizations of the goal of the *Metaphysics* in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary relate to each other is not our task here. What is important to notice is

[28] The relevance of [a] has been remarked by Gutas [1988], p. 251 and n. 29, who refers also to p. 1, 18–19 of Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary, where the *Metaphysics*—in the context of the discussion of its position (τάξις) in the Aristotelian *corpus*—is described as "theology", i.e. as an investigation of things completely unmoved. Frede [1987], p. 82, points at pp. 1, 18–2, 3 as an indicator that Ammonius/Asclepius conceived of the *Metaphysics* as a theological treatise. As a matter of fact, a reference to the theological character of some parts of Aristotle's natural philosophy occurs at p. 1, 22–24, within the discussion of the reason of the title (ἡ αἰτία τῆς ἐπιγραφῆς) of the *Metaphysics*. The same idea expressed in [b2] occurs also at p. 2, 23, within the context of the discussion of the utility (τὸ χρήσιμον) of the *Metaphysics*.

[29] See Chapter 4, §2.2, Text 11.

[30] See p. 395, 1–2; p. 397, 5–6.

[31] The goal of the *Metaphysics* is portrayed in this way also at p. 143, 15–16.

[32] The same idea occurs at p. 5, 29–32.

the striking similarity between the account of the goal of the *Metaphysics* in the *prolegomena* of Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary and its treatment in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*.[33]

Third, Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary on the *Metaphysics* takes into account not only the general goal of the *Metaphysics*, but also the goals of some of the single books of this work. This happens in the case of books B, Γ and E, namely three of the seven books that the commentary, in the form in which it is extant, embraces. The goal of these books is the first thing mentioned in the introduction to them.

> Text 6: Ammonius/Asclepius, *In Metaph.*, pp. 137, 13–14; 222, 6–7; 358, 4–5
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> [a] (p. 137, 13–14) Then [i.e. after books A and α] the goal (σκοπός) of the present book, namely of B, is to raise difficulties with regard to first philosophy.
>
> [b] (p. 222, 6–7) The goal (σκοπός) of the present book [i.e. Γ] is to solve many of the difficulties mentioned in the second [book], namely in B.
>
> [c] (p. 358, 4–5) The goal (σκοπός) of Aristoteles in [book] E is to speak about being *per accidens*.

Even though the description of the goal of books B, Γ and E is only partially similar in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary and in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* (cp. especially Text 6 [a] and [c] with [3.2] and [3.5]), the fact that both works devote considerable attention to this issue represents another significant similarity between them.

Fourth, section [1.3] of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* contains an undetermined reference to previous philosophers that can be regarded as an allusion to Ammonius.

> Text 7: al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 34, 14–18
>
> [a] Furthermore, the Ancients do not have (*lā yūǧad li-l-qudamā'*) any discussion aimed at explaining (*kalām fī šarḥ*) this book [i.e. the *Metaphysics*] as it is, contrarily to what happens with the other books [by Aristotle].
>
> [b] If such a discussion can be found, it is the incomplete one concerning treatise "L" by Alexander [of Aphrodisias], and the complete one [concerning the same treatise] by Themistius.
>
> [c] As to the other treatises, either they have not been explained, or [their explanation] has not been preserved,

[33] Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary exhibits also a notion of "being *qua* being" as "subject-matter" (ὑποκείμενον) of metaphysics—taken from Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary—that is similar to al-Fārābī's conception of "existent" as primary subject-matter of metaphysics in *Fī Aġrāḍ* [2.6a]; see Chapter 4, §2.2.

> [d] as one might think by seeing in the books (*kutub*) of the Posterior Peripatetics (*al-muta'aḫḫirīna min al-maššā'iyyīna*) that Alexander had commented upon the book [i.e. the *Metaphysics*] in its entirety.

In [a], al-Fārābī states that no complete commentary on the *Metaphysics* by "the Ancients" (*al-qudamā'*) is available in Arabic. The expression "the Ancients" refers to the Ancient Greek commentators, as it becomes clear in [b], in which the commentaries by Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius on *Metaphysics* Λ are mentioned as extant in Arabic. In [c], al-Fārābī maintains that either these ancient Greek commentators have not commented on the *Metaphysics* in its entirety, or that their commentaries have not been preserved. The latter alternative is corroborated by [d], which is the relevant part of Text 7 for our purposes.

In [d], al-Fārābī states that the inspection of certain "books" (*kutub*) of the "Posterior Peripatetics" (*al-muta'aḫḫirīna min al-maššā'iyyīna*) attests that Alexander of Aphrodisias had, in fact, commented upon the whole *Metaphysics*. Four remarks are in order. First, al-Fārābī had direct access to the books in question, since he maintains to have read them ("as one might think by seeing . . ."). Second, these books are independent treatises on metaphysics rather than commentaries on the *Metaphysics*, since they are named "books" (*kutub*), not "discussion aimed at explaining" (*kalām fī šarḥ*), i.e. commentaries, as in [a]. Third, the authors of these books, namely the Posterior Peripatetics, are later than the "Ancients", i.e. Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius, and are Greek philosophers, since they are witnesses of a part of Alexander's commentary not translated or not extant in Arabic. Fourth, these independent treatises on metaphysics of the Posterior Peripatetics must have contained many references to Alexander's commentary on the *Metaphysics* such as: "In his commentary on *Metaphysics* A, Alexander says that . . .", or: "In his commentary on *Metaphysics* α, Alexander says that . . ." etc., from which it could be inferred that the scope of Alexander's commentary was broader than book Λ.

All these indications converge on Ammonius. For some of his works on metaphysics were known to al-Fārābī, like the treatise on Aristotle's doctrine of God as artificer (i.e. efficient cause) of the world, quoted and portrayed as well-known in the *Ǧam*ʿ;[34] he was

[34] Al-Fārābī [1890], pp. 24, 24–25, 1; Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 102, 20–21; Al-Fārābī

posterior to Alexander and Themistius; and he made extensive use of Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on the *Metaphysics*, as his own commentary on the *Metaphysics* witnesses.[35] On account of this evidence, it can be inferred that Ammonius is one of the Posterior Peripatetics envisaged by al-Fārābī in [d].

Once Ammonius is placed in the background of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*, it is also possible to ascertain more precisely the work by Ammonius on which al-Fārābī's essay directly depends. This work

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[1999], p. 135, 1–2: "Ammonius is the author of a treatise specifically devoted to recording the statements of these two sages [i.e. Aristotle and Plato] on establishing [the existence of] the Artificer; on account of its celebrity we are dispensed from mentioning it here" (*wa-li-Amūniyūsa risālatun mufradatun fī ḏikri aqāwili hāḏayni l-ḥakīmayni fī iṯbāti l-ṣāniʿi istaġnaynā li-šuhratihā ʿan iḥḍārinā iyyāhā fī hāḍa l-mawḍiʿi*). See the French translation in Mallet [1989], pp. 86–87 and n. 92, and Nağğār-Mallet [1999], p. 134 and n. 1: "Ammonius a écrit une épître entièrement consacrée au rappel des discours de ces deux sages sur la preuve de l'existence de l'artisan. Nous nous sommes dispensés, en raison de sa célébrité de la citer ici-même". On this quotation, see Mahdi [1967], p. 236, n. 9; Badawī [1968], p. 107; Rowson [1988], pp. 254–257; Sorabji [1990], pp. 182–183; Endress [1991], p. 243, p. 249. Al-Fārābī's mention of the well-known nature of Ammonius' treatise might suggest that he is referring to the doxography widely circulating in the Arab world under the name of Ammonius (see Pseudo-Ammonius [1989]; I wish to thank Cristina D'Ancona for having brought this possibility to my attention). However, the treatise by Ammonius quoted by al-Fārābī appears to be a different one, namely the one mentioned by Simplicius in his commentaries on the *Physics* and the *De Caelo* (Simplicius [1895], p. 1363, 8–12 [ad *Phys.* 321b]: ". . . My teacher Ammonius wrote a whole book offering many proofs that Aristotle thought God was also an efficient cause of the whole cosmos . . .", Engl. transl. in Sorabji [1990], pp. 184–185; Simplicius [1894], p. 271, 18–21 [ad *De Cael.* 486a32]), and by the *Fihrist* (Ibn al-Nadīm [1871–2], p. 253, 21–22, Ibn al-Nadīm [1988], p. 314, 2: "Book of the commentary on Aristotle's doctrines on the Artificer" [*Kitāb šarḥ maḏāhib Arisṭālīs fī l-ṣāniʿ*]). The pseudo-Ammonian doxography deals with many more authors than Plato and Aristotle, conveys a disparaging view of Aristotle, and does not contain the doctrine ascribed by al-Fārābī to Ammonius. On the other hand, immediately before the aforementioned quotation of Ammonius, al-Fārābī attributes to Aristotle the doctrine of God as the efficient cause (*ʿilla fāʿila*) of the universe, the main tenet of Ammonius' treatise according to Simplicius. Ammonius is quoted even earlier in the *Ğamʿ*, in a logical context (Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 10, 4–5; Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 87, 3–4; Mallet [1989], p. 69 and n. 34; Nağğār-Mallet [1999], p. 86 and n. 1). In this quotation, Ammonius is portrayed as prior, rather than posterior, to Themistius. But this lack of chronological exactness does not necessarily imply that al-Fārābī is not referring to Ammonius Son of Hermeias, as Nağğār and Mallet propose (they think that he might be referring to Ammonius Saccas, teacher of Plotinus). Wisnovsky [2003], p. 108, regards al-Fārābī's attempt at reconciling the Aristotelian notion of "potency" (*quwwa*) and the Neoplatonic notion of "perfect" (*tāmm*) in [2.2] and [2.6c] as a sign of dependence upon Ammonius.

[35] Alexander's commentary is quoted in the exegesis of all the books commented

is not Ammonius' commentary on the *Metaphysics*, since this commentary was not translated into Arabic, and it is not mentioned by al-Fārābī in [1.3] (= Text 7) among the commentaries on the *Metaphysics* he had access to. Probably it is not Ammonius' treatise on Aristotle's doctrine of God as artificer of the world either, since this treatise, extant neither in Greek nor in Arabic, appears to be an essay on a specific metaphysical doctrine, rather than a general introduction to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* like the *Fī Aġrāḍ*. The work by Ammonius which lies behind al-Fārābī's treatise is probably the part concerning the *Metaphysics* of a general introduction to Aristotle's *corpus*, which, albeit not extant in Greek or Arabic, is mentioned in the Arabic bibliographical literature.

Significantly, among the works by Ammonius the Arabic historical sources report a book whose title is strikingly similar to that of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*. This represents a fifth piece of evidence to prove that Ammonius is the source of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*. In the entry devoted to Ammonius, the *Fihrist* mentions—after Ammonius' Aristotelian commentaries and his essay on Aristotle's doctrine of God as artificer—the following book:

> Text 8: *Fihrist*, vol. I, p. 253, 22
> Book on the goals (*fī aġrāḍ*) of Aristotle in his books (*fī kutubihī*).[36]

Unfortunately, this work by Ammonius is not extant either in Greek or Arabic. From its title we can surmise that it was a general introduction to the Aristotelian *corpus*, elucidating the goals (and possibly also the other preliminary issues) of each of Aristotle's works.

Now, the title of this essay is remarkably similar, both in the sequence of its elements and in its terminology, to the title of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*. The only difference between the two titles concerns their last element and points to a different scope of investigation of the two works: whereas Ammonius' essay ranges over all the Aristotelian *corpus* ("in his [i.e. Aristotle's] books"), al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* focuses on a specific work by Aristotle, i.e. the *Metaphysics*. On account of this evidence, it would not be far-fetched to assume that al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* reproduces, or is inspired by, the part of this essay by Ammonius dealing with Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Should this be the

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upon by Ammonius/Asclepius, except E. On the influence of Alexander's commentary on the *Metaphysics* on Ammonius/Asclepius', see Luna [2001c].

[36] *kitāb fī aġrāḍi Arisṭālīsa fī kutubihī*. Cp. Ibn al-Nadīm [1988], p. 314, 3.

case, then Ammonius' essay would be not only the source of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, but also—together with Ammonius' treatise on Aristotle's doctrine on God as artificer—one of the "books" (significantly in the plural) of the Posterior Peripatetics mentioned by al-Fārābī in Text 7 [d].

In front of these five pieces of evidence attesting the dependence of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* on Ammonius' metaphysics, there is one main reason that can be advanced in order to prove the contrary. This is the fact that Ammonius knew the *Metaphysics* in its entirety, whereas al-Fārābī was unaware of some of its books, like A and N. It might be argued, therefore, that a work by Ammonius cannot be the source of *Fī Aġrāḍ*, since in this case al-Fārābī would have known and presumably mentioned the books of the *Metaphysics* that, on the contrary, he ignores. This line of reasoning, however, is not conclusive. First, even though Ammonius comments upon book A in his commentary on the *Metaphysics*, and in the *prolegomena* of this same commentary maintains that the *Metaphysics* consists of fourteen books (from A until N)—rejecting the view of those who ascribe A not to Aristotle, but to Pasicles of Rhodes[37]—he also adopts a less inclusive numbering of the books of the *Metaphysics*, by calling B "second" book, instead of third, and Γ "third", instead of fourth.[38] Second, even if we assume that the work by Ammonius representing the source of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* encompassed all the books of the *Metaphysics*, al-Fārābī might have reworked the indications that he found in it adapting them to the data at his disposal, i.e. to the fact that the Arabic translation the *Metaphysics* accessible to him—the translation by Usṭāṯ—lacked books A and N. In other words, the different scope of the *Metaphysics* in Ammonius' essay and the *Fī Aġrāḍ* does not necessarily exclude the dependence of the latter upon the former; it could rather show that al-Fārābī was original in using Ammonius' metaphysics as his source.

To summarize: In the light of its literary genre (an introduction to the *Metaphysics* modeled on the *prolegomena* literature of Late Antiquity), some of its doctrines (the investigation of God as the main goal of metaphysics, metaphyiscs as the universal science of existent *qua* existent, the fact that the principles of the particular sciences are

[37] Asclepius [1888], p. 4, 18–22.
[38] Asclepius [1888], p. 222, 7; p. 223, 11.

proved by metaphysics), its theme (an investigation of the goal of the *Metaphysics* and of the goals of its single books), some of the authors referred to in it (the Posterior Peripatetics) and the range of its possible sources (Ammonius' treatise on the goals of Aristotle's works, mentioned in the *Fihrist*), al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* can be envisaged as dependent on Ammonius' metaphysics.

The reliance of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* on Ammonius' metaphysics needs further corroboration. The first question to be answered is how wide was the diffusion of Ammonius' treatise in the Arabic tradition,[39] and, more specifically, its relation with the last part of al-Kindī's *Risāla fī Kammiyyat kutub Arisṭāṭālīs* (*Treatise on the Number of Aristotle's Books*), in which the "goals" (*aġrāḍ*) of Aristotle's books are expounded,[40] even though only a few lines are devoted to the *Metaphysics*.[41] Should the pieces of evidence presented here be confirmed by future research, we would be in presence of an important, and unknown so far, *trait-d'union* between the Greek and the Arabic tradition of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. The historical significance of this connection cannot be overemphasized.

The *Fī Aġrāḍ*, and its presumed source in Ammonius, is built upon the doctrines of some books of the *Metaphysics*. Book Γ is primary in this regard. The entire part [2] of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* depends on Γ, as al-Fārābī himself acknowledges in the description of Γ in [3.3]. In this description, he also mention the fundamental distinction between the

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[39] The *Fihrist* does not say that this treatise was translated into Arabic. Al-Fārābī's acquaintance with it would imply the existence either of an Arabic translation unknown to Ibn al-Nadīm or of some kind of intermediate source. On al-Fārābī's dependence on Alexandrian philosophy, see Gutas [1983], Gutas [1999], Gutas [1999b] and Vallat [2004].

[40] Al-Kindī [1940], pp. 399–403 (chapters VIII–XII; Italian transl. pp. 414–419); Al-Kindī [1950b], pp. 378, 15–384, 20. In Al-Kindī [1940], the sources of this part of al-Kindī's treatise are not investigated. With regard to Abū l-Faraǧ ibn al-Ṭayyib, who mentions the "goals" of Aristotle's books on natural philosophy, Hein [1985], p. 276, states that "es bleibt zu untersuchen, welchen Vorbildern er hierbei möglicherweise folgt".

[41] Al-Kindī [1940], p. 403, 8–11 (chapter XI, Italian transl. p. 418); Al-Kindī [1950b], p. 384, 7–10. English translation in Gutas [1988], p. 244. In this passage, whose source is still to be identified, the "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) of Aristotle in the *Metaphysics* is described as two-fold: first, the investigation, among the things that are not joined with matter nor defined by means of it, of those immaterial things that subsist without matter, but exist in association with something material (probably the celestial intellects and souls); second, the elucidation of God's unicity, names, efficient and final causation of the universe, and government of the universe.

subject-matters studied by metaphysics and their properties.[42] Several themes of Γ are reproduced in [2].[43] More in general, al-Fārābī's conception of the content and structure of metaphysics, and his explanation of how philosophical theology belongs to metaphysics, come from Γ, 1–2, as we will see more in detail in Chapters 4–5. Among the other books of the *Metaphysics*, also Ε has exerted a certain influence.[44]

4 *Fī Aġrāḍ*: Influence on Avicenna

The *Fī Aġrāḍ* had a strong impact on the subsequent reception of the *Metaphysics* in Arabic. Averroes' Prologue to *Metaphysics* Λ, for example, appears to depend on this treatise.[45] As to Avicenna, in Chapter 2 we have already examined the famous passage of the Autobiography in which he acknowledges his debt towards this treatise for his understanding of the *Metaphysics*.[46] In the following chapters we will see in detail how the *Fī Aġrāḍ* influenced Avicenna's conception of the epistemological profile of the *Metaphysics*, with par-

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[42] This distinction is then resumed in the description of book Δ ([3.4]), where also the species are mentioned. In the puzzling description of book Κ ([3.10]), al-Fārābī alludes to a distinction between principles and "accidents" of metaphysics.

[43] The distinction between the particular sciences and the universal science in [2.1]–[2.2] is taken from Γ, 1, 1003a21–26; the reason why metaphysics investigates God, according to [2.4]—namely the fact that He is the principle of all existents, not of one existent to the exclusion of another—is the same reason why metaphysics investigates the axioms, according to Γ, 3, 1005a22–23; the idea that the knowledge of opposites is one in [2.6a] occurs in Γ, 2, 1004a9–10; Γ is the source also of some concepts taken into account by metaphysics, like priority, posteriority and perfect in [2.2] (Γ, 2, 1005a16, 1005a12), perfection, sameness and similarity in [2.6c] (Γ, 2, 1005a12, 1003b35–36).

[44] In [3.5], al-Fārābī indicated book Ε as the place where the relationship between the divine science and metaphysics is clarified. The expression "absolute existent" in [2.4] and [2.6a] resembles the expression (περὶ) ὄντος ἁπλῶς in Ε, 1, 1025b9 (*al-huwwiyya al-kulliyya*, *Tafsīr*, p. 698, 1).

[45] In *Tafsīr*, pp. 1395, 11–1405, 15, Averroes shapes his explanation of Alexander's introduction to Λ along the lines of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*: he provides a general outline of the contents of metaphysics (pp. 1395, 11–1397, 4), followed by a description of the single books (pp. 1397, 5–1405, 3). Furthermore, while describing the single books, he sometimes mentions their specific "goal" (*ġaraḍ*), as in the case of book Δ (p. 1401, 2). For the theological discussion in Λ as Aristotle's "primary intent" (*qaṣduhū al-awwal*) or "aim sought for" (*ġāya maqṣūda*) or "primary goal" (*ġaraḍuhū al-awwal*) in the *Metaphysics*, see *Tafsīr*, p. 1404, 4–5; p. 1404, 12.

[46] See Chapter 2, §2.

ticular regard to its subject-matter and goal (Chapter 4), structure (Chapter 5) and relationship with the other sciences (Chapter 7). In the present section, I wish to point to some passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt* which are quotations/paraphrases of texts of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*. These passages occur in the second and third chapter of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (I, 2–3), a part of this work in which also Avicenna, like al-Fārābī, faces some of the *prolegomena* issues.[47] They concern fundamental topics such as the role of existent *qua* existent as the subject-matter of metaphysics (Table 1), the function of metaphysics as the discipline that certifies the principles of the other sciences (Table 2), the classification of the things taken into account by metaphysics according to their different relation with matter (Table 3), and the name of metaphysics (Table 4).

Table 1

Ilāhiyyāt, I, 2, pp. 12, 15–13, 7 [p. 12, 18–29]	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 35, 8–11 [2.2]
[a] Likewise, there are also things that must be defined and verified in the soul and that are common in the sciences,	
[b] even though not even one of the sciences takes upon itself the task of discussing them	
[c] like one *qua* one, many *qua* many, congruent, different, contrary and so on.	. . . like priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfect and deficient, and similar things.
[d] Some of them [i.e. of the sciences] use them in a certain way, others only assume their definitions, without discussing the manner of their existence.	
	Universal science, on the other hand, investigates
[e] They are not proper accidents of any of the subject-matters of these particular sciences [. . .]	the things which are not proper accidents of any of the subject-matters of the particular sciences . . .
[f] They cannot be [proper] accidents of anything except of existent *qua* existent.	

[47] See Chapter 5, §4.2.

In this passage of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, Avicenna relies on a doctrine of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, in order to prove that the existent *qua* existent is the subject-matter of metaphysics.[48] Avicenna's argument is the following: there are certain things that must be known and are common to the sciences, like "one", "many", "congruent", "different", "contrary" etc. ([a], [c]); these things are not taken into account by the particular sciences ([b], [d]), since they are not properties of their subject-matters ([e]); hence, they are taken into account by metaphysics; they are properties of existent *qua* existent ([f]); hence, existent *qua* existent is the subject-matter of metaphysics, since every science takes into account the properties of its subject-matter. The list of the things common to the sciences and taken into account by metaphysics ([c]) is different in Avicenna and al-Fārābī. The doctrine expressed in [e], on the other hand, is *verbatim* identical. Whereas in Avicenna it is implicit that metaphysics takes into account these concepts (something explicit in al-Fārābī), in al-Fārābī it is implicit that the particular sciences do not take them into account (something explicit in Avicenna).

Table 2

Ilāhiyyāt, I, 2, pp. 14, 18–15, 7 [p. 15, 73–85]	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 36, 18–19 [2.6e]
[a] Another is that [part] investigating the principles of the particular sciences.	In it [i.e. in metaphysics] the principles of all the particular sciences and the definitions of their subject-matters are clarified.
[b] Since the principles of each science [that is] more specific are questions [discussed] in the science [that is] more general,[49] as the principles of medicine in natural [science] and [the principles] of geodesy in geometry, it occurs therefore to this science that the principles of the particular sciences which investigate the states of the particular [aspects] of "existent"[50] become clear in it.	

[48] See Chapter 4, §1.
[49] Reading *al-aʿammi* instead of *al-aʿlā* (see Appendix A).
[50] Reading *ǧuz'iyyāti al-mawǧūdi* instead of *al-ǧuz'iyyāti al-mawǧūdati* (see Appendix A).

Table 2 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt, I, 2, pp. 14, 18–15, 7 [p. 15, 73–85]	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 36, 18–19 [2.6e]
[c] Thus this science investigates the states of "existent" and the things that are like its divisions and species until it reaches [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter of natural science comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to natural science]—and [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter of mathematics comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to mathematics]—and similarly in the other cases.	[Each one of these, i.e. existent, one, non-existence and multiplicity] is branched out and divided, until the subject-matters of the particular sciences are reached and [consequently] this science ends.
[d] Of what precedes that specification and is as its principle,[51] on the contrary, [this science] investigates and determines the state.	

In this passage of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, Avicenna takes from the *Fī Aġrāḍ* not only the general idea that metaphysics investigates the principles of the particular sciences ([a]), but also the description of the concrete way according to which it performs this task ([c]): metaphysics analyzes and articulates "existent" (al-Fārābī adds also "one", non-existence and multiplicity); in so doing, it ultimately reaches a level of particularity that corresponds to that of the subject-matters of the particular sciences; at this point it stops its own investigation.

Table 3

Ilāhiyyāt, I, 2, pp. 15, 17–16, 7 [pp. 16, 02–17, 13]	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 36, 2–9 [2.5]
[a] Rather, the things investigated in it [i.e. in metaphysics] belong to four divisions.	

[51] Reading *wa-ka-l-mabda'i lahū* instead of *ka-l-mabda'i* (see Appendix A).

Table 3 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt, I, 2, pp. 15, 17–16, 7 [pp. 16, 02–17, 13]	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 36, 2–9 [2.5]
[b] Some of them are absolutely free from matter and material attachments.	Of the subject-matters of this science, on the other hand, some have no existence at all (be it imaginary or real) in natural things. It is not that imagination has abstracted them from natural things; rather, their existence and nature [itself] is abstracted [i.e. immaterial].
[c] Others are mingled with matter, but as the cause that is constitutive [of matter] and anterior [to it], whereas matter is not constitutive of it.	
[d] Others may exist in matter, but may [also] exist[52] not in matter, like causality and unity.	Others exist in natural things, even though they are imagined as abstracted from them.
[e] What these things as such share is the fact that they do not need the existence of matter in order to be verified. This group [of things] also shares the fact of not being material in existence, namely [the fact of] not receiving the existence from matter.	However, they do not exist in natural things essentially, i.e. in such a way that their existence is not independent from these and they are things whose subsistence is due to natural things. Rather, they exist both in natural things and in non-natural things (these latter being separate either really or in imagination).
[f] Others are material things, like movement and rest. But what is investigated [about them] in this science is not their state in matter, rather the mode of existence that they have.	

In this passage of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, Avicenna derives from the *Fī Aġrāḍ* not only the idea of providing a classification of the things investigated by metaphysics ("subject-matters" in al-Fārābī), but also two of the four elements of this classification, namely ([b]) the things that are completely immaterial ("have no existence at all in natural things" in al-Fārābī), and ([d]) those that are only partially material ("exist in natural things, even though they are imagined as abstracted from them" in al-Fārābī). The main difference is that in Avicenna section

[52] Reading *yūǧadu* instead of *tūǧadu* (see Appendix A).

[e] refers to all the types of things mentioned before (in [b], [c] and [d]), whereas in al-Fārābī it refers only to the type of things mentioned in [d].

Table 4

Ilāhiyyāt, I, 3, pp. 21, 12–22, 10; p. 24, 1–2 [pp. 24, 45–25, 65; p. 27, 2–4]	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, pp. 35, 19–36, 2 [2.5]
[a] As to the name of this science, it is "[science] of metaphysics" (*fīmā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*).[53]	Therefore it [i.e. the present science] should be called "metaphysics" (*ʿilm mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*).
[b] [Avicenna elucidates the meaning of *ṭabīʿa* and *baʿda* in the aforementioned name].	
[c] As to the name that this science deserves when it is considered in itself, it is "science of what is before nature" (*ʿilm mā qabla l-ṭabīʿa*),	. . . then this science is loftier than the science of nature and [comes] after the science of nature.
[d] since the things investigated in this science are, in themselves and on account of [their] universality (*bi-l-ʿumūm*), before nature.	Since these things are not proper to natural objects but are loftier than them in universality (*ʿumūman*) . . .
[e] However, someone could say that the pure mathematical things investigated in arithmetic and geometry are also before nature (especially number, for it does not depend at all on nature for its existence, since it may exist not in nature), and [that], therefore, arithmetic and geometry are necessarily science of what is before nature.	Although mathematics is loftier than the science of nature—since its subject-matters are abstracted from matter—
[f] What ought to be said against this objection is that, as far as geometry is concerned, [. . .] it is known that its subject-matter is not separate from nature in subsistence. [. . .]	it ought not to be called "metaphysics". For its subject-matters are abstracted from matter in imagination [only], not in existence. As to existence, they do not exist except in natural things.
[g] Hence arithmetic takes number into account only in so far as number possesses the consideration that it has when it is in nature.	

[53] Reading *fīmā* instead of *mā* (see Appendix A).

In the passage of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3 reported in Table 4, Avicenna reproduces some of al-Fārābī's considerations about the name of metaphysics. In [a] and [b], Avicenna indicates the same name that also al-Fārābī proposes, i.e. "metaphysics", literally: "what is after nature". Then, in [c] he adds a second name, i.e. "science of what is before nature", which is absent in al-Fārābī, but which corresponds to what al-Fārābī states about the superiority of metaphysics over natural philosophy. Moreover, in [d] Avicenna justifies this second name by means of considerations that are similar to those that al-Fārābī uses to explain the name "metaphysics", i. e. the universality of the things that metaphysics takes into account. Finally, in [e]–[g] Avicenna dismisses the claim of the two branches of mathematics (i.e. arithmetic and geometry) to be "metaphysics", along the lines indicated by al-Fārābī, even though al-Fārābī refers to mathematics in its entirety, whereas Avicenna distinguishes the case of geometry ([f]) from that of arithmetic ([g]).

Avicenna's reception of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* is not limited to the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The influence of this treatise by al-Fārābī is clearly visible, for example, in the metaphysical part of the *Naǧāt*. Also in this case, the dependence regards the very beginning of Avicenna's work, i.e. its Introduction.

Table 5

Naǧāt, Metaphysics, Introduction, Avicenna, [1985], p. 493, 2–13	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, pp. 34, 21–35, 7; 35, 8–12, 16–19; 36, 18–19
[a] We say that each of the natural sciences and the mathematical sciences examines the state of some existents only. The other particular sciences do the same. None of them investigates the states of the absolute existent, its attributes and its principles.	[2.1] Particular sciences are those whose subject-matters are some existents or some imaginary objects, and whose investigation regards specifically the accidents that are proper to them. [Examples of natural science, geometry, arithmetic and medicine follow]. None of them investigates what is common to all existents.
[b] It is evident, therefore, that there is a science which examines the condition of the absolute existent, its attributes which pertain to it by itself, and its principles.[54]	[2.2] Universal science, on the other hand, investigates the thing that is common to all existents (like existence and oneness), its species and attributes, the things which are not proper accidents of

[54] Part [b] is omitted (by homoioteleuton) in Avicenna [1985b].

Table 5 (*cont.*)

Naǧāt, Metaphysics, Introduction, Avicenna, [1985], p. 493, 2–13	*Fī Aġrāḍ*, pp. 34, 21–35, 7; 35, 8–12, 16–19; 36, 18–19
	any of the subject-matters of the particular science (like priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfect and deficient, and similar things) and the common principle of all existents, namely the thing that ought to be called by the name of God—may His glory be exalted.
[c] Since God the Most High, by unanimous consensus, is not principle of a caused existent to the exclusion of another,[55] but He is principle of the absolute caused existent,[56] there is no doubt that the divine science is this science.	[2.4] The divine science ought to belong to this [universal] science, because God is a principle of the absolute existent, not of one existent to the exclusion of another. That part [of the universal science], then, which contains providing the principle of the existent ought to be the divine science.
[d] This science, therefore, examines the absolute existent, and ceases from articulating [it] where the other sciences start. In this science, hence, is contained the clarification of the principles of the other sciences [which are] particular.	[2.6e] [Each one of these] is branched out and divided, until the subject-matters of the particular sciences are reached and [consequently] this science ends. In it the principles of all the particular sciences and the definitions of their subject-matters are clarified.

The introduction of the metaphysical part of the *Naǧāt* is a kind of selective summary of part [2] of the *Fī Aġrāḍ*. Avicenna reproduces sections [2.1], [2.2], [2.4] and [2.6e] of al-Fārābī's treatise. In same cases, as in [c] and [d], his account amounts to a paraphrase, similar to its source in terminology and syntax.[57] The only relevant doctrinal difference between the two texts regards section [c]: whereas in al-Fārābī the divine science, i.e. philosophical theology, is a part of metaphysics, in Avicenna it is identical to metaphysics itself.[58]

[55] Reading *dūna mawǧūdin maʿlūlin*, as in Avicenna [1985], instead of *dūna wuǧūdin maʿlūlin āḫara*, as in Avicenna [1938] and Avicenna [1985b], on account of *li-mawǧūdin maʿlūlin* immediately preceding.

[56] Reading *li-l-mawǧūdi l-maʿlūli l-muṭlaqi*, as in Avicenna [1985], instead of *li-l-wuǧūdi l-maʿlūli l-muṭlaqi*, as in Avicenna [1938] and Avicenna [1985b].

[57] In section [b], Avicenna does not call metaphysics "universal science", as al-Fārābī does in [2.2]. This expression, however, occurs in other works by Avicenna (see Appendix D, II.ii.5) and is somehow presupposed by the denomination of the disciplines other than metaphysics "particular sciences" in [a] and [d].

[58] See Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 1.

5 Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in the other works by al-Fārābī

The *Fī Aġrāḍ* is not the only work by al-Fārābī in which the *Metaphysics* is dealt with. Once ascertained that al-Fārābī's *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf* (*Book of Letters*) is not a commentary on the *Metaphysics*, as its title might suggest, but rather a treatise on the philosophical use of "particles" (*ḥarf, ḥurūf*),[59] three main categories of Farabian writings related, in different ways, to the *Metaphysics* can be distinguished. They are (i) the overviews of the Aristotelian *corpus*; (ii) the classifications of the sciences; (iii) al-Fārābī's own works on metaphysics. Even though al-Fārābī quotes the *Metaphysics* also elsewhere,[60] these three kinds of writings represent a privileged vantage point to observe his attitude towards this work.

(i) To the first rubric three works by al-Fārābī belong. In the treatise *Mā yanbaġī an yuqaddama qabla taʿallum falsafat Arisṭū* (*What ought to be premised to the learning of Aristotle's Philosophy*),[61] the mention of the *Metaphysics* is very brief: among Aristotle's books, al-Fārābī enlists

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[59] *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf* (*Book of Letters*) is one of the names of the *Metaphysics* in the Arabic tradition (see Appendix D, I.4). Since al-Fārābī wrote commentaries on Aristotle's logic (the most important of which is his literal commentary on the *De Interpretatione*) and natural philosophy (his commentaries on the *Physics* and the *De Caelo* are quoted by Averroes, see Mahdi [1967], p. 236), it is likely that he wrote also a commentary on the *Metaphysics*.

[60] See, for example, the following passages of the *Alfāẓ*: "Aristotle declares that he rejects this type of doctrine by saying the following: 'They care only to make themselves know, not to make us know; rather, they are reluctant in doing so. It is known that they said these things because they [i.e. these things] were known to them, except that what they established about this [topic] by means of this [type of] statement was incomprehensible to us. Likewise, we do not have to examine the statements of those whose philosophy is like an embellishment'" (Al-Fārābī [1968], pp. 91, 15–92, 3; cp. *Metaph.* B, 4, 1000a9–11, 13–15, 18–19, according to Usṭāṭ's translation, *Tafsīr*, p. 247, 3–4, 6–8, 10–12); "For, when Aristotle in the seventh treatise [= H] of the book *Metaphysics* enumerates the types of definitions and reaches the most perfect type of them, he says the following: 'Definitions like these are among those approved by Archytas'" (Al-Fārābī [1968], pp. 109, 14–110, 1; cp. *Metaph.* H, 3, 1043a21–22, according to a translation different from Usṭāṭ's, *Tafsīr*, p. 1045, 7–8). A further passage of the *Alfāẓ* (Al-Fārābī [1968], p. 110, 1–4), possibly referring to *Metaphysics* A or M, has been mentioned in Chapter 1, n. 63.

[61] Al-Fārābī [1890d]; Dieterici [1982d]. On this work see Gutas [1985], pp. 115–116.

also "the book in which divine things are learnt" (*mā yataʿallamu minhu* [*fīhi*?] *umūr ilāhiyya*).[62]

A fuller account of the *Metaphysics* is offered in the treatise *Falsafat Arisṭūṭālīs wa-aǧzāʾ falsafatihī* (*Aristotle's Philosophy and Its Parts*).[63] The *Metaphysics* is presented here as the completion of both natural philosophy and moral philosophy (in a classification of philosophy organized according to the Stoic scheme: logic-physics-ethics). On the one hand, it investigates the Active Intellect and the celestial bodies as causes of existence of sublunary things, rather than causes of intellection and movement only, as in natural philosophy (psychology and physics).[64] On the other hand, it settles the question of how wordly things have to be used in order to attain moral perfection.[65] Thus, the *Metaphysics* is depicted in the *Falsafat Arisṭūṭālīs* as the culmination and the foundation of all the system of knowledge. Conclusively, the *Metaphysics* is described as follows: "Therefore Aristotle proceeded in a book that he called *Metaphysics* to inquire into, and to investigate, the beings in a manner different than natural philosophy".[66]

Finally, in al-Fārābī's *Ǧamʿ*[67] we find scattered mentions of (1) the

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[62] Al-Fārābī [1890d], p. 50, 20–21.

[63] Al-Fārābī [1961], pp. 129, 9–132, 3; Mahdi [2001], pp. 128–130. See Druart [1987], pp. 29–31.

[64] Al-Fārābī [1961], pp. 129, 9–130, 18; Mahdi [2001], pp. 128–129.

[65] Al-Fārābī [1961], pp. 130, 18–132, 1; Mahdi [2001], pp. 129–130. Whereas the part of metaphysics completing natural philosophy has a theological character, we may wonder whether the part of it completing moral philosophy is envisaged by al-Fārābī as dealing with existent *qua* existent in a more general way.

[66] Al-Fārābī [1961], p. 132, 2–3; Mahdi [2001], p. 130. The reference to metaphysics occurring in the conclusion of the work (Al-Fārābī [1961], pp. 132, 4–133, 3; Mahdi [2001], p. 130) is puzzling: ". . . for we do not possess metaphysical science" (*iḏ lam yakun maʿanā l-ʿilmu lladī baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*, p. 133, 1). In the conclusion, al-Fārābī resumes what he has established about the "necessary knowledge", i.e logic, and "the science that comes after it" (*mā baʿdahū mina l-ʿilm*). This last expression does not refer to metaphysics (contrarily to ʿAbd-al-Laṭīf al-Baġdādī's view in the *Kītāb al-Naṣīḥatayn*, MS Bursa, Hüseyn Çelebi 823, f. 87r, as reported by Gutas [1999], p. 221b), but to moral philosophy and natural philosophy only, as it is clear from the description of the two purposes of the discipline in question.

[67] Al-Fārābī [1890]; Al-Fārābī [1960]; Al-Fārābī [1999]. German translation in Dieterici [1892c]; French translations in Abdel-Massih [1969]; Mallet [1989]; Naǧǧār-Mallet. English translation of Al-Fārābī [1890], pp. 5–7 (= Al-Fārābī [1960], pp. 84–85; Al-Fārābī [1999], pp. 71–77), in Gutas [1988], pp. 227–229. Lameer [1994], pp. 30–39, questions the authenticity of this work, but his view is criticized by Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], pp. 37–40, and Endress [1997b], p. 28, who retain al-Fārābī's authorship. On the influence of the *Ǧamʿ* on Avicenna, see Chapter 6, §4.5.

Metaphysics (*Kītāb fī mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*), with regard to the doctrine of definition,[68] the use of demonstrative procedures,[69] the doctrine of time,[70] and the criticism of Platonic philosophy;[71] (2) Aristotle's metaphysics as a science (*ʿilm ilāhī*), with regard to its imperfect application of syllogistic procedures;[72] and (3) metaphysics as a discipline in general (*ʿilm ilāhī, mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa, al-falsafa allatī baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*), with regard to its position in the classification of the sciences, Plato's doctrine of universals, and the use of ordinary language in the theological investigation.[73]

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[68] Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], p. 83, 3–8 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 9, 1–6, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 87, 11–16): "En effet, même si Aristote pense que la voie la plus courte et la plus sûre pour parvenir à des définitions est de chercher ce qui spécifie la chose et ce qui la comprend parmi les caractères qui lui appartiennent essentiellement et substantiellement (voyez tout ce qui'il mentionne dans le livre de la *Métaphysique* [*fī l-ḥarf . . . min kitābihī fīmā baʿda l-ṭabīʿati*] où il parle des définitions . . .)" (cp. Mallet [1989], p. 68). Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], n. 2, p. 166, indicate *Metaph.* Z, 4–5 as the place of the *Metaphysics* to which al-Fārābī refers in this passage (cp. Mallet [1989], n. 30, p. 101).

[69] Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 133, 13–17 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 24, 17–23, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 102, 15–19). See the analysis of this passage in Chapter 6, §4.5, Text 19.

[70] Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 129, 12–14 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 23, 4–6, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 101, 4–6): "Ils pensent alors qu'il [i.e. Aristotle] affirme l'éternité du monde. Mais il n'en pas ainsi puisqu'il a déjà montré dans ce livre et dans d'autres livres parmi ceux de physique et de théologie (*wa-ġayrihī mina l-kutubi . . . l-ilāhiyyati*), que le temps n'est que le nombre du mouvement de la sphère céleste et qu'il en résulte" (cp. Mallet [1989], pp. 84–85). Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], n. 3, p. 177 (cp. Mallet [1989], n. 79, p. 107) do not refer to the *Metaphysics*. The reference is to *Metaph.* Λ, 6, 1071b10–11.

[71] Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 143, 1–10, reported in Chapter 1, n. 63.

[72] Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 73, 6–8 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 6, 10–12, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 84, 22–24). Text quoted in Chapter 6, §4.5, n. 129.

[73] Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 58, 7–8 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 2, 8–9, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 80, 17–18): "En effet, les objects des sciences et leurs matières sont nécessairement soit théologiques (*ilāhiyya*), soit physiques, soit politiques, soit mathématiques, soit enfin logiques" (cp. Mallet [1989], p. 59). See Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], n. 1, pp. 160–161 (cp. Mallet [1989], n. 5, p. 98). Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 61, 3–5 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 2, 18–20, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 81, 5–7); "La confirmation de ce que nous affirmons apparaîtra clairement à quiconque s'est familiarisé avec la science des règles, je veux dire la logique, puis a pénétré dans la science de la nature et dans la théologie (*al-ilāhiyyāt*) et a étudié les livres des ces deux sages" (cp. Mallet [1989], p. 59). Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 81, 4–6 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 8, 11–14, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 86, 24–26): "Quant au sage Platon, quand il fait des universaux les substances qui l'emportent en antériorité et en supériorité, il ne fait cela que dans la métaphysique (*fīmā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*) et dans ses discours théologiques (*wa-fī aqāwīlihī l-ilāhiyyati*) où il considère les être simples, immuables, qui ne changent ni ne disparaissent" (cp. Mallet [1989], p. 67). Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 145, 15–17 (cp.

(ii) Al-Fārābī's main work on the classification of the sciences, the *Iḥṣāʾ al-ʿulūm* (*Survey of the sciences*), contains a detailed account of the "divine science" (*ʿilm ilāhī*), i.e. metaphysics.[74] Al-Fārābī states that this science is contained in its entirety in Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (*wa-huwa kulluhū fī kitābihī fīmā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*).[75] Three parts of metaphysics are singled out: the first deals with the existents and their attributes in so far as they are existents; the second with the principles of the particular sciences; the third with the existents that are neither bodies nor exist in bodies. We will see that this three-fold partition of metaphysics is, in all likelihood, the source of the outline of metaphysics that Avicenna presents in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2.[76] The impact on Avicenna of al-Fārābī's attribution to metaphysics, in this passage of the *Iḥṣāʾ*, of demonstrative procedures and of the proof of the other sciences' principles will be also documented.[77]

Whereas the *Iḥṣāʾ al-ʿulūm* provides a systematic classification of the sciences, the sequence of the sciences in the *Taḥṣīl al-saʿāda* (*The Attainment of Happiness*)[78] corresponds to a didactic order: the path leading to intellectual perfection and true happiness starts with mathematics (the "easiest" discipline), continues with natural philosophy and metaphysics, and ends in practical philosophy. Metaphysics is

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Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 28, 20–22, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 106, 13–14): "Chaque fois que s'affermit cette signification [i.e. the fact that expressions of the ordinary language, when applied to God, assume a different meaning] et qu'elle s'empare de l'esprit de qui apprend la philosophie métaphysique (*al falsafatu llatī baʿda l-ṭabīʾati*), il lui devient facile de se représenter ce que dirent Platon, Aristote et ceux qui suivirent leur voie" (cp. Mallet [1989], p. 91).

[74] Al-Fārābī [1949], pp. 120, 5–123, 7; Al-Fārābī [1953], pp. 87–91 (Arabic), pp. 110–111 (Latin translation by G. Camerarius, Paris 1638), pp. 163–166 (Latin translation attributed to Gerard of Cremona), pp. 63–65 (Spanish translation). A French translation of the part on metaphysics is available in Badawī [1972], pp. 530–531. An integral English translation is in preparation by D. C. Reisman and D. Gutas. On this work, see Gutas [1983], pp. 236–237, 255–256, 266–267 (Diagrams V and VI); Jolivet [1996], pp. 1011–1017.

[75] Al-Fārābī [1949], p. 120, 6; Al-Fārābī [1953], p. 87, 13. In the classification of the sciences proposed in the *Iḥṣāʾ*, al-Fārābī's does not take into account ps.-Aristotelian metaphysical writings like the *Theologia Aristotelis* and the *Liber de Causis*; their doctrine, however, is somehow included in the account of the "divine science"/*Metaphysics*.

[76] See Chapter 5, §6.5.

[77] See Chapter 6, §4.5, Text 18; Chapter 7, §5.3.

[78] Al-Fārābī [1981]; Mahdi [2001]; Marmura [1990], pp. 87–89; Zghal [1998]; Druart [1999], pp. 216b–217a.

the discipline to which the investigation of the principles of the celestial bodies in cosmology and the investigation of the intellect in psychology lead: it investigates the existents that are non-natural and incorporeal; it is the "science of what comes after nature" (*ʿilm mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*) in the process of learning, and the science of what is "above nature" (*fawqa l-ṭabīʿa*) in reality.[79] Metaphysics deals with (1) the existents that come after natural things in general, showing that they are immaterial and possess formal, efficient and final causes only; (2) the absolutely Uncaused Existent, i.e. the First Principle of all the other existents and their Fomal, Efficient and Final cause in a perfect way; and (3) the effects of the agency of the First Principle on the other existents in a descending order that goes from the closest to It to the farthest. This is the "divine investigation" (*al-nazar al-ilāhī*) of existents, since the First Principle is God and the incorporeal principles following It are divine principles.[80]

The same sequence of disciplines (mathematics, natural philosophy, metaphysics, and politics as representative of practical philosophy), and the same description of metaphysics as a "divine science" (*ʿilm ilāhī*) dealing with theological matters (what is neither a body nor in a body, and the ultimate causes of what the other sciences investigate) occur in the classification of the sciences in al-Fārābī's introduction to logic.[81]

Finally, in the survey of the sciences in chapter I, 5 of the *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf*, metaphysics (*ʿilm mā baʿda al-ṭabīʿa*) is presented as the discipline investigating (1) the things external to the categories (possibly "existent" and "one", the so-called "transcendentals"), and (2) the things contained in the categories (the categories proper to mathematics and politics included) in so far as the extra-categorial things are their causes.[82]

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[79] Al-Fārābī [1981], pp. 59, 18–61, 2; Mahdi [2001], pp. 21–22.

[80] Al-Fārābī [1981], pp. 62, 4–63, 3; Mahdi [2001], pp. 23–24.

[81] Al-Fārābī [1956–7], p. 227, 13–22 (Arabic), p. 232 (Engl. transl.).

[82] Al-Fārābī [1969], p. 69, 17–21; Zghal [1998], p. 193; Druart [1999], pp. 217b–218a. In the historical classification of the sciences which occurs in the second part of the *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf*, the section devoted to Aristotle (Al-Fārābī [1969], pp. 151, 17–152, 6; see Gutas [1983], pp. 231–267, p. 259 and n. 69, and diagram VI at p. 267) does not appear to contain any specific reference to metaphysics; the expression *al-falsafa al-nazariyya wa-l-ʿāmmiyya al-kulliyya* should be read as *al-falsafa al-nazariyya wa-l-ʿamaliyya al-kulliyya* (as in Mahdi's forthcoming new critical edition; I wish to thank Prof. D. Mallet for having provided me with a preliminary version of it) and refers to philosophy in general rather than metaphysics.

(iii) Al-Fārābī's own works on metaphysics encompass philosophical *summae* and treatises dealing with specific metaphysical subjects. In al-Fārābī's major philosophical *summae*, the theological part of metaphysics is the starting-point, and accordingly the foundation, of a theoretical system which encompasses also psychology, Islamic eschatology and prophetology, and practical philosophy. The *Mabādiʾ Ārāʾ Ahl al-Madīna al-Fāḍila* (*The Principles of the Opinions of the People of the Best City*),[83] for example, presents the following sequence of topics:

Outline 1: Main topics of al-Fārābī's *Mabādiʾ*
1) Nature of the First Principle (chapters 1–2)
2) Cosmology, both supralunar and sublunar (chapters 3–9)
3) Man's soul and body (chapters 10–12)
4) Noetics and Human Happiness (chapter 13)
5) Prophetology (chapter 14)
6) Politics: the Best City and its opposite (chapters 15–19)

Of these six parts, the first shows similarities with the last chapters of *Metaphysics* Λ. The doctrine of the identity of "intellect" (*ʿaql*), "subject of intellection" (*ʿāqil*) and "object of intellection" (*maʿqūl*) in God, for example, which occurs in chapter 1 of the *Mabādiʾ*, has its ultimate sources in *Metaph.* Λ, 7, 1072b18–24, and Λ, 9, 1074b36–1075a5.[84] In the second part, the doctrine of *Metaph.* Λ, 8 is reworked according to an emanative scheme whose inspiration is Neoplatonic.[85] As we will see in Chapter 5, the structure of the *Mabādiʾ* is mirrored by the structure of the theological part of Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*.

Al-Fārābī wrote also some short treatises dealing with topics contained in Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. They are the already mentioned *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf*, whose first part takes into account philosophical terms like "relation", "accident", "substance", "existent", "deriving from something" etc., which occur also in *Metaphysics* Δ,[86] and the *Fī l-Wāḥid wa l-waḥda* (*On One and Unity*), whose topic is the same as that of *Metaphysics* I.[87] The precise dependence of these treatises by al-Fārābī

[83] Al-Fārābī [1985], reviewed by Mahdi [1990]; Druart [1999], p. 218a–b. For previous editions and translations, see Daiber [1999], nn. 2902–2911.
[84] Al-Fārābī [1985], chapter 1, §6, pp. 70, 1–72, 6. See D'Ancona [2003], n. 2.
[85] See Hansawi [1990b].
[86] Al-Fārābī [1969]; Druart [1999], pp. 217b–218a.
[87] Al-Fārābī [1989]; Druart [1999], p. 217a–b.

on the books of the *Metaphysics* to which they are related has still to be ascertained in a comprehensive way.

To summarize: regardless whether Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is explicitly referred to (as in the *Mā yanbaġī an yuqaddama*, the *Falsafat Arisṭūṭālīs*, some of the mentioned places of the *Ǧamʿ*, and the *Iḥṣāʾ al-ʿulūm*), or the discipline of metaphyiscs is dealt with in more general terms, in all the three types of writings by al-Fārābī taken into account here metaphysics displays a constant element, i.e. the doctrine of God and divine things (natural theology), to which a broader investigation of existent in itself (ontology) is occasionally added. A purely ontological account of metaphysics occurs only, if anywhere, in the brief and somehow obscure mention of this discipline in the *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf*. In the other works by al-Fārābī, ontology is related to, and depends on, natural theology because the divine things are causes and principles of all the existents; this implies, on the epistemological level, that metaphyiscs provides the foundation of the other sciences. This two-fold nature of metaphysics (theology on the one hand, ontology on the other) is fully articulated in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, which is also the only work by al-Fārābī in which the single books of the *Metaphysics* receive particular attention. In this regard, despite its brevity, the *Fī Aġrāḍ* represents the most comprehensive account of metaphysics and the *Metaphysics* that can be found in the works of al-Fārābī.

Conclusion

Al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*, fully translated into English for the first time in §1, is an articulated overview of the *Metaphysics*, which provides both a description of the epistemological profile of the science of metaphysics and a comprehensive account of the specific contents of the *Metaphysics* (§2). Related to the commentatorial tradition of Greek Antiquity (Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius, but also—more importantly—Ammonius Son of Hermeias, §3), it represents the most detailed account of the *Metaphysics* among al-Fārābī's works (§5), and deeply influenced Avicenna's conception of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, as Avicenna's Autobiography, the *Ilāhiyyāt* and Avicenna's other metaphysical works witness (§4).

If the investigation of the sources of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* accomplished in §3 is correct, to the three channels of diffusion into Arabic of the

Greek tradition of the *Metaphysics* already known a fourth one can be added. Besides the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* itself,[88] of some Greek commentaries on this work,[89] and of the descriptions of the *Metaphysics* in the Greek surveys of the Aristotelian *corpus* or in the classifications of the sciences,[90] there is evidence for an Arabic version (i.e. al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*) of a Greek *introduction* to the *Metaphysics*: the part dealing with the *Metaphysics* of Ammonius' treatise *On the Goals of Aristotle in His Books*. This fourth channel is different from, and more affluent than, the other three on account of its larger scope: whereas the other three are either centered around book Λ (the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*), or limited to this book (the Arabic translations of the commentaries on the *Metaphysics*), or conducive of an image of the *Metaphysics* that is reducible to Λ (the Arabic versions of the surveys of the Aristotelian *corpus* and the classifications of the sciences), al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*—and Ammonius' introduction to the *Metaphysics* which is probably its source—encompasses the *Metaphysics* in its entirety.

As we are going to see in Part II, Avicenna's conception of metaphysics depends markedly, albeit with some differences and adjustements, on al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*. By means of this treatise—rather than some commentaries on *Physics* and *De Anima* of Late Antiquity—it is also related to Ammonius' metaphysics.

[88] See Chapter 1.
[89] See Chapter 2, §5.
[90] See Chapter 2, §7; above, §3, n. 40.

PART TWO

THE SCIENTIFIC PROFILE OF THE *METAPHYSICS* ACCORDING TO AVICENNA

INTRODUCTION

Avicenna's "reform" of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* aims primarily at providing the discipline expounded in this work with a new "form", i.e. a proper scientific status. The epistemological profile of metaphysics that emerges from the *Metaphysics* is regarded as imperfect by Avicenna, who—the heir, in this, of a long tradition—endeavours to transform this discipline into a fully accomplished science. The changes that Avicenna introduces in his reworking of the *Metaphysics* in order to fulfill this task are profound. They are the object of Part II.

Avicenna's scientific reshaping of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* regards four main areas. First, Avicenna clarifies what metaphysics is about, namely whether it deals primarily with God (as in al-Kindī), or rather with "existent" (i.e. "being") as such and its various features (as in al-Fārābī); in other words, he faces the issue whether metaphysics is a philosophical theology, namely a rational investigation of God, or rather an ontology, i.e. a study of "existent *qua* existent" and its different aspects. Avicenna's solution is a synthesis between these two perspectives: metaphysics is both an ontology, in so far as "existent *qua* existent" is its subject-matter, and a theology, since its goal is the knowledge of God (Chapter 4). Second, Avicenna recasts the structure of metaphysics in a systematic way, by dismissing the rather inconsequential order of books of the *Metaphysics*, and arranging this discipline according to a precise epistemological pattern (given by the species, properties and principles of "existent"), only adumbrated in Aristotle (Chapter 5). Third, he refines the method of metaphysics, by enhancing its use of demonstrations and terminoloigcal distinctions, introducing new methods of argumentation (like proofs by division and classifications), and reducing the role of procedures (like the criticism of previous philosophers' opinions, and the discussion of aporias) cognate with dialectic (Chapter 6). Finally, Avicenna elucidates the relationship of metaphysics with the other philosophical disciplines, namely logic (the instrument of all knowledge), natural philosophy and mathematics (the other two branches of theoretical philosophy), and practical philosophy (with which he deals briefly at the end of the *Ilāhiyyāt*): metaphysics results to be a science higher

than all these disciplines and encharged with providing their epistemological foundation (Chapter 7).

The four aforementioned areas of Avicenna's intervention are reflected in the themes discussed in the Prolegomena of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, namely in the first four chapters of this work (I, 1–4). An analysis of the subject-matter and goal of metaphysics is performed in the main part of chapters I, 1–2. The structure of metaphysics is briefly outlined in chapter I, 2, and described in detail in chapter I, 4. To the method of metaphysics is devoted the last part of chapter I, 2, where Avicenna discusses the different procedures of metaphysics, on the one hand, and dialectic and sophistic, on the other. The relation of metaphysics with the other philosophical disciplines is a *leitmotiv* of the entire Prolegomena: it is taken into special account in the introductory classification of the sciences (at the beginning of I, 1), and in the discussion of the utility, rank and name of metaphysics ("what comes after physics") in I, 3. In the sequence of their themes, the Prolegomena of the *Ilāhiyyāt* significantly mirror chapters II, 6–7 of the *Burhān*, i.e. of the section of the *Šifā'* corresponding to the *Posterior Analytics: Burhān* II, 6 deals with the subject-matters of the sciences, and also with their questions—namely the properties that each science proves to belong to its subject-matter—and principles (i.e. two of the three elements that together with the species, determine the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt*); chapter II, 7, on the other hand, takes into account differences and similarities between the various sciences, and in this context deals with both the relationship between metaphysics and the other sciences, and the distinction (mainly methodological) between metaphysics, on the one side, and dialectic and sophistic, on the other.

The scientific profile of the *Metaphysics* is reshaped by Avicenna in the light of four main sources. First and foremost among them are Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics*, the work of Aristotle's logic deputed to establish the features that a discipline must possess in order to be a science. The link between the *Ilāhiyyāt* and the *Posterior Analytics* is attested by the many quotations of the *Burhān* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, especially in the Prolegomena (see Chapter 7, Outline 1). The second source is book Γ of the *Metaphysics*, where Aristotle himself tentatively applies to metaphysics the epistemology of the *Posterior Analytics*, even though the program of "scientification" of metaphysics hinted at in Γ is not realized in the rest of the work (see Chapter 9). In the historical route leading from Aristotle to Avicenna a significant

role is played by Alexander of Aphrodisias, who picks up Aristotle's unaccomplished plan of a "scientific" metaphysics and—with express and constant reference to the *Posterior Analytics* and special regard to book Γ—substantiates it in his commentary on the *Metaphysics*. Al-Fārābī, finally, resumes in the Arab world the tradition of the Greek commentators on the *Metaphysics* (Alexander of Aphrodisias, Themistius and Ammonius/Asclepius), and outlines a scientific configuration of metaphysics which Avicenna will receive and, with significant modifications and refinements, apply in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Each chapter of Part II ends with a historical survey of Avicenna's sources that shows Avicenna's debt towards the aforementioned authors and works, and points at the possibilities of other, though less marked, influences (like those exerted by pseudo-Aristotelian works like the *Liber de Causis*).

CHAPTER FOUR

AVICENNA'S CONCEPTION OF THE THEME OF THE *METAPHYSICS*: "EXISTENT *QUA* EXISTENT" AS THE SUBJECT-MATTER, THE FIRST CAUSES AND GOD AS THE GOAL OF METAPHYSICS

In the *Metaphysics*, Aristotle describes the theme of the discipline he is dealing with in different and somehow conflicting ways. Three main perspectives in this regard can be distinguished. First, in book A, metaphysics is portrayed by Aristotle as (i) the "wisdom" dealing with the first causes and principles (A, 1, 981b28–29; A, 2, 982b9–10). Then, in book Γ Aristotle clarifies that (i) metaphysics investigates the first causes of "being *qua* being" (1003a26–32), in so far as it is (ii) the universal "science" of "being *qua* being", in distinction from the particular sciences (Γ, 1, 1003a20–26). Finally, in book E Aristotle repeats that metaphysics is (i) the research of the principles and causes of beings *qua* beings (E, 1, 1025b3–4), and (ii) the universal science of "being *qua* being", in distinction from all the other sciences (1025b7–10); but he also adds that it is (iii) the knowledge of what is eternal, immovable and existing on its own ("separated")—as distinct from, and superior to, the type of being investigated by natural philosophy and mathematics (E, 1, 1026a13–16); accordingly, he portrays metaphysics as the "theological philosophy" dealing with the divine (E, 1, 1026a16–23).

Despite these different perspectives Aristotle holds an unitarian view of the metaphysics' theme. For he reconciles perspectives (i) and (iii) by identifying the realm of the first causes with that of the divine (A, 2, 982b28–983a11) and viceversa (E, 1, 1026a16–18). Also, he does not regard perspectives (ii) and (iii) as mutually exclusive: he raises the issue of how they relate to one another, and concludes that metaphysics investigates universally being *qua* being in so far as it is the first science, i.e. the study of the immovable substance (E, 1, 1026a23–32). The two-fold nature of metaphysics as a science that, on the one hand, is universal in scope and, on the other hand, focuses on what is first recurs also elsewhere in the *Metaphysics* (see A, 2, 982a19–b10; Γ, 3, 1005a34–b1). Aristotle's conception of the

theme of metaphysics is therefore coherent—at least in his intentions—even though it is neither completely clear nor fully articulated.

Wolff's commonly accepted distinction of a *metaphysica generalis* (the universal science of "being *qua* being", or ontology) and a *metaphysica specialis* (the science of a particular genus of being, i.e. the divine, or theology) within metaphysics was turned into an opposition and surreptitiously introduced into Aristotle's *Metaphysics* by Paul Natorp, who approached the *Metaphysics* with the "Kantian" assumption that, within traditional metaphysics, ontology has to be retained and theology dismissed.[1] Natorp's idea of a conflict between ontology and theology in the *Metaphysics* deeply conditioned subsequent scholars, who either shared Natorp's point of view or felt compelled to explain why they disagreed with him. Schematically, five main positions on this issue can be singled out.[2] Some regard the conflict as unsolvable, in so far as ontology and theology are two incompatible dimensions of metaphysics.[3] Others explain the discrepancy in terms of the evolution of Aristotle's thought from theology to ontology,[4] or vice-versa.[5] According to a third group of interpreters there is no proper ontology as distinct from theology in the *Metaphysics*, since "being *qua* being" amounts—either directly, or in so far as its prime instance is substance and the prime instance of substance is the divine substance—to divine being.[6] A fourth trend envisages the *Metaphysics* as a theology encompassing an ontology, in so far as the study of the prime type of being (the divine) implies the study of being in general.[7] Finally, ontology and theology are regarded by a fifth group of interpreters as distinct but interconnected parts of the *Metaphysics*: the study of "being *qua* being" includes the study of divine being in so far as every science is concerned with investigating the principles of the sector of reality it takes into account.[8] Avicenna holds this last type of interpretation. As a matter of fact, he provides a "strong"

[1] Natorp [1887]. Together with Bekker's edition, Natorp's study can be regarded as the beginning of contemporary scholarship on Aristotle's *Metaphysics*.
[2] A survey of previous scholarship can be found in Owens [1982].
[3] Besides Natorp himself, see Zeller [1889] and Aubenque [1962].
[4] Jaeger [1923].
[5] Oggioni [1939]; Gohlke [1951]; Owen [1960]; Owen [1965].
[6] Merlan [1953]; Owens [1951]; Owens [1982].
[7] Patzig [1960–1]; Frede [1987].
[8] Reale [1961]; Decarie [1961]; Kahn [1985]; Berti [1994]; Yu [2003], pp. 201–210.

version of it, according to which the *Metaphysics* is constitutively an ontology, whose most relevant part is a theology.

The first specific endeavour of clarifying the relationship between ontology and theology within the *Metaphysics* took place, as far as we know, in Arabic philosophy. In post-Aristotelian Greek philosophy, this relationship was not perceived as problematic: it appears as a crucial issue neither in an independent "aporetic" treatise on metaphysics like Theophrastus' *Metaphysics*, nor in a reworking of the *Metaphysics* such as parts II and III of Nicholas of Damascus' *Philosophy of Aristotle* (at least judging from the extant portions of this latter work), nor in the commentaries on the *Metaphysics* by Alexander of Aphrodisias, Themistius, Syrianus and Ammonius/Asclepius. In Arabic philosophy the problem was determined by the "theologizing" interpretation of the *Metaphysics* offered by philosophers like al-Kindī, which derives proximately from the classifications of sciences of Late Antiquity and depends ultimately on Aristotle's perspective (iii) taken in isolation from the others.[9] Al-Fārābī's reacted to al-Kindī's one-sided view of the *Metaphysics*: connecting himself with the commentatorial tradition of Alexander of Aphrodisias, Themistius and Ammonius/Asclepius, he had a broader view of the *Metaphysics* and in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* he clarified that Aristotle's work contains not only a theology, but also an ontology.[10] The background of the entire discussion is the relationship of *falsafa* and Islam: whereas al-Kindī emphasizes the theological part of the *Metaphysics* in order to assimilate Aristotelian metaphysics (and Greek metaphysics in general) and Islamic theology, al-Fārābī stresses the distinction of metaphysics and philosophical theology and assigns a broader scope (and, implicitly, a higher rank) to the former with regard to the latter. Avicenna further develops al-Fārābī's point of view, somehow incorportating in it al-Kindī's perspective, and presents the fullest and most articulated account of the relationship of ontology and theology within metaphysics in the history of Medieval philosophy.

Avicenna regards as very important to determine the subject-matter of metaphysics: he starts the *Ilāhiyyāt* addressing this issue and adding the "subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ*), as we will see in Chapter 5, to the preliminary questions traditionally discussed by Aristotelian

[9] See Chapter 2, §§6–7.
[10] See Chapter 3, §2.

commentators at the beginning of their exegesis of Aristotle's works. He appears to be the first in the history of philosophy to have devoted to this issue a separate and articulated treatment, and his contribution in the first two chapters of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (I, 1–2) has rightly attracted the attention of scholars.[11] In Avicenna's powerful synthesis, Aristotle's different perspectives on the issue are elucidated and harmonized. As we are going to see in the first part of the present chapter, the main elements of Avicenna's discourse are five. First, he starts with a notion of metaphysics that gathers points (iii) and (i), namely the idea that metaphysics deals with immaterial things and with the first causes and the absolute Prime Cause, i.e. God. Second, he adds point (ii) to point (i) by means of the distinction between the "subject-matter" of metaphysics and the "things searched" (*maṭālib*, sg. *maṭlūb*) in it: according to Avicenna, "existent *qua* existent", rather than God or the first causes, is the subject-matter of metaphysics. God and the first causes are things searched in metaphysics, and can be taken into account by this discipline just because they are *not* its subject-matter, for the subject-matter of a discipline is something that is common to all the things searched by the discipline in question, without being itself one of them. Third, he brings to unity perspective (iii) and perspective (ii) by means of a peculiar notion of "existent", according to which this concept is immaterial in as much as it is not restricted to the sphere of material things. Conceived as immaterial, "existent" can be common to all the objects of research of metaphysics. Fourth, he reaches a synthesis between perspective (i) and perspective (ii) by stressing that the first causes and God are a part of "existent" and the principles of the "existent" that is caused. Fifth, he stresses that the first causes and God, despite not being the subject-matter of metaphyscs, have nonetheless a fundamental function within this discipline: among the things searched by metaphysics, they are its "goal" (*ġaraḍ*), namely the things whose knowledge is ultimately pursued. Adopting a metaphor that Avicenna applies to metaphysics elsewhere, it can be said that, according to him, the study of "existent *qua* existent" is the "root" of metaphysics, whereas the investigation of the first causes and God

[11] See Fakhry [1984]; Davidson [1987], pp. 284–288; Hasnawi [1991]; Roccaro [1994]; Ramón Guerrero [1996]; Bertolacci [2001b], pp. 230–232, 259–261.

is its "fruit".[12] Thus, Avicenna shows that metaphysics is, in different respects, a study of the first causes and God, which, among the "things searched" by metaphysics, are its goal; a study of "existent", which is its subject-matter; and a study of immaterial and motionless things, in so far as both the first causes and God, on the one hand, and "existent *qua* existent", on the other, are immaterial and motionless realities. Avicenna's account is one of the most coherent and systematic explanation of Aristotle's cryptic and apparently inconsistent views of the theme of metaphysics that have been ever proposed.

The second part of the present chapter deals with Avicenna's antecedents. His starting-point—i.e. the notion of metaphysics as the science of the immaterial, the first causes and God—occurs, besides Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, in the account of metaphysics in the classifications of the sciences provided by the Aristotelian commentators of Late Antiquity and subsequently adopted by the earliest Arab philosophers. The distinction of the "subject-matter" of a science from what a science researches comes originally from the *Posterior Analytics*. The ideas that the subject-matter of metaphysics is "existent *qua* existent" and that its goal is philosophical theology are present *in nuce* in Alexander of Aphrodisias' and Ammonius/Asclepius' commentaries on the *Metaphysics*, from which they passed in al-Fārābī. Finally, the notion of "existent" as an immaterial universal concept that becomes material in so far as it gets specified and particularized can be regarded as Proclean; its proximate source is probably the *Liber de Causis*. If compared with his sources, Avicenna is original in two respects. First, he connects explicitly the issue of what metaphysics as a science is about with the *Posterior Analytics*, by referring several times in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1–3 to the *Burhān*, namely to his own reworking of the *Posterior Analytics* in the *Šifā'*.[13] Second, he clarifies the notions of "subject-matter" (taken from the *Posterior Analytics*) and "goal", still confusedly used by al-Fārābī before him.

Despite the criticism by Averroes, Avicenna's accomodation of ontology and theology within the *Metaphysics* exerted an immense influence on subsequent philosophy. Its impact was particularly strong in Latin scholasticism, as thinkers like Albertus Magnus, Thomas

[12] Avicenna portrays the study of God as "fruit" (*tamara*) of the metaphysics in the Introduction of *Mabda'*, p. 1, 8–9.

[13] See Chapter 7.

Aquinas and Duns Scotus witness.[14] By means of its influence on Aquinas' thought, Avicenna's position on the relationship of ontology and theology in the *Metaphysics* still permeates Neo-Thomistic approaches to the problem.

1 Avicenna's Discussion of the Subject-Matter and Goal of Metaphysics in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1–2

1.1 *The Context*

Chapters I, 1–2 of the *Ilāhiyyāt* contain the specific discussion of the "subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ*) and "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) of metaphysics.[15] Of these two topics the former is, according to Avicenna, the most important, as the mention of the "subject-matter" in the title of both I, 1 and I, 2 attests.[16] After the proem and the preliminary classification of the philosophical sciences, chapter I, 1 posits two main problems: determining the subject-matter of metaphysics, and clarifying the relationship of metaphysics with first philosophy and wisdom. The solution of the first problem covers the rest of chapter I, 1 and the first part of chapter I, 2. The solution of the second problem includes the determination of the goal of metaphysics and covers the second part of chapter I, 2. The third and last part of chapter I, 2 is still related to the topic of the subject-matter of metaphysics, in so far as it is devoted to claryfing the relationship of metaphysics with the two other disciplines sharing its same subject-matter, i.e. dialectic and sophistic. Since the difference between metaphysics,

[14] See A. Zimmermann [1965].

[15] The analysis of the subject-matter of metaphysics apparently ends in I, 2, p. 14, 13 [p. 14, 67], with the discussion of an objection moved against the possibility for "existent *qua* existent" to be the subject-matter of metaphysics. Accordingly, the specific discussion of the goal of metaphysics starts in I, 2, p. 14, 14 [p. 14, 68]; it clearly ends in I, 2, p. 16, 11–12 [p. 17, 19–20], where Avicenna writes: "It has appeared and become evident what the goal (*ġaraḍ*) of this science is". Avicenna himself contends that the investigation of the goal of metaphysics is intimately connected with that of its subject-matter (I, 2, p. 10, 4–5 [p. 9, 57–58]).

[16] I, 1, p. 3, 7 [p. 1, 2]; I, 2, p. 10, 3 [p. 9, 56]. That the subject-matter is the most important element of a science, according to Avicenna, appears clearly in *Burhān* II, 7, where the difference and similarity between the sciences is portrayed as depending on the relationship of their subject-matters. The issue of the "subject-matter" is raised in *Madḫal* I, 4 with regard to logic (see Chapter 5, n. 134).

dialectic and sophistic is given by their respective methods, this part of I, 2 will be taken into account in Chapter 6.[17] What follows is an outline of I, 1:

Outline 1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1
Proem (p. 3, 8–10)
[1] The place of metaphysics in the system of the philosophical sciences (pp. 3, 11–5, 1)
- [1.1] Division of the philosophical sciences into theoretical and practical (pp. 3, 11–4, 6)
- [1.2] Division of the theoretical sciences into science of nature, mathematics and metaphysics ("divine science") (pp. 4, 7–5, 1)

[2] Epistemological problems regarding metaphysics (p. 5, 1–15)
- [2.1] First problem: What is its subject-matter? Is it the First Cause or something else? (p. 5, 1–6)
- [2.2] Second problem: What are first philosophy and wisdom? Is there only one wisdom or are there more than one? (p. 5, 7–15)
  - [2.2.1] Position of the problem (p. 5, 7–12)
  - [2.2.2] Anticipation of the solution: metaphysics is both first philosophy and wisdom; there is only one wisdom, i.e. metaphysics (p. 5, 13–15)

[3] Solution of the first problem. First part: God and the ultimate causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics (p. 5, 15–9, 10)
- [3.1] Introduction (p. 5, 15–16)
- [3.2] God is not the subject-matter of metaphysics (pp. 5, 16–7, 6)
  - [3.2.1] Introduction (p. 5, 16–17)
  - [3.2.2] Proof: the subject-matter's existence is not searched in the science of which it is the subject-matter, whereas God's existence is searched in metaphysics (pp. 5, 18–6, 2)
  - [3.2.3] Proof of the fact that God's existence is searched in metaphysics (p. 6, 2–15)
  - [3.2.4] Recapitulation (p. 6, 15–16)
  - [3.2.5] Only metaphysics investigates God's existence (pp. 6, 17–7, 6)
- [3.3] The ultimate causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics (pp. 7, 6–9, 10)
  - [3.3.1] Introduction (p. 7, 6–9)
  - [3.3.2] Proof (pp. 7, 10–9, 8)
    - [3.3.2.1] Four ways of taking into account the ultimate causes (p. 7, 10–13)
    - [3.3.2.2] The ultimate causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics when they are taken absolutely (pp. 7, 14–8, 18)

[17] See Chapter 6, §3.1, Text 5.1.

[3.3.2.3] The ultimate causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics when they are taken as causes of a certain type (pp. 8, 18–9, 1)
[3.3.2.4] The ultimate causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics when they are taken together (p. 9, 1–6)
[3.3.2.5] If the ultimate causes are the subject-matter of metaphysics when they are taken as existing things, then "existent" is the actual subject-matter of metaphysics (p. 9, 6–8)
[3.3.3] Conclusion (p. 9, 9–10)

1.2 *"Existent" as the Subject-Matter of Metaphysics*

In [1.2] Avicenna provides the following general account of the science of metaphysics, named "divine" (*ilāhiyya, ilāhī*). In accordance with the name, also the content of metaphysics has a theological character:

> Text 1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, p. 4, 14–17 [pp. 2, 29–3, 34]
> [a] [It has been mentioned] that the divine [sciences] (*al-ilāhiyya*)[18] investigate the realities that are separate from matter in subsistence and definition (*al-umūr al-mufāriqa li-l-mādda bi-l-qiwām wa-l-ḥadd*).
> [b] You have also learnt that the divine [science] (*al-ilāhī*) is the one that investigates the first causes (*al-asbāb al-ūlā*) of natural and mathematical existence and of what depends on them, [c] and the Cause[19] of causes and the Principle of principles, namely the divinity (*al-ilāh*).[20]

Among these three characterizations of metaphysics as divine science, [a] is fundamental: it will be often resumed throughout chapters I, 1–2.[21]

In [2.1], Avicenna introduces the issue of the subject-matter of metaphysics, meant as "divine science" along the lines of Text 1. In

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[18] In [a] Avicenna speaks of "divine [sciences]" in the plural for the sake of uniformity with the natural and mathematical sciences mentioned in the plural in what immediately precedes Text 1.

[19] Reading *sabab* instead of *musabbib* (see Appendix A).

[20] The reference in [a] ("It has been mentioned") is to *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 14, 5–6, 9, i.e. to the classification of the sciences at the very beginning of the *Šifāʾ* (see Marmura [1980], p. 246). The reference in [b]–[c] ("You have also learnt") is to places like *Burhān* II, 9, p. 178, 17–19, where Avicenna maintains that metaphysics provides the first efficient cause and the first final cause of certain natural events, and *Burhān* II, 7, p. 165, 7–10, where Avicenna shows that the Principle of all caused existence is known within metaphysics.

[21] See I, 2, p. 11, 9 [p. 10, 87–88]; p. 12, 11 [p. 12, 12–13]; p. 15, 13–14 [p. 16, 95–96].

the description of natural philosophy and mathematics in [1.2] Avicenna had indicated the subject-matters of these disciplines (bodies as in movement and rest and quantity, respectively), but had omitted this indication in the case of metaphysics in Text 1.

> Text 2.1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, p. 5, 1–6 [p. 3, 35–43]
>
> [a] It has not appeared clearly to you from this [i.e. from the previous books of the *Šifā'*] what the subject-matter of the divine science really is, apart from a pointer occurring in the *Book of Demonstration* in logic, if you remember: namely that in the other sciences you had [i] something that is the subject-matter, [ii] some things that are the things searched (*al-maṭlūba*), and [iii] some admitted principles from which the demonstrations are composed.
>
> [b] Now, you are not able to verify truly (*tuḥaqqiqu ḥaqqa l-taḥqīqi*) what the subject-matter of this science is, and whether it is the First Cause itself—so that what is sought for (*al-murād*) [in this science] would be the knowledge of Its attributes and actions—or something else.

The main point of Text 2.1 is the distinction between subject-matter and "things searched" (*maṭlūba*) of metaphysics (see [a]), a distinction which occurs repeatedly in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1–2.[22] In [b] the things searched are called "what is sought for" (*murād*). Avicenna has already briefly shown in *Burhān* II, 7 that the First Principle cannot be the subject-matter of metaphysics:[23] he now goes back to the same issue in order to provide its conclusive verification, as the expression "to verify truly" (*ḥaqqaqa ḥaqqa l-taḥqīqi*) makes clear.

On account of the distinction, established in [2.1], between subject-matter and things searched, in [3] Avicenna proves negatively that God and the ultimate causes (i.e. the material, formal, efficient and

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[22] See I, 1, p. 5, 16–17 [p. 4, 58–60]; p. 6, 1–2 [p. 4, 64–65], p. 8, 17–18 [p. 8, 37–39], p. 9, 9–10 [pp. 8, 52–9, 55]; I, 2, p. 13, 12–13 [p. 13, 36–38]. In [a], the reference is to *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 4–12 (see below, §2.1, Text 8.1), where the things searched in a science are called "questions" (*masā'il*). Avicenna refers to this same passage of *Burhān* II, 6 also a few lines later: I, 1, p. 5, 15 [p. 4, 57–58]: "It has already been known that every science has a subject-matter that is proper to it".

[23] *Burhān* II, 7, p. 165, 7–10: "Since what is not principle of the existence of some of the existents rather than others, but is rather principle of every caused existent, cannot be investigated in one of the particular sciences, nor can it be itself the subject-matter of a particular science, since it conveys a relationship with every existent, nor is it the subject-matter of the common universal science, since it is not something common and universal, its knowledge is necessarily part of this [common universal] science".

final first causes, which are ultimate with regard to our knowledge of reality) are not the subject-matter of metaphysics, but rather things searched in it.[24] Avicenna presents the thesis according to which God and the ultimate causes, respectively, are the subject-matter of metaphysics as opinions held by some thinkers.[25] In order to counter these opinions, he relies on the following two features of the subject-matter of a science:

> Text 2.2: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, pp. 5, 18–6, 1 [p. 4, 62–64]
> [a] For the subject-matter of each science is something whose existence is admitted in that science, [b] and of which only the states are investigated. [c] This has already been known elsewhere.[26]

On account of feature [a], Avicenna shows in [3.2] that God is not the subject-matter of metaphysics, since metaphysics does not take God's existence for granted; on the contrary, metaphysics, and only metaphysics, proves God's existence.[27]

In order to prove in [3.3] that the ultimate causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics, Avicenna relies on both features of the subject-matter of a science in Text 2.2. He first distinguishes four ways according to which the ultimate causes can be considered, and then shows that in none of these ways they can be the subject-matter of metaphysics.[28] Considered as causes in absolute terms (i.e. simply as causes), they are not the subject-matter of metaphysics, because metaphysics investigates certain notions (like universal and

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[24] In I, 1, p. 5, 16–17 [p. 4, 58–60], Avicenna states preliminarily that God is either the subject-matter of metaphysics or one of the things searched in it, and then he proceeds to prove that He is not the subject-matter. In I, 1, p. 9, 10 [p. 9, 54–55], he conclusively maintains that the ultimate four causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics, but rather its perfection and the thing searched in it.

[25] In I, 1, p. 7, 9 [p. 6, 11], after having expounded the thesis according to which the ultimate four causes are the subject-matter of metaphysics, Avicenna states: "For someone (*qawm*) believed this also (*ayḍan*)". The presence of the conjunction "also" implies that the thesis previously taken into account (according to which God is the subject-matter of metaphysics) is envisaged by Avicenna as an opinion held by someone as well (see Chapter 7, §3.2, Table 7).

[26] Cp. I, 1, p. 8, 17–18 [p. 8, 37–39]: "How the subject-matter of a science—whose states [only] are investigated among the things sought for [in that science]—can be something whose esistence is searched in it?". The reference in Text 2.2 [c] is again to *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 8–9 (see above, n. 22, and below, §2.1, Text 8.1).

[27] The method of argumentation that Avicenna employs in [3.2.2]–[3.2.4] will be analyzed in detail in Chapter 6, §1.3, Tables 1–4.

[28] For the method of argumentation in [3.3], see Chapter 6, Table 5.

particular, potency and act, possibility and necessity) which are not properties of the ultimate causes considered in such a way (against Text 2.2 [b]), and because such a consideration of the ultimate causes presupposes the proof of their existence[29]—something that neither sensation nor any of the other sciences except metaphysics can provide (against Text 2.2 [a]). Not even considered according to their distinctive way of being causes, the ultimate causes are the subject-matter of metaphysics, since this distinctive way (which Avicenna calls their "proper existence", i.e. essence) is something searched (*maṭlūb*) in metaphysics (against Text 2.1 [a]).[30] The ultimate causes cannot be the subject-matter of metaphysics considered as a whole, because in this case the parts of the whole (i.e. the four causes taken singularly) would be worthier to be the subject-matter (but this has already been excluded in the previous case). Finally, if the ultimate causes were the subject-matter of metaphysics considered as existents (a case opposite to the first one taken into account), then "existent *qua* existent" would be the first subject-matter (i.e. a subject-matter prior to the supposed subject-matter) of this discipline.

After having posited the issue and shown negatively in I, 1 that God and the ultimate causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics, in chapter I, 2 Avicenna proves positively that the subject-matter of metaphysics is the existent in so far as it is existent. What follows is an outline of the part of I, 2 relevant to this topic.

> Outline 2: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 10, 14–14, 13 [pp. 9, 56–14, 67]
> [1] Solution of the problem of the subject-matter. Second Part: "existent *qua* existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics (pp. 10, 4–14, 13)

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[29] In I, 1, p. 8, 5–8 [p. 7, 21–25], Avicenna states, literally, that (i) the knowledge of the absolute causes follows from (ii) the knowledge establishing the existence of causes for the caused things: without (ii)—which follows, on its turn, on (iii) establishing that the existence of the caused things depends on what is anterior to them in existence—we do not know (ia) *the existence* of the absolute cause. It seems that, according to Avicenna, point (i) is equivalent to, or follows immediately from, point (ia), and mediately from points (ii) and (iii). Thus, in order to convey point (i), metaphysics has to provide point (ia), i.e. the existence of the absolute causes, which implies that the absolute causes cannot be the subject-matter of metaphysics. In the following lines (p. 8, 8–18 [pp. 7, 25–8, 39]), Avicenna shows that neither sensation nor any of the sciences other than metaphysics can provide points (ii) and (iii), and that metaphysics consequently provides them.

[30] The distinctive features of each of the four causes is shown in VI, 1. For the equivalence between "proper existence" and "essence", see I, 5, p. 31, 5–9 [pp. 34, 55–35, 61].

[1.1] Introduction (p. 10, 4–5)
[1.2] Proofs (pp. 10, 5–12, 19)
[1.2.1] First Proof (pp. 10, 5–12, 14)
[1.2.1.1] No other science investigates its own subject-matter *qua* existent (pp. 10, 5–11, 2)
[1.2.1.2] The investigation of the other sciences' subject-matters *qua* existents is necessary (p. 11, 3–6)
[1.2.1.3] The investigation of the other sciences' subject-matters *qua* existents belongs to metaphysics (pp. 11, 7–12, 10)
[1.2.1.4] The other sciences' subject-matters *qua* existents are the states of "existent *qua* existent" (p. 12, 11–14)
[1.2.2] Second Proof (pp. 12, 15–13, 7)
[1.2.2.1] There are concepts common to all the sciences, that have to be defined and certified, but no other science investigates them (pp. 12, 15–13, 3)
[1.2.2.2] The concepts that are common to all the sciences are properties of "existent *qua* existent" (p. 13, 3–7)
[1.2.3] Conclusion of the first two proofs (p. 13, 8–9)
[1.2.4] Third proof: the quiddity of "existent *qua* existent" has not to be known and its existence to be proved (p. 13, 9–12)
[1.2.5] Conclusion of the three proofs (p. 13, 12–19)
[1.3] Objection and answer (p. 14, 1–13)

Avicenna provides three proofs. In the first ([1.2.1]) he shows that the other sciences do not study their own subject-matters (corporeal substance as subject to movement and rest in the case of natural philosophy,[31] continuous quantity abstracted from matter in the case of geometry, continuous quantity taken with matter in the case of astronomy, discrete quantity abstracted from matter in the case of arithmetic, discrete quantity taken with matter in the case of music, the second intelligible notions as capable of conveying new knowledge in the case of logic) as existent; that this investigation is necessary; that the subject-matters of the other sciences considered in this way

[31] In I, 2, p. 10, 6 [p. 9, 59] Avicenna indicates body (*ǧism*) as subject-matter of natural philosophy; at p. 11, 3–4 [p. 10, 79–80], he mentions both substance (*ǧawhar*) and body; at p. 11, 10 [p. 10, 88–89] only substance. This shift from body to substance in the description of the subject-matter of natural philosophy is meant to show that this subject-matter is a state and property of "existent *qua* existent" (a condition that applies properly speaking only to substance).

are immaterial things and their investigation belongs therefore to metaphysics, meant as divine science along the lines of Text 1;[32] and that the subject-matters of the other sciences considered in this way are states and (proper) accidents of "existent *qua* existent". On account of Text 2 [b], this implies that "existent *qua* existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics.

The second proof ([1.2.2]) is analogous to the first—even though it follows a different order and skips some passages—with regard to notions common to all the sciences like "one *qua* one", "many *qua* many", "coincident", "different", "contrary" etc. These first two proofs attest that "existent *qua* existent" complies with Text 2 [b], and point at the foundational role of metaphysics with regard to the other sciences, as we will see more in detail in Chapter 7. Avicenna appears to take these two proofs as the main reason why "existent *qua* existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics (see their common conclusion in [1.2.3]).

The third proof ([1.2.4]) is somehow added to the previous two, and relies on a new and extended characterization of the subject-matter of a science:

> Text 2.3: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 13, 11–12 [p. 13, 35–36]:
> . . . since establishing [the existence] of the subject-matter and verifying its quiddity cannot occur in the science of which it is the subject-matter, but only assuming its existence and quiddity [can occur in it].

Since the quiddity and existence of "existent *qua* existent" do not need to be proved (either in metaphysics or in any other science), on account of Text 2.3 "existent *qua* existent" results suitable to the role of the subject-matter of metaphysics.[33]

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[32] In I, 2, pp. 11, 10–12, 10 [pp. 10, 88–12, 11], Avicenna shows that the subject-matters of natural philosophy, arithmetic and logic are immaterial by considering them according to their universal essence (i.e. as substance, as number and as secondary intelligible notions, respectively) rather than as existents. This shift is anticipated in I, 2, p. 11, 3–4 [p. 10, 79–80], where, with regard to the subject-matter of natural philosophy, he points at the necessity of investigating "substance as existent *and substance*, and body as substance" (emphasis added).

[33] Aertsen [2006] raises the interesting question of why Avicenna choses "existent", not the apparently more universal concept of "thing", as the subject-matter of metaphysics. As far as I can see, a possible answer to this question can be found in I, 5, p. 32, 3–5 [p. 36, 79–83], where Avicenna states: "The concomitance of the meaning of "existence" does not separate itself from it [i.e. from the meaning

As a general conclusion of the three arguments ([1.2.5]), Avicenna states what follows:

> Text 3: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 13, 12–13 [p. 13, 36–38]:
> Therefore, the first subject-matter of this science is "existent *qua* existent", and the things searched by it are the realities that pertain to it [i.e. to "existent"] in so far as it is "existent", without any [further] condition.

Finally ([1.3]), he counters an objection which aims at showing that "existent *qua* existent" cannot be the subject-matter of metaphyiscs. This objection relies on a further characterization of the relationship between a science and its subject-matter:

> Text 2.4: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 14, 2–3 [p. 13, 49–50]:
> . . . since in every science the investigation regards the consequent attributes of its subject-matter, not the principles of it.

On account of Text 2.4, the opponent argues that—since metaphysics investigates the principles of "existent *qua* existent" (according to what Avicenna has proved in I, 1)—this latter cannot be the subject-matter of metaphysics. By "principles of existent *qua* existent", the opponent means its "ontological principles" (i.e. the causes of its existence), not the logical principles (mentioned in Text 2.1, [a.iii]). Avicenna agrees with the opponent's statement in Text 2.4: his answer is that the principles of the existents are not principles of "existent *qua* existent", but rather properties of it (since the fact of being a principle is neither constitutive of "existent *qua* existent", nor does it follow from a condition of existent other than its status of exis-

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of "thing"] at all; on the contrary, the meaning of "existent" accompanies it always, since it [i.e. "thing"] is either an existent in reality or an existent in the estimative faculty and in the intellect. Were it not be so, it would not be a thing". The outcome of this passage is that "existent", according to Avicenna, has a *greater* extension than "thing": every thing is an existent—i.e. exists either in reality or in the mind—whereas not every existent is a thing, since there is an existent (i.e. the Necessary Existent, namely God) that has no quiddity (see VIII, 6, p. 347, 10) and therefore is not a "thing" (in order to be a thing, something must possess an essence or quiddity). Thus, the extension of "existent" encompasses the extension of "thing", but exceeds its boundaries. Having a broader scope than "thing", and being therefore the most universal concept, "existent" is the best candidate to the role of subject-matter of the most universal science, i.e. metaphysics. For the studies on Avicenna's account of the relationship between "existent" and "thing", see Chapter 5, §4.3, n. 62; on the issue of whether or not God has a quiddity according to Avicenna, see Chapter 5, §4.4, n. 81.

tent); they are principles, not of "existent *qua* existent", but of some among the existents, i.e. of the caused existents.[34]

It is noteworthy that, in different places of chapter I, 2, Avicenna employs a notion of "existent *qua* existent", according to which this latter is the most universal reality and posseses a well-defined nature (consisting of species and properties) before becoming the existent that is natural, mathematical, ethical and so on. What follows is a collection of the relevant passages:

Text 4.1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 13, 16–19 [p. 13, 42–46]:

[a] Some of these [i.e. of the things pertaining to existent *qua* existent] belong to it[35] as proper accidents, like one and many, potency and act, universal and particular, possible and necessary. [b] For existent, in order to receive these accidents and be predisposed to them, does not need to be specified as natural, mathematical, ethical and so on.

Text 4.2: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 14, 4–8 [pp. 13, 52–14, 57]:

[a] The fact of being principle is neither constitutive of existent nor excluded from it; rather, with regard to the nature of existent, it is something inherent in it and one of the proper accidents of it. [b] For there is nothing more common than existent, so that existent would be an attribute of something else in a primary way. [c] Existent does not even need to become natural, mathematical or something else in order that the fact of being principle inheres in it.

Text 4.3: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 15, 3–7 [p. 15, 79–85]:

Thus this science investigates the states of "existent" and the things that are like its divisions and species until it reaches [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter of natural science comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to natural science]—and [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter of mathematics comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to mathematics]—and similarly in the other cases. Of what precedes that specification and is as its principle, on the contrary, [this science] investigates and determines the state.

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[34] In I, 2, p. 14, 8–9 [p. 14, 58–59], answering to this objection, Avicenna maintains that if "existent" in its entirety had a principle, its principle would be principle of itself. This implies that the principle of "existent", according to Avicenna, is itself an existent. The principles of "existent" are equated with the (proper) accidents of this latter a few lines earlier (p. 14, 3–4 [p. 13, 50–51]).

[35] Reading *baʿḍu hāḏihi lahū* instead of *baʿḍu hāḏihi* (see Appendix A).

Text 4.4: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 15, 9–11 [pp. 15, 89–16, 91]:
This is . . . first philosophy, since it is the science of the first thing in existence, namely the First Cause, and of the first thing in universality, namely existence and unity.

Text 4.5: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 15, 13–16 [p. 16, 95–99]:
[a] To it [i.e. to this science] pertains the definition of "divine science", namely "science of the realities that are separate from matter in definition and existence". [b] For [with regard to] existent *qua* existent, its principles and its [proper] accidents, none of them—as it has become evident—is otherwise than anterior to matter in existence and independent from the existence of matter in existence.

Text 4.6: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 4, p. 25, 8–9 [p. 28, 23–24]:
Since existent, in order to be an existing substance, does not need to become natural or mathematical (for there are substances besides these two [i.e. besides natural and mathematical substances]) . . .

Text 4.7: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 4, p. 26, 6–7 [p. 29, 45–46]:
Since existent, in order to be cause or caused, does not need to be natural or mathematical or something else . . .

"Existent" is—together with "one"—the most universal reality (see Text 4.2 [b]; Text 4.4). In fact, it encompasses even God, whom Avicenna will qualify in I, 6 as a particular type of existent, i.e. the Necessary Existent. On account of its utmost universality, existent, taken simply as existent, is higher than and precedes all the particular instances of existent (natural, mathematical, ethical etc.): already at this "pure" level, it has its own properties (Text 4.1 [b]; being principle, Text 4.2 [c]; being cause and caused, Text 4.7) and species (Text 4.3; substance, Text 4.6). Its anteriority with regard to the natural existent implies, in particular, its immateriality (Text 4.5 [b]). Thus, on account of the immateriality of its own subject-matter, "existent" (Text 4.5 [a]), metaphysics is divine science as envisaged by Text 1 [a].

1.3 *The Ultimate Causes and God as the Goal of Metaphysics*

On the assumption that "existent *qua* existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics, Avicenna can also explain why this discipline is divine science in its second respect, i.e. for the fact of taking the ultimate causes and God into account (Text 1 [b]–[c]): these latter are the causes and principles of "existent", and represent the goal of metaphysics meant as the science having "existent" as its subject-matter.

The notion of "goal" is a specification of that of "thing searched" in metaphysics, as distinct from its subject-matter.

Avicenna's view on the goal of metaphysics emerges not only from the section of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2 specifically devoted to this issue (see Outline 3), but also from scattered statements occurring both beforehand in chapters I, 1–2, and afterwards in chapter I, 3. From these statements in I, 1–2 we get two main indications: Avicenna contends that the investigation of the goal of this discipline is intimately connected with that of its subject-matter,[36] more precisely, that it is the investigation of the properties of this subject-matter;[37] he identifies the "goal" of metaphysics with the knowledge of the ultimate causes in general.[38]

In the specific discussion of the goal of metaphysics in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, the indications offered in the previous part of the work are clarified: the goal of metaphysics encompasses, in general, all the things taken into account by metaphysics and, in particular, the theological investigation that this discipline performs. What follows in an outline of this section of I, 2.

Outline 3: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 14, 14–16, 12 [pp. 14, 68–17, 20]
[2.1] Division of metaphysics (pp. 14, 14–15, 8)
[2.2] Solution of the problem of what first philosophy and wisdom are: metaphysics is first philosophy and wisdom (p. 15, 9–13)
[2.3] Metaphysics is, properly speaking, divine science (pp. 15, 13–16, 12)
- [2.3.1] Metaphysics possesses the definition of divine science (p. 15, 13–17)
- [2.3.2] Classification of the things investigated by metaphysics on account of their degree of separation from matter (pp. 15, 17–16, 11)
- [2.3.3] Conclusion: this type of things is the goal of metaphysics (p. 16, 11–12)

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[36] I, 2, p. 10, 4–5 [p. 9, 57–58].

[37] See I, 1, p. 7, 14–16 [p. 6, 8–11], where Avicenna states that, if the subject-matter of metaphysics were the four causes in absolute terms (i.e *qua* causes), then the goal (*ġaraḍ*) of metaphysics would be the examination of their accidents (i.e. proper accidents or properties) *qua* causes. The expression "our goal here (i.e. in metaphysics)" (*ġaraḍunā hunā*) in VII, 1, p. 303, 5 [p. 349, 7] (see Appendix A) includes the discussion of the properties of "being *qua* being" (*huwiyya min ḥayṯu hiya huwiyya*), i.e. of "existent *qua* existent" (see Chapter 5, §4.4, Text 4 [g]).

[38] In I, 1, p. 9, 10 [p. 9, 54–55] the ultimate causes are called the "perfection" (*kamāl*) of metaphysics.

In [2.1] Avicenna presents a three-fold division of metaphysics: this discipline includes an investigation of the ultimate causes and the First Cause of "the existent *qua* existent" that is caused (= OntologyC/ Theology); an investigation of the properties of "existent *qua* existent" (= OntologyP); and an investigation of the divisions and species of "existent *qua* existent" (= OntologyS).[39] In [2.2] he goes back to and solves the second issue concerning metaphysics raised in I, 1, namely the precise identity of first philosophy and wisdom and their relationship with metaphysics meant as divine science (see Outline 1 [2.2]). Finally in [2.3], he resumes and conclusively clarifies the description of metaphysics as divine science placed at the very beginning of I, 1, namely "science of the things separate from matter in definition and existence" (see Text 1 [a]).

It is clear that the things referred to as the goal of metaphysics in [2.3.3] are the immaterial things mentioned in [2.3.1] within the definition of metaphysics as divine science, and classified in [2.3.2].[40] The immaterial things investigated by metaphysics are not restricted, according to Avicenna, to the divine realm: they include, besides the principles of "existent", also "existent" itself and its properties,[41] and encompass even material things—considered though as immaterial—like movement and rest.[42] In this regard, therefore, the goal of metaphysics appears to embrace the entire scope of this discipline. In this same section of I, 2, however, Avicenna stresses in various ways the theological purport of metaphysics: it is noteworthy, for example, that in the division of metaphysics offered in [2.1], OntologyC/ Theology—i.e. the treatment of the ultimate causes and of the First Cause—is the first part of metaphysics mentioned by Avicenna, even though it is the last in the actual structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt*; likewise, while showing in [2.2] that metaphysics is both first philosophy and wisdom, Avicenna emphasizes the theological components of these two disciplines much more than he does in the passage of I, 1 where the issue of the relationship of metaphysics with first philosophy and wisdom is first raised.[43] Thus, it seems that in the specific discussion

[39] On this tripartition of metaphysics, see Chapter 5, §1, Text 2.
[40] The text of this classification is available in Chapter 3, §4, Table 3.
[41] I, 2, p. 15, 14–16 [p. 16, 97–99].
[42] I, 2, p. 16, 5–7 [p. 17, 10–13].
[43] In I, 1, p. 5, 7–8 [p. 3, 45–46] Avicenna describes first philosophy as the science that "provides the ascertainment of the principles of the other sciences"; in

in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, Avicenna both advances a broad notion of the goal of the metaphysics, but also specifies it—at least implicitly—as coinciding with theological issues.

What is implicit in the specific discussion of the goal of metaphysics in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, is made clear by Avicenna in I, 3. Here the goal of metaphysics is identified, in distinct occasions and according to different denominations, with the investigation of the highest causes,[44] of the celestial realm,[45] of God[46] and of the supra-natural reality.[47] The same happens in other works by Avicenna.[48] Significantly,

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I, 2, p. 15, 9–11 [pp. 15,89–16, 91], on the other hand, he describes it as "the science *of the first thing in existence, namely the First Cause*, and of the first thing in universality, namely existence and unity" (emphasis added). Likewise, in I, 1, p. 5, 8–10 [p. 3, 47–50], wisdom is described as (i) "the most excellent knowledge (*ʿilm*) of the most excellent known thing", (ii) "the knowledge (*maʿrifa*) which is most certain and perfect", and (iii) "the knowledge (or: science, *ʿilm*) of the first causes of everything"; in I, 2, p. 15, 11–13 [p. 16, 91–95], on the other hand, it is described as (i)–(ii) "the most excellent knowledge, i.e. certainty, of the most excellent known thing, *i.e. God . . . and the causes that are after Him*", (iii) "knowledge (*maʿrifa*) of the ultimate causes of everything", and (iv) "knowledge (*maʿrifa*) *of God*" (emphasis added).

[44] In I, 3, p. 18, 14–17 [p. 20, 70–76], "that whose knowledge is intended" (*al-maqṣūd maʿrifatuhū*) in metaphysics is described as the "principle of the existence" (*mabdaʾ li-wuǧūd*) of the things sought after in the particular sciences, a description used elsewhere (I, 1, p. 4, 14–17 [pp. 2, 31–3, 34]) to refer to God and the ultimate causes.

[45] In I, 3, p. 19, 5–6 [p. 21, 82–83] "the ultimate goal" (*al-ġaraḍ al-aqṣā*) of metaphysics is described as the knowledge of the arrangement of things provided by the Creator, the knowledge of the spiritual angels (i.e. the heavenly intelligences) and their ranks, and the knowledge of the order according to which the heavenly spheres are disposed.

[46] In I, 3, p. 21, 1–2 [p. 23, 30–31] "the goal" (*al-ġaraḍ*) of metaphysics is described as "a determination [of reality] that does not begin after another science" (reading *taḥṣīlun mubtadiʾun lā baʿda ʿilmin āḫara*, instead of *taḥṣīlu mabdaʾin illā baʿda ʿilmin āḫara*, see Appendix A). What immediately follows (p. 21, 2–7 [pp. 23, 31–24, 41]) is a summary of the main points of the treatment of God in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (the proof of His existence, immutability unicity and universal agency), so that God appears to be that thing whose determination represents the goal of metaphysics. In I, 3, p. 23, 5 [p. 26, 82], the knowledge of God is said to be the "end" (*ġāya*) of metaphysics. The proof of God's existence is called "goal" also in VIII, 1, p. 328, 15 [p. 378, 51–52], but Avicenna appears to refer here to the specific goal of chapters VIII, 1–3, not to the overall goal of metaphysics.

[47] In I, 3, p. 23, 6–8 [p. 26, 84–86], the "perfection" (*kamāl*), "noblest part" (*ašraf aǧzāʾihī*) and "prime intent" (*maqṣūd awwal*) of metaphysics—cp. "the noblest thing" (*al-maʿnā al-ašraf*), "the noblest part" (*al-ǧuzʾ al-ašraf*) and "the part which is like the end" (*al-ǧuzʾ allaḏī huwa ka-l-ġāya*) at p. 23, 5–6 [p. 26, 83–84]—is the knowledge of what is absolutely separate from nature.

[48] The theological investigation is called "completion" (*tamām*) of first philosophy in the opening lines of the *Hidāya* (p. 232, 5). See also the passage of the Introduction of the *Mabdaʾ* mentioned above, n. 12.

in some passages of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3 Avicenna calls this type of investigation "the ultimate goal" (*al-ġaraḍ al-aqṣā*) and "prime intent" (*maqṣūd awwal*),[49] as if he were implying that the theological investigation represents the prime instance of the goal of metaphysics.

In several places of I, 1–2, Avicenna develops the description of metaphysics offered in Text 1 [b]–[c], and relates God and the ultimate causes, i.e. the goal of metaphysics, to "existent", i.e. its subject-matter, as the principles of a portion of this latter.

> Text 5.1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, p. 7, 7–8 [p. 6, 99–00]
> Let us consider whether its subject-matter [i.e. of metaphysics] are all the four ultimate causes *of the existents* . . . (emphasis added).

> Text 5.2: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 14, 14–17; 15, 7–8 [pp. 14, 68–15, 72; 15, 86–87]
> One of them [i.e. of the parts of metaphysics] is that [part] investigating the ultimate causes, since they are the causes of every caused existent with regard to its existence, and the First Cause from which emanates every caused existent *qua* caused existent—not *qua* existent in motion only or possessed of quantity only. [. . .] Therefore [some] questions (*masā'il*) of this science regard the causes of the caused existent *qua* caused existent. . . .

> Text 5.3: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 15, 14–16 [p. 16, 97–99] = Text 4.5 [b]
> For [with regard to] existent *qua* existent, *its principles* and its [proper] accidents, none of them—as it has become evident—is otherwise than anterior to matter in existence and independent from the existence of matter in existence (emphasis added).

Text 5.1 precedes the objection regarding "existent *qua* existent" and its principles (see above, Outline 2 [1.3]): Avicenna does not speak of "causes of the existent", but of "causes of the existents" (in the plural), probably in order to clarify better the relationship between "existent *qua* existent" and its causes and principles in the discussion of this objection. Text 5.2 follows the answer to the aforementioned objection, in which Avicenna shows that "existent *qua* existent", on account of its all-encompassing universality and absolute priority, has no principle properly speaking: only a part of "existent", i.e. the caused "existent", has principles. Accordingly, in Text 5.2 he connects the ultimate causes and God only with the "existent" that is

[49] See the passages I, 3, p. 19, 5–6 [p. 21, 82–83] and I, 3, p. 23, 6–8 [p. 26, 84–86], quoted above, nn. 45, 47.

caused. In Text 5.3, finally, Avicenna does not take the objection into account any more, and mentions the principles of "existent *qua* existent" without further qualifications (he refers in all likelihood to God and the ultimate causes).

To summarize: in chapters I, 1–2 Avicenna shows that the assumption of "existent" as the subject-matter of metaphysics perfectly fits with the traditional view of this discipline as "divine science" (Text 1), and allows metaphysics to have a clear-cut and certain subject-matter (Texts 2.1–4). "Existent" is the only suitable candidate to the role of subject-matter of the metaphysics, both because the other two candidates (God and the ultimate causes) do not resist the epistemological test, and because it exhausitvely explains the scientific features of metaphysics, especially its role of supreme science. By having "existent" as its subject-matter, metaphysics fully satisfies the divine science's character of a study of what is immaterial (Text 1[a]), since "existent" is an immaterial reality (Texts 3.1–7); the ultimate causes and God as First Cause belong to the things searched by metaphysics (Text 1[b]–[c]), since they are the principles of "existent" (more precisely: of the existent that is caused; Texts 4.1–3), and represent the "goal" of this discipline. In this way Avicenna brings to unity Aristotle's view of metaphysics as science of "being *qua* being" (*Metaphysics* Γ, 1), science of what is unmoved, eternal and immaterial (*Metaphysics* E, 1) and science of the ultimate causes and principles (*Metaphysics* A, 1–2). At the same time, his account of metaphysics fully satisfies the epistemological requirements of the *Posterior Analytics*.

2 Avicenna's Sources

2.1 *Aristotle's* Metaphysics *and* Posterior Analytics

Avicenna's Text 1 (the view of metaphysics which he assumes and from which he starts the discussion of the subject-matter of this discipline) goes back ultimately—as far as its main element, [a], is concerned—to *Metaph.* E, 1, 1026a15–21.

> Text 6.1: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* E, 1, 1026a15–21
>
> As to the first science, it regards the things that are separate (*li-l-ašyā' al-mufāriqa*, χωριστὰ) and those that do not move either. It is required that all of them are eternal, these most of all, since they are causes (*'ilal*) of the evident things among the divine [things] (*al-ilāhiyya*,

τῶν θείων). Therefore the species of theoretical philosophy are three: mathematical, natural and theological (*al-ilāhiyya al-qawl*, θεολογική). For it is not ignored that, if the divine (*al-ilāhī*, τὸ θεῖον) exists, it is in such a nature.[50]

Part [a] of Avicenna's Text 1 and Aristotle's Text 6.1 both qualify the things investigated by metaphysics as "separate" (*mufāriqa*). But Avicenna, contrarily to Aristotle, specifies that these things are separate from matter, in a double respect (subsistence and definition), and does not mention their motionless nature. In this respect, Avicenna's Text 1 [a] mirrors texts like the account of metaphysics in the classification of the parts of philosophy that Ammonius offers at the beginning of his commentary on the *Isagoge* (a classification that also depends on the aforementioned passage of book E).

Text 6.2: Ammonius, *In Isag.*, Ammonius [1895], p. 11, 24–26.

There are three orders of all beings: they are either things totally separate from matter (χωριστὰ τῆς ὕλης), both in substance (τῇ ὑποστάσει) and in notion (τῇ . . . ἐπινοίᾳ).[51]

That Avicenna's description of metaphysics in Text 1 [a] is related to this passage of Ammonius' commentary is confirmed by *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 14, 5–6, where the similarity is even closer: in this place Avicenna describes metaphysics as considering things that are separate from matter in subsistence and "conceptualization" (*taṣawwur*), i.e. essence,[52] even though here—as in *Aqsām*, pp. 84, 24–85, 2—he mentions their separation not only from matter, but also from motion.[53] How Avicenna could have had access to Ammonius' commentary on the *Isagoge* is uncertain.[54]

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[50] *Tafsīr*, p. 707, 3–7. "[. . .] the first science deals with things which are both separable and immovable. Now all causes must be eternal, but especially these; for they are the causes of so much of the divine as appears to us. There must, then, be three theoretical philosophies, mathematics, natural science, and theology, since it is obvious that if the divine is present anywhere, it is present in things of this sort".

[51] In other two Alexandrian commentaries on the *Isagoge* (by Elias and David) metaphysics is depicted slightly differently: in Elias, it simply concerns the "immaterial" (ἄυλα) beings (Elias [1900], p. 27, 36ff.); in David, the beings that are "immaterial" (ἄυλα) in substance and notion (David [1904], p. 58, 1ff.).

[52] For the equivalence between "conceptualization" and "definition" (*ḥadd*), i.e. the formula of essence, in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see Chapter 5, n. 60.

[53] See Marmura [1980], p. 246. On Avicenna's dependence on Ammonius' classification of the parts of philosophy, see Hein [1985], pp. 164–165.

[54] No Arabic translation of Ammonius' commentary is extant or attested. The

The source of the following two parts of Text 1 ([b]–[c]) is less clear. They might depend just on Aristotle's Text 6.1, where the separate things are portrayed as "causes" (*'ilal*) of the evident (i.e. visible) divine things (probably the celestial bodies), and as the seat of the "divine" (*al-ilāhī*). These two ideas might correspond, respectively, to Avicenna's description of metaphysics as the science of the ultimate causes (Text 1 [b]), and of the divinity (Text 1 [c]). But they (especially point [b]) might also depend on other passages of the *Metaphysics*, like the ones that probably lay in the background of Avicenna's Texts 4.1–3.

Text 7.1: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 1, 1003a31–32

Therefore we have to seek the causes (*al-'ilal*, τὰς πρώτας αἰτίας) that affect being (*al-huwiyya*) with regard to its nature.[55]

Text 7.2: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Ε, 1, 1025b3–4

Aristotle says that the principles (*awā'il*, αἱ ἀρχαὶ) of beings and their causes (*'ilaluhā*, τὰ αἴτια) are seeked with regard to the fact that they are beings.[56]

Text 7.3: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Λ, 7, 1072b13–14

(Mattā's transl.) The heaven, therefore, and nature are in mutal agreement with a principle (*mabda'*) of this kind; thus, the heaven and nature are depending [on it].

(Usṭāṯ's translation) Therefore, on a beginning (*bi-bad'*)[57] like this are clinged the heaven and nature.[58]

In Aristotle's Texts 6.1–2, as in Avicenna's Texts 4.1–3, metaphysics is assigned the task of investigating the causes and principles of "being *qua* being" ("existent *qua* existent"). In Text 7.1 (at least in the Greek original) these causes are specified as "first". God is alluded to as principle of the heavenly and sublunary world in Text 7.3. As the

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Fihrist (p. 253, 20–21) mentions only his commentaries on Aristotle's works, not on Porphyry's *Isagoge*. Avicenna's Text 1 is the last part of a classification of the theoretical sciences (natural philosophy, mathematics, metaphysics; see above, Outline 1 [1.2]); what he says about natural philosophy and mathematics is different from Ammonius' descriptions of these disciplines in his commentary on the *Isagoge* (the pericope following Text 6.2).

[55] *Tafsīr*, p. 297, 4. "Therefore it is of being as being that we also must grasp the first causes".

[56] *Tafsīr*, p. 697, 6. "We are seeking the principles and the causes of the things that are, and obviously of things *qua* being".

[57] Reading *bi-bad'in* instead of *yabda'u*.

[58] *Tafsīr*, pp. 1608, 8–1609, 1; 1608, 4–1609, 1, bottom of page. "On such a principle, then, depend the heavens and the world of nature".

mention of "emanation" in Avicenna's Text 5.2 makes clear, Avicenna's doctrine of the ultimate causes and God as principles of existent is influenced also by Neoplatonic metaphysics (see also below, §2.4).

Finally, Avicenna's distinction of the subject-matter (*mawḍūʿ*) of a science from the things searched (*maṭlūba*) in it, and his conception of the subject-matter as something whose properties only are investigated in that science, since its existence is taken from granted and its principles remain outside the scope of investigation (Texts 2.1–4), resemble directly a passage of Avicenna's *Burhān* (Text 8.1), to which Avicenna refers explicitly in Text 2.1 and implicitly in Text 2.2. Indirectly, Avicenna refers also to the passage the *Posterior Analytics* (Text 8.2) of which Text 8.1 is the reworking.

Text 8.1: *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 4–12

We say that every discipline—especially the theoretical one—has [i] principles, [ii] subject-matters (*mawḍūʿāt*) and [iii] questions (*masā'il*). [i] Principles are the premises from which that discipline demonstrates, without them being demonstrated in that discipline, either because they are evident, or because they are of too high a rank to be demonstrated in it, and are demonstrated only in a superior science, or because they are of too low a rank to be demonstrated in that science, but rather [they are demonstrated] in an inferior science (even though this is rare). [ii] Subject-matters are the things of which the discipline investigates only (*innamā*) the states related to them, and the essential accidents belonging to them. [iii] Questions are the propositions whose predicates are the essential accidents of this subject-matter, or of its species, or of its accidents; doubts arise about them, and hence their state is clarified in that science.

Principles are the things from which the demonstrative proof is, questions are the things of which the demonstrative proof is, subject-matters are the things about which the demonstrative proof is. It is as if the purpose of that about which the demonstrative proof is were the essential accidents, [the purpose of] that for the sake of which that [i.e. the demonstrative proof] is were the subject-matter, and [the purpose of that] from which [the demonstrative proof is] were the principles.

Text 8.2: Arabic translation of *An. Post.* A, 10, 76b11–22

For every demonstrative science is three things: [i] one are the things that we posit as existent, namely that [particular] genus [*ḏālika l-ǧins*, τὸ γένος], of which it considers the affections belonging to it in themselves; and [ii] the well-known knowledges called "common", namely the first [things] from which they first clarify [the other things]; and third [iii] the affections, namely those of which they assume what each of them signifies. [. . .] In the same way, nonetheless, there is the exis-

> tence of these three things in the clarification of nature, I mean that about which [the science] demonstrates, the things that it demonstrates and the things from which it [demonstrates].[59]

Text 8.1 and Text 8.2 will be analyzed more in detail in Chapter 5, with particular regard to the three items mentioned in them ("principles", "subject-matters"/"genus", and "questions"/"affections"), and the distinction between "species" and "(essential) accidents" that Avicenna posits among the "questions". What has to be remarked here is, first, that the distinction between "subject-matters" and "questions" in Text 8.1 parallels that between "subject-matter" and "things searched" in Text 2.1; and, second, that in Text 8.1 Avicenna calls individually "subject-matters" (*mawḍūʿāt*) in the plural the things that Aristotle in Text 8.2 calls collectively "genus" (γένος):[60] as this latter's existence is taken for granted by the science dealing with it, according to Aristotle, so the former are investigated "only" (*innamā*) with regard to their "states" (probably their species) and "essential accidents" (i.e. properties), according to Avicenna.

Finally, Avicenna's Text 3 is an almost literal quotation of the beginning of *Metaphysics* Γ:

> Text 9: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 1, 1003a20–21
>
> Aristotle says that to one science belongs the theoretical study of "being" with regard to its nature (*al-huwiyya ʿalā kunhihā*, τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὄν) and the theoretical study of the things that belong to "being" in virtue

[59] Aristotle [1999], vol. I, pp. 463, 13–464, 4; 464, 10–11 (cp. Aristotle [1948–52], vol. II, pp. 339, 12–340, 7). "For every demonstrative science has to do with three things: [i] what it posits to be (these form the genus, of what it considers the attributes that belong to it in itself; and [ii] what are called the common axioms, the primitives from which it demonstrates; and thirdly [iii] the attributes, of which it assumes what each signifies. Nothing, however, prevents some sciences from overlooking some of these—e.g. from not supposing that its genus is, if it is evident that it is (for it is not equally clear that number is and that hot and cold are), and from not assuming what the attributes signify, if they are clear—just as in the case of the common items it does not assume what to take equals from equals signifies, because it is familiar. But none the less there are by nature these three things, that about which the science proves, what it proves and the things from which it proves".

[60] In a previous passage of the *Posterior Analytics* (*An. Post.* A, 7, 75a39–b2), to which Avicenna probably refers, Aristotle qualifies the genus as "underlying" (τὸ γένος τὸ ὑποκείμενον); this expression is rendered as *al-ǧins al-mawḍūʿ* in the Arabic translation of the *Posterior Analytics* (Aristotle [1999], vol. I, p. 455, 8; cp. Aristotle [1948–52], vol. II, p. 333, 1–4). The same expression occurs in the Arabic translation of *Metaph.* B, 2, 997ab (*Tafsīr*, p. 193, 2).

> of its [or: their] essence (*al-ašyā' allatī hiya li-l-huwiyya bi-ḏātihā*, τὰ τούτῳ ὑπάρχοντα καθ' αὑτό; καθ' αὑτά in Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary).[61]

The main difference between Avicenna's Text 3 and Aristotle's Text 9—apart from the presence of the expression "existent *qua* existent" in place of "being *qua* being"—is Avicenna's application to Aristotle's statement of the distinction between "subject-matter" and "things searched" (deriving from Texts 8.1–2): "existent *qua* existent", according to Avicenna, is the subject-matter of metaphysics, whereas the realities that pertain to it "*qua* existent" are the things searched by metaphysics. In Γ, Aristotle does not apply to "being *qua* being" the concept of "subject-matter" ("genus" in Aristotelian terms) since "being", in his opinion, is not a genus.[62] By introducing the new concept of "subject-matter" Avicenna solves this inner tension in Aristotle's doctrine in a way that facilitates the application to metaphysics of the epistemology of the *Posterior Analytics*.

2.2 *Post-Aristotelian Greek authors*

In the Greek post-Aristotelian tradition the issue of what metaphysics is about does not appear to have been raised and discussed more thoroughly than Aristotle himself does in Ε, 1, 1026a23–32. But our knowledge of the works where such a discussion should be expected, i.e. the Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics*, is incomplete in many respects. An overview of the Greek commentaries on Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is provided in the following table.[63]

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[61] *Tafsīr*, p. 296, 6–7. "There is a science which investigates being as being and the attributes which belong to this in virtue of its own nature".

[62] See, however, the mention of the "species" of "being" in Γ, 2, 1003b21–22 (see Chapter 5, §6.3, Text 13), and the veiled references to "genus" in connection with "being" in 1003b19, 22, 35.

[63] See the exhaustive surveys in D'Ancona [2002]; Luna [2003].

Table 1: Greek commentaries on Aristotle's *Metaphysics*

author	school	type	status	books													
				A	α	B	Γ	Δ	E	Z	H	Θ	I	K	Λ	M	N
Nicholas of Damascus (64 BC–after 14 AD)		paraphr.	summary in Syriac	o	o										o		o
			testimonia/fragments of **Arabic tr.**			o		o		o							
Aspasius (first half II AD)	Peripatetic		fragments in Alexander of Aphrodisias	o				o									
Aristotle of Mytilene (II AD)			fragment in Syrianus													o	
Alexander of Aphrodisias (appointed to chair between 198 and 209 AD)	Peripatetic	literal	Greek original	o	o	o	o	o									
			fragments in Ammonius and Syrianus							o						o	o
			fragments of **Arabic tr.**												o		
Porphyry (233–304)			fragment												o		
Themistius (fl. late 340s–384 or 385 AD)	Peripatetic	paraphr.	fragments of **Arabic tr.** Latin tr. Hebrew tr.												o		

Table 1 (*cont.*)

author	school	type	status	books														
				A	α	B	Γ	Δ	E	Z	H	Θ	I	K	Λ	M	N
Syrianus (d. ca. 437)	Neoplatonic, Athens	literal	Greek original			o	o									o	o
			Arabic tr. ?			o											
Ammonius (435/445–517/526 AD) *apud* Asclepius	Neoplatonic, Alexandria	literal	Greek original	o	o	o	o	o	o	o							
ps.-Simplicius (= Priscianus of Lydia, VI AD?)			references in Ps.-Simplicius' *On the Soul*												o		o
ps.-Alexander of Aphrodisias (= Michael of Ephesus, XII AD)	Anna Comnena's circle, Byzantium	literal	Greek original						o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o
ps.-Philoponus (after ps.-Alexander)			Greek original and Latin translation	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o	o
ps.-Herennius (XV AD)			Greek original	excerpts from Philo of Alexandria, Alexander of Aphrodisias, Proclus, Damascius, Augustinus, Georges Pachymère													

None of the commentaries antedating Avicenna is fully extant. Three of them (Alexander of Aphrodisias, Syrianus and Ammonius/Asclepius) include book Γ. Only one of them (Ammonius/Asclepius) includes book E and deals with the "crucial" passage E, 1, 1026a23–32, whose treatment can be regarded as an indicator of the degree of attention paid to the issue of what metaphysics is about.[64]

In line with his effort to apply to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* the model of science of the *Posterior Analytics*,[65] in his commentary on Γ Alexander introduces the epistemological concept of "subject" (ὑποκείμενον), i.e. subject-matter, and portrays "being *qua* being" as subject-matter of metaphysics.

> Text 10: Alexander of Aphrodisias, *In Metaph.* Γ, 1, 1003a21
>
> But the science which is not concerned with a kind of being, nor with a part of being, but simply with being in so far as it is being, the being through which particular beings are beings, *and having this as its subject-matter* (καὶ τοῦτο ὑποκείμενον ἔχουσα) would be different from those sciences (emphasis added).[66]

The significance of the attribution to "being *qua* being" of the role of "subject-matter" of metaphysics in Text 10 cannot be overemphasized. Alexander's commentary influenced later commentaries on the *Metaphysics*.[67] Text 10 is resumed almost *verbatim*, for example, in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary.[68]

In Alexander's commentary on Λ, as reported by Averroes in the

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[64] In books II–III of Nicholas of Damascus' *On the Philosophy of Aristotle*, *Metaphysics* E influences only the initial tripartition of theoretical philosophy (Nicholas of Damascus [1965], p. 74, pp. 135–136).

[65] See Bonelli [2001]; Bonelli [2001b]. Quotations of the *Posterior Analytics* occurs in Alexander's commentary on book A (Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 19, 27; p. 129, 23), book α (p. 146, 10; p. 168, 17; p. 168, 22), book B (p. 186, 2; p. 204, 14), and book Γ (p. 266, 22; p. 267, 1; p. 267, 2; p. 268, 5–6; p. 272, 16; p. 272, 17; p. 290, 8). Within the Neoplatonic school, a similar tendency led ultimately, through Syrianus, to Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica*. The stages of this evolution are well described in O'Meara [1986].

[66] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 239, 22–25; Engl. transl. in Madigan [1993], p. 13. The introduction of Alexander's commentary on Γ (*In Metaph.*, pp. 237, 3–239, 3) simply states that metaphysics "is about" (περὶ) "being *qua* being". Sentences like *In Metaph.*, p. 239, 8–9, translated as "for every science, whatever its *object*, demonstrates the properties that belong essentially to its *object*" in Madigan [1993], p. 12 (emphasis added), do not contain any item corresponding to the subject-matter of science in the *Posterior Analytics*. On Alexander's conception of the subject-matter of metaphysics, see Donini [2003].

[67] On its impact on Syrianus' commentary, see Luna [2001b] and Luna [2001c].

[68] Asclepius [1888], p. 225, 1–4.

Tafṣīr, also the idea that philosophical theology is the "goal" (lit. "aim" or "end", *ġāya*) of metaphysics surfaces.

> Text 11: Alexander of Aphrodisias, proem to *Metaph.* Λ *apud* Averroes, *Tafsīr*, p. 1394, 9–12 (= Chapter 5, Text 19 [e])
>
> As for the present book [i.e. L], in it he [= Aristotle] discusses the principles of the existent in so far as it is existent and the principles of the first substance which is the most true. He does it by clarifying that there is a substance which is in this state and what this substance is. The clarification of this substance is the aim sought for (*al-ġāya al-maqṣūda*) in this discipline.

Even though not every point of Text 11 is clear (we wonder what Alexander means by "principles of the first substance"), this text entails quite openly that the investigation of the divine substance and of the principles of beings is regarded by Alexander as the goal of the *Metaphysics*. Also in this case, Alexander's hint has been endorsed and developed by Ammonius/Asclepius, according to whom the "goal" (σκοπός) of the *Metaphysics* results to be primarily, albeit not exclusively, the theological investigation.[69]

The conceptual tools provided by Alexander ("being" as subject-matter, God and the ultimate causes as goal of metaphysics) seems to have contributed decisively to settle (or better: to avoid the insurgence of) the issue of Aristotle's different characterizations of metaphysics among Greek commentators. Significantly, in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary the exegesis of the "crucial" passage E, 1, 1026a23–32 is rather brief and consists mainly of a paraphrase of Aristotle's text.[70] Even Ammonius/Asclepius' extensive and propaedeutic treatment of the "goal" of the *Metaphysics* does not reveal any intent to solve a conflict between different views (theological and non-theological) of the *Metaphysics*: in the *prolegomena* at the beginning of the commentary, he mentions the views according to which the metaphysics' goal is an investigation of God, of "being *qua* being",

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[69] See Chapter 3, §3. The "goal" (σκοπός) of Λ is discussed by Iamblichus (250ca.–330ca. AD), according to the commentary on the *De Anima* attributed to Simplicius (see D'Ancona [2002], p. 208, n. 20; Luna [2003], p. 256). See also Alexander's mention of the "prime intent" (*qaṣd arroval*) of the *Metaphysics* in *Tafsīr*, p. 1395, 1.

[70] Asclepius [1888], p. 364, 9–27. In the introduction to the commentary on book E (p. 358, 25–28), this same passage is portrayed as a way Aristotle uses to clarify the distinction between metaphysics and natural philosophy, not as a problem affecting the epistemological status of metaphysics itself.

and of the (first) principles[71]—that is to say: the views of metaphysics as theology, ontology and aitiology—as complementary rather than mutually exclusive. Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary draws from all the previous commentatorial tradition (especially from Alexander and Syrianus): the absence in it of any specific discussion concerning the metaphysics' theme implies that such a discussion was probably lacking also in previous commentaries. In sum: the Greek commentators on the *Metaphysics* (at least the ones preceding Avicenna) do not seem to have regarded the issue of what metaphysics is about as a question worthy to be raised.

A line of commentaries dealing exclusively with book Λ (i.e. with the goal of the *Metaphysics* according to Alexander) is visible, starting with Porphyry and arriving to Themistius. To these authors also Iamblichus (250ca.–330ca. AD), student of Porphyry, who is credited with an exegesis of book Λ, can be added.[72] Among the Greek works that are not commentaries of the *Metaphysics*, but are nonetheless related to this latter, we notice a similar predilection for the theological aspect of metaphysics: Theophrastus' *Metaphysics*, for example, deals only with questions pertaining to theology rather than ontology;[73] the same holds true for Alexander of Aphrodisias' *Fī Mabādi' al-kull*.[74] Other indications of this "theologizing" tendency come from the descriptions of metaphysics within the subdivision of Aristotle's philosophy in the *prolegomena* of the Alexandrian commentaries on the *Isagoge* (by Ammonius, Elias, David, ps.-Elias),[75] and within the classification of Aristotle's writings in the *prolegomena* of the Alexandrian commentaries on the *Categories* (by Ammonius, Philoponus, Olympiodorus, Elias, Simplicius): in these subdivisions and classifications, Aristotle's metaphysics is constantly named "theology" and described

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[71] See, respectively, points [a] and [b2]; [b1]; [b3] in Chapter 3, §3, Text 5.

[72] See above, n. 69.

[73] "L'opuscule . . . est fait de questions et de difficultés . . . touchant la nature des principes et leur relation au mond physique", Theophrastus [1993], p. xviii; "L'opuscule suppose évidemment la théorie aristotélicienne du premier moteur . . . et donc le livre Λ de la *Métaphysique*", *ibid*., p. xx; one of its features is "l'absence frappante de toute allusion à la doctrine de la substance des livres Z H Θ", *ibid*., p. xxi.

[74] ". . . the ontological part of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is completely disregarded in it" (Genequand's introduction in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], p. 4). On the impact of this treatise on Avicenna, see Chapter 11, §11.

[75] Even though in this case we are in front of a subdivision of philosophy in general, in three commentaries on the *Isagoge* (Elias, David, ps.-Elias) Aristotle's subdivision of philosophy (both theoretical and practical) is distinguished from Plato's subdivision.

as the science of the immaterial, along the lines of E, 1, 1026a13–16.[76] A similar view of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is already expressed by the subdivision of philosophy at the beginning of Nicholas of Damascus' account of this work.[77]

2.3 *Early Arab philosophers*

In early Arabic philosophy, there is no trace of a discussion of the issue posed by Aristotle's different characterizations of the topic of metaphysics. Even more, this issue was, so-to-say, "removed" from the philosophical agenda, due to the first Arab philosophers' one-sided conception of metaphysics as theology and, consequently, their almost exclusive focus on the theological parts of the *Metaphysics*, in disregard of the others.

It is likely that the Arabs inherited this "theologizing" view of metaphysics from their Greek predecessors. The Greek classifications of Aristotle's writings played an important, probably decisive, role in this regard, as al-Kindī witnesses: his work on the classification of Aristotle's writings (the *Risāla fī Kammiyyat kutub Arisṭāṭālīs*) depends on (at least) two Greek sources, whose exact identity has still to be ascertained, and draws from each of them a theologizing view of the *Metaphysics*.[78]

A first effect of this situation is visible in the translation movement: as we have seen in Chapter 1, book Λ—i.e. Aristotle's account of philosophical theology—was the core of the translation activity regarding the *Metaphysics*, and all Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics* translated into Arabic (Alexander of Aphrodisias' literal commentary, and Themistius' paraphrase) were commentaries of this book.

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[76] See Westerink [1990], pp. 341–348.

[77] Nicholas of Damascus [1965], p. 74; Frede [1987], p. 82. It might not be coincidental that the Syriac summary of Nicholas of Damascus' account of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* encompasses only the parts of the original work corresponding to books A-α, Λ and N, and skips the intermediate ontological books, as if the Syriac epitomizer were also focusing on theology (and aitiology) within the *Metaphysics*.

[78] See Chapter 2, §7, n. 74. Drawing upon one of these sources, in a first set of passages al-Kindī proposes a theologizing account of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* as a book dealing with "what does not need bodies, nor is joined with them in any way" (Al-Kindī [1940], p. 391, 9 [chapter II, Italian transl. p. 405], p. 393, 8–9 [chapter III, Italian transl. p. 407]; Al-Kindī [1950b], p. 365, 2; p. 368, 16–17). In a later passage, depending on a different source, al-Kindī envisages the "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) of the *Metaphysics* in an equally theologizing perspective (see Chapter 3, n. 41). The account of metaphysics in the first context is similar to the description of the third part of metaphysics in al-Fārābī's *Iḥṣā'* (see Chapter 3, §5, [ii]).

A second, more important, effect regards the works on metaphysics of the first philosophers writing in Arabic. As we have seen in Chapter 2, in al-Kindī's *Falsafa Ūlā* metaphysics is conceived as theology, and the use of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (amounting not only to positive reception, but also to criticism) is restricted to books α and Λ, the former serving as a sort of introduction to the latter: thus al-Kindī skips the ontological part of the *Metaphysics* (books Α–Κ) and immediately passes from the beginning of this work (book α, the first book of the Arabic *Metaphysics*) to its theology (book Λ). The same emphasis on theology is visible in the first real commentary on the *Metaphysics* extant in Arabic, namely the *talḫīṣ* ("concise exposition") of this work by Ṯābit Ibn Qurra:[79] Ṯābit's *talḫīṣ* is a personal reworking of the theological core of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, namely of chapters 6–9 of book Λ, in which Ṯābit selects the main doctrinal points of these chapters and discusses them at length, trying to reconcile Aristotle's natural theology with Islamic tenets (as when he attributes will to the First Principle and calls *tawḥīd* its unicity). Moreover, Ṯābit contends that the "intention" (*qaṣd*) of the *Metaphysics* is the investigation of the unmoved substance.

Al-Kindī and Ṯābit Ibn Qurra are the main representatives of the theologizing interpretation of the *Metaphysics* that was common in the Arab world until the time of al-Fārābī: by focusing on theology, it minimized the role of ontology in the *Metaphysics*. As we have seen in Chapter 3, al-Fārābī reacted against this interpretation in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* by discussing the issue of the goal of the metaphysics more in detail than Ammonius/Asclepius had done, and by ascribing the function of primary subject-matter of the metaphysics to "existent *qua* existent".

2.4 *The* Liber de Causis

Texts 4.1–7—in which Avicenna contends that existent *qua* existent is prior to the existent that is natural, mathematical etc., that it is absolutely universal, and that it is immaterial—can be related to the *Kitāb fī Maḥḍ al-ḫayr* (*Book of the Pure Good*), also known as *Liber de Causis*, the Arabic reworking of Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica*. The real origin of the *De Causis* was first noticed by Thomas Aquinas in

[79] See Chapter 2, §5.

the XIIIth century: Avicenna possibly still regarded this work as Aristotelian, as its implicit use in the *Ilāhiyyāt* would suggest.[80] The fourth proposition of the *De Causis* contains a doctrine of "being" or "existence" (*anniyya*) as the first created thing (prior to sensation, soul and intellect), and as the "widest" (i.e. most universal) and most effective reality after the First Cause, that might have influenced Avicenna's notion of "existent" in the aforementioned texts.

> Text 12.1: *Liber de Causis*, prop. 4 [5], p. 6, 8–10
>
> The first among the created things is being, and there is no other created [thing] before it. For being is above sensation, above soul and above intellect. After the First Cause there is nothing wider and having more effects than it.

It has to be noticed that, even though "being" is portrayed in Text 12.1 as posterior to the First Cause, in other places of the *De Causis* (like prop. 8 [9], p. 12, 15) it is attributed to the First Cause itself. Including also the First Cause (one of the main doctrinal points of the *De Causis* and one of the distinctive features of this work with regard to the Proclean metaphysics from which it derives),[81] "being" in the *De Causis* presents the same all-encompassing universality that characterizes Avicenna's notion of "existent" in Texts 4.1–7.

A doctrine similar to that contained in Text 12.1 is present also in a passage of al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*. This latter might therefore constitute the connecting link between the *Liber de Causis* and Avicenna (or an additional source that Avicenna employs besides the *De Causis*).

> Text 12.2: Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 35, 19–20 (= Chapter 3, §1, [2.5])
>
> Since these things [i.e. existence, oneness, their species and attributes, priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfect and deficient etc.] are not proper to natural objects but are loftier than them in universality, ...

Al-Fārābī's Text 12.2, as Avicenna's Text 4.1–7, conveys the idea that "existent", "one" and the other concepts taken into account by metaphysics are more universal than, and prior to, the state they assume when they are restricted and lowered to the type of being proper of nature.

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[80] See Chapter 11, §2.4.

[81] For an exhaustive survey of the manuscripts, editions, translations, commentaries and studies on the *De Causis*, see D'Ancona-Taylor [2003].

2.5 *Al-Fārābī*

The *Fī Aġrāḍ* influenced Avicenna's account of the subject-matter and goal of the metaphysics in the Prolegomena of the *Ilāhiyyāt* in many respects. First, in this work al-Fārābī uses extensively the concept of "subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ*), with regard not only to metaphysics, but also to mathematics and other particular sciences.[82] Second, he ascribes the role of primary subject-matter of metaphysics to the "absolute existent" (i.e. "existent *qua* existent"), together with the "one".[83] Third, he refers to "existent" as a concept that, in itself, is more universal and higher than the natural existent (see above, §2.4, Text 12.2). Fourth, he contends that the goal of metaphysics is the theological investigation.[84] Fifth, he stresses that God is related to "existent" as its principle.[85] Thus, the main lines of Avicenna's discussion of the subject-matter and goal of metaphysics are already present in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*.

Avicenna's account, however, differs from al-Fārābī's in significant ways. First, Avicenna devotes to the issue of the subject-matter an independent treatment, distinct from, albeit related to, the treatment of the goal, whereas al-Fārābī addresses the former issue in the context of the latter (the only one that he formally takes into account in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*); thus Avicenna's discussion of the subject-matter is extensive and continuous, whereas al-Fārābī's discussion consists of brief and scattered statements.[86] Second, Avicenna proofs repeatedly that "existent *qua* existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics, whereas al-Fārābī simply states this point; in other words: Avicenna's method is probatory, whereas al-Fārābī's is assertive. Third, al-Fārābī uses a broad concept of "subject-matter" of a science, bearing the meaning of "topic"; accordingly, metaphysics has more than one subject-matter ("existent", "one", non-existence, multiplicity). Among the subject-matters of metaphysics "existent" is "primary", but the

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[82] See Chapter 3, Text 2 and n. 15.

[83] See Chapter 3, Text 2 [2.6a].

[84] See Chapter 3, Text 4. In pre-Farabian Arabic philosophy the idea that philosophical theology is the goal of the *Metaphysics* occurs in Ṯābit Ibn Qurra (see above, §2.3). The author of the *Theologia Aristotelis* mentions the "goals" (*aġrāḍ*) of the previous subjects dealt with (p. 6, 1–2; Lewis [1959], p. 487), among which he includes the *Metaphysics* (p. 5, 1–2, 12; Lewis [1959], p. 486–487), but does not specify what the goals of these subjects are.

[85] See Chapter 3, Text 3.

[86] See Chapter 3, Text 2.

rubric "primary subject-matter" does not include only "existent", but also the "one".[87] Avicenna, on the other hand, uses the concept of "subject-matter" in a strict, technical way: the subject-matter of metaphysics is only one, i.e. "existent",[88] and "one" represents one of the properties investigated by metaphysics about "existent" as subject-matter.[89] In other words, the distinction between subject-matter, on the one hand, and things searched, on the other, which is so sharp in Avicenna, is still vague in al-Fārābī. Fourth, Avicenna is much more explicit than al-Fārābī in contending that the theological investigation (the study of the ultimate causes and God) is the primary goal of the metaphysics, and, contrarily to al-Fārābī, does not take into account the goals of the single parts of this discipline or of the single books of the *Metaphysics*.

Conclusion

The question of the metaphysics' theme is raised and thoroughly discussed by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt* for the first time in the history of philosophy, as an ideal continuation of the *aporia* briefly and quite obscurely addressed by Aristotle in *Metaph.* E, 1, 1026a23–32. In *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1–2, Avicenna accomplishes a multiple harmonization. First, he succeeds in bringing to unity the different views on the topic of metaphysics advanced by Aristotle himself in the *Metaphysics* (metaphysics as a science dealing with the first causes and principles; with "being *qua* being"; with the separate, motionless and eternal things): for Avicenna, metaphysics is fundamentally an investigation of "existent *qua* existent"; this latter, however, considered in itself, is independent from matter and motion and implies the study of the first causes and principles as its ultimate *raisons d'être*. Second, Avicenna harmonizes the account of metaphysics emerging from the *Metaphysics* with the epistemology of the *Posterior Analytics*: "existent *qua* existent" is specified as the "subject-matter" of metaphysics, whereas the first

[87] See Chapter 3, Text 2, [2.6a].

[88] The mention of "existent" as the "first subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ awwal*) in I, 1, p. 9, 8 [p. 8, 52; see footnote] and in Text 3, does not entail the presence of a second subject-matter, since in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna does not apply the name of "subject-matter" to any other item. A broader and less rigorous concept of subject-matter occurs in *Burhān* II, 7, p. 166, 1.

[89] I, 2, pp. 12, 15–13, 7 [p. 12, 18–29].

causes and principles (and God as the Cause of causes and Principle of Principles) are among the "things searched" in this discipline: the distinction between "subject-matter" and "thing searched", absent in the *Metaphysics*, is taken, by Avicenna's own admission, from the *Posterior Analytics*. Third, Aristotle's perspective on the theme of metaphysics, both in the *Metaphysics* and the *Posterior Analytics*, is enriched with elements originally deriving from pseudo-Aristotelian Arabic reworking of Neoplatonic metaphysical works: both the idea of "existent" as an immaterial and motionless reality, and the doctrine of the causation of "existent" by the first causes and God, reveal the influence, for example, of the *Liber de Causis*. Finally, the Kindian "theological" view of metaphysics (reproducing the image of metaphysics conveyed by the classifications of the sciences of Late Antiquity) is harmonized with the Farabian "ontological" perspective (heir of the exegetical tradition of the *Metaphysics*) by means of the conceptual tools that al-Fārābī himself, and the tradition behind him, offer (Alexander's and Ammonius' notions of "being" as the subject-matter and theology as the "goal" of metaphysics): whereas "existent *qua* existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics, God and the ultimate causes are its "goal".

CHAPTER FIVE

AVICENNA'S REWORKING OF THE STRUCTURE OF THE *METAPHYSICS*: METAPHYSICS AS THE DISCIPLINE DEALING WITH THE SPECIES, THE PROPERTIES AND THE PRINCIPLES OF "EXISTENT"*

The structure of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* has always puzzled its interpreters. This work, as "edited" by Andronicus of Rhodes, is a collection of fourteen books, whose order and interconnection (and, in some cases, authenticity as well) is far from clear.

The sequence of books in Aristotle's *Metaphysics* can be outlined as follows:

> Outline 1: Structure of the *Metaphysics*
> (1) Book A: Metaphysics ("wisdom") as the science of the first causes and principles (A, 1–2); discussion of the predecessors' opinions on the four causes (A, 3–10).
> Book α: Metaphysics as the knowledge of the principles of eternal beings (α, 1); there is a first principle in each type of cause (α, 2); methodological remarks (α, 3).
> (3) Book B: Discussion of 15 metaphysical problems (aporias).
> (4) Book Γ: Metaphysics ("first philosophy") as the science of being *qua* being, its properties, causes and species (Γ, 1–2); defense of the axioms (principles of non-contradiction and excluded-middle) (Γ, 3–8).
> (5) Book Δ: Various meanings of 30 metaphysical terms.
> (6) Book E: Metaphysics ("first philosophy" and "theology") as the knowledge of what is eternal, motionless and separated [from matter] (E, 1); being *per accidens* (E, 2–3); being as true (E, 4).
> (7–8) Books Z-H: The main meaning of being: substance.
> (9) Book Θ: Potentiality and actuality.
> (10) Book I: Unity and multiplicity.
> (11) Book K: Summary of some of the previous books and of parts of the *Physics*.
> (12) Book Λ: Substance (Λ, 1–5); the motionless substance: God as Unmoved Mover and the other umoved movers (Λ, 6–10).
> (13–14) Books M-N: Criticism of the Platonic motionless substances (ideas, ideal numbers etc.).

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* This chapter is a revised version of Bertolacci [2002].

The very fact that the *Metaphysics* has two "first" books (A and α) is indicative of a certain disorder. Some books (B, Δ) break the continuity of the work, while others (K) are a reduplication of previous treatments. The doctrinal conclusion of the work, represented by the philosophical theology of book Λ, is followed by two further books (M-N), whose relation with Λ is not manifest. The occasional statements we find in the *Metaphysics*, aimed at connecting to one another some of its books, are in most cases later "editorial" interpolations. In addition, the names and descriptions of metaphysics that Aristotle uses change from book to book.

Among the Greek disciples and commentators of Aristotle—since the very first (Eudemus of Rhodes) until the very last (Ammonius and Asclepius)—the structure of the *Metaphysics* was regarded as an issue to be taken into proper account. In the Arabic tradition, the lack of order of Aristotle's works (*Metaphysics*, in all likelihood, included) is mentioned by al-Fārābī—who probably depends on an earlier source—in the context of the *topos* of Aristotle's intentional obscurity. The issue remains controversial even among contemporary Aristotelian scholars, who have proposed different interpretations of how the books of the *Metaphysics* relate to each other.[1]

Avicenna's attitude towards the structure of the *Metaphysics* is prefigured in the prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, where Avicenna compares this work with its sources. In the case of the *Ilāhiyyāt* the comparison is *in primis* with Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Avicenna says:

> Text 1: Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 9, 17–10, 7
>
> [a] There is nothing of account to be found in the books of the ancients which we did not include in this book of ours; *if it is not found in the place where it is customary to record it, then it will be found in another place which I thought more appropriate for it.* [. . .].
>
> [b] It is customary to prolong [the discussion on] the principles of logic with material that does not belong to logic but only to the discipline of wisdom (*al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya*) [i.e. metaphysics]—I mean the first philosophy (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*); therefore *I avoided mentioning any of that [in logic] and wasting thereby time, and deferred it to its [proper] place* (emphasis added).[2]

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[1] The structure of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* has been analyzed, among others, by Mansion [1958]; Patzig [1960–61]; Leszl [1975]; Kahn [1985]; Frede [1987], pp. 81–95; Berti [1994].

[2] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 51 (slightly modified); see also Gutas' remarks at pp. 110–112.

Even though [b] might be regarded as an example of [a], I take [a] and [b] as stating two distinct things. In [a] Avicenna stresses that the topics traditionally belonging *to each one* of the disciplines dealt with in the *Šifāʾ* (metaphysics included) are rearranged according to an innovative pattern. In [b], on the other hand, he shows that other structural changes are due to the transferral of some topics *from one discipline to another*: for instance, the discussion of the "principles of logic"[3] is moved from logic itself to metaphysics—named "discipline of wisdom" (*al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya*) and "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*).[4]

In the present chapter, I deal mainly with point [a], showing how the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is original with respect to Aristotle's *Metaphysics*.[5] Point [b], i.e. how this structural originality corresponds to a precise conception of metaphysics as *regina scientiarum*, will be properly investigated in Chapter 7.[6]

The aims of this chapter are mainly three: to give an account of the structure of metaphysics, as it is first outlined, then elucidated and finally concretely accomplished by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*; to show similarities and variations between the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* and in the other Avicennian works dealing with this

[3] By "principles of logic" Avicenna means some aspects of the doctrine of categories (Gutas [1988], p. 51 n. 3, pp. 265–267) and some aspects of the doctrine of universals (see Chapter 7).

[4] For the names of metaphysics in Avicenna's works, see Appendix D.

[5] Referring also to section [a] of Text 1, Marmura [1987], p. 73a, maintains that the "ingredients [of Avicenna's metaphysics] . . . are largely Aristotelian and Neoplatonic, but the final structure is other than the sum of its parts"; cp. Marmura [2005], p. xxii.

[6] Statement [a] does not regard only metaphysics. Avicenna points at the originality of his account of natural philosophy in another passage of the prologue of the *Šifāʾ*: "Logic is then followed by natural philosophy, but [here] I was mostly unsuccessful in pursuing a course parallel to the systematic treatise and the memoranda of the paradigmatic master in this discipline [i.e. Aristotle]" (p. 11, 3–4; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 53, slightly modified). Somehow surprisingly, in the prologue of the *Samāʾ*, Avicenna maintains that "[t]he arrangement (*al-tartīb*) on this occasion will correspond to that followed in Peripatetic philosophy" (Avicenna [1983], p. 3, 5–6 [p. 1, 6–7]; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 295). The structural differences of *Samāʿ* with regard to Aristotle's *Physics* are described in Hasnawi [1991], pp. 230–231; Hasnawi [2000], pp. 510–511; Hasnawi [2002], pp. 67–80. The *Ilāhiyyāt*, however, displays a recasting of the structure of the work to which it corresponds (the *Metaphysics*) that, as far as I can see, is unparalleled in the other parts of the *Šifāʾ*.

discipline; to clarify how the way of conceiving the structure of metaphysics evolved from Aristotle to Avicenna. Sections 1, 3 and 4, of the present chapter describe the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, on the bais of all the available pieces of evidence, namely the outline of the structure of metaphysics in chapter I, 2 (§1), the programmatic description of the work itself in chapter I, 4 (§3), and the very structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (§4); these three types of evidence do not completely overlap and are complementary to each other. Sections 2 and 5 are devoted to comparing the outline (§2) and the concrete structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (§5) with similar pieces of evidence in other Avicennian works. The final section (§6) takes into account Avicenna's sources and his originality on the issue of the structure of metaphysics.

Previous scholarship has already shown that the structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is the result of the different stages of the investigation of "existent" pursued in metaphysics.[7] The present chapter articulates

[7] The best treatments of this topic in recent scholarship are Gutas [1988], pp. 238–261, and Hasnaw [1991], pp. 237–239. Gutas detects a common pattern in Avicenna's metaphysical *œuvre* (p. 253), which he applies to some Avicennian works (see pp. 18–19, 90, 253–254). This pattern is given by a main division of metaphysics into two parts (which he calls "Universal science", and "Theology" respectively, adopting Avicenna's terminology in the *Mašriqiyyūn*), each of which is further subdivided into two sub-sections: thus, Universal science consists of the study of "being" as such and its consequent properties (a part of metaphysics that Gutas calls "Being as such"), and the study of the principles of the other sciences, or "First Philosophy"; Theology, on the other hand, encompasses "Natural Theology" and the so-called "Metaphysics of the Rational Soul" (destiny of human souls after death and prophecy). The present investigation differs from Gutas's in two respects. First, the main parts of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are apparently three: (i) the study of the species of "existent", or OntologyS (= Gutas' "Being as such"); (ii) the study of the properties of "existent", or OntologyP (= Gutas' "First Philosophy"); (iii) the study of the first cause(s) of "existent", or OntologyC/Theology (= Gutas' "Theology"). The investigation of the destiny of human souls after death and of the prophet's function (= Gutas' "Metaphysics of the Rational Soul") is not an additional part of metaphysics; Eschatology and Prophetology are, rather, two of the six sub-divisions of OntologyC/Theology (see §§1, 4). Second, metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is constituted, besides Ontology, by a second main axis, given by the analysis of the species and properties of "one" and "many", or Henology (cf. §§3–4). As to Hasnawi, my analysis differs from his since he regards OntologyS and OntologyP as two portions of the same part of metaphysics (what he calls "la partie qui traite des concomitants de l'étant"), and does not take Henology into account. In the section of Hein [1985] devoted to the divisions of the *Metaphysics* (pp. 306–313), Avicenna is taken into account only incidentally (pp. 312, 315–316). According to Lizzini [2002], pp. xl–xli, the *Ilāhiyyāt* consists of an ontological part (I–V) and a theological part (VI–X).

more precisely the topics of the doctrine of "existent" that determine the structure of metaphysics; shows that, besides the doctrine of "existent", also the doctrine of "one" and "many" is relevant for the structure of this discipline; describes more comprehensively the Aristotelian background of the structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Aristotle, Alexander of Aphrodisias, al-Fārābī).

1 Outline of the structure of metaphysics: Ontology (first causes, properties and species of "existent")

In the prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, Avicenna maintains that the *Ilāhiyyāt* consists of some "divisions" or "parts" (*aqsām*).[8] A text occurring towards the end of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, after the discussion of "existent" (*mawǧūd*) as the subject-matter of metaphysics, clarifies the identity of these parts.

Text 2: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 14, 14–15, 8 [pp. 14, 68–15, 88]

It is requisite for this discipline to be necessarily divided into some parts.

[1* OntologyC/Theology] One of them is that [part] investigating [1.1*] the ultimate causes (*al-asbāb al-quṣwā*), since they are the causes of every caused existent with regard to its existence, and [1.2*] the First Cause (*al-sabab al-awwal*) from which emanates every caused existent *qua* caused existent—not *qua* existent in motion only or possessed of quantity only.

[2* OntologyP] Another is that [part] investigating the accidents (*ʿawāriḍ*) of "existent".

[3* OntologyS] Another is that [part] investigating the principles of the particular sciences. Since the principles of each science [that is] more specific are questions [discussed] in the science [that is] more general,[9] as the principles of medicine in natural [science] and [the principles] of geodesy[10] in geometry, it occurs therefore that the principles of the particular sciences—which investigate the states of the

[8] "Finally, I concluded the book with the science related to the *Metaphysics* in accordance with its parts (*aqsām*) and aspects" (p. 11, 12; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 54, slightly modified).

[9] Reading *al-aʿamm* instead of *al-aʿlā* (see Appendix A).

[10] The Arabic terms *misāḥī* is rendered as "mensuratio" in the Latin translation (Avicenna Latinus [1977], p. 15, 76); "Planimetrie" by Horten [1907], p. 23; "mensuration" by Anawati [1978], p. 94; "[scienza] delle superfici" by Lizzini [2002], p. 41; "surveying" by Marmura [2005], p. 11. The same term occurs in *Aqsām*, p. 89, 11.

> particular [aspects] of "existent"[11]—become clear in this science. Thus this science investigates the states (*aḥwāl*) of "existent" and the things that are like its divisions (*aqsām*) and species (*anwāʿ*) until it reaches [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter (*mawḍūʿ*) of natural science comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to natural science]—and [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter (*mawḍūʿ*) of mathematics comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to mathematics]—and similarly in the other cases. Of what precedes that specification and is as its principle,[12] on the contrary, [this science] investigates and determines the state (*ḥāl*).
>
> Therefore [some] questions (*masāʾil*) of this science[13] regard the causes of the caused existent *qua* caused existent [= OntologyC/Theology], some other the accidents of "existent" [= OntologyP], some other the principles of the particular sciences [= OntologyS].

In Text 2, Avicenna envisages a three-fold division of metaphysics ("this discipline"), in connection with the status of "existent" as its subject-matter. The first part of metaphysics ([1*]) investigates the causes of "caused existent" (*mawǧūd maʿlūl*),[14] both the "ultimate causes" (*al-asbāb al-quṣwā*, [1.1*]) and the "First Cause" (*al-sabab al-awwal*, [1.2*]); the "ultimate causes" are apparently the four Aristotelian causes (matter, form, moving/efficient cause, final cause), whereas the "First Cause" is clearly God (see below, Table 1). The second part ([2*]) takes into account the "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*) of "existent", namely its "proper accidents" or properties (see below, Table 1).[15] The third part [3*], finally, deals with the principles of the particular sciences. Its connection with "existent" is less obvious than in the previous two cases. In the course of [3*], however, it becomes clear that the principles of the particular sciences regard their subject-

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[11] Reading *ǧuzʾiyyāt al-mawǧūd* instead of *al-ǧuzʾiyyāt al-mawǧūda* (see Appendix A).

[12] Reading *wa-ka-l-mabdaʾ lahū* instead of *ka-l-mabdaʾ* (see Appendix A).

[13] Reading *hāḏā l-ʿilm baʿḍuhā* instead of *hāḏā l-ʿilm* (see Appendix A).

[14] "Existent" in this case is specified as "caused" in order to avoid the objection that, if "existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics, metaphysics itself cannot take into account the causes of "existent", since no discipline takes into account the causes of its own subject-matter. Avicenna faces this objection in I, 2, p. 14, 1–13 [pp. 13, 47–14, 67], immediately before Text 2 (see Chapter 4, §1.2, Outline 2 [1.3]; Chapter 6, §3.3, Table 8). Part [1*] of Text 2.2 has been discussed in Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 5.2.

[15] On the meaning of "accident" as an epistemological concept in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see Appendix F, II.

matters, and that these latter are the result of the further particularization of the "divisions" (*aqsām*) and "species" (*anwāʿ*)—also named, broadly speaking, "states" (*aḥwāl*)[16]—of "existent", in a sort of Porphyrian tree going from the more universal to the more particular. The principles of the particular sciences, therefore, are the "divisions" and "species" of "existent".[17] Of these two synonymical terms, "species" is the salient one (see below, Table 1).

These three parts of metaphysics focus on different aspects of "existent"; each of them represents, therefore, an instance of what we can call "Ontology". For the sake of brevity, I call them, respectively, "OntologyC(auses)", "OntologyP(roperties)", and "OntologyS(pecies)". Since it deals with God, OntologyC can also be called "Theology". As the fact of occurring at the very beginning of the *Ilāhiyyāt* witnesses, the articulation of Ontology constitutes, according to Avicena, the main axis of metaphysics.[18]

The tripartition of metaphysics witnessed by Text 2 (OntologyC/Theology, OntologyP, OntologyS) does not reflect the order of human knowledge; it rather corresponds to the degree of importance of the things investigated in these three parts. For Avicenna OntologyC/Theology is surely the most important part of metaphysics.[19]

The exact nature and identity of the items mentioned in Text 2 (causes, properties and species of "existent) is clarified by what Avicenna says in chapter I, 1 and in three passages of chapter I, 2. Text 2 is compared with all these texts in the following table.

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[16] The "states" of "existent", mentioned in [3*] together with its "divisions" and "species", are broader than these latter and refer to all the relevant attributes of "existent", i.e. not only its "divisions" and "species", but also its "accidents" (mentioned in [2*]); see the occurrence of the term "states" in this broad meaning in the sentence immediately preceding. On Avicenna's use of *aḥwāl* and related terms as epistemological concepts in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see Appendix F, III.

[17] See the detailed discussion of [3*] in Chapter 7, §1, Text 2.

[18] In its full extent or on a reduced scale, Ontology is always part of Avicenna's works on metaphysics (see below, §§2–5).

[19] He emphasizes its relevance in other passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, as in I, 1, p. 9, 10 [p. 9, 54], where the ultimate causes are named the "perfection" (*kamāl*) of metaphysics, and in I, 3, p. 23, 3–8 [p. 26, 80–86], where the knowledge of God is called "end" (*ġāya*), "perfection" (*kamāl*), "the noblest part" (*ašraf aǧzā'ihī*) and "first aim" (*maqṣūd*) of this discipline. See Chapter 4, §1.3.

Table 1

Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, pp. 5, 1–9, 10	*Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 10, 5–13, 9	*Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 13, 12–19	*Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 14, 1–13	*Ilāhiyyāt* Text 2
				1* OntologyC/ Theology
four causes = ultimate causes				ultimate causes
God = First Cause				First Cause
		the things that are consequent to it (*al-umūr allatī talḥaquhū*) insofar as it is existent without condition:		
				2* OntologyP
	[ii] proper accidents or accidents of "existent":	[ii] proper accidents of "existent":	accidents, things that occur or proper accidents of "existent"	accidents of "existent":
	one *qua* one and many *qua* many	one and many		
	coincident and different			
	contrary			
		potentiality and actuality		
		universal and particular		
		possible and necessary		
			principle	
				3* OntologyS
				principles of the particular sciences

Table 1 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, pp. 5, 1–9, 10	*Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 10, 5–13, 9	*Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 13, 12–19	*Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 14, 1–13	*Ilāhiyyāt* Text 2
	subject-matters of natural philosophy, mathematics and logic			= subject-matters of natural philosophy, mathematics etc.
	[i] (states and accidents of "existent"):	[i] species:		(states), divisions and species of "existent"
	substances, quantities and other categories	substance, quantity and quality		

As we have seen in Chapter 4, chapters I, 1–2 of the *Ilāhiyyāt* are mainly devoted to the question of what the "subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ*) of metaphysics is. In the second half of chapter I, 1, where Avicenna negatively proves that neither God nor the four Aristotelian causes are the subject-matter of metaphysics (I, 1, pp. 5, 1–9, 10 [pp. 3, 35–9, 55]), God is also named "First Cause" (*al-ʿilla al-ūlā*),[20] whereas the four causes are called "ultimate causes" (*al-asbāb al-quṣwā*).[21] The ultimate causes and the First Cause mentioned in Text 2 [1*] are, therefore, respectively the four Aristotelian causes and God.

The first two proofs by means of which Avicenna positively argues in chapter I, 2 that the subject-matter of metaphysics is "existent *qua* existent" (I, 2, pp. 10, 5–13, 9 [pp. 9, 59–12, 31]) are of particular interest here. In the first proof, the subject-matters of natural philosophy, mathematics and logic, investigated by metaphysics as existents, are called—in a loose sense—"states" (*ḥālāt*) and "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*) of "existent",[22] and identified with the categories,

[20] I, 1, p. 5, 5–6 [p. 3, 42]. Cp. the denomination "First Principle" (*al-mabdaʾ al-awwal*), in I, 1, p. 7, 5 [p. 5, 94].

[21] I, 1, p. 7, 8 [p. 6, 99–00], p. 9, 6 [p. 8, 49], p. 9, 9–10 [p. 9, 54]; cp. I, 2, p. 15, 13 [p. 16, 94].

[22] See Appendix F, II–III. In I, 8, p. 54, 6–15 [pp. 63, 00–64, 14], Avicenna explains that the subject-matters of the other disciplines, in so far as they are "states occurring to 'existent'" (*aḥwāl taʿriḍu li-l-mawǧūd*) and "divisions" (*aqsām*) of it, are "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*) in metaphysics; thus, a specific substance that is the subject-

among which substance and quantity are expressly mentioned.[23] The reference to the subject-matters of the particular sciences indicates that this investigation corresponds to part [3*] of Text 2: the "divisions" and "species" of "existent" in Text 2 [3*] are therefore the categories. In the second proof, the notions that, according to Avicenna, are common to all the sciences—"one *qua* one", "many *qua* many", "coincident" (*muwāfiq*),[24] "different" (*muḫālif*), "contrary" (*didd*) and so on—are called "proper accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ ḫāṣṣa*),[25] that is properties, or simply "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*)[26] of "existent *qua* existent". They cannot but represent the "accidents" mentioned in Text 2 [2*].

In the conclusion of the three proofs (I, 2, p. 13, 12–19 [p. 13, 36–46]), Avicenna says that substance, quantity and quality are "like the species" (*ka-l-anwāʿ*) of "existent *qua* existent".[27] In this context, Avicenna uses four times the verb "to be divided" (*inqasama*) to clarify the division of "existent" into the categories, and the division of substance into "man" and "non-man".[28] This further confirms that the categories are the "divisions" and "species" of "existent" mentioned in Text 2 [3*]. In the list of the "proper accidents" of "existent *qua* existent", besides "one" and "many", Avicenna includes now also "potentiality", "actuality", "universal", "particular", "possible" and "necessary".[29]

Finally, in the answer to the objection moved against "existent" as the subject-matter of metaphysics (I, 2, p. 14, 1–13 [pp. 13, 47–14, 67]), Avicenna maintains that "principle" (*mabdaʾ*) is one of the "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*) of "existent",[30] a "thing that occurs" (*amr ʿāriḍ*) to

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matter of another discipline is, at the same time, "division" (*qism*) of the metaphysics' subject-matter and "accident" (*ʿāriḍ*) "in a certain way" (*bi-naḥwin mā*) of it.

[23] I, 2, p. 12, 11–14 [p. 12, 11–18].

[24] I, 2, p. 13, 1 [p. 12, 21]. The term *muwāfaqa* ("coincidence") occurs also in al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* (see below, Text 20.3 [3]).

[25] I, 2, p. 13, 3 [p. 12, 24]. Also in I, 5, p. 35, 1 [p. 40, 51], the "accidents that are proper to it [i.e. to 'existent']" (*ʿawāriḍ taḫuṣṣuhū*) are distinguished from the categories.

[26] I, 2, p. 13, 7 [p. 12, 29].

[27] I, 2, p. 13, 14 [p. 13, 38–39]. The presence of "like" is due to the fact that "existent" is not a genus, and hence the categories, properly speaking, are not its species.

[28] I, 2, p. 13, 14–16 [p. 13, 38–41].

[29] I, 2, p. 13, 16–18 [p. 13, 42–44]. Both the categories and these concepts are named "things that are consequent to it (*talḥaquhū*) insofar as it is existent without condition". For the term *lawāḥiq* and expressions including the verb *laḥiqa* in the context of epistemology in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see Appendix F, IV.

[30] I, 2, p. 14, 4 [p. 13, 51].

it,[31] and one of the "proper accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ ḫāṣṣa*) of "existent".[32] This corroborates the identity between "accidents" and "proper accidents" in Text 2 [2*], and allows the inclusion of "principle" in the list of the properties of "existent".

In these three passages of chapter I, 2, from the point of view of terminology, the "accidents" of "existent" in Text 2 [2*] are more precisely defined as "proper accidents" or properties, and the principles of the particular sciences (namely their subject-matters *qua* existents), which are also called "divisions" of "existent" in Text 2 [3*], are finally declared to be essentially the "species" of "existent".[33] From the point of view of doctrine, the properties of "existent" are identified with a series of concepts ("one", "many", "coincident", "different", "contrary", "potentiality", "actuality", "universal", "particular", "possible" and "necessary", "principle"), and the "species" of "existent" are said to be the categories.

To sum up: In the course of chapters I, 1–2 Avicenna takes into account, from different perspectives, four topics: (i) God as the First Cause; (ii) the four Aristotelian causes as the ultimate causes; (iii) the categories as the species of "existent"; (iv) a group of concepts regarded as properties of "existent". He calls all these topics "things searched" (*maṭālib*) in metaphysics.[34] These four *maṭālib*, in a different order—(i) and (ii) together, (iv), (iii)—are nothing else than the three questions (*masāʾil*) that Avicenna mentions in the closing sentence of Text 2.

2 Outlines of metaphysics in other Avicennian works

Text 2 and its afferents, as described in Table 1, can be compared, outside the *Ilāhiyyāt*, with two other Avicennian texts having the same

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[31] I, 2, p. 14, 5 [p. 14, 54].

[32] I, 2, p. 14, 5–6 [p. 14, 54].

[33] A passage of *Naǧāt* I, 4 (p. 495, 6–11; Avicenna [1938], p. 199, 10–14) clarifies that the process of "division" (*inqisām*) of "existent" into the categories (i.e. its "species") by means of the specific differences (*fuṣūl*) is only one of two types of division: the other is the division of "existent" into its "accidental sections" (*fuṣūl ʿaraḍiyya*) or "types" (*aṣnāf*) by means of its "(proper) accidents" (at the end of *Naǧāt* I, 3, the second type of division is said to produce the "difference of the states", *iḫtilāf ḥālāt*; p. 495, 3–4; Avicenna [1938], p. 199, 6–8). For "active" and "passive" (two proper accidents) as "divisions" of "existent", see below, n. 65.

[34] For God and the four causes as "thing searched" (*maṭlūb*), see Chapter 4, §1.2, n. 24. The species and properties of "existent" are called "things searched" (*maṭālib*) in I, 2, p. 13, 13 [p. 13, 38] (see Chapter 4, §1.2, n. 22).

character of outlines of metaphysics: the section on metaphysical knowledge in the eighth chapter of the *Maqāla fī l-Nafs ʿalā sunnat al-iḫtiṣār* (*Compendium on the Soul*), the earliest philosophical treatise by Avicenna;[35] and the section on the fundamental (as opposed to the derivative) divisions of metaphysics in the *Risāla fī Aqsām al-ʿulūm al-ʿaqliyya* (*Treatise on the Division of the Intellectual Sciences*), a writing specifically devoted to the classification of the sciences.[36]

Table 2

Ilāhiyyāt, Text 2 and afferents	*Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār*, chpt. 8, metaphysical knowledge	*Aqsām*, fundamental divisions of metaphysics
		[1] concepts (*maʿānī*) that are common to all existents:
		[1.1] "existent" (*huwiyya*)
[1* OntologyC/ Theology] causes of "caused existent"	[1.1 OntologyC/ Theology] principles of absolute "existent *qua* existent"	
[2*–3* OntologyP-S] the things that are consequent to it (*al-umūr allatī talḥaquhū = lawāḥiq*) insofar as it is existent without condition:	[1.2] its attributes (*lawāḥiq*):	
[2* OntologyP] proper accidents of "existent":	[OntologyP]:	[OntologyP]:
one *qua* one and many *qua* many	[1.2.7] unity and multiplicity	[1.2] unity and multiplicity
coincident (*muwāfiq*) and different (*muḫālif*)	[1.2.6] coincidence (*ittifāq*) and difference (*iḫtilāf*)	[1.3] coincidence (*wifāq*) and difference (*ḫilāf*)
contrary (*ḍidd*)	[1.2.5] contrariety (*muḍādda*) and homogeneity (*muǧānasa*)	[1.4] contrariety (*taḍādd*)
potentiality and actuality	[1.2.1] potentiality and actuality	[1.5] potentiality and actuality
universal and particular	[1.2.4] genus and species	

[35] Avicenna [1875], pp. 361–365. See Appendix C, Work 1.
[36] Avicenna [1986], pp. 89, 17–92, 6. See Appendix C, Work 4.

Table 2 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt, Text 2 and afferents	*Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār*, chpt. 8, metaphysical knowledge	*Aqsām*, fundamental divisions of metaphysics
possible and necessary		
principle	[1.2.2] principle and cause	[1.6] cause and effect
	[1.2.3] substance and accident	
[3* OntologyS] principles of the particular sciences (natural philosophy, mathematics etc.)	[2 OntologyS] first principles of the theoretical sciences (mathematics, natural philosophy and logic)	[2.1 OntologyS] fundaments and principles of[37] natural philosophy, mathematics and logic
= species of "existent":		
substance, quantity, quality, other categories		
		[2.2] refutation of the false opinions held in these sciences
	[3]–[4] OntologyC/ Theology	[3]–[5] OntologyC/ Theology

The *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār* presents a fourfold division of metaphysics, whereas the division in the *Aqsām* is fivefold. In both writings, OntologyC/Theology is the most extensive section of metaphysics and comes at the end. In the *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār* it occupies the last two parts of metaphysics ([3]–[4]), in the *Aqsām* the last three ([3]–[5]). In both writings the preceding two parts of metaphysics roughly correspond to OntologyP and OntologyS.

In general, the structure of metaphysics in this two works is less rigorous than in Text 2 and afferents. In *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār*, OntologyC/Theology is split into two units: it occurs not only at the end of metaphysics, but also at its beginning ([1.1]), followed by OntologyP ([1.2]). Furthermore, in *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār* the distinction between OntologyP ([1.2]) and OntologyS ([2]) is blurred:

[37] Reading *min* ("of") instead of *miṯl* ("as"); this latter reading occurs in Avicenna [1986], p. 21, and is retained by Anawati [1977], p. 331 ("comme la science des naturalistes") and Michot [1980], p. 68 ("comme la science des physiciens").

substance and accident ([1.2.3]), a sub-division of OntologyP—which does not encompass "necessary" and "possible"—can be regarded as belonging to OntologyS as well. Accordingly, in [1.2] both the properties of "existent" and its species (substance and accidents) are subsumed under the common heading of "attributes" (*lawāḥiq*) of "existent".[38]

In the *Aqsām* a further distinction fades: that between "existent" itself and its properties. Thus, some of the items of OntologyP—with the exclusion of "universal" and "particular", "necessary" and "possible"—are mentioned in the first part of metaphysics ([1.2–6]), together with "being" (*huwiyya*), i.e. "existent", itself [1.1].[39] All these notions are named "concepts that are common to all existents" (*al-maʿānī al-ʿāmma li-ǧamīʿ al-mawǧūdāt*).

To summarize: the originality of Text 2 and afferents, with respect to *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār* and *Aqsām*, lies essentially in the distinctions it introduces: that between OntologyP and OntologyS, on the one hand, and OntologyC/Theology, on the other (less clear-cut in *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār*); that between OntologyP and OntologyS (fluid in *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār*); and that between subject-matter and things searched by metaphysics (neglected in *Aqsām*).

3 Description of the structure of metaphysics: Henology ("one", "many" and their properties) as an additional part

A passage of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 4 provides further information about Avicenna's conception of the structure of metaphysics:[40] this latter is still articulated in three parts, as in Text 2, but the three parts are now

[38] This expression is probably equivalent to "things which are consequent to it (i.e. to "existent") insofar as it is existent without condition" (*al-umūr allatī talḥaquhū bi-mā huwa mawǧūd min ġayr šarṭ*), that we find in one of the afferents of Text 2 as a common rubric for OntologyP and OntologyS (see above, Table 1).

[39] For a discussion of *huwiyya* ("being") as a synonymous of *mawǧūd* ("existent") in the *Ilāhiyyāt* and in other Avicennian works, see Bertolacci [2003].

[40] Chapter I, 4 of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is entirely devoted to describing the contents of this work: its presence—a unique case in the Avicennian writings—is due to the influence of the Neoplatonic introductions to Aristotle's writings (see §4.2). Chapter I, 4, however, is not the mirror image of the *Ilāhiyyāt* as this latter actually is: I, 6 ("necessity" and "possibility"), for example, is mentioned in connection with IV, 2 ("potency" and "act", p. 25, 5–6 [pp. 27, 17–28, 20]); I, 8 is mentioned within the description of II, 1 (p. 25, 6–7 [p. 28, 20–22]); chapters V, 7–9 are mentioned

different. After mentioning the investigation of the categories, both substance and accidents,[41] and of some of the properties of "existent" encountered in Text 2, such as "necessity" and "possibility",[42] "potency" and "act",[43] "universal" and "particular",[44] and "cause",[45] Avicenna says:

> Text 3: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 4, pp. 26, 17–27, 9 [pp. 29, 57–30, 76]
>
> [1** = OntologyS-P] These [i.e. substance and accidents, necessity and possibility etc.] and similar things are attributes (*lawāḥiq*) of existence *qua* existence.
>
> [2** = Henology] [2.1**] Since "one" accompanies existence, it is incumbent upon us to investigate "one" as well; and once we investigate "one", we have to investigate "many" and to make known the opposite correspondence between the two.
>
> [2.2**] [2.2.1**] At this point it is necessary to investigate number: what is its relation to the existents, and what is the relation of continuous quantity—which is somehow in opposite correspondence to it [i.e. to number]—to the existents. [2.2.2**] We will enumerate all the false opinions regarding it [i.e. number], and we will make known that nothing of that [i.e. of number] is separate or a principle of the existents. [2.2.3**] We will prove the existence of the accidents that occur to numbers and to continuous quantities, such as figures and so on.
>
> [2.3** = HenologyP] Among the things that follow (*tawābiʿ*) "one" are: "like", "equal", "coincident" (*muwāfiq*), "homogeneous" (*muǧānis*), "conformable", "similar" and "same". It is necessary to speak of each one of them and of the things that are in opposite correspondence to them, and [to say] that they [i.e. these things] are related to multiplicity, as "unlike", "unequal", "non-homogeneous", "non-conformable", and "other" in general; "difference" (*ḫilāf*), "opposition" and their types; true "contrariety" (*taḍādd*) and its quiddity.
>
> [3** = OntologyC/Theology] Then, after that, we will pass to the principles of the existents.

Compared with Text 2, Text 3 shows three main differences. First, the treatment of the species and properties of "existent" ([1**]) is reduced to a single unit (I call OntologyS-P this aggregate of OntologyS and OntologyP). Thus, the tripartition of Ontology in Text 2

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immediately after the description of chapter II, 4 (p. 25, 12–13 [p. 28, 29–31]); only the first chapter of treatise VII is described (p. 27, 4–8 [p. 30, 69–74]), and so on.

[41] I, 4, pp. 25, 7–26, 2 [pp. 28, 22–29, 39].
[42] I, 4, p. 25, 5–6 [pp. 27, 17–28, 19].
[43] I, 4, p. 25, 6 [p. 28, 19–20].
[44] I, 4, p. 26, 3–6 [p. 29, 39–44].
[45] I, 4, p. 26, 6–11 [p. 29, 45–51].

(OntologyC/Theology, OntologyP, OntologyS) is reduced in Text 3 to a bipartition (OntologyS-P, OntologyC/Theology).[46] This simplification makes evident that Avicenna's discourse in Text 3 does not focus on the treatment of "existent".

Second and most important, OntologyS-P does not include a treatment of "one" and "many": this latter, together with the treatment of a group of related topics, figures as an independent structural unit ([2**]). Whereas in Text 2 and afferents "one" and "many" are recorded among the properties of "existent", and represent therefore an element of OntologyP, in Text 3 they constitute a part of metaphysics on their own. Even though "one" is still subordinated to "existent" from the logical point of view (it "accompanies" the "existent"),[47] from the structural point of view, together with "many", "number" etc., it represents an additional part of metaphysics, coming after OntologyS-P ([1**]) and before OntologyC/Theology ([3**]). Part [2**] of Text 3 can be called "Henology".

Third, in Text 3 OntologyC/Theology ([3**]) follows, instead of preceding, OntologyS-P. In this respect the order of the parts of metaphysics in Text 3 is opposite to that in Text 2.

Henology in Text 3 has an inner structure. "One" and "many" in [2.3**] are said to have some "things that follow" (*tawābiʿ*) them. Some of the items of OntologyP in Tables 1–2—namely "coincident" (*muwāfiq*), "homogeneity" (*muǧānasa*), "difference" (*ḫilāf*), and "contrariety" (*taḍādd*)—are presented in Text 3 as belonging to Henology: they are "things that follow" either "one"—as in the case of "coincident" and "homogeneous" (*muǧānis*)—or "many"—as in the case

[46] The topic of OntologyS-P in Text 3 are the "attributes" (*lawāḥiq*) of "existence". This term is here, in all likelihood, a common rubric for both properties and species, as in I, 2, p. 13, 12–10 (see above, §1, Table 1) and *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār* (see above, §2, Table 2).

[47] Although *musāwiq* ("accompanies") in [2.1**] might be the corruption of *musāwin* ("equivalent")—a term occurring, in a similar context, in al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* (see below, Text 20.3 [2])—and although "one" is treated as equivalent to "existent" in universality both in other passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, and elsewhere in the *Šifāʾ*—see I, 2, p. 15, 9–11 [pp. 15, 89–16, 91]; I, 5, p. 30, 3–4 (see Appendix A) [p. 33, 25–27]; III, 1, p. 95, 16–17 [p. 107, 67–68]; III, 2, p. 103, 7–9 [p. 114, 17–20]; V, 8, p. 243, 5–6 [p. 272, 18–19]; VII, 1, p. 303, 6–12 [p. 349, 9–18]; cp. VII, 2, p. 313, 6–7 [p. 362, 72–73]; *Burhān* II, 7, p. 162, 13; p. 165, 3; p. 166, 1—only "existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics, according to Avicenna (see Chapter 4, §2.5, n. 88): accordingly, all the other concepts taken into account by metaphysics are subordinated, as properties or otherwise, to "existent".

of "difference" and "contrariety". Text 3 suggests that these items are properties of "existent" indirectly, in so far as they are properties of "one" and "many", which, in their turn, depend on "existent". Subdivision [2.3**] can be called, therefore, "HenologyP".

The emergence of Henology among the parts of metaphysics in Text 3 enriches of a new element the threefold structure of this discipline displayed in Text 2. The presence of a treatment of "one", besides the treatment of "existent", within metaphysics as witnessed by Text 3 is highly significant.[48]

4 The actual structure of metaphysics: the notions of "subject-matter", "species", "properties" and "causes" applied to Ontology and Henology

4.1 *An Overview*

Since the *Ilāhiyyāt* is Avicenna's fullest account of metaphysics, the arrangement of the *Ilāhiyyāt* itself is our main evidence about Avicenna's view of the structure of this discipline. As Table 3 shows, the articulation of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is quite complex: it encompasses all the structural elements emerging from Text 2 and Text 3, plus some others.

Table 3: Overall structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt*

	ONTOLOGY	HENOLOGY
SUBJECT–	[1.1] **Prolegomena** I, 1–4	
	I, 1–2: subject-matter and goal of metaphysics: "existent" and its properties and species	I, 2: "one" and "many" as properties of "existent"
	I, 3: utility, rank and name of metaphysics	
	I, 4: topics dealt with in metaphysics	I, 4: "one", "many" and their properties
	[1.2] **Introduction** I, 5–8	

[48] In *Burhān* II, 7, p. 166, 1–2, Avicenna remarks that "first philosophy" takes into account the properties ("essential accidents") and the principles of both "existent" and "one".

Table 3 (*cont.*)

	ONTOLOGY	HENOLOGY
MATTER	I, 5: primary concepts: "existent" ("non-existent"), "thing", "necessary" ("possible", "impossible")	I, 5: primary concepts: "one"
	I, 6–7: Necessary Existent, possible existent	I, 6–7: unicity of the Necessary Existent
	I, 8: different types of truth; the primary logical principle (principle of the excluded-middle)	
	[2.1] **OntologyS** II–III, 1; III, 3–5; III, 7–10	[2.2] **HenologyS**: III, 2–6; III, 9
	II: substance	
	III: accidents	
	III, 1: introduction	
SPECIES		III, 2 species of "one": "one" by accident and "one" by essence (by genus, by species = by differentia, by relation, by subject, by number)
	III, 3–5: quantity	III, 3–5: quantity
	III, 3: accidentality of number	III, 3: accidentality of number
	III, 4: accidentality of continuous quantity	III, 4: accidentality of continuous quantity
	III, 5: nature, species and principles of number	III, 5: nature, species and principles of number
		III, 5 (end): species of "many": absolute and relative multiplicity
		III, 6: opposition "one"-"many"
	III, 7–8: quality	
	III, 9: qualities which are in quantities	III, 9: qualities which are in quantities
	III, 10: relation	
PROPERTIES	[3.1] **OntologyP** (IV–VI)	
	IV: prior and posterior, potency and act, perfect and imperfect, whole and part	
	V: universal and particular	
	VI: cause and effect	
		[3.2] **HenologyP** (VII, 1–3)

Table 3 (*cont.*)

	ONTOLOGY	HENOLOGY
		VII, 1: properties of "one": sameness by accident (similarity, equality, comparability), sameness by essence (in genus, species and properties); properties of "many": otherness, alterity, difference, privation and contrariety
		VII, 2: exposition of the views of Plato and the Phytagoreans
		VII, 3: criticism
	[4] **OntologyC/Theology** (VIII, 1–X, 3)	
	[4.1] VIII, 1–3: the First Principle's existence	
C A U S E S	[4.2] VIII, 4: the First Principle's nature	
		[4.2] VIII, 5: unicity of the First Principle
	[4.2] VIII, 6–7: the First Principle's nature	
	[4.3] IX, 1–5: Cosmology	
	[4.4] IX, 6: Theodicy	
	[4.5] IX, 7: Eschatology	
	[4.6] X, 1–3: Prophetology	
	Appendix: Practical Philosophy (X, 4–5)	
	X, 4: politics, economics (= household management)	
	X, 5: politics, ethics	

The *Ilāhiyyāt* consists of four main parts, the first three of which can be further split into two subdivisions. Thus, the *Ilāhiyyāt* embraces cumulatively seven units.

The first part of the *Ilāhiyyāt* corresponds to the first treatise, and includes the Prolegomena ([1.1] = I, 1–4) and the Introduction ([1.2] = I, 5–8). The second part ranges over treatises II and III and embraces OntologyS ([2.1] = II–III, 1; III, 3–5; III, 7–10) and

HenologyS ([2.2] = III, 2–6; III, 9). The third part encompasses treatises IV–VII and is represented by OntologyP ([3.1] = IV–VI) and HenologyP ([3.2] = VII). The fourth part, finally, is contained in the last three treatises (with the exception of chapters X, 4–5, which are an appendix dealing with practical philosophy)[49] and corresponds to OntologyC/Theology ([4] = VIII–X, 3).

The structure of metaphysics can be observed both in a "horizontal" and in a "vertical" perspective. Horizontally, the aforementioned four parts correspond to the four main areas that every scientific discipline takes into account: the subject-matter, the species and the properties of the subject-matter, and—since every true knowledge is a knowledge of causes—the causes of the subject-matter. In a vertical perspective, the *Ilāhiyyāt* is organized along two main axes, given by the doctrine of "existent", or Ontology, and the doctrine of "one" and "many", or Henology. Ontology is certainly the main axis of metaphysics, being present in all the four main parts of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[50] In comparison with Ontology, Henology appears as a second and subsidiary axis: it is not present in all the main parts, and, wherever is present, it results shorter.[51] The presence of Henology beside Ontology is most clearly visible in the third part of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: within this part, HenologyP is distinct from, and consecutive to, OntologyP. In the second part of metaphysics, on the other hand, HenologyS is independent from OntologyS only formally, whereas in the concrete development of Avicenna's discourse it is intermingled with it. As to the first and fourth part of metaphysics, some topics dealt with in them pertain to Henology; these topics, however, do not constitute independent structural units.[52]

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[49] In the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 11, 12; and in *Nafs*, Introduction, p. 3, 12 [I, p. 13, 64–65], practical philosophy in its entirety is called with the proper name of ethics, i.e. "science of the moral characters" (*ʿilm al-aḫlāq*). For ethics being named *ʿilm al-aḫlāq*, see *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 14, 15; cp. *Aqsām*, p. 85, 11–13.

[50] The first and the fourth part of metaphysics are primarily ontological, since they deal, respectively, with "existent" as the subject-matter of metaphysics, and with the first causes of "existent". The second and the third part as well contain a unit belonging to Ontology (OntologyS and OntologyP).

[51] Structural units belonging to Henology are absent in the first and fourth parts, and shorter than the corresponding parts of Ontology in the second and third parts.

[52] The main differences between the actual structure of metaphysics and its outline (§1) and description (§3) are the following. In the outline, Prolegomena, Introduction, HenologyS and HenologyP are missing, and the sequence OntologyS-OntologyP-OntologyC/Theology is inverted. In the description, the Prolegomena and HenologyS are missing (although the content of the Introduction—I, 5–8—is

What follows is a detailed description of each of the aforementioned seven units of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

4.2 *Prolegomena ([1.1])*

The first four chapters (I, 1–4) of the *Ilāhiyyāt* are a sort of preface. On account of their Greek source(s), I call them "Prolegomena". In these chapters Avicenna deals with some preliminary questions, which, to a large extent, correspond to the six or seven points discussed by the Neoplatonic commentators of Aristotle at the beginning of their exegesis of the single Aristotelian works.[53] These points are the explanation of the "goal" (σκοπός) of the book (or its author's aim), of its "utility" (χρήσιμον), "authorship" (γνήσιον), "place in the order of learning" (τάξις τῆς ἀναγνώσεως), "title" (ἐπιγραφή) and "division into chapters (i.e. main divisions)" (εἰς τὰ κεφάλαια διαίρεσις). Some commentators add a seventh point, the question "to which part of philosophy the book belongs" (εἰς ποῖον μέρος τῆς φιλοσοφίας ἀνάγεται). Avicenna himself in I, 3 contends that chapters I, 1–4 have a traditional and introductory character.[54] Among these preliminary questions—which he applies to metaphysics as a discipline, rather than to Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, since the *Ilāhiyyāt* is not a commentary

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described in I, 4, it is not depicted there as an independent part of metaphysics) and OntologyS and OntologyP are merged together.

[53] In the Neoplatonic commentaries, six or seven questions introduce the exegesis of each work of Aristotle. The number and *raison d'être* of these questions are preliminarily discussed at the end of the general introduction to Aristotle's philosophy, in ten questions, preceding the commentary on the first work of the Aristotelian *corpus* (the *Categories*). For the instances of these introductory schemes in Greek philosophy, see I. Hadot [1990], pp. 21–47, 138–160, and Mansfeld [1994], pp. 10–21; for their Arabic reception, see al-Fārābī [1890d]; Abū-l-Faraǧ ibn-al-Ṭayyib's Commentary on Aristotle's *Categories*, preserved in the MS. Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 1, as translated by Rosenthal [1975], pp. 70–72; Gutas [1983]; Gutas [1985]; Gutas [1988], p. 227; Harvey [2004] (at pp. 26–28, Harvey surveys the topics and rhetorical devices of the introductions of some of Avicenna's works).

[54] I, 3, p. 17, 9–10 [p. 19, 44]: "But when, at the beginnings of books, the utility of the sciences is investigated . . .". Before Avicenna, this introductory scheme is applied to the *Metaphysics* in Ṯābit Ibn Qurra's *Talḫīṣ* of Aristotle's work (see Ṯābit Ibn Qurra [forthcoming]), in whose introduction two such preliminay topics (goal and title) are discussed (in the same introduction Ṯābit addresses also two questions—how to solve the disagreement between Plato and Aristotle, and how to explain Aristotle's obscurity—of the general introduction to Aristotle's philosophy), and in al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* (goal, title and division into chapters; see Chapter 3, §2). See also the Prologue of the *Theologia Aristotelis*, p. 5, 10–11 (cp. p. 4, 4, p. 5, 13, p. 6, 2, 3, 7; Lewis [1959], p. 487).

on this work—he deals with the "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) of metaphysics in I, 1–2, a theme to which he connects the issue of its "subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ*);[55] its "utility" (*manfaʿa*), "rank" (*martaba*) and "name" (*ism*) in I, 3;[56] its contents (*ǧumlat mā yutakallamu fīhi*) in I, 4. Since he deals with metaphysics rather than the *Metaphysics*, he does not face the question of authorship. The brief classification of sciences which precedes the investigation of the goal of metaphyiscs in I, 1 might correspond to the seventh question, namely the part of philosophy to which metaphysics belongs.[57]

4.3 *Introduction ([1.2])*

The remaining chapters of the first treatise (I, 5–8), albeit distinct from the Prolegomena,[58] are closely linked to these latter, of which they represent a sort of doctrinal complement.[59] To mark their connection with the Prolegomena, I call chapters I, 5–8 "Introduction". Thus, the first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt* in its entirety (Prolegomena and Introduction) has a propaedeutic character with regard to the rest of the work. Both Prolegomena and Introduction focus on the subject-matter of metaphysics (roughly speaking, the Prolegomena establish its identity, the Introduction its nature) and are mainly concerned with Ontology, even though topics related to Henology are occasionally discussed in them.

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[55] See Chapter 4, §1.

[56] As names of metaphyiscs (I, 3, pp. 21, 12–24, 9 [pp. 24, 45–27, 13) Avicenna records "science of what is after nature" (*ʿilm fī mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*) and "divine science" (*ʿilm ilāhī*). See Appendix D, II.i–ii.

[57] I, 1, pp. 3, 11–5, 1 [p. 1, 7–3, 34].

[58] The discontinuity between Prolegomena and chapters I, 5–8 is clear in the summary of the contents of the *Ilāhiyyāt* provided in I, 4, where chapters I, 5–8 are taken into account, whereas the Prolegomena are not mentioned.

[59] Besides belonging to the same first treatise, chapters I, 5–8 appear to resume three points made in the Prolegomena: "existent" is a primary concept, whose quiddity and existence do not need to be proved (I, 2, p. 13, 9–12 [pp. 12, 32–13, 13, 36], third argument for "existent" as subject-matter of metaphysics; see Chapter 4, §1.2); a "pointer" (*išāra*) is available, attesting to the fact that metaphysics can prove the existence of the First Principle without using (particular) sensible data, but relying rather on universal intellectual premises (I, 3, p. 21, 2–8 [pp. 23, 31–24, 41]; see Marmura [1980], p. 339); the metaphysical investigation of the principles of the existents amounts to the analysis of one of the properties of "existent" (I, 2, p. 14, 1–13 [pp. 13, 47–14, 67], Avicenna's answer to the objection moved against "existent" as subject-matter of metaphysics, see Chapter 4, §1.2).

The Introduction deals with the foundation of knowledge. It takes into account the primary concepts (I, 5–7) and the primary propositions (I, 8).[60] Chapter I, 5 is an account of the primary concepts as such, namely "existent" (and "non-existent", *maʿdūm*), "thing" and "necessary" (together with "possible"—in the sense of "contingent"—and "impossible").[61] The discussion of the relationship between "existent" and "thing" contains Avicenna's famous distinction of essence and existence.[62] In I, 5 Avicenna clarifies the meanings of the primary concepts and describe their relationship with "existent", as first and most fundamental among them. Chapter I, 6 starts with a distinction related to the one of essence and existence: that between the "Necessary Existent"—the existent which exists necessarily *per se* (or: by essence), i.e. God—and "possible existent"—the existent which does not exist necessarily *per se*. The remainder of I, 6 and chapter I, 7 are mainly devoted to provide an investigation of the Necessary Existent based on the sole analysis of concepts. In this way Avicenna shows that metaphysics is able to prove the existence of the Necessary Existent, or First Principle, without taking into account sensible data.[63] In I, 8, finally, Avicenna describes and shows the validity of the axiom of the excluded-middle, qualifying it as a "property" (*ḫāṣṣa*)

[60] Primary concepts and primary propositions are mentioned together both at the beginning of I, 5 (p. 29, 7–16 [p. 32, 4–15]), where they are described as the principles of "conceptualization" (*taṣawwur*) and the principles of "the act of granting assent" (*taṣdīq*), and at the end of I, 8 (p. 54, 16–17 [p. 64, 14–17]), where they are canvassed as principles of "definition" (*ḥadd*) and principles of "demonstration" (*burhān*).

[61] In the list of the primary concepts, also "one" is mentioned (I, 5, p. 30, 4 [p. 33, 26], see Appendix A). For the historical background of "thing" as primary concept, see De Libera-Segonds [1999], p. xiii, n. 22.

[62] On this doctrine in particular (one of the most extensively studied of all the *Ilāhiyyāt*) see Goichon [1937]; Rahman [1958]; Rahman [1981]; Jolivet [1984]; Burrell [1986]; Ceylan [1993]; De Libera [1999], pp. 577–590; Wisnovsky [2000] (cp. Wisnovsky [2003]); Druart [2001]; Porro [2002b]; Aertsen [2006]. On chapter I, 5 in general, see Marmura [1984b]; Geoffroy [1999].

[63] I agree with Davidson [1987], p. 289—contrarily to Hourani [1972], Marmura [1980] and Rudolph [1997], pp. 340–344—that the analysis of the concept of "necessary existent" in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 6–7 is a description of the nature of God, not a proof of His existence. As far as I can see, by describing the nature of God in these chapters, Avicenna merely aims at providing a "pointer" (*išāra*) to the possibility of a "metaphysical" proof of His existence—as he says in I, 3, p. 21, 2–8 [pp. 23, 31–24, 41]—not the proof itself; this latter is provided in VIII, 1–3 (see below, §4.4). Marmura [1980] has first pointed out the connection between I, 6–7 and the passage of I, 3 just mentioned.

and one of the "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*)—in the sense of "proper accidents"—of "existent".[64]

The Introduction anticipates themes of OntologyS, OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology, but belongs structurally to none of them.[65]

4.4 *OntologyS, OntologyP, OntologyC/Theology*

After the preliminary first treatise, the concrete treatment of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* starts with the second treatise. Avicenna underscores the articulation of II–X, 3 in OntologyS ([2.1]), HenologyS ([2.2]), OntologyP ([3.1]), HenologyP ([3.2]) and OntologyC/Theology ([4]) in a series of scattered statements connecting these parts of metaphysics among themselves. In what follows, I take into account what he says, first, about OntologyS, OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology, then about HenologyS and HenologyP. I collect these two groups of statements, respectively, in Text 4 and Text 5.

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[64] I, 8, p. 48, 16–18 [p. 56, 74–76]; The axiom of the excluded-middle is called "principle" at p. 53, 16–17 [p. 63, 90–91]. On chapter I, 8, see Houser [1981]; Houser [1999].

[65] The "divisions" (*aqsām*) of "existent" mentioned in the title of chapter I, 5 ("Chapter on indicating 'existent', 'thing' and their first divisions (*aqsām*), by means of what contains a reminder of the [speaker's] goal", I, 5, p. 29, 3–4 [p. 31, 99–01]) are possibly the categories, which are briefly taken into account at p. 34, 15–17 [p. 40, 46–49] (see Chapter 9, Quotation 3). The content of I, 5 is summarized in I, 4, as "the state of the relation of 'thing' and 'existent' with the categories (*maqūlāt*), and the state of non-existence" (I, 4, p. 25, 4–5 [p. 27, 16–17]). In I, 5, p. 30, 6–7 [p. 33, 30–31], two categorial items ("active" and "passive") are described as "divisions" (*aqsām*) of "existent". Also the distinction of "Necessary Existent" and "possible existent" in I, 6 is qualified by Avicenna as a "division" (*inqisām*) of "existent": "We say: Things which enter into [the domain of] existence can be theoretically divided (*taḥtamilu fī l-ʿaqli l-inqisāma*) in two divisions (*qismayni*). One of these is that which, when it is considered in itself, its existence is not necessary [i.e. the possible being]. . . . The other of these is that which, when it is considered in itself, its existence is necessary [i.e. the Necessary Existent]" (I, 6, p. 37, 7–10 [p. 43, 8–13]; see Hyman [1970], p. 240; Hourani [1972], p. 82), but only later in the *Ilāhiyyāt* the connection between "possible existent" and the categories becomes clear (see II, 1, p. 60, 5–8 [p. 68, 70–75], where Avicenna states that the types of substance he has dealt with in that chapter—matter, form and compound—are possible existents). On the other hand, "necessary" and "possible" appear among the properties of "existent" in Text 2 and its afferents (see above, Table 1). The theme of chapters I, 6–7 is resumed in OntologyC/Theology (VIII, 4–5; see the references to a previous treatment occurring in VIII, 4, p. 343, 10–11 [p. 397, 55–58], and in VIII, 5, p. 349, 8–10 [p. 405, 2–6]). Chapter I, 8 is linked with OntologyP since the axiom of the excluded-middle is qualified as a "property" of "existent" (see above, n. 64).

OntologyS, OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology are mentioned in the opening sentences of treatises III–VII, and in the titles of treatises VIII–IX.

Text 4

[2.1 = **OntologyS**] [a] (beginning of III) We say: We have already shown the quiddity of substance [. . .]. Therefore it is suitable that we pass now to certifying [the essence of] the accidents and establishing their [existence].[66]

[b] (beginning of IV) Since we have spoken of the things occurring to "existent" and unity as species (*anwāʿ*). . . .[67]

[3.1 = **OntologyP**] [c] . . . it is suitable that we speak of the things occurring to them [i.e. "existent" and unity] as properties (*ḫawāṣṣ*) and concomitant accidents (*ʿawāriḍ lāzima*). We will start first with those belonging to "existent", and, among them, with anteriority and posteriority.[68]

[d] . . . seeing that potency and actuality themselves are among the accidents (*ʿawāriḍ*) of "existent",[69] its attributes (*lawāḥiq*) and the things that have to be known when the states (*aḥwāl*) of absolute "existent" are known.[70]

[e] (beginning of V) It is suitable that we speak now of "universal" and "particular", since it [i.e. this topic] is related also to what we have just finished with, and is one of the proper accidents (*aʿrāḍ ḫāṣṣa*) of "existent".[71]

[f] (beginning of VI) It is suitable that we speak now of "cause" and "caused thing", since they are also among the attributes (*lawāḥiq*) which are consequent (*talḥaqu*) upon "existent *qua* existent".[72]

[g] (beginning of VII) It seems that we have exhaustively discussed, with respect to our goal here,[73] the things that are proper to (*al-umūr allatī taḫtaṣṣu bi-*) "being *qua* being" (*huwiyya min ḥayṯu hiya huwiyya*) or are consequent to it (*talḥaquhā*).[74]

[4 = **OntologyC/Theology**] [h] (title of VIII) Eighth treatise on [3.1] knowing the First Principle (*al-mabdaʾ al-awwal*) of all existence and [3.2] knowing Its attributes (*ṣifāt*).[75]

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[66] III, 1, p. 93, 5–10 [p. 104, 5–13].
[67] IV, 1, p. 163, 4 [p. 184, 3–4].
[68] IV, 1, p. 163, 4–6 [p. 184, 4–6].
[69] Reading *al-mawǧūd* instead of *al-wuǧūd* (see Appendix A).
[70] IV, 1, p. 169, 16–17 [p. 193, 67–69].
[71] V, 1, p. 195, 4–5 [p. 227, 4–6].
[72] VI, 1, p. 257, 5–6 [p. 291, 6–8].
[73] Reading *hunā* instead of *hāḏā* (see Appendix A).
[74] VII, 1, p. 303, 5–6 [p. 349, 7–9]. See Chapter 9, §3.5, Table 5.
[75] VIII, p. 325, 1–2 [p. 376, 2–3].

> [i] (overall introduction to OntologyC/Theology in VIII, 1) Since we have reached this point of our book, it is suitable that we conclude it [lit.: seal it] with [4.1] the knowledge of the First Principle (*al-mabda' al-awwal*) of all existence, namely: whether It exists and [4.2] whether It is one, so that nothing shares Its rank and nothing is equal to It. [It is also suitable] that we indicate [4.3] Its rank in the existence, the arrangement of the things existing under It and their ranks, and [4.5] the way of returning to It.[76]
>
> [j] (title of IX) Ninth treatise on [4.3] the progression of things from the first ordering and [4.5] the[ir] return to it.[77]

[2.1] **OntologyS**. The "species" (*anwāʿ*) of "existent" as the main concern of OntologyS are mentioned in [b]. From [b] we learn also that OntologyS arrives until the end of the third treatise, thus ranging from II, 1 until III, 10. Since in these two treatises Avicenna deals with the categories (see [a]), the "species" of "existent" of OntologyS are the categories. As a matter of fact, not all the categories are taken into account in this section of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: whereas the second treatise is entirely devoted to substance, the third treatise, after the introduction (III, 1), deals only with some of the accidental categories, namely quantity (III, 3–5), quality (III, 7–9) and relation (III, 10). The treatment of quantity belongs, at the same time, to OntologyS (in so far as quantity is a division of "existent") and to HenologyS (in so far as the principle of quantity is "one"). The remaining chapters of the third treatise (III, 2 and III, 6), on the other hand, serving as prologue and complement to the discussion of quantity, are proper to HenologyS (see below, §4.5).

[3.1] **OntologyP**. The "properties" (*ḫawāṣṣ*) of "existent" dealt with in OntologyP (see [c]) are also named "concomitant accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ lāzima*) in [c], "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*) in [d], attributes" (*lawāḥiq*) in [d] and [f]), "states" (*aḥwāl*) in [d], "proper accidents" (*aʿrāḍ ḫāṣṣa*) in [e], and "things that are proper . . . or consequent" (*al-umūr allatī taḫtaṣṣu . . . aw talḥaqu*) in [g]. From [c] and [g] we learn that the treatment of the properties of "existent" is provided in treatises IV–VI. In the fourth treatise, Avicenna takes into account "anteriority' and "posteriority" in IV, 1 (see [c]), "potency" and "act" in IV, 2 (see [d]), "perfect" and "imperfect", "all" (together with "entire") and "part" in IV, 3. The fifth treatise is devoted to "universal" and "par-

[76] VIII, 1, p. 327, 4–6 [p. 376, 4–9].
[77] IX, p. 371, 1–2 [om.].

ticular" in V, 1–2 (see [e]), with special attention to the three universals belonging to essence ("genus" in V, 3–4, "species" in V, 5, "differentia" in V, 6), and to "definition" in V, 7–9. "Cause" and "caused thing" are the topic of the sixth treatise (see [g]).[78]

[4] **OntologyC/Theology**. OntologyC/Theology takes into account God as the First Principle of "existent" (see [h] and [i]). It is preceded by a brief introduction, in which Avicenna makes clear that this is the last part, and the culmination or "seal", of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see [i]).[79]

OntologyC/Theology embraces the last three treatises of the work (VIII–X, 3), and encompasses six subdivisions, corresponding to the six main topics it deals with. Four of them are mentioned in sections [h], [i] and [j]: [4.1] knowing the First Principle, namely establishing Its existence (VIII, 1–3);[80] [4.2] knowing Its attributes, namely Its nature (VIII, 4–7), with particular regard to Its unity/unicity (VIII, 4–5)[81] and omniscience (VIII, 6–7);[82] [4.3] the emanation of the universe from It (IX, 1–6);[83] [4.5] the return to It of some of

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[78] On VI, 1–2, see Jolivet [1991], and Wisnovsky [2003b]. On Avicenna's doctrine of causality in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see also Wisnovsky [2002]; Bertolacci [2002b]; Wisnovsky [2003].

[79] The privileged role of OntologyC/Theology within the *Ilāhiyyāt* is witnessed also by the fact that two of its three treatise (VIII, IX) are introduced not only by the indication of their number and the number of the chapters they contain (as in the case of all the other treatises), but also by a brief explanatory note (see Text 4, [h], [j]). The *Ilāhiyyāt* is portrayed as the "seal" of the *Šifā'* also in *Madḫal* I, 1, p. 11, 11, and *Nafs*, Introduction, p. 3, 13 [I, p. 13, 65].

[80] On this topic, see Davidson [1987]. Four passages of treatise VIII are noteworthy: VIII, 1, p. 327, 4–5 [p. 376, 5–6]: "Since we have reached this point of our book, it is suitable that we conclude it with the knowledge of the First Principle of all existence: *whether He exists* (*hal huwa mawǧūdun*) . . ." (emphasis added; see above Text 4 [i]); VIII, 1, p. 328, 15 [p. 378, 52]: ". . . the goal we pursue, namely *establishing [the existence] of the First Cause*" (empahsis added); VIII, 3, p. 340, 10–11 [p. 393, 69–70]: "Chapter on showing the finiteness of the final and formal causes, *on establishing [the existence of]* (*iṯbāt*) the First Principle in an absolute manner . . ." (emphasis added); cp. Marmura [1980], p. 338 and n. 6; VIII, 4, p. 343, 10 [p. 397, 55]: "*It has been established to you now [the existence of]* (*fa-qad ṯabata la-ka al-āna*) something that is a Necessary Existent" (emphasis added). Cp. also I, 4, p. 27, 9 [p. 30, 76]. According to these passages, chapters VIII, 1–3 are the specific section of the *Ilāhiyyāt* where Avicenna provides the proof of God's existence.

[81] The contrasting evidence regarding the issue of whether or not God possesses an essence according to Avicenna (VIII, 4) is discussed by Macierowsky [1988] and Rosheger [2002].

[82] Marmura [1962]; Marmura [1985]; Acar [2004]; Zghal [2004]; Adamson [2005].

[83] In the title of chapter IX, 1 (p. 373, 2–3 [p. 434, 2]), emanation is portrayed

the things that have emanated from It, namely the human souls after the death of the body (IX, 7).[84] In the actual structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, between subdivision [4.3] and subdivision [4.5] a further section is interposed: the theodicy of chapter IX, 6 ([4.4]).[85] In the tenth treatise, finally, Avicenna deals with a further group of topics, that can be gathered around the theme of prophecy (X, 1–3); I regard this treatment as a sixth subdivision of OntologyC/Theology ([4.6]).[86] For the sake of brevity, I call subdivisions [4.3–6], respectively, "Cosmology", "Theodicy", "Eschatology" and "Prophetology".[87]

4.5 *Henology S, HenologyP*

Avicenna's statements regarding HenologyS and HenologyP occur within the third treatise and in the opening sentences of treatises IV and VII.

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as another "attribute" (*ṣifa*) of the First Principle, namely His "active attribute" (*ṣifa fāʿiliyya*). On Avicenna's doctrine of emanation, see Hasnawi [1990b]; Janssens [1997]; Lizzini [2004].

[84] On this topic, see Gutas [1988], pp. 254–261, and Michot [1986]. God is the cause of the "return" of the human souls from the point of view of the final, not efficient, causality (I wish to thank R. Arnzen for having brought this point to my attention).

[85] See Inati [1984]; Ivry [1984]; Inati [1999]; Steel [2002]. For Avicenna's theodicy in the *Kawn wa-Fasād*, see M. Rashed [2000].

[86] "Prophecy" (*nubuwwa*) is mentioned in the title of X, 1 (p. 435, 5 [p. 522, 5]) and is the main subject of X, 2–3. It also constitutes the link between OntologyC/Theology and the Appendix, as the reference to prophecy at the end of chapter X, 5 (p. 455, 15 [pp. 552, 15–553, 16]) witnesses. Prophecy and the destiny of human souls are two distinct derivative divisions of metaphysics in the *Aqsām* (Avicenna [1986], pp. 91–92; Michot [1980], pp. 70–71).

[87] Text 4 and Text 2 display both similarities and differences. The three elements of the structure of metaphysics (OntologyS, OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology) are the same. As to OntologyS, in the *Ilāhiyyāt* this part of metaphysics proves the existence and describes the nature of the subject-matters of natural philosophy and mathematics—namely corporeal substance (II, 2–3) and discrete and continuous quantity (III, 3–5), thus laying the foundations of these two disciplines (see Chapter 7)—as Text 2 [3*] envisages; the species of "existent" in Text 4 are the categories, as in Text 2 [3*] and afferents. As to OntologyP, the properties of "existent" are—with the remarkable exception of "one" and "many" (see §4.5)—the same as those indicated in Text 2 and afferents. As to OntologyC/Theology, finally, its first subdivision is based on proving the finiteness of the four causal chains (VIII, 1–3), something that possibly corresponds to the mention of the "ultimate causes" in Text 2 [1.1*]. As to the differences, the order of succession of the parts of metaphysics is exactly the reverse: OntologyS is the first part in Text 4, the last in Text 2, OntologyC/Theology is the last part in Text 4, the first in Text 2 (in both texts, OntologyP occupies the middle position).

Text 5

[2.2 = **HenologyS**] [a] It is easy for you at this point to know that we have ascertained the divisions (*aqsām*) of "one".[88]

[b] By "multiplicity", two things (*maʿnayāni*) are understood.[89]

[c] (beginning of IV = Text 4 [b]) Since we have spoken of the things occurring to "existent" and unity as species (*anwāʿ*) . . ..

[3.2 = **HenologyP**] [d] (= Text 4 [c]) . . . it is suitable that we speak of the things occurring to them ["existent" and unity] as properties (*ḫawāṣṣ*) and concomitant accidents (*ʿawāriḍ lāzima*). We will start first with those belonging to "existent", and, among them, with anteriority and posteriority.

[e] (beginning of VII) Therefore it is suitable for us to speak also of the things that are proper (*al-umūr allatī taḫtaṣṣu*) to unity and to what is in opposite correspondence to it[90]—i.e. multiplicity—as sameness (*huwahuwiyya*),[91] homogeneity, coincidence (*muwāfaqa*), equality, likeness and the things that are in opposite correspondence to them.[92]

[2.2] **HenologyS**. The "species" (*anwāʿ*) of "one" (and "many") taken into account by HenologyS are mentioned in [c]. The species of "one" are also called "divisions" (*aqsām*) in [a]. As it appears from [a], their analysis is given in III, 2.[93] They are primarily the "one" by accident and the "one" by essence; under this latter heading, the "one" by genus, the "one" by species (which is presented as equivalent to the "one" by differentia), the "one" by relation, the "one" by subject and the "one" by number are enlisted. Avicenna deals with the meanings, or species, of "many" in the final part of chapter III, 5 (see [b]).[94] They are the absolute and relative multiplicity: the former is the opposite of unity, the latter of paucity.[95] The study

[88] III, 2, p. 103, 1–2 [p. 113, 9–10].

[89] III, 5, p. 124, 14 [p. 139, 99].

[90] Reading *wa-bi-muqābilatihā* instead of *wa-bi-muqābilātihā* (see Appendix A).

[91] Reading *al-huwahuwiyya* instead of *al-huwiyya* (see Appendix A).

[92] VII, 1, p. 303, 13–14 [pp. 349, 19–350, 22].

[93] According to manuscript P117 (see Appendix A), the title of chapter III, 2 is "Chapter on the divisions of 'one' and its species" (*faṣlun fī aqsāmi l-wāḥidi wa-anwāʿihī*).

[94] III, 5, pp. 124, 14–125, 4 [p. 139, 99–07].

[95] In *Naǧāt* I, 4, p. 495, 17, Avicenna states that the divisions of "many" are opposite to the divisions of "one" (Avicenna [1938], p. 200, 1). This would exclude the two meanings of multiplicity in *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 5 from the status of divisions of "many", since they are not opposite to the divisions of "one". On the other hand, the concrete analysis of the "species" of "many" in *Naǧāt* I, 22, pp. 544, 20–545, 5 (Avicenna [1938], p. 224, 10–13) deals with the same two meanings of multiplicity of *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 5.

of the opposition between "one" and "many" in chapter III, 6 is, thus, a complement of the final part of III, 5. Chapters III, 3–5, dealing with quantity, belong to HenologyS, in so far as unity is the principle of quantity. To the discussion of quantity is related also chapter III, 9, dealing with the qualities affecting quantities. HenologyS consists, therefore, of chapters III, 2–6 and III, 9.

[3.2] **HenologyP**. Section [d] refers to the "properties" (*ḫawāṣṣ*) of "one" and "many" investigated by HenologyP. These properties are called "concomitant accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ lāzima*) in [d], "things that are proper" (*al-umūr allatī taḫtaṣṣu*) in [e]. The properties of "one" and "many" are dealt with in chapter VII, 1. In this chapter Avicenna takes into account—among the properties of "one"—"same", "like", "equal", "correlative" (*munāsib*), "homogeneous", "similar" and "conformable", and—among the properties of "many"—"other", "different" and "opposition" (with special attention to "privation" and "contrariety").

In the following two chapters (VII, 2–3), Avicenna expounds and refutes the doctrine of those philosophers who regard quantity (both arithmetical and geometrical) as substance and principle of substance. He had announced this theme, not only in Text 3, but also in chapter III, 1,[96] as a sort of complement to the proof of the accidentality of quantity provided in chapters III, 3–5. Chapters VII, 2–3, therefore, can be regarded as a sort of *pars destruens* of the treatment of "one" and "many".[97]

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[96] III, 1, p. 95, 13–14 [p. 106, 63–64].

[97] The differences of Text 5 from Text 3 are mainly three. First and most important, whereas in Text 3 "one" and "many" have only "things that follow" (*tawābiʿ*) them, corresponding to their properties (HenologyP), in Text 5 they have both species (HenologyS) and properties (HenologyP). Second, in Text 3 the doctrine of "one" and "many" in its entirety appears as an independent unit, which is disconnected from the discussion of "existent", and comes after it; in Text 5, on the contrary, "existent", on the one hand, and "one" and "many", on the other, are dealt with in parallel stages: first OntologyS intermingled with HenologyS; then OntologyP followed by HenologyP. Third, the order of topics envisaged by Text 3 within the doctrine of "one", "many" and related matters, is different from that assigned to HenologyS and HenologyP in Text 5. Moreover, only some of the "things that follow" "one" and "many" in Text 3 figure among their properties in Text 5. Finally, many properties of "one" in Text 3 are subsumed under "same" in the concrete treatment of HenologyP (VII, 1–3): "like", "equal" and "correlative" (*munāsib*) are presented as instances of sameness concerning accidents (quality, quantity, relation); "homogeneous" and "similar" as instances of sameness concerning the essential constituents (genus and species); "conformable" as an instance of sameness concerning properties. In this list, "correlative" takes the place of "coincident"

HenologyS and OntologyS are intermingled, and do not constitute two independent subdivisions; thus, in Text 5 [c], Avicenna declares jointly concluded the treatment of both.[98] HenologyP and OntologyP, on the contrary, despite being subdivisions of the same part of metaphysics (see Text 5 [d]), are distinct from one another (see Text 5 [e]): Avicenna deals first with OntologyP (IV–VI) in its entirety, then, in a separate, independent treatise, with HenologyP (VII, 1–3).[99]

To sum up: the concrete structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt* results from the coexistence and interaction of two axes, one fundamental, the other complementary. The main axis concerns "existent" according to four different perspectives: its role as subject-matter of metaphysics, its species, its properties and its causes; accordingly, it ranges over Prolegomena and Introduction ([1.1]–[1.2]), OntologyS ([2.1]), OntologyP ([3.1]) and OntologyC/Theology ([4]). It is almost entirely prefigured in Text 2, albeit in the reverse order (OntologyC/Theology, OntologyP, OntologyS). The second axis of the *Ilāhiyyāt* regards "one" and "many", whose species and properties are taken into account; accordingly, it encompasses HenologyS ([2.2]) and HenologyP ([3.2]). However, if we consider the attention that Avicenna pays to the theme of the unicity and unity of the Necessary Existent both within the Introduction (I, 7) and within OntologyC/Theology (VIII, 4–5; see Text 4, [i]), we realize that Henology is not limited to the discussion of the species and properties of "one" and "many", but pervades all the *Ilāhiyyāt*. In this work, its role and importance emerges progressively: whereas in I, 2 (= Table 1) "one" and "many" are

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(*muwāfiq*) in Text 3 [2.3**]. Among the properties of "many" in Text 3, "unlike", "unequal", "non-homogeneous", "non-conformable" are omitted.

[98] OntologyS (II, 1–III, 10) encompasses HenologyS (III, 2–6; III, 9): OntologyS starts before HenologyS in the second treatise (substance, II, 1–4), and continues after it in the third treatise (quality and relation, III, 7–10). HenologyS, in its turn, embraces a part of OntologyS (quantity, III, 3–5), of which it constitutes, so to say, the framework. As Avicenna himself contends at the end of III, 1 (pp. 95, 15–96, 4 [p. 107, 66–75]), the reason of the insertion of chapter III, 2 (the starting-point of HenologyS) at this point of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is that "one" is a principle of quantity. Accordingly, the proof of the accidentality of number in III, 3 depends on the proof of the accidentality of "one" (see Bertolacci [2001c]). Probably because of the overlapping of OntologyS and HenologyS, the third treatise is the longest of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (ten chapters).

[99] The side-by-side treatment of "existent" and "one" in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is perhaps due to the overlapping of OntologyS and HenologyS, something that entails a link (for the sake of symmetry) also between OntologyP and HenologyP.

two of the many properties of "existent", in I, 4 (= Text 3) they constitute a specific topic of metaphysics. HenologyS intersects OntologyS in [2]; HenologyP is distinct from OntologyP in [3].

The fact that the *Ilāhiyyāt* is construed as a doctrine of "existent" (the main axis), but encompasses also a theory of "one" and "many" (the second axis), is one of the salient feature of this work.

5 The structure of metaphysics in the other Avicennian *summae*

Besides the *Šifāʾ*, Avicenna wrote other, less extensive, philosophical *summae* (both in Arabic and in Persian). The metaphysical sections of these *summae* present a structure of metaphysics that is different from, and less comprehensive than, that of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The *Ilāhiyyāt* emerges as an *unicum* in Avicenna's literary output not only from the point of view of doctrine, but also from the perspective of structure.

In the present section the following works are taken into account: *Al-Maǧmūʿ* (*The Compilation*) or *Al-Ḥikma al-ʿArūḍīya* (*Philosophy for ʿArūḍī*); *Kitāb al-Išārāt wa-l-Tanbīhāt* (*Book of Pointers and Reminders*); *ʿUyūn al-Ḥikma* (*Sources of Wisdom*); *Dānešnāme-ye ʿAlāʾī* (*Philosophy for ʿAlāʾ al-Dawla*, in Persian); *Kitāb al-Hidāya* (*Book of Guidance*); *Kitāb al-Naǧāt* (*Book of Salvation*). Conclusively, also *Al-Mašriqiyyūn* (*The Easterners*) or *Al-Ḥikma al-mašriqiyya* (*Eastern Philosophy*) will be considered.[100] These writings are studied here from a theoretical, rather than historical, point of view, in order to elucidate how they exemplify different typologies of the structure of metaphysics. Their sequence, accordingly, does not correspond to their relative chronology, but to a line of increasing structural complexity and proximity to the *Ilāhiyyāt*, culminating in the *Naǧāt*.

In the following table, the structure of metaphysics in the aforementioned works is preliminarily outlined and compared with that in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (the titles of the *summae* refer to their metaphysical sections).

[100] See Appendix C, Works 2, 13, 6, 10, 7, 9, 11.

Table 4

Ilāhiyyāt	*Maǧmūʿ*	*Išārāt*	*ʿUyūn*	*Dānešnāme*	*Hidāya*	*Naǧāt*
[1.1] Prolegomena				Prolegomena		
[1.2] Introduction						
[2.1] OntologyS			OntologyS-P	OntologyS	OntologyS	OntologyS
[2.2] HenologyS						
[3.1] OntologyP	OntologyP	OntologyP		OntologyP (including HenologyS-P)	OntologyP	OntologyP
					HenologyS ("one")	HenologyS-P
[3.2] HenologyP						
[4] OntologyC/ Theology	OntologyC/ Theology	OntologyC/ Theology	OntologyC/ Theology	OntologyC/ Theology	OntologyC/ Theology	OntologyC/ Theology
Appendix						

The extant part of the metaphysical section of the *Maǧmūʿ* includes a treatment of the properties of "existent" (OntologyP) and a treatment of the nature and activity of God (OntologyC/Theology).[101]

The metaphysical section of the *Išārāt* covers the last seven "chapters" (*anmāṭ*) of the second part of the work (II, 4–10). Thus metaphysics is not structurally independent from natural philosophy, expounded in the previous chapters of the second part (II, 1–3). The investigation starts *in medias res* and the internal structure of metaphysics is not stated anywhere. Due to the particular style of the work, which consists in "providing hints and guidelines to the student, rather than ready-made arguments",[102] it is difficult to reconstruct the structure of metaphysics on the basis of its content. It consists

[101] According to Gutas [1988], p. 90, the original part on metaphysics might have encompassed also two further sections, which are missing in the extant manuscript: one on "existent" itself, namely its species (OntologyS), the other on "one" and "many", namely their species and properties (HenologyS and HenologyP). In this case, the structure of metaphysics in the *Maǧmūʿ* would resemble closely that of the *Naǧāt*, a work in which passages of the *Maǧmūʿ* were copied.

[102] Gutas [1988], p. 141.

apparently of a very succinct OntologyP, placed at the beginning of II, 4,[103] and a much more extensive OntologyC/Theology, covering the rest of II, 4 and II, 5–10. OntologyP is restricted to the doctrine of causality and is not clearly separated from OntologyC/Theology: rather, it is intimately linked and propaedeutic to this latter.[104] As to OntologyC/Theology, it contains, in a slightly different order, the six sub-divisions of OntologyC/Theology in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[105]

The *ʿUyūn* is a work portrayed by both Medieval Arab commentators and modern editors as "scattered and lacking architecture".[106] Despite the presence of some introductory remarks,[107] the only clues

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[103] Avicenna [1892], pp. 138, 2–140, 11 (OntologyC/Theology starts apparently in II, 4, p. 140, 12). The title of II, 4 ("On existence and its causes", p. 138, 1) might apply to the sole OntologyP, which consists of a section dealing with "existent" (pp. 138, 2–139, 13) and another dealing with the causes (pp. 139, 14–140, 11). Davidson [1987], p. 239 and n. 44, regards pp. 140ff. as the place of the *Išārāt* where the proof of God's existence is provided.

[104] As the conclusion of II, 4 (pp. 146, 13–147, 2) makes clear, the doctrine of this chapter is essentially theological: in it, the analysis of "existent" is the starting-point of the proof of God's existence (p. 140, 12–142, 9; see Marmura [1980b], pp. 339–341; Davidson [1987], p. 289, n. 44; Mayer [2001]) and a description of His nature (p. 142, 10–147, 2). The distinction between "existent" and "sensible" at the very beginning of II, 4 (pp. 138, 2–139, 10), therefore, has to be read in the light of what Avicenna says at the end of the same chapter, namely that the investigation of God he proposes "does not need to take into account His creation and His action" (p. 146, 14–15). In II, 4 the initial distinction between "existent" and "sensible" is followed by that between essence and existence (p. 139, 11–13), corresponding to *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5, pp. 31, 2–32, 5 [pp. 34, 50–36, 83].

[105] After OntologyP, the proof of the God's existence, and the description of His nature in II, 4, chapters II, 5–6 are devoted to Cosmology. Chapter II, 7 is a sort of miscellaneous unit, dealing mainly with noetics, that goes back to another attribute of the Necessary Existent, namely Its knowledge of Itself and of the universe (i.e. Its providence, which entails a Theodicy), and provides a first account of Eschatology. Chapter II, 8 takes into account *ex professo* Eschatology (Michot [1983], p. 50: ". . . le texte des *Ishārāt* dont nous venons d'évoquer le contenu nous est paru d'un grand intérêt car ce que le philosophe propose dans ses deux premières parties, c'est en fait un réexamen des principaux thèmes qu'il étudie ailleurs, par exemple à la fin de la *Métaphysique* du *Shifāʾ*, dans les exposés qu'il consacre explicitement au *maʿād*, au retour, c'est-à-dire à la vie future"). Also chapter II, 9 deals with Eschatology: it is a reworking, according to an original pattern and some sufi terminology, of many doctrines that Avicenna expounds in *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 7 (see Gutas [2000], pp. 163–165 and n. 14). Finally, chapter II, 10 is devoted to Prophetology (see Goichon [1951], p. 514, n. 2: "Dans cet ouvrage, Ibn Sīnā suit donc la même progression de pensée que dans le *Šifāʾ* et la *Naǧāt*, qui s'achèvent pour ainsi dire, sur l'étude de la prophétie"). Apart from the fact that Theodicy comes after Cosmology, not before it, the structure of OntologyC/Theology in the *Išārāt* is the same as in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

[106] See Badawī's introduction in Avicenna [1980b], p. vii.

[107] In the opening lines (p. 47, 4–15)—resembling in content chapter I, 2 of the *Ilāhiyyāt*'s Prolegomena—"existent" is declared to be the subject-matter of meta-

about the structure of metaphysics can be gained from the actual content of the metaphysical section of this work: it consists of a single unit, which can be divided tentatively into a scanty treatment of both OntologyS and OntologyP, whose distinction, however, is fluid,[108] and a treatment of OntologyC/Theology.[109] Henology is missing.[110] OntologyC/Theology treats three topics: God's existence,[111] the description of Its nature,[112] and Eschatology.[113]

The metaphysical section of the *Dānešnāme*, after logic and before natural philosophy and mathematics, starts with two preliminary chapters that echo some themes dealt with in the Prolegomena of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[114] The second of these chapters implies a division of metaphysics into OntologyS-P, on the one hand, and OntologyC/Theology,[115] on the other, even though this bipartition is not immediately visible in the concrete structure of the work, where OntologyS (chapters 3–11)[116] is followed by OntologyP (chapters 12–18)[117] and

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physics, whereas the things searched by this discipline are subsumed under a sole rubric, that of the "essential accidents" (*'awāriḍ ḏātiyya*) of "existent". As examples of these latter Avicenna provides "one" and "many", "universal" and "particular", "act" and "potency" and causality. Even though these concepts represent properties of "existent", and in the opening lines no mention is made of its species, the doctrine of "existent" in the rest of the work consists not only of OntologyP, but also of OntologyS.

[108] A first treatment of the species of "existent" (essentially the category of substance, pp. 47, 15–49, 15) is followed by the analysis of its properties (potency and cause, pp. 49, 17–53, 2), by a second treatment of its species (substance and accidents, pp. 53, 4–55, 2), and by the analysis of some other properties (necessary and possible applied to "existent"—as in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 6–7—and universal, pp. 55, 2–57, 6).

[109] Avicenna [1980b], pp. 57, 7–60, 10.

[110] Avicenna refers, *en passant*, to unity and multiplicity in the section of the work devoted to the analysis of "universal" (pp. 56, 5–57, 6).

[111] Avicenna [1980b], p. 57, 7–11.

[112] Avicenna [1980b], pp. 57, 12–59, 13.

[113] Avicenna [1980b], pp. 59, 13–60, 10; cp. Gutas [1988], pp. 258–259 and n. 41.

[114] The first chapter can be considered an introduction to theoretical philosophy in general: it deals with the division of the sciences (cp. *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 1, pp. 3, 11–5, 1 [pp. 1, 7–3, 34]). Chapter 2 takes into account the subject-matter and the things searched by metaphysics (cp. *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 2), and the rank of this discipline with respect to natural philosophy and mathematics (cp. *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 3, pp. 19, 1–21, 11 [pp. 20, 77–24, 44]).

[115] In chapter 2 the "states" of "existent" investigated by metaphysics are sharply distinguished from its causes (see Morewedge [1973], p. 14). The term "states" appears to refer here to both species and properties (see Appendix F, III).

[116] The first part of chapter 3 (Morewedge [1973], p. 15) deals with "existent" as primary concept (cp. *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 5, pp. 29, 5–30, 11 [pp. 31, 2–33, 36]), whereas

by OntologyC/Theology (chapters 19–57) without any clear break of continuity.[118] No explicit distinction between species and properties of "existent" occurs anywhere. Henology is possibly alluded to in chapter 2,[119] but actually occurs in chapter 13: the treatment of the species and properties of "one" and of the species and properties of "many" (HenologyS-P), however, has no structural independence, but is just an element of OntologyP. OntologyC/Theology encompasses, differently ordered, three of the six topics of the *Ilāhiyyāt*'s OntologyC/Theology (God's nature, Eschatology, Cosmology).[120]

The introductory remarks of the metaphysical section of the *Hidāya* allude to the bipartition of metaphysics in OntologyS-P, on the one hand, and OntologyC/Theology, on the other, and to the greater importance of OntologyC/Theology with regard to OntologyS-P.[121] In the actual structure of the work, OntologyS is separated from OntologyP, both of which are followed by an independent treatment of the species of "one" (HenologyS).[122] The eminence of OntologyC/

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its second part (Morewedge [1975], pp. 15–16) and the following eight chapters (4–11) are devoted to OntologyS: the species of "existent" taken into account are substance (chs. 3–8) and accidents (ch. 9), with particular attention to quantity and quality (ch. 10). The last chapter of OntologyS (ch. 11) deals with the way in which "existent" is predicated of the categories (cp. *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2 [p. 40, 46–53]).

[117] OntologyP encompasses the treatment of "universal" and "particular" (ch. 12), "one" and "many" (ch. 13), "prior" and "posterior" (ch. 14; see also ch. 16), "cause" and "effect" (chs. 15–16), "potency" and "act" (ch. 17), and an analysis of "necessary" and "possible" as applied to "existent" (ch. 18; cp. *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 6–7), which constitutes the transition to OntologyC/Theology.

[118] The last chapter of OntologyS-P (ch. 18) can be regarded as the beginning of OntologyC/Theology, whereas the second chapter of OntologyC/Theology (ch. 20) still belongs to OntologyS-P (see above, n. 117, and below, n. 120).

[119] In this chapter "one" and "many", "to be in agreement" and "to be in disagreement" are mentioned apart from the other "states" of "existent"; see Morewedge [1973], p. 14.

[120] Within OntologyC/Theology (chs. 19–57), chapters 19–37 deal with God's nature, chapter 37 takes into account also Eschatology, and chapters 38–57 deal with Cosmology. Eschatology, thus, is placed before Cosmology. Chapter 20, however, breaks the continuity of OntologyC/Theology, and would fit better in an ontological context: its title mentions the "possible existent" (see chapter 18), and its content is a general discussion of the causal relationship between the cause of existence and its effect (see chapters 15–16). See Morewedge [1973], p. 206.

[121] Avicenna [1974], ch. 1, p. 232, 4–7. In this pericope, "what occurs" (*mā ya'riḍu*) to "existent *qua* existent" is presented as the object of investigation of metaphysics, whereas the study of the first principles is called the "perfection" (*tamām*) of this discipline.

[122] After a few lines elucidating the mode of predication of "existent" (ch. 1,

Theology over OntologyS-P is confirmed by the fact that only the first chapter of the work is devoted to the latter, whereas the remaining five deal with the former. Of the five theological chapters, chapter 2 deals with the distinction of Necessary Existent and possible existent, and with the nature of the Necessary Existent; chapters 3–4 with Cosmology; chapter 5 with Prophetology; chapter 6 with Eschatology. The absence of a proof of God's existence, and the precedence of Prophetology over Eschatology in OntologyC/Theology is noteworthy.[123]

In the metaphysical section of the *Naǧāt*, the structure of metaphysics is clearly formulated in the opening four chapters (I, 1–4),[124] and consistently accomplished in the rest of the work. Chapter I, 1 is a sort of general introduction, in which Avicenna alludes to the tripartition of metaphysics into OntologyS, OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology.[125] Chapters I, 2–4 are an introduction to OntologyS and OntologyP in particular: after portraying metaphysics in I, 2 not only as an Ontology, but also as a Henology, and providing in I, 3 a distinction equivalent to that between species and properties of a subject-matter,[126] in the first part of I, 4 Avicenna gives a preliminary

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p. 232, 9–12; cp. *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2 [p. 40, 46–53]), the first chapter of the work contains OntologyS (substance, pp. 232, 12–238, 7), OntologyP (anterior and posterior, cause, and universal, pp. 239, 2–255, 3) and HenologyS (species of "one", p. 255, 6–259, 6).

[123] See Gutas [1988], pp. 258–259.

[124] Chapters I, 1–3 and the first half of chapter I, 4 in the *Naǧāt* roughly correspond to *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2. A pericope of *Naǧāt* I, 4 (p. 496, 1–3; cp. Avicenna [1938], p. 200, 3–5)—in which Avicenna contends that "existent" is a primary concept—has a more extensive parallel in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5, pp. 29, 5–30, 11 [pp. 31, 2–33, 36].

[125] The tripartition of "states" (*aḥwāl*), "attributes" (*lawāḥiq*) and "principles" (*mabādiʾ*) of absolute "existent" in *Naǧāt* I, 1 (p. 493, 4–5; cp. Avicenna [1938], p. 198, 5)—rephrased immediately thereafter as a tripartition of "condition" (*amr*), "attributes that pertain to it *per se*" (*lawāḥiq allatī lahū bi-ḏātihī*) and "principles" (p. 495, 6–7; p. 198, 6)—prefigures the division of metaphysics in OntologyS, OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology. In *Naǧāt* I, 3–4, Avicenna uses the term "states" in order to explain how a subject-matter "gets divided" (*yanqasimu*)—even though the division in question is distinct from the division into species—and employs the term "attributes" to refer to the properties of "one" and "many" (see below, n. 126, and Appendix F, III).

[126] In I, 3, pp. 494, 4–495, 4 (cp. Avicenna [1938], pp. 198, 18–199, 8), Avicenna classifies the attributes of a thing into essential and non-essential, the essential ones into those that are more particular than the thing of which they are attributes and those that are not, and the essential and more particular ones into "specific differences" (*fuṣūl*) and "(proper) accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*), which divide the thing, respectively, into "species" (*anwāʿ*) and "states" (*ḥālāt*). At the beginning of the following chapter (I, 4, p. 495, 10–11; cp. Avicenna [1938], p. 199, 13–14), the "states" are called "acci-

account of OntologyS, OntologyP, HenologyS and HenologyP.[127] As to the concrete structure, the metaphysical part of the *Naǧāt* consists of two treatises, the former including OntologyS, OntologyP, HenologyS and HenologyP, the latter devoted to OntologyC/Theology. The first treatise can be further subdivided into two consecutive parts, dealing respectively with OntologyS and OntologyP, and HenologyS and HenologyP.[128] HenologyS and HenologyP, however, are not clearly separated from one another.[129] OntologyC/Theology in the second treatise encompasses seven topics, one more than in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The first three chapters (II, 1–3) take into account the Necessary

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dental sections" (*fuṣūl ʿaraḍiyya*) and "types" (*aṣnāf*). Also in the *Naǧāt*, therefore, the classification of the attributes of a subject-matter leads ultimately to the distinction between the "species", on the one hand, and the "(proper) accidents" producing the "accidental sections" (or "states", or "types"), on the other. Avicenna regards the "proper accidents" in question as more particular than the thing to which they belong probably because he refers to them singularly (as "odd", for example, with regard to number), not in couples ("odd and even").

[127] Avicenna [1985], p. 495, 6–20; cp. Avicenna [1938], pp. 199, 10–200, 3. OntologyS is said to focus on the categories, OntologyP on "potency" and "act", "one" and "many", "anterior" and "posterior", "perfect" and "imperfect", "cause" and "caused". Henology is described as dealing first with "one"—its species are "one" by genus, by species, by accident, by analogy and by number; its properties are equality, likeness, "correspondence" (*muṭābaqa*), homogeneity, conformability and "same"—then with "many"—its species are said to be opposite to those of "one"; its properties are otherness, opposition, unlikeness, unequality, non-homogeneity and non-conformability.

[128] The second half of chapter I, 4, and chapters I, 5–10 deal with OntologyS: particular attention is paid, among the categories, to substance, quantity and quality, whereas relation is not discussed. OntologyP covers chapters I, 11–21: "eternal", "coming-into-existence" and "universal" are added to the properties of "existent" mentioned in I, 4. The transition from OntologyP to Henology is marked by the title of chapter I, 22: "Chapter on the species of 'one' and 'many'" (Avicenna [1985], p. 544, 1; Avicenna [1938], p. 223, 20). In this chapter Avicenna deals first with the species of both "one" and "many" (HenologyS): the former are those enlisted in I, 4, with the addition of "one" by subject and "one" by universality (for example, the Sun); the latter are absolute and relative multiplicity, as in *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 5. Then he faces the properties of both "one" and "many" (HenologyP): the former are those mentioned in I, 4 plus "parallelism" (*muwāzāt*); among the latter, only opposition is recalled, and difference and contrariety are added. According to the program (I, 4), on the other hand, the species and properties of "one" should have been taken into account together, before the species and properties of "many". It has to be noticed that, despite the distinction of Ontology from Henology, "one" and "many" occur among the properties of "existent" in I, 4 (p. 495, 7–8; p. 199, 11), and "unity" is treated within OntologyP in I, 9.

[129] HenologyS and HenologyP are treated together in a chapter (I, 22), whose title mentions only the "species" (*anwāʿ*) of "one" and "many" (see above, n. 128).

Existent and the possible existent in themselves.[130] The elucidation of the Necessary Existent's nature both precedes (II, 4–11) and follows (II, 16–20) the proof of Its existence (II, 12–15). Cosmology (II, 21–36), Theodicy (II, 37), Eschatology (II, 38) and Prophetology (II, 39–40) follow.[131]

To summarize: in the works taken into account, the structure of metaphysics is increasingly complex. In the first stage of the process (*Maǧmūʿ*, *Išārāt*), almost no structural pattern is discernible (OntologyP represents a very brief introduction to OntologyC/Theology). In the second stage (*ʿUyūn*), the main bipartition (OntologyS and OntologyP, on the one hand, OntologyC/Theology, on the other) is present—as in all the following stages—but OntologyS is intermingled with OntologyP (OntologyS-P), and Henology is missing. In the third stage (*Dānešnāme*) OntologyS does not overlap with OntologyP—as in all the following stages—and Henology makes its first appearance; this latter comprehends all its elements (species and properties of both "one" and "many"), but constitutes a single unit (HenologyS-P) belonging to OntologyP. In the fourth stage (*Hidāya*), Henology becomes independent, but is limited in scope: it focuses only on the species of "one". In the final stage (*Naǧāt*), Henology is detached from Ontology and displays, albeit fluidly, an articulation in HenologyS and HenologyP.

In comparison with the *Ilāhiyyāt*, the main axis of metaphysics in the other works is less clearly articulated: in some of them (*Maǧmūʿ*, *Išārāt*) OntologyS is missing; in other (*ʿUyūn*) the distinction of OntologyS and OntologyP fades; even in the works in which OntologyS and OntologyP are separated from one another (*Dānešnāme*, *Hidāya*, *Naǧāt*), their distinction is not stated as openly as in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The only part of the main axis of metaphysics that is present everywhere is OntologyC/Theology. This attests to its importance on the structural level. In some of the other works, OntologyC/Theology is even more comprehensive and articulated than in the *Ilāhiyyāt*: this happens, significantly, both in the first stage of the sequence

[130] Chapters II, 1–4 and II, 11 resemble chapters I, 6–7 of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: as these, they deal with the Necessary Existent and Its unicity and with the possible existent.

[131] "Prophecy" is not mentioned in the title of chapter II, 39 of the *Naǧāt* as it is in the title of the corresponding chapter of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (X, 1).

(*Išārāt*),[132] and in the last (*Naǧāt*).[133] As to the secondary axis of metaphysics, in the works in which it occurs (*Dānešnāme, Hidāya* and *Naǧāt*), Henology plays a role much less prominent than in the *Ilāhiyyāt*: either it is encapsulated in OntologyP (*Dānešnāme*), or it follows it (*Hidāya, Naǧāt*), without running parallel to it as it does in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. As to the additional elements of metaphysics that we find in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, in the other works they are missing: with the only exception of the *Dānešnāme*, either nothing corresponds to the Prolegomena and the Introduction (*Maǧmūʿ, Išārāt*), or very partial correspondences can be detected (*ʿUyūn, Hidāya, Naǧāt*);[134] nothing is equivalent to the Appendix.

From the point of view of structure, hence, the *Ilāhiyyāt*'s originality is twofold. It lies, first of all, in the articulation of OntologyS and OntologyP as two independent units, distinct from OntologyC/Theology; and, second, in the emphasis on Henology as the second fundamental dimension of metaphysics.[135]

Little can be said with certainty about the structure of metaphysics in the *Mašriqiyyūn*, due to the loss of the metaphysical section of this work. From what remains of the *Mašriqiyyūn*, however, a noteworthy aspect of the structure of metaphysics can be surmised: OntologyC/Theology is sharply distinguished from the rest of metaphysics, and the two resulting parts of this discipline are designated by means of different names: "divine science" (*al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*) and "universal science"

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[132] The additional elements are chapter 7 on noetics, and the double treatment of the destiny of human souls in chapters 8–9.

[133] The additional element is the analysis of the Necessary Existent and the possible existent in themselves (II, 1–3).

[134] The presence of extensive Prolegomena is peculiar to the *Ilāhiyyāt* also within the *Šifāʾ*. In *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 12, 3–10, Avicenna mentions the "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) of philosophy in general, and the "end" (*ġāya*) of theoretical and practical philosophy in particular. *Madḫal* I, 3 and I, 4 investigate, respectively, the "utility" (*manfaʿa*) and "subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ*) of logic. *Maqūlāt* I, 1 takes into account the "goal" (*ġaraḍ*) of the part of logic corresponding to the *Categories*. Methodological remarks are present in *Samāʿ* I, 1, III, 1 and IV, 1: IV, 1 is devoted to describing the "goals" (*aġrāḍ*, p. 261, 3) of the fourth treatise.

[135] This implies a considerable expansion of the non-theological part of metaphysics: in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, OntologyS-P and HenologyS-P cover six treatises (II–VII) against the two treatises and half of OntologyC/Theology (VIII–X, 3). The proportion in the *Naǧāt*, for example, is the reverse: the first treatise (OntologyS-P and HenologyS-P) contains 21 chapters, the second (OntologyC/Theology) encompasses almost the double amount of chapters (40). The only exception is represented by the *ʿUyūn*, in which the extent of OntologyS-P is the double of that of OntologyC/Theology.

(*al-ʿilm al-kullī*).[136] This difference can be regarded as an expression of the more original and independent way of exposition that Avicenna avowedly follows in the *Mašriqiyyūn* in comparison to the *Šifāʾ*.[137]

6 Avicenna's antecedents: *Posterior Analytics*, *Metaphysics* Γ-E, Alexander of Aphrodisias, al-Fārābī

We have seen so far that the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is the combination of seven units (Prolegomena, Introduction, OntologyS, HenologyS, OntologyP, HenologyP, OntologyC/Theology). These units result from the intersection of two main vertical "doctrinal" axes (Ontology and Henology), with four horizontal "epistemological" layers (subject-matter, species, properties, causes).

The last section of this chapter investigates the sources of Avicenna's conception of the structure of metaphysics. Briefly put, three of the four horizontal layers (subject-matter, species and properties) derive originally from Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics*. In books Γ and E of the *Metaphysics*, Aristotle himself applies "theoretically", for the first time, the concepts of "species" and "properties", together with the fourth layer (causes), to the two vertical axes of metaphysics. Alexander of Aphrodisias emphasizes the importance of book Γ within the *Metaphysics*, comments on this work at the light of the epistemology of the *Posterior Analytics*, and underscores in its text some elements of the first vertical axis (OntologyP, OntologyC/Theology). Finally, al-Fārābī provides a first complete—albeit "abstract" and, on particular points,

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[136] Avicenna [1910], p. 7, 5–7; p. 8, 9–10; see Gutas [1988], p. 254; Pines [1952], p. 27 and n. 2; Gutas [2000], p. 167. See Appendix D, III. In the introductory classification of the sciences, "divine science" is mentioned before "universal science" (p. 7, 5–7; see Gutas [1988], p. 124); in the description of the content of the work (p. 8, 8–14), on the other hand, the former is mentioned after the latter (p. 8, 9–10; see Gutas [2000], p. 169).

[137] See, in general, the Introduction to the *Mašriqiyyūn* (pp. 2–4; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 43–49) and the reference to the *Mašriqiyyūn* in the Prologue to the *Šifāʾ* (p. 10, 11–13, 15; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 52–53). In *Mašriqiyyūn*, p. 7, 5–7 (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 254), Avicenna states that "it is customary" (*qad ǧarat al-ʿāda*) to call "Natural Philosophy", "Mathematics", "Divine Science" and "Universal Science" the four parts of theoretical philosophy, and, somehow inconsistently, that "this division" (i.e. the bipartition of metaphysics) is not "generally acknowledged" (*mutaʿārif*). He probably means that the names of the two parts of metaphysics are traditional, whereas their application to distinct parts of this discipline is an innovation.

vague—sketch of this discipline according to all the aforementioned layers and axes. This development towards completeness (i.e. epistemological articulation), precision (i.e. conceptual clarity) and concreteness (i.e. correspondence with the actual text of the *Metaphysics*) reaches its final stage with Avicenna.

In what follows I will take into account each of these four antecedents of Avicenna. Preliminarily, I will describe how the issue of the structure of the *Metaphysics* was perceived as problematic before Avicenna.

6.1 *The issue of the structure of the* Metaphysics *in Greek and pre-Avicennian Arabic philosophy*

The first sign of dissatisfaction with the arrangement of the *Metaphysics* among Aristotelian interpreters dates back to Nicholas of Damascus, around the beginning of the Christian era, whose views on this issue are reported and strongly opposed by Averroes in the *Tafsīr*. Averroes says:

> Text 6: Averroes, *Tafsīr*, p. 1405, 6–8
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> Nothing in them [i.e. in the books of the *Metaphysics*] is without [proper] arrangement (*tartīb*) and order (*niẓām*), contrarily to what we find that Nicholas of Damascus states in his book [i.e. in his exposition of Aristotle's philosophy], [where] he chooses, in order to explain this science, a better arrangement, according to what he states, than the present one.[138]

Seven centuries after Nicholas, the issue surfaces again among interpreters of the *Metaphysics* in Late Antiquity. One of the preliminary topics discussed in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary on the *Metaphysics* (VI century AD) is the way according to which the *Metaphysics* is organized (ὁ τρόπος τῆς συντάξεως).[139] Whithin the discussion of this topic, Ammonius/Asclepius points out that the *Metaphysics* lacks a rigorous order, as a consequence of significant omissions and repetitions:

> Text 7: Ammonius/Asclepius, *In Metaph.* p. 4, 4–8
>
> The present treatise [i.e. the *Metaphysics*] is arranged differently from the other [treatises] of Aristotle, and does not seem to have good order and continuity. Rather, some [parts] useful for the discourse's continuity [seem] to be missing, while some other [seem] to be transferred [here] in their entirety from other treatises, [so that Aristotle] says the same things more than once.

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[138] Cp. Genequand [1984], p. 65; Martin [1984], p. 42.
[139] Asclepius [1888], p. 4, 4–16. See Chapter 3, n. 26.

After Text 7, Ammonius/Asclepius reports an explanation, which he approves as historically correct, of the disorder affecting the *Metaphysics*, and in this context he mentions Eudemus of Rhodes (IV–III century BC), one of the earliest and most prominent disciples of Aristotle:

> Text 8: Ammonius/Asclepius *In Metaph.*, p. 4, 8–15
> Someone provides the reason of this, and well does so, [saying] that [Aristotle], after he wrote the present treatise, sent it to his disciple Eudemus of Rhodes, who later thought not to be good, as it happened, to divulgate such an extensive treatise [or: such an important treatise, τηλικαύτην πραγματείαν]. In the meantime [Aristotle] died and some [parts] of the book got lost. The successors, not daring to add [anything] on their own, because very much of the man's [i.e. of Aristotle's] thought was missing, transposed the parts missing from his other treatises, adapting [them] as well as possible.[140]

The historical value of Ammonius/Asclepius' report of the vicissitudes of the *Metaphysics* is debated,[141] and many of its elements are obscure.[142] It is impossible to say whether already Eudemus regarded the structure of the *Metaphysics* as problematic.[143] What is sure, on the other hand, is that the author(s) whose view Ammonius/Asclepius is reporting ("Someone") perceived the arrangement of the *Metaphysics* as incoherent, felt the need to explain such a situation, and pointed at the loss of some parts of the original version of this work, and the restoration later attempted by some unnamed scholars, as its cause.

At the end of the pericope, Ammonius/Asclepius assignes the interpreter of the *Metaphysics* the task of finding out its original order:

> Text 9: Ammonius/Asclepius In Metaph., p. 4, 15–16
> However, also in these [i.e. in the original parts of the *Metaphysics*] one can find preserved the consistency of what is said.

Thus, among the Greek disciples and commentators of Aristotle, we have a significant chain of interpreters—starting possibly with Eudemus

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[140] Cp. Eudemus of Rhodes [1969], fr. 3, p. 9, 17–23.

[141] The historicity of the report is questioned by Wehrli [1969], p. 78; Gottschalk [2002], p. 33. It is defended by Berti [1982]; Dorandi [2002], pp. 44–47.

[142] It is not clear what is Ammonius/Asclepius' source, who are the successors of Aristotle that revised the *Metaphysics*, and what precisely they added to this work. Berti [1982] (followed by Dorandi [2002]), thinks, respectively, of (i) Andronicus of Rhodes; (ii) Eudemus, Praxiphanes of Mitylene and Hieronimus of Rhodes; (ii) book α.

[143] His perplexity about the opportunity of divulgating the original version of this work is allegedly due to its extent (or, according to another possible interpretation of the adjective τηλικαύτην, its importance), not to its lack of order.

of Rhodes, passing through Nicholas of Damascus and the source of Ammonius/Asclepius' report, and ending with Ammonius and Asclepius themselves—who regarded the structure of the *Metaphysics* as an issue to be taken into proper account.[144]

In the tenth century, the problem of structure is addressed again, with regard to the Aristotelian *corpus* in general, in al-Fārābī's *Ǧamʿ*.[145] In a passage of this work al-Fārābī contends that Plato's and Aristotle's apparently different ways of recording sciences and composing books are, in fact, similar: Plato, initially reluctant to provide a written record of his thought, finally resolved to write books whose symbols and allegories could be understood only by competent readers; but also Aristotle—whose aim is, allegedly, "to elucidate, record, arrange in order (*al-tartīb*), communicate, uncover, expound and to treat exhaustively"—for similar reasons, endeavoured to render the subjects he dealt with cryptic and intricate.[146] The intentional obscurity of Aristotle's works is portrayed by al-Fārābī as the effect of peculiarities regarding, among other things, their structure. Here is the relevant text:

> Text 10: Al-Fārābī, *Ǧamʿ*, p. 75, 6–13
>
> [a] The *order, arrangement, and plan* (*al-nazm wa-l-tartīb wa-l-rasm*) of his scientific [i.e. acroatic] works are such that make one think that these are his peculiar characteristics, from which it is impossible for him to deviate. But when his [exoteric] epistles are examined closely, it is found that what he says in them is *structured and ordered* (*mansūqan wa-manzūman*) according to *plans and arrangements* (*rusūm wa-tartībāt*) which differ from those in the [acroatic] books.
>
> [b] It is sufficient for us [to mention here] his well-known letter to Plato in response to what Plato had written to him, reprimanding him for writing books and classifying the sciences, and making them public in his complete and penetrating works. Aristotle clarified the matter in this letter to Plato, and said: "Although I have recorded [in writ-

[144] Some Greek manuscripts of the *Metaphysics*—among which Laurentianus 87, 12 (Ab, 12th c.) and Laurentianus 81, 1 (S, 13th c.)—present the last four books of the work in the order MNKΛ (see Nicholas of Damascus [1965], p. 32, n. 16), thus emphasizing the role of Λ and reducing the relevance of M-N. See Kahn [1985], p. 334: "The critique of abstract substances in M-N is the negative counterpart to ousiology; it is not clear to me whether Aristotle intended it to come before or after the theology of Λ".

[145] See Chapter 3, §5 (i).

[146] Al-Fārābī, *Ǧamʿ*, pp. 71, 6–77, 3 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], pp. 5, 22–7, 10; Al-Fārābī [1960], pp. 84, 11–85, 21); Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 228–229.

> ing] these sciences and the philosophical doctrines which they contain, *I have nevertheless arranged them in a way* (*rattabtuhā tartīban*) that will be accessible only to their adherents, and expressed them in ways that will be comprehended only by their practicioners" (emphasis added).[147]

The frequency of terms like "order", "arrangement", "plan" and "structure" in this text makes sufficiently clear that the "obfuscating" defect of the Aristotelian *corpus* that al-Fārābī is dealing with is the imperfect structure of the single works.[148]

Finally, changes in the structure of the *Metaphysics* occur in the Arabic tradition of this work: the first Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics* (Usṭāṭ) omits probably book A and starts with book α; this latter remained the opening book of the Arabic *Metaphysics* even when book A was later translated into Arabic: Averroes, for example, first comments on α, and then on A.[149]

6.2 *The* Posterior Analytics

The distinction between the subject-matter of a science and the things searched in it, and the further articulation of the things searched in a science into species and properties of the subject-matter—that is to say, three of the four epistemological layers of the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (subject-matter, species and properties)—come ultimately from Avicenna's understanding of Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics*. The relevant texts—i.e. the Arabic translation of *An. Post.* A, 10, 76b11–22, Avicenna's paraphrase of this pericope of the *Posterior*

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[147] Cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 7, 1–8; Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 85, 13–20; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 229 (modified).

[148] Significantly, the original version of the letter that al-Fārābī reports in part [b]—probably a pseudoepigraphic letter by Aristotle to Alexander the Great, rather than Plato, referred to in Gellius' *Noctes Acticae* (Aristotle [1977], p. 28; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 226; see Al-Fārābī, *Ǧamʿ*, p. 74, n. 1; Gottschalk [2002], p. 33 and n. 15)—does not mention the inconsequent structuring as a device used by Aristotle to make his works inaccessible and incomprehensible: the reference to structure has been added either by al-Fārābī himself or in an intermediate stage of the transmission of this letter, and witnesses to the increasing concern with the issue at stake in the development of the Aristotelian tradition. In Text 10 al-Fārābī might be referring to the overall structure of the Aristotelian *corpus*, rather than to the structure of Aristotle's single works: but this is unlikely, since, in this case, Plato's criticism of Aristotle reported in section [b], with regard to Aristotle's classification of the sciences (lit.: arrangement of the sciences, *tartīb li-l-ʿulūm*)—that Plato must have found clear and accessible—would be pointless.

[149] See Chapter 1, §1.1, §2.

Analytics in the *Burhān*, and the reference to this passage of the *Burhān* in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1—have been already discussed in Chapter 4, with particular regard to the distinction between subject-matter and things searched. I report them again in what follows, in order to provide a more comprehensive analysis.

Text 11.1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, p. 5, 1–4 [p. 3, 35–40] (= Chapter 4, Text 2.1)

It has not appeared clearly to you from this [i.e. from the previous books of the *Šifāʾ*] what the subject-matter of the divine science really is, apart from a pointer occurring in the *Book of Demonstration* in logic, if you remember: namely that in the other sciences you had [i] something that is the subject-matter (*mawḍūʿ*), [ii] some things that are the things searched (*al-maṭlūba*), and [iii] some admitted principles from which the demonstrations are composed.

Text 11.2: *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 4–12 (= Chapter 4, Text 8.1)

We say that every discipline—especially the theoretical one—has [i] principles, [ii] subject-matters (*mawḍūʿāt*) and [iii] questions (*masāʾil*). [i] Principles are the premises from which that discipline demonstrates, without them being demonstrated in that discipline, either because they are evident, or because they are of too high a rank to be demonstrated in it, and are demonstrated only in a superior science, or because they are of too low a rank to be demonstrated in that science, but rather [they are demonstrated] in an inferior science (even though this is rare). [ii] Subject-matters are the things of which the discipline investigates only the states (*aḥwāl*) related to them, and the essential accidents (*al-ʿawāriḍ al-d̲ātiyya*) belonging to them. [iii] Questions are the propositions whose predicates are the essential accidents (*ʿawāriḍ d̲ātiyya*) of this subject-matter, or of its species (*anwāʿ*), or of its accidents (*ʿawāriḍ*); doubts arise about them, and hence their state is clarified in that science.

Principles are the things from which the demonstrative proof is, questions are the things of which the demonstrative proof is, subject-matters are the things about which the demonstrative proof is. It is as if the purpose of that about which the demonstrative proof is were the essential accidents, [the purpose of] that for the sake of which that [i.e. the demonstrative proof] is were the subject-matter, and [the purpose of that] from which [the demonstrative proof is] were the principles.

Text 11.3: Arabic translation of *An. Post.* A, 10, 76b11–22 (= Chapter 4, Text 8.2)

For every demonstrative science is three things: [i] one are the things that we posit as existent, namely that [particular] genus [*d̲ālika l-ǧins*, τὸ γένος], of which it considers the affections belonging to it by themselves [*al-taʾṯīrāt al-mawǧūda lahū bi-d̲ātihā*, τῶν καθ' αὐτὰ παθημάτων]);

> and [ii] the well-known knowledges called "common", namely the first [things] from which (*al-awā'il allatī minhā*, ἐξ ὧν πρώτων) they first clarify [the other things]; and third [iii] the affections (*al-ta'ṯīrāt*, τὰ πάθη), namely those of which they assume what each of them signifies. [. . .] In the same way, nonetheless, there is the existence of these three things in the clarification of nature, I mean that about which [the science] demonstrates, the things that it demonstrates and the things from which it [demonstrates].

In Text 11.3 three elements are singled out: [i] the things representing "the genus" (*al-ǧins*, τὸ γένος), [ii] "the first things" (*al-awā'il*, τὰ πρώτα) from which scientific clarification proceeds, and [iii] the "affections" (*al-ta'ṯīrāt*, τὰ πάθη) of the genus, qualified in [i] as "affections belonging to it (i.e. to the genus) by themselves (i.e. *per se*)" (*al-ta'ṯīrāt al-mawǧūda lahū bi-ḏātihā*, τὰ καθ' αὑτὰ παθήματα). Element [ii] regards the logical principles of every scientific knowledge, namely the axioms of non-contradiction and excluded-middle, and not the ontological causes and principles taken into account by Avicenna in OntologyC/Theology.

In Text 11.2, summarized in Text 11.1, Avicenna calls "subject-matter" (*mawḍūʿ*) the genus ([ii]), and "questions" (*masā'il*) or "things searched" (*maṭlūba*) the affections ([iii]) of Text 11.3. In part [ii] Avicenna mentions, besides the "essential accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ ḏātiyya*) corresponding to the "affections *per se*" of Text 11.3 [i], also the "states" (*aḥwāl*) of a discipline's subject-matter. In part [iii], the subject-matter is said to have "essential accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ ḏātiyya*), "species" (*anwāʿ*) and "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*): whereas the "species" appear to correspond to the "states" mentioned in part [ii], the difference, if any, between "essential accidents" and "accidents" remains obscure.[150] Thus, the main point of Text 11.2 lies in the distinction between species (or states) and essential accidents (or accidents) of a scientific subject-matter.

This distinction is taken, in all likelihood, from another passage of the *Posterior Analytics* (*An. Post.* A, 28, 87a38–39), where Aristotle distinguishes the "parts" and the "attributes" of a scientific subject-matter. I report first Avicenna's paraphrase of this Aristotelian passage in the *Burhān* (Text 11.4), and then the Arabic translation of the passage itself (Text 11.5).

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[150] The "accidents" and the "species" of the subject-matter are cryptically described in [iii] as having, in their turn, "essential accidents".

Text 11.4: *Burhān* III, 8, p. 247, 3–5

[Different] investigations belong to a single science only [a] when they share the first subject-matter and concern nothing else than the essential accidents (*al-ʿawāriḍ al-ḏātiyya*) occurring to it, or to its parts (*aǧzāʾ*), or to its species (*anwāʿ*), and [b] when they share the first principles from which those essential accidents are demonstrated as belonging to the first subject-matter, or to its parts (*aǧzāʾ*), or to its species (*anwāʿ*).

Text 11.5: Arabic translation of *An. Post.* A, 28, 87a38–39

As to the science [that is] one, it is that which clarifies, with regard to one genus (*ǧins wāḥid*, ἑνὸς γένους), all the things that are composed from first principles (*mabādiʾ uwal*, ἐκ τῶν πρώτων) and are parts (*aǧzāʾ*, μέρη) of these, or the things that are consequent [attributes] of these in themselves (*al-ašyāʾ al-lāzima lahā bi-ḏātihā*, πάθη τούτων καθ' αὐτά).[151]

Text 11.5 is not completely clear: it is difficult to understand whether the "parts" (*aǧzāʾ*, μέρη) and the "things that are consequent [attributes] in themselves" (*al-ašyāʾ al-lāzima bi-ḏātihā*, πάθη καθ' αὐτά) are meant to belong to the genus (i.e. to the subject-matter) or to the first principles.[152] Avicenna's interpretation goes openly in the former direction. But even Avicenna's Text 11.4 is not without difficulties.[153] What is important for our purposes is that in Text 11.4 Avicenna associates the "parts" of the subject-matter to its "species", probably taking the latter as synonym of the former.

If now we go back to Text 11.2, we see that the terms that Avicenna uses are exactly those that he employs in Text 2 and afferents (see above, Table 1): "subject-matter", "questions", "species" or "states", "(essential) accidents" (i.e. "proper accidents"). In other words, the passages of the *Posterior Analytics* that Avicenna paraphrases in Texts 11.2 and 11.4 are the place of origin of the distinction between a scientific subject-matter, its species and its properties, which produces the first three epistemological layers of the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

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[151] Aristotle [1999], vol. I, p. 533, 3–4 (cp. Aristotle [1948–52], vol. II, p. 395, 13–14). "A science is one if it is of [i] one genus (ἑνὸς γένους)—of whatever things are composed from [ii] the primitives and are [iv] parts or [iii] attributes of these [i.e. of the things composed from the primitives] in themselves" (slightly modified).

[152] In Barnes [1993], p. 190, both possibilities are left open.

[153] In Text 11.4, as in Text 11.2, the parts and species of the subject-matter have essential accidents, as the subject-matter itself.

6.3 *Metaphysics Γ, 1–2 and E, 1*

In the *Posterior Analytics* the aforementioned epistemological concepts are considered in general, without any special application to metaphysics. In two main places of the *Metaphysics* (Γ, 1–2 and E, 1), however, Aristotle himself refers some of them to metaphysics.[154] The application to metaphysics of the concept of "subject-matter" ("genus" in Aristotelian terms) is prevented by Aristotle's view of "being" as a non-generic concept, as we have seen in Chapter 4.[155] Nonetheless, in *Metaph.* Γ, 1–2 and E, 1, Aristotle applies to "being", as the main theme of metaphysics, and to "one" and "many", as concepts intimately linked to "being" and as fundamental concerns of metaphysics, the distinction between species and properties, that in the *Posterior Analytics* regards the subject-matter of science; in this way, he points at the existence, within metaphysics, of OntologyS, OntologyP, HenologyS and HenologyP. Furthermore, he provides also the fourth epistemological layer (causes), which he applies to "being", thus hinting at the presence of OntologyC/Theology in metaphysics.

In the Arabic translation of Γ, 1–2 and E, 1, Aristotle assigns to metaphysics—described as the science of "being qua being", literally of "being with regard to its nature" (*al-huwiyya ʿalā kunhihā*, τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὄν), or related expressions—the investigation of the properties of "being". They are called "the things that belong to being in virtue of its essence" (*al-ašyāʾ allatī hiya li-l-huwiyya bi-ḏātihā*, τὰ τούτῳ ὑπάρχοντα καθ' αὑτό) in Text 12.1 (cp. the equivalent expressions in Texts 12.3–4), and "proper affections" (*ālām ḫāṣṣa*, ἴδια) in Text 12.2:[156]

> Text 12.1: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 1, 1003a20–21 (= Chapter 4, Text 9)
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> Aristotle says that to one science belongs the theoretical study of "being" with regard to its nature (*al-huwiyya ʿalā kunhihā*, τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὄν) and

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[154] The doctrine of *An. Post.* A, 10, 76b11–22 (= Text 11.3) is recalled also in *Metaph.* B, 2, 997a6–9 (discussion of aporia 2) and 997a19–21 (discussion of aporia 3). Another doctrine of the *Posterior Analytics* (there is no demonstration of substance, *An. Post.* B, 3–8) is resumed in 997a31–32 (discussion of aporia 4, whose solution is provided in Γ, 2, 1004a31–34). In book B, however, the epistemology of the *Posterior Analytics* is employed in an aporetic context and is not positively applied to metaphysics, as in Γ, 1–2 and E, 1. On the reception of the *Posterior Analytics* in the *Metaphysics*, see Bell [2004].

[155] See Chapter 4, §2.1.

[156] On the difference between attributes of "being *qua* being" and properties, and between attributes of "being" *per se* (καθ' αὑτὸ) and attributes *per se* (καθ' αὑτά) of "being", see Leszl [1975], pp. 313–315.

the theoretical study of the things that belong to "being" in virtue of its [or: their] essence (*al-ašyā' allatī hiya li-l-huwiyya bi-ḏātihā*, τὰ τούτῳ ὑπάρχοντα καθ' αὑτό; καθ' αὑτά in Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary).

Text 12.2: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004b15–17

In the same way, also "being" in virtue of its nature (*al-huwiyya bi-kunhihā*, τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὄν) has proper affections (*ālām ḫāṣṣa*, ἴδια), and these affections are those which the philosopher has to examine.[157]

Text 12.3: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1005a13–14

It is known then that to one science belongs the theoretical study of "being" with regard to its nature and of the things related to "being" according to its nature (*al-ašyā'u llatī tunsabu ilā l-huwiyyati ʿalā kunhihā*, τὰ ὑπάρχοντα αὐτῷ ᾗ ὄν).[158]

Text 12.4: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Ε, 1, 1026a31–32

Since it belongs to it the theoretical study of "being" in so far as it is "being" (*al-huwiyya bi-annahā huwiyya*, τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὄν), of what it is, and of what belongs to it in so far as it is ["being"] . . . (*mā lahā bi-annahā [i.e. huwiyya]*, τὰ ὑπάρχοντα ᾗ ὄν).[159]

Even though "being", according to Aristotle, is not a genus, "being *qua* being" in Γ, 2 displays, besides the aforementioned properties, also some "species" or "forms" (*ṣuwar*, εἴδη), whose nature is not further clarified:

Text 13: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1003b21–22

Therefore we say that the theoretical study of all the forms (*ṣuwar*, εἴδη) of "being" with regard to its nature belongs to a science [which is] one in virtue of the genus. As to the forms, they are forms of the forms (*fa-ammā l-ṣuwaru, fa-hiya ṣuwaru l-ṣuwari*, τά τε εἴδη τῶν εἰδῶν).[160]

Despite some slight terminological differences, Texts 12.1–4 and Text 13 appear to be the result of the application to metaphysics

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[157] *Tafsīr*, p. 325, 5–6. "So too being as such has certain properties, and it is about these that the philosopher has to investigate the truth" (slightly modified).

[158] *Tafsīr*, p. 331, 10–12. "Obviously then it is the work of one science to examine being *qua* being, and the attributes which belong to it *qua* being".

[159] *Tafsīr*, p. 714, 15. "And it will belong to this to consider being *qua* being—both what it is and the attributes which belong to it *qua* being".

[160] *Tafsīr*, p. 302, 5–7. "Therefore to investigate all the species of being *qua* being, is a work of a science which is generically one, and to investigate the several species is the work of the specific parts of the science". This is a controversial passage, variously explained by modern interpreters of Aristotle.

of the distinction between properties and species of a discipline's subject-matter, coming from the *Posterior Analytics*.

In Γ, 1 and E, 1—in accordance with the principle that knowledge is always knowledge of causes (see *Metaph.* A, 3, 983a25–26; α, 1, 993b23–24)—Aristotle enlists among the things that metaphysics has to investigate, besides the properties and the species of "being *qua* being", also its "causes" (*al-ʿilal*, τὰς πρώτας αἰτίας) and "principles" (*awāʾil*, αἱ ἀρχαὶ). These cause and principles are the metaphysical causes of "being" and have not to be confused with the logical axioms ("principles") mentioned in the *Posterior Analytics* (see above, Texts 11.1–3), even though they represent in the order of things what the axioms represent in the order of propositions.

> Text 14.1: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 1, 1003a31–32 (= Chapter 4, Text 7.1)
>
> Therefore we have to seek the causes (*al-ʿilal*, τὰς πρώτας αἰτίας) that affect "being" with regard to its nature.

> Text 14.2: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* E, 1, 1025b3–4 (= Chapter 4, Text 7.2)
>
> Aristotle says that the principles (*awāʾil*, αἱ ἀρχαὶ) of beings and their causes (*ʿilaluhā*, τὰ αἴτια) are seeked with regard to the fact that they are beings.

Texts 14.1–2 introduce, thus, the fourth horizontal layer of the structure of metaphysics (causes) with regard to the main axis of this discipline, namely the investigation of the causes of "being *qua* being", or OntologyC/Theology.

Even though metaphysics is, properly speaking, the science of "being", in Γ, 2 Aristotle underscores also the relevance of "one" for the epistemological status of this discipline. In the course of this chapter he tightly links "one" with "being": both are said in many ways (Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19, 1004a22–31) and are principles of contraries (1004b28), both are not universal and separate entities (1005a9). From the doctrine of the so-called "convertibility" of "being" and "one", he concludes to the existence of some species, literally "forms" (*ṣuwar*, εἴδη) of "one":

> Text 15: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1003b22–25, 33–35
>
> As to "one" and "being", if they are one thing and have one nature, then they follow each other as principle and cause follow each other, not because a single definition signifies both of them. [. . .] Thus, it is known that the forms (*ṣuwar*, εἴδη) of "one" are as many as the forms

(*ṣuwar*) of "being", and to one science belongs the absolute theoretical study of these forms and the knowledge of what they are.[161]

Like "being", "one" has not only species, but also properties, named this time "affections" concerning "one" "by their essence" (*bi-d̲ātihā ālām*, καθ' αὐτά πάθη):

Text 16: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004b5–8

Since, then, these things and their like are, by their essence, affections (*bi-d̲ātihā ālām*, καθ' αὐτά πάθη) of "one" alone and of "being" in virtue of its nature, and are not affections of "one" and "being" in so far as they are a number, or a line, or a fire, then it is known that to the science that grasps "one" and "being" belongs knowing what is "one", what is "being", and what are the accidents occurring to them (*al-aʿrāḍu llatī taʿriḍu lahumā*, τὰ συμβεβηκότ' αὐτοῖς).[162]

Since it deals with "one", metaphysics investigates also "plurality" (*al-kaṯ̲ra*, πλῆθος), a point entailed, albeit not expressly stated, by Aristotle:

Text 17: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004a9–10

Since the theoretical study of opposites necessarily belongs to one science, and the opposite of unity is plurality (*al-kaṯ̲ra*, πλῆθος) [. . .].[163]

The aforementioned passages of Γ, 1–2 and E, 1, thus, display Aristotle's version of the main axis of metaphysics (OntologyS, OntologyP, OntologyC/Theology) and of its secondary axis (HenologyS and HenologyP).[164]

As to the precise identity of the species and properties of "being", "one" and "plurality", immediately after Text 15 Aristotle maintains

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[161] *Tafsīr*, pp. 310, 2–4; 311, 2. "If, now, being and unity are the same and are one thing in the sense that they are implied in one another as principles and causes are, not in the sense that they are explained by the same formula [. . .]—all this being so, there must be exactly as many species of being as of unity. And to investigate the essence of these is the work of a science which is generically one".

[162] *Tafsīr*, pp. 324, 8–12. "Since, then, these are affections *per se* of unity *qua* unity and of being *qua* being, not *qua* numbers or lines or fire, it is clear that it belongs to this science to investigate both the essence of these concepts and their accidents" (slightly modified). See Cassin-Narcy [1989], p. 172 (Ross in Aristotle [1924] and Kirwan [1971] do not comment on this passage).

[163] *Tafsīr*, p. 316, 14–16. "Now since it is the work of one science to investigate opposites, and plurality is opposite to unity [. . .]".

[164] The doctrinal relevance and historical significance of these two aspects of metaphysics emerging from Γ, 1–2 and E, 1 are emphasized by modern interpreters of Aristotle (see, for example, Reale [1994]).

that "same" (*al-muttafiq*, ταὐτὸ), "similar" (*al-šabīh*, ὅμοιον) and "the things resembling these" (*al-ašyā' allatī tušbihu hādihi*, τὰ ἄλλα τὰ τοιοῦτα) are species of "one".[165] Later on, he regards "other" (*al-ġayr*, τὸ ἕτερον), "dissimilar" (*allādī lā šabīh*, ἀνόμοιον) and "unequal" (*allādī laysa musāwin*, ἄνισον) as opposite to "the concepts we named above", i.e. "same" and "similar".[166] This entails that, besides "same" and "similar", also "equal" is a species of "one", and that "other", "dissimilar", "unequal" are species of plurality.[167] Aristotle mentions in the same context, as connected with the species of plurality, also "contrariety" (*ḍiddiyya*, ἐναντιότης) and "difference" (omitted in Usṭāṯ's translation, διαφορά).[168] Furthermore, at the end of Γ, 2 he states that among the properties of "being"—called properties of substance, for substance is the primary meaning of "being"—are "prior" and "posterior", "genus" and "species", "whole" and "part".[169] To these concepts, also "perfect", mentioned a few lines earlier, can be added.[170]

The difficulties in Aristotle's exposition are mainly two. First, he does not say what the species of "being" (Text 13) are: according to modern interpreters, they are either the species of "one" (namely "same", "similar" and "equal"),[171] or the categories (meant as distinct from the species of "one").[172] Second, in the course of Γ, 2, Aristotle confounds the species of "one" and "many" with the properties of "one" and "many" and with the properties of "being".[173]

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[165] *Tafsīr*, p. 311, 3, corresponding to Γ, 2, 1003b35–36. Aristotele deals with "same" and "similar" in I, 3, after examining "one" in I, 1–2.

[166] *Tafsīr*, p. 317, 6, corresponding to Γ, 2, 1004a17–18.

[167] In a passage of *Metaphysics* I, 3 (1054a29–32, *Tafsīr*, p. 1286, 2–3), Aristotle states that "same" (*al-huwa huwa*, τὸ ταὐτό), "similar" (*al-šabīh*, ὅμοιον), and "equal" (*al-musāwī*, ἴσον) belong to "one", whereas "other", "dissimilar" and "unequal" belong to plurality.

[168] *Tafsīr*, p. 317, 8, partially corresponding to Γ, 2, 1004a21–22.

[169] *Tafsīr*, p. 331, 10–14, corresponding to Γ, 2, 1005a13–18. Leszl [1975], p. 313, maintains that, in Aristotle's original plan, these concepts were the only properties of "being", as distinct from the species of "one" and "many".

[170] *Tafsīr*, p. 331, 10, corresponding to Γ, 2, 1005a12.

[171] This is the opinion, for example, of Berti [1974], p. 216, n. 39, who mentions Colle [1931], Mansion [1958], and G. Reale as advocates of the same view. To these scholars, Robin [1908] can be added (see Leszl [1975], p. 241, n. 26).

[172] See Leszl [1975], pp. 236–244, 276–282, 312–313; at p. 241 Leszl recalls Decarie [1961].

[173] In Text 16 Aristotle regards the species of "one" and "many" in general, and "same" and "contrariety" in particular, as *properties* of "one" and "being" jointly taken. In Γ, 2, 1005a14–18 (*Tafsīr*, p. 331, 10–14), he does not qualify them as properties of "one": he calls them "the aforementioned things" (*al-ašyā' allatī qīlat*,

Thus, the distinction between OntologyS, OntologyP, HenologyS and HenologyP is somehow formulated, but remains fluid.

If compared with Aristotle's, Avicenna's conception of the structure of metaphysics is considerably different. He identifies decidedly the species of "existent" with the categories; regards as properties of "one" and "many" the items ("same", "other", etc.) that Aristotle takes to be their species; proposes for the status of species of "one" and "many" a different group of concepts ("one" by accident etc.). The list of the properties of "existent" in Avicenna is longer than in Aristotle, including also "potency" and "act", "universal" and "particular", "cause" and "effect" (cf. Table 4);[174] the boundaries of OntologyS, OntologyP, HenologyS, HenologyP are much more rigid than in Aristotle. The differences between Aristotle and Avicenna result even greater, if we observe how the envisaged structure of metaphysics is accomplished in their works: whereas the succession of books of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in Andronicus of Rhodes' edition does not reflect the parameters established in Γ, 1–2,[175] the concrete structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is the coherent (although not completely straightforward) application to metaphysics of the indications provided in the Outline (I, 2) and the Description (I, 4).

Despite some common features, the distance separating Aristotle from Avicenna in conceiving and accomplishing the structure of metaphysics is considerable. I will now focus on the two main stages

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τὰ εἰρημένα), and regards them simply as properties of "being", on the same level as "prior" and "posterior", "genus" and "species", "whole" and "part".

[174] "Potency" is one of he main four meanings of "being" that Aristotle distinguishes in Δ, 7, E, 2 (1025a33–b2), Θ, 1 (1045b32–35). Avicenna regards "universal" and "particular" as the common heading under which "genus" and "species" are subsumed.

[175] Particularly puzzling is the treatment of OntologyS and OntologyP. In the hypothesis that the species of "being" are the categories, Aristotle takes into account only one of them (substance in books Z-H); within Z-H, however, he does not deal with the categories as species of "being", nor does he mention the species of "being" anywhere else in the *Metaphysics*. The only place of this work where the properties of "being" are investigated is book Δ ("prior" and "posterior" in Δ, 11; "genus" in Δ, 28; "whole" in Δ, 26, "part" in Δ, 25; "perfect" in Δ, 16): in this book, however, they are not investigated as such, but together with many other concepts. The *Metaphysics* ends with the treatment of "one" and "many" and their species (book I), and a group of three books (Λ-N) dealing with the causes and principles of "being" according to Aristotle (the Unmoved Mover and its peers, in Λ) and according to Plato and his followers (mathematical entities and Ideas, in M-N): these two sections of the *Metaphysics* can be regarded, respectively, as Aristotle's Henology and OntologyC/Theology.

of the historical route connecting Aristotle with Avicenna on this issue: Alexander of Aphrodisias among the Greek commentators on the *Metaphysics*, and al-Fārābī among its Arab interpreters.

6.4 *Alexander of Aphrodisias*

The introduction of Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on *Metaphysics* Δ provides an interesting indication about the structure of the *Metaphysics*.

> Text 18: Alexander of Aphrodisias, In *Metaph.* Δ, proem
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> In this book, then, he distinguishes things that are the common attributes of being (κοινῶς τῷ ὄντι ὑπάρχοντα) and that, because they are its concomitants (παρακολουθοῦντα), seem also to be expressed in various ways.[176]

The common attributes of being (κοινῶς τῷ ὄντι ὑπάρχοντα) mentioned in Text 18 appear to be identical to the "attributes *per se* of being" (τὰ τούτῳ ὑπάρχοντα καθ' αὑτό, or: καθ' αὑτά) referred to in Aristotle's Text 12.1, i.e. the properties of "being". Thus, Alexander apparently links OntologyP with book Δ.

Remarks on the structure of the *Metaphysics* are available also in the introduction of Alexander's commentary on Λ. This introduction, like the rest of Alexander's commentary on Λ, is known to us by being quoted by Averroes in the *Tafsīr*. According to Averroes' report (Text 19), Alexander's main point in this introduction is that Λ can be regarded as the last book of the *Metaphysics* (section [a]), since the two following books (M and N) do not contain Aristotle's point of view but are a discussion of the Platonic doctrine of principles (section [f]), and since Aristotle himself in some places of the *Metaphysics* points at Λ as the final book of this work (section [g]). While arguing for his main point, however, Alexander also provides a sketch of the structure of the *Metaphysics* (sections [b]–[e]):

> Text 19: Alexander of Aphrodisias, proem to *Metaph. Λ apud* Averroes, *Tafsīr*, pp. 1394, 3–1395, 8
>
> [a] We say: Alexander begins by saying that the statement of those who say that this book, i.e. book L, is the last of this discipline is necessary [i.e. necessarily true],
>
> [b] because some of the other books which he [i.e. Aristotle] put in this science contain the problems that had to be solved in this science, after having been raised [i.e. book B];

[176] Alexander of Aphrodisias, [1891], p. 345, 18–20; Engl. transl. in Dooley [1993], pp. 11–12 (slightly modified).

[c] some others contain the solution of these problems: this is what he [i.e. Aristotle] did in the books placed after this book [i.e. after book B];

[d] and still others contain the discussion about the things which belong to the existent in so far as it is existent (*al-ašyā' al-mawǧūda li-l-mawǧūd bi-mā huwa mawǧūd*) [**OntologyP**].

[e] As for the present book [i.e. L], in it he discusses the principles (*mabādi'*) of the existent in so far as it is existent and the principles (*mabādi'*) of the first substance which is the most true [**OntologyC/ Theology**]. He does it by clarifying that there is a substance which is in this state and what this substance is. The clarification of this substance is the aim sought for in this discipline.

[f] For in the two books which come after this, he does not clarify anything pertaining to his primary aim, nor does he ascertain in them any view proper to him. They contain only the refutation of the statements of those who say that the principles of the existents are Forms and Numbers. He [i.e. Alexander] says: He [i.e. Aristotle] had already discussed these things to some extent in the book designated as "A major" [. . .].[177] Then he discusses them exhaustively in these last two books.

[g] He [i.e. Alexander] says: From his discussion at the beginning of book G and elsewhere, one can infer that this book is the last in which he discusses about this science.

This, then, is the gist of Alexander's introduction to this book.[178]

In Texts 18–19 Alexander envisages therefore four main parts of the *Metaphysics*:

Outline 2: Structure of the *Metaphysics* according to Alexander of Aphrodisias

(1) exposition of aporias: book B ([b])
(2) solution of aporias: books Γ-? ([c])
(3) discussion of the "things belonging to the existent *qua* existent", i.e. its properties: book Δ ([d]) = **OntologyP**
(4) discussion of the principles of the existent *qua* existent: book Λ ([e]) = **OntologyC/Theology**

Despite some obscurities,[179] the outline of metaphysics that Alexander provides in this text is interesting in two respects: first, it contains

[177] The following sentence "namely the second book of this work" is probably a gloss: in Alexander's commentary, A is the first, not the second, book of the *Metaphysics*.

[178] Cp. the Engl. transl. in Genequand [1984], p. 60 (see the remarks in Gutas [1987c]), and the French translation in Martin [1984], pp. 30–31.

[179] It is not clear, for example, whether part 2 encompasses also parts 3–4 or not; if it does not, it is not clear where it stops and where part 3 starts. On Γ as

two of the four elements of the main axis of metaphysics that also Avicenna enucleates (OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology); second, it is a "theoretical" or "ideal" table of contents of metaphysics, since both the first (A) and the last two books (M-N) of the *Metaphysics* are excluded from the outline on account of their doxographical content. This disconnection of the structure that the *Metaphysics* actually *has* from the one that it *should have* is the first step of a road that will lead ultimately to Avicenna's overall recasting of this discipline in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[180]

6.5 *Al-Fārābī*

The works of al-Fārābī that appear to have influenced Avicenna's conception of the structure of metaphysics are mainly three: the *Iḥṣā'*, the *Mabādi'* and the *Fī Aġrāḍ*. The structure of metaphysics emerging from the *Iḥṣā'*[181] is quite simple. In this work, al-Fārābī singles out only the three elements of Ontology that also Avicenna posits: he distinguishes a first part of metaphysics dealing with the existents and "the things occurring to them" (*al-ašyā' allatī taʿriḍu lahā*) in so far as they are existents (= OntologyP); a second part taking into account the principles of the particular sciences (= OntologyS, despite no mention of "divisions" or "species" of "existent"); and a third part focusing on the immaterial existents (= OntologyC/Theology). This passage of al-Fārābī's *Iḥṣā'* might lie in the background of Avicenna's Text 2.

Al-Fārābī's *Mabādi'*,[182] on the other hand, appears to have influenced the inner articulation of Avicenna's OntologyC/Theology and the link between this latter and the Appendix on practical philosophy.

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the book of the *Metaphysics* in which Aristotle starts to solve the *aporiai* of B, according to Alexander, see Chapter 9, §5.1, Text 1.1.

[180] Remarkably, also in the *Ilāhiyyāt* books A and M-N of the *Metaphysics* are quoted together at the end of HenologyP (VII, 2–3), as an answer to the doctrines of Plato and the Pythagoreans on mathematical entities (see Chapter 8, §5.1, §§5.13–14).

[181] See Chapter 3, §5.

[182] See Chapter 3, §5.

Table 5

Avicenna, OntologyC/Theology	Al-Fārābī, *Mabādi'*
[1] VIII, 1–3: the First Principle's existence	
[2] VIII, 4–7: the First Principle's nature	1–2: the First Principle's nature
[3] IX, 1–5: Cosmology	3–9: Cosmology, both supralunar and sublunar
[4] IX, 6: Theodicy	
	10–12: Man's soul and body
[5] IX, 7: Eschatology	13: Noetics and Human Happiness
[6] X, 1–3: Prophetology	14: Prophetology
Appendix: Practical Philosophy	
X, 4: politics, economics (= household management) X, 5: politics, ethics	15–19: Politics: the Best City and its opposite

Four of the six sections of OntologyC/Theology in the *Ilāhiyyāt* ([2], [3], [5] and [6]) have a correspective in the *Mabādi'*.[183] Also the connection between the last section of OntologyC/Theology (Prophetology) and the appendix on practical philosophy finds an antecedent in al-Fārābī's work, where politics follows and is connected with Prophetology. *Via* al-Fārābī, the sequence of topics of Avicenna's OntologyC/Theology mirrors the structure of summaries and compendia of Medieval Islamic theology (*kalām*).[184]

In the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, al-Fārābī resumes and further develops the conception of the structure of the *Metaphysics* proposed by Alexander of Aphrodisias (and possibly by Ammonius).[185] The profile of metaphysics that al-Fārābī proposes in this treatise is very articulated. Three passages are particularly salient in this respect.

[183] The main structural difference is given by the lengthy discussion of man's soul and body, absent in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, that precedes Eschatology and Prophetology in the *Mabādi'*. The doctrine of the heavenly souls that characterizes the *Ilāhiyyāt*'s Cosmologiy does not appear in the Cosmology of the *Mabādi'*.

[184] See Frank [1992], pp. 12–15.

[185] Alexander's commentary on Λ is explicitly mentioned in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* (see Chapter 3, §1, [1.3])

Text 20.1: Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 35, 8–12 (= Chapter 3, §1 [2.2])

Universal science (*al-ʿilm al-kullī*), on the other hand, investigates [1 **Ontology+Henology**] the thing that is common to all existents (like existence and oneness), [2 **OntologyS+HenologyS**] its species (*anwāʿ*) and attributes (*lawāḥiq*) [3 **OntologyP+HenologyP**], the things which are not proper accidents (*lā taʿriḍ bi-l-taḫṣīṣ*) of any of the subject-matters of the particular sciences (like priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfect and deficient, and similar things), and [4 **OntologyC/Theology**] the common Principle (*mabdaʾ*) of all existents, namely the thing that ought to be called by the name of God.

Text 20.2: Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 35, 16–19 (= Chapter 3, §1 [2.4])

[4 **OntologyC/Theology**] The divine science (*al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*) ought to belong to this science [i.e. universal science], because God is a principle (*mabdaʾ*) of the absolute existent, not of one existent to the exclusion of another. That division (*qism*) of it, then, which contains providing the principle of the existent ought to be the divine science.

Text 20.3: Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 36, 9–20 (= Chapter 3, §1 [2.6])

[1 **Ontology/Henology**] The primary subject-matter (*al-mawḍūʿ al-awwal*) of this science is the absolute existent and what is equivalent to it in universality, namely the one. But since the knowledge of opposite correlatives is one, the investigation of non-existence (*al-ʿadam*) and multiplicity is also included in this science.

[2 **OntologyS+HenologyS**] Then, after these subject-matters (*mawḍūʿāt*) and their varification, it investigates the things which are like species (*anwāʿ*) to them, like the ten categories of the existent, the species (*anwāʿ*) of the one (like the individual one, the one by species, the one by genus, the one by analogy, and the divisions of each one of these), and similarly the species (*anwāʿ*) of non-existence and "many".

[3 **OntologyP+HenologyP**] Then [it investigates] into the attributes (*lawāḥiq*) of existent (like potency and act, perfect and deficient, cause and effect), the attributes (*lawāḥiq*) of unity (like sameness, similarity, equality, coincidence (*muwāfaqa*), parallelism, analogy etc.), and the attributes (*lawāḥiq*) of non-existence and multiplicity.

[4 **OntologyC/Theology+HenologyC**] Then [it investigates] into the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of each one of these.

[Each one of these] is branched out and divided, until the subject-matters of the particular sciences are reached, and [consequently], this science ends. In it the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of all the particular sciences and the definitions of their subject-matters are clarified.

In the above texts, al-Fārābī mentions five topics dealt with by metaphysics. Since he calls "division" (*qism*) one of these topics in Text 20.2, we may assume that he regards also the other four topics as divisions or parts of metaphysics. The five parts of metaphysics that al-Fārābī envisages are the following:

Outline 3: Structure of metaphysics in al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*
[1 **= Ontology+Henology**] the investigation of "existence", "non-existence", "one" and "many" in themselves;
[2 **= OntologyS+HenologyS**] the investigation of their species;
[3 **= OntologyP+HenologyP**] the investigation of their properties;[186]
[4 = **OntologyC/Theology+HenologyC**] the investigation of their principles;
[5] the clarification of the principles and subject-matters of the particular sciences.

With regard to Alexander of Aphrodisias, al-Fārābī introduces the remaining element of Ontology, i.e. OntologyS, and the entire Henology.

Even though the *Fī Aġrāḍ* influences deeply the structure of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, it differs from this latter in significant ways. First, the first and fundamental epistemological layer (subject-matter) is still not sufficiently clarified: thus in Text 20.3 al-Fārābī first envisages two instances of the "primary subject-matter" of metaphysics ("existence" and "one"), and then refers to a plurality of "subject-matters" (see Chapter 4, §2.5). Second, Ontology and Henology are not two distinct axes of metaphysics, but two different aspects of the same (and only) axis of this discipline: thus, in Text 20.1 al-Fārābī jointly refers to "existence" and "one" as equivalent instances of "thing that is common to all existents"; in Text 20.3, as we have just seen, he regards both "existence" and "one" as the primary subject-matter of metaphysics. Third, part [5] of metaphyiscs according to al-Fārābī does not have a correspective in the *Ilāhiyyāt*: Avicenna takes the part of metaphysics that provides the clarification of the principles and subject-matters of the particular sciences to be same as the non-theological part of metaphysics. Most importantly, al-Fārābī resumes only occasionally the structural parameters established in the first part of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* in the second part of the work, i.e. in the account of the single books of the *Metaphysics*, thus leaving a gap between what the structure of metaphysics should be (Texts 12.1–3), and what it actually is in Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (account of

[186] Whereas in Text 20.1 the properties of "existence" are named "the things which are not proper accidents" (*al-ašyāʾ allatī lā taʿriḍ bi-l-taḥṣīṣ*) of the particular sciences' subject-matters (thus being proper accidents of the metaphysics' subject-matter), and are kept distinct from the "attributes" (associated with the "species"), in Text 20.3 the properties of "existent" and "one" are named "attributes" (*lawāḥiq*), as distinct from the "species".

the single books).[187] Avicenna, on the contrary, not only expounds his view about the structure of metaphysics (Texts 1–2), but also reworks Aristotle's *Metaphysics* according to this prefigured structure (Table 3 and Texts 4–5).

Avicenna's recasting of the content of the *Metaphysics* according to the parameters established by Aristotle himself in Γ, 1–2 and E, 1, first theorized by Alexander of Aphrodisias in his introduction to book Λ, and further developed by al-Fārābī in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, is Avicenna's major contribution to the history of the interpretation of the structure of the *Metaphysics*.

Conclusion

The pieces of evidence discussed in the present chapter attest that in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* metaphysics receives a new, clear and coherent—though not totally straightforward—structure, quite different from the disordered pattern discernible in Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Before the Appendix on practical philosophy, the core of metaphysics is the result of two vertical axes (dealing respectively with "existent", and "one" and "many"), intersected by four horizontal lines (subject-matter, species, properties, causes).

The first and main axis concerns "existent *qua* existent" and is, therefore, an Ontology. It rests on a sequence of four main parts. In the first part, the Prolegomena ([1.1]) establish "existent *qua* existent" as the subject-matter of metaphysics, in the context of the discussion of a set of preliminary issues (the goal, utility, rank, name and division of this discipline). The Introduction ([1.2]) clarifies better the status of "existent *qua* existent" as subject-matter of metaphysics: it elucidates its rank of primary concept, its fundamental

[187] The distinction between the subject-matters studied by metaphysics, their species and their properties is mentioned again only in connection with books Γ and Δ: in the latter case (p. 37, 6–8), book Δ is portrayed as dealing with the "subject-matters" of this science, their "species" and their "attributes"; in the description of book Γ (p. 37, 4–5), al-Fārābī mentions only "subject-matters" and "proper accidents" (*al-aʿrāḍ al-ḫāṣṣa*, which may suggest that the regards this last expression as a common rubric for both species and attributes). In the course of the description of book E, he further clarifies the relationship between theology and metaphysics in general (p. 37, 9–13). In the obscure description of book K, finally, he alludes to a distinction between principles and "accidents" of metaphysics (p. 38, 1).

division in "Necessary Existent in Itself"/"possible existent in itself", and its relation with the axioms. The following three parts of Ontology deal with the species of "existent" (the categories, [2.1]), its properties (priority and posteriority, potency and act, perfection and imperfection, "whole" and "part", universality and particularity, "cause" and "effect", [3.1]) and its causes (God and the first causes, [4]), and can be called OntologyS(pecies), OntologyP(roperties) and OntologyC(auses). Since the first cause of "existent" is God, OntologyC is also a Theology.

The second axis of metaphysics concerns "one", as a concept equivalent to "existent", and "many", as the concept opposite of "one". Thus, metaphysics is not only an Ontology, but also a Henology. Henology encompasses two main parts: a treatment of the species of "one" and "many" (HenologyS, [2.2]), and an analysis of their properties (HenologyP, [3.2]). To these, the frequent references to "one", unity and unicity within Prolegomena-Introduction and OntologyC/Theology have to added.

In the actual structure of metaphysics, these two axes coexist and partially overlap. OntologyS is intermingled with HenologyS; OntologyP and HenologyP, on the other hand, are distinct sections, consecutive to each other. Among these parts, OntologyC/Theology is the most important: it is the first part of metaphysics to be mentioned in the outline of this discipline in I, 2 (§1, Text 2), and is portrayed by Avicenna as the "seal" of the metaphysics (§4.5 [4]).

In comparison with the other major works by Avicenna dealing with metaphysics, the *Ilāhiyyāt*'s structure shows a common pattern (the emphasis on Ontology and, within Ontology, on OntologyC/Theology), but is decidedly richer: in no other work OntologyS is so clearly distinguished from OntologyP; nowhere else Henology is so widely displayed; no other work has such extensive Prolegomena and Introduction.

The horizontal layers are taken from the *Posterior Analytics* (the idea that each science has a subject-matter, and investigates the species and the properties of this subject-matter) and Aristotle's repeated characterization of knowledge as a grasp of the causes of the thing known. A first application of the epistemology of the *Posterior Analytics* to metaphysics is performed by Aristotle in books Γ and Ε of the *Metaphysics*. The same trend is at work in at least some of the Greek commentators on the *Metaphysics* (*in primis* Alexander of Aphrodisias). Within the same Aristotelian tradition, taking inspiration especially

from *Metaphysics* Γ (possibly through Ammonius), al-Fārābī provides the fullest and most influential account of the structure of metaphysics before Avicenna. The Prolegomena derive from the exegetical tradition of Late Antiquity, whereas the inner articulation of OntologyC/Theology (also influenced by al-Fārābī) results similar to that of Islamic theological literature.

In a synchronic perspective, the structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is an extremely comprehensive synthesis. The fundamental axis is the Ontology of the Peripatetic tradition, articulated in conformity with the conceptual apparatus of Aristotle's epistemology (the *Posterior Analytics*). The core of second axis (HenologyS and HenologyP) still derives from Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, but is preceded (Introduction) and followed (OntologyC/Theology) by a discussion of God's unity and unicity foreign to Aristotle, which can be taken as a reflex of the Neoplatonic doctrine of the One as the First Principle, and a way to comply with the Islamic dogma of the *tawḥīd Allāh*, the profession of God's unicity. In a diachronic perspective, the structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, though depending on many sources, has one main aspect of originality: it is the refinement and the concrete application to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* of what was before a bare conception (i.e. a "theory") of the structure of metaphysics as a science.

CHAPTER SIX

AVICENNA'S ELABORATION OF THE METHOD OF THE *METAPHYSICS*: METAPHYSICS AS A DEMONSTRATIVE, ANALYTICAL, NON-DIALECTICAL SCIENCE

Contemporary Aristotelian scholars agree on what the method of Aristotle's works *is not*, i.e. on the fact that the apodictic (or axiomatic) method envisaged as proper to science in the *Posterior Analytics* does not govern, in fact, the writings of the *corpus*. This is explained by pointing out that some Aristotelian works, like the *Physics* and the *Metaphysics*, are not treatises of science, but essays about the foundation of science, whereas more properly scientific writings like the *Meteorology* and the *Parts of Animals* reflect a science still in progress, not an accomplished discipline whose results can be expounded in an apodictic form. Much more disputed, on the contrary, is the issue of what the method of Aristotle's works positively *is*. Under debate, in particular, is the question of whether—and, in case, to what extent—the method of the Aristotelian writings is dialectical, i.e. an expression of the discipline described in Aristotle's *Topics*. Three main positions can be distinguished in this regard. According to the traditional view, upheld by the majority of scholars, the method of the Aristotelian *corpus* is mainly dialectical; for dialectic is presented by Aristotle in the *Topics* as the method for attaining the first principles, starting from "reputable opinions" (ἔνδοξα), in every field of research, and the prime aim of Aristotle's works is just to grasp the first principles of the subject under consideration.[1] According to a more sophisticated version of this same position, the fundamental method of the Aristotelian writings is certainly dialectical, but the result of a "strong", rather than ordinary, type of dialectic: while ordinary dialectic, by the very fact of resting on opinions (though reputable), cannot guarantee the certainty of its results, this alleged "strong" dialectic would be capable of producing an absolutely certain knowledge of the first principles by relying on a special class of

[1] See the studies quoted in Berti [1989], pp. 75–112.

"reputable opinions", i.e. those without which any rational account of reality would be impossible.[2] Somehow as a reaction to this second trend, other scholars maintain that the Aristotelian *corpus* does not depends in any way on dialectic—since dialectic is conceived by Aristotle as a syllogistic discipline, whereas Aristotle's arguments are not syllogisms—and does not exhibit any constant methodology: the method is problem-oriented, in so far as it mainly consists in the piece-meal solution of doctrinal puzzles.[3]

Since the scientific character of a discipline depends primarily upon its method, it is not surprising that Avicenna's attempt to transform Aristotle's *Metaphysics* into a rigorous science involves a thorough revision of the method of this work. Avicenna's attitude towards the method of the *Metaphysics*—and the Aristotelian *corpus* in general—has four main features. First, he appears to be aware of the situation agreed upon by contemporary Aristotelian scholars, i.e. of the gap separating the theory from the practice in Aristotle's scientific method (in other words, the discrepancy between epistemology and concrete instances of scientific endeavour), to regard it as a state of imperfection requiring emendation, and, accordingly, to strive for changing and improving it. Second, he regards the apodictic method theorized by the *Posterior Analytics* as the one that should be instantiated by all the Aristotelian *corpus*, and proceeds to explain or rework Aristotle's writings according to it. Since demonstration is basically a syllogism whose premises are true and first, this implies, on the one hand, that Avicenna makes recourse to syllogisms and other rigorous forms of inference; and, on the other hand, that he pays special attention to the truth-conditions of the premises of these syllogisms. Third, as a complement of the apodictic method, Avicenna employs extensively procedures that can be labelled as "analytical" (like the distinction/classification of the different meanings of terms). Fourth, in his reworking of the Aristotelian *corpus* he gives a subordinate methodological role to the "dialectical" procedures used by Aristotle, such as the survey of the predecessors' opinions, and the discussion of *aporiai* (i.e. unsolvable or unsolved problems).[4] This does not mean

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[2] Irwin [1988].

[3] Barnes [1991], p. 115: "Alors *quelle méthode* enfin Aristote utilise-t-il pour philosopher? Il ne suit aucune méthode". Cp. Barnes [2000], pp. 59–63 (Chapter 9: "Ideal and Achievement").

[4] In so far as the predecessors' opinions are ἔνδοξα, their exposition can be

that Avicenna avoids to confront himself with other thinkers' views, or to point out difficulties; these procedures, on the contrary, are quite frequent in the *Šifā'*. But his recourse to them is dictated by theoretical necessities, not by an intent of imitating Aristotle. In other words, Avicenna accepts the dialectical methodology employed by Aristotle, but subordinates it to apodicitc patterns, and adjusts it to his own philosophical agenda.

The present chapter consists of four sections. In the first (§1), I focus on how in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna grounds metaphysics on demonstrations and other equivalent argumentative procedures. The second section (§2) is devoted to Avicenna's analytical approach to metaphysics, i.e. his reliance on the semantic analysis of the metaphysical terms. Next (§3), I deal with Avicenna's "reductionist" attitude towards the two main dialectical aspects of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (doxographies and *aporiai*). Finally, I survey the sources of Avicenna's conception of metaphysics as an apodictic science (§4), and—more briefly—as an anlytical and non-dialectical discipline (§5).

1 *Metaphysics* and demonstration

The importance of Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics*, and of the theory of demonstration therein, for Arabic philosophy has already been stressed in previous studies.[5] As to Avicenna in particular, D. Gutas has documented that he mastered the apodictic method during his education (as reported in the Autobiography, the *Dānešnāme-ye 'Alā'ī* and the *Mašriqiyyūn*), taught it to his students (as emerges from Ibn Zayla's so-called "Memoirs of a Disciple from Rayy" in the *Mubāḥaṯāt*), and applied it in his works, two examples of which are his literal commentaries on the *De Anima* and the *Metaphysics*.[6] The use of

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regarded as an expression of dialectic. The same applies to the discussion of *aporiai*, which in most cases are the result of contrasting ἔνδοξα (B, 1, 995a24–26: "It is necessary . . . for us first to go through the issues about which one must first raise aporiae. These are *issues about which people have held different views*, as well as anything else that has been overlooked", Madigan [1999], p. 1, emphasis added; for the connection between *aporiai* and ἔνδοξα, see Arist., *De an.* A, 2, 403b20–25, *Eth. Nic.* H, 1, 1145b2–7). Aristotle's doxographies are occasionally neglected also by modern Aristotelian interpreters: in Hamlyn [1993], for example, Aristotle's doxography in *De Anima* A is only partially translated.

[5] See Marmura [1990]; Endress [2005].

[6] Gutas [1988], pp. 177–181; pp. 70–71, §§5–7 (cp. Reisman [2002], p. 253); pp. 311–318.

demonstration regards not only Avicenna's exegesis of Aristotle's works, but also his original works.[7] In these latter, he often relates demonstration with metaphysics.[8]

The reliance of the various parts of the *Šifāʾ* on the doctrine of *apodeixis* of the *Posterior Analytics* is evident.[9] In this chapter, I am going to articulate in detail this point with regard to the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The presence of apodictic arguments in this work is signaled in other writings by Avicenna.[10] The *Ilāhiyyāt* itself documents the relationship between metaphysics and demonstration in various ways: by means of Avicenna's statements on this subject, both in a historical

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[7] See *Nafs ʿalā sunnat al-iḫtiṣār*, chpt. 9 of the table of contents (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 85), and the reference to this work in *Risāla fī l-Nafs al-nāṭiqa* (*On the Rational Soul*, Avicenna [1952b], pp. 195–199; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 82–83) and *Ḥāl al-Nafs*, p. 45, 4–5 (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 99).

[8] See *Burhān* II, 7, p. 166, 7–9 (below, Text 5.2); *Aqsām*, p. 91, 1–2, where, at the end of the description of the five parts of metaphysics, Avicenna states that "all this is known by means of the certain demonstration (*bi-l-burhān al-yaqīnī*)"; *Mabdaʾ*, p. 81, 16–18 (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 312); *Letter to an Anonymous Disciple*, Avicenna [1947f], p. 246, 2 (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 59). Avicenna's statement in *Nafs ʿalā sunnat al-iḫtiṣār*, p. 361, 14, according to which the intelligibles that are not received by divine inspiration come about in the human rational soul by means of syllogistic acquisition and "apodictic discovery" (*istinbāṭ burhānī*), applies also to the "conceptualization of divine things" (*taṣawwur al-umūr al-ilāhiyya*), i.e. to metaphysics (p. 362, 3–4); see Gutas [1988], pp. 17–18. In *Aġrām*, p. 40, 16–19, Avicenna states that the principles of all the sciences are contained in first philosophy and divine science "according to demonstration" (*ʿalā sabīl al-burhān*). Marmura [1987], p. 73a, notices that Avicenna "injects in it [i.e. in his metaphysics] a pattern of deductive reasoning that anticipates the kind of thinking encountered in seventeenth-century European rationalist philosophies".

[9] In the opening classification of the sciences, Avicenna maintains that the truth of what the different branches of practical philosophy establish is verified by means of "theoretical demonstration" (*al-burhān al-naẓarī*) and the testimony of the revealed law (*Madḫal* I, 2, p. 14, 15–16; Engl. transl. in Marmura [1980], p. 247). His statement about the reliance on demonstration can be applied, in all likelihood, not only to practical philosophy, but also *a fortiori* to theoretical philosophy (i.e. philosophy of nature, mathematics and metaphysics). A. Hasnaw has shown that in the *Samāʿ* Avicenna concretely applies the apodictic method to the doctrine of Aristotle's *Physics*, regarding it as distinct from, and superior to, dialectical procedures (Hasnawi [2000], p. 512: "Le but ultime d'Avicenne, à travers ces remaniements, est de se conformer au modèle d'exposition de la science qui est celui des *Seconds Analytiques*"; Hasnawi [2002], pp. 74–75, describes Avicenna's "remplacement de la démarche dialectique par une démarche thétique", his "réserve à l'égard de la démarche dialectique", and points at a passage of the *Samāʿ* in which Avicenna states that "les arts démonstratifs ne [doivent] pas être mêlés de dialectique"). The same holds true for the mathematical part of the *Šifāʾ* (see the passage of *Ḥisāb* I, p. 60, 10–12, translated by R. Rashed [1984], p. 32).

[10] See *Mubāḥaṯāt*, Avicenna [1947e], §264, p. 173, 6–8, Avicenna [1992], §900, p. 321, 7–10; see Gutas [1988], p. 311; cp. Reisman [2002], p. 248.

(§1.1) and in a theoretical perspective (§1.2), and by his concrete use of demonstration in the reworking of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (§1.3).

1.1 *Metaphysics as an apodictic science in historical perspective: Aristotle's contribution*

Two texts of the *Ilāhiyyāt* reveal cumulatively that Avicenna's ascribes to Aristotle the first use of demonstration in metaphysics.

> Text 1: *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 2, p. 310, 10–14 [p. 358, 91–99]
>
> [a] [i] We say that every discipline has a starting-point[11] of [its] growth in which it is unripe and immature. [ii] After some time, however, it ripens. [iii] Then, after some other time, it grows and reaches perfection.
>
> [b] [i] Philosophy, therefore, when the Greeks first occupied themselves with it, was rhetorical. [ii] Then it was mixed with sophism and dialectic.
>
> [c] [i] The first of its sections that arrived to the common people was the [one dealing with] natural [science]. [ii] Then they started to pay attention to the mathematical [section]. [iii] Then to the divine (*al-ilāhī*).
>
> [d] But their transitions from one part to another were incorrect, and, when they first passed from the sensible to the intelligible, they got confused.[12]

In section [a] Avicenna likens the growing process of a discipline to that of a fruit, envisaging a sequence of three distinct stages (unripeness, ripeness, perfection). In the following two sections he applies this sequence to the history of Greek philosophy, with regard to two distinct fields: the method in section [b] (rhetoric, sophistic-dialectic, and—as it can be surmised—demonstration); and the content in section [c] (the three parts of theoretical philosophy: natural philosophy, mathematics, metaphysics; this latter is called the "divine section" of philosophy).[13] In [b] Avicenna mentions only the first two stages of the process (philosophy was initially rhetorical, then sophistical and dialectical), omitting the final stage corresponding to the state

[11] Reading: *lahā ibtidā'a* instead of *lahā* (see Appendix A).

[12] The importance of this text, and its dependence on al-Fārābī, has been stressed by Gutas [1983], p. 259, n. 70, who also translates lines 11–13.

[13] Obviously Avicenna does not envisage a one-by-one correspondence between the elements of these two fields: in particular, he does not mean that the method of sophistic was used in natural philosophy, and the method of sophistic-dialectic in mathematics.

of perfection in [a] (in all likelihood, the stage in which metaphysics becomes demonstratitive).[14] This omission is significant, since it suggests that, according to Avicenna, the perfection in method (demonstration) does not lie entirely and properly within the scope of Greek theoretical philosophy. Section [c], on the other hand, displays all three stages. In [d], Avicenna remarks that the initial phase of the third stage (metaphysics) was problematic, since the Greek philosophers, "when they first passed" (*awwala mā ntaqalū*) from the sensible to the intelligible (i.e. the metaphysical intelligible, that is separated from matter not only in our way of knowing it, but also in its own existence) were puzzled. As the temporal indication makes clear, Avicenna refers here to the very first Greek metaphysicians, i.e. pre-Aristotelian philosophers like Plato and the Pythagoreans, whose errors he is going to criticize after Text 1 in VII, 2–3. Their confusion, stated in [c], is probably due to their lack of the method missing in [b], i.e. to the lack of demonstration, the only method suited to deal with intelligible matters, according to Avicenna. The fact that Aristotle is not included among the Greek philosophers who got confused about metaphysics implies that his metaphysics, according to Avicenna follows, at least in part, the apodictic method.

That demonstration is something carried out after Plato, and against him, by Aristotle is implicit in this other text of the *Ilāhiyyāt*:

> Text 2: *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 6, p. 357, 16–17 [p. 415, 32–34]
>
> [a] . . . it was not impossible for a numerous sect [of philosophers] to conceive that, among the [different] things, there is one that moves itself,[15]
>
> [b] until the demonstration (*al-burhān*) of this impossibility arose.[16]

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[14] Even though it cannot be excluded that Avicenna means sophistic as the second stage and dialectic as the third, this possibility is not supported by the syntax of [b], which encompasses only two sentences ([i] "when first, *fī qadīm* . . . [ii] "Then", *ṯumma* . . .), and by the association between the third stage and perfection (a quality that dialectic has not, according to Avicenna) in [a.iii].

[15] Reading *muḥarrikan li-ḏātihī* instead of *mutaḥarrikan ʿan ḏātihī* (see Appendix A). I take *li-* as introducing the object of the nomen agentis *muḥarrik*.

[16] The general context of Text 2 is the investigation of the Necessary Existent as, at the same time, intellect (*ʿaql*), subject of intellection (*ʿāqil*) and object of intellection (*maʿqūl*) of Itself (VIII, 6, pp. 356, 16–358, 13 [pp. 414, 95–417, 61]). Avicenna's particular point (p. 357, 14–20 [pp. 415, 28–416, 38]) is that, even though a thing in movement implies a mover, it is not self-evident whether the mover is the thing in movement itself or something else. This case is mentioned in support of Avicenna's thesis that, even though a subject of intellection implies an

Section [a] refers primarily to Plato's doctrine of the soul's self-motion (*Phaedrus* 245c5–246a2; *Laws* 895e10–896a4). Avicenna knew this doctrine through Aristotle's *De Anima*—where it is not ascribed to Plato, but generically to "some philosophers", together with the similar theory (probably by Xenocrates, Plato's second successor in the Academy) that the soul is a self-moving number[17]—and *Metaphysics*, where it is explicitly attributed to Plato.[18] Since Avicenna portrays the advocates of this doctrine as numerous, he is probably referring not only to Plato, but to the Platonic school in general.[19] Section [b], on the other hand, refers probably to Aristotle's arguments for the impossibility of self-motion, provided, in general terms, in *Phys.* Θ, 5, 257a31–258b4, and with particular regard to the animals' self-motion, in *Phys.* Θ, 6, 259b1–31.[20] Thus, in Text 2 Avicenna regards a doctrine held by Plato and his followers as replaced by an apodictic proof—a "demonstration" (*burhān*)—provided by Aristotle. It seems reasonable to assume that the same kind of relationship between Plato and Aristotle underlies also Avicenna's point of view in Text 1 [d], namely that in this text Avicenna regards Plato's metaphysics, still indebted to dialectic, as superseded by Aristotle's metaphysics, more depending on demonstration.[21]

Thus, taken together, Texts 1–2 show that, according to Avicenna, the stage of perfection in metaphysics (i.e. the use in it of demonstration) starts with Aristotle. This, of course, does not mean that, in his opinion, metaphysics is fully accomplished as an apodictic science by Aristotle: rather he regards this latter as the initiator of a trend that his disciples, and Avicenna in first person, have to bring to full completion.[22] Significantly, in the *Ilāhiyyāt* demonstration (lit.

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object of intellection, it is not self-evident whether the object of intellection is the subject of intellection itself or something else (pp. 357, 13–358, 6 [pp. 415, 26–416, 47]).

[17] Aristotle reports the former doctrine in *De An.* A, 2, 404a20–25, and refutes it in *De An.* A, 3. The latter doctrine is expounded in *De An.* A, 2, 404b27–30, and rejected in A, 4, 408b32–409a30.

[18] *Metaph.* Λ, 6, 1071b37–1072a3; *Tafsīr*, p. 1574, 4–5; p. 1574, 1–2, bottom of page.

[19] See Appendix B, I.3, s.v. *farīq lahū ʿadad.*

[20] See Graham [1999], pp. 96–103, 110–119.

[21] With regard to Plato, in the logic of the *Šifāʾ* Avicenna states that "philosophy in his time had not matured to the point of reaping" (Gutas [1988], p. 38; cp. p. 287).

[22] See the text of *Mašriqiyyūn* quoted in the Introduction.

"deductive argument", *qiyās*) is sometimes added to doctrines of the *Metaphysics*,[23] and deficiencies in Aristotle's method in this work are pointed out, as we are going to see. According to Avicenna, the complete integration between demonstration (i.e. perfection in method) and metaphysics (perfection in content) is not performed by Greek philosophers (not even by Aristotle) but by himself.

1.2 *Theoretical perspective: the role and limits of demonstration in metaphysics*

Throughout the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna makes clear, in different contexts and respects, that the method proper of metaphysics is demonstrative. Even though demonstration is occasionally mentioned in connection with sciences other than metaphysics—as, for example, natural philosophy in Text 2[24]—or in connection with philosophy in general,[25] Avicenna is particularly clear about the apodictic character of metaphysics. His most explicit statement in this regard is the following:

> Text 3: *Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 3, p. 188, 3–4 [p. 215, 13–16]
>
> [a] After having pointed (*ašarnā*) to all these things, let us turn away from them.
>
> [b] For it is not our custom to discuss things like these, that rest on persuasive conjectures (*taḫmīnāt iqnāʿiyya*) and do not belong to the methods of the scientific syllogisms (*wa-laysat min ṭuruqi l-qiyāsāti l-ʿilmiyyati*).

In Text 3, Avicenna contrasts two different methods, and declares the latter to be the one he usually adopts in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The first

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[23] IX, 2, p. 393, 6–11 [pp. 463, 78–464, 86].

[24] In I, 2, p. 14, 11–13 [p. 14, 64–67], Avicenna states that the particular sciences demonstrate (*tubarhinu*) the existence of what, among the things they take into account, is principle of some other of these things.

[25] In IX, 7, p. 428, 10–11, 14–16 [p. 514, 57–60; p. 515, 63–66] he maintains that some people acquire the desire of perfectioning their intellectual faculty when it is demonstrated (*yubarhanu*) to them that "it is proper to the soul to grasp the quiddity of everything, by acquiring the unknown from the known, and to reach the perfection in act"; they start to have this desire when it is demonstrated (*burhina*) to their psychic faculty that "there are things of which knowledge can be acquired by means of the middle terms [of syllogisms], as you know". The demonstration Avicenna is referring to in this passage appears to be the proof of the existence of philosophy *tout court*. He probably regards this demonstration as not provided by any single philosophical discipline, but rather gained cumulatively from all the branches of philosophy.

method is based on "conjecture" (*taḫmīn*) and "persuasion" (*iqnāʿ*). The reference ("all these things", "things like these") is to the portion of chapter IV, 3 preceding Text 3, namely to Avicenna's reworking of *Metaphysics* Δ, 16 (the different meanings of the term "perfect", τέλειον, *tāmm*), complemented with additional meanings of "perfect" taken from elsewhere, and ascribed to the "common people" (*al-ğumhūr*).[26] Thus, Avicenna regards a chapter of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* as based on a method that appears to be "dialectical", in so far as it is conjectural, persuasive, and expressing the point of view of the common people.[27]

Section [b] indicates what method Avicenna regards as suitable for metaphysics, instead of dialectic: the "scientific syllogisms", i.e. the apodictic procedures that Aristotle portrays as typical of science in the *Posterior Analytics*.

Avicenna relates demonstration and metaphysics with particular regard to this latter's function of proving the things that the other sciences cannot prove, namely their "principles" broadly intended.[28] Examples of things demonstrated by metaphysics on behalf of other sciences occur frequently in the *Ilāhiyyāt*: in I, 1, for instance, Avicenna states that "the apodictic clarification" (*al-bayān al-burhānī*) of the fact that things having a temporal beginning depend on a principle—something he actually proves in IV, 2, identifying such a principle with matter[29]—is given by metaphysics, since no other science provides it;[30] in I, 3, he solves an objection according to which the principles

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[26] See Chapter 8, §5.5.

[27] In this regard, the presence of the verb "having pointed" (*ašarnā*) in section [a] might not be coincidental: Avicenna could regard this method as an expression of the method called "indicative" by Gutas [1988], pp. 307–311, namely the use of "pointers" (*išārāt*), as opposed to demonstrations, in order to convey briefly and allusively a philosophical doctrine. Gutas distinguishes two different addressees of Avicenna's indicative method (philosophers and common people), corresponding to its two main functions (didactic and obfuscatory). Also Text 3 connects the indicative method with the common people, but reverses the perspective: the common people are not the addressees of Avicenna's obfuscatory intent, but rather the origin of the indicative method, which—through Aristotle's *Metaphysics*—creates a (temporary) obfuscation in Avicenna's discourse. References to what appears to be the indicative method occur also elsewhere in the *Ilāhiyyāt*: see, for example, the contrast between *išāra* and *taḥqīq* in I, 1, p. 5, 2, 5 [p. 3, 36, 40–41]), and the mention of *išāra* in I, 3, p. 21, 2 [p. 23, 32].

[28] See Chapter 7.

[29] IV, 2, pp. 177, 5–179, 3 [pp. 202, 42–205, 93], 181, 7–182, 18 [pp. 208, 50–210, 93]. This place is recalled in IX, 1, p. 374, 1 [p. 435, 31].

[30] I, 1, p. 8, 13–16 [p. 8, 32–37]. In this passage Avicenna relates the demon-

of natural science and mathematics cannot be "demonstrated" (*tubarhanu*) in metaphysics since this latter assumes some of the conclusions of these sciences;[31] In III, 9, he says that geometry is unable to "demonstrate" (*an yubarhina*) the existence of the qualities inherent in quantities.[32]

The most explicit text in this regard occurs in chapter I, 8, at the end of the defense of the principle of the excluded-middle. Avicenna first states that metaphysics is deputed to discuss both the principles of demonstration, i.e. the axioms (whose fundamental role within the process of demonstration is underscored), and the substance of the subjects of demonstration.[33] Then he expounds an objection according to which metaphysics cannot take into account either of them: if it did so by means of definitions, it would accomplish what the particular sciences are already capable of doing; if, on the other hand, it did so by means of judgements, its discourse would be apodictic whereas, in good Aristotelian terms, neither the axioms nor substance can be demonstrated.[34] In his reply, Avicenna distinguishes the case of the subjects of demonstrations from that of the axioms, and maintains that metaphysics has an apodictic approach to the former and a non-apodictic approach to the latter. Here is the relevant part of what he says:

> Text 4: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 8, p. 54, 7–8, 17 [pp. 63, 0–4; 64, 15–16]
>
> [a] We say that these [things] that are subject-matters in other sciences become [proper] accidents in this science. For they are states inhering in "existent" and divisions of it. Therefore, what is not demonstrated in another science, is demonstrated here (*mā lā yubarhanu ʿalayhi fī ʿilmin āḫara yubarhanu ʿalayhi hunā*).
>
> [b] . . . nor is the investigation of the principles of demonstration (*mabādiʾ al-burhān*) a demonstration (*burhān*).

Two points of section [a] are remarkable. First by "subject-matters" of the other sciences, Avicenna means the *substance* of these subject-matters, as the focus on substance in the lines immediately following section [a] makes clear.[35] Second, the statement "what is not

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stration provided by metaphysics with the apodictic procedures displayed in Euclid's *Elements of Geometry*, which he quotes (see Appendix B, II.2.1, s.v. *kitāb Ūqlīdis*).

[31] I, 3, pp. 19, 10–20, 18 [pp. 21, 90–23, 29].

[32] III, 9, p. 145, 11–12 [p. 164, 55–56].

[33] I, 8, pp. 53, 16–54, 2 [p. 63, 90–97].

[34] I, 8, p. 54, 3–5 [p. 63, 98–00]. This objection is Avicenna's reworking of *aporia* 2 of *Metaphysics* B (see Chapter 10, §2.1).

[35] I, 8, p. 54, 9–15 [pp. 63, 4–64, 14]. In this regard, he goes much further

demonstrated in another science, is demonstrated here" applies to what is proper to each of the other sciences, not to what is common to all of them. As section [b] indicates, metaphysics does not demonstrate the principles of demonstrations, i.e. the axioms, which are common to all the sciences.[36]

What qualifies a syllogism as scientific, i.e. as a demonstration, is the nature of its premises. In *Burhān* II, 7, metaphysics is described as relying on premises that are "apodictic" (*burhāniyya*) and "certain" (*yaqīniyya*), in distinction to dialectic, whose premises are "commonly accepted" (*mašhūra*).[37] This distinction is fundamental in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. In a passage of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, for example, Avicenna recalls from his reworking of Aristotle's *Topics* in the *Šifā'* the difference between what is "primarily clear" (*bayyin awwalī*) or "self-evident" (*bayyin bi-nafsihī*)—like the premises of a scientific syllogism, that are either "principles" (*awā'il*) in the intellect, or "clear by means of these principles" (*bayyina ʿan al-awā'il*)—and what is "commonly accepted" (*mašhūr*)—like the premises of a dialectical syllogism:[38] the fact that things that come into existence have causes, according to Avicenna, is not "clear and first", but rather "commonly accepted", and metaphysics has to provide the "apodictic clarification" (*al-bayān al-burhānī*) of this fact.[39] Also elsewhere in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna is careful in alerting the reader when a doctrine is a commonly accepted view (see below, §3.1). Thus metaphysics, according to Avicenna, does not rely on commonly accepted views; it rather provides their demonstration. In other words, the syllogistic procedures adopted by metaphysics are never dialectical, but always apodictic: they depend on "clear" premises and occasionally clarify tenets that are assumed as true without being such in a clear way.

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than Aristotle, according to whom essence and substance cannot be demonstrated (see *Metaph.* E, 1, 1025b14–16).

[36] This reflects the standard Aristotelian doctrine according to which the axioms cannot be demonstrated (see Γ, 4, 1006a10–11; Γ, 6, 1011a13).

[37] See below, Text 5.2. Avicenna paid great attention to determining the modality of the premises of syllogisms from the very beginning of his philosophical education (see Gutas [1988], pp. 177–181).

[38] *Ğadal* I, 5, p. 43, 4–7 (corresponding to *Top.* A, 1, 100a30–b23).

[39] I, 1, p. 8, 12–16 [pp. 7, 30–8, 37]. In the previous lines (p. 8, 9–11 [p. 7, 27–30]) Avicenna remarks that the "conviction" (*iqnāʿ*) of the cause's existence provided by the many cases of causation apprehended by way of sensation and experience (i.e repeated sensation) is not, as such, certain. Janssens [2004] shows that, according to Avicenna's *Burhān*, experience (*tağriba*) can bestow certainty only by means of a hidden syllogism that always accompanies regular observation.

Avicenna's recourse to demonstration in metaphysics is joint with a clear awareness of the limits imposed on this procedure by the nature of the things dealt with in this discipline. Since—in good Aristotelian terms—there cannot be demonstration of everything, Avicenna marks the areas of metaphysics in which the method of demonstration cannot be applied. This restriction regards two main contexts: the axioms (the logical first principles) and God (the ontological first principle). We have already seen in Text 4 [b] that, according to Avicenna, axioms cannot be demonstrated: if there were such a demonstration, since the axioms are the first principles of demonstration, a *regressum ad infinitum* in demonstrations would follow. However, within the defense of the axiom of the excluded-middle in I, 8, Avicenna adds a long section devoted to show that this defense, despite not being a demonstration, is nonetheless a form of syllogistic argumentation.[40]

As to God, in I, 3 Avicenna remarks that the OntologyC/Theology of the *Ilāhiyyāt* will be able to follow the apodictic method (*al-ṭarīq al-burhānī*)—described as proceeding from principles to secondary things and from causes to effects—only in some groups of the ranks of the existents emanating from God (i.e. in the heavenly triads given by intellect-soul-heavenly body) and, even in this case, indistinctly (i.e. with no absolute precision).[41] Likewise, in VIII, 4 he maintains that there is no demonstration of God, since God is uncaused, and no "why" (*lima*) of Him, i.e. no cause leading to a proper demonstration ("demonstration *why*"), can be provided.[42] In IX, 7, Avicenna

[40] I, 8, pp. 49, 5–50, 4 [pp. 56, 81–58, 5].

[41] I, 3, p. 21, 6–8 [p. 24, 38–41]. In IX, 3, p. 401, 9–17 [pp. 475, 20–476, 36], Avicenna proposes two alternative views, regarded as equally possible, of the number of the heavenly intellects (ten, according to Avicenna himself; more than ten, according to Aristotle). Nonetheless, the heavenly world, according to Avicenna, results to be more suitable than the earthly one to be studied with precision: see for example, X, 1, p. 440, 14–15 [p. 530, 68–69], where Avicenna states that only the number of heavenly things causing the existence of the phaenomena that astrology presumes to predict can be determined exactly, not the number of earthly things cooperating with them. Methodological deficiences in Avicenna's account of emanation have been noticed by al-Ġazālī (see Marmura [1990], pp. 91–92), and amended by some of Avicenna's commentators, like Naṣīr al-Dīn al-Ṭūsī, by means of more rigorous procedures taken from mathematics (see R. Rashed [1999], R. Rashed [2002]).

[42] VIII, 4, p. 348, 5–6 [p. 430, 70–73]. In *Burhān* I, 7 Avicenna distinguishes the "demonstration of the why" (*burhān li-mā*) from the "demonstration of the that"

avows that he is unable to determine precisely how much knowledge is necessary to the human soul in order to obtain happiness in the afterlife, and that his view on this topic is only his personal opinion.[43]

The lack of apodictic method in OntologyC/Theology, however, is not absolute: "to demonstrate" is expressly mentioned by Avicenna as a task of metaphysics even with regard to divine matters. In IX, 2, for example, Avicenna recalls a doctrine already expounded in VIII, 7 (the type of intellection proper of the heavenly intellects) with the expression "according to what we have made evident and was our business to demonstrate" (*ʿalā mā min šaʾninā an nubarhina*).[44] In I, 1, he admits that there is a "sign" (*dalīl*), namely a "demonstration *quod*", of God's existence.[45] Thus, according to Avicenna, the human soul can truly conceptualize the first causes and principles and make certain statements abouth them, when they are present to it by means of demonstration (*bi-l-burhān*).[46] Likewise, the future destiny of the human souls that the metaphysician investigates—as opposed to the future destiny of human bodies that religion reveals—can be grasped, according to Avicenna, with the intellect and "the apodictic syllogism" (*al-qiyās al-burhānī*).[47]

1.3 *Some examples of demonstrations in the* Ilāhiyyāt

This section will provide some examples of the different argumentative procedures adopted by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*: they are either syllogisms or some of the other ways of arguing taken into account in the *Prior Analytics*, like the *reductiones ad absurdum*.[48]

(*burhān inna*) or *dalīl* (see below, n. 45): the latter proves only the truth of a state of affairs, without providing its cause, the former provides also its cause. Since God is the First Cause, no further cause of Him can be provided.

[43] IX, 7, p. 429, 4–7 [p. 515, 78–82].

[44] IX, 2, p. 384, 19 [p. 451, 41].

[45] I, 1, p. 6, 11–12 [p. 5, 78–79]. The term "sign" (*dalīl*) corresponds to *tekmerion* in the expression *syllogismos tekmeriodes* employed by the Neoplatonic commentators of Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics* in place of the Aristotelian *syllogismos hoti* (see Daiber [2004]).

[46] IX, 7, p. 429, 7–8 [p. 516, 82–84].

[47] IX, 7, p. 423, 8 [p. 507, 98]. Also the reference to *al-qiyās* (syllogism, i.e. inferential, deductive reasoning) in IX, 2, p. 393, 6 [p. 463, 78] (cp. IX, 3, p. 394, 1 [p. 465, 96]) can be taken as a reference to a scientific syllogism or demonstration.

[48] Besides the *loci* mentioned here, *reductiones ad absurdum* can be found, for exam-

In Avicenna's proof that God is not the subject-matter of metaphysics, the main argument, conveniently rephrased,[49] is a categorical syllogism of form amenable to BAROCO.[50]

Table 1

[Major premise, universal affirmative (AaB)] (p. 5, 18–19): For the subject-matter of each science is something whose existence is admitted in that science, and whose states [i.e. properties] only are investigated.
[Minor premise, particular negative (CoB)] (p. 6, 1–2): But the existence of God [. . .] cannot be assumed [. . .] in this science; it is rather a thing searched in it.
[Conclusion, particular negative (CoA)] (p. 5, 18): We do say that [God] cannot be the subject-matter [of metaphysics].

Whereas the Major premise is declared to be taken from elsewhere ("This has already been learnt elsewhere", i.e. in the *Burhān*),[51] the Minor premise is proved with a *reductio ad absurdum* reported in the following table:[52]

ple, in I, 2, p. 11, 10–11 [p. 10, 88–90]; I, 6, p. 38, 1–5 [p. 44, 24–31]; p. 38, 6–10 [p. 44, 31–37]; p. 39, 6–16 [pp. 45, 59–46, 71]; I, 7, pp. 43, 4–44, 16 [pp. 49, 40–51, 79]; p. 46, 4–12 [pp. 52, 12–53, 20]; I, 8, p. 52, 8–12 [pp. 60, 50–61, 59]; pp. 52, 13–53, 5 [pp. 61, 59–62, 74]; p. 54, 3–5 [p. 63, 98–00] (see Chapter 10, §2.1); II, 3, pp. 72, 8–74, 12 [pp. 82, 51–86, 8]; pp. 74, 13–77, 8 [pp. 86, 9–89, 75]; VII, 1, p. 303, 9–12 [p. 349, 15–18] (see Chapter 9, §3.5, Table 5 [8]).

[49] Avicenna formulates the minor premise as follows: "But the existence of God [. . .] cannot be assumed *as subject-matter* in this science; it is rather something that is sought for in it". His way of expressing his own thought, however, is imprecise, since God, rather than God's existence, is the supposed subject-matter of metaphysics. The same imprecision occurs also in the lines immediately preceding the proof ("Let us consider whether the existence [*inniyya*] of God is the subject-matter of this science", p. 5, 16–17 [p. 4, 58–60]), and affects in all likelihood its conclusion, stated soon thereafter, as well ("We do say that that [*d̲ālika*, i.e. God's existence] cannot be the subject-matter [of metaphysics]"). I rephrase the minor premise according to what appears to be Avicenna's intention, as it can be ascertained from the recapitulation of this proof a few lines later (see below, Table 3).

[50] I, 1, pp. 5, 18–6, 2 [p. 4, 60–65]; see Chapter 4, Outline 1 [3.2.2].

[51] See Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 2.2.

[52] I, 1, p. 6, 2–13 [pp. 4, 65–5, 81]; see Chapter 4, Outline 1 [3.2.3].

Table 2

(p. 6, 2) If this were not so [i.e. if God's existence were not a thing searched in metaphysics], then	
[a] (p. 6, 3) either [God's existence] would be assumed in this science and searched in another,	
	[b] (p. 6, 3–4) or it would be assumed in this science and not searched in another.
(p. 6, 4) But both cases are false.	
[non-a] (p. 6, 5–9) For [God's existence] cannot be searched in another science. Since the other sciences are either moral, or political, or physical, or mathematical, or logical (among the philosophical sciences there is no one that escapes this division), but in none of them how to establish [the existence of] God is investigated. [. . .]	
	[non-b] (p. 6, 9–12) But [God's existence] cannot either not to be searched in another science. Since, in such a case, it would not be searched in any science at all, being either [ba] clear in itself, or [bb] without hope of being clarified rationally. But is is neither clear in itself, nor without hope of being clarified, since there is an inductive proof of it. Furthermore, how the existence of what is without hope of being clarified can be taken for granted?
(p. 6, 12–13) It remains that the investigation of it occurs only in this science.	

Within the overall *reductio*, the falsity of [b] is proved in [non-b] by means of another *reductio ad absurdum*.

The recapitulation of the main argument is a categorical syllogism of form amenable to FESTINO.[53]

[53] I, 1, p. 6, 15–16 [p. 5, 83–85]; see Chapter 4, Outline 1 [3.2.4].

Table 3

[Major premise, universal negative (AeB)] (p. 6, 16): Establishing [the existence] of its subject-matter is the duty of no science.
[Minor premise, particular affirmative (CiB)] (p. 6, 15): The investigation of His [i.e. God's] existence occurs in this science.
[Conclusion, particular negative (CoA)] (p. 6, 15–16): God cannot be the subject-matter of this science.

In some cases, the form of Avicenna's syllogism is not impeccable. Let us take, for example, the proof of the fact that only metaphysics investigates God's existence:[54]

Table 4

[Major premise, particular affirmative (AiB)] (p. 6, 18–19): It has already appeared clearly to you about the status of this science that it is an investigation of things absolutely separated from matter.
[Minor premise, particular affirmative (CiB)] (pp. 6, 19–7, 1): It has already become manifest to you in the natural sciences that God is not a body nor the power of a body; rather He is one, free from matter and from being mingled with movement in every respect.
[Conclusion, particular negative (CiA)] (p. 7, 1–2) The investigation of God must belong to this science.

This syllogism would be conclusive (DARII), only if the Major Premise were "All immaterial things are investigated by this science" (BaA).

The proof that the ultimate causes cannot be the subject-matter of metaphysics is a *reductio ad absurdum*:[55]

Table 5

(p. 7, 10–13) The four causes can be investigated by metaphysics			
[a] either as existents	[b] or as absolute causes [i.e. simply as causes]	[c] or according to the specific properties of each one of them	[d] or taken altogether [i.e. according to their common features]

[54] I, 1, pp. 6, 18–7, 2 [p. 5, 87–91]; see Chapter 4, Outline 1 [3.2.5].
[55] I, 1, pp. 7, 10–9, 10 [pp. 6, 1–9, 55]; see Chapter 4, Outline 1 [3.3].

Table 5 (*cont.*)

	[non-b] (pp. 7, 14–8, 18) They cannot be subject-matter in this way		
		[non-c] (pp. 8, 18–9, 1) They cannot be subject-matter in this way	
			[non-c] (p. 9, 1–6) They cannot be subject-matter in this way
[non-a] (p. 9, 6–8) If they are subject-matter in this way, then the primary subject-matter is "existent"			
(p. 9, 9– 10) Hence, the four causes are not the subject-matter of metaphysics			

One example of disjunctive syllogism occurs in chapter II, 4, as a proof that the link between form and matter is a link of cause and effect. Here Avicenna employs a *modus tollendo ponens* ("p" or "q" or "r"; but "non-p" and "non-r"; therefore "q"), that can be sketched as follows:[56]

Table 6

[p] (p. 80, 5–6) The link between form and matter is either the link of two relatives		
[non-p] (pp. 80, 7–81, 1) But this is not the case		
	[q] (p. 81, 1) or it is the link of cause and effect	[r] (p. 81, 1–3) or it is the link of two things equal in existence, none of which is the cause of the other and both of which exist at the same time
		[non-r] (pp. 81, 3–83, 3) But this is not the case

[56] II, 4, pp. 80, 5–83, 3 [pp. 92, 30–95, 97].

Avicenna does not state explicitly that [q] results to be the true case. He does so implicitly, though, by discussing, in the part of chapter II, 4 following the proof, whether matter is the cause of form or viceversa.

Finally, chapter IX, 7 provides an interesting example of proof *more geometrico* of the happiness and misery of human souls in the afterlife: in the first part of the chapter, Avicenna provides five "fundamental principles" (lit. "roots", *uṣūl*), playing the role of "axioms", on which he bases his argumentation in the rest of the chapter.[57]

2 The analytical method: proofs by divisions, terminological distinctions, classifications

"Division" (*qisma*) is mentioned at the very beginning of *Maqūlāt* as one of the methods capable of leading to the acquisition of the knowledge of the unknown.[58] Avicenna ascribes this method, namely the use of "distinction" (*tafṣīl*), to the *Šifā'*.[59] The presence in Avicenna's metaphysics of a method that can be defined as "analytical" has already been noticed.[60] In the present section, I would like to substantiate this claim with regard to the *Ilāhiyyāt* in particular, and to expound the different forms that the method of analysis assumes in this work.[61]

Three main types of analysis can be found in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The first is the proof of a fact by taking into account all the possible perspectives from which it can be envisaged: Avicenna divides a certain state of affairs in all the cases it can entail, in order to show the truth of only one of these. The second is the practice of starting a

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[57] IX, 7, pp. 423, 13–425, 14 [pp. 507, 9–510, 70]). For Avicenna's conception of the "fundamental principles" and the "derivation of corollaries" (*tafrīʿ*), see Appendix E, [ii]–[iii].

[58] *Maqūlāt* I, 1, p. 4, 7.

[59] See the the passage of the *Letter to Kīyā* reported in Appendix E, n. 6.

[60] Marmura [1987], p. 73b: ". . . a very characteristic aspect of these writings [is] the analytic. It is here that one encounters his distinctions, clarifications and hard-headed attempts to solve problems".

[61] In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna refers to the various aspects of the analytical method by means of terms deriving from the Arabic roots *f-ṣ-l*, like "sectioning" (*tafṣīl*)—see I, 3, p. 21, 8 [p. 24, 41]; VI, 3, p. 280, 11 [p. 309, 83]; VIII, 7, p. 362, 16 [p. 423, 80]—or "section(s)" (*faṣl, fuṣūl*)—see IV, 2, p. 182, 18 [p. 210, 94]—and *q-s-m*, like "dividing" (*taqsīm*)—see VI, 3, p. 271, 2 [p. 310, 97]—and "division(s)" (*qism, aqsām*)—see VI, 3, p. 270, 12, 13, p. 271, 1 [p. 310, 85, 95].

discussion by distinguishing the different meanings of the main philosophical term at stake: Avicenna sorts out its various acceptions before proving his point about the reality it expresses. The third type of analysis is displayed by Avicenna's classifications. The first type of analysis is argumentative and occurs in the core of Avicenna's discourse; the second type has a propaedeutic function; the third type is either introductory or recapitulating.

The first type of analysis occurs frequently; the degree of accuracy with which it is applied differs from case to case. Sometimes Avicenna's divisions of the various alternatives are extremely detailed.[62] The semantic analysis in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is tightly linked with the reception of book Δ of the *Metaphysics*, Aristotle's "glossary" of metaphysical terms. As it will be shown in Chapter 8, Δ is one of the books of the *Metaphysics* most frequently and extensively quoted by Avicenna.[63] In some cases, Avicenna adds to the terminological distinctions taken from, or inspired by, *Metaphysics* Δ similar distinctions occurring in other books of the *Metaphysics* or in other works by Aristotle.[64] Avicenna's analysis of metaphysical terms, however, is not limited to his use of Δ: terminological distinctions independent from this book of the *Metaphysics* occur frequently in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[65] The classifications

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[62] See, for example, the proof of the fact that a bodily action that is neither accidental nor forced is always due to a potentiality in IV, 2, pp. 179, 4–181, 6 [pp. 205, 94–208, 49]. Avicenna first distinguishes the voluntary bodily action (in which the *demonstrandum*, he says, is evident) from the non-voluntary bodily action. Then he divides this latter case into [a] a bodily action that occurs in the body from the body itself; [b] a bodily action that occurs in the body from another body; [c] a bodily action that occurs in the body from an incorporeal thing. According to Avicenna, [a] supports the thesis to be proved; [b] can be dismissed as falling under the rubric of forced or accidental action; [c] is divided into three further cases, one of which ([ca]) is excluded as false, another ([cb]) allegedly proves the *demonstrandum*, the third ([cc]) is divided into two further cases, [cca] and [ccb]. Case [cca] is dismissed as implying a *regressum ad infinitum*; case [ccb] is divided into two further cases, [ccba] and [ccbb]. The process of division goes on in this way until it reaches branches of sixth level—[ccbaca] and [ccbacb]. By showing that all the cases taken into account either corroborate the *demonstrandum* or should be rejected, Avicenna proves that a bodily action is always due to a potentiality.

[63] See Chapter 8, §5.5.

[64] For example, in Avicenna's definition of "matter" (VI, 4, pp. 278, 13–280, 1; 281, 5–14 [pp. 320, 25–321, 51; 323, 87–99]) and "element" (VI, 4, pp. 280, 14–281, 4 [pp. 322, 74–323, 86]), passages from various books of the *Metaphysics*, the *Categories*, the *Physics* and the *De Anima* are quoted together with *Metaphysics* Δ, 2–3 (see Bertolacci [2002b], pp. 147–149).

[65] See, for example, I, 2, pp. 11, 14–12, 9 [pp. 9, 64–10, 72]; I, 3, pp. 17, 4–18, 17 [pp. 18, 35–20, 76]; II, 1, p. 59, 16 [p. 68, 64–65]; II, 2, p. 61, 7–15

by means of which Avicenna occasionally introduces or summarizes doctrines of the *Ilāhiyyāt* are comprehensive and detailed.[66]

3 Metaphysics as a non-dialectical science: Avicenna's approach to opinions and doubts

3.1 *Avicenna's attitude towards dialectic*

Avicenna regards dialectic as a form of argumentation less reliable and effective than demonstration. The passage of *Ǧadal*, in which Avicenna modifies Aristotle's remarks on dialectic as a method capable of leading to the discovery of the first principles, in order to reduce the importance of dialectic as a philosophical procedure, has been pointed out by A. Hasnawi.[67] The same reductive consideration of dialectic is visible also in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

The best instance of Avicenna's attitude towards dialectic in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is probably his reworking of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004b17–26, a passage in which Aristotle describes the similarities and the differences between metaphysics, on the one hand, and dialectic and sophistic, on the other.[68] The importance of this passage for Avicenna is witnessed by its citation not only in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, but also in *Burhān* II, 7.[69]

> Text 5.1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 16, 13–20 [pp. 17, 21–18, 32]
>
> [1] The present science shares something, in a way, with dialectic (*al-ǧadal*) and sophistic (*al-safsaṭa*); it is different, in another way, from both of them; and it is different, in [still] another way, from each of them.

[pp. 69, 91–70, 4]; III, 4, p. 116, 7–12 [p. 129, 98–04]; III, 5, pp. 124, 14–125, 2 [p. 139, 99–05]; IV, 1, pp. 167, 9–169, 8 [pp. 190, 10–192, 57]; V, 1, pp. 195, 4–196, 5 [pp. 227, 7–228, 24]; VI, 2, p. 267, 10–19 [pp. 305, 95–306, 11]; VI, 4, p. 282, 6–14 [pp. 324, 13–325, 26]; VIII, 4, p. 344, 12–15 [p. 399, 85–90]; IX, 6, p. 419, 4–11 [p. 501, 71–83].

[66] See, for example, II, 1, p. 60, 9–14 [pp. 68, 76–69, 83]; III, 2, pp. 102, 11–103, 1 [p. 113, 2–9]; VI, 1, p. 258, 1–11 [pp. 292, 25–293, 41]; VI, 3, pp. 280, 11–282, 11 [p. 309, 83–312, 41]; VI, 4, p. 280, 1–14 [pp. 321, 52–322, 73]; VI, 5, pp. 286, 14–287, 10 [pp. 330, 45–331, 62]; IX, 6, p. 421, 5–11 [p. 504, 35–44].

[67] *Ǧadal* I, 5, pp. 50, 5–51, 7; Hasnawi [2002], pp. 74–75.

[68] See the detailed analysis of this passage in comparison with its Aristotelian source in Chapter 9, §3.2.

[69] *Burhān* II, 7, pp. 165, 17–166, 15.

> [2] As to the things it shares with them, this is due to the fact that a scholar of a particular science does not discuss (*lā yatakallamu*) what is investigated in the present science, whereas the dialectician (*al-ǧadalī*) and the sophist do discuss (*yatakallamu*) about it.
>
> [3] As to the difference [from both of them], it is due to the fact that the first philosopher [i.e. the metaphysician], *qua* first philosopher, does not discuss (*lā yatakallamu*) the questions of the particular sciences, whereas they [i.e. the dialectician and the sophist] do discuss (*yatakallamāni*) [about them].
>
> [4] As to the difference from dialectic (*al-ǧadal*) in particular, it is due to capacity, since the dialectical discussion (*al-kalām al-ǧadalī*) provides opinion (*al-zann*), not what is certain (*al-yaqīn*), as you have learnt in the discipline of logic [*Ǧadal* I, 1, p. 11, 6–8, corresponding to *Top.* A, 2].
>
> [5] As to the difference from sophistic, it is due to will, since the former [i.e. the first philosopher] wants what is true itself, whereas the latter [i.e. the sophist] wants to be regarded as a wise man who says what is true, even though he is not.

Two points of Text 5.1 are remarkable.[70] First, Avicenna insists on the differences, rather than on the similarities, between metaphysics, dialectic and sophistic: he adds to Aristotle's original account, for example, section [3], which contains a further element of difference between the former discipline and the latter two. This implies that Avicenna's general aim in Text 5.1 is mainly to distinguish metaphysics from dialectic and sophistic. Second, in section [4] Avicenna points out that the methods of dialectic produces "opinion" (*al-zann*), not certainty (*al-yaqīn*): this implies that certainty is produced by metaphysics by means of a different method.

The identity of the higher method used by metaphysics, i.e. demonstration, is made clear by the passage of *Burhān* parallel to Text 5.1. In the relevant part of this long text, the premises used by metaphysics are qualified not only as "certain" (*yaqīniyya*), but also as "apodictic" (*burhāniyya*).

> Text 5.2: *Burhān* II, 7, p. 166, 7–9
>
> First philosophy distinguishes itself from [dialectic and sophistic] in the starting-point. For first philosophy takes its starting-points from

[70] In describing the procedures of dialectic and sophistic in sections [2]–[4], Avicenna constantly uses the verb "to discuss" (*tatakallama*), or nominal forms related to it (*kalām*); these terms might refer to the arguments *ad personam* ("dialectical" in the etymological sense) used by dialectic and sophistic.

> premises that are apodictic and certain (*al-muqaddimāt al-burhāniyya al-yaqīniyya*). As to dialectic, its starting-point is from premises that are truly generally known (*al-d̲āʾiʿa*) and commonly accepted (*al-mašhūra*). As to sophistic, its starting-point is from premises that seem to be generally known (*al-d̲āʾiʿa*) or certain (*al-yaqīniyya*), but are not truly so.

Texts 5.1–2 document Avicenna's scarce consideration for dialectic and sophistic in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. He shows the same attitude towards other forms of syllogistic argumentation, like the rhetorical and the poetical, that he regards as even more distant from demonstration.[71]

Some of Avicenna's implicit quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* might contain a criticism of Aristotle's use of dialectic.[72] Since in the *Metaphysics* Aristotle relies on dialectic, mainly, in the criticism of the predecessors' opinions in books A, Z, Λ, M and N, and in the discussion of the problems that arise when a reliable doctrine or state of things conflicts with another doctrine or state of things equally reliable (the *aporiai*), Avicenna's treatment of these two aspects of the method of the *Metaphysics* will be examined in the following two sections.

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[71] In X, 1, p. 440, 4–6 [p. 529, 49–53], for example, astrology is criticized by Avicenna for not relying on demonstration (*burhān*), and using instead experience (*taǧriba*), divine inspiration (*waḥy*) and rhetorical and poetical syllogisms (*qiyāsāt šiʿriyya aw-ḫaṭābiyya*) to prove its premises. For Avicenna's contempt for the "indicative method" in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see above, Text 3. In I, 8, p. 51, 8–11 [p. 59, 30–34], he points to the confusion determined in common people, with regard to the truth of the axioms, by what Gutas [1988], pp. 299–307, calls the "symbolic method". Cp. the following passage of the *Memoirs*: "By God, among the books of confused people that we have studied carefully, never have our eyes fallen on anything more astray and tortuous than the contents of these books [i.e. of the commentaries on Aristotle's logic, natural philosophy and metaphysics by Abū-l-Faraǧ Ibn-al-Ṭayyib]: the scant attention to subjects (*al-maʿānī*), the narrow scope of exposition, the dubious argumentation that fails to convince, *the use of rhetorical and sophistical methods in the demonstrative sciences*, and the inconsistent procedures" (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 69, slightly modified; emphasis added).

[72] Some of Aristotle's terminological remarks in *Metaph.* Δ are portrayed by Avicenna as a "commonly accepted belief" (*mašhūr*), or as points of view of the "common people" (*al-ǧumhūr*; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [7–9, 11]; §5.5, n. 52) or as conjectural and persuasive rather than apodictic (see above, Text 3). In *Šarḥ Lām*, p. 31, 16–18, Avicenna criticizes Aristotle's statement "For it is better not seeing rather than seeing many things" (Λ, 9, 1074b32–33) as "a saying most characteristic of the vulgar" (*kalām ʿāmmī ǧiddan*; Engl. transl. in Pines [1987], p. 192). In *Memoirs*, p. 209, 16, Avicenna regards some of Aristotle's examples in the *Sophistici Elenchi* as expressing "common definitions" (*ḥudūd ʿāmmiyya*; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 71).

3.2 *Doxographies*

In a passage of IX, 3, after expounding and criticizing a false opinion about the heavenly motion, and before providing a fuller account of its falseness (see below, Table 7), Avicenna states the following:

> Text 6.1: *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 3, p. 395, 16–17 [p. 467, 48–50]
> Since this clarification requires a longer treatment and a verification (*taḥqīq*), and contains objections that can be solved only with a complete discussion, let us turn to the more evident method (*al-ṭarīq al-awḍaḥ*).

This text makes clear that for Avicenna the discussions of false opinions, albeit useful, cannot replace the "more evident method", i.e. demonstration, the only one which provides certainty.

In the *Ilāhiyyāt*, the critical evaluation of the predecessors' opinions occurring in the *Metaphysics* is not omitted, as in other works:[73] the task of criticising certain wrong views, corresponding to the ones reported by Aristotle, is mentioned in I, 4 as part of the program of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, and recalled in III, 1.[74] This doxographical survey, however, is quoted with a subordinate role. First, Aristotle's discussion of the previous philosophers' views on causes and principles in almost three entire books of the *Metaphysics* (A, M, N) is summarized by Avicenna in two sole chapters at the end of HenologyP (VII, 2–3);[75] thus, whereas in the *Metaphysics* this doxographical survey is

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[73] Outside the *Šifa'*, the Aristotelian surveys of the predecessors' opinions are rarely taken into account: in *Šarḥ Lām*, for example, the opinions mentioned by Aristotle in Λ, 6 (1071b31–1072a9) and Λ, 10 (1075a28–1076a4) are not commented upon (see Janssens [2003], pp. 412–413). Likewise, in the *Mašriqiyyūn* Aristotle's discussion of opinions concerning the soul is completely and avowedly omitted (see Gutas [2000], p. 173). In the *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī*, Avicenna makes clear that Aristotle's discussion of the predecessors' opinions in the *De Caelo* has not to be taken as a demonstration (pp. 12, 11–13, 3: "Second question [by al-Bīrūnī]: Why does Aristotle regard the statements of [thinkers of] past centuries and previous ages about the heaven, and the fact that they find it different from how he finds it, a strong proof, which he mentions in two places of his book [i.e. *De Caelo* B, 1 and Γ, 1], for the incorruptibility of the heaven and its eternity, whereas anyone who is not sectarian and does not incline to falsehood knows for sure that this [fact] is unknown, and that about the duration of the heaven we know only few of the many things that the People of the Book say? [. . .] Answer [by Avicenna]: You must know that that does not amount to providing the demonstration (*al-burhān*) [of the issue at stake], but is only a thing to which the conflict of opinion [between Aristotle and the previous thinkers] leads").

[74] I, 4, p. 27, 2–3 [p. 30, 65–67]; III, 1, p. 95, 13–14 [p. 106, 62–64].

[75] See Chapter 5, §4.5.

extensive, noticeable (in so far as it both opens and closes the work) and important, in Avicenna is shorter, less visible and serving as a kind of appendix.[76] Second, Aristotle's dialectical defense of the axioms (Γ, 3–8) is reworked by Avicenna in I, 8 with two main modifications: on the one hand, he adds a long section devoted to show that this defense is a form of syllogistic argumentation;[77] on the other hand, he shortens drastically Aristotle's discussion of the opinions of those who deny the axioms.[78] Thus, Avicenna's defense of the axioms is both closer to a demonstration and less dialectical than Aristotle's.[79] The same tendency to reduce the importance of Aristotle's doxographies can be observed also in other parts of the *Šifā'*.[80]

In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna faces not only opinions reported by Aristotle in the *Metaphysics*, but also views taken from elsewhere.[81] The space accorded to the discussion of these opinions is a secondary, but significant, element of Avicenna's method. In some cases,

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[76] This emerges clearly from the aforementioned place of III, 1, where Avicenna states that the solution of the difficulties adavanced by those (Pythagoreans and Plato) who regard continuous and discrete quantities as substances and principles (i.e. chapters VII, 2–3) has to be postponed to the proof of their accidentality (provided in III, 3–4).

[77] I, 8, pp. 49, 5–50, 4 [pp. 56, 81–58, 5].

[78] See I, 8, p. 53, 10–11 [p. 62, 82–83].

[79] Aristotle's doxographies are quoted not only in I, 8 and VII, 2–3, but occasionally also elsewhere in the *Ilāhiyyāt*; they are taken mainly, but not exclusively, from the *Metaphysics*: see III, 6, p. 128, 12–16 [pp. 142, 68–143, 75] (*Metaph.* A, 5, 986a22–26; see Bertolacci [1999]); III, 6, p. 132, 14–15 [p. 148, 70–72] (*Metaph.* I, 1, 1053a35–b3); IV, 2, pp. 176, 14–177, 5 [p. 202, 35–42] (*Metaph.* Θ, 3, 1046b29–30, 1047a14–17, 1047a7–10); IV, 2, pp. 182, 18–183, 11 [pp. 210, 93–211, 10] (*Metaph.* Λ, 6, 1071b27–28; 1072a5; 1072a8); VI, 4, p. 281, 1–2 [pp. 322, 79–323, 83] (*Metaph.* B, 3, 998b9–11; see Chapter 10, §2.2); VII, 1, pp. 306, 5–9 [pp. 352, 79–353, 86] (*Eth. Nic.* A, 4); pp. 306, 9–307, 10 [pp. 353, 87–354, 14] (*Metaph.* A, 5, 986a22–26); VIII, 4, pp. 344, 16–345, 5 [p. 399, 85–99] (*Metaph.* B, 4, 1001a9–19; see Chapter 10, §2.4); VIII, 6, p. 357, 16–17 [p. 415, 32–34] (see above, Text 2).

[80] In *Samā'* I, 4 and I, 14 the doxographies of *Physics* A, 2–5 and B, 4 are presented as incidental topics, dealt with due to the disciples' request and out of respect for tradition (*Samā'* I, 4, p. 26, 5–6 [p. 43, 3–7]; p. 28, 16–17 [p. 48, 89–90]; I, 14, p. 67, 7–9 [p. 120, 5–8]; see Hasnawi [2000], pp. 511–512; Hasnawi [2002], p. 75). In *Nafs*, the doxographical part, taken from Aristotle's *De Anima*, is placed at the very end of the work as a sort of appendix (V, 7). Aristotle's discussion of other philosophers' opinions appears to have a more substantive role in *Kawn wa-Fasād* 1–3.

[81] To this latter group belong the wrong doctrines regarding OntologyC/Theology whose discussion is mentioned in the "table of contents" of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (I, 4, p. 27, 8–9 [p. 30, 82–83]); see the last seven opinions reported below in Table 7.

Avicenna's target is Aristotle himself; more frequently are post-Aristotelian philosophers. Avicenna's implicit criticism of some Aristotelian metaphysical and logical doctrines will be taken into account in Chapter 8;[82] the following table gathers the passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt* where Avicenna faces opinions held by other thinkers.

Table 7: Opinions (not reported or endorsed by Aristotle) discussed by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*

Opinion	Avicenna's attitude
I, 1, pp. 5, 15–7, 6 (*yuẓannu*, p. 7, 7): God is the subject-matter of metaphysics	criticism
I, 1, pp. 7, 6–9, 10 (*yaẓunnu qawm*, p. 7, 9): the four ultimate causes are the subject-matter of metaphysics	criticism
I, 5, pp. 32, 6–34, 9 (*al-qawm allaḏīna yarawna hāḏā l-ray'*, p. 33, 16 = Mu'tazilites, according to Marmura [1985], Wisnovsky [2003], pp. 145–155): a "thing" can be absolutely non-existent (pp. 33, 16–34, 9: some non-existents have no thing-ness, is an opinion held by a different group of Mu'tazilites, according to Wisnovsky [2003], pp. 155–156)	criticism
I, 5, pp. 34, 9–14 (*qawm yaqūlūna*): *ḥāṣil* is other than *mawǧūd; šay'* can be neither existent nor non-existent; *šay'* is other than *allaḏī* and *mā*	criticism
I, 5, p. 36, 6–19: (*qawl man yaqūlu*): what has ceased to exist can be brought back to existence	criticism
II, 1, p. 58, 10–16 (*kaṯīr mimman yadʿā al-maʿrifata* = Porphyry): something can be both substance and accident from different points of view	criticism
II, 2, p. 65, 5–9 (*ashal al-maḏāhib naqḍan*): branch of atomism supposing that atoms have different shapes	criticism recalled from *Samāʿ*
II, 2, pp. 65, 9–66, 14 (*maḏhab wa-ta'y*): branch of atomism supposing that atoms have the same shape	criticism

[82] See Chapter 8, §4.

Table 7 (*cont.*)

Opinion	Avicenna's attitude
III, 4, pp. 114, 13–115, 4 (*man zanna*): surface, line and point can be imagined to be what they are in separation from a solid	criticism
III, 4, p. 115, 5–15 (*allaḏī yuqālu*): the point's motion causes the line's existence	criticism
III, 4, p. 116, 3–117, 5 (*qad zunna, allaḏī yaẓunnuhū*): the angle is a fourth type of continuous quantity	criticism
III, 5, pp. 122, 13–123, 12 (*qad qāla baʿḍuhum*): two is not a number	criticism
III, 7, pp. 134, 8–139, 13 (*min al-nās man yarʾā*): qualities are substances	criticism
III, 9, pp. 146, 8–148, 13 (*maḏhab man yurakkibu l-maqādīr min aǧzāʾin lā tataǧazzaʾu*): atomism	criticism
III, 10, pp. 156, 6–160, 9 (*qawm ḏahabū . . . wa-qawm qālū*): two opinions about relation: it exists in the soul/it exists in reality	acceptance of the second opinion
IV, 2, pp. 172, 13–173, 12 (*yuẓannu*): what can only act does not have potentiality to act	criticism
IV, 2, p. 183, 4–6 (*baʿḍu al-šāriʿīna fīmā lā yaʿnīhi wa-lā lahū daraǧat al-ḫawḍ fī miṯlihī*): the Soul was encharged with governing the matter and bestowing to it the form, but she did not perform well its task, so the Creator Himself came into her help and improved what she had done (= Abū-Bakr al-Rāzī?)	criticism
IV, 2, p. 183, 7–8 (*ʿāmma min al-qudamāʾ . . . minhum man qāla*): the original matter (?) moved eternally by nature by means of disordered motions, set in order by the Creator (= Plato?)	criticism
V, 1, p. 202, 9–203, 14 (*al-šubha . . . li-ṭāʾifa mimman tatašaḥḥaṭu fī l-tafalsuf*, p. 202, 15–16 = Aristotelians of Baġdād?; Abū al-Qāsim al-Kirmānī?): animal *qua* animal does not exist in individual animals	criticism
VI, 1, pp. 261, 5–263, 18 (*zanna zānn*): the agent causes only the beginning of the existence of the effect, not its permanence in existence	criticism
VI, 2, pp. 264, 5–265, 5 (*allaḏī yuẓannu*): the effects remain after their causes have ceased to exist	criticism

Table 7 (*cont.*)

Opinion	Avicenna's attitude
VI, 2, p. 267, 10–19 (*min al-nās man . . . min al-nās man . . .*): two opinions on the meaning of "creation": production of something immaterial by the First Cause without any intermediate cause/regardless whether there is an intermediate cause	qualified acceptance of both positions
VI, 3, pp. 269, 1–270, 10 (*yuẓannu, yurā*): common opinions on the relationship between the agent bestowing one of its own features to the effect, and its effect	partial criticism
IX, 1, p. 376, 11–15 (*baʿḍuhum*, p. 376, 12): will is a state that begins to exist in God, but is external to His self	criticism
IX, 1, pp. 379, 13–381, 8 (*hāʾulāʾi al-muʿaṭṭila*, p. 380, 11): the world is created in time	criticism
IX, 3, pp. 393, 16–395, 16 (*qawm . . . yaqūlu*): the difference of the heavenly movements is aimed at ensuring the permanence of the species in the sublunary world	criticism
IX, 3, pp. 399, 8–401, 9 (*al-qudm min aḥdaṯ al-mutafalsifa al-islāmiyya fī tašwīš al-falsafa iḏ lam yafham ġaraḍ al-aqdamīn* = Abū-l-Ḥasan al-ʿĀmirī): the celestial bodies strive to assimilate themselves to other celestial bodies	criticism
IX, 5, pp. 413, 1–414, 13 (*qawm min al-muntasibīna ilā ahl al-ʿilm* = al-Kindī?): the four elements are generated by the movements of the heavenly bodies, without any intervention of the heavenly souls and the Agent Intellect	criticism
IX, 7, pp. 431, 12–432, 12 (*baʿḍ al-ʿulamāʾ*): common people undergo rewards and punishments in the afterlife by way of imagination	acceptance
X, 1, p. 440, 4–19 (*al-munaǧǧim al-qāʾil bi-l-aḥkām*): astrology	criticism

Non only the number of the opinions discussed is noteworthy, but also the space that Avicenna accords to them: in some cases, as in III, 7, the discussion is not just one of the topics of a chapter, but its main theme. Avicenna, however, always discusses these opinions with a theoretical, rather than doxographical, purpose, in so far as they invalidate (or, more rarely, corroborate) particular points of the

doctrines he holds; their scrutiny serves thus to confirm and further clarify Avicenna's own view.[83]

Avicenna tests the value of the opinions he discusses on the basis of logical parameters. During the discussion of the opinion reported in IX, 5, pp. 413, 1–414, 13, for example, he states the following:

> Text 6.2: *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 5, p. 413, 7–8 [p. 492, 88–90]
> This is what they say. But this cannot be ascertained by means of a syllogistic discussion (*bi-l-kalām al-qiyāsī*), nor is it sound, once it is thoroughly examined.

The "syllogistic discussion" mentioned in this text is, once again, demonstration. Even though the discussion of opinions has a relevant methodological function in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, it is meant as a complement of the apodictic procedures examined in §2.

3.3 Aporiai

Avicenna's attitude towards the *aporiai* raised and discussed by Aristotle in the *Metaphysics*, i.e. his reception of book B, will be taken into account in Chapter 10. As in the case of the opinions reported by Aristotle, also in the case of Aristotle's *aporiai* Avicenna reduces their number, extent and impact: he selects only some of them, quotes part of their content, and scatters the quotations throughout the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Furthermore, he subordinates Aristotle's aporetic method to probatory and apodictic procedures: almost always he quotes the *aporiai* together with their solution.

Difficulties not considered by Aristotle are frequently faced by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. These difficulties, however, differ from Aristotle's *aporiai* in a double respect: they are mentioned after the positive exposition of the doctrine, as objections that can be moved to it; they are never left unsolved, but are always followed by their solution.

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[83] It does not seem coincidental that the holders of these opinions are never mentioned by their proper names or by means of definite descriptions easy to identify, like the ones that Avicenna uses for Aristotle, Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius (see Appendix B, I.2).

Table 8: Objections taken into account by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*

objection	Avicenna's answer
I, 2, p. 14, 1–3 (*li-qā'il an yaqūla*): metaphysics does not take into account the principles of "existent"	I, 2, p. 14, 3–13 (*fa-l-ǧawāb ʿan hāḏā*)
I, 3, p. 19, 10–13 (*illā anna li-sā'ilin an yas'ala fa-yaqūla*): if metaphyscs takes for granted the conclusions of natural philosophy and mathematics, it cannot prove the principles of these two disciplines	I, 2, pp. 19, 13–20, 18 (*wa-llaḏī yaǧibu an yuqāla fī ḥall hāḏihī l-šubha*)
I, 3, p. 22, 4–7 (*wa-lākinnahū li-qā'il an yaqūla*): also arithmetic and geometry are sciences of what comes before nature	I, 3, pp. 22, 8–24, 9 (*fa-llaḏī yaǧibu an yuqāla fī hāḏā l-taškīk*)
I, 7, p. 46, 13–14 (*fa-in qāla qā'il*): the fact that necessary existence belongs to the Necessary Existent does not prevent it from belonging to something else	I, 7, pp. 46, 14–47, 5 (*fa-naqūlu*)
I, 8, p. 54, 3–5 (*qad yutašakkaku*): metaphysics does not take into account axioms and substance	I, 8, p. 54, 6–17 (*fa-naqūlu*)[84]
II, 2, p. 65, 5–7 (*li-qā'il an yaqūla*): bodies are aggregates of atoms	II, 2, p. 65, 8–9 (*qad takallamnā ʿalā ibṭāl hāḏā*)
II, 2, p. 65, 9–10 (*in qāla qā'il*): atoms have similar shapes	II, 2, pp. 65, 10–66, 14 (*yaǧibu an yubṭala maḏhabuhū wa-ray'uhū bi-mā aqūlu*)
II, 2, p. 67, 14–15 (*li-sā'il an yas'ala*): prime matter is compounded by matter and form	II, 2, pp. 67, 16–68, 10 (*fa-naqūlu*)
II, 3, p. 76, 9 (*fa-in qīla*): two substances can become one	II, 3, p. 76, 9–13 (*fa-naqūlu*)
II, 4, p. 86, 10–12 (*li-qā'ilin an yaqūla*): matter cannot receive its existence from the Giver of Forms through its form	II, 4, pp. 86, 13–87, 5 (*fa-naqūlu*)
II, 4, p. 87, 6–8 (*wa-lākin li-qā'il an yaqūla*): matter, being one in number, cannot by caused by both the Giver of Forms and its form, which are one in species	II, 4, p. 87, 8–12 (*fa-naqūlu*)
III, 1, pp. 93, 15–94, 1 (*allāhumma illā an yaqūla qā'il*): action does not exist in what causes it, but in what is affected by it	II, 4, p. 94, 1–2 (*fa-laysa yaḍurru*)

[84] See Chapter 10, §2.1.

Table 8 (*cont.*)

objection	Avicenna's answer
III, 3, p. 105, 15–16 (*in qāla qā'il*): multiplicity can consist of things that are not unities	III, 3, p. 105, 16–18 (*fa-naqūlu*)
III, 3, p. 109, 11–14 (*wa-laysa li-qā'il an yaqūla*): unity is inseparable from the thing whose unity it is as the genus is inseparable from the species	III, 3, pp. 109, 15–110, 3 (*fa-naqūlu laysa l-amr ka-ḏālika*)
III, 6, p. 126, 9–12 (*wa-lākin li-qā'il an yaqūla*): unity and multiplicity are contraries	III, 6, pp. 126, 13–128, 2 (*fa-naqūlu fī ǧawāb hāḏā l-insān*)
III, 8, p. 140, 5–9 (*fa-ammā l-ʿilm fa-inna fīhi šubha. wa-ḏālika li-anna li-qā'il an yaqūla . . .*): if forms of substances are substances, they cannot exist in the intellect and be known by it	III, 8, p. 140, 10–15 (*fa-naqūlu*)[85]
III, 9, p. 147, 10–11 (*fa-in qāla qā'il*): it is impossible to build a circle using atoms, as Avicenna has done	III, 9, pp. 147, 11–148, 8 (*fa-innā naqūlu lahū*)
IV, 1, p. 167, 6–8 (*li-qā'il an yaqūla*) simultaneity in existence and non-existence prevents cause and effect to be causally related	IV, 1, pp. 167, 9–169, 14 (*naḥnu naǧību ʿan ḏālika*); see p. 169, 9 (*naqūlu fī ḥall al-šubha*)
V, 1, p. 199, 10–11 (*fa-in sa'alnā sā'ilun*): stating about "humanity" that is not so-and-so implies that it is different from simple humanity	V, 1, p. 199, 11–13 (*fa-naqūlu*)
V, 1, p. 202, 9–16 (*li-qā'ilin an yaqūla*): animal *qua* animal does not exist in individual animals	V, 1, pp. 202, 16–203, 14 (*fa-naqūlu*)
V, 3, p. 219, 4 (*fa-in qāla qā'il*): to the genus "body", as conceived by Avicenna, everything can be attached as differentia	V, 3, p. 219, 4–14 (*fa-naqūlu*)
V, 4, p. 226, 10–11 (*wa-lākin li-qā'il an yaqūla*): Avicenna's account of the genus makes this latter identical to an individual	V, 4, pp. 226, 12–227, 9 (*fa-naqūlu*)
V, 6, p. 231, 6–13 (*min al-šukūk allatī taʿriḍu ʿalā hāḏā al-kalām*): there is a *regressum ad infinitum* in the *differentiae*	V, 6, pp. 231, 14–235, 1 (*allaḏī yaǧibu an yuʿlama ḥattā yanḥalla bihī hāḏā al-šakk*)
V, 7, p. 236, 4–9 (*li-qā'il an yaqūla*): genus cannot be predicated of the species, since it is a part of this latter	V, 7, pp. 236, 9–237, 4 (*fa-naqūlu*)

[85] The remainder of chapter III, 8 (pp. 140, 16–144, 6 [pp. 158, 57–163, 43]) is the answer to four further objections that can be moved to this reply.

Table 8 (*cont.*)

objection	Avicenna's answer
VI, 1, p. 260, 12 (*fa-in qāla qā'il*): not only the effect's existence, but also the fact that the effect exists after not having existed, has a cause	VI, 1, pp. 260, 13–261, 4 (*fa-naqūlu*)
VI, 2, p. 265, 12–17 (*lākinna al-iškāl hunā fī šay'*): Avicenna's doctrine entails an infinite number of simultaneous causes	VI, 2, pp. 265, 17–266, 5 (*fa-naqūlu*)
VI, 3, p. 272, 12–13 (*li-qā'il an yaqūla*): Avicenna does not take into account the case in which cause and effect are immaterial	VI, 3, p. 272, 13–15 (*fa-l-ǧawāb ʿan hāḏā*)
VI, 3, p. 274, 5–7 (*in qāla qā'il*): sometimes the effect is more intense than its cause, as when fire makes metals incandescent	VI, 3, pp. 274, 7–276, 3 (*fa-innā naǧību*); see p. 276, 1 (*mā tanḥallu bihī al-šubha*)
VI, 5, pp. 283, 15–284, 1 (*lam yatabayyan baʿdu*): not every motion has a final cause	VI, 5, pp. 284, 8–288, 17 (*ammā al-šakk al-awwal . . . fa-naḥulluhū*); see p. 287, 11–12 (*qawl man yaqūlu . . . huwa qawl kāḏib*), p. 287, 13–14 (*qawl al-qā'il . . . huwa qawl kāḏib*)
VI, 5, p. 284, 1–4 (*ṯumma li-qā'il an yaqūla*): there is *regressio ad infinitum* in the final causes	VI, 5, pp. 288, 18–291, 18 (*ammā al-šakk allāḏī yalīhi fa-yunkašafu . . .*)
VI, 5, p. 284, 4–6 (*ṯumma li-qā'il an yaqūla*): the final cause does not precede the other causes	VI, 5, pp. 292, 1–294, 5 (*ammā al-šakk allāḏī yalīhi fa-yanḥallu . . .*)
VIII, 2, pp. 332, 6–333, 8 (*li-qā'il an yaqūla*); p. 333, 9–11 (*wa-ayḍan*); p. 333, 12–17 (*wa-ayḍan*); pp. 333, 18–334, 11 (*wa-ayḍan*); pp. 334, 12–335, 2 (*wa-ayḍan*): objections raised against Aristotle's doctrine of the finiteness of the material causes expounded by Avicenna in VIII, 1	VIII, 2, pp. 335, 3–337, 8 (*ḥall hāḏihi l-šukūk*); p. 337, 7–21 (*ammā al-šubha . . . fa-ḥalluhā . . .*); pp. 338, 1–340, 2 (*ammā al-šubha . . . fa-l-ǧawāb . . .*); p. 340, 3–8 (*ammā al-šakk . . . fa-ḥalluhū . . .*)[86]
VIII, 4, p. 344, 6–7 (*in qāla qā'il*): there is *regressio ad infinitum* in the relations of the Necessary Existent with the other things	VIII, 4, p. 344, 8–9: the relation has already been shown to be finite (cp. III, 10)
cp. VIII, 4, p. 346, 3–4 (*. . . law qāla qā'il*)	VIII, 4, p. 346, 5–6 (*fa-lā ḍayra . . .*)

[86] The second objection (p. 333, 9–11 [p. 383, 56–59]) apparently is not answered by Avicenna. The solution of both the first and the fourth objection contains the exposition and solution of a further objection moved against the solution itself (p. 336, 13–19 [p. 338, 50–58]: *wa-laysa li-qā'il an yaqūla . . . fa-l-ǧawāb ʿan ḏālika anna . . .*; pp. 339, 15–340, 2 [p. 392, 47–57]: *fa-in qāla qā'il . . . fa-l-ǧawāb ʿan ḏālika anna . . .*).

Table 8 (*cont.*)

objection	Avicenna's answer
VIII, 4, p. 348, 6–8 (*li-qā'il an yaqūla*): the genus of the Necessary Existent is substance	VIII, 4, pp. 348, 8–349, 6 (*fa-naqūlu*): the definition of substance that applies to the Necessary Existent is not the definition of substance as a genus
VIII, 6, pp. 364, 16–365, 17: various possibilities of explaining how God knows the intelligibles	VIII, 6, p. 366, 1–7 (*yanbaġī an taǧtahida ǧihdaka fī l-taḫalluṣi min hāḏihi l-šubha*)
IX, 1, pp. 378, 16–379, 1 (*lā maʿnā fīmā yaqūluhū qā'il*): the question why God has chosen existence rather than non-existence at a certain point of time is pointless because can be raised at any time	IX, 1, p. 379, 1–2 (*bal*): just because it can be raised at any time, the question is not pointless
IX, 2, pp. 384, 14–385, 3 (*wa-lākin qad yumkin an yutawahhama*): the proximate mover of the celestial spheres could be a changing intellect	IX, 2, pp. 385, 4–386, 13 (*fa-naqūlu*): the proximate mover of the celestial spheres is a soul
IX, 3, p. 396, 11; p. 397, 3–4; p. 398, 1–2; p. 398, 9–10 (*in qāla qā'il*): four objections against Avicenna's doctrine that the celestial movement's goal is not the benefit of the sublunar world	IX, 3, pp. 396, 11–397, 2 (*qīla*); p. 397, 4–19 (*fa-naqūlu*); p. 398, 2–8 (*fa-l-ǧawāb*); pp. 398, 10–12
IX, 4, p. 404, 8–10 (*wa-lākin li-qā'il an yaqūla*): the first thing starting to exist from the First Principle is a material form from which the existence of its matter necessarily follows	IX, 4, pp. 404, 10–405, 9 (*fa-naqūlu*)
IX, 6, p. 418, 12–13 (*in qāla qā'il*): God could have created a pure good free from evil	IX, 6, pp. 418, 13–419, 4 (*fa-naqūlu*)
IX, 6, p. 421, 12 (*in qīla*): why did not God eliminate the evil completely from what is both good and evil?	IX, 6, pp. 421, 12–422, 8 (*fa-yuqālu*)
IX, 6, p. 422, 9 (*in qāla qā'il*): the evil is not less frequent than the good	IX, 6, p. 422, 9–18 (*fa-laysa huwa ka-ḏālika*)

As the criticism of opinions, also the reply to objections is an important element of the method of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Not only objections are raised and answered frequently: sometimes they are the only topic of a chapter (III, 8; VIII, 1), or one of the most important themes therein, as their mention in the title witnesses (VI, 2; VI, 5).[87] The

[87] VI, 2, p. 264, 3 [p. 300, 92]; VI, 5, p. 283, 12 [p. 326, 50].

quite articulated structure of some of Avicenna's answers makes clear how much care he puts in solving the objections.[88]

In the *Ilāhiyyāt*, the discussion of objections is not radically distinct from the criticism of opinions.[89] The last chapter in which Avicenna criticizes an opinion is IX, 7 (see above, Table 7). The rejection of objections ends with IX, 6. Thus, in Prophetology (X, 1–3) and in the appendix on practical philosophy (X, 4–5) the method of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is less developed (as far as discussion of opinions and answers to objectives are concerned, at least) than in the previous sections.

4 The sources of Avicenna's conception of metaphysics as an apodictic science

4.1 *Aristotle*

Aristotle's explicit remarks on method in the *Metaphysics* are rare and elliptic; many of them concern metaphysics only indirectly. Nowhere in this work he links expressly metaphysics and demonstration.[90] The

[88] In III, 8 and VIII, 2, for example, Avicenna defends the answer he provides from further objections (see above, nn. 85–86). In V, 6, the treatment of the objection is structured like a Latin medieval *responsio*: exposition of the difficulty (p. 231, 6–13); first premise of the answer (pp. 231, 14–232, 15); second premise of the answer (pp. 232, 16–233, 6); answer (pp. 233, 7–234, 4); example (p. 234, 5–9); criticism of the objection's premises (pp. 234, 10–235, 1); I wish to thank Prof. Olga Weijers for her observations on this passage.

[89] Some passages (like II, 2, p. 65, 5–9; pp. 65, 9–66, 14; V, 1, p. 202, 9–203, 14) perform both functions.

[90] In the *Metaphysics*, demonstration is often taken into account incidentally, as an example of a broader topic, or in order to point out the subjects to which it does not apply and the thinkers who did not make use of it. Thus, in book Δ it is an instance of "element" (Δ, 3, 1014a35–b3) or "necessary" (Δ, 5, 1015b6–9). In E, 1, 1025b10–16 (cp. K, 7, 1064a4–10), Aristotle remarks that the particular sciences demonstrate only the properties of their subject-matters (cp. Γ, 3, 1005a25–27), not also the substance or essence of them. In Z, 15, 1039b27–1040a2, it is stressed that sensible particular substances have neither definition nor demonstration. In Λ, 8, 1073a21–22, Aristotle blames a version of the Platonic doctrine of the ideas-numbers for its lack of apodictic rigour (cp. N, 1, 1087b18–21). A specific and constant concern with demonstration emerges only in book B (within the discussion of *aporiai* 2–4) and in book Γ, in the context of the defense of the axioms of non-contradiction and excluded-middle (Γ, 3–8). In the former case it is not clear whether Aristotle personally endorses the arguments he is advancing. For Aristotle's remarks on demonstration in the latter case, see Chapter 9, §3.4.

indications he provides are a possible attribution to metaphysics of the method of mathematics (Text 7), a note on the methodological importance of the *Posterior Analytics* (Text 8), and the characterization of metaphysics as the science that provides true knowledge, in distinction from dialectic and sophistic (Text 9).

A few lines of chapter α, 3 (995a12–17)—the only chapter of the *Metaphysics* to be entirely devoted to methodological issues—are relevant for metaphysics.

> Text 7: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* α, 3, 995a12–17
>
> [a] Therefore someone must be instructed in knowing the way of [clarifying] every thing that he desires to clarify (*fī maʿrifat sabīl kulli wāḥidin min al-ašyāʾ allatī yarūmu tabyīnahā*, πῶς ἕκαστα ἀποδεκτέον), since it is inconvenient to investigate at the same time a science and the mode (*al-ǧiha*, τρόπον) in which it should be clarified; it is not even easy to find one of [these] two things.
>
> [b] It is not necessary to seek in every science a discussion as thorough as the one of mathematics. It is necessary to seek such [a discussion] only in the case of what is not mixed with matter.
>
> [c] Therefore this mode (*hāḏihi al-ǧiha*, ὁ τρόπος) is not natural.
>
> [d] For it is convenient that all nature . . . is mixed with matter.[91]

In section [a] Aristotle states that the "mode" (*al-ǧiha*, τρόπος), or method, of a science has to be investigated preliminarily: it basically consists in knowing "the way of [clarifying] every thing that someone desires to clarify", i.e. the gnoseological approach peculiar to each science (in the previous lines Aristotle has pointed at mathematical procedures, the use of examples, the reliance on the authority of poets etc., as instances of different methods), and its determination is as difficult as the acquisition of the science itself. Since Aristotle's

[91] *Tafsīr*, p. 45, 5–8; p. 49, 5–9 (Isḥāq's transl.). "Therefore one must be already trained to know how each thing has to be taken since it is absurd to seek at the same time a science and the mode of a science; and neither is easy to get. The minute accuracy of mathematics is not to be demanded in all cases, but only in the case of things that have no matter. Therefore the method is not that of natural science. For presumably all nature has matter" (modified). Usṭāṯ's translation of this passage in the *Tafsīr* (p. 45, 4–5, bottom of page; p. 49, 1–2, bottom of page) presents several lacunae. It is noteworthy that ἀποδεκτέον in [a] is rendered by Usṭāṯ as "the demonstration . . . is provided" (*yuʾaddā burhān*), as if the Greek manuscript translated by Usṭāṯ had *ἀποδεικτέον instead of ἀποδεκτέον (the same happens in the codex Laurentianus 87.12). Thus, an Arab reader of Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics* could get the impression that, according to Aristotle, the method of each science is, in general terms, apodictic.

statement applies to every science, it regards also metaphysics: also the method of metaphysics, therefore, according to Aristotle, has to be learned beforehand. But he does not say what this method is: from sections [b] and [c] we might infer that the method of metaphysics is as accurate as that of mathematics and different from that of natural philosophy;[92] it is not clear, however, whether "the things that have no matter" in section [b] are all or some of the things investigated by metaphysics (along the lines of *Metaph.* E, 1, 1026a15–21), or rather the things investigated by mathematics, and whether the method referred to in section [c] is also the method of metaphysics, or only that of mathematics.

Section [a] of Text 7 is resumed in a passage of Γ, 3, within Aristotle's defense of the axioms.

> Text 8: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 3, 1005b2–5
>
> Some of those who talk (*baʿḍ al-mutakallimīna*, τῶν λεγόντων τινὲς) try to clarify the truth and [to determine] in what way truth must be known (*bi-ayy nawʿ yanbaġī an yuʿlama al-ḥaqq*, ὃν τρόπον δεῖ ἀποδέχεσθαι). However, they are not able to do that; they do that [i.e. they try to clarify at the same time the truth and the way in which it must be known] only because they do not know the *Analytics*; for someone learning the truth must first know these things [i.e. the *Analytics*], without investigating them when he asks questions about them.[93]

The main indication provided by Text 8 is that the propaedeutic instruction about the method of a science consists in being familiar with Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics*. But also in this case Aristotle's point is quite general and does not concern metaphysics in particular.

The most explicit reference to the method of metaphysics in the *Metaphysics* occurs in Γ, 2, 1004b22–26, a passage in which Aristotle distinguishes metaphysics from dialectic and sophistic. This text lies in the background of Avicenna's Texts 5.1–2.[94] The distinction of metaphysics from dialectic, according to Aristotle, is due to their different methods.

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[92] The method of mathematics is probably the axiomatic procedure mentioned in B, 3, 998a25–27 and Δ, 2, 1014a35–b3, where it is described as a concatenation of propositions that have certain starting-points or "elements", and are object of demonstrations (αἱ ἀποδείξεις).

[93] *Tafsīr*, p. 341, 2–5. "And the attempts of some of those who discuss about truth [to determine] in what way should [each thing] be taken are due to a want of training in the *Analytics*; for they should know these already when they come [to a special study], and not be inquiring into them while they are pursuing it" (modified).

[94] Avicenna's Text 5.1 is compared with Aristotle's Text 9 in Chapter 9, §3.2.

Text 9: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004b22–26

[a] For the science of the sophists and the science of the logicians (*ʿilm al-manṭiqiyyīn*) go back to one genus, namely the genus of philosophy. [b] But philosophy is distinct from the one science on account of the type of power (*bi-nawʿ al-quwwa*, τῷ τρόπῳ τῆς δυνάμεως), from the other science on account the way of conducting life. [c] For the science of logic (*ʿilm al-manṭiq*) knows what the philosopher knows, whereas the science of the sophist is believed to know, but in fact does not know.[95]

In [a] and [b] "philosophy" refers to metaphysics (even though in some other places of Γ, 2 the same term means theoretical philosophy in general). In [b] Aristotle ascribes to metaphysics and dialectic a different "type of power" or "mode of ability" (*nawʿ al-quwwa*, τρόπος τῆς δυνάμεως). In [c] (a passage that is not faithfully translated by Usṭāṯ, but which Avicenna knew probably by means of another Arabic translation)[96] he explains this difference on account of their different method: while dialectic is "critical" (πειραστικὴ)—in the sense that it tests the common opinions upon which it relies—"philosophy" (i.e. metaphysics) is "cognitive" (γνωριστικὴ)—in the sense that it bestows true knowledge. Aristotle, however, does not clarify further the nature of the knowledge provided by metaphysics. The overall indication is mainly negative: the method of metaphysics *is not* that of dialectic.

4.2 *Alexander of Aphrodisias*

Even though hints to the apodictic nature of metaphysics can be found in previous Greek commentators of Aristotle, as in Aspasius,[97] Alexander of Aphrodisias stands out as the first Aristotelian interpreter who gave demonstration within the *Metaphysics* a much more enhanced role than it has in Aristotle. This happens in Alexander's commentary on the *Metaphysics*, in which references to demonstration (ἀπόδειξις) and related terms are widespread.[98] Five aspects of

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[95] *Tafsīr*, p. 325, 10–15. "For sophistic and dialectic turn on the same class of things as philosophy, but this differs from the latter in the mode of ability and from the former in the choice of life. Dialectic is merely critical (πειραστικὴ) where philosophy claims to know, and sophistic is what appears to be philosophy but is not" (modified).

[96] See Chapter 8, §1.1, Table 1[4].

[97] See the references in Bonelli [2001], p. 83, n. 97.

[98] See the indexes in Dooley [1989], p. 207b; Dooley-Madigan [1992], p. 67a, p. 206b; Madigan [1993], p. 203b–204a; Dooley [1993], p. 206b.

Alexander's commentary are noteworthy in this regard: in the first three cases demonstration is linked with the *Metaphysics*; in the other two, it is connected, more in general, with metaphysics as a discipline.

First, Alexander connects sections [a]–[c] of Aristotle's Text 7 (α, 3, 995a12–17), more or less directly, with the *Metaphysics*: he takes section [a] as referring to demonstration and the *Posterior Analytics*, and sections [b] and [c] as linking the theological investigation carried out in *Metaph.* Λ with a method different from that of natural philosophy. He does not clarify, however, what this latter is.

> Text 10: Alexander of Aphrodisias, *In Metaph.* α, 3, 995a12–17
>
> [a] He makes this same point in the *Posterior Analytics*, telling us that we must have a general education and know how each of the things being discussed is to be understood (for all things are not alike or capable of being treated with the same degree of precision). *And [this requirement applies] especially to those who intend to listen to these [lectures]*, for [their subject-matter] is not perceptible or concerned with perceptible objects, nor is it something ordinary to which we are accustomed. This is Aristotle's way of pointing out to us that we must first of all be well trained in the [*Posterior*] *Analytics* and in logic generally, and know the modes *of demonstration* (τῶν ἀποδείξεων) and the conclusions [that can be drawn] from arguments; for it is ridiculous to be seeking scientific knowledge of something while at the same time asking how scientific knowledge itself is produced and acquired, for not even just one of these inquiries is found to be easy. [. . .]
>
> [b] Perhaps he is pointing out to us that precision of this sort [i.e. mathematical precision] is needed *for the present inquiry too*, for the treatise on the first principles [= book Λ] deals with immaterial objects, not with things to which we are accustomed. [. . .]
>
> [c] But Aristotle might also be saying this about *the arguments that concern us now*—that sc. they are not [the kind of arguments used in] natural [philosophy]; for it is immaterial objects about which we propose to speak, and they require more accurate arguments than do natural objects (emphasis added).[99]

Likewise, in the commentary on Γ, 3, 1005b2–5 (= Text 8), Alexander adds to the single reference to the *Posterior Analytics* made by Aristotle two other quotations of this same work.[100] In his exegesis of Γ, 2, 1004b22–26 (= Text 9) he remarks the demonstrative and scientific character of metaphysics in distinction from dialectic, saying that

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[99] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], pp. 168, 16–169, 1; p. 169, 7–9; p. 169, 15–17; Dooley-Madigan [1992], pp. 59–60 (slightly modified).

[100] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 266, 32–267, 14; Madigan [1993], p. 46.

"the philosopher, [i.e. the metaphysician] demonstrates and . . . has scientific knowledge" (ὁ φιλόσοφος ἀποδεικτικός τε καὶ ἐπιστήμων).[101]

Second, Alexander maintains that in the *Metaphysics* Aristotle does actually provide some demonstrations. Thus, while explaining B, 1, 995b20–25 ("Further, with regard to the same and the other and like and unlike and contrariety, and with regard to prior and posterior and all other such terms, about which the dialecticians try to inquire, starting their investigation from reputable premises only,—whose business is it to inquire into all these?"), he states:

> Text 11: Alexander of Aphrodisias, *In Metaph.* B, 1, 995b20–25
>
> Aristotle proposes to inquire about these things as well, since he himself makes use of them *in his own demonstrations* (ἐν τοῖς ἀποδεικνυμένοις πρὸς αὐτοῦ) in this treatise [i.e. in the *Metaphysics*]. For example, he uses sameness, precisely that which is spoken of in the case of substances; at least he inquires whether all substances are the same as one another, or not the same but rather different. But it is also necessary for him, *in demonstrations* (ἐν ταῖς ἀποδείξεσιν), to make further use of all the other things which he listed; for they are the common tools *of those who demonstrate* (τοῖς ἀποδεικνύουσι) (emphasis added).[102]

Third, he recasts some of Aristotle's arguments in the *Metaphysics* in an apodictic form. Thus, he reworks A, 9, 992b24–30 ("And how could we *learn* the elements of all things? Evidently we cannot start by knowing something before. For as he who is learning geometry, though he may know other things before, knows none of the things with which the science deals and about which he is to learn, so is it in all other cases. Therefore if there is a science of all things, as some maintain, he who is learning this will know nothing before") in the following way:

> Text 12: Alexander of Aphrodisias, *In Metaph.* A, 9, 992b24–30
>
> His [i.e. Aristotle's] argument is as follows.
>
> [M1] It is impossible to know any of the things that have principles unless one knows its principles; [proof of M1] for it is impossible to know things the knowledge of which is through their principles before [one has] knowledge of their principles.
>
> [m1] But according to the Platonists, there are common principles of all the things that are;

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[101] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], pp. 259, 24–260, 29 (Madigan [1993], pp. 37–38); the quoted expression occurs at p. 260, 6–7.

[102] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 177, 2–8; Dooley-Madigan [1992], p. 95. See Bonelli [2001], pp. 73–74.

> [C1] therefore, it is impossible to know any of the things that are without having first learned its principles.
>
> [M2] But it is surely impossible to have knowledge of things having principles whose principles it is impossible to learn;
>
> [m2] but it is impossible to learn the principles of the things that are;
>
> [C2] therefore, it is impossible to have knowledge of the things that are.
>
> And that it is impossible to learn the principles of the things that are [= m2] he proves in this way.
>
> [Pi] All learning comes from things known beforehand [the quotation of *An. Post.* A, 1, 71a11, follows]. [proof of Pi] For [Pii] what a person is learning because it does not know it he cannot know before [he learns]; [Piii] but it is of course necessary to have prior knowledge of certain things by means of which learning [takes place]. [Aristotle's example of the student of geometry follows].
>
> [P→Q] Now if all learning comes from a prior knowledge [= Pi] of certain other things [= Piii], not of the things being learned [= Pii], one who hopes to learn the principles of the things that are will also need to know certain other things [beforehand].
>
> [¬Q] But this is impossible; [proof of ¬Q] for [M3] whatever might be taken [as a thing for him] to know [beforehand] will be a thing of some sort and under the principles of being, [m3 = C1] but it is impossible to know any of the things that are before having learned its principles.
>
> [¬P] Therefore, either the learner will know beforehand what he is learning [something that goes against Pii], or he will not learn [= C2].[103]

Now, the first argument is given by two subsequent syllogisms (M1, m1, C1; M2, m2, C2), whereas the second argument is a *modus tollens* (P→Q; ¬Q; therefore ¬P), in which the negation of the consequent (¬Q) is proved by means of a further syllogism (M3, m3, ¬Q).

Fourth, in some of Alexander's rephrasings of Aristotle's statements the method of metaphysics as a discipline is portrayed as apodictic. For example, while commenting on Γ, 1, 1003a20–21 ("There is a science which investigates being as being and the attributes which belong to this in virtue of its own nature"), he states:

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[103] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], pp. 129, 14–130, 11; Dooley [1989], pp. 172–173. In what follows (pp. 130, 11–131, 11), Alexander regard lines 992b30–33 as supporting the truth of (Pi).

Text 13: Alexander of Aphrodisias, *In Metaph.* Γ, 1, 1003a20–21

He [i.e. Aristotle] first assumes that there is a certain science concerned with being as being, that is, a science that considers being as being, and that *demonstrates* (ἀποδεικτικὴν) the essential properties of being; for every science, whatever its object, *demonstrates* (ἀποδεικτικὴ) the properties that belong essentially to its object (emphasis added).[104]

Likewise, he remarks on Γ, 2, 1004b5–8 ("Since, then, these are essential modifications of unity *qua* unity and of being *qua* being, not *qua* numbers or lines or fire, it is clear that it belongs to this science to investigate both the essence of these concepts and their properties"):

Text 14: Alexander of Aphrodisias, *In Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004b5–8

And in this way he shows that the consideration of one and being and of the things under them, consideration of just what each of them is, does not belong to one science while it belongs to another *to demonstrate* (ἀποδεικνύναι) the essential properties of these things [. . .]. For as in other cases it belongs to the same science both to know the subject [of the science] and *to demonstrate* (ἀποδεικνύναι) what its essential properties are, so too in the case of the science of being (emphasis added).[105]

Fifth, he maintains that metaphysics not only uses demonstration, but also investigates its nature. Thus, at the end of his commentary on Γ, 3, 1005a19–b2, he states (calling "philosopher" the metaphysician, and "philosophy" metaphysics):

Text 15: Alexander of Aphrodisias, *In Metaph.* Γ, 3, 1005a19–b2

For, as the discussion of the axioms belongs to the philosopher, so does the discussion of demonstration (περὶ ἀποδείξεως)—not [the demonstration] of this or that, but the general discussion of what demonstration is and how it is carried on. For demonstration does not belong to some one genus, among the genera that fall under the sciences; on the contrary, in each science there is demonstration corresponding to the proper objects of the science; each [scientist] practises [demonstration] on a hypothetical basis, assuming from philosophy [the knowledge of] how one should demonstrate (ἀποδεικνύναι).[106]

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[104] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 239, 6–9; Madigan [1993], p. 12. See Bonelli [2001], pp. 61–62.

[105] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 258, 5–10; Madigan [1993], p. 35. For the assertion of the apodictic character of natural philosophy, see Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 195, 20–25; Dooley-Madigan [1992], p. 126.

[106] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 266, 22–28; Madigan [1993], p. 46; cp. pp. 267, 34–268, 6 (Madigan [1993], p. 47).

Texts 10–15 are complemented by Alexander's *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*: in this work he states the impossibility of applying the apodictic method to the investigation of the first principles (a point that also Avicenna makes), but, on the other hand, credits Aristotle with a demonstration of the First Mover's unicity.[107] Three of the aforementioned texts by Alexander (Text 10 [a], Text 13 and Text 15) are reproduced almost *verbatim* in Ammonius/Asclepius' commentary:[108] Alexander's endeavour of linking the *Metaphysics* and metaphysics with demonstration has probably influenced also other Greek commentators.[109] The idea of the impossibility of a proper demonstration of God's existence occurs in the Arabic version of Themistius' paraphrase of *Metaphysics* Λ.[110]

4.3 *Al-Kindī*

Despite the absence of statements by al-Kindī expressly relating Aristotle's *Metaphysics* with demonstration, his conception of metaphysics as an apodictic discipline can be inferred from what he says in *Falsafa Ūlā*.[111] In the first chapter of this work, for example, resuming a traditional argument for the necessity of the study of philosophy (originating from Aristotle's *Protrepticus*), he states:

> Text 16: Al-Kindī, *Falsafa Ūlā*, p. 15, 20
>
> . . . and the presentation of cause and *demonstration* (*al-burhān*) are part of possessing knowledge of the real nature of things.[112]

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[107] Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], p. 42, 9–13; p. 90, 5–11. See the mention of a "demonstration" (*burhān*) of the principles of the existents in Alexander's commentary on *Metaph.* Λ *apud* Averroes, *Tafsīr*, p. 1420, 8–9. The references to "apodictic investigation" (*al-nazar al-burhānī*) and "demonstration" (*burhān*) in the Introduction of Alexander's commentary on Λ (*Tafsīr*, p. 1399, 10–13, p. 1400, 13–16) are not part of Averroes' report of Alexander's text, but of his explication (see Gutas [1987c], p. 124).

[108] Asclepius [1888], p. 136, 5–13; p. 224, 15–17; p. 256, 29–34.

[109] The methodological remarks that can be found in the classifications of sciences provided by Alexandrian commentators deserve a separate investigation. In David's commentary on Porphyry's *Isagoge*, for example, exact knowledge is associated only with mathematics, and is excluded from natural philosophy and metaphysics—an idea mirored in Paul the Persian's Introduction to Logic (see Gutas [1983], pp. 247–248).

[110] Themistius [1947], p. 12, 6–7.

[111] On this work, see Chapter 2, §7.

[112] Cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 105, 8; Engl. transl. in Ivry [1974], p. 54. On the Greek sources of the argument that al-Kindī is reporting, see al-Kindī [1998], p. 103 (Notes complémentaires, ad n. 15).

Since "knowledge of the true nature of things, insofar as is possible for man" is the definition al-Kindī provides of philosophy at the very beginning of the same chapter,[113] and since he states later that first philosophy, i.e. metaphysics, contains all that belongs to philosophy,[114] it is fair to assume that demonstration in al-Kindī's view is an essential part not only of philosophy, but also of metaphysics.

Al-Kindī lived before the *Posterior Analytics* were translated into Arabic: according to him, therefore, the demonstrative method of philosophy in general, and of metaphysics in particular, is mathematical rather than logical, as D. Gutas has shown.[115] This is confirmed by the second chapter of *Falsafa Ūlā*, where, before entering *in medias res*, al-Kindī provides a methodological introduction, based, among other sources, on chapters 1 and 3 of the *Metaphysics*. Particularly interesting is his elaboration of what Aristotle states in *Metaph.* α, 3, 995a14–17 (= Text 7 [b]–[d]):

Table 9

Kindī, *Falsafa Ūlā*, pp. 23, 19–25, 2[116]	Aristotle, *Metaph.* α, 3, 995a14–17 = Text 7 [b]–[d]	Usṭāṭ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*, *Tafsīr* p. 49, 1–2 (bottom of page)
[1] [Inquirers have been confused] also in physical things, because they have used mathematical investigation.		
[2] For this ought to be only in what has no hyle.	[b] The minute accuracy of mathematics is not to be demanded in all cases, but only in the case of things that have no matter.	incompl.

[113] *Falsafa Ūlā*, p. 9, 8–9; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 97, 8–9; Engl. transl. in Ivry [1974], p. 55.

[114] *Falsafa Ūlā*, p. 11, 13–14 (Al-Kindī [1950], p. 101, 15–16, provides a different text; cp. Ivry [1974], p. 56).

[115] See Gutas [2004b].

[116] Cp. Al-Kindī [1950], pp. 110, 19–111, 6; Engl. transl. in Ivry [1974], pp. 64–65.

Table 9 (*cont.*)

[3] For hyle is subject to being acted upon and, consequently, is in motion. Now, nature is the primary cause of everything that is in motion and in rest.		
[4] Therefore every natural [thing] has hyle.	[d] For presumably all nature has matter.	om.
[5] Therefore it is impossible to use the mathematical investigation in the discovery of natural things,		
[6] since it is proper to what has no matter.	[b] The minute accuracy of mathematics is not to be demanded in all cases, but only in the case of things that have no matter.	incompl.
[7] If it is of such a type, then the investigation [performed] by means of it applies to what is not natural.	[c] Therefore the method (ὁ τρόπος) is not that of natural science.	Therefore the [type of] discourse (*al-qawl*) here is not natural.[117]
[8] Consequently, whoever uses it in the research of natural things, deviates from and misses truth.		

Three aspects of al-Kindī's text are noteworthy. First, the overall purport of Aristotle's text (the method of mathematics has not to be applied to the study of nature) is also al-Kindī's main point (sections [1], [5] and [8]). Second, section [b] of Aristotle's text (mathematical investigation regards only immaterial things) is repeated twice (in sections [2] and [6]) and, in this way, emphasized. Third and most important, in section [7] the content of section [c] of Aristotle's text

[117] "Discourse" (*al-qawl*) in Usṭāṭ's translation presupposes ὁ λόγος, instead of ὁ τρόπος, in the Greek, a reading actually attested in Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on this passage (see Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 169, 9; Dooley-Madigan [1992], p. 60).

is modified: whereas Aristotle maintains that the method of mathematics *does not* apply to what is natural, al-Kindī states that the mathematical investigation *does* apply to what is *not* natural. This change is significant, for al-Kindī portrays metaphysics not only as "first philosophy" and "divine science",[118] but also as "the science of what is above natural things" (*ʿilm mā fawqa l-ṭabīʿiyyāt*).[119] Section [7] implies, therefore, that the mathematical method is the method of metaphysics as well.

Later on in the same chapter 2 of *Falsafa Ūlā*, al-Kindī qualifies mathematics as an apodictic discipline:

> Text 17: Al-Kindī, *Falsafa Ūlā*, p. 25, 17–18
> Similarly, we should not seek persuasive arguments in mathematical sciences, but rather demonstration (*al-burhān*).[120]

Thus, in so far as the method of metaphysics is mathematical (Table 9), and the method of mathematics is apodictic (Text 17), it is safe to conclude that al-Kindī's *Falsafa Ūlā* attests, albeit indirectly, that the method of metaphysics is apodictic.[121]

4.4 Liber de Causis

In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna appears to endorse not only Aristotle's syllogystic *apodeixis*, but also the "Platonic" method of mathematical *elementatio*, whose first application to metaphysics occurs in Plato's *Republic* and which is best instantiated by the adoption of the method of Euclid's *Elements* in Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica*. In this regard, Avicenna's quotation of Euclid's *Elements* at the very beginning of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (I, 1), in a methodological context, is significant.[122] The part of *Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 3 that comes after Text 3 has been shown to

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[118] The name "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa l-ūlā*) occurs in Al-Kindī [1988], p. 9, 14, p. 11, 13 (cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 98, 1, p. 101, 15; Ivry [1974], p. 56); "divine science" (*ʿilm ilāhī*) at p. 27, 2 (cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 113, 15; Ivry [1974], p. 66).

[119] Al-Kindī [1998], p. 25, 9–10; cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 111, 13; Ivry [1974], p. 65.

[120] Cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 112, 6; Engl. transl. in Ivry [1974], p. 66.

[121] For al-Kindī metaphysics is essentially a theology (see Chapter 2, §7): thus, the idea that the theological part of the *Metaphysics* rests on the apodictic method proper of mathematics—an idea that surfaces in Alexander of Aphrodisias' Text 10, and circulates in Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica* and the *Liber de Causis*—is not alien to the *Falsafa Ūlā*.

[122] See above, §1.2, n. 30.

depend on the *Liber the Causis* and the *Theologia Aristotelis*.[123] Thus, the axiomatic procedures typical of Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica* and its Arabic reworking might lie in the background of the apodictic method which Avicenna portrays as proper of metaphysics in Text 3 [b].

4.5 *Al-Fārābī*

The connection between demonstration and metaphysics, simply alluded to by al-Kindī, is openly stated by al-Fārābī.[124] In the *Iḥṣā'*, he points at the apodictic character of philosophy in general by portraying the *Posterior Analytics* as the part of logic that provides the rules of philosophy.[125] Among the various philosophical disciplines, however, only the "divine science", i.e. metaphysics (and the book containing it, i.e. the *Metaphysics*), is insistently described as relying on demonstrations; this applies in particular to its theological part. After mentioning "the investigation into the principles of demonstrations (*mabādi' al-barāhīn*)"—i.e. the defense of the axioms along the lines of *Metaphysics* Γ, 3–8—as one of the topics of the second part of metaphysics,[126] al-Fārābī says the following about the third, theological, part of this discipline:

> Text 18: Al-Fārābī, *Iḥṣā'*, p. 121, 2–9
>
> The third part [of the divine science] is the investigation of beings which are neither bodies nor in bodies. It investigates first whether these exist or not, and *demonstrates* (*yubarhinu*) that they do. Then it investigates whether they are many or not, and explains that they are many. Then it investigates whether they are finite or infinite, and *demonstrates* (*yubarhinu*) that they are finite. Then it investigates whether their degrees of perfection are the same or varying, and *demonstrates*

[123] Wisnovsky [2002], pp. 113–119 (see Chapter 11, §2.2, §2.4).

[124] The influence of al-Fārābī on Avicenna's way of understanding metaphysics as an apodictic science has been pointed out, for example, by Endress [1991b], p. 168: ". . . er [i.e. Avicenna] auch sein Verständnis der Ersten Philosophie von al-Fārābī bezog: *Apodeixis aus Universalien, welche Gewißheit begründet*" (emphasis added).

[125] Al-Fārābī [1949], p. 87, 11–12: "The fourth [part of logic] contains the rules by which apodictic statements (*al-aqāwīl al-burhāniyya*) are tested, and the rules for the things of which philosophy [as a whole] consists" (Engl. transl. by D. C. Reisman and D. Gutas, forthcoming). Cp. Al-Fārābī [1956–7], pp. 226–227, pp. 231–232: "The fourth book [of logic] is the *Book of Demonstration* (*Posterior Analytics*). It includes the special rules by which the philosophic art in particular is constituted".

[126] Al-Fārābī [1949], p. 120, 10. Engl. transl. by Reisman-Gutas, forthcoming (slightly modified).

> (*yubarhinu*) that they are of varying perfection. Then it *demonstrates* (*yubarhinu*) that, although multiple, they advance from the least perfect to the more perfect and thence to the most perfect until, at the end of that, they reach a particular perfect being which no other thing can supersede in perfection . . . (emphasis added).[127]

Similar statements regarding other branches of philosophy are much less frequent in the *Iḫṣā'*.[128]

In the *Ǧamʿ*, al-Fārābī points out Aristotle's imperfect application of the apodictic method to metaphysics.[129] On the other hand, he occasionally acknowledges the apodictic character of the theological part of metaphysics, with particular regard to book Λ:

> Text 19: Al-Fārābī, *Ǧamʿ*, p. 133, 13–17
>
> [a] Also because in Aristotle's letters on metaphysics (*ḥurūf . . . fīmā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*, i.e. in the books of the *Metaphysics*), he ascends from the premises that are necessary and apodictic (*al-muqaddimāt al-ḍarūriyya wa-l-burhāniyya*) up to the clarification of the Creator's unity . . . in letter *Lam*. [b] Then he turns back to clarifying the truth of the premises (*muqaddimāt*) previously employed . . . [c] As far as it is known, in [accomplishing] that no one before him has preceded him and no one after him has been equal to him until today.[130]

Even though not all the aspects of this text are manifest,[131] the mention of "the premises" in [a] and [b], their description as "neces-

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[127] Engl. transl. by Reisman-Gutas, forthcoming (slightly modified).

[128] See Al-Fārābī [1953], pp. 82, 15–83, 2: "Natural science makes natural bodies known by treating as given those whose existence is evident, and by demonstrating (*yubarhina*) the existence of those whose existence is not evident" (Engl. transl. by Reisman-Gutas, forthcoming, slightly modified; part of this passage is omitted in Al-Fārābī [1949]).

[129] Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 73, 6–8 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 6, 10–12, Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 84, 22–24): "In many of the syllogisms which he [Aristotle] presents in the fields of physics, metaphysics, and ethics (*min kaṯīri mina l-qiyāsāti l-ṭabīʿiyyati wa-l-ilāhiyyati wa-l-ḫulqiyyati*), it is found in what he says that he omits the necessary premise. The commentators have pointed out the passages where this occurs" (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 228; cp. Mallet [1989], p. 64).

[130] Cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 24, 17–23; Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 102, 15–18 (cp. Mallet [1989], p. 86).

[131] It is not clear to what part of the *Metaphysics* section [b] refers. According to Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], n. 3, p. 183, it indicates Aristotle's discussion of the principles of natural philosophy and mathematics in *Metaphysics* M-N. Since section [a] describes Aristotle's argumentative "ascension" to the First Principle, section [b] might refer to the origination (a sort of "descension") of things from God, a topic that al-Fārābī in the *Iḫṣā'*, regards as belonging to the final part of the *Metaphysics* (al-Fārābī [1949], p. 122, 11–16).

sary and apodictic" in [a], and the reference to their "clarification" in [b], make sufficiently clear that al-Fārābī is referring here to a syllogistic demonstration.[132]

5 The sources of Avicenna's conception of metaphysics as an analytical and non-dialectical science

5.1 *Proofs by division and terminological distinctions*

Even though in his logical works Aristotle rejects the method of division, displayed in Plato's dialogues, as a deductive procedure (see *An. Pr.* A, 31; *An. Post.* B, 5), he accepts it as a way of defining things, with certain provisos (see *An. Post.* B, 13, 96b25–97b6). Due to its partial endorsement by Aristotle and, especially, its detailed exposition by Porphyry in his commentary on Plato's *Sophist*, this method exerted a deep influence on philosophers and commentators of Aristotle in Late Antiquity, and was transmitted to Arab thinkers as one of the main methodological tools.[133] A key-figure in this regard is, once again, al-Fārābī. His contribution to the issue is two-fold: first, he stresses that Aristotle, despite criticizing the method of division in certain of his works, employs it hiddenly in others;[134] second, he assigns to this method a function that is not only descriptive and gnoseological, but also normative and ontological: according to al-Fārābī, it not only helps human mind to understand better things, but determines also how things in themselves are.[135]

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[132] D. Gutas has documented the deep impact of al-Fārābī's *Ǧamʿ* on Avicenna, as far as methodological issues are concerned (Gutas [1988], p. 177; p. 229; p. 286, n. 3; pp. 307–308; Gutas [1983], p. 259, n. 70).

[133] Gutas [1983], pp. 244–245, 256–257, documents the increasing use of the method of division within the Alexandrian scholastic tradition and its reception in the Arab world. On the Greek antecedents and the transmission into Arabic of the method of division, see also Gutas [1999a], p. 220a–b.

[134] *Ǧamʿ*, p. 83, 3–8 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 9, 1–6; Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 87, 11–16). Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], p. 84: "En effet, même si Aristote pense que la voie la plus courte et la plus sûre pour parvenir à des définitions est de chercher ce qui spécifie la chose et ce qui la comprend parmi les caractères qui lui appartiennent essentiellement et substantiellement (voyez tout ce qu'il mentionne dans le livre de la *Métaphysique* où il parle des définitions et de même dans les *Seconds Analytiques* et dans les *Topiques* aux endroits sur la définition qu'il serait fastidieux de répéter), son discours, dans sa plus grande partie, ne se prive pas de recourir à quelque division, et cela alors même qu'il ne le dit pas clairement" (cp. Mallet [1989], p. 68). The reference to the *Metaphysics* in this text is analyzed in Chapter 3, §5, n. 68.

[135] Gutas [1983], p. 257, maintains that "[t]he trend . . . of shifting from the

As far as the terminological distinctions in particular are concerned, the first traces of the application of the analytical method to metaphysics can be found in Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. A remark in Γ, 2 (1004a25–31) points towards the necessity of distinguishing the various meanings of the *pros hen legomena*:

> Text 20: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004a25–29
>
> Since all things are referred to the first [thing] which is first with regard to them, as when we say that all things said "one" are referred to the one which precedes [them] on account of [its] priority, similarly we must say with regard to what is said "same", what is said "other", and the contraries. Thus we must distinguish (*nufaṣṣila*, διελόμενον) first of all in how many ways each of these [terms] is said; likewise we [must] refer them to their principles and state how they are referred to them [i.e. to their principles] in all the categories.[136]

The entire book Δ of the *Metaphysics* is a concrete application of Aristotle's remark in Text 20, in so far as it provides the analysis of the different meanings of thirty philosophical terms and, in many cases, individuates among them a primary meaning. The lengthy exegesis of Text 20 and the equally lengthy introduction to book Δ in Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary make clear the importance that Alexander ascribes to terminological analysis.[137] Al-Fārābī's description of book Δ in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* emphasizes in a similar vein the distinction of terms that Aristotle accomplishes in this book.[138]

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descriptive function of classification [by division] to the normative one, which started with Alexandrian scholarship, reaches its logical conclusion with al-Fārābī in whom normative classification becomes autonomous".

[136] *Tafsīr*, pp. 317, 13–318, 3. "And since all things are referred to that which is primary, as for instance all things which are one are referred to the primary one, we must say that this holds good also of the same and the other and of contraries in general; so that after distinguishing (διελόμενον) the various senses of each, we must then explain by reference to what is primary in each terms, saying how they are related to it".

[137] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], pp. 255, 5–256, 18, Madigan [1993], pp. 31–33; pp. 344, 2–345, 20, Dooley [1993], pp. 11–12.

[138] See Chapter 3, §1, [3.4]. Other works by al-Fārābī contain semantic distinctions that might be inspired, albeit in a different context, by *Metaphysics* Δ: the *Risāla fī l-ʿAql* (*Treatise on the Intellect*), for example, is a discussion of the six different meanings that the term "intellect" bears in common usage, in theological discourse and in Aristotle's writings, which al-Fārābī distinguishes and summarizes at the very beginning of the treatise (Al-Fārābī [1938], pp. 3, 3–4, 3).

5.2 *Dialectic*

Even though the dialectical aspects of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* are occasionally enhanced by Aristotle's disciples in their own works on metaphysics,[139] a tendency to undermine the role of dialectic in metaphysics—along the lines of Aristotle's Text 9—surfaces in the Aristotelian tradition long before Avicenna. It first appears in Alexander of Aphrodisias. In his introduction to the commentary on *Metaphysics* Γ, books A and B (together with α) are distinguished from book Γ itself: the former have a dialectical character (A is doxographical, B aporetical), whereas the latter displays an apodictic method.[140] Likewise, in Alexander's introduction to the commentary on Λ reported by Averroes, books A, M and N of the *Metaphysics*, on account of their doxographical content, are regarded as not belonging to the doctrinal "core" of this work.[141]

Similarly, in al-Fārābī's description of *Metaphysics* E in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, "dialectic" (*ǧadal*) is mentioned in connection with "sophistic" (*ṣināʿat al-muġāliṭīna*), as dealing with "being *per accidens*" (*al-huwiyya allatī tuqālu bi-l-ʿaraḍ*).[142] Significantly, in the passage of the *Metaphysics* to which al-Fārābī refers (E, 2, 1026b14–21) only sophistic is regarded, on Plato's authority, to be linked with this kind of being: dialectic appears to be added by al-Fārābī himself.

In the Aristotelian tradition antedating Avicenna, the tendency to regard Aristotle's doxographies as less important, and therefore negligeable, parts of his works is evident. A prime example is provided once again by al-Fārābī, who in the *Gamʿ* refers to the doxographical part of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* as something that can be dispensed with.[143] The attitude of the Neoplatonic tradition towards doxography,

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[139] The editors of Theophrastus' *Metaphysics*, for instance, say that "[l]e caractère aporétique de l'opuscule est patent" (Theophrastus [1993], p. xviii). On the influence of Theophrastus' *Metaphysics* on Alexander of Aphrodisias' *Fī Mabādiʾ al kull*, see Chapter 11, §1.

[140] See Chapter 9, §5.1, Text 1.1.

[141] See Chapter 5, §6.4, Text 19 [f].

[142] See Chapter 3, §1, [3.5].

[143] Al-Fārābī [1999], p. 143, 1–10 (cp. Al-Fārābī [1890], p. 27, 11–20; Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 100, 6–15). Naǧǧār-Mallet [1999], p. 144: "Dans ses livres sur la *Métaphysique* (*fī ḥurūfihī fīmā baʿda l-ṭabīʿati*), Aristote argumente pour critiquer les partisans des modèles et des formes dont on dit qu'ils existent, qu'ils se tiennent, incorruptibles, dans le monde de la divinité. Il explique quelles absurdités s'ensuivent . . . et d'autres absurdités qu l'on profére dans ces affirmations *et dont la mention prolongerait à l'excès le présent propos. Nous nous dispensons, en raison de leur célébrité, de les répéter ici-même*, ainsi

as expressed by al-Kindī and the works accomplished within his circle, is less straightforward.[144]

Conclusion

Avicenna regards the *Metaphysics* as the starting-point of a process of mutual integration between metaphysics and demonstration that, according to him, reaches its peek only in his own *Ilāhiyyāt*. By starting to apply demonstration to metaphysics, Aristotle is viewed by Avicenna as the initiator of a new phase of Greek philosophy (§1.1); but what he has accomplished in this respect, according to Avicenna, is insufficient: the method of metaphysics needs to rely on demonstration much more substantially than it does in the *Metaphysics*. Avicenna performs this task in a double way: on the one hand, he clarifies the status and limits of metaphysics as an apodictic science, reworks its content in syllogistic form, and pays the required attention to the degree of truth and certainty of the propositions serving as premises (§1.2–3); on the other hand, he complements the apodictic method with "analytical" procedures, like proofs by division, terminological distinctions and classifications (§2). The method of the *Metaphysics*, according to Avicenna, is also too dependent on dialectic, either because it is persuasive and conjectural, or because it relies on "commonly accepted opinions", or because it expresses the point of view of the "common people" (§3.1). In this regard, Avicenna endeavours to lessen the role and visibility of the dialectical procedures adopted by Aristotle (scrutiny of other thinkers' opinions and discussion of *aporiai*): on the one hand, he relegates the doxographies of books A, M and N in a marginal and subordinate position, replacing them with a piece-meal refutation of views contrary to his own, whose aim is to corroborate the doctrine he proposes (§3.2); on the other hand, he quotes a few of the *aporiai* of book B in scattered

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que nous l'avons fait des autres discours quand nous les avons évoqués, avons indiqué leur place et avons laissé le soin de les mentionner à qui les cherchera où ils se trouvent afin de se consacrer à leur étude et à leur interprétation" (emphasis added; cp. Mallet [1989], p. 90). The reference to the *Metaphysics* in this text is analyzed in Chapter 1, §3, n. 63.

[144] A doxographical aim is evident in the *Theologia Aristotelis*, whose first *mīmar* "presents a doxography of the soul", and in al-Kindī's *al-Qawl fī l-Nafs*, which is "a doxography in its own right" (see Adamson [2000], pp. 110, 112).

places of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, always connecting them with their solution, in accordance with his broader tendency to raising difficulties and facing objections in order to solve them (§3.3).

Both the "positive" and the "negative" aspect of Avicenna's "transformation" of the method of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (i.e. the introduction or enhancement of apodictic procedures, and the elimination or reduction of dialectical ones) has a long history. In the *Metaphysics*, Aristotle hints at a connection between the method of metaphysics and the *Posterior Analytics* (§4.1, Texts 7–8), imposes on the metaphysician the task of analysing the various acceptions of terms with multiple meanings (§5.1, Text 20), and distinguishes the method of metaphysics, on the one hand, from that of dialectic and sophistic, on the other (§4.1, Text 9). These hints are developed by Alexander of Aphrodisias (§4.2); even though the idea of metaphysics as a demonstrative science circulates in al-Kindī (§4.3), and is well expressed by the application of the mathematical *elementatio* to philosophical theology in Arabic Neoplatonic metaphysics (§4.4), al-Fārābī is the first to formulate a precise view of the apodictic and analytical nature of metaphysics (§4.5; §5.1), and of its independence from dialectic (§5.2), on the basis of the *Posterior Analytics*. The Farabian view of the method of metaphysics is concretely applied to this discipline by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

CHAPTER SEVEN

AVICENNA'S CONCEPTION OF THE RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN THE *METAPHYSICS* AND THE OTHER PARTS OF THE ARISTOTELIAN *CORPUS*: METAPHYSICS AS THE FOUNDING DISCIPLINE

Aristotle's *Metaphysics* overlaps with other parts of the Aristotelian *corpus*: it partially coincides, for example, with the *Organon* (substance is dealt with both in the *Categories* and in *Metaphysics* Z), and the *Physics* (the proof of the Unmoved Mover's existence is provided both in *Physics* Θ and *Metaphysics* Λ). These overlappings prompt contemporary scholars to speak of a lack of "systematization" in Aristotle's *corpus*,[1] and raise the question of the precise way (if any) in which the *Metaphysics* relates to the other works by Aristotle.

Avicenna's view of the mutual relation of the philosophical disciplines is extremely clear: the *Ilāhiyyāt* starts, like the *Šifā'*, with a classification of the sciences (a device that occurs frequently in Avicenna's works, occasionally being their exclusive topic) and is part of a *summa* or collection of disciplines (the literary genre of which Avicenna is the inventor). Avicenna's approach to the issue at stake, namely the precise relation of the *Metaphysics* with the other works by Aristotle, is three-fold. First, he points out that some doctrines are dealt with both in metaphysics and in other sciences in as much as their treatement in these latter is improper and has a propaedeutic function. Second, he remarks that some doctrines are properly dealt with both in metaphysics and in other sciences, but according to different perspectives. Third, he states that metaphysics resumes doctrines of other sciences in order to provide their foundation, since metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* has the function of establishing the principles of the other sciences.[2] The third case somehow embraces the

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[1] "Systematization is not achieved in the [Aristotelian] treatises; but it is an ideal, ever present in the background. [. . .] Aristotle was a systematic thinker; his surviving treatises present a partial and unfinished sketch of his system", Barnes [2000], pp. 62–63.

[2] The first scenario applies, for example, to the doctrine of God's immateriality and unicity, presented by natural philosophy before metaphysics in a propaedeutic

other two: metaphysics provides the foundation of the other sciences just because it discusses from a different point of view their subject-matters and some of the notions they use (second case); in so doing, it addresses some specific issues that cannot be discussed in the other disciplines (first case).

Thus, according to Avicenna the interrelation among the sciences is not simply a matter of interconnection: it rests ultimately on the dependence of all the other disciplines upon metaphysics. In other words, the system of science, as displayed in the *Šifā'*, is not only organic but also hierarchical: metaphysics stays at the top of a pyramid of disciplines, which continues with logic and the other two theoretical sciences (natural philosophy and mathematics), practical philosophy (ethics, household management and politics), and the particular disciplines subordinated to the main branches of theoretical and practical philosophy. This well-structured system of sciences, culminating in metaphysics as the crowning discipline, is remarkable for coherence and solidity; but has certain disadvantages. For, if the dependence of all the other disciplines on metaphysics guarantees the system a strong "focal" unity, it also prevents the single sciences from proceeding and developing autonomously. This probably explains why the many concrete observations present in Avicenna's philosophy of nature—and in all the subsequent authors adopting his same classification of sciences—did not and could not evolve into a fully accomplished empirical approach to reality.[3] Only when, in modern times, metaphysics ceased to regulate and "control" from above the other sciences, a so-called "scientific revolution" within the system of knowledge became possible.

The present chapter consists of five sections. The first (§1) is a survey of Avicenna's statements on the relationship between metaphysics and the other sciences. The next three sections examine the three main instances of this relationship, i.e. how metaphysics relates to logic (§2), natural philosophy (§3), and mathematics (§4). The final

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way. The second case is given by the doctrine of the efficient cause, treated in natural philosophy as a principle of movement, in metaphysics as a principle of existence. The third perspective regards the resumption in metaphysics of the logical doctrines of categories and universals, as a foundation, in different respects, of logic, natural philosophy and mathematics.

[3] The same restrictions apply to medicine with regard to natural philosophy (the foundational discipline of medicine), as Gutas [2003] has shown.

section is devoted to ascertaining the sources of Avicenna's conception of metaphysics as *regina scientiarum*.

1 Avicenna's general statements on the relationship between metaphysics and the other sciences

In *Burhān* II, 7 Avicenna maintains that the particular sciences are not parts of metaphysics but are subordinated to it, whereas metaphysics is not subordinated to any other science; rather, the "principles" (*mabādi'*) of all the other sciences "turn out to be true" (*taṣiḥḥu*) or "are clarified" (*tubayyanu*) in metaphysics (named "first philosophy", *al-falsafa al-ūlā*).[4] Resuming this point, in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1 Avicenna states that metaphysics (called, once again, "first philosophy") has to provide the "verification" (*tasḥīḥ*) of the "principles" (*mabādi'*) of the other sciences.

> Text 1: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, p. 5, 7–8 [p. 3, 44–46]
>
> You have also heard that there is a philosophy of truth and a first philosophy, and that it provides the verification (*taṣḥīḥ*) of the "principles" (*mabādi'*) of the other sciences.[5]

The outline of the structure of metaphysics in I, 2, already taken into account in Chapter 5,[6] clarifies the identity of the "principles" mentioned in Text 1.

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[4] *Burhān* II, 7, p. 165, 3–7, 11–16. This passage (= Avicenna [1954], p. 108, 12–17) is Text 3 in Hasnawi [2000], pp. 518–519; see also Hasnawi [2002], p. 76. *Burhān* II, 7 has no precise correspondence with the *Posterior Analytics*. The same point is repeated in *Burhān* III, 1, p. 194, 6–11 (corresponding to *An. Post.* A, 12, 77b5–6); see also *Qiyās* I, 2, p. 13, 14–17. Outside the *Šifā'*, see the text of *Aġrām* quoted in Chapter 6, n. 8.

[5] Cp. I, 2, p. 15, 9–11 [pp. 15, 89–16, 91]: "This [i.e. the knowledge sought for in this discipline] is first philosophy, since it is the science of the first thing in existence, namely the First Cause, and of the first thing in universality, namely existence and unity". In so far as metaphysics certifies the principles of the other sciences, its name in the aforementioned passage of the *Burhān* and in Text 1 and in similar passages (see below, Text 4, Texts 11–12) does not seem coincidental, as if metaphysics were "first philosophy" just because it deals with was is "first" and plays the role of principle in all the branches of philosophy. On "first philosophy" and "philosophy of truth" as names of metaphysics in Avicenna, see Appendix D, II.ii.2 and II.ii.4.

[6] See Chapter 5, §1.

Text 2: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 14, 18–15, 8 [p. 15, 73–88] (= Chapter 5, Text 2 [3*])

[a] Another [part of metaphysics] is the one investigating the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of the particular sciences.

[b] Since the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of each science [that is] more specific are questions [discussed] in the science [that is] more general, as the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of medicine in natural [science] and [the principles] of geodesy in geometry, it occurs therefore that the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of the particular sciences—which investigate the states of the particular [aspects] of "existent"—become clear in this science.

[c] Thus this science investigates the states (*aḥwāl*) of "existent" and the things that are like its divisions (*aqsām*) and species (*anwāʿ*) until it reaches [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter (*mawḍūʿ*) of natural science comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to natural science]—and [a stage] specifying [such divisions and species] at which the subject-matter (*mawḍūʿ*) of mathematics comes about—then [this science] delivers it [i.e. the subject-matter] to it [i.e. to mathematics]—and similarly in the other cases.

[d] Of what precedes that specification and is as its principle (*al-mabdaʾ*), on the contrary, [this science] investigates and determines the state (*ḥāl*).

[e] Therefore [some] questions of this science regard the causes of the caused existent *qua* caused existent, some other the accidents of "existent", some other the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of the particular sciences [= OntologyS].

The general claim in [a], repeated conclusively in [e], is substantiated in [b] and [c]. In section [b], Avicenna likens the relationship between metaphysics and two particular sciences (natural philosophy and mathematics) to the relationship between these latter (natural philosophy and one of the branches of mathematics, i.e. geometry) and the sciences subordinate to them (respectively medicine and geodesy). This implies that, according to Avicenna, all the philosophical disciplines other than metaphysics (natural philosophy and mathematics among the theoretical sciences, logic,[7] and—we can suppose—the practical sciences) are subordinated to this latter. This subordination, together with the fact that the principles of the more particular science become "questions" (*masāʾil*) in the more general science, attests

[7] Logic is mentioned as one of the disciplines of which metaphysics certifies the principles in the parallel passages of Text 2 in both the *Mafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣāt* and the *Aqsām* (see Chapter 5, §2, Table 2).

that the principles under discussion are the particular sciences' assumptions or presuppositions, namely their hypotheses.

Section [c] makes clear that, according to Avicenna, the principles of the particular sciences concern their subject-matters. As we have seen in Chapter 4, every science (metaphysics included) takes for granted both the existence and the essence of its own subject-matter.[8] Thus, the "principles" of the particular sciences in [b] are, in all likelihood, their hypotheses about the existence and the essence of their subject-matters. Contrarily to the hypotheses of metaphysics, those of the particular sciences need to be grounded, and metaphysics takes care of ascertaining them.[9] It does so by investigating the "divisions" (*aqsām*) and "species" (*anwāʿ*) of "existent", i.e. the categories, whose particularization determines the subject-matters of the particular sciences: metaphysics clarifies the principles of the particular sciences by taking into account their subject-matters (corporeal substance in the case of natural philosophy, continuous and discrete quantity in the case of mathematics, etc.) simply as existents and as divisions and species of "existent", before they are specified as peculiar subject-matters of the particular disciplines.[10]

In section [d], the term "principle" has apparently a different meaning: it is not the hypothetical strating-point of a particular science, but the real cause of the subject-matter of this latter. Since no science investigates the "ontological" principles of its subject-matter,[11] metaphysics provides the foundation of the particular sciences also in this respect: "existent" and its "divisions" and "species", namely the categories, are the "principles" (in this sense) of the particular sciences' subject-matters, in so far as they are more general than the specific types of existents that serve as subject-matters of the particular sciences, and are causally prior to them.

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[8] See Chapter 4, §1.2, Texts 2.2–3.

[9] The hypotheses of metaphysics do not need to be proved since the subject-matter of metaphysics, i.e. "existent *qua* existent", cannot be demonstrated as existent (having, properly speaking, no cause), nor can it be further determined with regard to essence (due to the impossibility of defining it).

[10] As we have seen in Chapter 4, §1.2, this is the idea supporting Avicenna's first proof of "existent" as the subject-matter of metaphysics. See also I, 8, pp. 53, 18–54, 1 [p. 63, 94–96]: "But knowledge of the substance of the subject-matters [of demonstrations], [something] that in the preceding [sciences] was known only by means of definition, is one of the things that the philosopher has to determine here".

[11] See Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 2.4.

According to Avicenna, however, the metaphysical foundation of the particular sciences is not restricted to certifying their "principles". In I, 2, he states that there are some "things" (*umūr*) that have to de defined and "verified" (*yağibu an . . . tutaḥaqqaqa*), in so far as they are "common to the sciences" (*muštariqa fī l-ʿulūm*), even though no particular science takes them into account. As examples of this group of things Avicenna mentions concepts like "one *qua* one", "many *qua* many", "congruent", "different", and "contrary", that the other sciences either simply use, or whose definitions they assume, without discussing the mode of their existence.[12] An implicit assumption of Avicenna's discourse is that it is metaphysics that accomplishes this task; on the basis of this assumption, Avicenna provides the second proof that "existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics.[13] In I, 3, while discussing the utility of metaphysics with regard to the other sciences, Avicenna links the metaphysics' treatment of these things with its verification of the principles of the particular sciences:

> Text 3: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3, p. 18, 12–13 [p. 20, 67–70]
> The utility of this science . . . consists in providing certainty to the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of the particular sciences, and in verifying (*taḥaqquq*) the quiddity of the things that are common in them [i.e. in the particular sciences] (*al-umūr al-muštariqa fīhā*), even though they are not principles.[14]

At the beginning of chapter I, 5, the principles of the particular sciences mentioned in Texts 1–3 are qualified as "principles of the act of conceptualizing" (*mabādiʾ al-taṣawwur*): this rubric encompasses not only "existent" and its "first divisions" (*aqsām uwal*, possibly the categories),[15] but also "thing", "necessary", "one", "non-existent", "possible" and "impossible". In the same chapter, these principles are contrasted with another set of principles, i.e. the "principles of

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[12] I, 2, pp. 12, 15–13, 7 [p. 12, 18–29].

[13] See Chapter 4, Outline 2 [1.2.2]; for the other concepts belonging to this group of things, see Chapter 5, Table 1.

[14] Later in chapter I, 3, Avicenna defends the point made in Text 3 against the objection that, if the "principles" (*mabādiʾ*) of natural philosophy and mathematics were "demonstrated" (*tubarhanu*) in metaphysics, this latter couldn't take for granted the conclusions of these two disciplines—as instead Avicenna maintains (I, 3, p. 19, 1–9 [pp. 20, 77–21, 89])—without falling in a sort of *petitio principii* (see Chapter 6, §1.2; §3.3, Table 8). Avicenna explains in detail why this is not the case (I, 3, pp. 19, 10–20, 18 [pp. 21, 90–23, 28]).

[15] I, 5, p. 29, 3 [p. 31, 99–00]; see Chapter 5, n. 65.

the act of granting assent" (*madādiʾ al-taṣdīq*): while the former are conceptual, the latter are propositional.[16] In I, 8, these two groups of principles are described, respectively, as "principles of definition" (*mabādiʾ al-ḥadd*) and "principles of demonstration" (*mabādiʾ al-burhān*).[17] The latter are the logical axioms of non-contradiction and excluded-middle, that Avicenna defends in I, 8, stressing that their defense has to be provided by the metaphysician. Even though the axioms are not proper principles of the particular sciences, but rather common principles of "demonstration", i.e. of science *tout court*, their defense by metaphysics can be regarded as another aspect of the foundation that Avicenna ascribes to metaphysics with regard to the system of knowledge.

As Text 2 [c] attests, the certification of the "principles" of the particular sciences occurs in the part of metaphysics dealing with the divisions and species of "existent" (OntologyS).[18] The "things" common to the particular sciences whose quiddities are certified by metaphysics, on the other hand, are the properties of "existent" (OntologyP), which include "one" and "many" and some of the properties of these latter, like "congruent" and "contrary" (HenologyP).[19] Thus, all the non-theological part of metaphysics (OntologyS—which includes HenologyS—OntologyP and HenologyP) has in different respects, according to Avicenna, the aforementioned foundational function. More specifically, metaphysics is foundational with regard to logic (categories in treatises II–III, and universals in treatise V), natural philosophy (the investigation of substance in treatise II is primarily an analysis of corporeal substance) and mathematics (within the treatments of accidents in treatise III, quantity has a place of eminence).[20] In the next three sections, I will analyze Avicenna's account of the metaphysical treatment of the principles of these three disciplines.

[16] I, 5, p. 29, 7–16 [p. 32, 4–15].
[17] I, 8, p. 54, 16–17 [p. 64, 14–17].
[18] See Chapter 5, §1.
[19] See Chapter 5, §1, Table 1.
[20] Avicenna does not mention any foundation of practical philosophy by metaphysics. However, the fact that practical philosophy is dealt with as an appendix of metaphysics (X, 4–5), and the fact that Avicenna's treatment of practical philosophy is based on the doctrine of prophecy, which metaphysics takes into account (X, 1–3) and of which provides the foundation (see below, §3.2), suggest that metaphysics provides also, indirectly, the foundation of practical philosophy.

His account of the defense of the axioms performed by metaphysics will be considered in Chapter 9.[21]

2 Metaphysics and logic

2.1 *The metaphysical foundation of logic: the doctrine of universals and categories*

That metaphysics ("first philosophy") discusses, and therefore establishes, the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of logic is declared by Avicenna in the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*:

> Text 4: Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 10, 5–7 (= Chapter 5, Text 1, [b])
> It is customary to prolong [the discussion on] the principles (*mabādiʾ*) of logic with material that does not belong to logic but only to the philosophical discipline (*ṣināʿa ḥikmiyya*)—I mean first philosophy (*falsafa ūlā*); therefore I avoided mentioning any of that [in Logic] and wasting time thereby, and deferred it to its [proper] place.[22]

The metaphysical discussion and foundation of the principles of logic mentioned in this passage consists, as in the case of natural philosophy and mathematics, in a deeper investigation of the subject-matter of this discipline.

In *Madḫal* I, 2, a chapter entirely devoted to providing a division of the sciences, Avicenna alludes to the limited character of the logical investigation of quiddities.

> Text 5: *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 16, 10–12
> This kind of investigation is called "science of logic". It is the investigation of the aforementioned matters [i.e. quiddities], inasmuch as one arrives by means of them to making known the unknown, and of what occurs to them inasmuch as they are such, *no more* (*lā ġayra*).[23]

In *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, he clarifies the limitation alluded to in Text 5, and indicates in what respect logic does not take into account its own subject-matter:

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[21] See Chapter 9, §3.4.

[22] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 51 (slightly modified). See also Avicenna's account of the "verifying clarification" (*bayān muḥaqqiq*) provided by metaphysics ("first philosophy") of the topics common to logic and metaphysics in *Qiyās* I, 2, p. 13, 5–8.

[23] Engl. transl. in Marmura [1980b], p. 250 (slightly modified).

Text 6: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, pp. 10, 17–11, 2 [p. 10, 73–77]

The subject-matter of logic, as you know, is given by the secondary intelligible notions (*al-maʿānī al-maʿqūla al-ṯāniya*), based on (*allatī tastanidu ilā*) the first intelligible notions (*al-maʿānī al-maʿqūla al-ūlā*), with regard to how it is possible to pass by means of them from the known to the unknown, *not in so far as they are intelligible and possess intellectual existence ([an existence] which does not depend on matter at all, or depends on an incorporeal matter)*.

The subject-matter of logic in this text, namely the secondary intelligible notions, are concepts like "subject" and "predicate", "universal" and "particular", "essential" and "accidental"; they are based on the "first intelligible notions", namely the categories.[24]

Shortly afterwards in the same chapter, Avicenna maintains that such an investigation is necessary:

Text 7: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 11, 3–6 [p. 10, 81–84]

Furthermore, the investigation [. . .] of the formal things that are not in matter, or are in a matter different from that of the bodies, *[of] how they are and [of] what type of existence is proper to them*, is something that is necessary to investigate separatedly.

Finally he declares that the subject-matter of logic, taken in itself, is not a sensible thing, and that its investigation belongs, therefore, to the science of immaterial things, i.e. metaphysics:

Text 8: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 12, 10 [pp. 11, 10–12, 11]

As to the subject-matter of logic considered in itself, it evidently lies outside sensible things.

In sum: metaphysics clarifies the principles of logic (Text 4), by taking into account the notions of "universal" and "particular" that (together with notions like "subject" and "predicate", "essential" and "accidental") are the subject-matter of logic, and, at an even more fundamental level, the categories (Text 6). In so far as "universal" and "particular" are among the properties of "existent", and the categories are the species of "existent", this amounts to considering the subject-matter of logic ("universal", "particular" and related notions) and the categories from the point of view of their existence (Texts

[24] Sabra [1980], pp. 753–755. In *Nafs* I, 5, p. 49, 7–8 [II, pp. 96, 45–97, 57], the expression "first intelligibles" refers to the axioms, which are called "primary premises" in *Nafs* V, 1, p. 209, 8 [I, p. 81, 80] (see Marmura [1985], p. 219, n. 2).

7–8), not from the point of view of their capacity of leading the mind from the known to the unknown (Text 5).

Accordingly, the relationship between logic and metaphysics is taken into account at the beginning of Avicenna's treatment of universals and categories in the *Šifā'*, namely in *Madḫal* (the reworking of Porphyry's *Isagoge*) and *Maqūlāt* (the reworking of Aristotle's *Categories*).

> Text 9: *Madḫal* I, 5, p. 27, 10–14
>
> It is not incumbent upon you, in so far as you are a logician, [to explain] how this relation [i.e. the relation between the universal notion and the many things to which it refers] occurs; whether this notion, in so far as it is one thing shared [by many other things], has an existence (*wuǧūd*) in those things themselves that are regarded as sharing it, and, in general, an existence (*wuǧūd*) which is separate and external, different from that which is in your mind; or how its realization (*ḥuṣūl*) in the mind occurs. For the investigation of such things belongs to one or two other disciplines (*li-ṣināʿa uḫrā aw li-ṣināʿatayni*).

The two disciplines mentioned in this text (that somehow corresponds to Porphyry's *Isagoge*, p. 1, 10ss.) are metaphyscs and—in so far as the presence of the universal notion in the mind is concerned—psychology. This passage makes clear that what logic does not take into account about universals—and what metaphysics, on the contrary, does—is the mode of their existence in external reality, or the mode of their "realization" (*huṣūl*)—a synonym of existence—in the mind.

A similar statement occurs in the first chapter of *Maqūlāt*.

> Text 10: *Maqūlāt* I, 1, p. 4, 15–21
>
> [a] The single utterances have other states—namely the fact of signifying the existent things (*al-umūr al mawǧūda*) according to one of the two modes of existence (*al-wuǧūdayni*) which we have clarified when we have made known the subject-matter of logic [*Madḫal*, I, 4].
>
> [b] Knowing these [states] is not absolutely necessary (in order to know the discipline of logic, I mean); nor is it necessary in part, either [i] with regard to the fact that they [i.e. the single utterances] signify the particular individuals (since this is not useful at all in any science, not to speak of logic); or [ii] with regard to the manner in which they signify the species (since this does not help anyone in the discipline of logic, which is complete [even] without this); or [iii] with regard to the manner in which they signify the highest genera (which are usually called "categories" and to which a book at the beginning of logic, entitled *Categories*, is devoted).

As the previous part of *Maqūlāt* I, 1 attests, the states of the single utterances mentioned in section [a] are "other" with regard to the

states that are required in order to know compound utterances: these latter states are those that the single utterances possess in so far as they are "universal" and "particular", "essential" and "accidental", i.e. their condition of genera, species, differentiae, properties and accidents (the so-called "five universals"); the states mentioned in [a], on the contrary, are not required for this purpose, and, therefore, are not useful for logic in any way ([b]).[25] They regard, in general terms, the semantic relation between single utterances and things existing either in reality or in the mind (the two modes of existence that Avicenna posits). Thus, in Text 10 as in Text 9, the perspective that results to be foreign to logic (and, by implication, proper to metaphysics) is the ontological consideration of things.

The main purport of Texts 9–10 is summarized by Avicenna in another passage of *Maqūlāt* I, 1:

> Text 11: *Maqūlāt* I, 1, p. 5, 6–9
>
> [a] Disregarding the ten categories causes no harm to speak of, nor would it be a weakness in logic for one to labor under the misconception that there is a greater or smaller number of categories.
>
> [b] Furthermore, knowing whether some matters should be described as genera is not any more incumbent upon him than knowing whether some others should be described as species.
>
> [c] Rather, the knowledge of these [things] with regard to the modality of their existence (*kayfiyyat al-wuğūd*) belongs to first philosophy (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*).[26]

The things mentioned in Text 11 [c] are apparently not only the categories in [a], but also to genera and species (and, by implication, the other universals) in [b]. Thus, the investigation of the modality of existence of both categories and universals is assigned to metaphysics ("first philosophy") according to Avicenna.

A later passage of *Maqūlāt* mentions a second task of metaphysics, besides the one envisaged in Texts 10–11: metaphysics has to certify not only the existence of the categories, but also their nature and the fact that they are accidents.

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[25] Since knowing the states of the single utterances is unnecessary in logic, according to Avicenna, not only when these utterances signify individuals ([i]) or species ([ii]), but also when they signify the *summa genera* ([iii]), the doctrine of the categories might be eliminated from logic without any harm for this discipline (see, below Text 11 [a], and points 1 and 4 of Lemma 57 in Gutas [1988], pp. 265–267).

[26] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 266 (slightly modified).

Text 12: *Maqūlāt* I, 1, p. 6, 15–16

You should know that everything with which they attempt to establish [a] the number of these ten [categories], [b] that there is no science of them,[27] [c] that one is distinct from the other, [d] that each of them has such-and-such property (*ḫāṣṣiyya*), [e] that [the last] nine of them differ from the first in that it [i.e the first] is substance whereas they are accidents, and similar things, are elucidations drawn from other disciplines and insufficient in every respect. This is so because there is no way to know about such things except after a thorough examination, and there is no way to engage in a thorough examination except after attaining the level of the science called "first philosophy" (*falsafa ūlā*).[28]

Among the various points of the philosophical agenda of metaphysics ("first philosophy") that Avicenna draws in this text, the most important are [d] and [e]: the investigation of the properties of categories (i.e the features descending from their essences and pertaining exclusively to them), and the proof that the nine accidental categories are accidents rather than substances. Since the distinction between accident and substance is mainly a distinction between two different types of existence (dependent and independent existence, respectively), point [e] can be seen as a further aspect of the investigation of the existence of the categories. Point [d], on the other hand, indicates that metaphysics has to take into account the categories also in the perspective of their nature or essence.

A text at the beginning of Avicenna's treatment of accidents in *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 1 clarifies how metaphysics provides the investigation of the existence and essence of categories and universals prefigured in *Maqūlāt*.

Text 13: *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 1, p. 93, 5–10 [p. 104, 5–13]

[a] We say: We have already clarified the quiddity (*māhiyya*) of substance and that it is predicated of what is separate, of body, of matter and of form [see II, 1]. As to body, establishing it [i.e. proving its existence, *iṯbātuhū*)] is superfluous. As to matter and form, we have already established them [*qad aṯbatnāhumā*; see II, 3–4]. As to what is separate, we have already established it [*qad aṯbatnāhu*] by means of the potency that is close to act,[29] and we will establish it [*wa-naḥnu*

[27] Avicenna possibly means that the categories, in so far as they are *summa genera*, cannot be properly defined, and therefore cannot be know in a truly scientific way.

[28] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 266 (slightly modified).

[29] The place referred to in this case is not clear. It might be the same place of

> *nuṯbitūhu*] again [see OntologyC/Theology]. However, if you remember what we have said about the [human] soul, it appears true to you [even now] the existence (*wuǧūd*) of a substance separate and incorporeal [see *Nafs*, V, 7].
>
> [b] It is convenient to pass now to verifying (*taḥqīq*) the [quiddites of] accidents and establishing them (*iṯbātihā*).

This text recapitulates the treatment of substance in treatise II (part [a]), and introduces the treatment of accidents in treatise III (part [b]). In both cases, metaphysics accomplishes a double task: the discussion of essence (clarification of the "quiddity", *māhiyya*, in the case of substance; "verification", *taḥqīq*—in the sense of providing the "essence", *ḥaqīqa*—in the case of accidents), and the proof of existence (expressed by means of the *maṣdar iṯbāt*, the verb *aṯbata*, "to establish", and related forms).[30]

As to the category of substance, the program outlined in Text 13 is fully accomplished in treatise II. The general definition of substance (together with the negative definition of accident as thing that is not a substance) is provided in II, 1. In this chapter, substance is shown to be the cause of the accident's existence, and to have three main instances (form, matter and compound of matter and form, i.e. body); the separate substances (souls and intellects) are added to these three types of substances at the end. Chapter II, 2 deals with the "verification" (*taḥqīq*) of the bodily substance, i.e. with its definition and the proof that it is made of matter and form. Chapters II, 3–4 take into account the existence of matter and form, proving that matter cannot exist without form (II, 3), and that form is the cause of the matter's existence (II, 4). The existence and nature of the separate substances (souls and intellects) is clarified, with regard to the heavenly realm, in IX, 2–5.[31]

The treatment of the quiddities of the nine accidental categories, albeit *de iure* pertaining to metaphysics according to Text 13, is de

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Nafs referred to later; or it might be *Samāʿ* IV, 5, p. 331, 6, where Avicenna states the existence of a mover of the eternal heavenly motion, and portrays it as having an infinite power and not being a body or in a body.

[30] For *iṯbāt* as "proving the existence", see I, 1, p. 8, 5–6 [p. 7, 21–23]; p. 8, 12 [p. 7, 30–31]. See also the mention of "existence" at the end of part [a].

[31] In treatise II, Avicenna occasionally resumes some themes from the *Maqūlāt*; but this happens mainly in chapter II, 1, and concerns particular points of Avicenna's discourse, not its core: see Appendix B, II.2.2.1, s.v. *awāʾil al-manṭiq*; II.3.2.1, s.v. *mā salafa; qad ʿarafta.*

facto provided by Avicenna in the *Maqūlāt*, as a way of complying with the previous Aristotelian tradition, and from there is resumed in the *Ilāhiyyāt*:[32] Avicenna's discourse in *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 1–10 focuses on the existence of the accidental categories (both their existence *tout court* and their existence as accidents) rather than their essence.[33] In III, 1, he states that, whereas there is no doubt about the accidental nature of seven of the nine accidental categories (relation, space, time, position, action, passion; he omits possess), the accidentality of quantity and quality is disputed, since some philosophers (Pythagoreans, Platonists, advocates of the occultation of qualities) regard them as substances rather than accidents. III, 2 shows that unity and number are accidents. III, 4 contains the proof of the accidentality of the continuous quantities, whose existence, in the same chapter, is declared to be evident; III, 4 provides also, conclusively, a general definition of quantity. The criticism of the Pythagorean and Platonic views of quantities as substances is provided in VII, 2–3. The existence of sensible and corporeal qualities is declared to be unquestionable at the beginning of III, 7; this chapter is rather a proof of their accidentality, based on the criticism of the opinion of those who regard them as substances.[34] A particular case of quality (knowledge) is proven to be an accident in III, 8, by means of the criticism of an objection stating the contrary.[35] In III, 9, Avicenna deals with a special case of qualities, those inhering in quantities—like evenness and oddness in numbers (discrete quantities), and circle, curved line, sphere, cylinder and cone in extensions (continuous quantities)—proving their existence and the fact that they are accidents.

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[32] See Gutas [1988], pp. 265–267. See III, 1, p. 93, 11 [p. 104, 13–14] (immediately after Text 12): "We say: As to the ten categories, you have understood their quiddities (*māhiyyāt*) at the beginning of logic [i.e. in the *Maqūlāt*]"; III, 4, p. 117, 7 [p. 130, 24], where Avicenna states that the accidentality of time (*zamān*) and its dependence on movement has already been verified (the reference is to *Maqūlāt* VI, 5; cp. *Samāʿ* II, 10–13); III, 10, p. 152, 4–5 [173, 12–14]: "As to what has to be said about the relative, the clarification of how the quiddity (*māhiyya*) of the relative and of relation has to be verified (*kayfa yağibu an tutaḥaqqaqa*), and their definition, what we have anticipated in logic [i.e. in *Maqūlāt* IV, 3–5] is sufficent for the person who has understood it".

[33] The verification (*taḥqīq*) of the quiddity (*māhiyya*) of "one" and "many" and of number is mentioned in the titles, respectively, of III, 3 and III, 5. But none of these items is, properly speaking, a category.

[34] See Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7.

[35] See Chapter 6, §3.3, Table 8.

In III, 10, the accidentality of relation is stated to be evident: the chapter discusses whether relation is a single reality existing in the two relatives, or rather each of the two relatives has a peculiar feature that makes it relative to the other, and whether the existence of relation is real or mental.

In treatise V Avicenna applies the same pattern of investigation (essence, existence) also to universals. He first provides a definition of "universal" and "particular" and a classification of the different types of universals (beginning of V, 1); then he focuses on the "modality of existence" (*kayfiyyat wuǧūd*) of universals, showing that universality attaches to the natures of things only when they exist in the mind (V, 1–2). The initial general definition of "universal" (i.e. the account of its essence) in V, 1 appears to be taken from *Madḫal*.[36] In the following chapters, Avicenna occasionally provides the "verification" (*taḥqīq*) of some of the five universals, as of differentia in V, 6.

Thus, the most important metaphysical doctrine by Avicenna, namely the distinction between essence and existence, is the theoretical tool by means of which metaphysics elucidates the principles of the subject-matter of logic (categories) and this subject-matter itself (universals), thus providing the epistemological foundation of this discipline.

2.2 *References to metaphysics in the logical treatises*

A complete inventory of the references to metaphysics occurring in the previous parts of the *Šifāʾ* is certainly a *desideratum*. What follows is a provisional survey to the main references to metaphysics that can be found in *Madḫal*, *Maqūlāt* and *Burhān*, i.e. in Avicenna's reworkings of Porphyry's *Isagoge*, and Aristotle's *Categories* and *Posterior Analytics*.

Besides the veiled reference to metaphysics in Text 9, in *Madḫal* we find two announcements of a forthcoming treatment in metaphysics of topics provisionally taken into account in this work; both occur within the tripartition of universals into "natural", "intellectual" and "logical", or into "before multiplicity", "in multiplicity" and

[36] At the end of the classification of universals in V, 1, Avicenna maintains: "The universal employed in logic and its like must be this" (V, 1, p. 196, 2–3 [p. 228, 21]). A similar classification occurs in *Madḫal* I, 5.

"after multiplicity", roughly corresponding to the tripartion of universals in universals *per se*, in reality, and in human mind (I, 12).[37] One of these references is explicit (metaphysics is called "first philosophy") and regards the individuation of universals;[38] the other is veiled and concerns the status "before multiplicity" of universals.[39] The place referred to, in both cases, is *Ilāhiyyāt* V, 1–2.[40]

In *Maqūlāt*, Avicenna refers to metaphysics not only in Texts 11–12, which regard collectively all the categories, but also in the context of the exposition of some of the single categories and related topics. This happens in the case of the categories of quantity in III, 4 (about the fact that quantities are accidents),[41] and of quality in VI, 1 (about qualities inherent in quantities).[42] Likewise, in IV, 3 Avicenna states that the investigation of the existence of relation does not belong to logic,[43] thus implying that it belongs to metaphysics.

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[37] On this chapter, see Marmura [1979]. On the background of Avicenna's tripartition in the Greek commentaries on the *Isagoge*, see De Libera [1996], pp. 183–184.

[38] *Madḫal* I, 12, p. 72, 7: "This is among the things that you will ascertain in first philosophy (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*)"; Engl. transl. in Marmura [1979], p. 52.

[39] *Madḫal* I, 12, p. 69, 16–18: "Since for this there is another theoretical discipline"; Engl. transl. in Marmura [1979], p. 50, and n. 55.

[40] In *Madḫal* I, 9, p. 54, 5, about the definition of relatives Avicenna states: "You will see that in another place" (*fa-sa-tarā ḏālika fi makānin āḫara*). In *Madḫal* I, 11, p. 64, 6–9, he contends: "Likewise, it is not impossible that under a *summum genus* (*ǧins al-aǧnās*) there are predicates that are not genera, but rather concomitant notions (*maʿānī lāzima*) shared by some of the *summa genera*, like existence and accidentality, or like the realities that are predicated of a certain number of highest genera, as you will understand later (*mimmā sataftanu lahā baʿdu*)". It is matter of future research to ascertain whether these two references regard metaphysics or the sections of logic following *Madḫal*.

[41] *Maqūlāt* III, 4, p. 113, 1–2: "We say that the verification (*taḥqīq*) of these things belongs to what the logician does not take into account; on the contrary, the logician must take for granted what we say, and this latter must be clarified in another discipline (*ṣināʿa uḫrā*); p. 116, 3: "The verification (*taḥqīq*) of these things occurs in another discipline (*ṣināʿa uḫrā*)". Cp. *Qiyās* I, 2, p. 14, 9–10: "The theoretical investigation of quantity and what pertains to it is not a logical investigation".

[42] *Maqūlāt* VI, 1, p. 206, 13–16: "This is so because the dispositions of number . . . are neither numbers, nor differentiae of numbers, but accidents that inhere in numbers and accompany them inseparably, as it will be verified (*taḥaqqaqa*) in first philosophy (*falsafa ūlā*) and is commonly acknowledged". See also the mention of "another discipline" (*ṣināʿa uḫra*) at p. 208, 14.

[43] *Maqūlāt* IV, 3, p. 143, 15–16: "It is not for the logician to prove the existence of the relative and to show its state in existence or in conception. Whoever undertakes this undertakes, inasmuch as he is a logician, that which is neither his concern nor his special task"; Engl. transl. in Marmura [1979], p. 36.

Other references to metaphysics occur in the preliminary discussion of how "existent" relates to the categories (II, 1),[44] and in the treatment of contrariety (VII, 3).[45]

No doctrine of *Burhān* is delayed, for its final elucidation, to metaphysics:[46] it is rather metaphysics that has to comply with the epistemological standards set by Aristotle in the *Posterior Analytics* and expounded by Avicenna in this work. Thus in *Burhān* Avicenna anticipates some of the features of metaphysics as science. Besides the texts showing that metaphysics clarifies the principles of the other sciences, and pointing at the differences between metaphysics, dialectic and sophistic,[47] Avicenna refers to metaphysics in the context of causation: according to him, explaining how something can be, as such, the cause of two different effects does not pertain to logic, but to metaphysics ("first philosophy");[48] and whereas natural philosophy provides the material and formal causes of certain facts, metaphysics ("first philosophy") provides the causes of these causes, i.e. the ultimate efficient and final causes, thus bringing to completion the account of causation provided by natural philosophy.[49]

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[44] In *Maqūlāt* II, 1, p. 62, 11, Avicenna states that explaining how the differentiae of substances are substances themselves and, nonetheless, differentiae, belongs to another discipline (*ṣinā'a uḫrā*) and lies outside the scope of logic.

[45] *Maqūlāt* VII, 3, p. 264, 12–13: "But we do not debate such things in a book like this; for the verification of such matters, it will be given to you a place providing it" (this statement occurs at the end of the discussion of the opposition between courage, cowardice and temerity, a topic resumed in *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 1, pp. 307, 11–308, 3 [pp. 354, 14–355, 28]). Cp. p. 262, 17–19: "But, since this book is built upon things that are commonly believed and known and are not brought back to the conditions by which they become true, it is not necessary to pay attention in it to this type of verification"; p. 264, 7: "Since this book is not the book devoted to the deep investigation [of these matters]"; p. 265, 12: "Let us limit ourselves, for the moment, to this much".

[46] In *Qiyās* I, 2, p. 13, 11–17, on the other hand, Avicenna states that the proposition "Natural science is a knowledge of things having principles" is apprehended in the "art embracing the teaching concerning demonstration" (*al-fann al-muštamil 'alā ta'līm al-burhān*), but is "truly verified" (*tataḥaqqaqu bi-l-ḥaqīqa*) only in "first philosophy".

[47] See the texts of *Burhān* II, 7 and III, 1 mentioned above, §1 and n. 4, and Chapter 6, §3.1, Text 5.2.

[48] *Burhān* I, 8, p. 87, 6–16.

[49] *Burhān* II, 9, pp. 178, 8–179, 13. In this passage, Avicenna states that natural philosophy, as an example of "inferior science" (*'ilm asfal*), and metaphysics ("first philosophy"), as an example of "superior science" (*'ilm a'lā*), differ in providing the causes of certain phaenomena. As to explaining why the first movement (i.e. the movement of the first celestial sphere) is uniform and stable, natural philosophy provides the formal cause (the nature of the celestial bodies has no contrary) and the material cause (the matter of the celestial bodies is simple and without differences,

2.3 *References to logic in metaphysics*

The passages discussed in §2.1 are not the only ones in which Avicenna refers back to the logical part of the *Šifāʾ*. Other references occur elsewhere.[50] Among these references, particularly relevant are those regarding the *Burhān*: from the point of view of form, the *Burhān* is the only section of the logical part of the *Šifāʾ* whose title ("Book of Demonstration") is mentioned in the *Ilāhiyyāt*;[51] from the point of view of content, it plays a decisive role in Avicenna's view of the scientific profile of metaphysics, as we have seen.[52] An annotated list of the quotations of the *Burhān* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is provided in the following outline.[53]

Outline 1: Quotations of the *Burhān* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*
Explicit determinate quotations:

I, 1, p. 5, 1–4 [p. 3, 35–40]: "It has not appeared clearly to you from this what the subject-matter of the divine science really is, apart from a pointer occuring in the *Book of Demonstration* in logic, if your remember: namely that in the other sciences you had something that is the subject-matter, some things that are the things searched, and some admitted principles from which the demonstrations are composed" (= Chapter 4, §1.2, Texts 2.1 [a]). The reference is to *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 4–12, where Avicenna paraphrases *An. Post.* A, 10, 76b11–22 (cfr. I, 28, 87a38–39).

Cp. I, 1, p. 5, 15 [p. 4, 57–58] (see below, explicit indeterminate); I, 1, p. 7, 6–7 [p. 6, 97]: "Since it is unescapable that this science has a subject-matter . . .".

I, 3, p. 19, 13–14 [p. 21, 95–96]: "What has to be said in order to solve this difficulty [the fact that the principles of natural philosophy

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and, therefore, incorruptible and unchangeable); metaphysics, on the other hand, indicates the separate efficient cause (the Pure Good and the Pure Intellect), and the first final cause (the Pure Existence [*wuǧūd*], or the Pure Generous [*ǧawād*] according to another manuscript). As to explaining why the Earth is not perfectly spherical and water flows in its abysses (i.e. the oceans), natural philosophy provides again the material and formal causes (earth is dry and non-elastic, water is fluid and elastic), whereas metaphysics points at the final cause (generable things ultimately stop in their own natural places).

[50] See Appendix B, II.2.2.1 and II.3.2.1.

[51] The *Burhān* is frequently quoted also elsewhere in the *Šifāʾ: Samāʿ* I, 1, p. 7, 5 [p. 5, 5] (see Hasnawi [2000], p. 518); p. 7, 14 [p. 6, 22]; p. 8, 3 [p. 7, 35]. *Nafs* I, 1, p. 12, 1 [I, p. 28, 53–54] (cp. I, 1, p. 11, 5–7 [I, p. 27, 36–38]; I, 5, p. 46, 9–15 [I, pp. 91, 76–92, 84]).

[52] See Chapter 4, Text 8.1; Chapter 5, Texts 11.2 and 11.4; Chapter 6, Text 5.2; above, §1, and n. 4.

[53] For the typology of quotations ("explicit determinate", "explicit indeterminate", "implicit"), see Chapter 8, §2.

and mathematics are demonstrated in metaphysics, whereas metaphysics assumes the results of natural philosophy and mathematics] is what has already been said and explained in the *Book of Demonstration*". See *Burhān* II, 7 *in toto* (an expanded version of *An. Post.* A, 7, 75b2–4), II, 9, pp. 177, 3–183, 5 (corresponding to *An. Post.* A, 9, 76a9–16), e III, 8, p. 247, 3–11 (corresponding to *An. Post.* A, 28).

I, 8, p. 48, 14–16 [p. 56, 70–74]: "The first of all the true statements in which the analysis of everything ends—so that it is said potentially or actually of everything that is clarified or results clear by means of it—as we clarified in the *Book of Demonstration*, is that there is no middle between affirming and denying". See *Burhān* I, 4, p. 64, 3–4; I, 5, p. 69, 14–17.

II, 2, p. 69, 10–11 [p. 80, 2–3]: "You have already known the distinction between the two [i.e. between corporeity as form and corporeity as genus] in the *Book of Demonstration*". See *Burhān* I, 10.

Explicit indeterminate quotations:

I, 1, p. 5, 15 [p. 4, 57–58]: "It has already been known that every science has a subject-matter that is proper to it" (see above, explicit determinate).

I, 1, pp. 5, 18–6, 1 [p. 4, 62–64]: "For the subject-matter of each science is something whose existence is admitted in that science, and of which only the states are investigated. This has already been known elsewhere" (= Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 2.2). The reference is to *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 8–9, where Avicenna paraphrases *An. Post.* A, 10, 76 b 11–22 (cp. I, 28, 87a38–39).

Cp. I, 1, p. 8, 17–18 (see below, implicit)

Implicit quotations:

I, 1, p. 8, 17–18 [p. 8, 37–39]: "How the subject-matter of a science—whose states [only] are investigated among the things sought for [in that science]—can be something whose existence is searched in it?"

I, 2, p. 13, 2–3 [p. 12, 22–24]: "Some of them [i.e. of the other sciences] only use them [i.e. the common notions that have to be defined and determined in the soul], whereas some other only assumes their definitions, without discussing the mode of their existence". Cp. *An. Post.* I, 10.

I, 2, p. 13, 11–12 [p. 13, 35–36]: ". . . since establishing [the existence] of the subject-matter and verifying its quiddity cannot occur in the science of which it is the subject-matter, but only assuming its existence and quiddity [can occur in it]" (= Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 2.3).

I, 2, p. 14, 2–3 [p. 13, 49–50]: "since in every science the investigation regards the consequent attributes of its subject-matter, not the principles of it" (= Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 2.4).

Other references to logic—even though not to the logic of the *Šifā'*, but to the source of this latter, i.e. Aristotle's *Organon*—are Avicenna's

quotations of the *Categories* and the commentaries thereupon,[54] the *De Interpretatione*,[55] the *Prior Analytics*[56] and the *Posterior Analytics*.[57]

3 Metaphysics and natural philosophy

3.1 *The metaphysical foundation of natural philosophy: the doctrines of physical substance and causality*

Natural philosophy is presented as subordinated to metaphysics in *Qiyās* and *Burhān*.[58] In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna portrays metaphysics as providing the epistemological foundation of natural philosophy with regard to two main contexts: physical substance, the subject-matter of natural philosophy; and causality, the main "common" notion employed in this disicpline. This foundation consists of three different, though interrelated, procedures: the certification of the principles of natural philosophy; the resumption of some of its topics from a

[54] VII, 1, pp. 307, 11–308, 3 [pp. 354, 14–355, 28], contains an explicit indeterminate quotation of *Cat.* 11, 14a1, 14a22–23 (see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [14]). Implicit quotations occur in the following places: II, 1, p. 57, 7–11 [p. 65, 9–13] (cp. *Cat.* 2, 1a20–b6); IV, 1 (cp. *Cat.* 12), as remarked by Marmura [1981], p. 66; VI, 4, p. 281, 3–4 [p. 323, 84–85], where what Avicenna says about "element" is based, among other Aristotelian sources (Δ, 3, 1014a26–b9, B, 3, 998b9–11) on *Cat.* 5, 2b5–10 (see Bertolacci [2003], pp. 31–37). The continuous quantities discussed by Avicenna in treatise III are those taken into account in *Cat.* 6, 4b20–25, with one notable exception, namely space, which Avicenna regards as identical with surface and not as a continuous quantity on its own (see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [6]). As to the commentaries on the *Categories*, see Chapter 11, §1.2 (Simplicius) and §2.3 (Porphyry).

[55] See Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [1]–[2].

[56] See Appendix B, II.1.1.

[57] Marmura [2000], pp. 89–92, points at two main areas in which the *Ilāhiyyāt* is influenced by the *Posterior Analytics*. The first is the doctrine according to which God knows the particulars in the celestial realm in so far as they are the only instances of their species (*Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 6). This doctrine depends on the general idea of *An. Post.* that knowledge is of the universal, and on the specific allusion to individuals that are the only instances of their species in *An. Post.* A, 5, 74a4–12, according to Avicenna's interpretation of this passage (*Burhān* II, 4, p. 144). The second is the idea of inferring effects from causes through demonstration, that Avicenna enuntiates in *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 3, p. 21, 2–8 (see Chapter 6, §1.2) with regard to the emanation of the divine triads from God. Marmura's first point is further developed in the throrough account by Adamson [2005], who rightly remarks that the main example of particular thing known universallly by God that Avicenna provides in *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 6, i.e. the eclipse, depends on the mention of the eclipse in *An. Post.* A, 8.

[58] *Qiyās* I, 2, p. 13, 14–17; *Burhān* II, 9, pp. 178, 8–179, 13 (see above, n. 49).

more universal point of view; the clearer delimitation of its scope of investigation.

In three passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, within the discussion of physical substance (treatise II), sensible quality (III, 7) and the four causes (treatise VI), Avicenna portrays some topics dealt with in this metaphysical context as "principles" (*mabādi'*) of natural philosophy.

> Text 14: *Ilāhiyyāt* II, 3, p. 78, 14 [p. 91, 10–12]
> Thus, it has been known that hyle is predisposed by itself to [receive] different extensions. This too is a principle (*mabda'*) for [the science of] natural things.

> Text 15: *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 7, p. 139, 12–13 [p. 157, 36–37]
> It has been clarified that qualities that are sensible are accidents. This is a principle (*mabda'*) for [the science of] natural things.

> Text 16: *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 5, p. 294, 4–5 [p. 339, 30–32]
> It has thus been made clear to you how something may be cause as well as effect, given that it is [both] an agent and an end. This is one of the natural philosophers' principles (*mabādi'*).[59]

Together with the doctrines mentioned in these texts, also the "proof of the existence" (*iṯbāt*) of causes—which is ascribed to metaphysics in I,1,[60] and regards in particular the final cause (VI, 5)[61] and the First Principle (VIII, 1–3)[62]—and the account of the essence of physical substance (II, 2) and of the existence of its two constituents, i.e. material form and matter (II, 3–4), can be regarded as belonging to the metaphysical foundation of the principles of natural philosophy in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[63] Another aspect of natural philosophy, more precisely of psychology, i.e. the treatment of prophecy in *Nafs*, receives its metaphysical foundation in *Ilāhiyyāt* X, 1–2, where Avicenna proves the necessity of the prophet's existence.[64]

In another case, about efficient causality, Avicenna distinguishes the theoretical approach of natural philosophy from that of metaphysics.

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[59] Engl. transl. in Wisnovsky [2000], p. 202 (slightly modified).
[60] See I, 1, p. 8, 5–16 [pp. 7, 21–8, 37].
[61] VI, 5, p. 283, 12 [p. 326, 49].
[62] VIII, 1, p. 328, 15 [p. 378, 52]; VIII, 3, p. 340, 11 [p. 393, 70]; VIII, 4, p. 343, 10 [p. 397, 55].
[63] Significantly, in *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 13–14, Avicenna mentions a presupposition of "existence" (*wuǧūd*)—i.e. the existence of motion—as a proper principle of natural philosophy.
[64] X, 1, pp. 435, 14–436, 1 [p. 523, 22–30]; X, 2, p. 442, 1–2 [p. 532, 7–8], p. 442, 6–8 [p. 533, 16–18].

Text 17: *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 1, p. 257, 13–14 [p. 292, 19–22]

The metaphysicians (*al-falāsifa al-ilāhiyyūn*) do not mean by "agent" the principle of motion only (*fa-qaṭṭ*), as natural philosophers (*al-ṭabīʿiyyūn*) do, but the principle of existence and what provides it, like the Creator with regard to the world.

In this text the metaphysical perspective on efficient causality results to be different from that of natural philosophy by being wider: whereas natural philosophy regards the efficient cause only as principle of motion, metaphysics posits itself on a higher and more universal level (that of existence), and takes the efficient cause as principle of existence. Avicenna's implicit assumption—made more explicit in a passage of VI, 2[65]—is that the metaphysics' approach encompasses that of natural philosophy and is more fundamental than this latter, thus providing its foundation.

In two further instances (Texts 18–19), Avicenna declares that certain topics, albeit dealt with in natural philosophy, are extraneous to this latter and belong rather to metaphysics. This regards primarily the crucial issue of which is the discipline deputed to investigate God and the divine matters. This issue is crucial since it determines the further, and even more fundamental, issue of which is the subject-matter of metaphysics: as we have seen in Chapter 4, Avicenna can maintain that "existent" rather than God is the subject-matter of metaphysics just because only this discipline deals with God and proves His existence.[66] In Text 18 Avicenna establishes two main points: first, the investigation of God pertains properly only to metaphysics, since God is immaterial and metaphysics—according to Avicenna's first and fundamental characterization of this discipline—is the science of what is immaterial;[67] second, the account of God provided by natural philosophy (in places like *Samāʿ* IV, 15, p. 331, 6) is alien to this discipline and motivated only by didactical purposes.

Text 18: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, pp. 6, 19–7, 6 [p. 5, 88–6, 96]

It has appeared to you in [the science of] natural things that the Divinity is neither a body, nor a bodily power, but is one and free from matter and mixture with motion in every respect. Therefore, Its investigation must belong to the present science. What appeared to

[65] VI, 2, p. 268, 2–4 [p. 306, 14–18].
[66] See Chapter 4, §1.2.
[67] See Chapter 4, Text 1 [a].

> you about this [topic] in [the science of] natural things was extraneous to [the science of] natural things; of it [i.e. of this topic] it was used in it [i.e. in the science of natural things] what was not part of it [i.e. of the science of natural things]. However, in this way it was intended to accelerate man's acquaintance with the First Principle's existence (*inniyya*), and strenghten his desire of acquiring the sciences and be led to the present place, in order to attain [here] Its true knowledge.

In the light of Text 18, it is noteworthy that IX, 1 contains a long and detailed proof of the eternity of the heavenly motion, meant to supersede the one provided in natural philosophy.[68] Since the eternity of the heavenly motion is the basis of the proof of God's existence in natural philosophy, Avicenna's aim in IX, 7 is apparently to "transfer" the account of the heavenly motion from natural philosophy to metaphysics, thus "depriving" natural philosophy of the possibility of proving, in its own way, God's existence and, consequently, of dealing with God's nature and related issue. In other words, in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna assumes a position on the relationship between natural philosophy and metaphysics on the issue of the proof of God's existence that is even more radical than the one expressed elsewhere:[69] natural philosophy and metaphysics do not have distinct and independent ways of proving God's existence (by way of motion the former, by way of the concept of existence the latter), as in *Šarḥ Sām* and the *Memoirs*; only metaphysics is the discipline deputed to prove God's existence and to deal with divine matters.[70]

With regard to a different topic (the doctrine of the finiteness of everything having order), the following text establishes a point similar to that of Text 18.

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[68] In IX, 1, p. 373, 18 [p. 435, 29–30], Avicenna states that in the present chapter he aims at increasing the reader's insight about the eternal heavenly movement and its mover, already taken into account in natural philosophy (the "natural sciences" are mentioned at p. 373, 13 [p. 435, 20]; see *Samāʿ* IV, 15, p. 331, 5–6; IV, 9, p. 301, 3–8).

[69] See the passages discussed in Gutas [1988], pp. 261–265.

[70] This "transferral" of theology from natural philosophy to metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* parallels the analogous displacement of the treatment of the human souls' destiny (the "fruit" of natural philosophy) from psychology to metaphysics, as documented by Gutas [1988], pp. 254–261 (see below, §3.2).

Text 19: *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, p. 329, 6–7 [p. 379, 63–64]

On the contrary, you have already known that every thing that by nature has order is finite. [You have known] this in [the science of] natural things [see *Samāʾ wa-ʿĀlam*, 10; *Kawn wa-Fasād*, 4, p. 101, 11–13], even though [this topic] was somehow intrusive in it (*ka-l-daḫīl fīhā*).

3.2 *References to metaphysics in natural philosophy*

The present section surveys the references to metaphysics occurring in *Samāʿ* (Outline 2) and *Nafs* (Outline 3), i.e. in Avicenna's reworking of Aristotle's *Physics* and *De Anima*.[71] References to metaphysics concentrate in the first treatise of the *Samāʿ*, dealing with the causes and principles of natural things.

Outline 2: References to metaphysics in *Samāʿ*

1) I, 2, pp. 14, 10–14 [p. 21, 50–59]: natural philosophy takes for granted that the body is composed of matter and form, and that matter cannot exist in act without form; see Hasnawi [2000], p. 512; Hasnawi [2002], p. 73. See the discussion of these assumptions in *Ilāhiyyāt* II, 2–4.
2) I, 2, p. 15, 12–13 [p. 22, 83–85]: the existence of the agent that bestows the first form (i.e. corporeal form) to first matter will be explained "in its own place" (*fī mawḍiʿihī*). See Avicenna's account of the Giver of Forms in *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 4–5.
3) I, 2, p. 16, 17–18 [p. 25, 24–26]: the fact that the principles are the aforementioned four (i.e. matter, form, agent, end) is assumed by natural philosophy and demonstrated by "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 1.
4) I, 2, pp. 17, 20–18, 2 [p. 27, 72–77]: whether the generation and the coming into existence of something requires a previously existent substance (i.e. matter), which is first linked with the privation of form, and from which then the privation of form disappears, will be demonstrated in "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*); see Hasnawi [2000], p. 518 (Texte 2); Hasnawi [2002], p. 75. The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 2.
5) I, 5, p. 30, 6–7 [p. 51, 33–36]: that the bodies are in motion due to powers internal to them is something that the natural philosopher assumes and the metaphysician ("divine philosopher", *al-ilāhī*) demonstrates; see Druart [2000], p. 271 and n. 23. The reference is probably to *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 2.

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[71] Among the other sections of the natural philosophy of the *Šifāʾ*, see, for example, *Kawn wa-Fasād*, p. 196, 16, where the task of discussing the possibility of the return of what has ceased to exist is assigned to "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*); see M. Rashed [2000], p. 227 and n. 8. The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5.

6) I, 5, p. 31, 5–6 [p. 52, 66–69]: the existence (*wuǧūd*) of nature is a principle (*mabdaʾ*) for the natural philosopher; the proof of its existence (*iṯbātuhā*) pertains to the first philosopher (*ṣāḥib al-falsafa l-ūlā*), whereas the verification (*taḥqīq*) of its quiddity (*māhiyyatihā*) pertains to the natural philosopher. See *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 5.
7) I, 5, p. 34, 1–3 [p. 58, 73–77]: nature is the principle of substantial change not by causing the occurrence of a (new) form, but by preparing matter to it, as it will be explained in "another discipline" (*ṣināʿa uḫrā*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* II, 4.
8) I, 6, p. 35, 7–12 [p. 60, 30–38]: in compound bodies, nature (i.e. the *forma partis*) is only a part of the form (i.e. of the *forma totius*); the form of these bodies is the result of the union of many things (i.e. of *forma partis* and matter); the mode of this union will be clarified in "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* II, 2–4.
9) I, 10, p. 48, 10–11 [p. 86, 7–11]: the fact that all generable and corruptible things, all things in motion, and all things composed of matter and form have causes, and the fact that the causes are exactly four, does not belong to the natural philosopher but to the metaphysician ("divine philosopher", *al-ilāhī*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 1–5.
10) I, 10, pp. 49, 18–50, 5 [pp. 89, 63–90, 2]: the clarification of the relationship of form and matter will be given in the "first discipline" (*al-ṣināʿa al-ūlā*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* II, 2–4.
11) I, 11, p. 53, 10–12 [p. 95, 14–19]: the relationship between efficient and final causality will be made clear in "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*); see Wisnovsky [2000], p. 217. The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 5.
12) I, 12, p. 59, 8–12 [p. 105, 42–51]: certifying the simultaneity of cause and effect belongs to "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 1–2.
13) I, 13, p. 63, 17–18 [p. 113, 31–32]: the clarification of the fact that to be caused means to exist necessarily, and similar things, is delayed to "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 1–2.
14) I, 13, p. 66, 2–4 [p. 117, 12–15]: the opinion according to which some things are aimless without being fortuitous, will be refuted in "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*). See *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 5.
15) I, 14, p. 67, 7–9 [p. 120, 4–8]: the discussion of the false doctrines concerning chance is provided in natural philosophy, even though it should be delayed to "metaphysics" (*mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*) and "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*).

Apart from the fifth reference, concerning motion, all the other references regard two main topics: the relationship between matter and form within corporeal substances (1–2, 4, 7–8, 10), and causality (3, 9, 11–15). These are exactly the same topics about which

metaphysics provides the foundation of natural philosophy in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see above, §3.1).[72]

Outline 3: References to metaphysics in *Nafs*

1) Prologue, p. 3, 12 [I, p. 13, 64]: the "divine science" (*al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*) is one of the parts of the *Šifāʾ* that follow *Nafs*.
2) I, 1, p. 14, 1 [I, p. 32, 96], p. 14, 5 [I, p. 33, 01]: the rationality and sensibility of the celestial spheres is different from the one that can be found on earth, "as you will see (*ʿalā mā tarā*)". The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 2 (Avicenna Latinus [1972], p. 32, n. 96, p. 33, n. 1).
3) I, 2, p. 22, 13 [I, p. 49, 97]: the rebuttal of the opinion of those who regard number as principle, quiddity and definition of everything will be provided in "the discipline of first philosophy" (*ṣināʿat al-falsafa l-ūlā*). Avicenna Latinus [1972], p. 49, n. 97, refers to a marginal annotation of the edition Venice 1508, according to which the reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 5; it is rather to *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 2–3.
4) IV, 2, p. 178, 13 [II, p. 28, 82]: the principle from which the warnings that are present in dreams occur is investigated by means of things that we take for granted in a certain way, and will appear clear to us only in "the discipline of first philosophy" (*al-ṣināʿa allatī hiya al-falsafa l-ūlā*). According to Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 28, n. 81–82, the reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 2–5; it is rather to *Ilāhiyyāt* X, 1.
5) IV, 2, p. 178, 16–17 [II, p. 28, 86–87]: the notions of all things are present in the knowledge that God and the celestial intellects, on the one hand, and the celestial souls, on the other, have. "These two aspects will become clear to you in another place" The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 2–5 (Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 28, n. 87).
6) V, 1, p. 202, 13–14 [II, p. 70, 15–16]: man needs social life because he is more perfect than animals, "as you will know in other places" (*ʿalā mā sataʿlamuhū fī mawāḍiʿa uḫrā*). The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* X, 1 (Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 70, n. 16).
7) V, 1, p. 207, 3–4 [II, p. 77, 20]: the treatment of universality and particularity is delayed to the "sapiential discipline in the last section" (*al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya fī āḫir al-funūn*). The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* V, 1–2 (cp. Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 77, n. 20).
8) V, 2, p. 208, 18–19 [II, p. 80, 69–70]: the human soul is predisposed to protect itself from the harms occurring to it from the union

[72] The sixth reference is significant: it ascribes to metaphysics the proof of the existence of nature, and to natural philosophy the investigation of its essence. From this point of view it represents a case of splitted comptences between natural philosophy (essence) and metaphysics (existence) similar to the one put in practice by Avicenna with regard to the accidental categories (see above, §2.1).

with the body "as we will explain in its place" (*ka-mā sanašraḥuhū fī mawḍiʿihī*). According to Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 80, n. 69, the reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* X, 1, 3; it seems to be rather to *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 7.

9) V, 5, p. 237, 6 [II, p. 130, 96]: the unity of different things by abstraction will be clarified in the "sapiential discipline" (*al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya*). The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* V, 1–2 (Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 130, n. 96).
10) V, 5, p. 238, 6 [II, p. 132, 20]: the destiny of the human soul after death has not to be discussed in natural philosophy, but in the "sapiential discipline" (*al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya*). The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 7 (Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 132, n. 20).[73]
11) V, 6, p. 241, 1 [II, p. 138, 85]: intellection, the subject of intellection and the object of intellection are one not in the human souls, but in something else, "as you will see in its place" (*ʿalā mā satalmaḥuhū fī mawḍiʿihī*). Avicenna means the Necessary Existent and refers to *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 6 (Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 138, n. 85).
12) V, 6, p. 247, 1 [II, p. 148, 38]: we will clarify in the "first wisdom" (*al-ḥikma al-ūlā*) that the intelligible form does not exist separate. The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 2 (Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 148, n. 38).
13) V, 6, p. 248, 8 [II, p. 150, 74]: the present topic is the future happiness of the human soul, "as we will discuss in its place" (*kamā natakallamu ʿalayhi fī bābihī*). The reference is to *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 7 (Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 150, n. 74).[74]

These references can be divided into three main classes. They regard either issues concerning both psychology and metaphysics (incidentally the former, properly the latter), like the doctrine of universals (nn. 7, 9, 12), the type of intellection proper of God, the celestial intelligences and the celestial souls (nn. 2, 5, 11), the true nature of mathematical entities (n. 3), and the ontological perfection of man (n. 6); or topics that are integral part of psychology and are dealt with in the *Nafs*, but receive their theoretical foundation in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, like revelations occurring in dreams (n. 4); or, finally, issues that pertain

[73] The passage p. 238, 5–7 [II, p. 132, 18–21], is translated as follows by Gutas [1988], p. 258: "The subject of the Destination of the soul ought not to be discussed in the context of Physics but only in the context of the philosophical discipline (*al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya*) where the things that are separable [from matter] are investigated".

[74] A further reference might occur in V, 7, p. 259, 10 [II, p. 169, 51–52], if we read "divine discipline" (*al-ṣināʿa al-ilāhiyya*) with MSS. AB and the Latin translation (*divina doctrina*) instead of *al-ṣināʿa al-āliyya* in the edition.

to psychology but are transferred by Avicenna in metaphysics, like the destiny of the human soul after death (nn. 8, 10, 13).

With regard to the third class of references, it is remarkable that contrarily to Aristotle (*De An.* A, 1, 403a27–28; *Metaph.* E, 1, 1026a5–6), Avicenna does not regard intellection as the non-physical area of psychology, probably because, according to him, intellection needs the abstraction of forms from sensible data—and therefore the connection of the soul with the body—in order to take place. The non-physical area of psychology, according to Avicenna, is rather the soul's after life, i.e the state of radical separation of the soul from the body. Gutas has properly called this area "metaphysics of the rational soul".[75]

3.3 *References to natural philosophy in metaphysics*

Avicenna refers back to what he has already established in natural philosophy not only in the passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt* already discussed in §3.1, but also elsewhere.[76] Remarkable are the references to *Nafs*, the only section of natural philosophy of the *Šifāʾ* whose title is mentioned in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[77]

To these quotations of the natural philosophy of the *Šifāʾ*, also the quotations of Aristotle's works on natural philosophy can be added, especially the *Physics*,[78] the *De Caelo*[79] and the *De Anima*.[80]

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[75] Gutas [1988], pp. 254–261.

[76] See Appendix B, II.2.2.2, II.3.2.2.

[77] See Appendix B, II.1.2.

[78] One of the explicit determinate quotations of Aristotle (see Chapter 8, §3.2, Outline 2 [1]) is a joint reference to *Phys.* Θ, 4, 254b17, and *De Caelo* B, 2, 285a29. The examples that Avicenna provides in VI, 4, p. 279, 1 [p. 320, 28–29] (the wax of a statue as an example of a type of matter), VI, 4, p. 279, 4 [p. 320, 32–33] (the wood of a bed as an example of a type of matter), and VI, 4, p. 279, 10 [pp. 320, 38–321, 40] (prime matter as an example of a type of matter) correspond to *Phys.* A, 7, 191a8–11. For the first example, see also *Phys.* B, 1, 193a12, and *Metaph.* Δ, 2, 1013a25; for the second example, see also *Phys.* B, 1, 193a11. The example in VI, 4, p. 279, 8–9 [p. 320, 36–27] (the semen of an animal as a type of matter) might be taken from *Physics* A, 7, 190b4–5; see also *Metaph.* H, 4, 1044a35. See also Chapter 6, §1.1, Text 2.

[79] The explicit determinate quotation of Aristotle in IX, 2, p. 392, 5 [p. 462, 45] (heaven is in motion due to a soul), refers to *De Caelo* B, 2, 285a29 (see previous footnote). Aristotle's definition of solid, reported by Avicenna in II, 2, p. 63, 11 [p. 72, 44], corresponds not only to *Metaph.* Δ, 6, 1016b26–28 (see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [3]), but also to *De Caelo* A, 1, 268a6–8.

[80] In VI, 4, p. 278, 15–16 [p. 320, 26–28], the tablet with regard to writing as

4 Metaphysics and mathematics

An allusion to the limited character of the mathematical (i.e. arithmetical) investigation of number occurs in *Madḫal*.[81] This point is developed in *Ḥisāb*, the section of the *Šifāʾ* dealing with arithmetic, where Avicenna states that the "verification" (*taḥqīq*) of number will be provided in the "highest science" (*al-ʿilm al-aʿlā*), namely in metaphysics.[82] In the *Ilāhiyyāt*, Avicenna resumes this idea; in the Prolegomena, for example, he maintains preliminarily what follows.

> Text 20: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3, p. 24, 8–9 [p. 27, 11–13]
> The investigation of number itself and of what inheres accidentally in number in so far as it [i.e number] does not depend from matter and is not based on it, belongs to the present science.

What Avicenna states about arithmetic in *Madḫal*, *Ḥisāb* and *Ilāhiyyāt*, can be taken as a sign of his view of the global foundation of mathematics performed by metaphysics. In fact, the discussion of discrete quantity (number) in III, 3 and III, 5, of continuous quantity (geometrical extension) in III, 4, and of qualities inherent in quantities (i.e. evenness, oddness, and the specific geometrical shapes) in III, 9, amounts to a proof of the subject-matters of arithmetic and geometry, and, by implication, of music and astronomy, which are subordinated to arithmetic and geometry.

In other respects, however, metaphysics itself depends on mathematics. This applies primarily to astronomy.

> Text 21: *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3, p. 19, 5–8 [p. 21, 82–88]
> As to mathematics, this is so because the ultimate goal of the present science—namely the knowledge of the Creator's government, the knowledge of the spiritual angels and their ranks, and the knowledge

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an example of matter comes from *De An.* Γ, 4, 429b30–430a2, where Aristotle uses this same image to describe the intellect with regard to the intelligibles. The pair *taṣawwur*/*taṣdīq* in I, 5, p. 29, 7–16 and elsewhere, might derive from *De An.* Γ, 6, where Aristotle distinguishes the intellection of the indivisible (essence) from the intellection of the divisible (cp. *Metaph.* Θ, 10); in the corresponding place of *Nafs* (V, 5, pp. 236, 3–238, 18 [I, pp. 128, 54–133, 38]), however, Avicenna focuses only on *taṣawwur*. IX, 7, p. 426, 9–10 [p. 511, 93–94]), where Avicenna contends that intellection, its subject and its object are identical in the human soul, might depend on *De An.* Γ, 4, 429b26–29, 430a2–9.

[81] *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 14, 8–9.

[82] *Ḥisāb* 1, p. 17, 12.

> of the order in the diposition of the heavenly spheres—cannot be attained except by means of astronomy, and astronomy cannot be attained except by means of arithmetic and geometry.

This text makes clear that the part of the *Ilāhiyyāt* dealing with the "goal" of metaphysics, i.e. OntologyC/Theology,[83] depends primarily, among the mathematical disciplines, on astronomy. Ptolemy's *Almagest* and Avicenna's *Hay'a* (i.e. the section of the *Šifā'* dealing with astronomy and being the reworking of the *Almagest*) are repeatedly quoted in IX, 2–3, with regard to the issue of determing the number of the heavenly spheres and the heavenly intellects.[84]

The quotations of Euclid's *Elements* and of the parts of the *Šifā'* dealing with arithmetic and geometry (*Ḥisāb, Handasa*) attest also the dependence of the *Ilāhiyyāt* on these disciplines.[85] The proof of the existence of the qualities of numbers in III, 9 is taken from arithmetic.[86]

5 The sources of Avicenna's conception of metaphysics as the founding science

5.1 *Aristotle*

In the *Posterior Analytics*, Aristotle envisages a subordination of different disciplines only in the cases of "pure" and "applied" sciences (like geometry with regard to optics, and arithmetic with regard to music), and rejects Plato's doctrine of a supreme science that demonstrates the principles of all the other disciplines.[87] On the other hand, references to a further investigation of the topics at stake occur, for

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[83] See Chapter 4, §1.3.

[84] See Appendix B, I.1, s.v. *Baṭlamiyūs*; II.1.1, s.v. *Al-Maǧisṭī*; II.2.2.3, s.v. *ṣinā'at al-Maǧisṭī, kalāmunā fī l-riyāḍiyyāt.*

[85] See Appendix B, II.2.1, s.v. *kitāb Ūqlīdis*; II.2.2.3, s.v. *ṣinā'at al-Ḥisāb*; II.3.2.3, s.v. *qad bayyannā, mawāḍi'*. On the importance of the *Elements* for Avicenna's conception of the method of metaphysics, see Chapter 6, §4.4. According to Wisnovsky [2002], p. 113, Avicenna's numerical discussion of perfection in IV, 3 is influenced by Euclid's *Elements* and Nicomachus of Gerasa's *Introduction to Arithmetic* (but see also the remarks in Chapter 8, §5.5, n. 52). On the influence of algebra on Avicenna's ontology (his doctrine of "thing" in particular), see R. Rashed [1984], pp. 34–35. See the quotation of the *Elements* in *Maqūlāt* II, 1, p. 61, 11–12.

[86] III, 9, p. 145, 8 [p. 163, 50]. The demonstration of the existence of the triangle (one of the qualities of continuous quantity according to Avicenna) is ascribed to Euclid's *Elements* in *Maqūlāt* II, 1, p. 61, 11–12.

[87] *An. Post.* A, 7; A, 9, 76a16–20.

example, in several passages of *Physics, De Caelo* and *De Anima*, where the *Metaphysics* is mentioned either explicitly ("first philosophy") or implicitly.[88] Conversely, in some passages of the *Metaphysics*, Aristotle points at the limits of the scientific investigation performed by the particular sciences.

Text 22: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* E, 1, 1025b7–18

[a] After having enclosed a certain being and a certain genus, each one of these [sciences] deals with that thing, without dealing with and searching universal being and [being] in so far as it is being.

[b] Nor do they investigate any of these [things] according to what they are, at all. Rather, some of them, with regard to this notion, establish it only by means of sensation,[89] some others on account of the evidence deriving from taking [it] for granted. In this way they demonstrate and clarify the things that belong essentially to the genus they encompass, either cogently or in an easier way. Therefore, from what follows this statement, it is clear that there is no demonstration of substance and of "what it is", but another indication [of it] in some way.

[c] Likewise, they do not state at all whether the genus with which they deal is or is not.

This is so, because it belongs to the same [type of] thinking to clarify what it is and whether it is.[90]

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[88] *Phys.* A, 2, 184b25–185a4: "Now to investigate whether what exists is one and motionless is not a contribution to the science of nature. For just as the geometer has nothing more to say to one who denies the principles of his science—this being a question for a different science or for one common to all— . . ."; B, 2, 194b14–15: "The mode of existence and essence of the separable it is the business of first philosophy to define"; *De Caelo* A, 8, 277b10; *De An.* A, 3, 407b12–13; Γ, 7, 431b17–19. Both in *De An.* A, 1, 403a27–28, and *Metaph.* E, 1, 1026a5–6, Aristotle points out that the physicist does not study the soul in its entirety, but only the parts of it that are connected with matter, i.e. with the body, thus implying that there is an area of psychology (i. e. the study of the immaterial part of the soul, in all likelihood the intellect) that does not belong to physics, but rather to metaphysics.

[89] The phrase *yuṯbitu innamā huwa bi-l-ḥissi*, is probably the corruption of a sentence originally containing the expression *mā huwa* ("what it is", τοῦ τί ἐστιν).

[90] *Tafsīr*, pp. 697, 9–698, 8. "But all these sciences mark off some particular being—some genus—and inquire into this, but not into being simply nor *qua* being, nor do they offer any discussion of the essence of the things of which they treat; but starting from the essence—some making it plain to the senses, others assuming it as a hypothesis—they then demonstrate, more or less cogently, the essential attributes of the genus with which they deal. It is obvious, therefore, from such a review of the sciences, that there is no demonstration of substance or of the essence, but some other way of revaling it. And similarly the sciences omit the question whether the genus with which they deal exists or does not exist, because it belongs to the same line of thought to show what it is and that it is".

According to Text 22, the particular sciences have three limitations: they do not take into account "being *qua* being", but a particular genus of being ([a]); they do not investigate the essence, i.e. the substance and the "what it is" , of the genus that they take into account, but only the properties of this latter: they either make the essence clear by perception, or assume it as an hypothesis ([b]); they do not establish the existence of the genus that they take into account ([c]).[91]

Whereas Text 22 indicates that the particular sciences investigate their "subject-matters" (in Avicennian terms) with precise restrictions, the following text implies that these sciences do not investigate at all the notions corresponding to Avicenna's "things that are common to the sciences".

> Text 23: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1005a11–13
>
> For this reason, it does not belong to the geometer to inquire what is the contrary, what is the one, what is the perfect, what is the thing in itself, what is the other, except by way of *ufūsānīs*.[92]

In one case, with regard to the axioms, Aristotle not only underscores the particular sciences' inadequacy to conduct a proper investigation, but states also that metaphysics is the discipline deputed to fill this theoretical gap.

> Text 24: Arabic translation of *Metaph.* Γ, 3, 1005a29–b2
>
> For this reason, none of those who investigate the particular things want to say anything about them [i.e. about the axioms], whether they are true or not: neither the experts of mensuration, nor the experts of number. Some naturalists, on the contrary, said something in this regard, since they believed to be the only ones who examined the universal knowledge of nature and of being. However, since there is a science that is superior to the science of the naturalists (for nature is [only] one among the genera of being), the investigation of these things must (*yanbaġī*) belong to the person who examines the knowledge of the universe (or: of all, *al-kull*) and the first substance. For natural science is one among the types of sciences, but is not the first and prior science.[93]

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[91] The distinction between [b] and [c] in this text is possibly one of the sources of Avicenna's essence-existence distinction.

[92] *Tafsīr*, p. 331, 9–10. "[J]ust for this reason it does not belong to the geometer to inquire what is contrariety or completeness or being or unity or the same or the other, but only to presuppose these concepts".

[93] *Tafsīr*, p. 336, 10–18. "And for this reason no one who is conducting a special inquiry tries to say anything about their truth or falsehood,—neither the geometer nor the arithmetician. Some natural philosophers indeed have done so, and their

According to Text 24, geometry and arithmetic do not discuss the axioms, whereas natural philosophy says something about them, but on the basis of the false assumptions that nature is the only type of being, and natural sciences, consequently, the only science of being. Due to its universality (it deals with everything) and primacy (it deals with first substance), it is rather metaphysics the discipline that "must" take the axioms into account.[94]

Thus, Avicenna's conception of the relationship between metaphysics and the particular sciences is prefigured by these scattered remarks by Aristotle: Aristotle's Text 22–23 clearly correspond to Avicenna's Texts 2–3, whereas Text 24 represents a specific instance of what Avicenna states, in more general terms, in Text 1. But the interconnections that Aristotle establishes between metaphysics and the other disciplines are not joined, in the Aristotelian *corpus*, with a full-fledged theory of the dependence of the latter upon the former. The reason is, in all likelihood, the explicit veto on the possibility of a supreme science governing the entire system of knowledge, expressed in the *Posterior Analytics*. The historical route connecting Aristotle with Avicenna passes through a profound revision of the *Posterior Analytics*' dictate in this regard.

5.2 *Post-Aristotelian philosophy*

The highly hierarchical system of sciences envisaged by Plato in the *Republic* permeates the Neoplatonic tradition. It is mirrored in the *curriculum* of philosophical studies, starting with logic, passing through natural philosophy and culminating in metaphysics and theology, that is adopted by the Neoplatonic schools of Late Antiquity and transmitted to Arabic philosophy.[95] This tradition has certainly

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procedure was intelligible enough; for they thought that they alone were inquiring about the whole of nature and being. But since there is one kind of thinker who is even above the natural philosopher (for nature is only one particular genus of being), the discussion of these truths also will belong to him whose inquiry is universal and deals with primary substance. Natural science also is a kind of wisdom, but it is not the first kind".

[94] The point made in Text 24 is prefigured in Γ, 2, 1004a2–9, and repeated in E, 1, 1026a10–23, where Aristotle portrays metaphysics as prior to natural philosophy and mathematics by being the first type of theoretical philosophy, adding that it is the most honorable and preferable of all sciences.

[95] See D'Ancona [2005b]. See also the subordination of natural philosophy with regard to metaphysics envisaged by Alexander of Aphrodisias in his commentary on *Metaph.* Λ *apud* Averroes (*Tafsīr*, pp. 1420, 8–13; 1429, 5).

influenced Avicenna's view of the relationship between metaphysics and the other sciences. It also lies in the background of Avicenna's major source on this topic, namely al-Fārābī.

5.3 *Al-Fārābī*

In al-Fārābī's main work on the classification of the sciences, the *Iḥṣā'*, the second part of metaphysics is portrayed as dealing with the "certification" (*taṣḥīḥ*) and "determination of properties" (*taʿrīf al-ḫawāṣṣ*) of the "principles" (*mabādi'*) of the particular sciences.[96] This idea is developed in the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, with explicit reference not only to the principles, but also to the subject-matters of the particular sciences.

> Text 25: Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 36, 17–19 (= Chapter 3, §1, [2.6e])
> [Each one of "existent", "one", non-existence and multiplicity] is further ramified and divided, until the subject-matters of the particular sciences are reached, and [consequently] the present sciences ends. In it [i.e. in the present science], the principles (*mabādi'*) of all the particular sciences and the definitions (*ḥudūd*) of their subject-matters are clarified.

It is not clear whether in this text—that, as we have seen, is the source of Avicenna's Text 2[97]—al-Fārābī takes the principles of the particular sciences and the definitions of their subject-matters as the same group of things (as Avicenna does in Text 2), or as two distinct items. Regardless of this point, the main doctrine is the same in both authors: metaphysics is the universal discipline founding all the other, particular, sciences.[98]

Al-Fārābī joins this fundamentally "Aristotelian" view of metaphysics (see above, §5.1) with a conception of the relationship among the sciences that is markedly different from Aristotle's. He tries, however, to "impose" *a posteriori* this non-Aristotelian conception to Aristotle himself, by introducing it in his account of the *Posterior Analytics*. In the *Falsafat Arisṭūṭālīs*,[99] while describing the *Posterior Analytics* (as the other parts of the Aristotelian *corpus*), he significantly modifies Aristotle's

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[96] Al-Fārābī [1949], pp. 120, 10–121, 1; cp. Al-Fārābī [1953], p. 88, 7. See Chapter 3, §5, [ii].

[97] See Chapter 3, §4, Table 2.

[98] For the metaphysical foundation of mathematics, according to al-Fārābī's *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf*, and the corresponding foundation of politics, according to his *Taḥṣīl al-Saʿāda*, see Zghal [1998], p. 193; M. Rashed [2000], p. 239.

[99] On this work, see Chapter 3, §5, [i].

doctrine of the subalternation of the sciences, portraying metaphysics as the highest theoretical discipline:

> Text 26: Al-Fārābī, *Falsafat Aristūṭālīs*, Al-Fārābī [1961], pp. 76, 19–77, 4
>
> [a] Then he [i.e. Aristotle] made known the relative ranks of the species of the theoretical arts, what is common to them and what differentiates them, which of them is anterior and which of them posterior, and which of them is subordinate to which.
>
> [b] He investigated whether there is among them an art that precedes all the rest, so that there will be no species [of theoretical arts] anterior to it, and so that the rest will be subordinated to that one.
>
> [c] He explained in how many respects an art can be subordinated to another.
>
> [d] And he explained that the one that was shown to be anterior to the rest ought to deserve most the name of "wisdom" and to deserve most the name of "science". Consequently, it is called "true wisdom", "true science", "the wisdom of wisdoms", "the science of science", and similar names.[100]

Whereas sections [a] and [c] roughly correspond to *An. Post.* A, 7–9,[101] sections [b] and [d] are added by al-Fārābī.[102] Remarkably, however, there is no break of continuity in the text: the pronoun "he" refers to Aristotle in the latter two sections as it does in the former. In this way al-Fārābī ascribes to Aristotle a non-Aristotelian view of the subordination of all the sciences to metaphysics, thus reconciling Aristotle's original position with the subsequent developments that took place in the Greek Neoplatonic tradition and continued in Arabic philosophy. His attempt to "Aristotelianize" the Neoplatonic view of the system of sciences is a sign of the unitarian approach to Greek philosophy that, starting with Porphyry, characterizes later Greek and early Arabic philosophy.

Avicenna adopts al-Fārābī's enlarged and revised reading of the *Posterior Analytics*: in the *Burhān*, he makes a similar, even more extensive, addition to his reworking of *An. Post.* A, 7. Between the paraphrase of the beginning of chapter A, 7 (75a39–75b2) in *Burhān* II,

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[100] Engl. transl. in Mahdi [2001], p. 86 (slightly modified).

[101] The passage of *Falsafat Aristūṭālīs* immediately preceding Text 26 (Al-Fārābī [1961], p. 76, 16–18) corresponds to *An. Post.* A, 7, 75a39–b2 (the very beginning of chapter A, 7). The one immediately following (p. 77, 5–6) to *An. Post.* A, 10–11. The doctrine of *An. Post.* A, 7–9 is resumed also in A, 27.

[102] Additions by al-Fārābī to the account of the *Posterior Analytics* occur also elsewhere (see Al-Fārābī [1961], pp. 75, 22–76, 10).

6, and the paraphrase of the rest of this chapter and of the following one (A, 8) in *Burhān* II, 8, he introduces an entire chapter (II, 7), with no correspondence in Aristotle's work, dealing with the classification of the sciences: in this chapter, he states explicitly that metaphysics ("first philosophy") verifies the principles of the other sciences because it is the most universal science.[103] That this chapter is alien to the *Posterior Analytics* and interrupts the continuity of the *Burhān* was noticed by Dominicus Gundissalinus, who incorporated its Latin translation in his *De Divisione philosophiae*.[104]

6 Categories, universals and metaphysics before Avicenna

Avicenna's doctrine of the metaphysical foundation of logic can be regarded as his attempt to explain two problematic features of the Aristotelian *corpus*. First, the occurrence of the doctrine of the categories both in Aristotle's *Categories* and in various places of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (for example, in the aporias 2–4 and 11–12 of B; Δ, 8; Z; Λ, 1–5). Second, the presence within the treatment of substance in *Metaphysics* Z, by Aristotle's own admission, of a "logical" type of investigation (λογικῶς, Z, 4, 1029b13), dealing with essence (Z, 4–6), definition (Z, 10–12), universality and particularity (Z, 14–15).

This problem was debated in Neoplatonic philosophy: its insurgence is witnessed by what we can call—according to the traditional scholarly view—Plotinus' "criticism" of Aristotle's treatment of the categories in a metaphysical context, and its subsequent "defense" by Porphyry.[105] The first traces of the solution that Avicenna actually provides—i.e. the idea that considerations regarding the ontology of categories and universals pertain to metaphysics rather than logic—can be found in the commentaries on Aristotle by Neoplatonic authors: the starting-point of this current can be traced to Porphyry, who, in his introduction to the *Isagoge*, posits a firm distinction between logical investigation and ontological questions. Likewise, Simplicius' commentary on the *Categories*—known in Arabic philosophy[106]—keeps

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[103] See above, §1 and n. 4.
[104] Gundissalinus [1903], pp. 124–133.
[105] See Hadot [1990]; Chiaradonna [2002]. The "romantic picture of Porphyry saving the *Categories* from Plotinus' devastating criticism" is questioned by De Haas [2004].
[106] See Chapter 11, §1.3.

the logical treatment of the categories distinct from the metaphysical one.[107] In al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* the categories, as species of "existent", are among the topics dealt with by metaphysics.[108]

Conclusion

By having "existent *qua* existent" as its subject-matter, metaphysics in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* is the discipline that ascertains the principles of the other sciences. This foundational role performed by metaphysics regards not only the logical principles common to all the sciences (the axioms), taken into account in I, 8, and the concepts that all the sciences use without discussing them (anteriority, posteriority, perfection, imperfection etc.), analyzed in treatises IV–VI, but also the principles, proper to each one of the sciences, that determine their specific subject-matters, i.e. their hypotheses: the metaphysical discussion of these principles occurs mainly, but not exclusively, in treatises II–III.

No science, metaphysics included, can assess the existence and clarify the essence of its own subject-matter: it takes both for granted, and investigates only its properties. This epistemological rule applies equally to metaphysics and to the particular sciences: but whereas the fundamental assumptions of metaphysics (the existence and essence of "existent") do not need, and cannot, be ascertained, those of all the other sciences must. In so far as it is the science of "existent *qua* existent" and provides a sort of epistemological "self-certification" in the Introduction (I, 5–8), metaphysics is entitled to clarify the other sciences' fundamental hypotheses or "principles", i.e. to prove the existence and to elucidate the essence of their subject-matters. This applies primarily to logic and the other two branches of theoretical philosophy, namely natural philosophy and mathematics.

With regard to logic, metaphysics elucidates the existence of the universals (its subject-matter) and of the categories (the first intelligible

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[107] See Hoffman [2000].

[108] Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 39, 11–13 (= Chapter 3, §1, [2.6b]): "Then, after these subject-matters and their verification, it investigates the things which are like species to them, like the ten categories of the existent (*ka-l-maqūlāt al-aš'ar li-l-mawǧūd*) . . .". Druart [2005], p. 338: "Avicenna integrates into the *Metaphysics* of the *Šifā'* al-Fārābī's point about the different approach to the categories in logic and metaphysics".

notions upon which secondary intelligible notions like "universal" depend): this discipline discusses either the "place" of their existence (in the mind, rather than in external reality, in the case of universals; in the external reality, rather than in the mind, in the case of the category of relation), or the mode of their existence (accidental existence, rather than substantial existence, in the case of the nine categories of accidents, especially quantity and quality), or their existence *tout court* (as in the case of immaterial substance, and the two constituents of material substance, i.e matter and form). With regard to natural philosophy, it ascertains the mode of existence of the two parts of its subject-matter, i.e. of physical substance (form is the intermediate cause of the existence of matter; matter cannot exist independently from form), and the mode of existence of the main "common" notions employed by natural philosophy, namely "cause" and "effect" (how the cause's existence relates to the effect's existence; the final cause does actually exist). With regard to mathematics, finally, metaphysics determines the quiddity and accidentality of discrete quantity, namely number (the subject-matter of arithmetic), and the accidental nature of both continuous quantity (geometrical extension) and the qualities inhering in it (the geometrical shapes). In the logical, physical and mathematical parts of the *Šifā'*, the metaphysical foundation of these disciplines is announced by several references to the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

By developing certain clues already present in Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, and revising the non-hierarchical view of the relationship among the different sciences offered by the *Posterior Analytics*, Avicenna (who puts in practice in both respects al-Fārābī's indications) provides in the *Ilāhiyyāt* a very comprehensive, articulated and coherent account of metaphysics as *regina scientiarum*.

PART THREE

THE CONTENT OF THE *METAPHYSICS* ACCORDING TO AVICENNA

INTRODUCTION

The range of sources of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is extremely wide. They include, of course, the *Metaphysics*, but are not restricted to it. Avicenna's statement in the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*: "There is nothing of account to be found in the books of the ancients which we did not include in this book of ours",[1] fits the *Ilāhiyyāt* particularly well. Schematically, five main sources of the *Ilāhiyyāt* can be singled out.

First, in the Prologue to the *Šifāʾ* Avicenna maintains that the *Ilāhiyyāt* contains "the science related to [Aristotle's] *Metaphysics*".[2] Even though the *Metaphysics* is occasionally quoted elsewhere in the *Šifāʾ*, and even though the *Metaphysics* is not the only Aristotelian work quoted in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, this latter is the section of the *Šifāʾ* where quotations of the *Metaphysics* are most frequent and extensive. Avicenna's quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are first-hand, in the sense that he has direct access to the text of this work and refers to it without intermediaries. He uses different Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*, and quotes this work in more than one way, i.e. either nominally, or in an explicit, but not totally open, way, or implicitly. The prime source of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is, therefore, the *Metaphysics* itself.

Second, still in the Prologue Avicenna states that the *Šifāʾ* is "*more* accommodating to [my] colleagues [in philosophy] among the Peripatetics" than his *Al-Ḥikma al-mašriqiyya* (*Eastern Philosophy*).[3] He thus makes clear, first, that the Peripatetic affiliation is—in different degrees—a common feature of both these works, and, second, that this feature is particularly salient in the *Šifāʾ*. With regard to the *Ilāhiyyāt* this implies that, besides the *Metaphysics* itself, Avicenna takes into account also the subsequent reception of this work, both in Greek and in Arabic. In fact, the *Ilāhiyyāt* depends not only on the *Metaphysics*, but also on the Greek commentaries on this work translated into Arabic (Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius on book Λ), other metaphysical works by these same commentators (Alexander

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[1] *Madḫal* I, 1, pp. 9, 17–10, 1; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 51.

[2] *Al-ʿilm al-mansūb ilā mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa* (p. 11, 11; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1998], p. 54, modified).

[3] *wa-ašaddu maʿa l-šurakāʾi mina l-maššāʾīna musāʿadatan* (p. 10, 14, Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 52, modified).

of Aphrodisias' treatise *Fī Mabādi'al-kull, On the Principles of the Universe*), and the writings of the Arab interpreters of the *Metaphysics* anterior to Avicenna (especially al-Kindī and al-Fārābī).

Third, Aristotle's *corpus* of metaphysical writings, as Avicenna knew it, was not restricted to the *Metaphysics*. It encompassed also other works, such as the so-called *Theologia Aristotelis* and the *Liber de causis*, that we know now to be pseudo-epigraphical, but that Avicenna regarded as Aristotelian. Also these works—especially the *Theologia Aristotelis*, upon which Avicenna commented in the *Kītāb al-Inṣāf* (*Book of the Fair Judgement*)—are among the sources of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

Avicenna's own previous metaphysical writings are a fourth source of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, in two different respects. First of all, Avicenna's habit of reproducing parts of his earlier works in later ones—of quoting himself, so-to-say—regards also the *Ilāhiyyāt*: in this latter, for example, long sections of the *Kītāb al-Mabda' wa-l-maʿād* (*Book of the Provenance and Destination*) are copied almost *verbatim*. Furthermore, doctrines occurring both in the *Mabda'* and in other Avicennian works antedating the *Ilāhiyyāt* undergo in this latter a process of refinement and revision: thus, the original formulations of these doctrines can be regarded as the source of their later versions in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. In short: the continuity, on the one hand, and the evolution, on the other, of Avicenna's thought—the study of which is a relatively new trend in Avicennian scholarship—make his own previous metaphysical output another source of the *Ilāhiyyāt* to be taken into account.

Finally, Avicenna's philosophy in general, and his metaphysics in particular, have religious connotations. This aspect of his thought has been poignantly expressed by saying that he conceives philosophy as "a religion for intellectuals",[4] and that in his metaphysics "he reconciles reason and faith".[5] Avicenna's attempt at harmonizing, as much as possible, rational investigation and Islamic beliefs surfaces with particular evidence in the *Ilāhiyyāt*—the part of the *Šifā'* deputed to deal, among other things, with God, His nature and His actions. The impact of Islamic religion and theology on the *Ilāhiyyāt* was already noticed by Averroes,[6] and is reflected in the choice of topics and in the language of this work.

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[4] Endress [1991], p. 240; Endress [1997b], p. 3. See also Endress [1990]; Endress [1990b].

[5] Endress [1991b], p. 169.

[6] Averroes, *Tafsīr*, p. 313.

The five aforementioned sources are reflected in the authors and works quoted explicitly in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see Appendix B). These are, in chronological order: (i) the pre-Socratic philosophers, Socrates and Plato (through Aristotle's *Metaphysics*); (ii) Aristotle's *Metaphysics*; (iii) Aristotle's *Prior Analytics* and *Nicomachean Ethics*; (iv) Euclid (the *Elements of Geometry*) and Ptolemy (the *Almagest*); (v) Alexander of Aphrodisias (the *Fī Mabādi'al-kull*) and Themistius; (vi) the *Qur'ān*, the Prophet Muḥammad, and some caliphs (vii) Avicenna's *Kītāb al-Birr wa-l-iṯm* (*Book on Piety and Sin*) and his reworkings of Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics* and *De Anima* in the *Šifā'*. Quotations (i) and (ii) clearly show the centrality of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* within the *Ilāhiyyāt*, both in itself and as a source of information on previous Greek philosophers. Quotations (iii) indicate that the Aristotelian sources of the *Ilāhiyyāt* are not limited to the *Metaphysics*, but include other writings of the Aristotelian *corpus*, such as *Prior Analytics* and *Nicomachean Ethics*. If works of logic and practical philosophy are referred to by Avicenna, it is reasonable to assume that he pays attention also to writings of metaphysics like the *Theologia Aristotelis*, that, although not belonging to the Aristotelian *corpus*, are nonetheless parts of the philosophical curriculum. Quotations (iv) and (v) regard writings of the later Greek tradition that Avicenna uses to complement the doctrine of the *Metaphysics*. Among them, quotations (v) make clear Avicenna's Peripatetic affiliation, since they concern two of the most famous Aristotelian commentators (Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius). The religious/theological background of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is evident in quotations (vi). This is confirmed by some of the quotations (vii), in so far as Avicenna's *Book on Piety and Sin* is a rational interpretation of certain aspects of Islamic religion. Quotations (vii) represent also a case of self-reference, in so far as the work quoted is by Avicenna himself.

Recent scholarship on Avicenna has cumulatively shown that the aforementioned five sources coexist and interact in the most important (and most extensively studied) doctrines of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Let us take as an example what can be regarded as the key-doctrine of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, namely Avicenna's famous distinction between essence and existence. The background of this doctrine has been located by different scholars in, first, Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (the Aristotelian idea of the universality of essence *vs.* the individuality of existence);[7] second, the Peripatetic tradition, both Greek (the Stoic doctrine,

[7] Booth [1983]; Burrell [1986].

reported by Alexander of Aphrodisias, of a concept more universal than, and therefore distinct from, "being", namely "thing") and Arabic (al-Fārābī's discussion of the differences between "existent" and "thing");[8] third, the Arab Neoplatonic tradition (the idea of a simple "being" as distinct from all its attributes, also the essential ones, circulating in the Arabic Plotinus, the *Liber de Causis* and al-Kindī);[9] fourth, Avicenna's previous metaphysical writings (whose version of the essence-existence distinction is congruent, but also significantly at variance, with that in the *Ilāhiyyāt*);[10] fifth, Islamic theology (the contrasting views on the relationship between "thing" and "existent" held by the two main schools of *kalām*, i.e. the Ashʿarites and the Muʿtazilites).[11]

Part III of the present work deals *ex professo* with the first and main source of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, namely Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. A comprenhensive account of the reception of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* will be provided in Chapter 8. Chapters 9 and 10 will focus more in detail on Avicenna's quotations of two of the fourteen books of the *Metaphysics*, i.e. Γ and Β. These two books are particularly apt to show Avicenna's conception of metaphysics as a science (Γ), and his view of the role of dialectic within this discipline (Β). The remaining sources of the *Ilāhiyyāt* are the object of Chapter 11.

Preliminarily, however, as a necessary *proviso*, it is important to stress that the *Ilāhiyyāt* is not the bare sum and result of its sources. In the Prologue to the *Šifāʾ* Avicenna underscores, together with his debt towards the predecessors, also his personal contribution to the various disciplines he deals with (with the exception perhaps of mathematics).[12] In other words: the dependence upon previous authors and works, and the continuity with his earlier speculation, does not prevent Avicenna from being original.[13]

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[8] Wisnovsky [2002], pp. 153–154; pp. 150–153.

[9] Adamson [2002], pp. 310–312.

[10] Wisnovsky [2002], pp. 158–160.

[11] Marmura [1984b]; Jolivet [1984]; Marmura [1991–2]; Wisnovsky [2002], pp. 145–160.

[12] "To this I added some of the things which I perceived through my own reflection and whose validity I determined through my own theoretical analysis, especially in the science of nature (*ʿilm al-ṭabīʿa*) and [the science] of what comes after nature (*mā baʿdahā*)—and even in logic, if you will" (*Madḫal* I, 1, p. 10, 2–5; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 51, modified).

[13] "The conceptual building blocks, so to speak, of this system [i.e. of Avicenna's metaphysics] are largely Aristotelian and Neoplatonic . . . however . . . the chosmic vision it portrays has a character all its own" (Marmura [2005], p. xxii).

CHAPTER EIGHT

THE QUOTATIONS OF THE *METAPHYSICS* IN THE *ILĀHIYYĀT*

The content of Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* is related to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in three different ways. Some places of the *Ilāhiyyāt* depend directly on the *Metaphysics*, according to one or more of its Arabic translations. Other passages of this work are also dependent on the *Metaphysics*, but indirectly, i.e. by means of a work that represents Avicenna's direct source in this regard and is influenced, in its turn, by the *Metaphysics*. A third group of *loci*, finally, is almost completely unrelated to the *Metaphysics* (regardless whether Avicenna is totally original or uses some other source). Scholarly research has focused mainly on the third category of places, as the numerous studies on the "original" doctrines by Avicenna, like the distinction between essence and existence and the proof of God's existence, witness.[1] The other two categories, with particular regard to the first, are the object of the present chapter.

Even though the *Metaphysics* is occasionally quoted in other sections of the *Šifā'*,[2] the *Ilāhiyyāt* is the section of this work in which quotations of the *Metaphysics* are most frequent and extensive. The present chapter is devoted to identify the Arabic versions of the *Metaphysics* employed by Avicenna (§1), to classify his different ways of quoting this work (§2), and to collect and elucidate each of them: explicit determinate quotations (§3), explicit indeterminate quotations (§4), and implicit quotations (§5). Conclusively, all the quotations of the *Metaphysics* will be summarized in a comprehensive table and Avicenna's strategy in recasting the content of this work will be discussed (§6).

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[1] Avicenna's distinction of essence and existence, however, might be inspired by *loci* of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* like Text 22 in Chapter 7.

[2] See the quotation of α, 1, 993b7–11 in *Nafs* V, 5, pp. 237, 16–238, 3 [II, pp. 131, 7–132, 16], or the quotation of Γ, 2, 1004b17–26, in *Burhān* II, 7, pp. 165, 17–166, 15. A further passage of *Nafs* V, 5 (p. 238, 9–12 [II, pp. 132, 24–133, 28]) might be regarded as Avicenna's interpretation of α, 1, 993b7–8 in particular.

1 The Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* used by Avicenna

Avicenna's quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* reflect four (at least) Arabic translations of Aristotle's work, among the ones mentioned in Chapter 1: the two main versions (by Usṭāṯ and Isḥāq); an Arabic translation of *Metaphysics* A more faithful to the Greek original than the only extant one; an Arabic version of *Metaphysics* N that might be the only attested translation of this book (by Naẓīf).

1.1 *Usṭāṯ's translation*

The *Ilāhiyyāt* attests in many ways to Avicenna's familiarity with Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics*. The clearest indication in this regard is the terminology that Avicenna occasionally adopts in ontological discussions in this work. In some places of the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna paraphrases certain passages of *Metaphysics* B and Γ using the term *huwiyya* ("being") as a synonym of the more usual *mawqūd* ("existent").[3] Now, *huwiyya* is a peculiarity of Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics* in general, and of the passages of B and Γ that Avicenna is quoting in particular, as a rendering of the Greek term for "being" (ὄν).[4] Striking similarities with Usṭāṯ's translation surface also in Avicenna's quotations of *Metaphysics* Θ (see below, §5.9). Furthermore, Usṭāṯ's translation of books Δ and Z of the *Metaphysics* is quoted *verbatim* by Avicenna in other works of his:[5] we can surmise that this same translation is used by Avicenna also in his quotations of *Metaphysics* Δ and Z in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The same argument can be applied also to book Λ: the reliance on Usṭāṯ's translation of Avicenna's *Šarḥ Lām* has been recently pointed out.[6] In sum: Avicenna's wide recourse to

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[3] VI, 4, 281, 2 [p. 322, 81]; VII, 1, p. 303, 5–6 [p. 349, 8–9]. See Chapter 10, §2.2, Table 2.2 [2]; Chapter 9, §3.5, Table 5 [1].

[4] See Bertolacci [2003].

[5] Y. Michot has detected in Avicenna's *Letter to Abū Sa'd* four literal quotations of the *Metaphysics* according to Usṭāṯ's translation: p. 45, 12–14 (corresponding to Δ, 26, 1023b32–34), p. 46, 3–9 (corresponding to Δ, 5, 1015b36–1016 a 1; 1016 a 1–4), p. 47, 8–12 (corresponding to Z, 11, 1037a22–24), p. 49, 1–5 (corresponding to Z, 10, 1035b6–8; Z, 10, 1035b10).

[6] See Janssens [2003]. According to Morewedge [1973], p. 76, Usṭāṯ's translation of a passage of Λ, 7 is quoted in the metaphysical section of Avicenna's *Dānešnāme* II, 38.

Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics*—documented in the case of books B, Γ and Θ, and presumable in the case of books Δ, Z and Λ—indicates that Usṭāṯ's translation is the Arabic version of the *Metaphysics* most extensively used by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

This does not imply, however, that Avicenna relied only on Usṭāṯ's translation in his reworking of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Some remarkable differences between Avicenna's quotations of the *Metaphysics* and Usṭāṯ's version of this work surface occasionally in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Avicenna's paraphrases of some passages of *Metaphysics* B,[7] Γ[8] and Δ, for example, are more similar to Aristotle's original text than Usṭāṯ's translation is, as Table 1 shows.

Table 1

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (VI, 5, p. 298, 19–20) We say that *these four causes* (*hāḏihi l-ʿilal al-arbaʿa*), even though they are believed not to gather[9] in many things existing in the sciences, . . .	(B, 2, 996a21–22) Further, there are many things to which not *all* [*the principles*] (πᾶσαι) pertain.	(p. 183, 10–11) It is known that *many principles* (*kaṯīr min al-awāʾil*) do not belong to many beings.
[2] (VI, 5, p. 299, 2–3) . . . for this reason someone *belittled these things* (*istaḫaffa bihā*) . . .	(B, 2, 996a32–33) And so for this reason some of the Sophists, e.g. Aristippus, *ridiculed mathematics* (προεπηλάκιζεν αὐτάς) . . .	(p. 184, 6–7) For this reason some of the Sophists *rejected this cause* (*yarfiḍūna hāḏihi l-ʿilla*), as Arisṭīfūs did.
[3] (VI, 5, p. 300, 7) *Were these* [i.e. the investigations of the four causes] *independent sciences* (*wa-law kānat hāḏihi ʿulūman mufradatan*), . . .	(B, 2, 996b1–3) But *if there are several sciences of the causes* (εἴ γε πλείους ἐπιστῆμαι τῶν αἰτίων εἰσὶ), and a different science for each different principle, . . .	(p. 184, 9–10) *It is known that the sciences of the causes are many* (*fa-maʿlūmun anna ʿulūma l-ʿilali kaṯīratun*) and each primary cause has the principle of a different science.
[4] (I, 2, p. 16, 17–18) for *the dialectical discussion* (*al-kalām al-ǧadalī*) provides opinion, not certainty . . .	(Γ, 2, 1004b25–26) *Dialectic* (διαλεκτικὴ) is merely critical (πειραστικὴ) where philosophy claims to know;	(p. 325, 13–14) For *the science of logic* (*ʿilm al-manṭiq*) knows what the philosopher knows.

[7] See Chapter 10, §2.3, Tables 3.1 and 3.2.
[8] See Chapter 9, §3.2, Table 2.
[9] Reading *lā taǧtamiʿu* instead of *taǧtamiʿu* (see Appendix A).

Table 1 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[5] (III, 10, p. 152, 12–14) To [the relative having different terms] belong: . . . the one [whose difference] is not ascertained in any way, *like the exceeding and the deficient* (*miṯla l-zā'id wa-l-nāqiṣ*) . . .	(Δ, 15, 1021a3–4) *the relation of that which exceeds to that which is exceeded* is numerically quite indefinite.	(p. 609, 8–9) *As to the superior with regard to what it is superior to* (*ammā l-aʿlā ilā llaḏī yaʿlūhū*), it, in a universal way, is not definite according to number.

Table 1 shows that Avicenna, in the cases at stake, did not rely on Usṭāṯ's translation, but on another version of the *Metaphysics*. The alternative Arabic version of the *Metaphysics* that Avicenna employs in the cases reported in Table 1 is very probably Isḥāq Ibn Ḥunayn's translation.

1.2 *Isḥāq Ibn Ḥunayn's translation*

Table 1 entails not only that the translation on which Avicenna relied was more faithful to the original than Usṭāṯ, but also that this further translation was wide enough to encompass books Β, Γ and Δ. Since, as we have seen in Chapter 1, Isḥāq's translation was, besides Usṭāṯ's, the only Arabic version of the *Metaphysics* to include these books, the translation in question is, in all likelihood, the one by Isḥāq. Avicenna's use of Isḥāq's translation is in accordance with the rendering of the Greek ὄν as *mawǧūd* in this latter.[10]

Even though the comparison between Avicenna's quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* and the fragments of what appears to be Isḥāq's version of books Γ, Θ, Ι and Λ in the *Tafsīr* does not allow to conclude that Avicenna's relied on Isḥāq's translation,[11] positive

[10] See, for example, *Tafsīr*, 13, 4 (α, 1, 993b28); p. 467, 9 (Γ, 8, 1012b28); see also the Arabic translation of Theophrastus' *Metaphysics*, ascribed to Isḥāq in MS Tehrān, Malik 5925, Theophrastus [1985], p. 196, 11 (corresponding to p. 8b19 of the Greek text).

[11] In his commentary on *Metaphysics* Γ, Θ, Ι and Λ, Averroes reports fragments of a second translation, which might be Isḥāq's (see Chapter 1, §2, nn. 34, 42). The fragments reported by Averroes as second translation of book Γ, however, do not regard the passages of the *Metaphysics* that Avicenna quotes in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Averroes' fragments regard chapters 6–8 of Γ, whereas Avicenna paraphrases only

evidence on Avicenna's use of this translation can be gained from his quotations of book α in VIII, 1–3.

Table 2

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–328, 4	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* α, 2, 994a11–16	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Isḥāq's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 327, 12) Then we say that, if we suppose a caused [thing], and we suppose that it has a cause, and that its cause has a cause,	(994a11–12) For in the case of an intermediate, which has a last term and a prior term outside it,	(p. 18, 1, bottom of page) For in the things that are middle and have a first and a last,	(p. 18, 11–12) For [in] the intermediate things (*al-ašyā' al-mutawassiṭa*)—namely the things in which there is something anterior and something posterior—
[2] (p. 327, 12–13) it is not possible that every cause has a cause *ad infinitum*.			
[3] (p. 327, 13–14) For, if the caused [thing] and its cause, and the cause of its cause are considered together, one in relation with the other,			
[4] (p. 327, 14) the cause of the	(994a12–14) the prior must be the	(pp. 18, 2–19, 1) necessarily the first	(p. 18, 12–13), the anterior must

chapters 1–5). As to book Θ, in three cases Averroes' fragments and Avicenna's quotations overlap: but in two of these three circumstances it is difficult to assess whether Avicenna's text is closer to these fragments or to the main translation (Usṭāṯ) used by Averroes (*Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 2, p. 184, 16 [p. 212, 42–43]; *Metaph.* Θ, 8, 1050a9; *Tafsīr*, main translation, p. 1186, 7, second translation, p. 1188, 9–10; *Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 2, p. 184, 4–5 [p. 211, 26–27]; *Metaph.* Θ, 8, 1050b4–6; *Tafsīr*, main translation, pp. 1195, 16–1196, 1, second translation, p. 1198, 6–7); in the third circumstance, Avicenna's text appears to be closer to the main translation (*Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 2, p. 183, 12–14 [p. 211, 12–16]; *Metaph.* Θ, 8, 1050b6–8; *Tafsīr*, main translation, p. 1196, 1–3, second translation, p. 1198, 9–11). Avicenna quotes some of the passages of book I of which Averroes reports a second translation: Avicenna's quotations, however, are doctrinal rather than textual and their inspection does not provide decisive evidence for his use of either translation. As to the fragments of alternative translations of book Λ reported by Averroes, they do not coincide with any of Avicenna's textual quotation of this book.

Table 2 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–328, 4	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* α, 2, 994a11–16	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Isḥāq's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
cause is the absolute first cause *of the [other] two things* (*li-l-amrayni*),	cause *of the later terms* (τῶν μετ' αὐτὸ). For if we had to say which of the three is the cause, we should say the first;	is the cause *of middles* (*li-awsāṭin*). For if we want to say which among these three things is the cause, we say the first.	necessarily be the cause *of what comes after it* (*li-mā baʿdahū*). For, if we are asked which one is the cause of the three, we say the first.
[5] (p. 327, 14–15) and the other two relate to it as caused things, even though they differ in so far as one of them is caused by mediation, while the other is caused not by mediation.			
[6] (p. 327, 16) Neither the last [term] nor *the intermediate* (*al-mutawassiṭ*) are so.	(994a14, 994a15) surely not the last . . . nor even *the intermediate* (τὸ μέσον),	(p. 19, 1, p. 19, 1–2) We do not say the last . . . Nor *the middle* (*al-awsaṭ*) is the cause of the two extremes . . .	(p. 18, 13, pp. 18, 14–19, 1) For the last is not the cause of them. . . . Likewise, also *the intermediate* (*al-mutawassiṭ*) is not the cause of them,
[7] (pp. 327, 16–328, 1) For the intermediate [term]—which is the cause in contact with the caused [thing]—is cause of only one thing,	(994a15) for it [i.e. the intermediate] is the cause only of one	. . . but of one.	(p. 19, 1) in so far as it is only cause of one.
[8] (p. 328, 1) whereas the caused [thing] is not cause of anything.	(994a14–15) . . . for the final term is the cause of none;	(p. 19, 1) . . . for the end is not a a cause of anything.	(p. 18, 13–14) . . . in so far as it is cause not even of one.
[9] (p. 328, 1–3) Each one of the three has a proper feature. The proper feature of the caused extreme is that it is not the			

Table 2 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–328, 4	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* α, 2, 994a11–16	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Isḥāq's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
cause of anything. The proper feature of the other extreme is that it is the cause of everything other than itself. The proper feature of the intermediate (*al-mutawassiṭ*) is that it causes one extreme and is caused by the other,			
[10] (p. 328, 4) regardless whether *the middle* (*al-wasaṭ*) is one or more than one.	(994a15–16) It makes no difference whether there is one [*intermediate* (τὸ μέσον)] or more.	(p. 19, 2) It makes no difference whether *the first cause* (*al-ʿilla l-ūlā*) is one or multiple.	(p. 19, 1–2) It makes no difference whether there is one *intermediate* (*mutawassiṭ*), or the *intermediates* (*al-mutawassiṭāt*) are more than one.

Sections [4] and [10] show clearly enough that Avicenna is not employing Usṭāṯ's translation, at least in the form according to which this latter is preserved in Averroes' *Tafsīr*. In section [4] Aristotle maintains that the first among the three things he is dealing with is the cause of "the things after it" (τῶν μετ' αὐτὸ). Usṭāṯ regards this expression as referring to the "intermediate things" (*awsāṭ*), in the plural. His interpretation seems incorrect, since Aristotle is presently considering only one intermediate thing; he will take into account the possibility of more than one intermediate thing in sections [10] and following. Avicenna, by contrast, reproduces what Aristotle actually means, namely that the first thing is the cause of both the intermediate and the last thing. In other words, Avicenna's paraphrase is closer to Aristotle's text than Usṭāṯ's translation. The same happens in section [10]. There Aristotle refers implicitly to "the intermediate" (τὸ μέσον), mentioned in section [6]; Usṭāṯ thinks Aristotle is referring to "the first cause" (*al-ʿilla l-ūlā*), whereas Avicenna holds the right interpretation. This implies that Avicenna's paraphrase is not based on Usṭāṯ's translation.

Instead of Usṭāṯ's, Avicenna is probably using Isḥāq's translation. Even though in sections [4] and [10], about the points of interpretation at stake, the readings in Isḥāq's translation are not identical, albeit compatible, with Avicenna's paraphrase, in sections [6] and [9], in order to refer to the intermediate thing, Avicenna employs exactly the same term (*al-mutawassiṭ*) that appears as a rendering of the Greek τὸ μέσον in Isḥāq's translation of sections [1] and [6], and which does not occur in Usṭāṯ's translation of the passage examined in Table 2. Similar evidence attesting Avicenna's use of Isḥāq's translation can be gained also from Avicenna's paraphrase of other passages of *Metaphysics* α, 2.[12]

1.3 *Other translations*

It has already been remarked in Chapter 1,[13] that in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna probably used a translation of *Metaphysics* A different from the only extant Arabic translation of this book, i.e. the one by Naẓīf (see also below, §5.1).

The fact that some passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt* resemble certain *loci* of *Metaphysics* M (see below, §5.13), implies that Avicenna knew and quoted an Arabic translation of this book. On account of Avicenna's wide recourse to Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see above, §1.1), his quotations of *Metaphysics* M might derive from Usṭāṯ's version of this book, which is attested by the *Fihrist*.[14] The possibility, however, that Avicenna's quotations are taken from the other two attested translations of M (Yaḥyā ibn-ʿAdī and ʿIsā ibn-Zurʿa) cannot be excluded.

Avicenna's quotations of book N (see below, §5.14) depend possibly on the only attested translation of this book, the one by Naẓīf.[15]

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[12] Avicenna's use of Isḥaq's translation of α is confirmed by the presence of an abridged version of Isḥāq's translation of α, 1–2 (993a30–994b31) in the Ms. Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 6, in which texts originally belonging to Avicenna's library have been copied (see Chapter 1, §2).

[13] See Chapter 1, §3, Table 2.1.

[14] See Chapter 1, §1.1.

[15] See Chapter 1, §1.2. It cannot be excluded that Avicenna quoted the anonymous shortened paraphrase of Λ, 6–10, preserved in the "Avicennian" manuscript Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 6 (see Chapter 1, §2). In this paraphrase God is called "First Cause" (*al-ʿilla al-ūlā*, Aristotle [1947], p. 5, 17–18; cp. *al-ʿilal al-uwal* p. 8, 18), as He is called sometimes in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see, for example, VIII, 1, p. 328, 15 [p. 378, 52]). But this bare lexical similarity, first noticed by Pines [1956], p. 18, n. 3, is too vague to prove that Avicenna not only knew this paraphrase, but actually

Table 3: Different types of quotations

type	*Ilāhiyyāt*	*Metaph.*	reference	attitude
1.1	VIII, 1–3	α, 2	The First Teacher (*al-muʿallim al-awwal*) The First Teaching (*al-taʿlīm al-awwal*)	acceptance and defense
1.2	IX, 2–3	Λ, 7–8 *Phys.* Θ, 4 *De Cael.* B,2	The First Teacher	acceptance
2	I, 5	Δ, 5 *De Int.* 13	The Ancients (*al-awwalūna*)	criticism
2	I, 5	*De Int.* 13	What is said . . . (*mā yuqālu*)	criticism
2	II, 2	Δ, 6	It is said . . . (*yuqālu*)	qualified acceptance
2	III, 3	I, 6	It is surprising that someone/some . . . (*al-ʿaǧab mimman*)	criticism
2	III, 3	Δ, 15	It is said . . . (*yuqālu*)	acceptance
2	III, 4	Δ, 6 *Cat.* 6	Sometimes it is said . . . (*wa-qad yuqālu*)	criticism
2	IV, 1	Δ, 11	What is commonly believed among common people (*al-mašhūr ʿinda al-ǧumhūr*)	implicit criticism
2	IV, 2	Δ, 12	The commonly accepted meaning (*al-maʿnā al-mašhūr*); Philosophers (*al-falāsifa*); Geometers (*al-muhandisūna*)	implicit criticism
2	IV, 3	Δ, 26	Common people . . . say (*al-ǧumhūr . . . yaqūlūna*)	criticism
2	IV, 3	Δ, 26	They say (*yaqūlūna*)	implicit criticism
2	VI, 3	α, 1	What is commonly believed (*al-mašhūr*)	qualified acceptance
2	VI, 4	Δ, 2	A group (*qawm*)	criticism
2	VI, 4	Z, 9	It was believed . . . (*zunna*)	criticism
2	VII, 1	*Cat.* 11	The statement . . . (*al-qawl*)	criticism
2	VIII, 1	α, 2	The statement of the one who says . . . (*qawl al-qāʾil*)	qualified acceptance
3	I,1–IX, 7	α-I, Λ-N	—	acceptance (mostly)

2 Typology of quotations

From the point of view of style (i.e. on account of the different ways of mentioning the author and/or the work), Avicenna quotes Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* according to three distinct modalities. In a descending order of completeness, these modalities are classified in Table 3.

(1) The first type of quotations refers either to Aristotle, by means of the definite description "First Teacher" (*al-muʿallim al-awwal*), or to the *Metaphysics*, by means of the cognate expression "First Teaching" (*al-taʿlīm al-awwal*).[16] These quotations can be named "explicit determinate", for they clearly show both that Avicenna is quoting an author or a work (in this sense they are explicit), and the identity of the quoted author and work, i.e. Aristotle or the *Metaphysics* (in this sense they are determinate). Avicenna never expresses disagreement with the doctrines he reports.[17] He presents his own exposition as their elucidation.[18]

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quoted it: God is called "First Cause", for example, also in the *Liber de Causis* (see Chapter 4, §2.4, Text 12.1).

[16] See Appendix B, I.2, II.2. Even though there is no reference to Aristotle or the *Metaphysics* in the quotations of α, 2 in VIII, 1 and VIII, 3, they can be regarded as quotations of type 1.1 due to the link between α and chapter VIII, 1 that Avicenna's states in VIII, 2, p. 332, 4–5 [p. 382, 30–32], and the connection between VIII, 1 and VIII, 3 that he establishes in VIII, 1, p. 327, 8–10 [p. 376, 10–15]. On "First Teaching" and "First Teacher" as expressions designating the *Metaphysics* and Aristotle, see Appendix D, I.3. The expression "First Teacher" is what modern logicians call a "definite description", in so far as it refers to one and only one thing, in our case Aristotle; in the case of other expressions that Avicenna uses to refer to previous authors, on the contrary, the referent can be uncertain (see, for example, Street [2001]). Gutas [1988], pp. 287–288, has explained the reasons underlying Avicenna's switch from referring to Aristotle by means of his proper name (*Arisṭūṭālīs*) or the epithet "the Philosopher" (*al-faylasūf*) in his early works, to referring to him by means of the expression "First Teacher" in his later writings. Not only the style, however, but also the quantity, of Avicenna's quotations of Aristotle changed over time. In the *Mabdaʾ*, for example, we find the same four explicit references to *Metaphysics* Λ that occur in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, plus other four. See *Mabdaʾ* p. 61, 10 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 392, 4 [p. 462, 43–44]); p. 61, 18 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 392, 9 [p. 462, 53]); p. 62, 3 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 392, 15–16 [p. 463, 65]); p. 68, 7 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 401, 16 [p. 476, 34]); p. 34, 3; p. 68, 14; p. 68, 21; p. 85, 8. In this work Aristotle is named "Philosopher" (*faylasūf*) and the *Metaphysics Kitāb Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa* (p. 36, 5).

[17] No explicit criticism of Aristotle occurs in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, even though the explicit quotations of Aristotle/the *Metaphysics* in this work occasionally incorporate explicit indeterminate quotations of critical tone (see below, §3.1, Table 4 [16]). This type of criticism surfaces in the *Šarḥ Lām*: p. 23, 21; p. 30, 23, with regard to Λ, 9, 1074b28–29 (see Gutas [1988], p. 288 and n. 12); p. 31, 16–18, with regard to Λ, 9, 1074b32–33 (English translation in Pines [1987], p. 192; see Chapter 11, §1.2, n. 52).

[18] In VIII, 2, p. 332, 4 [p. 382, 31], Avicenna states that his previous exposi-

In fact, this type of quotations presents two subdivisions, 1.1 (seven quotations) and 1.2 (six quotations). The main differences between 1.1 and 1.2 are the following. First, in 1.1 also the book of the *Metaphysics* from which the quotations are taken, namely a, is mentioned;[19] in 1.2, on the contrary, the indication of the quoted book (Λ) is omitted. Second, quotations 1.1 are longer and more similar to the original text than quotations 1.2.[20] Third, in 1.1 Avicenna also defends the texts he quotes from possible criticisms,[21] whereas in 1.2 no defensive attitude is present. Fourth, whereas quotations 1.1 refer exclusively to the *Metaphysics*, quotations 1.2 refer occasionally also to other works by Aristotle, like *Physics* and *De Caelo*.

(2) The second group of quotations (fifteen cases) is characterized by different formulas. Sometimes Avicenna refers to Aristotle himself by means of generic names ("the Ancients", *al-awwalūna*; "a group", *qawm*), pronouns ("someone/some", *man*) or verbs ("they say", *yaqūlūna*). In some other cases, he refers to Aristotle's views, rather than to Aristotle, describing them neutrally as "what is said" (*mā yuqālu, yuqālu*), a thing that "was believed" (*zunna*) or as a "statement" (*qawl, qawluhum, qawl al-qā'il*). In a further set of instances, the "sources", so to say, of Aristotle's doctrines are underscored: Avicenna refers to "what is commonly believed" (*al-mašhūr*) or to "the commonly accepted meaning" (*al-maʿnā al-mašhūr*), occasionally ascribed to the "common people" (*al-mašhūr ʿinda al-ğumhūr*); to the "common people" (*al-ğumhūr*) themselves; and to the "philosophers" (*al-falāsifa*) and "geometers" (*al-muhandisūna*). Quotations like these can be called "explicit indeterminate": they are explicit, because Avicenna makes clear that he is reporting someone else's thought, but they are indeterminate, since it is not clear whom exactly Avicenna is referring to; only the content reveals that Aristotle and the *Metaphysics* are at stake. These quotations are significant, since they often reveal a

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tion in chapter VIII, 1 is taken from the *Metaphysics* ("First Teaching"; see below, §3.1, Table 4 [19]). Likewise, in IX, 2, p. 392, 4–6 [p. 462, 43–48], he maintains that his own exposition in the previous part of IX, 2 explains Aristotle's ("First Teacher") position on the same issue.

[19] "the treatise named *A minor*" (*al-maqāla al-mawsūma bi-alif al-ṣuġrā*), VIII, 2, p. 332, 4–5 [p. 382, 31–32].

[20] Avicenna rightly employs in this regard the verb "to imitate" (*ḥāḏā*; VIII, 2, p. 332, 4 [p. 382, 31]).

[21] The first two quotations of α, 2 in VIII, 1, are followed in VIII, 2 by the solution of a series of objections moved against Aristotle's quoted doctrines (see Chapter 6, §3.3, Table 8).

critical attitude towards Aristotle on Avicenna's part:[22] it is as if in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna wanted to hide or veil his disagreement towards the "First Teacher". They regard books α, Δ, Z and I of the *Metaphysics* and, occasionally, other works by Aristotle (*Categories, De Interpretatione*).

(3) In the third group of quotations, finally, Aristotle is not referred to in any way, nor is there any sign of Avicenna's reliance on a source. In this regard these quotations can be labelled "implicit". Quotations 3 are the most frequent: they occur throughout treatises I–IX of the *Ilāhiyyāt* and range over the *Metaphysics* in its entirety, with the exception of book K. In the majority of cases, Avicenna's attitude is positive.[23] Occasionally, albet not frequently, these quotations are indirect, i.e. refer to the *Metaphysics* by means of some other intermediate source.[24]

All the aforementioned types of quotations (1–3) are paraphrastic, even though they belong to the category of paraphrase in different ways. For the sake of convenience, I distinguish two main modes of paraphrase, which I call, respectively, "textual" (when the syntax and terminology of the original text is, more or less faithfully, respected) and "doctrinal" (when the main point of the original text is reproduced, but the phrasing is different). Whereas all the quotations of

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[22] The same happens in other sections of the *Šifāʾ* with regard to the corresponding writings of the Aristotelian *corpus*. For example, in *Ǧadal* I, 5, pp. 50, 5–51, 7, Avicenna dissents from *Top.* A, 2, 101a34–b4, where Aristotle charges dialectic with proving the principles of the other sciences ("Do not pay attention to what is said . . ."; see Hasnawi [2002], pp. 74–75). In *Samāʿ* I, 2, pp. 20, 7–21, 8 [pp. 32, 63–34, 00], Avicenna rejects *Phys.* A, 9, 192a20–23, where Aristotle describes matter as desiring the form, and compares matter and form, respectively, to the female and the male ("Sometimes, in a context like the present one, the state of the matter's desire for the form is mentioned . . ."). This latter criticism is possibly due to the fact that matter and form are likened to the female and the male by Plato, according to Aristotle in *Metaph.* A, 6, 988a5–6.

[23] Some of Avicenna's quotations present doctrinal differences with regard to the *Metaphysics* that can be regarded as implicit rejections of Aristotle's positions therein (III, 5, p. 119, 6 [p. 132, 70], see below §5.13; III, 6, pp. 126, 4–130, 4 [pp. 139, 9–144, 8], see below, §5.10; VI, 2, p. 265, 1–2 [p. 301, 17–19], see below, §5.12; VII, 1, p. 309, 13–16 [p. 357, 70–76], see below, §5.10).

[24] See the quotation of *Metaph.* A, 5, 986a22–26, in III, 6, p. 128, 12–16 [pp. 142, 68–143, 75], through Themistius's paraphrase and Philoponus' commentary of Aristotle's *Physics* (see below, §5.1). Likewise, the distinction of the theoretical from the practical sciences in I, 1, pp. 3, 11–4, 6 [pp. 1, 7–2, 19], comes from *Metaph.* α, 1, 993b20–23, through the tradition of the classification of the sciences (see below, §5.2). Also the tripartition of theoretical philosophy in natural philosophy, mathematics and metaphysics in I, 1, p. 4, 7–14 [p. 2, 20–30], originally formulated in *Metaph.* E, 1, 1025b18–1026a23 is mediated by the same tradition (see below, §5.6).

type 1.1 are "textual", only some of the quotations of type 1.2 belong to this category; each of the other types of quotations as well (2–3) encompasses both "textual" and "doctrinal" quotations.

In the following three sections (§§3–5), I will focus on the three types of quotations just described. Quotations are recorded in the order they appear in the *Ilāhiyyāt* and are enumerated according to the place of the *Metaphysics* to which they refer (i.e. a passage of the *Ilāhiyyāt* in which Avicenna quotes distinct pericopes of the *Metaphysics* is regarded as constituting a corresponding number of distinct quotations). Textual quotations are distinguished from doctrinal quotations by being reported in italics. In the case of doctrinal quotations, the existence of intermediate sources, either Aristotelian or non-Aristotelian, cannot be excluded.

3 Explicit determinate quotations

Quotations of type 1, in both their varieties, indicate Avicenna's predilection for two particular portions of the *Metaphysics*, namely α, 2 and Λ, 7–8. Since the same predilection for α and Λ within the *Metaphysics* is exhibited by the first Arab philosopher, al-Kindī, I have argued in Chapter 2 that Avicenna's particular attention to α, 2 and Λ, 7–10, witnessed by quotations of type 1, is a remnant of his initial, selective, "Kindian" way of reading the *Metaphysic*s, later superseded by a more comprehensive approach, under the influence of al-Fārābī. Furthermore, it is significant that quotations of type 1 occur only in OntologyC/Theology: this attests to the fact that Avicenna's theological philosophy in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, despite its Neoplatonic underpinnings,[25] has a strong Aristotelian basis.

3.1 *Quotations of book α*

All the quotations of type 1.1 are concentrated in VIII, 1–3 and regard chapter α, 2 of the *Metaphysics*. In detail:

Outline 1

1) *VIII, 1, p. 327, 8–9 [p. 376, 10–12]* (the causes are finite in every respect and each class of them has a first principle): *α, 2, 994a1–2.*
2) *VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–329, 6 [pp. 377, 17–378, 60]* (efficient causes are finite): *α, 2, 994a3–19.*

[25] See Chapter 11, §§2.2, 2.4.

3) *VIII, 1, pp. 329, 7–331, 13 [pp. 379, 64–381, 27]* (material causes are finite): *α, 2, 994a19–b6.*
4) *VIII, 2, pp. 332, 6–334, 11 [pp. 382, 24–385, 91]*: the first four objections, answered at *pp. 335, 3–340, 2, [pp. 385, 04–392, 57]*, regard Aristotle's distinction of two ways according to which a thing can come from another in *α, 2, 994a22–24.*
5) *VII, 2, pp. 334, 12–335, 2 [p. 385, 92–03]*: the fifth objection, answered at *p. 340, 3–8, [p. 393, 58–67]*, regards Aristotle's doctrine of the mutual transformation of the four elements in *α, 2, 994b5–6.*
6) *VIII, 3, pp. 340, 14–341, 13 [pp. 393, 74–395, 3]* (final causes are finite): *α, 2, 994b9–16.*
7) *VIII, 3, pp. 341, 14–18 [p. 395, 4–11]* (formal causes are finite): *α, 2, 994b16–20.*

Let us take as an example the second quotation of this type, whose first part has already been examined in §1.2 (Table 2). Table 4 reproduces this quotation in its entirety.

In *Metaphysics* α, 2 Aristotle establishes that in each of the four types of causes (material, formal, moving/efficient and final) there is a first principle, and that the types of causes that exist in reality are exactly these four, not more. Our passage belongs to the treatment of the first issue. In the passage quoted by Avicenna, Aristotle provides a kind of general remark on the subject, in five points. First, he maintains that the presence of an intermediate thing implies the presence of a first thing before it, and a last thing after it (section [1]). Second, that in this sequence the first thing is the cause of the other two things (section [4]). Third, that the last thing is not the cause of the other two, since it is not a cause at all; the intermediate thing as well is not the cause of the other two, since it is the cause of only one of them, namely of the last one (sections [6], [7] and [8]). Fourth, that the intermediate thing can be indifferently either one or many, and, if many, either limited or unlimited in number (sections [10] and [12]). Finally, Aristotle further clarifies the role of the intermediate cause, excluding this time the possibility of an infinite number of such causes. For, in his opinion, if there is not a first cause before the intermediate causes, there is not causation at all (section [15]).

This Aristotelian passage is very important for Avicenna. Avicenna quotes it at the very beginning of OntologyC/Theology (VIII, 1), and in section [18] he applies its content to the efficient cause: since God in Avicenna's opinion is an efficient cause, our quotation is an

Table 4

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–329, 6; p. 332, 4–5	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* α, 2, 994a11–19	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Isḥāq's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 327, 12) Then we say that, if we suppose a caused [thing], and we suppose that it has a cause, and that its cause has a cause,	(994a11–12) For in the case of an intermediate, which has a last term and a prior term outside it,	(p. 18, 1) For in the things that are middle and have a first and a last,	(p. 18, 11–12) For [in] the intermediate things—namely the things in which there is something anterior and something posterior—
[2] (p. 327, 12–13) it is not possible that every cause has a cause *ad infinitum*.			
[3] (p. 327, 13–14) For, if the caused [thing] and its cause, and the cause of its cause are considered together, one in relation with the other,			
[4] (p. 327, 14) the cause of the cause is the absolute first cause of the [other] two things,	(994a12–14) the prior must be the cause of the later terms. For if we had to say which of the three is the cause, we should say the first;	(pp. 18, 2–19, 1) necessarily the first is the cause of middles. For if we want to say which among these three things is the cause, we say the first.	(p. 18, 12–13), the anterior must necessarily be the cause of what comes after it. For, if we are asked which one is the cause of the three, we say the first.
[5] (p. 327, 14–15) and the other two relate to it as caused things, even though they differ in so far as one of them is caused by mediation, while the other is caused not by mediation.			
[6] (p. 327, 16) Neither the last	(994a14, 994a15) surely not the	(p. 19, 1, p. 19, 1–2) We do not	(p. 18, 13, pp. 18, 14–19, 1) For the

Table 4 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–329, 6; p. 332, 4–5	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* α, 2, 994a11–19	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Isḥāq's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[term] nor the intermediate are so.	last . . . nor even the intermediate,	say the last . . . Nor the middle is the cause of the two extremes . . .	last is not the cause of them. . . . Likewise, also the intermediate is not the cause of them,
[7] (pp. 327, 16–328, 1) For the intermediate [term]—which is the cause in contact with the caused [thing]—is cause of only one thing,	(994a15) for it [i.e. the intermediate] is the cause only of one	. . . but of one.	(p. 19, 1) in so far as it is only cause of one.
[8] (p. 328, 1) whereas the caused [thing] is not cause of anything.	(994a14–15) . . . for the final term is the cause of none;	(p. 19, 1) . . . for the end is not a cause of anything.	(p. 18, 13–14) . . . in so far as it is cause not even cause of one.
[9] (p. 328, 1–3) Each one of the three has a proper feature. The proper feature of the caused extreme is that it is not the cause of anything. The proper feature of the other extreme is that it is the cause of everything other than itself. The proper feature of the intermediate is that it causes one extreme and is caused by the other,			
[10] (p. 328, 4) regardless whether the middle is one or more than one,	(994a15–16) It makes no difference whether there is one [intermediate] or more,	(p. 19, 2) It makes no difference whether the first cause is one or multiple,	(p. 19, 1–2) It makes no difference whether there is one intermediate, or the intermediates are more than one,

Table 4 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–329, 6; p. 332, 4–5	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* a, 2, 994a11–19	Usṭāṭ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Isḥāq's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[11] (p. 328, 4) and, if it is more than one,			
[12] (p. 328, 4–5) regardless whether [the middles] are arranged in a finite series, or in an infinite series.	(994a16) nor whether they are infinite or finite in number.	(p. 19, 2–3) nor whether it is finite or does not have any finiteness.	(p. 19, 2–3) and whether they are finite or infinite.
[13] (p. 328, 5–11) [lengthy explanation of 12]			
[14] (p. 328, 11–12) It is impossible, therefore, that there is a group of existing causes without there being among them an uncaused cause and a first cause.			
[15] (p. 328, 12–13) For an infinite group [of causes] would be a middle without extreme, and this is impossible.	(994a16–19) But of series which are infinite in this way, and of the infinite in general, all the parts down to that now present are alike intermediates; so that if there is no first there is no cause at all.	(p. 19, 3–5) For all the parts of what has no end in this way, and in general all the parts of the no-end, are now equally middles. For, if there is no first thing, there is no cause at all, not even one.	(p. 19, 3–6) The parts of infinite things that are gathered in this way, and in general all the parts of the infinite, are intermediate in the same way until this moment. Necessarily, therefore, if there is no first thing, there is in general no cause at all.
[16] (pp. 328, 13–329, 2) [additional remarks on 15 representing a revision/criticism of the "statement" (*qawl*) holding 12]			
[17] (p. 329, 3–4) [conclusion]			

Table 4 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–329, 6; p. 332, 4–5	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* a, 2, 994a11–19	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Isḥaq's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[18] (p. 329, 5–6) [the above argument can be applied to all types of causes, even though it has been applied here only to the efficient cause]	cp. α, 2, 994a1–11		
[19] (VIII, 2, p. 332, 4–5) In this explanation we have chosen to imitate what is mentioned in the First Teaching, in the treatise named "A Minor".			

essential step in Avicenna's proof of God's existence. Table 4 reveals four noteworthy aspects of Avicenna's quotation technique. First, he quotes Aristotle's text in its entirety: in some sections ([1], [4], [6], [7], [8], [10], [12] and [15]) he paraphrases Aristotle's text, whereas in others (section [18]) he summarizes it.[26] Second, he slightly changes the content of Aristotle's text, in order to elucidate it: in section [1], for example, he states immediately that one of the three things in question is an effect, another its cause, another the cause of its cause; in Aristotle's text, on the other hand, the reference to causation appears only in section [4]. Third, he adds all the remaining sections: among them, section [2] emphasizes, in negative terms, the main point of the discussion, namely the impossibility of an endless

[26] A tendency towards brevity is visible also in the other quotations of type 1.1. In the third quotation, for example, Avicenna omits the last part of Aristotle's proof of the finiteness of material causes (α, 2, 994b6–9). In the seventh quotation, similarly, he omits some of Aristotle's arguments against the infinite regress of formal causes (α, 2, 994b20–27).

series of causes; the same function have section [14], which stresses, in positive terms, the necessity of a first cause in the series of causes, and section [17], which represents the general conclusion. Sections [3] and [5] introduce and conclude, respectively, section [4]. Section [9] summarizes what precedes. Section [11] connects sections [10] and [12]. Fourth, Avicenna submits a doctrine by Aristotle (the intermediates can be either infinite or finite, section [12]) to a thorough explanation ([13]) and revision/criticism ([16]).[27]

The quotation of α, 2 taken into account in Table 4 display all the main features of Avicenna's approach to Aristotle's *Metaphysics*: comprehensive reception, doctrinal elaboration, selectiveness (expansion of certain points and compression of others) and critical attitude.

3.2 *Quotations of book Λ*

Also the quotations of type 1.2 occur in a single place of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (IX, 2–3); they concern a limited portion of the *Metaphysics*, namely chapters 7–8 of book Λ, plus some passages of *Physics* and *De Caelo*. In detail:

Outline 2
1) X, 2, p. 392, 4–5 [p. 462, 43–45] (heaven is in motion on account of its nature): *Phys.* Θ, 4, 254b17, and *De Caelo* B, 2, 285a29.
2) *IX, 2, p. 392, 5–6 [p. 462, 43–46]* (the mover of the heaven is an infinite power): *Λ, 7, 1073a7–8.*
3) *IX, p. 392, 6 [p. 462, 46–47]* (the mover of the heaven moves by being loved): *Λ, 7, 1072b3.*
4) IX, 2, p. 392, 8–10 [p. 462, 51–54] (every celestial sphere has a proximate mover—i.e. a soul—and an object of desire and love—i.e. an intellect—proper to it): Λ, 8, 1073a14–b1.
5) IX, 2, p. 392, 15–17 [p. 463, 65–67] (the number of celestial spheres is established on the basis of the evidence available at the time of Aristotle, and is equal to the number of separate principles): Λ, 8, 1073b1–1074a18.
6) IX, 3, p. 401, 16 [p. 476, 33–34] (the separate things—i.e. the celestial intellects movers of the spheres—are approximately fifty): Λ, 8, 1073b38–1074a17.

Let us take as an example the second and third quotation of this type. They refer to two of the most famous statements by Aristotle about the Unmoved Mover, i.e. God: that It has an infinite power, and that It moves as an object of love.

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[27] See below, §4, Outline 3 [15]; Druart [1999], p. 263.

Table 5

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 2, p. 392, 4–6	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Λ, 7	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 392, 4) It is also evident to you from all this what the First Teacher . . .		
(p. 392, 5–6) . . . meant, when he said that [the heaven] is in movement by means of an infinite power (*quwwa ġayr mutanāhiya*),	(1073a7–8) For it [i.e. the substance that is eternal, unmovable and separate] produces movement through infinite time, but nothing finite has infinite power.	(p. 1625, 13–14) For it moves for an infinite time, but nothing finite has an infinite power (*quwwa lā mutanāhiya*).
[2] (p. 392, 6) which moves (*tuḥarriku*) as the object of love (*al-maʿšūq*) does.	(1072b3) Thus it produces motion by being loved . . .	(p. 1599, 2) It moves (*yuḥarriku*) like the object of love (*al-maʿšūq*).

Three things are noteworthy. First, Avicenna quotes one after the other in sections [1] and [2] two *loci* of Λ, 7 that in the original text are disconnected. Second, he reverses their order, since the passage quoted in section [2] actually follows in the *Metaphysics*, rather than preceding, the one quoted in section [3]. Third, he elaborates on the content of the text quoted in section [1]: Aristotle's point is that the Unmoved Mover is not finite in magnitude, since (i) It moves eternally, (ii) what moves eternally has an infinite power, and (iii) what has an infinite power is not finite. Avicenna somehow isolates step (ii) of Aristotle's argument, namely that the Unmoved Mover moves by means of an infinite power.

For these reasons, i.e. the conflation of two distinct passages of the *Metaphysics* (rather than the thorough analysis of a single pericope), their transposed (rather than consecutive) reproduction, and the exclusive focus on what is regarded as the main point of one of them (rather than its integral reproduction), the style of this quotation is sensibly different from that of the quotation reported in Table 4.

4 Explicit indeterminate quotations

Quotations of type 2 occur in treatises I–VIII of the *Ilāhiyyāt* and refer to four distinct books of the *Metaphysics* (α, Δ, Z, I), with particular regard to book Δ. Occasionally they concern also other works

by Aristotle (like *Categories* and *De Interpretatione*). In several cases, they show a peculiar attitude on Avicenna's part, who criticizes Aristotle, but, at the same time, by the very nature of the quotation, hides his criticisms. The first aspect, i.e. the disagreement with Aristotle, shows that, even in avowedly Aristotelian works like the *Šifāʾ*, Avicenna does not blindly follow his model, but always maintains a critical approach. The second aspect, namely Avicenna's reticence in criticizing Aristotle, is a sign of his adherence to Aristotle's school and the Peripatetic tradition. He probably means just this conciliatory attitude when in the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, he states that this work is "more accommodating to [his] Peripatetic colleagues" than the *Mašriqiyyūn*,[28] or when in the Introduction to this latter work he maintains that in the *Šifāʾ* "the veils of feigned neglect" conceal his dissent towards the Peripatetics.[29]

Outline 3

1) The second circular definition of "necessary" (*al-ḍarūrī*) attributed to the "Ancients" (*al-awwalūna*, p. 35, 4 [p. 40, 56]) in I, 5, p. 35, 12 [p. 40, 67], resembles *Metaph.* Δ, 5, 1015a33–35. In the same context, the first circular definition of "necessary" (p. 35, 10–11 [p. 40, 65–66]) and the circular definitions of "possible" (*al-mumkin*, p. 35, 8–10 [p. 40, 62–65]) and "impossible" (*al-muḥāl*, p. 35, 14–16 [p. 41, 70–73]) are comparable to *De Int.* 13, 22a24–31 (see below, Table 6).
2) The circular definitions ("what is said", *mā yuqālu*, I, 5, p. 35, 17 [p. 41, 74]) of "impossible" (*al-mumtanaʿ*), "necessary" (*al-wāǧib*) and "possible" (*al-mumkin*) in I, 5, pp. 35, 17–36, 2 [p. 41, 73–77]) mirror *De Int.* 13, 22a24–31.
3) *II, 2, p. 63, 11–12 [p. 72, 44–46]*: Avicenna puts some limitations on the description according to which body "is said" (*yuqālu*, p. 63, 11 [p. 72, 44]) to be "that which is divisible in every dimension" (*Δ, 6, 1016b27–28*; cp. *De Caelo* A, 1, 268a6–8).
4) III, 3, p. 105, 11–12 [p. 116, 55–56]: Avicenna finds surprising that "someone/some" (*man*, p. 105, 11 [p. 116, 55]) define number as "multiplicity composed by unities or things that are one" (cp. I, 6, 1057a3–4).[30]

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[28] See *Madḫal*, p. 10, 14, English translation in Gutas [1988], p. 52.

[29] The passage of the Introduction to the *Mašriqiyyūn* in which Avicenna states "[i]f ever we spoke out openly our disagreement with them [i.e. the Peripatetics], then it concerned matters which it was impossible to tolerate; the greater parts [of these matters], however, we concealed with the veils of feigned neglect" (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 47) regards *in primis* the *Šifāʾ*.

[30] That Avicenna is referring to Aristotle is indicated by his subsequent criticism of this opinion (p. 105, 12–14 [p. 116, 56–61]), in which he rejects Aristotle's view of multiplicity "as the genus of number" in the same passage of I, 6 (1057a2–3).

5) III, 3, p. 106, 6 [p. 117, 73]: Avicenna reports a definition ("it is said", *yuqālu*) of equality comparable to the definition of "equal" in Δ, 15, 1021a12.
6) III, 4, pp. 117, 15–118, 11 [pp. 131, 37–56]: Avicenna criticizes the opinion according to which space (*Cat.* 6, 5a8–14) and heavy/light (Δ, 13, 1020a22) "are said" (*yuqālu*, p. 117, 15 [p. 131, 37]) to be quantities.
7) *IV, 1, p. 163, 9–14 [pp. 184, 11–185, 18]*: Avicenna ascribes priority and posteriority in place and time (*Δ, 11, 1018b12–19*) to "what is commonly believed among the common people" (*al-mašhūr ʿinda al-ğumhūr*, p. 163, 9–10 [p. 184, 11]).
8) *IV, 2, pp. 170, 4–172, 12* [pp. 193, 72–196, 34]: the discussion of the various types of power and related concepts depends on *Δ, 12* (capacity, incapacity, possible and impossible). Avicenna divides power into non-philosophical (pp. 170, 4–171, 3 [pp. 193, 72–195, 93]; Δ, 12, 1019a23–32), philosophical (pp. 171, 4–172, 5 [pp. 195, 94–196, 23]; Δ, 12, 1019a15–22, b21–23) and mathematical (pp. 172, 6–9 [p. 196, 24–29]; Δ, 12, 1019b24–25, 34–35), which he ascribes, respectively, to the "commonly accepted meaning" (*al-maʿnā al-mašhūr*, p. 171, 13 [p. 195, 8]), the "philosophers" (*al-falāsifa*, p. 171, 4 [p. 195, 94]) and the "geometers" (*al-muhandisūna*, p. 172, 6 [p. 196, 24]).
9) IV, 3, p. 187, 1–4 [p. 214, 92–95]): the opinion of the "common people" (*al-ğumhūr*, p. 187, 1 [om.]) according to which a number is not perfect, neither is it an "all" and a "whole", if it is minor than three, appears to be related to Aristotle's discussion of the cases in which "all" and "whole" apply to number in Δ, 26, 1024a1–10. In IV, 3, p. 188, 3–4 [p. 215, 13–16], the doctrine of the previous part of IV, 3 is severely criticized (see Chapter 6, Text 3).
10) *IV, 3, p. 190, 2–4 [pp. 217, 61–218, 63]*: Avicenna reports the doctrine of some thinkers who "say" (*yaqūlūna*, p. 190, 2 [p. 217, 61]) about "all" and "whole" what Aristotle maintains in *Δ, 26, 1024a1–3*. In what follows, Avicenna replaces this definition of "all" and "whole" with his own definition, finally declaring all the discussion "superfluous".
11) VI, 3, p. 268, 12–15 [p. 307, 28–33]: the doctrine according to which the agent that produces an existence (i.e. a nature) similar to its own is worthier and more powerful than the effect with regard to the nature it bestows (α, 1, 993b24–25) is qualified as a "commonly accepted belief" (*mašhūr*, p. 268, 13 [p. 307, 29]) that is not true from every point of view; it is true only with regard to existence itself and truth (the same realities to which Aristotle himself applies the aforementioned doctrine in α, 1, 993b26–31).
12) *VI, 4, p. 279, 15 [p. 321, 46–47]*: "a group" (*qawm*) of thinkers regard the premises as the material cause of the conclusion (*Δ, 2, 1013b20–21*), whereas, in fact, they are the formal cause of the

syllogism and the efficient cause of the conclusion (see below, Table 7).

13) VI, 4, pp. 281, 17–282, 1 [p. 324, 3–5]: Avicenna reports the doctrine according to which the matter containing the moving principle "was believed" (*zunna*, p. 282, 1 [p. 324, 5]) to move by itself (cp. Z, 9, 1034a11–13; 1034b4–6); he then criticizes this opinion.

14) VII, 1, p. 307, 11 [pp. 354, 14–16]: Avicenna reports the "statement" (*qawl*) according to which courage and temerity belong to contrary genera (*Cat.* 11, 14a1) and are contrary to each other (*Cat.* 11, 14a22–23; cp. *Maqūlāt* VII, 3, pp. 260, 4–262, 19); the following discussion amounts to a criticism of it.

15) *VIII, 1, pp. 328, 13–329, 2 [p. 378, 49–58]*: Avicenna reports and criticizes the "statement of one saying" (*qawl al-qā'il*, p. 328, 13 [p. 378, 49], p. 328, 16 [p. 378, 52]) that the intermediate elements in a series of causes having a beginning and an end can be infinite (*α, 2, 994a16*).

Let us take the first (Table 6) and the eleventh quotation (Table 7) as representative of this category. The last quotation has already been taken into account in §3 (Table 4, [16]).

In I, 5, Avicenna deals with the primary concepts, among which he includes the "necessary". This brings him to discuss the relationship between "necessary" and the other two modal concepts, namely "possible" and "impossible". In the course of the discussion, Avicenna quotes the treatment of these concepts by "the Ancients" (*al-awwalūna*), whom he criticizes, since they defined each one of these three concepts in terms of the other two, falling therefore in a sort of *petitio principii*. The ancient philosophers that Avicenna mentions are above all, if not exclusively, Aristotle.

In section [1], the expression "the Ancients" (*al-awwalūna*) refers to the Greek philosophers of Antiquity. Their two definitions of "necessary" in sections [3]–[4] result to be circular when they are compared with the previous definition of "possible" in terms of "non-necessary" (p. 35, 8–9 [p. 40, 62–63]) and the following definition of "impossible" in terms of "necessarily non-existent" (p. 35, 35, 14–15 [p. 41, 70–72]). That the reference to the Ancients in section [1] is, in fact, a designation of Aristotle is immediately attested by section [2], where Avicenna refers back to the "sections of logic" of the *Šifā'*: he recalls in all likelihood places like *'Ibāra* II, 4 (i.e. his own reworking of *De Interpretatione* 12–13), where he rephrases Aristotle's doctrine of the mutual implication of the modal concepts (ascribing it to the "common people", *al-ğumhūr*, and the "philosophers", *al-falāsifa*), and defends the point of view of the "First Teacher"

Table 6

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5, p. 35, 4–5, 10–12	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Δ, 5, 1015a33–35	Usṭāṭ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 35, 4–5) What has been said to make these [concepts, i.e. necessary, possible, impossible] known, coming to you from the Ancients (*al-awwalūna*), almost produces a [logical] circle.		
[2] (p. 35, 5) For, as you have known in the sections of logic [of the present work] . . .		
[3] (p. 35, 10–11) . . . when they tried to define the necessary (*al-ḍarūrī*), they said that it is that thing which is not possible (*lā yumkin*) to suppose as non-existent,	Cp. *De Int.* 13, 22a24–31, right lower cell: not possible not to be; not admissible not to be; impossible not to be; necessary to be.	Aristotle [1948–52], p. 90, 28–31: not possible not to exist (*laysa mumkinan allā yūǧad*); not admissible not to exist (*laysa muḥtamalan allā yūǧad*); prevented from not existing (*mumtanaʿ allā yūǧad*); necessary to exist (*wāǧib an yūǧad*).
[4] (p. 35, 12) or that thing which, if it is supposed differently from the way in which it is, is impossible (*muḥāl*).	We say that that which cannot be otherwise is necessarily so. Cp. E, 2, 1026b29; Λ, 7, 1072b13.	(p. 516, 6–7) "Necessary" (*muḍṭarr*) was also said of the thing which cannot (*laysa yumkin*) be in another way.

(*al-muʿallim al-awwal*) against the misleading interpretation of a "group" (*qawm*) of later thinkers.[31] In fact, the first definition of "necessary" in section [3] (as the definitions of "possible" in what precedes section [3], and the definitions of "impossible" in what follows section [4]) resembles, according to a different terminology, Aristotle's tables of conversion of the modal propositions in *De Interpretatione* 13, 22a24–31.[32] The second definition of "necessary" in terms of the

[31] *ʿIbāra* II, 4, pp. 116, 13–121, 8. Significantly, Aristotle's "circular" definition of "possible" in *Prior Analytics* A, 13, 32a19–20, is omitted by Avicenna in his reworking of *An. Pr.* A, 13 (Aristotle's account of possibility as a way of introducing the treatment of syllogisms with possible premises) in *Qiyās* II, 3 (pp. 104, 5–105, 14). Davidson [1987], p. 290, points at some instances of negative reception of *De Interpretatione* and *Prior Analytics* in Avicenna's analysis of "necessary", "possible" and "impossible" in I, 5.

[32] These tables are more directly referred to by Avicenna, with a terminology

impossibility of being otherwise in section [4], on the other hand, mirrors a passage of *Metaphysics* Δ, 5: in this passage Aristotle enucleates the main meaning of "necessary", a meaning that he resumes also elsewhere in the *Metaphysics*.[33]

Chapter VI, 4 of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Avicenna's treatment of the material cause) depends implicitly, in many respects, on *Metaphysics* Δ, 2 (see below, §5.5). A particular passage of Δ, 2 is quoted by Avicenna in an explicit indeterminate way: Aristotle is designed in this case by means of the expression "a group" (*qawm*) and, once again, is criticized on a particular aspect of his doctrine of material causality; the issue at stake (Aristotle's consideration of the syllogistic premises as matter of the conclusion) has logical implications.

Table 7

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 4, p. 279, 15–17	Aristotle, *Meta physics* Δ, 2, 1013b17–21	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Albertus Magnus, Commentary on the *Metaphysics* (Albertus Magnus [1960], p. 217, 25–28)
	(1013b17–20) For the letters are the causes of syllables, and the material is the cause of manufactured things, and fire and earth and all such things are the causes of bodies, and the parts are causes of the whole,		
[1] (p. 279, 15) A group (*qawm*) [of philosophers] thought that the premises are so [i.e. material	(1013 b 20–21) and the hypotheses are causes of the conclusion, in the sense that they are that out	(p. 487, 12–13) and the premises (*muqaddimāt*) of the conclusion (*al-natīğa*) are like the causes that [are]	(p. 217, 25–26) Thus, also the . . . premises are elements [i.e material causes] of the conclusions.

more similar to the Arabic translation of the *De Interpretatione*, in the second explicit indeterminate quotation of Aristotle in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, that immediately follows (see above, Outline 3 [2]).

[33] See Davidson [1987], p. 290 and n. 52. The consensual explicit determinate quotation of the *Prior Analytics* that Avicenna places immediately after the two explicit indeterminate criticisms of Aristotle in I, 5 (see Appendix B, II.1.1) can be regarded as another device that he uses to make his disagreement with Aristotle in this pericope less striking.

Table 7 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 4, p. 279, 15–17	Aristotle, *Meta physics* Δ, 2, 1013b17–21	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*	Albertus Magnus, Commentary on the *Metaphysics* (Albertus Magnus [1960], p. 217, 25–28)
causes] with regard to the conclusion.	of which (τὸ ἐξ οὗ) [these respectively are made].	from something (*allatī min šay'*).	
[2] (p. 279, 15) But this is false.			(p. 217, 26–28) Avicenna, who denies all these things—and his follower Algazel as well—did not notice this.
[3] (p. 279, 15–17) On the contrary, the premises are so [i.e. material causes] with regard to the form of the syllogism. As to the conclusion, it is not a form [inhering] in the premises, but something necessarily resulting from them, as if the premises produced the conclusion in the soul.			

In section [1] Avicenna reports the opinion of the "group" of philosophers, i.e. of Aristotle.[34] In section [2] he states that this opinion is false. In section [3] he explains why. Albertus Magnus was apparently the first Avicennian "scholar"—in the sense of a knowledgeable and penetrating interpreter of Avicenna—to discover and identify this quotation. In his commentary on the *Metaphysics*, after para-

[34] Section [1] is apparently a further case in which Avicenna's quotation is closer to Aristotle's original text than Usṭāṯ's translation (see above, §1.1, Table 1). The expression *allatī min šay'in* as a rendering of the Greek τὸ ἐξ οὗ in the *Tafsīr*, however, might be the corruption of an original *allatī minhā šay'un*.

phrasing sympathetically Aristotle's position in section [1], he points out and rejects Avicenna's criticism of Aristotle in section [2].[35]

5 Implicit quotations

Quotations of type 3 are grouped in the present section according to the books of the *Metaphysics* to which they refer.[36]

5.1 *Book A* (Alpha Meizon)

Avicenna is aware of the doxographic nature of A. Quotations of this book occur in three main places of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: in the exposition of the opinions regarding wisdom and the subject-matter of metaphysics in I, 1 (Outline 4.1); in the criticism of an opinion attributed to a group of ancient philosophers in III, 6 (Outline 4.2); and in the comprehensive criticism of Plato's and the Pythagoreans' philosophies in VII, 2–3 (Outline 4.3).[37] The passages of A quoted in the first two places are not extant in Naẓīf's translation; some of those quoted in the third place attests to Avicenna's use of an Arabic translation of A different from Naẓīf's.[38]

Outline 4.1
In I, 1, p. 5, 8–10 [p. 3, 47–50]: the three descriptions of wisdom that Avicenna provides derive ultimately from A, 2, 982a21–b10. In detail:

I, 1, p. 5, 8–9 [p. 3, 47–48]; I, 2, p. 15, 11–12 [p. 16, 91–94] (wisdom as the noblest knowledge of the noblest knowable thing): cp. A, 2, 982a30–b2; see also B, 2, 996b13–14; Λ, 10, 1075b20; *Eth. Nic.* Z, 7, 1141a18–20, b2–3.

I, 1, p. 5, 9–10 [p. 3, 48–49] (wisdom as the truest and most perfect knowledge): cp. A, 2, 982a26–27; see also *Eth. Nic.* Z, 7, 1141a16–17.

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[35] See Bertolacci [1998], pp. 273–275.

[36] This implies that quotations in which Avicenna refers to different books of the *Metaphysics* (see, for example, Chapter 10, §2.2) are divided into their single elements, each of which is analyzed in the section regarding the book of the *Metaphysics* from which it is taken.

[37] Janssens [2004], pp. 46–47, states that Avicenna's reference to experience in I, 1, p. 8, 9–11 [p. 7, 27–30] might depend on A, 1, 980b26–981a30, but he notices that this reliance "is not evident". The order according to which the four causes are enumerated in VI, 1, pp. 257, 7–17 [pp. 291, 10–292, 25]—form, matter, agent, end—might correspond to the order attended by Aristotle in A, 3, 983a26–32.

[38] See Chapter 1, §3.

I, 1, p. 5, 10 [p. 3, 49–50]; I, 2, p. 15, 12–13 [p. 16, 94–95] (wisdom as the knowledge of the first causes of everything): cp. A, 2, 982a21–b10; see also A, 1, 981b27–29; B, 2, 996b13–14.[39]

I, 1, p. 5, 10–15 [pp. 3, 50–4, 56]: Avicenna announces that these three descriptions of wisdom will be shown to belong to one and the same discipline, namely metaphysics, the discipline he is presently dealing with, along the lines of A, 2, 982b7–8 (the name sought for, i.e. "wisdom", pertains to one and the same science).

I, 1, pp. 7, 6–9 [pp. 6, 97–01]: the second opinion on the subject-matter of metaphysics that Avicenna discusses in the remainder of I, 1, i.e. the four ultimate causes of the existents as the subject-matter of this discipline, corresponds to A, 2, 982a21–b10 ("wisdom" as the science of the first causes and principles).

Outline 4.2

III, 6, p. 128, 12–16 [pp. 142, 68–143, 75]: a long and literal quotation of *A, 5, 986a22–26*, in which Aristotle expounds the Pythagorean doctrine of the "columns of contraries" (συστοιχίαι), occurs within Avicenna's discussion of the opposition between unity and multiplicity, i.e. two of the contraries taken into account by the Pythagoreans. Avicenna ascribes this opinion to "a group" (*qawm*) of "ancients" (*qudamā'*). Avicenna's quotation appears to be mediated—at least in part, possibly in its entirety—by the tradition of the commentators of Aristotle' *Physics*.[40] For the idea, ascribed by Avicenna to this group of ancient philosophers (p. 128, 12–13), that "one" and "many" are the first contraries, see also I, 4, 1055b27–28.

Outline 4.3

VII, 2–3 (cp. III, 1, p. 94, 5–8, pp. 94, 14–95, 12 [p. 105, 26–30, pp. 106, 39–61]): Avicenna's exposition and rejection of Plato's and the Pythagoreans' philosophy resembles in many respects Aristotle's account and criticism of these thinkers in A, 5–6, 8–9. The references to A are brief and mostly non-literal; they do not respect the order of Aristotle's text, and are interwoven with other doxographic material, occasionally taken from *Metaphysics* M (see below, §5.13). In detail:

exposition of Plato's philosophy:

VII, 2, pp. 310, 14–311, 8 [pp. 358, 00–359,4] (Socrates' and Plato's doctrine of ideas): A, 6, 987a32–b10 (= M, 4, 1078b12–32, where more

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[39] These three descriptions of wisdom might derive not only from A: they occur also in other *loci* of the *Metaphyics* (see the outline), in Alexander of Aphrodisias (*In Metaph.*, p. 171, 7–8) and al-Fārābī (*Mabādi'*, p. 73); Avicenna resumes them from the previous books of the *Šifā'* by means of the formula "You have already heard" (*wa-qad kunta tasma'u*), the reference being to places like *Burhān* II, 7, p. 165, 7–10; II, 9, p. 178, 17–19.

[40] See Themistius' paraphrase (Themistius [1900], p. 73, 19–20) and Philoponus' commentary (Philoponus [1887], p. 360, 25–28 = Simplicius [1882], p. 429, 7–18) of *Physics* Γ, 2. The Arabic translations of Themistius' paraphrase and Philoponus' commentary are preserved, respectively, in fragments and in a summary/paraphrase of books Γ–Z. See Bertolacci [1999].

details are given, but Plato is not mentioned); A, 9, 990b11–13 (= M, 4, 1079a7–9)

VII, 2, p. 311, 14–15 [p. 360, 25–26] (Plato's doctrine of mathematical entities): *A, 6, 987b14–16* (not in M). This literal quotation is significant not only because it attests that Avicenna is using an Arabic translation of A different from Naẓīf's,[41] but also because it shows that he is quoting directly book A, not Aristotle's parallel treatment of the same subjects in books M and N.[42] This is further attested by the similar procedure adopted by Avicenna in VII, 2–3 and Aristotle in A (they both first describe—VII, 2, pp. 310, 14–314, 7 [pp. 358, 00–363, 99]; A, 5–6—and then criticizes—VII, 2, pp. 314, 8–316, 14 [pp. 363, 00–366, 66]; VII, 3; A, 8–9—the doctrines of Plato and the Pythagoreans),[43] and by the explicit mentions of Plato in VII, 2, p. 311, 6 [p. 359, 9–10], p. 311, 14 [p. 360, 25], and in various places of A, 6 (in books M–N Plato is mentioned only once and incidentally in M, 8, 1083a32).

exposition of the Pythagoreans' philosophy:

VII, 2, p. 312, 16–17 [p. 351, 57–58]: "Some regard them [i.e. numbers and extensions] as principles, but do not regard them as separate. These are the followers of Pythagoras": A, 5, 985b24–986a3 (numbers as principles in Pythagoras' view), A, 6, 987b24–25 (numbers as causes), A, 6, 987b27–31 (numbers as identical with things); cp. M, 8, 1083b10–11 (number as not separated), N, 3, 1090a22–23 (numbers as not separated and as "that from which" things are), M, 6, 1080b16–18 (the mathematical—as opposed to the ideal—number as not separated and as "that from which" things are).

VII, 2, p. 312, 17–18 [p. 351, 58–59]: "They believe everything is compounded by unity and duality": A, 6, 987b25–27 (an opinion attributed by Aristotle to Plato).

VII, 2, p. 312, 18 [p. 351, 59–60]: "They posit unity in the realm of good and limit, duality in the realm of evil and illimit": A, 5, 986a22–26; cp. *Eth. Nic.* A, 4, 1096b5; B, 5, 1106b29.

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[41] See Chapter 1, §3, Table 2.1.

[42] Within Aristotle's account of Plato's philosophy in A, 6, lines 987a32–b10 correspond almost *verbatim* to M, 4, 1078b12–32, where more details are given, but Plato is not mentioned; within Aristotle's criticism of Plato's philosophy in A, 9, lines 990b2–991b9 correspond almost *verbatim* to M, 4, 1078b34–1079b3 and M, 5, 1079b12–1080a8. Avicenna himself remarks in *Mabda*' that Aristotle's criticism of Plato's doctrine of ideas is contained in many Aristotelian works ("It seems that by 'forms' Plato means these forms [i.e. the intelligible forms that are thought by the heavenly intelligences]. But the apparent [meaning] of his doctrine is inconsistent and false, [as] the Philosopher [= Aristotle] has thoroughly discussed in many books", p. 85, 6–7). A criticism of Plato's ideas occurs also in Z, 14–16.

[43] The distinction between description, on the one hand, and criticism, on the other, of Plato, the Pythagoreans and the other philosophers taken into account is also explicitly formulated by Aristotle in A, 7, 988b16–21. The Pythagoreans are also mentioned in M, 4, 1078b21–23; M, 6, 1080b16–21; M, 6, 1080b30–33; M, 8, 1083b8–19; N, 3, 1090a20–35; N, 3, 1091a13–20.

VII, 2, pp. 313, 17–314, 2 (the form of each number corresponds to a real form): A, 5, 985b27–31, 32–33.
rejection of Plato's philosophy:
VII, 3, p. 318, 8–12 [p. 368, 8–13] (the separate things are not causes of matter): A, 9, 991a8–19 (= M, 5, 1079b12–23).
rejection of the Pythagoreans' philosophy:
VII, 3, p. 323, 17–18 [p. 375, 60–62] (numbers cannot explain lightness and heaviness): A, 8, 990a12–14; cp. N, 3, 1090a30–35.

5.2 *Book α* (Alpha Elatton)

Being the object not only of explicit determinate and explicit indeterminate quotations (see above, §§3–4), but also of several implicit quotations, α is the only book of the *Metaphysics* quoted in all the aforementioned three modes. The implicit quotations regard mainly the causal theory of α, 2, but also some particular points of α, 1. Avicenna appears to disregard, instead, α, 3.

Outline 5
I, 1, pp. 3, 11–4, 6 [pp. 1, 7–2, 19]: the distinction of the theoretical from the practical sciences comes originally from α, 1, 993b20–23, through the tradition of the classification of the sciences (cp. *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 12, 2–10).

I, 1, p. 5, 7 [p. 3, 44] (Avicenna calls metaphysics "philosophy of the truth", *falsafa bi-l-ḥaqīqa*; cp. the immediately following "wisdom of the truth", *al-ḥikma bi-l-ḥaqīqa*): α, 1, 993b19–20 ("philosophy", ἡ φιλοσοφία, is called "science of the truth", ἐπιστήμη τῆς ἀληθείας); cp. VI, 3, p. 278, 6–8.

I, 8, p. 48, 7–9 (the Necessary Existent is true by Itself always): α, 1, 993b28–30 (the principles of eternal beings are necessarily true in the highest degree always and do not have any cause of their being true); see also below, VIII, 6, p. 356, 8–15.[44]

VI, 1, p. 257, 10–17 [pp. 291, 14–292, 25] (some causes, i.e. the efficient and final ones, are causes of existence): α, 1, 993b29–30 (a "cause of being" is mentioned).

VI, 3, p. 278, 5–6 [p. 319, 13–18] (the principle bestowing the truth shared [by it and its effects] is worthier of the truth [than its effects]; the first principle bestowing truth to other things is the True by Itself): *α, 1, 993b26–30.*

VI, 4, p. 279, 1–3 [p. 320, 28–30] (the potentiality of matter sometimes is like the potentiality of the child towards the adult man): α, 2, 994a23–24.

VI, 4, p. 279, 7 [p. 320, 35–36] (the potentiality of matter sometimes is like the potentiality of water towards air): α, 2, 994a24.

[44] See Davidson [1987], p. 297 and n. 98.

VIII, 6, p. 356, 8–15 [p. 413, 83–94] (the Necessary Existent is the truest thing): α, 1, 993b28–30 (the principles of eternal beings are necessarily true in the highest degree always and do not have any cause of their being true); see also above, I, 8, p. 48, 7–9.

The importance of book α in Avicenna's eyes is witnessed by its quotations also in other parts of the *Šifāʾ*, like the Prologue and *Nafs*.[45]

5.3–4 *Books B* (Beta) *and Γ* (Gamma)

The implicit quotations regarding these two books will be examined, respectively, in Chapter 10 and Chapter 9.

5.5 *Book* Δ (Delta)

Besides the five explicit indeterminate quotations of Δ already analyzed in §4, many implicit quotations of this book occur in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[46] They are summarized in the following table according to the chapter of Δ to which they refer (chapters of Δ quoted by Avicenna are reported in bold).

Table 8

Ilāhiyyāt	*Metaphysics* Δ
	1 principle
I, 1; VI, 1–3	2 **cause**
VI, 4	3 **element**
VI, 4	4 **nature**
I, 6; VIII, 4	5 **necessary**
III, 2	6 **one**
II, 1	7 **being**
	8 substance
VII, 1	9 **same, other, different, like, unlike**
VII, 1	10 **opposite, contrary, other in species, same in species**
IV, 1	11 **prior and posterior**

[45] A passage of the Prologue to the *Šifāʾ* (p. 9, 9–10) seems to be inspired by α, 1, 993b1–4, in the light of Marmura's remarks (Marmura, [1991], pp. 338b–339a) on Gutas' translation of this passage (Gutas [1988], p. 50, n. 1). *Nafs* V, 5, pp. 237, 16–238, 3 [I, pp. 131, 7–132, 16], contains the quotation of α, 1, 993b7–11 (p. 238, 9–12 might be regarded as Avicenna's interpretation of α, 1, 993b7–8 in particular).

[46] The role of Δ is equally relevant in the metaphysical sections of other *summae* by Avicenna; Wisnovsky [2000], p. 202, n. 38, for example, points out that the section on causality of the *Ḥikma ʿArūḍīya* depends on *Metaph.* Δ, 1–2.

Table 8 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt	*Metaphysics* Δ
IV, 2	12 **capacity, incapacity, possible and impossible**
III, 4	13 **quantity**
	14 quality
III, 10; VII, 1	15 **relative**
IV, 3	16 **complete** (**perfect**)
	17 limit
	18 that in virtue of which
	19 disposition
	20 having
	21 affection
VII, 1	22 **privation**
	23 to have
	24 to come from something
IV, 3	25 **part**
IV, 3; V, 2	26 **whole**
	27 mutilated
V, 3	28 **kind** (**genus**)
	29 false
	30 accident

Avicenna's implicit use of Δ presents three main features. First, it is extensive: Avicenna quotes, in different extents, a large portion of Δ, namely seventeen of its thirty chapters. Second, it is pervasive: implicit quotations of Δ occur in the first eight treatises of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, frequently in the non-theological part of this work, but occasionally also in OntologyC/Theology (VIII, 4); sometimes they cover entire chapters or even treatises of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: this happens in chapter III, 2 with regard to Δ, 6, and in treatise IV (IV, 1–3) with regard to Δ, 11–12, 16, 25–26.[47] Third, it is propaedeutic: the quotations often introduce the doctrine of the chapters in which they occur (as it happens in III, 10; IV, 1–3; V, 3) or the doctrine of following chapters (as it happens in III, 2 with regard to III, 3). As we have seen in Chapter 6, these features are related to Avicenna's adoption in the *Ilāhiyyāt* of a method definable as "analytical", and can be explained in the light of *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004a22–31, where Aristotle himself establishes terminological analysis as the method to be followed in the rest of the work.[48] The fact that the quotations of Δ

[47] Davidson [1979], p. 171: "Avicenna . . . used Book V of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* as a cadre for a good half of his own *Metaphysics* . . .".

[48] See Chapter 6, §2; §5.1, Text 20.

are not assembled in a single unit of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, but rather dislocated in distinct chapters of this work, might be due to the influence of Nicholas of Damascus.[49]

In what follows, the implicit quotations of Δ are grouped according to the treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt* in which they occur (Outlines 6.1–8).

Outline 6.1

I, 1, p. 7, 10–13 [p. 6, 1–7]: the four possible ways of regarding the causes—i.e. 1) as "beings" (*mawǧūdāt*); 2) as "absolute causes" (*asbāb muṭlaqa*), i.e. only as causes; 3) as "each of the four in the way proper to it"; 4) as "the group resulting from them"—appear related to Δ, 2, 1014a18–19, where Aristotle says that the causes can be taken either as combined or as simple (ἢ ὡς συμπλεκόμενα ταῦτα ἢ ὡς ἁπλῶς λεγόμενα; om. ar.). Avicenna's case 4) corresponds to Aristotle's former case (ὡς συμπλεκόμενα). On purely linguistic grounds, we could link Aristotle's latter case (ὡς ἁπλῶς λεγόμενα) with Avicenna's case 2). But since ὡς συμπλεκόμενα in Aristotle is opposite to ὡς ἁπλῶς λεγόμενα ("as individually taken"), as case 4) in Avicenna is opposite to case 3), Aristotle's latter case probably corresponds to Avicenna's case 3) rather than 2).

I, 6, p. 38, 6–10, p. 39, 6–16 [p. 44, 31–37, pp. 45, 59–46, 71]: the distinction between the Necessary Existent, which is not necessary in virtue of something else, and the possible existent, which is necessary in virtue of its cause, corresponds to Δ, 5, 1015b9–11 (distinction of necessary in virtue of a cause and necessary not in virtue of a cause).[50]

Outline 6.2

II, 1, p. 57, 4–5 [p. 65, 4–5]: the distinction between existence *per se* and existence *per accidens* is taken from *Δ, 7, 1017a7–8* (one of the examples Avicenna uses, "white", figures among the examples of being *per accidens* in 1017a15).

II, 1, p. 58, 7–9 [p. 66, 26–29]): the doctrine according to which an accident inheres in another accident because both inhere in a substance corresponds to *Δ, 7, 1017a8–22*; cp. Γ, 4, 1007a33–b16.

Outline 6.3

A passage of III, 1 (p. 95, 95, 17 [p. 68–69]), about "one" as the principle of quantity, might be related to Δ, 6, 1016b17–18; cp. I, 1, 1052b23–24.

Avicenna's extensive use of *Δ, 6* ("one") in *III, 2*—in the context of the description of the "one" and the distinction and classification of its various types—is outlined in the following table:

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[49] See Chapter 10, §4.1.

[50] See Davidson [1987], p. 291 and n. 60.

Table 9

III, 2, p. 97, 4–5	Δ, 6, 1016b2–6; I, 1, 1052b15–16
III, 2, p. 97, 5	Δ, 6, 1016b6–9
III, 2, p. 97, 7–12 (“one” by accident)	Δ, 6, 1015b17–36
III, 2, p. 97, 13–15	Δ, 6, 1016a17–32, 1016b31–1017a3
III, 2, p. 98, 2–3	Δ, 6, 1016a24–32
III, 2, p. 98, 6–7	Δ, 6, 1016b36–1017a2
III, 2, pp. 98, 12–99, 13	Δ, 6, 1015b36–1016a17
III, 2, p. 98, 14–15	Δ, 6, 1016a12–13, 15–16
III, 2, pp. 98, 16–99, 1	Δ, 6, 1016a2, 12–17
III, 2, p. 99, 1–3	Δ, 6, 1016a5–6
III, 2, p. 99, 3	Δ, 6, 1016a3
III, 2, p. 99, 3–4	Δ, 6, 1016a4
III, 2, p. 100, 6–8	Δ, 6, 1016b25–26
III, 2, p. 100, 12–13	Δ, 6, 1016b25

The definition of quantity that Avicenna proposes at the end of *III, 4* (*p. 118, 14–15* [p. 132, 60–62]) corresponds to *Δ, 13, 1020a7–8*.

Avicenna’s implicit quotation of *Δ, 15* in the first part of *III, 10* (*pp. 152, 5–154, 6* [pp. 173, 14–175, 59]) examplifies other extensive quotations of this kind. It is reported in the following table.

Table 10

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Δ, 15	Usṭāṯ’s Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 152, 5–8) As to the fact that [relation] . . . is an accident, there is no doubt about it. . . . For there is no relation unless it is accidental to substance first,		
as to father and son,	(1021a23–24) For it is in this way that a father is called father of his son.	(p. 610, 9–10) And in this way the father of a son is said father also.
or to quantity.		
[2] (p. 152, 8–10) To the relative belong the one having two different terms, and the one having [two] coincident [terms]. The		

Table 10 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Δ, 15	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[relative] having different [terms] is		
like double and half,	(1020b26) Things are relative as double to half . . .	
whereas that having coincident [terms] is like		
equal and equal,	(1021a9) . . . and so in another way are the equal . . . (1021b7) . . . e.g. equality is relative because the equal is.	(p. 609, 12–13) And are also said [according to number and the affections of number], in another way, the equal . . . (p. 611, 9–10) . . . as equalities [are relative] because the equal is.
opposite and opposite . . .		
[3] [3.1] (p. 152, 12) To the [relative] having different [terms] belong:		
[3.2] (p. 152, 12) the one whose difference is determined and ascertained, like half and double;	(1020b33–34) . . . e.g. the double is in a definite numerical relation to 1,	(p. 609, 3) . . . like the double with regard to the one; for it is a definite number.
[3.3] (p. 152, 12–13) the one [whose difference] is not ascertained, even though it is based on something ascertained, like multiple, all and part;	(1020b34–35) and that which is many times as great is in a numerical, but not in a definite, relation to 1. (1021a2–3) that which is 1 and a bit times something else is in an indefinite relation to its reciprocal, as that which is many times as great is in an indefinite relation to 1.	(p. 609, 3–4) As to the multiple number, it is not relative to a definite one. (p. 609, 7–8) As to the all and the part with regard to the deficient in the part, it is not definite, like the multiple with regard to the one.
[3.4] (p. 152, 13–14) and the one [whose	(1021a3–4) the relation of that which exceeds	(p. 609, 8–9) As to the superior with regard to

Table 10 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Δ, 15	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
difference] is not ascertained in any way, like the exceeding and the deficient,	to that which is exceeded is numerically quite indefinite.	what it is superior to, it in a universal way, is not definite according to number.
the element of a whole and the whole.		
[4] [4.1] (p. 153, 1–2) To the relative belong: that regarding quality; of it, some has coincident [terms],		
like similarity,	(1021b8) . . . and likeness [is relative] because the like is.	(p. 611, 10) . . . and also similar [things are said to be relative] on account of similarity.
and some has different [terms], like quick and slow in motion . . .		
[4.2] (p. 153, 3) [that] regarding space,		
like superior and inferior,	(1021a3–4) the relation of that which exceeds to that which is exceeded is numerically quite indefinite.	(p. 609, 8–9) As to the superior with regard to what it is superior to, it, in a universal way, is not definite according to number.
[4.3] (p. 153, 4) [and that] regarding time,	(1021a21–22) Of relations which imply capacity some further imply particular periods of time.	(p. 610, 8) . . . and [acts according to motion] are said to be relative to those according to time.
like anterior and posterior.		
[5] (p. 153, 4–6) Relatives are somehow reducible [5.1] to the divisions of equality,		
[5.2] to those according to excess and defect,	(1020b26–28) Things are relative as double to half and treble to a third, and in general that which contains	(p. 608, 7–9) Some relatives are said like double with regard to half, triple with regard to the third [part], and

Table 10 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Δ, 15	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
	something else many times to that which is contained many times in something else, and that which exceeds to that which is exceeded.	all that applies many times with regard to another that has not applied many times, and are like that which is superior with regard to that to which it is superior.
[5.3] to those according to acting and being acted upon,	(1020b28–30) and in general the active to the passive.	(p. 608, 10–11) and every agent with regard to the thing acted upon.
whose origin comes from potency,	(1021a14–16) The active and the passive imply an active and a passive capacity and the actualization of the capacities.	(p. 610, 4–5) As to things active and things acted upon, they are according to a potency to act and to be acted upon, and [according to] the acts of the potencies.
[5.4] and to those according to assimilation.		
[5.5] (p. 153, 7–8) As to those according to excess, ...		
[5.6] (p. 153, 8–9) Those according to acting and being acted upon are like father and son,	(1021a23–24) For it is in this way that a father is called father of his son.	(p. 610, 9–10) And in this way the father of a son is said father also.
the thing which cuts and the thing which is cut,	(1020b29–30) . . . and that which can cut to that which can be cut.	(p. 608, 10) . . . and the thing which cuts with regard to the thing which is cut.
and the like.	(1020b28–29) as that which can heat to that which can be heated. . . .	(p. 608, 10) Some of them are like that which heats with regard to that which is heated . . .
[5.7] (p. 153, 9) Those according to assimilation are like knowledge and thing	(1020b31–32) . . . and the knowable to knowldege and the perceptible to	(pp. 608, 11–609, 1) Some of them are like . . . the thing known with regard to knowl-

Table 10 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Δ, 15	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
known, sensation and sensible thing.	perception.	edge and the sensible thing with regard to sensation.
[5.8] For between the two assimilation occurs, since . . .		
[6] [6.1] (p. 153, 12–15) But relatives are reducible [to their main types also] in [another] way. Sometimes the two relatives are two things which do not need anything else . . .		
[6.2] (pp. 153, 15–154, 2) Sometimes it is needed that something [else] be present in each of the two realities [i.e. the two relatives] . . .		
[6.3] (p. 154, 3–6) Sometimes this thing is present in one of the two respects [i.e. one of the two relatives] and not in the other, as with the knower and the thing known.		
For in the essence of the knower a quality, i.e. knowledge, occurs, by means of which [the knower] becomes relative to the other [i.e. the thing known].		
In the essence of the thing known, on the other hand, no other thing occurs,		
and it becomes relative only because some-	(1020b29–31) but that which is measurable or	(pp. 610, 14–611, 1) As to the thing measured,

Table 10 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Δ, 15	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
thing, i.e. knowledge, occurs in that other [i.e. the knower].	knowable or thinkable is called relative because something else is related to it. For the thinkable implies that there is thought of it. lectually grasped means	the thing intellectually grasped and the thing known, it is said relative due to the fact that a certain other thing is said with regard to it. For the thing intelthat there is an intellectual grasp of it.

Avicenna's text corresponds, with some "irregularities", to Aristotle's original account, and shows, together with an obvious dependence, many aspects of originality. In section [1], Avicenna takes from Δ, 15 the example (father and son) that he provides to clarify the doctrine at stake. Likewise, the only example of the former case Avicenna is dealing with in section [2] (double and half), and one example of the latter case (equal) are taken from Δ, 15. Section [3] is the most similar to Δ, 15, amounting to a paraphrase of a passage of this chapter. The second example in [3.3] (all and part) can be explained as a sort of misunderstanding on Avicenna's part of the Arabic translation, in which the Greek τὸ ἐπιμόριον, relative to τὸ ὑπεπιμόριον, is rendered as *al-kull wa-l-ğuz'* (the all and the part, meaning: the all plus a part). The first example in [3.4] (the exceeding and the deficient) is closer to the Greek in Avicenna than in Usṭāṯ's translation, and indicates Avicenna's use of a translation different from Usṭāṯ's (see above, §1.1, Table 1 [5]); the second example, on the other hand, has no parallel in Aristotle. One of the examples of section [4.1] (similarity) is taken from Δ, 15; the only example of case [4.2] (superior and inferior) is not in the Greek text, but in the Arabic translation of Δ, 15. It is not clear whether case [4.3] is taken from Aristotle (the Arabic translation is less close to what Avicenna says than the Greek original), or is made by Avicenna, like the previous two cases. In section [5] Avicenna provides a first classification of relatives. In it, he reworks Aristotle's threefold classification of relatives at the beginning of Δ, 15, to which he adds some considerations taken from their concrete treatment in the remainder of that chapter. Avicenna adds to Aristotle's classification: (a) the

entire first item ([5.1]), meant to encompass the relatives having coincident terms (which Aristotle deals with only incidentally); (b) the heading of the fourth item (= third member in Aristotle, [5.4]), and its explanation ([5.8]); (c) some examples concerning the second item (= first member in Aristotle, [5.5]). The other sub-sections are taken from Aristotle. Avicenna's approach to Aristotle's text is synthetic and elaborative. In section [5.2], Avicenna reduces the first member of Aristotle's classification to its most general heading (excess and defect); also in this case, as in section [3.4], Avicenna's text is closer to the Greek original than Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation. Part of the second member of the classification in Aristotle becomes the heading of the third item in Avicenna (acting and being acted upon, [5.3]); a notation on potency, taken from the concrete treatment of the second member in Δ, 15, is added. The remainder of Aristotle's second member is selectively placed in a further section ([5.6]), together with an example (father and son) taken again from its concrete treatment by Aristotle. Finally, the third member in Aristotle is selectively reproduced as examples of the fourth item (knowledge and thing known, sensation and sensible thing, [5.7]). Finally, in Avicenna's second classification of relatives, section [6.3] shows a certain resemblance with a further passage of Δ, 15. For the rest, this classification has no correspective in Aristotle: Avicenna apparently takes form Aristotle the idea that the thing known is relative not because of itself, but on account of something else, i.e. on account of knowledge; but, whereas in Aristotle knowledge is the item which is relative to the thing known (cf. [5.7]), in section [6.3] this function is performed by the knower, knowledge being the quality that makes the knower relative to the thing known.

Outline 6.4

IV, 1, pp. 163, 7–164, 17 [pp. 184, 11–186, 45]: the first part of the discussion of the various types of priority and posteriority depends on *Δ, 11* (prior and posterior).[51]

IV, 3, p. 186, 4–16 [pp. 213, 73–214, 91]: the first group of meanings of "perfect" (*tāmm*) corresponds to the analysis of "complete" or "perfect" (τέλειον, *tāmm* in Usṭāṯ's translation) that Aristotle provides in *Δ, 16, 1021b12–1022a1*; cp. I, 4, 1055a10–16.[52]

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[51] See Marmura [1981], p. 66.

[52] Avicenna ascribes one of these meanings ("perfect in height") to the "common people" (*al-ğumhūr*, mentioned twice at p. 186, 7 [p. 214, 77; p. 214, 78]): he pos-

Within the discussion of "all" and "whole" in IV, 3, Avicenna's statement (p. 189, 12 [p. 217, 48–49]) that the meanings of "perfection" (*tamām*), "all" (*kull*) and "whole" (*ǧamīʿ*) are similar might be due to the fact that Aristotle's definition of "perfect" (gr. τέλειον, ar. *tāmm*) in Δ, 16, 1021b12–13, resembles that of "whole" (gr. ὅλον, ar. *kull* = "all") in Δ, 26, 1023b26–27. In Δ, 26, 1024a1–10, Aristotle deals also with "all" (gr. πᾶν, ar. *ǧamīʿ*) in similar terms.

IV, 3, pp. 189, 13–15 [p. 217, 50–52]: Avicenna applies to "all" what in *Δ, 26, 1023b27–28, 32–34*, Aristotle says with regard to "whole" in general, and one ot its two types (i.e. the whole which is continuous and limited) in particular, namely the fact of bringing to unity the many things (actual or potential) of which it consists.

IV, 3 p. 191, 1–4 [pp. 218, 81–219, 87]: the treatment of "part" corresponds to *Δ, 25, 1023b12–17, 20–22*.

Outline 6.5

V, 2, p. 212, 3–16 [pp. 244, 79–245, 97]: Avicenna adopts the distinction of two meanings of "whole" (gr. ὅλον, rendered as *kull*, "all", in Usṭāṭ's translation), namely "continuous and limited" (1023b32–34) and "universal" (1023b28–32), in *Δ, 26, 1023b28–34*. Avicenna, however, calls "all" the continuous and limited whole (cfr. IV, 3, pp. 189, 13–15).

V, 3, p. 213, 5–10 [p. 246, 00–08]: Avicenna's distinction of the various meanings of genus is taken from *Δ, 28, 1024a29–b9*.

Outline 6.6

Chapter VI, 1, with regard to its overall structure, is modeled on Δ, 2. Thus, VI, 1, p. 257, 3 [p. 291, 2–3], p. 258, 17 [p. 293, 50] (the distinction between the species of the causes and their states) is taken from Δ, 2, 1013b28–30; VI, 1, pp. 257, 7–17 [pp. 291, 10–292, 25] (enumeration of the four causes) corresponds to Δ, 2, 1013a24–b3; VI,

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sibly refers to height what Aristotle says about time in Δ, 16, 1021b13–14. Wisnovsky [2002], p. 113, points at the dependence of this passage of IV, 3 on *Metaph.* Δ, 16, but regards the arithmetical sections of Euclid's *Elements* and Nicomachus of Gerasa's *Introduction to Arithmetic* at its main sources, since "Avicenna thinks that numerical perfection . . . is the most primitive sense of the term, in contrast to Aristotle who introduces his discussion of *to teleion* by referring to the idea of quantitative completeness (i.e., wholeness, being in possession of all one's part)". However, Aristotle's example of the first meaning of "perfect" is a quantity, namely time (1021b13–14): Avicenna's idea that numerical (i.e quantitative) perfection is the most primitive sense of "perfect", therefore, might have some connection with Δ, 16. Moreover, Nicomachus' concept of numerical perfection in the *Introduction*, according to which a number is perfect when it equals the sum of its divisors (as in the case of numbers 6, 28, 496 and 8128; see D'Ooge [1926], pp. 209–212; Nicomachus of Gerasa [1959], pp. 39, 4–44, 6; *Hisāb*, p. 32, 7–20), is different from the concept of numerical perfection mentioned by Avicenna in the passage in question, according to which a number is perfect when it has a starting-point, a middle part and an end (as in the case of number 3 and all the following numbers).

1, pp. 258, 1–17 [pp. 292, 25–293, 50] (classification of causes) mirrors Δ, 2, 1013b16–28. In the classification of the causes, the distinction between hyle and subject (this latter in the sense of substratum of accidents) derives in all likelihood from Δ, 2, 1013b16 (where Aristotle calls matter ὕλη = hyle) and 1013b21 (where he calls it ὑποκείμενον = subject); cp. A, 3, 983a29–30. Matter is characterized as subject also in Z, 3, 1029a1–2; Z, 7, 1033a9–10; H, 1, 1042a26–27; H, 2, 1042b9–10. However, whereas in Aristotle matter as subject means usually "subject of transformation", in Avicenna it means "subject of accidents".

Likewise, the main theme of VI, 2 (simultaneity of true cause and effect) corresponds to Δ, 2, 1014a20–25 (the particular and actual cause is simultaneous to its effect).

In VI, 3, pp. 270, 11–271, 8 [pp. 309, 83–310, 8], the distinction of the case in which the effect derives from its cause as species from the case in which it derives from it as individual, corresponds to Δ, 2, 1014a10–13 (causes can be of individuals, of species and of genera).

VI, 4, pp. 280, 14–281, 1 [pp. 322, 74–81]: the discussion of "element" is based on *Δ, 3, 1014a26–b12*.

VI, 4, pp. 281, 14–15 [pp. 323, 99–324, 2]: Avicenna's distinction of the subject that is common to all (material) things (i.e. prime matter) from the subject that is common only to some of them is taken from *Δ, 4, 1015a7–10*.

Outline 6.7

VII, 1, pp. 303, 15–304, 5 [p. 350, 25–33]: Avicenna's account of identity and its types corresponds to Δ, 9, 1017b27–1018a9 ("identical" and related concepts); Aristotle, however, regards identity *per accidens* the identity between two accidents inherent in the same substance, or the identity between an accident and the substance in which it inheres, or between the compound of substance and accident and substance and accident taken singularly; Avicenna, on the other hand, regards identity *per accidens* the identity between two subtances in which the same accident inheres (this is probably due to the influence of the place of Δ, 15 quoted immediately afterwards). The passage *VII, 1, p. 304, 1–3* [p. 350, 27–29], in particular, i.e. Avicenna's statement that the same in quality is similar, the same in quantity is equal, the same in relation is correlated, is a quotation of *Δ, 15* ("relative"), *1021a8–12*.

VII, 1, p. 304, 6–10 [pp. 350, 34–351, 42]: the account of otherness, diversity and difference corresponds to *Δ, 9, 1018a9–15*.

VII, 1, p. 304, 10–14 [p. 351, 42–48]: Avicenna's account of the opposition and its types corresponds to *Δ, 10, 1018a22–23*.

VII, 1, pp. 304, 18–305, 9 [pp. 351, 54–352, 65]: the various types of privation are taken from *Δ, 22*.

VII, 1, p. 308, 3–15 [pp. 355, 29–356, 49]: the general account of contrariety resembles Δ, 10, 1018a25–29.

Outline 6.8
The main theme of VIII, 4, i.e. the idea of the absolute simplicity of the Necessary Existent, might be inspired by Δ, 5, 1015b11–14 (the first and main type of necessary is simple);[53] the Unmoved Mover is portrayed as a simple substance in Λ, 7, 1072a32–34.

5.6 *Book E* (Epsilon)

Avicenna's implicit use of E regards primarily the first chapter of this book: E, 1 (on the three parts of theoretical philosophy) inspires some general themes of the Prolegomena, and, together with book Γ, is the main source in the *Metaphysics* of Avicenna's scientific reshaping of metaphysics, with particular regard to the subject-matter of this discipline, its structure and its role in the system of knowledge (Outline 7.1). E, 2–3 and E, 4 (on being *per accidens* and being as "true", respectively) lay in the background of some particular points that Avicenna makes in the Introduction (I, 8), and at the beginning of OntologyS (II, 1; see Outline 7.2).

Outline 7.1
I, 1, p. 4, 7–14 [p. 2, 20–30]: the tripartition of theoretical philosophy in natural philosophy, mathematics and metaphysics derives ultimately from E, 1, 1025b18–1026a23, through the mediation of the classification of the sciences of Late Antiquity (cp. *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 14, 3–10).

I, 1, p. 4, 14 [p. 2, 29–31] (= Chapter 4, Text 1 [a]); I, 2, p. 15, 13–16 [p. 16, 95–99] (= Chapter 4, Text 4.5): Avicenna's first and fundamental characterization of metaphysics as science of totally immaterial things has its first origin in Aristotle's description of first philosophy as "theological (philosophy)" (θεολογική [φιλοσοφία]) in E, 1, 1026a19–21, as mediated by the account of metaphysics in the classification of the sciences by Neoplatonic commentators of Aristotle in Late Antiquity (see Chapter 4, §1.2, n. 20; §2.1, Text 6.1).

I, 1, p. 4, 14–17 [pp. 2, 31–3, 34]: the idea, endorsed by Avicenna in the context of the determination of the subject-matter of metaphysics, that this discipline deals with the causes and principles of the existing things, occurs in E, 1, 1025b3–4 (see Chapter 4, §1.2, Text 1 [b]–[c]; §2.1, Text 7.2; cp. Chapter 5, Text 14.2).

I, 2, pp. 10, 5–11, 2 [pp. 9, 59–10, 78]: Avicenna's view of metaphysics as the discipline that clarifies what the other sciences take for granted (i.e. the essence and existence of their subject-matters)—a doctrine on which the first argument by means of which Avicenna proves that "existent qua existent" is the subject-matter of metaphysics is based (see Chapter 4, §1.2) and which is concretely applied in *Ilāhiyyāt* II–III

[53] See Davidson [1987], pp. 293–294 and n. 77.

and V—comes from E, 1, 1025b7–18, where Aristotle states that the particular sciences do not investigate the essence of their subject-matters, nor do they deal with their existence (see Chapter 7, §5.1, Text 22).

I, 2, pp. 12, 15–13, 7 [p. 12, 18–29]; p. 13, 12–13, 16–19 [p. 13, 36–38, 42–46]; p. 14, 17–18, p. 15, 15, 8 [p. 15, 72–73, 87]: the notion of metaphysics as dealing, besides the causes and principles of the existent things, also with the properties of "existent", comes from E, 1, 1026a31–32 (see Chapter 5, §1, Table 1; §6.3, Text 12.4).

Outline 7.2

I, 8, p. 48, 6–7 [p. 55, 59–61]: one of the meanings of "true" that Avicenna distinguishes ("true" as related to statement and opinion) corresponds to E, 4, 1027b18–28.

II, 1, p. 57, 5–6 [p. 65, 5–7]: the exclusion of the realities that are *per accidens* from the scope of metaphysics on account of their infinity corresponds to what Aristotele establishes on the same issue in *E, 2, 1026b2–24* with regard to every science.

5.7 *Book Z* (Zeta)

Besides a passage of I, 5 (Outline 8.1), Avicenna quotes implicitly book Z in three main places of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: in the doctrine of substance in treatise II, which he draws from Aristotle's general account of substance in Z, 1–3 (Outline 8.2); in the doctrine of universals in treatise V, in which he reproduces Aristotle's "logical" treatment of substance in Z, 4–6, Z, 10 and Z, 15 (Outline 8.3); and in the doctrine of material and formal causality in treatise VI, in which he places several themes of Aristotle's "physical" account of substance in Z, 7–9 (Outline 8.4). In the first case, the similarity regards the general themes dealt with, even though they are treated differently; in the second case, extensive parts of the aforementioned chapters of Z are also paraphrased; in the third case, Avicenna's doctrine resembles Aristotle's on particular points. To this third context belongs also the explicit indeterminate quotation of Z discussed in §4 (Outline 3 [13]).

Outline 8.1

I, 5, p. 34, 16 [p. 40, 47–48]: the doctrine of "existent" as a notion in which its various meanings coincide according to priority and posteriority might be inspired by Z, 4, 1030a21–22 (see Chapter 9, Quotation 3).

Outline 8.2

II, 1, pp. 57, 7–58, 4 [pp. 65, 8–66, 23]: the theme of the priority of substance over the accidents is the same as the one dealt with by Aristotle in Z, 1; cp. Γ, 2, 1003a33–b10.

II, 1, pp. 59, 1–60, 4 [pp. 67, 40–68, 69]: the topic of the substantiality of form, matter and compound, occurs also in Z, 3, 1029a1–3, 30–33; cp. H, 1, 1042a24–31.

Similarly, the main doctrine of II, 4, namely the anteriority of form over matter, expressed in its title (p. 80, 3 [p. 82, 26–27]; cp. p. 88, 13 [p. 101, 9]) has as its inspiring source *Metaphysics* Z, 3, 1029a5–6 ("Therefore if the form is prior to the matter and more real . . ."). As to the doctrine of form as the cause of matter, by means of which its anteriority over matter is argued (II, 4, p. 85, 3 [p. 98, 42]), it might be inspired by what Aristotle states in Z, 17, 1041a32–b33; in this passage, however, the form is described by Aristotle as the cause of the matter's being something (for example as the cause explaining why the matter of a house is a house), whereas in Avicenna it is portrayed as the cause of the matter's existence.

Outline 8.3

Doctrinal quotations of Z occur in the first seven chapters of *Ilāhiyyāt* V. The definition of the first type of "universal" in V, 1, p. 195, 6 [p. 227, 7–8], for example, can be compared to the one provided by Aristotle in Z, 13, 1038b11–12. Likewise, we may wonder whether the main doctrine of V, 1–2, namely the rebuttal of extra-mental universality, is related to Aristotle's denial of the substantiality of universals in Z, 13, Z, 16, 1040b23–27, 1041a3–5, and his criticism of Plato's ideas (which are supposedly both substances and universals) in Z, 14–16 (Avicenna mentions Plato's ideas in V, 1, p. 204, 5 [p. 236, 4] and announces the explicit criticism of Plato on this issue, occurring in VII, 2–3, in V, 2, p. 211, 8–9 [p. 244, 63–65]). Avicenna's general account of universals in V, 1–2, however, does not seem to rely on Aristotle's doctrine of universality in Z, as it is witnessed by p. 195, 11–15 [pp. 227, 12–228, 19], where the Sun and the Earth are presented as examples of the third type of universal, against Z, 15, 1040a34–b2, where the universality of the Sun is denied (cp. *De Caelo* A, 9 about the world's unicity). Similarly, the main theme of V, 3, i.e. the distinction between genus and matter, is alluded to, but only *en passant*, in Z, 12, 1038a5–8; Z, 13, 1038b5–6; it is resumed by Porphyry in the *Isagoge* (Porphyry [1887], p. 11, 15). Textual quotations of Z occur in V, 8–9, namely within the extensive analysis of definition (V, 7–9) that Avicenna connects with the treatment of the the universal "species" (V, 5).[54] Thus, in *V, 8, pp. 243, 4–244, 18* [pp. 272, 15–274, 56], Avicenna deals with the relationship of substance and accidents with defintion along the lines of *Z, 4–5*. What immediately follows (V, 8, pp. 244, 19–245, 13 [pp. 274, 57–275, 75]—namely the discussion of the case in which the definition

[54] In some Arabic manuscripts and in the Latin translation, chapters V, 7–8 precede chapter V, 6 (devoted to the differentia).

is identical with the thing defined and the cases in which it is not—is the same theme dealt with by Aristotle in Z, 6, even though it is treated differently by Avicenna. The continuation (*V, 8, pp. 245, 14–247, 12* [pp. 275, 75–278, 29], i.e. the doctrine according to which particular things have a quiddity but no definition, corresponds to *Z, 10, 1035b34–1036a8 and Z, 15*. Finally, chapter *V, 9* (the relation of the definition with its parts) mirrors *Z, 10*.

Outline 8.4
The connotation of matter and form in terms, respectively, of potentiality and actuality—a recurrent theme of treatise VI (see VI, 1, p. 257, 7–9 [p. 291, 10–14]; p. 258, 12–15 [p. 293, 41–47]; VI, 4, p. 278, 12–13 [p. 320, 24–25]; p. 280, 1–4 [pp. 321, 52–322, 73]; p. 282, 6–14 [pp. 324, 13–325, 26]; see also II, 4, pp. 83, 4–85, 3 [pp. 96, 98–98, 42]; pp. 88, 13–89, 12 [pp. 101, 10–102, 33])—comes from texts like Z, 7, 1032a20–22 (matter is the cause of potentiality in something else); H, 1, 1042a27–28, H, 2, 1042b10 (matter is itself potential); H, 2, 1042b10–11, 1043a12–13, 1043a27–28, H, 3, 1043b1–2 (form is actuality).

VI, 4, p. 281, 5–14 [p. 323, 87–99]—where Avicenna distinguishes the cases in which something can be said to derive from its matter (like "the door derives from wood") from the cases in which it cannot, and the cases in which something can bear the adjective taken from its subject (like "wooden" from wood) from the cases in which it cannot—is taken from *Z, 7, 1033a5–23*.

VI, 4, p. 282, 2–5 [p. 324, 7–12]—where Avicenna distinguishes the matter of natural things, which is moved by their nature (= their form), from the matter of artifacts, which is moved by an external agent—is inspired by Z, 9, 1034a9–21 (in the lines immediately preceding, however, Avicenna criticizes what Aristotle states in 1034a11–13; see the explicit indeterminate quotation in §4 outline 3 [13]).

VI, 4, p. 282, 15–18 [p. 325, 26–32]: the doctrine of the identity between formal and efficient causes in artificial productions is taken from *Z, 7, 1032a24–25, a32–b13, b21–23*.

5.8 *Book H* (Eta)

Besides the *loci* mentioned in the previous section, Avicenna's implicit use of H appears to be limited to the choice of examples elucidating the doctrine of matter in VI, 4.

Outline 9
VI, 4, pp. 281, 14–15 [pp. 323, 99–324, 2]: the examples illustrating the distinction of the subject that is common to all (material) things (i.e. prime matter) from the subject that is common only to some of them are inspired by H, 5, 1044b31–32, 34–36, 1045a2, 5–6.

VI, 4, p. 279, 11–12 [p. 321, 40–42]: the electuary as an example of mixture of different material ingredients appears to be the medical correspective of the honey-water mentioned by Aristotle in H, 2, 1042b15–17.

VI, 4, p. 279, 13 [p. 321, 42–43]: the example of wood and stone as matter of the house has a parallel in H, 2, 1043 a 8–9.

5.9 *Book Θ* (Theta)

All the implicit quotations of Θ occur in a single chapter of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, i.e. chapter IV, 2, dealing with potentiality. This is the only case in which a book of the *Metaphysics* is quoted comprehensively and continuously (despite some differences in arrangement) in a limited portion of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Most quotations occur in the second part of this chapter (IV, 2, pp. 173, 13–185, 17 [pp. 198, 58–213, 69]). They are summarized in Table 11.

Some similarities between Avicenna's quotations of the aforementioned passages of the *Metaphysics* and Usṭāṯ's translation of these same passages are noteworthy. Usṭāṯ, for example, renders "Megarics" (οἱ Μεγαρικοί) in Θ, 3, 1046b29, as *ġārīqūn* (*Tafsīr*, p. 1124, 9);[55] Avicenna names these philosophers in a significantly similar way (*ġārīqū*, IV, 2, p. 176, 14 [om.]).[56] Likewise, Avicenna's paraphrase of *Metaph.* Θ, 8, 1050b6–8, in IV, 2, p. 183, 13–14 (Table 12), displays a terminology that is similar to the one adopted in Usṭāṯ's translation (the main translation in Averroes' *Tafsīr*), whereas it differs in significant ways from the terminology of the "other translation" reported by Averroes (probably Isḥāq's translation).

Both the rendering of "eternal things" as *al-mu'abbada*, and the opposition between them and the things that "perish" (*tafsudu*), are common to Avicenna's paraphrase and Usṭāṯ's translation. The only similarity with Isḥāq's translation lies in the rendering of the idea of priority by means of the verb *tataqaddama*, rather than by means of the preposition *qabla*.

5.10 *Book I* (Iota)

In addition to the explicit indeterminate quotation already examined (see above, §4, Outline 3 [4]), book I is implicitly quoted in two

[55] This rendering is probably the consequence of the (mis)reading of οἱ Μεγαρικοί as *οἱ μὲν Γαρικοί.

[56] See Appendix B, I.1.

Table 11

Ilāhiyyāt IV, 2	*Metaphysics* Θ
p. 171, 6	cp. Θ, 1, 1046a26; Θ, 2, 1046b6
p. 173, 13–14	Θ, 2, 1046b1–2; Θ, 5, 1048a2–4
pp. 173, 14–174, 1	Θ, 2, 1046b4–9
pp. 174, 1–175, 4	Θ, 5, 1048a5–24
pp. 175, 4–176, 2	Θ, 7, 1049a14–17
p. 176, 3–14	Θ, 5, 1047b31–1048a5
pp. 176, 14–177, 5	Θ, 3, 1046b29–30, 1047a14–17, 1047a7–10
p. 177, 5–7	Θ, 8, 1050b9–12
p. 183, 12–13	Θ, 8, 1049b17–19
p. 183, 13–14	Θ, 8, 1050b6–8
p. 183, 14–15	Θ, 8, 1049b10–12; cp. 1051a2–3
p. 183, 15	Θ, 8, 1050b2–3
p. 184, 1–2	Θ, 8, 1050b16–18
p. 184, 2	Θ, 8, 1050b3–4; cp. 1050a4
p. 184, 3–4	Θ, 8, 1049b24–25
p. 184, 4–5	Θ, 8, 1050b4–6
p. 184, 6	Θ, 8, 1049b29
p. 184, 8–9	Θ, 8, 1050a2–3
p. 184, 9–10	Θ, 8, 1049b19–24
p. 184, 12–13	Θ, 8, 1049b12–14
p. 184, 16	Θ, 8, 1050a9–10
p. 185, 9–10	Θ, 9, 1051a4–5, 15–16
p. 185, 16–17	Θ, 8, 1051a2–3

main places of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: in several chapters of treatise III (Outline 10.1), especially within the discussion of "one" and "many" and their definitions (III, 3), number and the various types of multiplicity (III, 5), the opposition between "one" and "many" and the opposition between quantitative concepts like "greater", "smaller" and "equal" (III, 6); and in chapter VII, 1 (Outline 10.2), in the context of the analysis of otherness and difference, and of the main types of opposition (possess and privation, contrariety, contradiction). In some cases, Avicenna modifies Aristotle's doctrine in order to make it more coherent.

Outline 10.1

III, 1, p. 95, 16–17 [p. 107, 67–68]: the doctrine of the tight relationship between "one" and "existent" corresponds to I, 2, 1054a13; cp. Γ, 2, 1003b22–23.

III, 1, p. 95, 17: the doctrine of "one" as the principle of quantity corresponds to I, 1, 1052b18–19, 1053b4–6.

III, 2, p. 103, 7–8 [p. 114, 17–18]: the idea that the correspondence between "one" and "existent" is due to the fact that both are predicable of each of the categories is taken from I, 2, 1054a13–15.

Table 12

Ilāhiyyāt IV, 2, p. 183, 13–14	*Metaph.* Θ, 8, 1050b6–8	Usṭāṭ translation, p. 1196, 2–3	Other translation (Isḥāq), p. 1198, 10–11
As to the universal things, or the eternal [things] (*al-mu'abbada*) that do not perish (*allatī lā tafsudu*) despite being particular, they are not preceded (*lā tataqaddamuhā*) at all by [the things] that are in potentiality.	[. . .] for eternal things are prior in substance to perishable things, and no eternal thing exists potentially.	[for] the eternal things (*al-ašyā' al-mu'abbada*) are prior (*qabla*) in substance to the things that perish (*allatī tafsudu*), and no eternal things (*šay' mu'abbad*) is in potentiality.	[. . .] the eternal [things] (*al-azaliyya*) are prior (*mutaqaddima*) in [their] substances to the sensible [things] (*al-maḥsūsāt*), and none among the eternal [things] (*min al-azaliyya*) is in potentiality.

III, 3, p. 105, 1–7 [pp. 115, 41–116, 51]: Avicenna's statement that "many" is prior to "one" with regard to knowledge is a quotation of *I, 3, 1054a26–29*.

III, 5, pp. 123, 13–124, 13 [p. 138, 76–139, 98]: Avicenna's consideration of number 2 as the first number mirrors *I, 6, 1056b25–32*.

III, 5, pp. 124, 14–125, 3 [p. 139, 99–07]: the various types of multiplicity are taken from I, 6, 1056b16–25.

III, 6 (pp. 126, 4–130, 4 [pp. 139, 9–144, 8]): the topic that Avicenna investigates—namely whether the opposition between "one" and "many" is an opposition of contrariety, possess and privation, contradiction, or relation—corresponds to the theme dealt with by Aristotle in I, 3, 1054a20–26; I, 6, 1056b3–14, 1056b32–1057a17; Aristotle, however, portrays the opposition between "one" and "many" as an opposition of contrariety (I, 3), and of contrariety and relation (I, 6), whereas Avicenna excludes both possibilities.

III, 6, pp. 130, 5–7 [pp. 144, 9–12]: the statement that "one" and "many" are opposite as measure and measured thing are corresponds to *I, 6, 1056b20–22, 32–33*.

III, 6, pp. 130, 10–132, 13 [pp. 145, 16–147, 67]: the description of "one" as measure of things is taken from discrete passages of *I, 1, 1053a8–18, 24–27*. In detail: III, 6, p. 130, 10–12: I, 1, 1053a24–27; III, 6, p. 131, 2–12: I, 1, 1053a8–12; III, 6, p. 131, 13–14: I, 1, 1053a12–13; III, 6, p. 131, 15–16: I, 1, 1053a13; III, 6, p. 132, 3–13: I, 1, 1053a14–18.

III, 6, p. 132, 13–18 [pp. 147, 67–148, 75]: the exposition and criticism of Protagoras' view of man as the measure of things is based on *I, 1, 1053a31–b3*. In detail: III, 6, p. 132, 13–14: I, 1, 1053a31–32; III, 6, p. 132, 14–15: I, 1, 1053a35–b3; III, 6, p. 132, 15–16: I, 1, 1053a32–33.

III, 6, pp. 133, 1–15 [pp. 148, 76–149, 95]: the discussion of the opposition between greater, smaller and equal corresponds to I, 5, even though the opinion that Avicenna reports at p. 133, 5–6 (greater and smaller do not imply the existence of the equal) seems incompatible with I, 5, 1056a12, 24, where Aristotle states that the equal is intermediate to the large and the small.

Outline 10.2

VII, 1, p. 304, 8 ("other" as opposite to identical): I, 3, 1054b14–16.

VII, 1, p. 304, 9–10 (difference between "other" and "different"): I, 3, 1054b23–27.

VII, 1, p. 304, 15 (possess and privation are a type of contradiction): I, 4, 1055b3–8.

VII, 1, p. 304, 15–16 (contrariety is a type of possess and privation): I, 4, 1055a33–35, b13–14.

VII, 1, pp. 305, 13–306, 4 (contrary things share the same genus): *I, 4, 1055a27–29; I, 7, 1057a28–30.*

VII, 1, p. 308, 4–15 (contrariety as the greatest difference): I, 4, 1055a3–17, 24–30.

VII, 1, pp. 308, 15–309, 7 (unicity of the contrary of something): *I, 4, 1055a19–23.*

VII, 1, p. 309, 8–13 (the status of the intermediate terms between contraries): *I, 7, 1057a21–22, 24–26.*

VII, 1, p. 309, 13–16 [p. 357, 70–76] (possess and privation are a type of contradiction; contradiction does not entail the existence of intermediate terms): I, 7, 1057a33–34; I, 4, 1055b1–4, 7–9. Avicenna holds that also possess and privation, like contradiction, do not entail the existence of intermediate terms, whereas Aristotle appears to allow this possibility (1055b9–11). Aristotle, however, refers to the logical possibility of something escaping the alternative between possess and privation, whereas Avicenna excludes the existence of intermediate steps in the process connecting the states of possess and privation.

5.11 *Book K* (Kappa)

Due to the nature of this book, which is a duplicate of other Aristotelian material, and the style of Avicenna's quotations, which are never literal replicas of the quoted texts, it is impossible to assess whether a certain quotation of the *Metaphysics* is taken from K or from its parallel place in the *Metaphysics*. For this reason, book K will not be taken into account in the present survey.

5.12 *Book Λ* (Lambda)

Besides the five explicit determinate quotations examined in §3.2, several implicit quotations of Λ occur in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. They all belong

to the category of doctrinal quotations. This creates the possibility of an indirect reception of Aristotle's natural theology by Avicenna, mainly through Alexander of Aphrodisias' *Fī Mabādi' al-kull*. The non-theological part of Λ (chapters 1–5) lays possibly in the background of some tenets of Avicenna's doctrine of causality in treatise VI (Outline 11.3); the theological part of this book (Λ, 6–10) inspires Avicenna's general conception of God in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Outline 11.1), is the source of some opinions reported by Avicenna in IV, 2 and VIII, 6 (Outline 11.2), and shapes his particular treatment of theological issues in treatises VIII–IX (Outline 11.4). Thus, despite Avicenna's use of the *Theologia Aristotelis* and the *Liber de Causis* in OntologyC/Theology (see Chapter 11), the framework of this section of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is Aristotelian rather than Neoplatonic: God is, at the same time, One, Necessary Existent and First Intellect as in Λ, and there is no hierarchy of One (or Good), Being, and Intellect as in Plotinus or Proclus.

Outline 11.1
Three main features that Avicenna ascribes to God from the very beginning of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (necessary existence, simplicity and unicity) have a correspective, among other sources, in Λ.

For God as Necessary Existent (as in I, 6 and elsewhere), see Λ, 7, 1072b10.[57]

For the absence of any distinction between essence and existence in the Necessary Existent (as in I, 6 and elsewhere), see the description of the Unmoved Mover as a simple substance in Λ, 7, 1072a32; cp. also Plotinus, *Enneads*, V, 4 (7), 1, 5, 10–15, corresponding to *Epistola de scientia divina* 159, 162.

For the unicity of the Necessary Existent (as in I, 6–7 and elsewhere), see Λ, 8, 1074a36–37; cp. also Plotinus, *Enneads*, V, 4 (7), 1, 15–16, corresponding to *Epistola de scientia divina* 163.

Outline 11.2
IV, 2, p. 183, 8–10 [pp. 210, 5–211, 8]: the opinion of a group of ancient philosophers, reported by Avicenna, according to which the original element was darkness, or the abyss, or something infinite constantly at rest and then moved, or Anaxagoras' mixture, appears to be taken from Λ, 6, 1071b26–28, 1072a7–8: there Aristotle mentions night (1071b27; 1072a8), chaos (1072a8) the state in which all things are together (1071b28), and Anaxagoras' νοῦς (1072a4–6), when he discusses whether potentiality is prior to actuality.[58]

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[57] See Davidson [1987], p. 289 and n. 48.

[58] Avicenna ascribes to Anaxagoras the doctrine of mixture (*al-ḫalīṭ*): within the

VIII, 6, p. 357, 16–17 [p. 415, 32–34]: Λ, 6, 1071b37–1072a3 (see Chapter 6, §1.1, Text 2).

Outline 11.3

VI, 1, p. 257, 7–9 [p. 291, 10–14]: Avicenna's distinction of internal causes (matter and form) and external causes (agent and end) can be compared with Λ, 4, 1070b22–30. In this passage of Λ, however, the internal principles include, besides matter and form, also privation, whereas the external ones are restricted to the sole moving cause.[59]

VI, 2, p. 265, 1–2 [p. 301, 17–19]: Avicenna's doctrine that true causes are simultaneous to their effects, whereas the causes preceding their effects are not true causes, can be regarded as an implicit criticism of Λ, 3, 1070a21–22, where the moving causes are depicted as "existing before" (προγεγενημένα) the effect, whereas the formal causes are portrayed as existing "at the same time" (ἅμα).

Outline 11.4

VIII, 6, pp. 356, 16–357, 5 [p. 414, 95–10]: the doctrine of the identity in God of intellection (or intellect, *ʿaql*), subject of intellection (*ʿāqil*) and object of intellection (or intelligible, *maʿqūl*)—a doctrine resumed in VIII, 7, p. 368, 1–2 [p. 430, 29–30]; p. 369, 4–5 [p. 432, 65])[60]—is originally taken from Λ, 7, 1072b19–21, Λ, 9, 1075a3–5—as Avicenna's *Šarḥ Lām* witnesses (pp. 31, 22–32, 15)—even though it is mediated by Alexander, *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*, pp. 94, 16–110, 14, and al-Fārābī's *Mabādiʾ* (pp. 70, 1–72, 6).

VIII, 7, p. 366, 13–17 [p. 428, 90–97]: the Necessary Existent's productive intellection is Its life: cp. Λ, 7, 1072b26–30.

VIII, 7, pp. 368, 13–370, 7 [pp. 431, 50–433, 02]: the Necessary Existent is beautiful, object of desire, object of love: cp. Λ, 7, 1072a26–b4.

VIII, 7, pp. 369, 1–370, 7 [pp. 431, 58–433, 02]: the Necessary Existent experiences pleasure: cp. Λ, 7, 1072b14–26.[61]

Metaphysics, this doctrine of Anaxagoras is mentioned in Α, 8, 989a30–b21; Γ, 5, 1009a26–27 (cp. Κ, 6, 1063b25–30); see also Γ, 4, 1007b25–26; Ι, 6, 1056b28–30; Λ, 2, 1069b20–21. The "abyss" (*al-hāwiyyatu*) in Avicenna's text (IV, 2, p. 183, 9 [p. 210, 6]) is the correspective of χάος in Λ, 6, 1072a8 (Ar. transl., p. 1575, 4, bottom of page: *huwiyatun*, pro: *hāwiyyatun*).

[59] See Jolivet [1991], p. 63, n. 4. The post-Aristotelian historical background of this doctrine is excellently canvassed by Wisnowsky [2003b]. At p. 61, Wisnowsky points at another possible source of this passage, namely Δ, 1, 1013a4–10, 19–20; in this passage, however, whereas the external cause is clearly the moving one, the internal cause appears to be other than matter or form. More closely related to Avicenna's doctrine is probably Δ, 2, 1013a24–25, even though only matter is mentioned there as the internal (ἐνυπάρχον) cause.

[60] In IX, 7, p. 426, 9–10 [p. 511, 93–94]), Avicenna appears to apply this same identity to the human soul (but see *Nafs* V, 6, p. 239, 7–8 [II, p. 134, 46] V, 6, p. 241, 1 [II, p. 138, 85]); in this case the source might be *De Anima* Γ, 4, 429b26–29, 430a2–9.

[61] See Davidson [1987], p. 298 and n. 99.

IX, 2–3: these chapters are meant as an explanation of Aristotle's doctrine of the causes of the celestial movement in *Metaphysics* Λ, 7–8, *Physics* and *De Caelo*, as it appears from the explicit quotations of these works occurring towards the end of these chapters (see above, §3.2). More specifically, the doctrine of IX, 2, p. 387, 8–13 [p. 455, 4–14], according to which the First Mover is totally unmoved and causes the celestial movement by being desired and loved, by being aimed at, and by being good, corresponds to Λ, 7, 1072a24–b4.

The remark in IX, 2, p. 387, 17 [p. 455, 20–21], p. 388, 1–2 [pp. 455, 22–456, 24]—i.e. the object of the desire coming from opinion is what is believed to be good, whereas the object of the desire coming from intellect is the true good—resembles Λ, 7, 1072a27–28.

IX, 2, p. 389, 13–390, 1 [p. 458, 71–80]: Avicenna's point, namely that the celestial body is potential with regard to its place although not to its substance, can be compared to Λ, 7, 1072b4–7.

IX, 4–7: similarities regarding the themes dealt with, rather than real quotations, are detectable in these chapters. The topic of the derivation of the world from the First Principle (IX, 4–5) and the subsequent theodicy (IX, 6), for example, might correspond to Λ, 10, where Aristotle discusses how the good is present in the universe by means of the universe's order (1075a11–25), and criticizes the predecessors' view about the derivation of things from their principles (1075a25–1076a4).

IX, 7, p. 428, 16 [p. 515, 66–67]: the parenthetical remark about the fact that desire follows opinion, corresponds to Λ, 7, 1072a29.

5.13 *Book M* (Mu)

The implicit quotations of book M, as those of book N, occur mainly in VII, 2–3 (see Outline 12.3), before the quotations of α and Λ in OntologyC/Theology: Avicenna draws from M the opinions of the thinkers he expounds and criticizes in these two chapters. In the rest of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, the doctrine of M is sometimes endorsed by Avicenna (see Outline 12.1), sometimes contradicted (see Outline 12.2).

Outline 12.1
VI, 5, p. 299, 14–17 [p. 347, 98–05]: the doctrine that mathematical things have also the final cause—called "perfection", *tamām*, and meant as the good resulting from their symmetry, delimitation and order—comes from M, 3, 1078a31–b5; cp. Λ, 7, 1072b1–3.

Outline 12.2
III, 5, p. 119, 6 [p. 132, 70]: the doctrine that numbers exist in real things goes against the main tenet of M, 2.

Outline 12.3
Besides the places of M already mentioned in §5.1—to which Avicenna

might have referred together with (or, less likely, in alternative to) their parallel *loci* in book A—the following passages appear to be quoted by Avicenna on their own.

In VII, 2, p. 311, 8–13 [pp. 359, 15–360, 24], the view of those who believe that mathematical entities, rather than ideas, are separate, appears to be taken from M, 1, 1076a17–19, 21–22; M, 9, 1086a2–3.

VII, 2, p. 313, 6–14 [p. 362, 70–82]: the three ways of deriving number from unity that Avicenna reports correspond in part to M, 6, 1080a15–35.

VII, 2, p. 314, 2–3 [p. 363, 89–91]: the opinion mentioned by Avicenna ("Some think that between these numerical forms and the ideas there is a distinction") mirrors M, 1, 1076a19–20.

VII, 2, p. 314, 4 [p. 363, 93–94]: the Pythagoreans' opinion reported by Avicenna ("Most of the Pythagoreans think the mathematical number to be the principle, without, however, being separate") corresponds to M, 6, 1080b16–18 (for number as principle, according to the Pythagoreans, see A, 5, 985b24–986a3; 987a19; A, 6, 987b24–25; for number as not separate, see A, 6, 987b27–31; M, 8, 1083b10–11; for both points of view, see N, 3, 1090a22–23).

VII, 2, p. 314, 4–5 [p. 363, 94–96]: the further opinion of the Pythagoreans reported by Avicenna corresponds to M, 8, 1083b11–19, in a peculiar way: in this place of M Aristotle opposes the Pythagorean opinion that bodies are composed of mathematical numbers (see Ross [1924], vol. II, p. 441); Avicenna seems to apply to the Pythagoreans some statements declared false in Aristotle's refutation (without any explicit reference to the Pythagoreans, though), as if they were tenets of Pythagorean philosophy denied by Aristotle. In particular: "geometrical forms are composed from unities" = μέγεθος δὲ ἐξ ἀδιαιρέτων συγκεῖσθαι πῶς δυνατόν; 1083b15–16; "they exclude, therefore, that extensions can be bisected" = οὔτε γὰρ ἄτομα μεγέθη λέγειν ἀληθές 1083b13 (on this point, see also M, 6, 1080b29).

VII, 3, p. 318, 13–18 [p. 369, 14–23]: Avicenna's criticism of those who regard geometrical entities as principles is based on M, 2, 1077a20–24 (p. 318, 13–15: geometrical quantities cannot be separated from each other), and M, 2, 1077a31–36 (p. 318, 15–18: the line is not the cause of the body).

VII, 3, p. 318, 18–319, 13 [pp. 369, 24–370, 42]: the criticism of those who regard arithmetical entities as separate relies on M, 8, 1084a21–25 (pp. 318, 18–319, 3: the differences among things cannot be explained according to a greater or smaller number), M, 9, 1083a1–17 (p. 319, 4–9: unities are neither equal nor different from each other), and M, 8, 1083b36–1084b2 (p. 319, 10–13: a separate number would be neither finite nor infinite).

VII, 3, p. 321, 17–18 [p. 373, 2–3]: Avicenna's rejection of the Pythagorean doctrine that numbers are principles of extensions resembles M, 8, 1083b13–16. The following argument, according to which the matter of geometrical entities can be neither common to all nor

different for each one (VII, 3, p. 322, 2–7 [p. 373, 4–19]), used against those who regard numbers as principles of geometrical entities, is taken from M, 9, 1085a35–b4.

VII, 3 (VII, 3, p. 324, 3–5 [om.]): the proof of the fact that goodness is present also in mathematical things corresponds to M, 3, 1078a36–b2.

5.14 *Book N* (Nu)

In comparison with the quotations of book M, those of book N are fewer. Besides the *loci* mentioned in §5.1 and §5.13, only two passages of the *Ilāhiyyāt* appear to depend on N.

Outline 13

VII, 2, p. 313, 1–3 [pp. 361, 61–362, 65]: the opinion of those who regard excess, defect and equality as principles, resembles N, 1, 1087b3–9, 17–18.

VII, 2, p. 313, 4–6 [p. 362, 66–70]: the two opinions reported immediately afterwards—some regard number as principle of extension, others regard number and extensions as independent from one another—are taken from N, 3, 1090b13–24.

6 Overview of Avicenna's reordering of the content of the *Metaphysics*

The quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* show both an extensive use of this work and a radical recasting of its content. Avicenna quotes, in different ways, all the books of the *Metaphysics*, but according to an order that is strikingly different from their original disposition in Aristotle's work. This aspect of Avicenna's approach to the content of the *Metaphysics*—parallel to his thorough revision of the structure of this work (see Chapter 5)—represents the main trait of originality of the *Ilāhiyyāt* with regard to the other sections of the *Šifāʾ*, in which Avicenna reproduces *grosso modo* the "table of contents" of Aristotle's corresponding treatise.

The data of the previous sections (and those of Chapters 9–10) are gathered in the following two tables. Explicit determinate quotations are recorded in bold; explicit indeterminate quotations in italics; doctrinal quotations are distinguished from textual quotations by the siglum "cp." preceding the place of the *Metaphysics* (Table 13), or of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Table 14), to which they refer.

Table 13

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*
Prolegomena	
I, 1, pp. 3, 11–4, 6	cp. α, 1, 993b20–23
I, 1, p. 4, 7–14	cp. E, 1, 1025b18–1026a23
I, 1, p. 4, 14; I, 2, p. 15, 13–16	cp. E, 1, 1026a19–21
I, 1, p. 4, 14–17	cp. E, 1, 1025b3–4
I, 1, p. 5, 7	cp. α, 1, 993b19–20
I, 1, p. 5, 8–10	cp. A, 2, 982a21–b10
I, 1, p. 5, 10–15	cp. A, 2, 982b7–8
I, 1, p. 7, 6–9	cp. A, 2, 982a21–b10
I, 1, p. 7, 10–13	cp. Δ, 2, 1014a18–19
I, 2, pp. 10, 5–11, 2	cp. E, 1, 1025b7–18
I, 2, pp. 10, 6–13, 19	cp. Γ, 1–2 *passim*
I, 2, pp. 12, 15–13, 7; p. 13, 12–13, 16–19; p. 14, 17–18, p. 15, 15, 8	cp. E, 1, 1026a31–32
I, 2, p. 13, 12–13	Γ, 1, 1003a20–21
I, 2, p. 16, 13–20	Γ, 2, 1004b17–26
Introduction	
I, 5, p. 31, 7	cp. Γ, 2, 1003b32–33
I, 5, p. 31, 8–9	cp. Γ, 2, 1003a33
I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2	Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19
I, 5, p. 34, 16	cp. Z, 4, 1030a21–22
I, 5, p. 35, 10–12	cp. Δ, 5, 1015a33–35
I, 6, p. 38, 6–10, p. 39, 6–16	cp. Δ, 5, 1015b9–11
I, 8, p. 48, 6–7	cp. E, 4, 1027b18–28
I, 8, p. 48, 7–9	cp. α, 1, 993b28–30
I, 8, pp. 48, 12–54, 2	Γ, 3–5 *passim*
I, 8, p. 54, 3–5	B, 2, 997a2–11
I, 8, p. 54, 17	cp. Γ, 4, 1006a10–11; Γ, 6, 1011a13
OntologyS-HenologyS	
II, 1, p. 57, 4–5	Δ, 7, 1017a7–8, 15
II, 1, p. 57, 5–6	E, 2, 1026b2–24
II, 1, pp. 57, 7–58, 4	cp. Z, 1
II, 1, p. 58, 7–9	Δ, 7, 1017a8–22
II, 1, pp. 59, 1–60, 4	cp. Z, 3, 1029a1–3, 30–33
II, 2, p. 63, 11–12	Δ, 6, 1016b27–28
II, 2	cp. Z, 3, 1029a5–6
III, 1, p. 95, 16–17	cp. Γ, 2, 1003b22–23; I, 2, 1054a13
III, 1, p. 95, 17	cp. I, 1, 1052b18–19, 1053b4–6
III, 2	Δ, 6 *passim*
III, 2	Δ, 6 *passim*
III, 2, p. 103, 7–8	cp. I, 2, 1054a13–15; Γ, 2, 1003b24–25
III, 3, p. 105, 1–7	I, 3, 1054a26–29
III, 3, p. 105, 11–12	I, 6, 1057a3–4
III, 3, p. 106, 6	cp. Δ, 15, 1021a12
III, 4, p. 118, 1–11	cp. Δ, 13, 1020a22
III, 4, p. 118, 14–15	Δ, 13, 1020a7–8
III, 5, pp. 123, 13–124, 13	I, 6, 1056b25–32

Table 13 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*
III, 5, pp. 124, 14–125, 3	cp. I, 6, 1056b16–25
III, 6, pp. 126, 4–130, 4	cp. I, 3, 1054a20–26; I, 6, 1056b3–14, 1056b32–1057a17
III, 6, p. 128, 12–16	A, 5, 986a22–26
III, 6, pp. 130, 5–132, 13	I, 6, 1056b20–22, 32–33
III, 6, pp. 130, 10–132, 13	I, 1, 1053a8–18, 24–27
III, 6, p. 132, 13–18	I, 1, 1053a31–b3
III, 6, p. 133, 1–15	cp. I, 5 *passim*
III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6	Δ, 15 *passim*
OntologyP	
IV, 1, pp. 163, 7–164, 17	Δ, 11 *passim*
IV, 1, p. 163, 9–14	Δ, 11, 1018b12–19
IV, 2, pp. 170, 4–172, 12	Δ, 12 *passim*
IV, 2, p. 171, 6	cp. Θ, 1, 1046a26; Θ, 2, 1046b6
IV, 2, pp. 173, 13–185, 17	Θ, 2–3, 5, 7–9 *passim*
IV, 2, p. 183, 8–10	cp. Λ, 6, 1071b26–28, 1072a7–8
IV, 3, p. 186, 4–16	Δ, 16 *passim*
IV, 3, p. 187, 1–4	cp. Δ, 26, 1024a1–10
IV, 3, p. 189, 12	cp. Δ, 16, 1021b12–13; Δ, 26, 1023b26–27, 1024a1–10
IV, 3, pp. 189, 13–15	Δ, 26, 1023b27–28, 32–34
IV, 3, p. 190, 2–4	Δ, 26, 1024a1–3
V, 2, p. 212, 3–16	Δ, 26, 1023b28–34
V, 3, p. 213, 5–10	Δ, 28, 1024a29–b9
V, 8, pp. 243, 4–244, 18	Z, 4–5 *passim*
V, 8, pp. 244, 19–245, 13	cp. Z, 6
V, 8, pp. 245, 14–247, 12	Z, 10, 1035b34–1036a8; Z, 15
V, 9	Z, 10 *passim*
VI, 1, p. 257, 3; p. 258, 17	cp. Δ, 2, 1013b28–30
VI, 1, p. 257, 7–17	cp. Δ, 2, 1013a24–b3
VI, 1, p. 257, 10–17	cp. α, 1, 993b29–30
VI, 1, p. 258, 1–17	cp. Δ, 2, 1013b16–28
VI, 2	cp. Δ, 2, 1014a20–25
VI, 3, p. 268, 12–15	cp. α, 1, 993b24–25
VI, 3, pp. 270, 11–271, 8	cp. Δ, 2, 1014a10–13
VI, 3, p. 278, 5–6	α, 1, 993b26–30
VI, 4, p. 279, 1–3	cp. α, 2, 994a23–24
VI, 4, p. 279, 7	cp. α, 2, 994a24
VI, 4, p. 279, 11–12	cp. H, 2, 1042b15–17
VI, 4, p. 279, 13	cp. H, 2, 1043a8–9
VI, 4, p. 279, 15–17	Δ, 2, 1013b20–21
VI, 4, pp. 280, 14–281, 1	Δ, 3, 1014a26–b12
VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4	B, 3, 998a20–23, b9–11; 998b19–21, 999a4–5
VI, 4, p. 281, 5–14	Z, 7, 1033a5–23
VI, 4, p. 281, 14–15	Δ, 4, 1015a7–10; cp. H, 5, 1044b31–32, 34–36, 1045a2, 5–6
VI, 4, pp. 281, 17–282, 1	cp. Z, 9, 1034a11–13
VI, 4, p. 282, 2–5	cp. Z, 9, 1034a9–21

Table 13 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*
VI, 4, p. 282, 15–18	Z, 7, 1032a24–25, a32–b13, b21–23
VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 4; p. 300, 7–8	B, 2, 996a20–b3, 10–13
VI, 5, p. 299, 4–5	cp. Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19
VI, 5, p. 299, 14–17	cp. M, 3, 1078a31–b5
HenologyP	
VII, 1, p. 303, 5–6	Γ, 1, 1003a21–22
VII, 1, p. 303, 6–14	Γ, 2, 1003b22–1004a20
VII, 1, pp. 303, 15–304, 5	cp. Δ, 9, 1017b27–1018a9
VII, 1, p. 304, 1–3	Δ, 15, 1021a8–12
VII, 1, p. 304, 6–10	Δ, 9, 1018a9–15
VII, 1, p. 304, 8	cp. I, 3, 1054b14–16
VII, 1, p. 304, 9–10	cp. I, 3, 1054b23–27
VII, 1, p. 304, 10–14	Δ, 10, 1018a22–23
VII, 1, p. 304, 15	cp. I, 4, 1055b3–8
VII, 1, p. 304, 15–16	cp. I, 4, 1055a33–35, b13–14
VII, 1, pp. 304, 18–305, 9	Δ, 22 *passim*
VII, 1, pp. 305, 13–306, 4	I, 4, 1055a27–29; I, 7, 1057a28–30
VII, 1, p. 308, 3–15	cp. Δ, 10, 1018a25–29; I, 4, 1055a3–17, 24–30
VII, 1, pp. 308, 15–309, 7	I, 4, 1055a19–23
VII, 1, p. 309, 8–13	I, 7, 1057a21–22, 24–26
VII, 1, p. 309, 13–16	cp. I, 7, 1057a33–34; I, 4, 1055b1–4, 7–9
VII, 2, pp. 310, 14–311, 8	cp. A, 6, 987a32–b10; A, 9, 990b11–13
VII, 2, p. 311, 8–13	cp. M, 1, 1076a17–19, 21–22; M, 9, 1086a2–3
VII, 2, p. 311, 14–15	A, 6, 987b14–16
VII, 2, p. 312, 16–17	cp. A, 6, 987b24–25, 27–31
VII, 2, p. 312, 17–18	cp. A, 6, 987b25–27
VII, 2, p. 312, 18	cp. A, 5, 986a22–26
VII, 2, p. 313, 1–3	cp. N, 1, 1087b3–9, 17–18
VII, 2, p. 313, 4–6	cp. N, 3, 1090b13–24
VII, 2, p. 313, 6–14	cp. M, 6, 1080a15–35
VII, 2, pp. 313, 17–314, 2	cp. A, 5, 985b27–31, 32–33
VII, 2, p. 314, 2–3	cp. M, 1, 1076a19–20
VII, 2, p. 314, 4	cp. M, 6, 1080b16–18
VII, 2, p. 314, 4–5	cp. M, 8, 1083b11–19
VII, 3, p. 318, 8–12	cp. A, 9, 991a8–19
VII, 3, p. 318, 13–15	cp. M, 2, 1077a20–24
VII, 3, p. 318, 15–18	cp. M, 2, 1077a31–36
VII, 3, p. 318, 18–319, 3	cp. M, 8, 1084a21–25
VII, 3, p. 319, 4–9	cp. M, 9, 1083a1–17
VII, 3, p. 319, 10–13	cp. M, 8, 1083b36–1084b2
VII, 3, p. 321, 17–18	cp. M, 8, 1083b13–16
VII, 3, p. 322, 2–7	cp. M, 9, 1085a35–b4
VII, 3, p. 323, 17–18	cp. A, 8, 990a12–14
VII, 3, p. 324, 3–5	cp. M, 3, 1078a36–b2

Table 13 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*
OntologyC/Theology	
VIII, 1, p. 327, 8–9	α, 2, 994a1–2
VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–329, 6	α, 2, 994a3–19
VIII, 1, pp. 328, 13–329, 2	α, 2, 994a16
VIII, 1, pp. 329, 7–331, 13	α, 2, 994a19–b6 (obj.)
VIII, 2, pp. 332, 6–334, 11; pp. 335, 3–340, 2	α, 2, 994a22–24 (obj.)
VIII, 2, pp. 334, 12–335, 2; p. 340, 3–8	α, 2, 994b5–6
VIII, 3, pp. 340, 14–341, 13	α, 2, 994b9–16
VIII, 3, pp. 341, 14–18	α, 2, 994b16–20
VIII, 4	cp. Δ, 5, 1015b11–14
VIII, 4, pp. 344, 16–345, 5	B, 4, 1001a9–19
VIII, 6, p. 356, 8–15	cp. α, 1, 993b28–30
VIII, 6, pp. 356, 16–357, 5	cp. Λ, 7, 1072b19–21; Λ, 9, 1075a3–5
VIII, 6, p. 357, 16–17	cp. Λ, 6, 1071b37–1072a3
VIII, 7, p. 366, 13–17	cp. Λ, 7, 1072b26–30
VIII, 7, pp. 368, 13–370, 7	cp. Λ, 7, 1072a26–b4
VIII, 7, pp. 369, 1–370, 7	cp. Λ, 7, 1072b14–26
IX, 2, p. 387, 8–13	cp. Λ, 7, 1072a24–b4
IX, 2, p. 387, 17, p. 388, 1–2	cp. Λ, 7, 1072a27–28
IX, 2, p. 389, 13–390, 1	cp. Λ, 7, 1072b4–7
IX, 2, p. 392, 5–6	Λ, 7, 1073a7–8
IX, 2, p. 392, 6	Λ, 7, 1072b3
IX, 2, p. 392, 7–15	cp. Λ, 8, 1073a14–b1
IX, 2, p. 392, 15–17	cp. Λ, 8, 1073b1–1074a18
IX, 2, p. 401, 16	cp. Λ, 8, 1073b38–1074a17
IX, 7, p. 428, 16	cp. Λ, 7, 1072a29

Table 14

Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*
A, 2, 982a21–b10	cp. I, 1, p. 5, 8–15; I, 1, p. 7, 6–9
A, 2, 982b7–8	cp. I, 1, p. 5, 10–15
A, 5, 985b27–31, 32–33	cp. VII, 2, pp. 313, 17–314, 2
A, 5, 986a22–26	III, 6, p. 128, 12–16; cp. VII, 2, p. 312, 18
A, 6, 987a32–b10	cp. VII, 2, pp. 310, 14–311, 8
A, 6, 987b14–16	VII, 2, p. 311, 14–15
A, 6, 987b24–25, 27–31	cp. VII, 2, p. 312, 16–17
A, 6, 987b25–27	cp. VII, 2, p. 312, 17–18
A, 8, 990a12–14	cp. VII, 3, p. 323, 17–18
A, 9, 990b11–13	cp. VII, 2, pp. 310, 14–311, 8
A, 9, 991a8–19	cp. VII, 3, p. 318, 8–12
α, 1, 993b19–20	cp. I, 1, p. 5, 7
α, 1, 993b20–23	cp. I, 1, pp. 3, 11–4, 6
α, 1, 993b24–25	*VI, 3, p. 268, 12–15*
α, 1, 993b26–30	VI, 3, p. 278, 5–6

Table 14 (*cont.*)

Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*
α, 1, 993b28–30	cp. I, 8, p. 48, 7–9; VIII, 6, p. 356, 8–15
α, 1, 993b29–30	cp. VI, 1, p. 257, 10–17
α, 2, 994a1–2	**VIII, 1, p. 327, 8–9**
α, 2, 994a3–19	**VIII, 1, pp. 327, 12–329, 6**
α, 2, 994a16	*VIII, 1, pp. 328, 13–329, 2*
α, 2, 994a19–b6 (obj.)	**VIII, 1, pp. 329, 7–331, 13**
α, 2, 994a22–24 (obj.)	**VIII, 2, pp. 332, 6–334, 11; pp. 335, 3–340, 2**
α, 2, 994a23–24	cp. VI, 4, p. 279, 1–3
α, 2, 994a24	cp. VI, 4, p. 279, 7
α, 2, 994b5–6	**VIII, 2, pp. 334, 12–335, 2; p. 340, 3–8**
α, 2, 994b9–16	**VIII, 3, pp. 340, 14–341, 13**
α, 2, 994b16–20	**VIII, 3, pp. 341, 14–18**
Β, 2, 996a20–b3, 10–13	VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 4; p. 300, 7–8
Β, 2, 997a2–11	I, 8, p. 54, 3–5
Β, 3, 998a20–23, b9–11; 998b19–21, 999a4–5	VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4
Β, 4, 1001a9–19	VIII, 4, pp. 344, 16–345, 5
Γ, 1, 1003a20–21	I, 2, p. 13, 12–13
Γ, 1, 1003a21–22	VII, 1, p. 303, 5–6
Γ, 2, 1003a33	cp. I, 5, p. 31, 8–9
Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19	I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2; cp. VI, 5, p. 299, 4–5
Γ, 2, 1003b22–23	cp. III, 1, p. 95, 16–17
Γ, 2, 1003b22–1004a20	VII, 1, p. 303, 6–14
Γ, 2, 1003b24–25	cp. III, 2, p. 103, 7–8
Γ, 2, 1003b32–33	cp. I, 5, p. 31, 7
Γ, 2, 1004b17–26	I, 2, p. 16, 13–20
Γ, 1–2 *passim*	cp. I, 2, pp. 10, 6–13, 19
Γ, 3–5 *passim*	I, 8, pp. 48, 12–54, 2
Γ, 4, 1006a10–11	cp. I, 8, p. 54, 17
Γ, 6, 1011a13	cp. I, 8, p. 54, 17
Δ, 2, 1013a24–b3	cp. VI, 1, pp. 257, 7–17
Δ, 2, 1013b16–28	cp. VI, 1, pp. 258, 1–17
Δ, 2, 1013b20–21	*VI, 4, p. 279, 15–17*
Δ, 2, 1013b28–30	cp. VI, 1, p. 257, 3; p. 258, 17
Δ, 2, 1014a10–13	cp. VI, 3, pp. 270, 11–271, 8
Δ, 2, 1014a18–19	cp. I, 1, p. 7, 10–13
Δ, 2, 1014a20–25	cp. VI, 2
Δ, 3, 1014a26–b12	VI, 4, pp. 280, 14–281, 1
Δ, 4, 1015a7–10	VI, 4, p. 281, 14–15
Δ, 5, 1015a33–35	cp. *I, 5, p. 35, 10–12*
Δ, 5, 1015b9–11	cp. I, 6, p. 38, 6–10, p. 39, 6–16
Δ, 5, 1015b11–14	cp. VIII, 4
Δ, 6, 1016b27–28	*II, 2, p. 63, 11–12*
Δ, 6 *passim*	III, 2
Δ, 7, 1017a7–8, 15	II, 1, p. 57, 4–5

Table 14 (*cont.*)

Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*
Δ, 7, 1017a8–22	II, 1, p. 58, 7–9
Δ, 9, 1017b27–1018a9	cp. VII, 1, pp. 303, 15–304, 5
Δ, 9, 1018a9–15	VII, 1, p. 304, 6–10
Δ, 10, 1018a22–23	VII, 1, p. 304, 10–14
Δ, 10, 1018a25–29	cp. VII, 1, p. 308, 3–15
Δ, 11 *passim*	IV, 1, pp. 163, 7–164, 17
Δ, 11, 1018b12–19	*IV, 1, p. 163, 9–14*
Δ, 12 *passim*	*IV, 2, pp. 170, 4–172, 12*
Δ, 13, 1020a7–8	III, 4, p. 118, 14–15
Δ, 13, 1020a22	cp. *III, 4, p. 118, 1–11*
Δ, 15, 1021a8–12	VII, 1, p. 304, 1–3
Δ, 15, 1021a12	cp. *III, 3, p. 106, 6*
Δ, 15 *passim*	III, 10, pp. 152, 5–154, 6
Δ, 16, 1021b12–13	cp. IV, 3, p. 189, 12
Δ, 16 *passim*	IV, 3, p. 186, 4–16
Δ, 22 *passim*	VII, 1, pp. 304, 18–305, 9
Δ, 26, 1023b26–27, 1024a1–10	cp. IV, 3, p. 189, 12
Δ, 26, 1023b27–28, 32–34	IV, 3, pp. 189, 13–15
Δ, 26, 1023b28–34	V, 2, p. 212, 3–16
Δ, 26, 1024a1–10	cp. *IV, 3, p. 187, 1–4*
Δ, 26, 1024a1–3	*IV, 3, p. 190, 2–4*
Δ, 28, 1024a29–b9	V, 3, p. 213, 5–10
E, 1, 1025b3–4	cp. I, 1, p. 4, 14–17
E, 1, 1025b7–18	cp. I, 2, pp. 10, 5–11, 2
E, 1, 1025b18–1026a23	cp. I, 1, p. 4, 7–14
E, 1, 1026a19–21	cp. I, 1, p. 4, 14; I, 2, p. 15, 13–16
E, 1, 1026a31–32	cp. I, 2, pp. 12, 15–13, 7; p. 13, 12–13, 16–19; p. 14, 17–18, p. 15, 15, 8
E, 2, 1026b2–24	II, 1, p. 57, 5–6
E, 4, 1027b18–28	cp. I, 8, p. 48, 6–7
Z, 1	cp. II, 1, pp. 57, 7–58, 4
Z, 3, 1029a1–3, 30–33	cp. II, 1, pp. 59, 1–60, 4
Z, 3, 1029a5–6	cp. II, 2
Z, 4, 1030a21–22	cp. I, 5, p. 34, 16
Z, 4–5 *passim*	V, 8, pp. 243, 4–244, 18
Z, 6	cp. V, 8, pp. 244, 19–245, 13
Z, 7, 1032a24–25, a32–b13, b21–23	VI, 4, p. 282, 15–18
Z, 7, 1033a5–23	VI, 4, p. 281, 5–14
Z, 9, 1034a9–21	cp. VI, 4, p. 282, 2–5
Z, 9, 1034a11–13	cp. *VI, 4, pp. 281, 17–282, 1*
Z, 9, 1034b4–6	cp. *VI, 4, pp. 281, 17–282, 1*
Z, 10, 1035b34–1036a8	V, 8, pp. 245, 14–247, 12
Z, 10 *passim*	V, 9
Z, 15	V, 8, pp. 245, 14–247, 12
H, 2, 1042b15–17	cp. VI, 4, p. 279, 11–12
H, 2, 1043 a 8–9	cp. VI, 4, p. 279, 13
H, 5, 1044b31–32, 34–36, 1045a2, 5–6	cp. VI, 4, p. 281, 14–15

Table 14 (*cont.*)

Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*
Θ, 1, 1046a26	cp. IV, 2, p. 171, 6
Θ, 2, 1046b6	cp. IV, 2, p. 171, 6
Θ, 2–3 *passim*	IV, 2, pp. 173, 13–185, 17
Θ, 5 *passim*	IV, 2, pp. 173, 13–185, 17
Θ, 7–9 *passim*	IV, 2, pp. 173, 13–185, 17
I, 1, 1052b18–19, 1053b4–6	cp. III, 1, p. 95, 17
I, 1, 1053a8–18, 24–27	III, 6, pp. 130, 10–132, 13
I, 1, 1053a31–b3	III, 6, p. 132, 13–18
I, 2, 1054a13–15	cp. III, 2, p. 103, 7–8
I, 2, 1054a13	cp. III, 1, p. 95, 16–17
I, 3, 1054a20–26	cp. III, 6, pp. 126, 4–130, 4
I, 3, 1054a26–29	III, 3, p. 105, 1–7
I, 3, 1054b14–16	cp. VII, 1, p. 304, 8
I, 3, 1054b23–27	cp. VII, 1, p. 304, 9–10
I, 4, 1055a3–17, 24–30	cp. VII, 1, p. 308, 3–15
I, 4, 1055a19–23	VII, 1, pp. 308, 15–309, 7
I, 4, 1055a27–29	VII, 1, pp. 305, 13–306, 4
I, 4, 1055a33–35, b13–14	cp. VII, 1, p. 304, 15–16
I, 4, 1055b1–4, 7–9	cp. VII, 1, p. 309, 13–16
I, 4, 1055b3–8	cp. VII, 1, p. 304, 15
I, 5 *passim*	cp. III, 6, pp. 133, 1–15
I, 6, 1056b3–14, 1056b32–1057a17	cp. III, 6, pp. 126, 4–130, 4
I, 6, 1056b16–25	cp. III, 5, pp. 124, 14–125, 3
I, 6, 1056b20–22, 32–33	III, 6, pp. 130, 5–132, 13
I, 6, 1056b25–32	III, 5, pp. 123, 13–124, 13
I, 6, 1057a3–4	*III, 3, p. 105, 11–12*
I, 7, 1057a21–22, 24–26	VII, 1, p. 309, 8–13
I, 7, 1057a28–30	VII, 1, pp. 305, 13–306, 4
I, 7, 1057a33–34	cp. VII, 1, p. 309, 13–16
Λ, 6, 1071b26–28, 1072a7–8	cp. IV, 2, p. 183, 8–10
Λ, 6, 1071b37–1072a3	cp. VIII, 6, p. 357, 16–17
Λ, 7, 1072a24–b4	cp. IX, 2, p. 387, 8–13
Λ, 7, 1072a26–b4	cp. VIII, 7, pp. 368, 13–370, 7
Λ, 7, 1072a27–28	cp. IX, 2, p. 387, 17, p. 388, 1–2
Λ, 7, 1072a29	cp. IX, 7, p. 428, 16
Λ, 7, 1072b3	**IX, 2, p. 392, 6**
Λ, 7, 1072b4–7	cp. IX, 2, pp. 389, 13–390, 1
Λ, 7, 1072b14–26	cp. VIII, 7, pp. 369, 1–370, 7
Λ, 7, 1072b19–21	cp. VIII, 6, pp. 356, 16–357, 5
Λ, 7, 1072b26–30	cp. VIII, 7, p. 366, 13–17
Λ, 7, 1073a7–8	**IX, 2, p. 392, 5–6**
Λ, 8, 1073a14–b1	cp. **IX, 2, p. 392, 7–15**
Λ, 8, 1073b1–1074a18	cp. **IX, 2, p. 392, 15–17**
Λ, 8, 1073b38–1074a17	cp. **IX, 3, p. 401, 16**
Λ, 9, 1075a3–5	cp. VIII, 6, pp. 356, 16–357, 5
M, 1, 1076a17–19, 21–22	cp. VII, 2, p. 311, 8–13
M, 1, 1076a19–20	cp. VII, 2, p. 314, 2–3
M, 2, 1077a20–24	cp. VII, 3, p. 318, 13–15
M, 2, 1077a31–36	cp. VII, 3, p. 318, 15–18
M, 3, 1078a31–b5	cp. VI, 5, p. 299, 14–17
M, 3, 1078a36–b2	cp. VII, 3, p. 324, 3–5

Table 14 (*cont.*)

Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*
M, 6, 1080a15–35	cp. VII, 2, p. 313, 6–14
M, 6, 1080b16–18	cp. VII, 2, p. 314, 4
M, 8, 1083b11–19	cp. VII, 2, p. 314, 4–5
M, 8, 1083b13–16	cp. VII, 3, p. 321, 17–18
M, 8, 1083b36–1084b2	cp. VII, 3, p. 319, 10–13
M, 8, 1084a21–25	cp. VII, 3, pp. 318, 18–319, 3
M, 9, 1083a1–17	cp. VII, 3, p. 319, 4–9
M, 9, 1085a35–b4	cp. VII, 3, p. 322, 2–7
M, 9, 1086a2–3	cp. VII, 2, p. 311, 8–13
N, 1, 1087b3–9, 17–18	cp. VII, 2, p. 313, 1–3
N, 3, 1090b13–24	cp. VII, 2, p. 313, 4–6

Leaving book K aside (see above, §5.11), Avicenna quotes, or is inspired by, in different extents, all the books of the *Metaphysics*.

The Prolegomena and the Introduction are based on the entire book Γ, the only book of the *Metaphysics* textually quoted in these sections (see Chapter 9), and on chapter 1 of book E, even though E, 1 inspires only the doctrine, not also the text, of these sections of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

The framework of OntologyS-P and HenologyS-P is provided by book Δ, which is frequently quoted in these sections.[62] Besides Δ, more specific influences of other books of the *Metaphysics* can be detected. OntologyS (substance, treatise II) depends on book Z. HenologyS ("one", quantity and related issues, treatise III) relies on book I. OntologyP attests Avicenna's use of books Θ (potentiality and actuality, IV, 2) and Z (universals, V, 8–9; material and formal causes, VI, 4). As to HenologyP, its *pars construens* (VII, 1) is based on book I, whereas its *pars destruens* (VII, 2–3) is taken from books A and M.

OntologyC/Theology depends on book α, 2 (the finiteness of causal chains in the proof of God's existence, VIII, 1–3) and book Λ, 6–10 (the nature of God in treatise VIII, and Its function of First Principle of the universe in IX, 2–3).

The aforementioned books (or parts of books) of the *Metaphysics* (A; α, 2; Γ; Δ; E, 1; Z; I; Λ, 6–10; M) are the most important from

[62] Avicenna's reliance on Δ was recognized by Albertus Magnus, who reproduced many chapters of this part of the *Ilāhiyyāt* in his commentary on *Metaphysics* Δ. See Bertolacci [1998]; Bertolacci [2001b].

Avicenna's perspective. The remaining books (with the exception of K) are also quoted, but in a subsidiary way, either to confirm dialectically doctrines taken from other books (as with book B, see Chapter 10), or for minor points (as with α, 1, E, 2–4, Λ, 1–5), or in conjunction with some of the other books serving as main sources (as with books H and N with regard, respectively, to Z and A–M in VI, 4 and in VII, 2–3).

The style of the quotations highlights the importance of OntologyC/Theology within the *Ilāhiyyāt*: explicit determinate quotations of the *Metaphysics* occur only in this part of Avicenna's work. The quantity of the quotations, on the other hand, indicates that OntologyC/Theology is less dependent on the *Metaphysics* than the parts of the *Ilāhiyyāt* preceding it: quotations of the *Metaphysics*, despite being more evident as to their style, are definitely fewer in OntologyC/Theology; this latter relies not only on the *Metaphysics*, but also on other sources.

Conclusion

Avicenna's approach to the content of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is marked, first of all, by his use of different Arabic translations of this work, primarily those of Usṭāṭ (§1.1) and Isḥāq Ibn-Ḥunayn (§1.2); and, second, by the different styles of his quotations of the *Metaphysics*: this work is referred to either nominally (§3), or by means of more opaque expressions (§4), or hiddenly (§5). Whereas the adoption of different versions of the text reveals what we can call a "philological" attitude towards the *Metaphysics*, the different manners of quoting this work convey distinct doctrinal attitudes: whilst the nominal ("explicit determinate") and hidden ("implicit") references are used by Avicenna to express agreement towards Aristotle, the more opaque ("explicit indeterminate") ones are often linked with a critical tone. This veiled criticisms of Aristotle reveal Avicenna's aim, expressed in the Prologue to the *Šifāʾ*, to be "accommodating to [his] Peripatetic colleagues".

Considered collectively (§6), the quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* show both an extensive use of this work and a radical recasting of its content. Avicenna quotes, in different ways, all the books of the *Metaphysics* (apart, perhaps, from K), but according to an order that is strikingly different from their original disposition in Aristotle's work. Thus, book A is quoted by Avicenna not at the

beginning of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, but at the end of HenologyP. Chapters 1–2 of book α are transferred even "further", namely to OntologyC/Theology, in conjunction with chapters 6–10 of book Λ. Avicenna refers to some of the aporias of book B in distinct places of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Introduction, OntologyP, OntologyC/Theology). Whereas books A-α are, so-to-say, "postponed", and book B is "scattered", book Γ is placed in the forefront: its quotations occur mainly in the Prolegomena and the Introduction. Avicenna employs (sometimes with critical accents) several terminological distinctions deriving from book Δ as linguistic preliminaries to the treatment of various issues he takes into account in all the parts of the *Ilāhiyyāt* preceding OntologyC/Theology (Prolegomena, Introduction, OntologyS-HenologyS, OntologyP and HenologyP). Chapter 1 of book E inspires, together with book Γ in its entirety, some themes of the Prolegomena: due to the "dispersive" use of Δ (analogous to the one of B), E, 1 results directly linked to Γ, and, together with this latter, orientates Avicenna's scientific reform of metaphysics; chapters E, 2–4, on the contrary, lay in the background of some minor points of the Introduction and OntologyS. The doctrine of book Z is used partly in the treatment of substance in OntologyS, partly in the treatment of the universals and material and formal causes in OntologyP. A comprehensive summary of book Θ is provided by Avicenna in the analysis of potentiality and actuality within OntologyP. Book I is the main source of HenologyP. Chapters 6–10 of book Λ are quoted, as the continuation of α, 1–2, within OntologyC/Theology. Books M and N, finally, are quoted in HenologyP together with book A, thus being somehow placed "before" book Λ, which is cited in OntologyC/Theology.

In general terms, we can say that Avicenna's reworking of the content of the *Metaphysics* consists in enucleating three main "poles" around which the books of this work can be grouped: the epistemological pole (Prolegomena and Introduction), given by books Γ and E, 1; the ontological-henological pole (OntologyS-P and HenologyS-P), constituted primarily by Z-H, Θ and I, in which B plays a "trouble-shooting" role, Δ provides the semantic preliminaries to the discussion, and A-M-N serve as a doxographical complement; and the theological pole (OntologyC/Theology) constituted by α, 2 and Λ, 6–10. This thorough recasting of the sequence of books of the *Metaphysics* is accompanied by the substantial enlargement of the theological part of this work.

CHAPTER NINE

THE MAIN SOURCE OF AVICENNA'S CONCEPTION OF METAPHYSICS AS A SCIENCE: BOOK Γ AND ITS QUOTATIONS*

The title of the *Šifā'* apparently derives, either directly or indirectly, from *Metaphysics* Γ. In a passage of chapter 5 of this book, Aristotle distinguishes two groups of philosophers who deny the principle of non-contradiction: those who simply have to be persuaded of its truth; and those who must be obliged to acknowledge its validity. About the former, Aristotle states that "their ignorance can easily be cured" (τούτων εὐίατος ἡ ἄγνοια, Γ, 5, 1009a19), whereas of the latter he maintains that "their cure is the refutation" (τούτων δ' ἔλεγχος ἴασις, 1009a21). In Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics* (the only extant Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics* containing the passage in question), the references to the "cure" in the aforementioned sentences are rendered by the term *šifā'*.[1] The Arabic translation of this passage of Γ, 5, which Avicenna is familiar with, since he paraphrases it in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, is probably the ultimate source of the title of Avicenna's *summa*.[2] Whereas the title of the *Šifā'* may depend on *Metaphysics* Γ, Avicenna's interpretation of this book explains perhaps, on its turn, the title of Maimonides' *Guide of the Perplexed* (*Dalālat al-Ḥā'irīn*): in his paraphrase of Γ, 5, 1009a19, Avicenna describes the philosopher that has to be persuaded about the truth of the principle of non-contradicition as "the perplexed whom we can guide" (*al-mutaḥayyir yumkinunā an nahdiyahū*); the resemblance of this phrase with the title of Maimonides' *Guide* is striking. The fact that *Metaphysics* Γ might have influenced the titles of both Avicenna's major philosophical

* This chapter is a revised version of Bertolacci [2004].

[1] *Tafsīr*, p. 404, 2–3: "their ignorance has a cure" (*li-ǧahlihī šifā'*); "their cure is by way of correction" (*šifā'uhum bi-taṣḥīḥ*).

[2] See Houser [1999], pp. 116–118. Gutas [1988], p. 205, regards Paul the Persian—who presents the Aristotelian *corpus* as "a complete course of *treatment* by means of which souls are *cured* of the diseases of ignorance" (emphasis added)—as the source of the title. Aristotle is compared to a wise physician who provides a remedy to ignorance also by the Syriac commentators of Aristotle (see Hugonnard-Roche [1997b], p. 347).

summa and, through Avicenna, of Maimonides' masterpiece on philosophy, is an eloquent sign of the deep impact that this book of the *Metaphysics* has exerted in Arabic philosophy. The *Ilāhiyyāt* constitutes a privileged vantage point to observe this influence.

Among the various books of the *Metaphysics*, Γ plays a key-role in the *Ilāhiyyāt* for two main reasons. First, the quotations of Γ are concentrated in the first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, precede those of the other books of the *Metaphysics*, and concern all the main doctrinal points of this book. Second, Avicenna rebuilds metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* according to the parameters (subject-matter, structure, method, relationship with the other sciences) that are either ascribed by Aristotle to "first philosophy" (i.e. metaphysics) in Γ, or are further developed by subsequent interpreters of Aristotle's account of metaphysics in this book. The reception of Γ in the *Ilāhiyyāt* deserves to be investigated on its own: even though previous studies have occasionally pointed at the *Ilāhiyyāt*'s dependence on Γ, a systematic exam of all the quotations and of the overall influence of this book has never been accomplished before.

The present chapter consists of five parts. In the first (§1), the content of Γ is briefly presented. The second part (§2) is an overview of the quotations of Γ in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. In the third part (§3), the most important quotations are examined in detail. The fourth part (§4) shows that Avicenna's conception of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* depends on Γ. In the fifth part (§5), finally, the main stages of the reception of Γ in Greek philosophy and in Arabic philosophy before Avicenna are described.

1 A Brief Description of *Metaphysics* Γ

Γ is the fourth book of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* according to the Greek numeration.[3] It deals with both ontology and logic, and consists of two parts: in the first (chapters 1–2), Aristotle describes metaphysics as the science of "being *qua* being" and provides the guide-lines of what can be considered his ontology; the second part of the book (chapters 3–8), on the other hand, is an articulated discussion of the logical laws or axioms of non-contradiction (chapters 3–6) and excluded-middle (chapter 7)—already taken into account by Aristotle in the *Organon*—and related issues.

[3] On *Metaphysics* Γ, see Kirwan [1971]; Cassin-Narcy [1989]; Cachia [1999].

Γ is characterized by epistemological concerns: significantly, it is the only book of the *Metaphysics* in which the *Posterior Analytics* are explicitly referred to (Γ, 2, 1005b2–5). When, at very beginning of the book, Aristotle calls this discipline "science" (ἐπιστήμη, Γ, 1, 1003a20),[4] he understands this term in a very strong sense. Especially in the first part of this book, but also in the following chapters, Aristotle provides an outline, regrettably unaccomplished, of his conception of metaphysics as a science.

2 An Overview of the Quotations of *Metaphysics* Γ in the Ilāhiyyāt

The quotations of Γ in the *Ilāhiyyāt* exhibit three peculiar features. First, they concentrate in the first treatise of this work. Second, they are the first quotations of texts, rather than doctrines, of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Third, they refer to book Γ in its entirety.

These quotations are taken directly from one of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics*, without being mediated by previous authors, like al-Kindī or al-Fārābī.[5] Avicenna apparently uses more than one Arabic version of Γ: he relies on Usṭāṯ's translation,[6] but employs probably also a translation different from this latter, which is, in all likelihood, the one by Isḥāq.[7] All the quotations are implicit: five are textual, the others are doctrinal.

Table A provides an annotated conspectus of the quotations of Γ in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. Together with all the references (both textual and doctrinal) to this book, it reports also the textual quotations of the three previous books of the *Metaphysics* (A, α, B).

Whereas the doctrinal quotations of Γ are scattered throughout the *Ilāhiyyāt*, most of the textual quotations (Quotations 1–4) occur in the first treatise. Due to them, the first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt* mirrors the sequence of themes of Γ, albeit not being its replica: like Γ, it starts with a discussion of "existent *qua* existent" as the theme of metaphysics, and ends with a treatment of the axioms.

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[4] See A, 1, 982a2.

[5] Quotation 5 (see Table 1) refers to a passage of Γ quoted also by al-Kindī in *Falsafa Ūlā* (see below, §5.2, n. 60). Al-Kindī's quotation, however, is much briefer than Avicenna's, and reproduces Aristotle's text according to a different terminology.

[6] See below, §3.5, Table 5 [1].

[7] See below, §3.2, Table 2 [2]–[3], [4b]. On these two translations, see Chapter 8, §§1.1–2.

Table A

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* A, α, B, Γ
I, 2, p. 13, 12–13: "existent *qua* existent" as the subject-matter of metaphysics (= Quotation 1)	Γ, 1, 1003a20–21
I, 2, pp. 10, 6–13, 19: the study of the species, properties and principles of "existent *qua* existent", and the study of "one", "many" and other concepts, belong to metaphysics	cp. Γ, 1–2 *passim*
I, 2, p. 16, 13–20: similarities and differences between metaphysics and dialectic/sophistic (= Quotation 2)	Γ, 2, 1004b17–26
I, 5, p. 31, 7: essence as proper existence	cp. Γ, 2, 1003b32–33
I, 5, p. 31, 8–9: existence is said in many ways	cp. Γ, 2, 1003a33
I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2: the science of "existent qua existent" is one (= Quotation 3)	Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19
I, 8, pp. 48, 12–54, 2: defense of the principle of excluded-middle (= Quotation 4)	Γ, 3–5 passim
I, 8, p. 54, 3–5	B, 2, 997a2–11 (second aporia)
I, 8, p. 54, 17	cp. Γ, 4, 1006a10–11; Γ, 6, 1011a13
III, 1, p. 95, 16–17: "existent" and "one" have a tight mutual relationship	cp. Γ, 2, 1003b22–23
III, 2, p. 103, 7–8: "existent" and "one" have different notions	cp. Γ, 2, 1003b24–25
III, 6, p. 128, 12–16	A, 5, 986a22–26
VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4	B, 3, 998a20–23, b9–11, b19–21, 999a4–5
VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 4; p. 300, 7–8	B, 2, 996a20–b1–3, 10–13
VI, 5, p. 299, 4–5	cp. Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19
VII, 1, p. 303, 5–14: "existent" and "one" imply each other, despite their different notions; metaphysics	Γ, 1, 1003a21–22; Γ, 2, 1003b22–1004a20

Table A (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* A, α, B, Γ
studies not only the properties of "existent", but also those of "one" and "many" (= Quotation 5)	
VII, 2–3	A, 5–6, 8–9 *passim*
VIII, 1–3	α, 2
VIII, 4, pp. 344, 16–345, 5	B, 4, 1001a9–19

Apart from Quotation 5 and its afferents, the other quotations of Γ precede the textual, i.e. main, quotations of the first three books of the *Metaphysics*: books A and α are quoted by Avicenna after Γ, whereas book B is quoted in scattered places of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The same priority regards also the books of the *Metaphysics* following Γ. Thus, Γ is the first book of the *Metaphysics* whose text Avicenna quotes in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

Avicenna's textual quotations concern the most important doctrines of Γ: metaphysics as the science of "being *qua* being" (Γ, 1, 1003a20–21) in Quotation 1; the similarities and differences between metaphysics, on the one hand, dialectic and sophistic, on the other (Γ, 2, 1004b17–26) in Quotation 2; the unicity of the science of "being *qua* being" as a consequence of the unified way in which "being" is predicated of the various beings (Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19) in Quotation 3; the defense of the axioms (Γ, 3–5) in Quotation 4; the mutual implication and semantic distinction of "being" and "one" (Γ, 2, 1003b22–1004a22) in Quotation 5. Other important themes of Γ are reproduced by Avicenna by means of doctrinal quotations.[8] Thus, the quotations of Γ regard all the salient themes of this book, and range over it in its entirety, with the exception of chapters 6–8, that Avicenna does not quote for an avowed intent of succinctness (see below, §3.4). This extensive, almost exhaustive, reproduction of a book of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is remarkable.

[8] Doctrinal quotations deal with the various aspects of metaphysics meant as science of "being *qua* being" (Γ 1–2 *passim*); the fact that essence is a kind of "existence" (Γ, 2, 1003b32–33); the fact that "existent" is a multivocal notion (Γ, 2, 1003a33).

The concentration of the quotations of Γ in the first treatise of Avicenna's work, their precedence with regard to the quotations of the other books of the *Metaphysics*, and their comprehensiveness attest clearly the fundamental role played by Γ in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The *leitmotiv* of these quotations is the doctrine of metaphysics as science: Quotations 1–4 pick up from Γ several aspects of Aristotle's conception of the science of metaphysics, and clarify and deepen the epistemological implications of Aristotle's statements; they occur in the first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Prolegomena and Introduction)—in which, as we have seen, the epistemological parameters of metaphysics are discussed,[9] and Avicenna's *Burhān* is quoted[10]—just because they contribute, together with the *Posterior Analytics*, to assess the scientific profile of metaphysics. Quotation 5, on the other hand, is the practical application in the *Ilāhiyyāt* of the doctrine it expresses: it deals with the relationship of "being", on the one hand, and "one" and "many", on the other, and the implication of this relation on the properties of these concepts, and marks, accordingly, the passage from Ontology P to Henology P. By quoting Γ in this way Avicenna strives to recast metaphysics according to a new epistemic configuration, more rigorous and complete than the one provided by Aristotle.

3 The Textual Quotations

3.1 *Quotation 1*

Quotation 1 occurs in the Prolegomena of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (I, 2). Avicenna refers to the famous *incipit* of book Γ (Γ, 1, 1003a21–22), in which Aristotle portrays metaphysics as the science of "being *qua* being" (τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὂν) and its essential attributes, i.e. its properties. By "being *qua* being" (Avicenna's "existent *qua* existent") Aristotle means "being in itself", as distinct from physical being, mathematical being, etc. I gather in the following table the texts of Avicenna and Aristotle discussed separatedly in Chapter 4.

The significance of Quotation 1 for Avicenna's doctrine of the subject-matter of metaphysics has been already remarked in Chapter 4.[11]

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[9] See Chapter 5, §§4.2–3.
[10] See Chapter 7, §2.3, Outline 1.
[11] See Chapter 4, Text 3 and Text 9.

Table 1 (Quotation 1)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 13, 12–13 [p. 13, 36–38]	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Γ, 1, 1003a20–21	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*, p. 296, 6–7
Therefore, the first subject-matter of this science is "existent *qua* existent", and the things searched by it are the realities that pertain to it [i.e. to "existent"] in so far as it is "existent", without any [further] condition.	There is a science which investigates being as being (τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὂν) and the attributes which belong to this in virtue of its own nature (τὰ τούτῳ ὑπάρχοντα καθ' αὐτό; καθ' αὐτά in Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary)	Aristotle says that to science belongs the theoretical study of "being" with regard to its nature (*al-huwiyya ʿalā kunhihā*) and the theoretical study of the things that belong to "being" in virtue of its [or: their] essence (*al-ašyāʾ allatī hiya li-l-huwiyya bi-ḏātihā*)

3.2 *Quotation 2*

Also Quotation 2 occurs in the Prolegomena of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (I, 2). The text quoted by Avicenna is meant by Aristotle to be a confirmation of the thesis that he establishes in the previous part of Γ, 2, where he resumes and solves the fourth aporia of Β, namely the question of who has to "theorize" (θεωρῆσαι) the group of notions ("same", "other", "contrary" etc.) that dialectic tries to "investigate" (σκοπεῖν) on account of commonly accepted opinions.[12] Aristotle says that "theorizing" (θεωρεῖν) these notions belongs to the "philosopher", namely—at least in the present case—the metaphysician,[13] and that "those who investigate these things" (οἱ περὶ αὐτῶν σκοπούμενοι)—the dialecticians, in all likelihood—are wrong since they do not pay any attention to substance, the main meaning of "being" (Γ, 2, 1004a31–b17). Thus, according to Aristotle, the aforementioned notions are studied by both dialectic and metaphysics, but according to different methods and with different results. The passage of Γ that Avicenna reproduces in Quotation 2 is also quoted, more extensively, in *Burhān*.[14]

[12] Β, 1, 995b20–25.

[13] Aristotle's use of the terms φιλοσοφία and ὁ φιλόσοφος in the *Metaphysics* is ambivalent: sometimes these terms refer to theoretical philosophy in general, as in α, 1, 993b20, Γ, 2, 1003b19, 1004a3, 6; other times, to metaphysics in particular, as in Γ, 2, 1004a34; 1004b1; 1004b18, 21–22, 23, 26 (our text); Γ, 3, 1005a21, 1005b6, 11.

[14] *Burhān* II, 7, pp. 165, 17–166, 15 (see Chapter 6, Text 5.2).

The quotation of a doctrine of the *Metaphysics* in a section of the *Šifā'* different from the *Ilāhiyyāt* is unusual,[15] and indicates the great importance that Avicenna ascribes to the doctrine in question. The fact that the other section of the *Šifā'* in which this text of the *Metaphysics* is quoted is *Burhān*, i.e. Avicenna's reworking of the *Posterior Analytics*, shows that, according to Avicenna, this text is relevant in an epistemological perspective.

Quotation 2 consists of five sections. The first section is introductory; the other four deal with the themes mentioned in the first section, i.e. the similarities between the metaphysician, the dialectician and the sophist ([2]); their general differences ([3]); the difference between metaphysics and dialectic in particular ([4]); the difference between metaphysics and sophistic in particular ([5]). Only sections [2], [4] and [5] are taken from the passage of Γ, 2: the other two sections ([1] and [3]) are added by Avicenna. Let us see sections [2]-[5] more in detail.

Section [2] establishes that the similarity of metaphysics, dialectic and sophistic is due to the fact that these disciplines take into account the same things. Of the corresponding text of Aristotle Avicenna quotes only lines 1004b17–18 and b19–23; he mentions lines b18–19 in section [5].

In section [3], Avicenna faces a theme not taken into account by Aristotle in Γ, 2, namely the difference between metaphysics, on the one hand, and dialectic and sophistic, *jointly taken*, on the other. According to him, the difference between these disciplines is given by the fact that metaphysics does not discuss the questions of the particular sciences ([3a]), whereas dialectic and sophistic do discuss them ([3b]). The doctrine that Avicenna adds is Aristotelian in inspiration; it is not clear, however, from what specific place of the *corpus* it is taken.[16]

In section [4], Avicenna gathers what Aristotle states in b23–24 and b25–26, on the difference between dialectic and metaphysics.

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[15] See Chapter 8, n. 2.

[16] Section [3a] might refer to *Metaph.* A, 2, 982a8–10 (the wise man knows everything universally, not each single thing), or B, 2, 997a17–19 (a single demonstrative science of all attributes is unreasonable). Section [3b] resembles *loci* like *An Post.* A, 11 or *Top.* A, 1; in *De An.* A, 1, 403a29–b2, Aristotle shows that dialectic discusses a question (the definition of wrath) of one of the particular sciences (natural philosophy); in *Metaph.* E, 2, 1026b15–21, sophistic is portrayed as discussing the issues of mutual identity and generation with regard to accidental items.

Table 2 (Quotation 2)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 16, 13–20 [pp. 17, 21–18, 32]	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004b17–26	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 16, 13–14) The present science shares something, in a way, with dialectic (*al-ǧadal*) and sophistic; it is different, in another way, from both of them; and it is different, in [still] another way, from each of them.		
[2] (p. 16, 14–15) As to the things it shares with them, this is due to the fact that a scholar of a particular science does not discuss what is investigated in the present science, whereas the dialectician (*al-ǧadalī*) and the sophist do discuss about it.	(b17–18, 19–23) An indication of this may be mentioned: dialecticians (διαλεκτικοί) and sophists assume the same guise as the philosopher . . . . . and dialecticians διαλεκτικοί embrace all things in their dialectic, and being is common to all things; but evidently their dialectic embraces these subjects [i.e. "same", "other" etc.], because these are proper to philosophy. For sophistic and dialectic (διαλεκτική) turn on the same class of things as philosophy.	(p. 325, 6–8, 8–12) The sign of this is that logicians (*al-manṭiqiyyūn*) and sophists persevere in the same kind of labor (*taʿab*) in which the philosopher perseveres . . . As to the logicians (*al-manṭiqiyyūn*), they discuss all things, and being (*al-huwiyya*) is what is common to, and shared by, all of them. It is well-known that they discuss of these things since they are common to philosophy. For the science of the sophists and the science of the logicians (*ʿilm al-manṭiqiyyīn*) go back to one genus, namely the genus of philosophy.
[3a] (p. 16, 15–17) As to the difference [from both of them], it is due to the fact that the first philosopher [i.e. the metaphysician], *qua* first philosopher, does not discuss the questions of the particular sciences,	Cp. A, 2, 982a8–10; B, 2, 997a17–19	

Table 2 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 16, 13–20 [pp. 17, 21–18, 32]	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1004b17–26	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[3b] (p. 16, 17) whereas they [i.e. the dialectician and the sophist] do discuss [these questions].	Cp. *An Post.* A, 11, 77a29, 31–32; *Top.* A, 1, 100a19–20. Cp. *De An.* A, 1, 403a29–b2; *Metaph.* E, 2, 1026b15–21.	
[4a] (p. 16, 17) As to the difference from dialectic (*al-ǧadal*) in particular, it is due to capacity,	(b23–24) but this [i.e. philosophy] differs from the latter in the mode of ability (τῷ τρόπῳ τῆς δυνάμεως) . . .	(p. 325, 12) But philosophy is distinct from the one science on account of the type of power . . .
[4b] (p. 16, 17–18) since the dialectical discussion (*al-kalām al-ǧadalī*) provides opinion, not what is certain, as you have learnt in the discipline of logic.	(b25–26) Dialectic (διαλεκτική) is merely critical (πειραστική) where philosophy claims to know;	(p. 325, 13–14) For the science of logic (*ʿilm al-manṭiq*) knows what the philosopher knows.
[5a] (p. 16, 18–19) As to the difference from sophistic, it is due to will (*al-irāda*),	(b24–25) . . . and from the former in the choice of life (τοῦ βίου τῇ προαιρέσει).	(p. 325, 13) [whereas it is distinct] from the other science on account of the way of conducting life (*bi-ʿtibār tadbīr al-ḥayāt*).
[5b] (p. 16, 19–20) since the former [i.e. the first philosopher] wants what is true itself, whereas the latter [i.e. the sophist] wants to be regarded as a wise man who says what is true, even though he is not.	(b18–19) . . . for sophistic is philosophy which exists only in semblance, (b26) . . . and sophistic is what appears to be philosophy but is not	(p. 325, 8) For the science of the sophist is wisdom only by way of feigning. (p. 325, 14–15) whereas the science of the sophist is believed to know, but in fact does not know.

The difference in question is given by the different way in which these two disciplines know their objects ([4a]): dialectic provides a knowledge based on opinion, and does not reach the certainty proper of metaphysics ([4b]). The reference to logic is probably to the section of the *Šifāʾ* corresponding to Aristotle's *Topics*.[17]

[17] See *Ǧadal* I, 1, p. 11, 6–8.

In section [5], finally, Avicenna collects what Aristotle maintains in b18–19, b24–25 and b26 about the difference between metaphysics and sophistic. This difference is given by what these two sciences plan to do ([5a]): metaphysics aims at being a true wisdom whereas the sophistic's goal is to pretend to be wisdom ([5b]).

Quotation 2 is an expanded version of the corresponding passage of Γ, 2: Avicenna quotes this Aristotelian place in its entirety (in sections [2], [4], [5]) by means of a kind of "cut-and-paste" procedure; he adds to it sections [1] and [3], the former introductory, the latter dealing with the difference of metaphysics, on the one hand, and dialectic and sophistic, on the other. The addition of section [3] witnesses that Avicenna's aim is to stress the differences, more than the similarities, between these disciplines. The relevance of Quotation 2 for Avicenna's view of the method of metaphysics has been underscored in Chapter 6.[18]

The comparison of Quotation 2 with the original text of the *Metaphysics* and Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation shows that, in some cases, Avicenna's paraphrase is more similar to Aristotle's original text than Usṭāṯ's version,[19] whereas in other cases Avicenna and Usṭāṯ emphasize distinct aspects of the Aristotelian text.[20] This implies that Avicenna

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[18] See Chapter 6, Text 5.1 and Text 9.

[19] In sections [2], [3] and [4b] Usṭāṯ translates διαλεκτικοὶ as "logicians" (*manṭiqiyyūn*), and διαλεκτικὴ as "science of the logicians" (*ʿilm al-manṭiqqiyyīn*) and "science of logic" (*ʿilm al-manṭiq*), whereas Avicenna refers to dialectic by means of the specific term *ǧadal* (dialectic is said to argue "logically", λογιχῶς, in Alexander of Aphrodisias' summary of this passage of Γ in the introduction to his commentary on *Metaph.* Δ; Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 344, 19, Dooley [1993], p. 11). Also the "will" (*irāda*) mentioned by Avicenna in section [5a] is closer to Aristotle's προαιρέσις ("aim" or "choice") than Usṭāṯ's "way of conducting life" (*tadbīr l-ḥayāt*). But the text of Usṭāṯ's translation in the *Tafsīr* (*fa-bi-ʿtibāri tadbīri l-ḥayāti*, p. 325, 13) might be the corruption of "in the choice of how to conduct life" (*fa-bi-ḫtiyār tadbīri l-ḥayāti*).

[20] In section [4b], for example, Aristotle states that dialectic and philosophy (i.e. metaphysics) are, on the one hand, similar, because they know the same realities, but, on the other hand, different, because they know these realities in different ways: dialectic is πειραστικὴ ("critical", in the sense that it tests the validity of opinions), whereas philosophy provides true knowledge. Now, Usṭāṯ's translation stresses the first point (dialectic knows the same things that philosophy knows), whereas Avicenna insists on the second (dialectic provides opinion, not certainty, as metaphysics does). Although Avicenna might refer to other Aristotelian *loci*—like *Metaph.* B, 1, 995b23–24, where Aristotle maintains that the dialecticians' investigation is based exclusively on common opinions—the use of a different translation of the *Metaphysics* seems more likely. The positive image of dialectic resulting from Usṭāṯ's translation might be due the "Platonism" of al-Kindī's circle, to which he belonged.

was using, at least in this circumstance, an Arabic translation of Γ different from Usṭāṯ's, probably the one by Isḥāq.[21]

3.3 *Quotation 3*

Quotation 3 occurs within Avicenna's treatment of the primary concepts in the Introduction (I, 5). The quoted text is the passage of Γ, 2 commonly known as Aristotle's theory of the "focal meaning" of "being".[22] This theory represents Aristotle's solution of the major epistemological antinomy of the *Metaphysics* ("being", in order to be the main theme of a science, has to be a genus, but, as such, it is not): Aristotle contends that "being" is a "quasi-genus", since all its various meanings refer to a primary meaning (substance), and that therefore can be investigated by a science, i.e. metaphysics. Avicenna reproduces, with some significant difference, Aristotle's main point. The doctrine of Quotation 2 is recalled also elsewhere in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[23]

Quotation 3 can be divided into four sections. The first two deal with the way according to which "existent" is predicated: section [1] establishes, in negative terms, that "existent" is not a genus ([1a]), and that is not predicated univocally ([1b]); section [2] establishes, in positive terms, that "existent" is predicated according to priority and posteriority ([2a]), and that substance is the first thing of which it is predicated ([2b]). The other two sections elucidate how, on account of the way according to which it is predicated, there can be a science of "existent": section [3] declares, on the basis of sections [1] and [2], that "existent" is one notion or reality ([3a]), and that it has some proper accidents or properties ([3b]); section [4], finally, states that there is one science of "existent" ([4a]), pointing at the similar case of the one science of what is healthy [4b].

In section [1a], Avicenna makes explicit what is implicit in Aristotle's text, namely that "existent" is not a genus. The phrase "as you know" refers to *Madḫal*.[24]

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[21] See Chapter 8, §1.1, Table 1 [4].

[22] See Owen [1960].

[23] VI, 5, p. 299, 4–5 [p. 346, 83–84].

[24] *Madḫal* I, 11, p. 64, 4–9. In the *Isagoge*, in the context of the description of the predicable "species", Porphyry states that "being" is not a genus and invokes Aristotle's authority in this regard (Porphyry [1887], p. 6, 5–6; see De Libera-Segonds [1999], p. 7; for Porphyry's antecedents in this regard, see De Libera-Segonds [1999], p. xiii and n. 22; p. 50, n. 53). Aristotle contends that "being" is

Table 3 (Quotation 3)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2 [p. 40, 46–53]	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1a] (p. 34, 15) We say now that the existent, even though it is not a genus, as you know,	B, 3, 998b22; H, 6, 1045a36–b7; I, 2, 1053b22–24	
[1b] (p. 34, 15–16) nor is it predicated in an equal way of what is beneath it,	(Γ, 2, 1003a33) There are many senses in which a things may be said to "be" . . . (1003b5) So, too, there are many senses in which a thing is said to be . . .	(p. 300, 13) Being is said in many ways . . . (p. 301, 4) Likewise also being is said in many ways . . .
[2a] (p. 34, 16) nonetheless is a notion in which congruence occur (*maʿnā muttafaq fīhi*) by means of priority and posteriority (*ʿalā l-taqdīm wa-l-taʾẖīr*).	(1003a33–34) . . . but they are related to one central point, one definite kind of thing. (1003b5–6) . . . but all refer to one starting-point (ἀρχήν) (1003b16–18) But everywhere science deals chiefly with that which is primary (τοῦ πρώτου) [. . .]. If, then, this is substance . . .	(p. 300, 14) . . . but it is related to one thing and one nature. (p. 301, 4–5) . . . but all these ways are related to one first thing (*awwal*). (p. 302, 1–3) The science that is verily science of all things is science of the prior thing (*al-šayʾ al-mutaqaddim*) [. . .]. If this prior [thing] (*hāḏā l-mutaqaddim*) is substance . . .
	Cp. Z, 4, 1030a21–22: For as "is" is predicable of all things, not however in the same sense, but of one sort of things primarily and of others in a secondary way, so too the "what" belongs simply to substance, but in a limited sense to the other categories.	om.
[2b] (p. 34, 16–17) The first thing to	(Γ, 2, 1003b6–10) some things are said to be	(p. 301, 5–6) For some things are said

not a genus in several places of his works, included the *Metaphysics* (*Metaph.* B, 3, 998b22; H, 6, 1045a36–b7; I, 2, 1053b22–24).

Table 3 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2 [p. 40, 46–53]	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
which it belongs, is the quiddity which is substance; afterwards, it belongs to what come after it [i.e. after substance].	because they are substances, others because they are affections of substance, others because they are a process towards substance etc.	"being" because they are substances, some others because they are affections, some others because they are a way towards substance etc.
[3a] (pp. 34, 17–35, 1) In so far as it is one notion, in the manner we have alluded to,		
[3b] (p. 35, 1) some accidents that are proper to it pertain to it, as we have clarified before.		
[4a] (p. 35, 1–2) Therefore, it has one science encharged with studying it,	(1003b15–16) It is clear then that it is the work of one science also to study all things that are, *qua* being.	(pp. 301, 14–302, 1) It is well-known, therefore, that the investigation of all beings, according to what they are, belongs to one science
[4b] (p. 35, 2) as everything that is healthy (*ǧamīʿ mā huwa ṣiḥḥī*) has one science [encharged with studying it].	(1003b11–12) As, then, there is one science which deals with all healthy things, the same applies in the other cases also.	(p. 301, 10–11) Thus, as the science of the things restored to health (*al-ašyāʾ al-mubraʾa*) is one, likewise the science of the other things resembling these [is one].

In section [1b], he paraphrases in negative terms what Aristotle states in positive terms in lines 1003a33 and b5, about the way according to which "being" is predicated: Aristotle maintains that "being" is predicated πολλαχῶς, i.e. "in many ways"; whereas Avicenna states that "existent" is not predicated "in an equal way", or "according to equality" (*bi-l-tawāsī*).

In some recent studies section [2] has been portrayed as a fundamental stage of the historical process transforming Aristotle's the-

ory of the predication πρὸς ἕν of "being" into the Medieval doctrine of the "analogy" of "being".[25] Especially Avicenna's view of "existent" as a point of convergence (*muttafaq fīhi*), according to anteriority and posteriority, of the various things of which it is predicated ([2a]), has been regarded as extremely significant in this perspective. Section [2], however, is not the only place of the *Šifā'* in which this doctrine occurs.[26] Furthermore, Avicenna's idea of a priority and posteriority among the meanings of "existent" is not totally original, since it can be found in other *loci* of the *Metaphysics*.[27]

What is original in Quotation 3 is section [3] rather than section [2]. Part [3a] is connected with part [2a]: "in the manner we have alluded to" means "according to priority and posteriority". Part [3b], on the other hand, resumes one of the main epistemological features of metaphysics, namely the fact that this discipline—as every other science, according to the rules of Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics*—demonstrates the properties of its subject-matter. The phrase "as we have clarified before" refers to texts like Quotation 1. Thus, the whole section [3] aims at elucidating: (i) that "existent" is one notion ([3a]); (ii) that, in so far as it is one notion, it has some properties ([3b]), (iii) and that, in so far as it has some properties, it can be the subject-matter of a science.

Section [4] corresponds almost *verbatim* to lines 1003b15–16 ([4a]) and b11–12 ([4b)] of Aristotle's text. In these two passages, after having compared the "focal meaning" of "being" with the "focal meaning" of "healthy" and "medical", Aristotle focuses on "healthy" in order to clarify that, as there is a science of what is healthy (Aristotle probably means physiology), likewise there is a science of "being" (that is, metaphysics).[28] Avicenna does the same, inverting,

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[25] De Libera [1989], pp. 328–337.

[26] See, for example, *Maqūlāt* I, 2.

[27] *Metaph.* Z, 4, 1030a21–22, is strikingly similar to section [2a]: in this passage Aristotle compares the "focal meaning" of the verb "is" to the "focal meaning" of the expression "what is it", or essence, and he says that "is" is predicated either in a primary way (of substance) or in a secondary way (of accidents). Unfortunately this passage of the *Metaphysics* is not contained in Usṭāṯ's translation (in the form in which this is extant), nor is it attested by the additional translations that Averroes occasionally quotes in the *Tafsīr*. See also Γ, 2, 1003b5–6, b16–18, where Aristotle calls substance "principle" (or "starting-point") and "what is primary" among the things of which "being" is predicated. For the idea of a priority and posteriority among the meanings of "being", see also Δ, 11, 1019a1–11.

[28] In Z, 4, 1030a34–b3 (*Tafsīr*, p. 798, 10–11), on the contrary, Aristotle selects

however, the order: there is one science of "existent", according to Avicenna, as there is one science of what is healthy.

Quotation 3 reproduces the guide-lines of the passage of Γ, 2 that Avicenna is quoting. Avicenna's paraphrase is selective, and some details of Aristotle's text are omitted. The quotation's succinctness emphasizes what Avicenna adds to Aristotle's text in section [3]: a reference to a theme occurring three chapters before, which consists in the application to metaphysics of a rule of the *Posterior Analytics*. Thus Quotation 3 makes clear, first of all, that the doctrine of *Metaphysics* Γ permeates the entire first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, and, second, that Avicenna's reception of this book is oriented to clarify the way according to which metaphysics is a science.

3.4 *Quotation 4*

In Quotation 4, Avicenna reworks Aristotle's defense, in the second part of Γ (chapters 3–8), of the fundamental logical laws (non-contradiction and excluded-middle), called by Aristotle "axioms" or "principles of demonstration".[29] With regard to the axioms Aristotle establishes two main points: first, that there cannot be demonstration of everything, and that the axiom of non-contradiction is the first among the things of which there is no demonstration (Γ, 4, 1006a5–11; Γ, 6, 1011a8–13); second, that its defense, qualified as "demonstration by way of refutation" (ἀποδεῖξαι ἐλεγκτικῶς, Γ, 4, 1006a11–12, 15–16)—i.e. by way of rebuttal of the views of those who deny it—and "demonstration" *tout court* (ἀπόδειξις Γ, 4, 1006a24), is not a proper demonstration (Γ, 4, 1006a17–18; Γ, 6, 1011a13). Aristotle's considerations on the axiom of non-contradiction can be

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the other example of "focal meaning" ("medical") as parallel case to the "focal meaning" of "being".

[29] See Houser [1981]; Houser [1999]. In Γ, Aristotle calls these laws "axioms" ("the truths which are in mathematics called axioms", Γ, 3, 1005a20), and describes them as "the principles of deduction" (1005b7); cp. "the common (axioms)" and "the principles of these" [of the common axioms?] in K, 4, 1061b17–19. In B, these laws are called "the principles on which all men base their proofs", B, 1, 995b8–10 (among them Aristotle mentions the law of non-contradiction and "all other such things"); "the demonstrative principles", B, 2, 996b26–31 (Aristotle describes them as "the common beliefs, on which all men base their proofs", and mentions among them the law of the excluded-middle, the law of non-contradiction and "all other such propositions"); cp. K, 1, 1059 a 23–24; "axioms", B, 2, 997a11, 13. On the meaning of "axioms" in B, see Madigan [1999], p. 41.

extended to the axiom of excluded-middle. As we have seen in Chapter 7 (§1), for Avicenna these axioms are not only principles of demonstration, but also "principles of the act of granting assent"; together with the "principles of the act of conceptualizing", they are the base of all knowledge, and must be taken into account by metaphysics as the founding discipline of the system of sciences.

Quotation 4 reworks and adjusts the doctrine of Γ, 3–8. It is quite long (it covers the main part of chapter I, 8) and cannot be analyzed in detail. I provide in Table 4 the list of correspondences between Avicenna's and Aristotle's texts.

The main features of Avicenna's reworking of Aristotle's defense of axioms in *Metaphysics* Γ are four. First, Avicenna's quotation is selective: it regards almost exclusively chapters 3–5 of Γ; the content of chapters 6–8 is not taken into account. Significantly, Avicenna states that the discussion he provides might be prolonged.[30] Second, Avicenna applies Aristotle's arguments in Γ, 3–5 not to the principle of non-contradiction (as Aristotle does; see Γ, 3, 1005b18–34), but to the principle of the excluded-middle, which Aristotle takes into account, more briefly, in Γ, 7. This is probably due to the influence of the *Posterior Analytics*, in which the principle of the excluded-middle is mentioned more frequently than the principle of non-contradiction.[31] Third, within the paraphrase of Aristotle's text, Avicenna inserts a long section with no correspective in Aristotle, whose aim is to show that the metaphysician's defense of the principle of the excluded-middle is a syllogism "by analogy".[32] This insertion—which is probably motivated not only by Aristotle's statement in Γ, 4, 1006a11–12, 15–16, 24, but also by his reference to a "demonstration *ad impossibile*" (εἰς τὸ ἀδύνατον ἀποδειξις) of the axiom of the excluded-middle in *An. Post.* A, 11, 77a22–25—is meant to emphasize the deductive (even though not apodictic *stricto sensu*) nature of the metaphysical defense of the axioms.[33] Fourth, in connection with this quotation of Γ, 3–5, Avicenna provides a solution of the second aporia of B.[34]

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[30] I, 8, p. 53, 10–11 [p. 62, 82–83].

[31] The principle of the excluded-middle is mentioned in *An. Post.* A, 11, 77a22–23, 77a30; A, 32, 88a37; cp. *Burhān* I, 5, p. 69, 14–17. The principle of non-contradiction is mentioned in *An. Post.* A, 11, 77a10–11.

[32] I, 8, pp. 49, 5–50, 4 [pp. 56, 81–58, 5].

[33] See Chapter 6, §3.2.

[34] See Chapter 10, §2.1.

Table 4

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 8	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*
p. 48, 12–13: the features of the truest proposition	cp. Γ, 3, 1005b11–18
p. 48, 14–16: description of the principle of the excluded-middle (PEM)	cp. Γ, 7, 1011b23–24
p. 48, 16–18: the PEM is a property of "existent"	cp. Γ, 3, 1005a22–25
p. 49, 1–3: reason why the validity of PEM is denied by the stubborn person and the perplexed person	cp. Γ, 5, 1009a18–26
p. 49, 3–4: the metaphysician has to defend PEM against the sophist and the perplexed person	cp. Γ, 3, 1005a20–21, a28–29, a34–b1, b5–11
p. 49, 4–5: the metaphysician's defense of PEM is a kind of polemical argument	cp. Γ, 4, 1006a11–12, 15–18
pp. 49, 5–50, 4: the metaphysician's defense of PEM is a syllogism by analogy	
p. 50, 5–7: the sophist is obliged either to remain silent or to admit the validity of PEM	Γ, 4, 1006a12–15, 18–28
p. 50, 14–15: philosophical relativism is one of the reasons why the perplexed person denies PEM	Γ, 5, 1009b33–38
p. 51, 4–6: one way of solving the doubt of the perplexed person is to show that, in certain matters, some people are more trustworthy than others	Γ, 5, 1010b11–14
pp. 51, 11–53, 12: proof of the validity of PEM	Γ, 4 *passim*
p. 53, 13–15: how the stubborn person has to be treated	Γ, 5, 1009a18
p. 53, 16: This principle, that we have defended from who denies it, is the first among the principles of demonstrations, . . .	Γ, 3, 1005b33–34
p. 53, 16–17: . . . and it is incumbent upon the first philosopher to defend it.	Γ, 3, 1005a21–22, b10–11

Table 4 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 8	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*
p. 54, 2: Therefore, it belongs to this single science to discuss of both things [i.e. axioms and substance] together.	Γ, 3, 1005b5–8

3.5 *Quotation 5*

Quotation 5 occurs in *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 1, and marks the transition between Ontology P and HenologyP.[35] Mirroring Aristotle's doctrine in Γ, 1–2, Avicenna shows that metaphysics deals not only with the properties of "existent", but also with the properties of "one" and "many".

Table 5

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 1, p. 303, 5–14 [pp. 349, 7–350, 22]	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Γ, 1, 1003a21–22; Γ, 2, 1003b22–27, 32–36, 1004a9–20	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 303, 5–6) It seems we have exhaustively discussed, with respect to our aim here,[36] the things that are proper to "being *qua* being" (*huwiyya min ḥayṯu hiya huwiyya*) or are consequent to it.	(Γ, 1, 1003a21–22) There is a science which investigates being as being (τὸ ὂν ᾗ ὄν) and the attributes which belong to this in virtue of its own nature.	(p. 296, 5–7) Aristotle says that to a certain science belongs the investigation of being (*huwiyya*) in its nature and the investigation of the things that belong to being (*huwiyya*) in itself.
[2] (p. 303, 6) Furthermore, "one" and "existent" (*mawǧūd*) are equal to each other in being predicated of things,	(Γ, 2, 1003b22–24) If, now, being and unity are the same and are one thing in the sense that they are implied in one another as principle and cause are, . . .	(p. 310, 2–4) As to one and being (*huwiyya*), if they are one thing and have one nature, then they follow each other as principle and cause follow each other
[3] (p. 303, 7) so that each thing that is said	(1003b26–27) for one man, existent (ὢν) man	(p. 310, 5–6) . . . since the expressions "one

[35] See Chapter 5, §4.5, Text 5 [e].
[36] Reading *hunā* instead of *hāḏā* (see Appendix A).

Table 5 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 1, p. 303, 5–14 [pp. 349, 7–350, 22]	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Γ, 1, 1003a21–22; Γ, 2, 1003b22–27, 32–36, 1004a9–20	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
"existent" (*mawǧūd*) in a certain respect can be properly said "one" in another,	and a man are the same thing[37]	man", or "man is (*huwa*)", or "this man", signify one thing.
[4] (p. 303, 7–8) and everything has one existence (*wuǧūd*).	(1003b32–33) and if, further, the essence of each thing is one in no merely accidental way, and similarly is from its very nature something that *is* (ὅν τι)	(p. 310, 11–12) We also say that the substance of each thing is one not accidentally, and therefore we say that the substance of everything is a being (*huwiyya*).
[5] (p. 303, 8) Therefore sometimes it is thought that the concept of each of them is the same,	(1003b25–26) (though it makes no difference even if we interpret them similarly—in fact this would strengthen our case)	(p. 310, 4–5) Therefore, there is no difference in their relationship, even if we think in this way.
[6] (p. 303, 8) but it is not so.	(1003b24–25) . . . not in the sense that they are explained by the same formula.	(p. 310, 4) . . . not because a single definition signifies both of them.
[7] (p. 303, 8–9) Rather they are the same in subject, i.e. each thing that is characterized by the former is characterized by the latter.	(1003b26–27) for one man, existent man and a man are the same thing.[38]	(p. 310, 5–6) since the expressions "one man", or "man is (*huwa*)", or "this man", signify one thing.
[8] (p. 303, 9–12) If the concept of "one" were the concept of "existent" (*mawǧūd*) in every aspect, then the many, in as much as it is many, would not be an existent (*mawǧūd*), as it is not		

[37] Reading ταὐτὸ γὰρ εἷς ἄνθρωπος καὶ ὢν ἄνθρωπος καὶ ἄνθρωπος, as in Aristotle [1957], instead of ταὐτὸ γὰρ εἷς ἄνθρωπος καὶ ἄνθρωπος, καὶ ὢν ἄνθρωπος καὶ ἄνθρωπος, as in Aristotle [1924].

[38] See above, n. 37.

Table 5 (*cont.*)

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt* VII, 1, p. 303, 5–14 [pp. 349, 7–350, 22]	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* Γ, 1, 1003a21–22; Γ, 2, 1003b22–27, 32–36, 1004a9–20	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
one—even though "one" accidentally occurs to it as well, so that multiplicity is said to be "one multiplicity" (but not in so far as it is multiplicity).		
[9] (p. 303, 13–14) Therefore it is suitable for us to speak also of the things that are proper to unity and its opposite[39]—i.e. multiplicity—as sameness (*huwahuwiyya*),[40] homogeneity, coincidence (*muwāfaqa*), equality, likeness and their opposites. similar and the other	(1003b33–36) all this being so, there must be exactly as many species of being as of unity. And to investigate the essence of these is the work of a science which is generically one—I mean, for instance, the discussion of the same (ταὐτοῦ) and the similar and the other concepts of this sort.	(p. 311, 1–3) Thus, it is known that the species of "one" are as many as the species of being (*huwiyya*), and the absolute investigation of these species and the knowledge of what they are belong to one science—I mean that the investigation of the coincident (*muttafiq*), the things that resemble these, belongs to one science.
	(1004a9–20) Now since it is the work of one science to investigate opposites, and plurality is opposite to unity . . . in view of all these facts, the contraries of the concepts we named above, the other and the dissimilar and the unequal, and everything else which is derived either from these or from plurality and unity, must fall within the province of the science above-named.	(pp. 316, 14–317, 8) Since the investigation of opposites necessarily belongs to one science, and the opposite of unity is plurality . . . then it is known that the other, the dissimilar, the unequal and all the other things that are said in this way or in the way of plurality, are opposite to the aforementioned things. Since knowledge of unity belongs to the science we mentioned . . .[41]

[39] Reading *wa-bi-muqābilatihā* instead of *wa-bi-muqābilātihā* (see Appendix A).
[40] Reading *al-huwahuwiyyati* intead of *al-huwiyyati* (see Appendix A).
[41] Usṭāṯ read the second part of the Greek original text (ὥστε καὶ τἀντικείμενα

Quotation 5 consists of nine sections.[42] Section [1] is a retrospective summary in which Avicenna recalls the topics he has dealt with in the previous part of the *Ilāhiyyāt.* namely the "things that are proper to" (*al-umūr allatī taḫtaṣṣu bi-*) "being *qua* being" (*huwiyya min ḥayṯu hiya huwiyya*)[43]—i.e. the properties of "existent *qua* existent" in OntologyP (treatises IV–VI)—or "are consequent to it" (*talḥaquhā*)—an expression that possibly includes, besides the properties, also the species of "existent *qua* existent" in OntologyS (treatises II–III).[44] In section [1] Avicenna refers to the opening sentence of book Γ (Γ, 1, 1003a21–22), already cited in Quotation 1 (see above, §3.1).

In sections [2]–[8], Avicenna shows that there is a very tight relationship between "existent" and "one": they refere to the same things ([2]–[4]), even though they have different meanings ([5]–[8]); in other words: they have the same "extension", but different "intentions". In section [9], on account of the aforementioned relationship between "existent" and "one", Avicenna states that metaphysics has to investigate not only the properties of "existent", but also those of "one" and "many", thus justifying the presence of HenologyP in the *Ilāhiyyāt.* Sections [2]–[7] are a discontinuous paraphrase of Γ, 2, 1003b22–33: Avicenna cites distinct passages of this pericope, occasionally changing their order and elucidating their doctrine. In section [7], Avicenna explains Aristotle's idea of the extensional identity of "being" and "one" by means of the notion of identity "in subject" (*bi-l-mawḍūʿ*). In section [8], he adds a proof of Aristotle's doctrine of the intensional difference between "being" and "one" (1003b24–25, quoted in section [6]), by means of a *reductio ad absurdum* of the contrary thesis.

In section [9], Avicenna concludes that metaphysics has to investigate both the properties of "one" and the properties of the concept

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τοῖς εἰρημένοις, τό τε ἕτερον καὶ ἀνόμοιον καὶ ἄνισον καὶ ὅσα ἄλλα λέγεται ἢ κατὰ ταὐτα ἢ κατὰ πλῆθος καὶ τὸ ἕν, τῆς εἰρημένης γνωρίζειν ἐπιστήμης) according to the following syntax: ὥστε καὶ τἀντικείμενα τοῖς εἰρημένοις τό τε ἕτερον καὶ ἀνόμοιον καὶ ἄνισον καὶ ὅσα ἄλλα λέγεται ἢ κατὰ ταὐτα ἢ κατὰ πλῆθος. καὶ τὸ ἕν τῆς εἰρημένης γνωρίζειν ἐπιστήμης . . .

[42] The dependence of sections [2]–[7] on *Metaphysics* Γ, 2 has been pointed out by Wisnovsky [2000], p. 198 and n. 34, p. 219.

[43] Avicenna's use in section [1] of *huwiyya* ("being"), rather than *mawǧūd* ("existent") occurring in sections [2], [3] and [8]), is probably due to his reliance on Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics* (see Chapter 8, §1.1, and the analysis of this text in Bertolacci [2003]).

[44] See Chapter 5, §4.4, Text 4 [g]. On the terminology by means of which Avicenna describes here the attributes of "existent", see Appendix F, Ib, IV.

opposite to "one", i.e "multiplicity". What Avicenna says in these two regards corresponds to Γ, 2, 1003b33–36, and Γ, 2, 1004a9–20. In the former passage, Aristotle includes the "same" (ταὐτό) among the properties of "one", as Avicenna does with "sameness" (*huwahuwiyya*).[45]

4 The Influence of Γ on Avicenna's Conception of Metaphysics as a Science

In *Metaphysics* Γ are present *in nuce* the guide-lines of Avicenna's scientific reshaping of the metaphyiscs: within the Aristotelian *corpus*, this book represents the first tentative and incomplete application to metaphysics of the epistemological canons of the *Posterior Analytics*. About the theme of metaphysics, in Γ Aristotle portrays this discipline as the science of "being *qua* being" (Γ, 1, 1003a20);[46] about its structure, he ascribes to metaphysics the investigation of the species, properties, and principles of "being" (Γ, 2, 1003b21–22; Γ, 1, 1003a20–21; Γ, 2, 1004b15–17; Γ, 2, 1005a13–14; Γ, 1, 1003a31–32), the species and properties of "one" (Γ, 2, 1003b22–25, 33–35; Γ, 2, 1004b5–8), and the investigation of "multiplicity" (Γ, 2, 1004a9–10, 17–20);[47] as to the method, he distinguishes the procedures of metaphysics, on the one hand, from those of dialectic and sophistic, on the other (Γ, 2, 1004b22–26), and assigns to the metaphysician the

[45] Usṭāṯ translates ταὐτό in Γ, 2, 1003b33–36, as *muttafiq*; likewise, he renders τὴν αὐτὴν ἔχει φύσιν in B, 2, 998a6, as *tuwāfiqu bi-l-ṭibā'i* (*Tafsīr*, p. 211, 2). In I, 3, 1054a29–32 ("To the one belong . . . the same—ταὐτό—and the like and the equal, and to plurality belong the other and the unlike and the unequal"), on the contrary, Usṭāṯ translates ταὐτό as *huwahuwa* (*Tafsīr*, p. 1286, 1–2: " . . . to one belong the same—*huwahuwa*, the similar and the equal, and to plurality belong the other, the dissimilar and the unequal"). It cannot be excluded that Avicenna's section [9] depends on both Γ, 2 and I, 3, according to Usṭāṯ's translation. The two different renderings of ταὐτό in Usṭāṯ's translation of these two *loci* might explain the presence of both *huwahuwīya* ("sameness") and *muwāfaqa* (which I tentatively translate as "coincidence") among the properties of unity that Avicenna enlists in section [9]. *Muwāfaqa* is an *apax logomenon* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The term *al-muwāfiq* occurs in I, 2, p. 13, 1 [p. 12, 21], and I, 4, p. 27, 5 [p. 30, 69–70]; for *wifāq*, see *Aqsām*, p. 89, 19. The other properties of unity that Avicenna mentions in section [9], with the exception perhaps of "homogeneity", are also taken from the *Metaphysics*. The term ὁμογενῆ occurs only once in the *Metaphysics* (I, 7, 1057b29), where it is not related in any way to unity. It is translated as *muǧānisa* by Usṭāṯ (*Tafsīr*, p. 1355, 13). Unity in genus is one of the types of unity Aristotle distinguishes in Δ, 6.

[46] See Chapter 4, §2.1, Text 9.

[47] See Chapter 5, §6.3, Texts 13, 12.1–3, 14.1; Texts 15–16; Text 17.

task of analyzing the various acceptions of mutivocal terms (Γ, 2, 1004a25–31);[48] finally, with regard to the relationship between metaphysics and the other sciences, he hints at the epistemological limitations of the particular sciences (Γ, 2, 1005a11–13), and points at metaphysics as the discipline that undertakes the epistemological foundation that the particular sciences, like mathematics and natural philosophy, are unable to accomplish (Γ, 3, 1005a29–b2).[49] We have already observed in Part II the deep impact of all these doctrines on Avicenna's conception of the subject-matter, structure, method and rank of metaphysics.

5 The Reception of *Metaphysics* Γ before Avicenna

5.1 *Greek commentators: Alexander of Aphrodisias*

All the three extant Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics* dating from the Imperial Age and Late Antiquity (namely the commentaries by Alexander of Aphrodisias on books A-Δ, by Syrianus on books B-Γ and M-N, and by Ammonius/Asclepius on books A-Z) encompass book Γ.[50] More precisely: Γ, together with B, is the only book of the *Metaphysics* upon which all these authors comment.

In the light of Alexander of Aphrodisias' endeavour of transforming metaphysics into a properly scientific discipline, the special attention that he pays to Γ among the books of the *Metaphysics* is not surprising. In the introduction to his commentary on Γ, Alexander portrays this book as the doctrinal "beginning" of the *Metaphysics*, i.e. as the first book in which Aristotle's expounds his own point of view.

> Text 1.1: Alexander of Aphrodisias, In *Metaph.* Γ, proem
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> . . . after the aporiae [i.e. of book Beta] he [= Aristotle] begins the present book, Gamma, in this book finally telling and establishing his own positions, and solving the points of aporia.[51]

In Text 1.1 Alexander appears to disconnect Γ from the books preceding it: the fact that Aristotle is "finally telling and establishing his

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[48] See Chapter 6, §4.1, Text 9; §5.1, Text 20.
[49] See Chapter 7, §5.1, Text 23; Text 24.
[50] See Chapter 4, §2.2.
[51] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 238, 1–3; Engl. transl. in Madigan [1993], p. 11.

own positions" seems to refer not only, directly, to book B, but also, indirectly, to books A and α.[52] In this way, Alexander singles out what he regards as one of the fundamental joints of the *Metaphysics*.

The idea expressed in Text 1.1 is resumed by Alexander in his introduction to the commentary on Λ, according to Averroes' *reportatio*:

> Text 1.2: Alexander of Aphrodisias, proem to *Metaph.* Λ *apud* Averroes, *Tafsīr*, p. 1394, 7–8; p. 1395, 5–7 (= Chapter 5, §6.4, Text 19 [c], [g])
>
> [a] Some other [books of the *Metaphysics*] contain the solution of these problems [i.e. of the *aporiai* of B]: this is what he [i.e. Aristotle] did in the books placed after this book [i.e. after book B]. [. . .]
>
> [b] He [i.e. Alexander] says: From his discussion at the beginning of book G and elsewhere, one can infer that this book [i.e. L] is the last in which he discusses about this science.[53]

Text 1.2 repeats the point already established by Text 1.1 (in Γ Aristotle starts to solve the aporiai of book B) and credits this book with a noteworthy "authority": the portrayal of metaphysics as the sciences of the principles of "being *qua* being" in Γ, 1, 1003a26–32, is the proof, according to Alexander, that Aristotle's own doctrine in by Avicenna the *Metaphysics* ends with book Λ.[54]

Alexander's exegesis of book Γ shows similarities with Avicenna's reception of this book. The passage of Γ, 2 reworked by Avicenna in Quotation 2 is mentioned among the most important topics of Γ in Alexander's introduction to this book, and is also recalled in his introduction to book Δ.[55] The idea that Aristotle's defense of the axioms is a syllogism (Quotation 4) is already present in Alexander's commentary.[56] Also the interpretation of Aristotle's doctrine of the

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[52] Alexander regards A as doxographical (see Chapter 5, §6.4, Text 19 [f]), and α as incomplete and introductory (In *Metaph.*, pp. 137–138; Dooley-Madigan [1992], pp. 9–11).

[53] *Tafsīr*, p. 1394, 7–8; p. 1395, 5–7.

[54] Alexander might refer not only to Γ, 1 but also to the so-called "theological passages" occurring in the defense of the axioms in Γ, 5–7 (Γ, 5, 1009a36–38; 1010a32–35; Γ, 7, 1012b22–31).

[55] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 238, 22–27 (Madigan [1993], p. 12); p. 344, 14–16, 18–20 (Dooley [1993], p. 11).

[56] With regard to Aristotle's "demonstration by way of refutation" of the principle of non-contradiction, Alexander contends that the axioms cannot be demonstrated (p. 266, 17–22; p. 266, 32–34; Madigan [1993], pp. 45–46), and that Aristotle's defense is a syllogism (p. 273, 11–12, p. 273, 13, p. 273, 22; Madigan [1993], pp. 54–55), even though it cannot be called "demonstration" literally speaking and with no further qualification (p. 274, 15, p. 274, 19; Madigan [1993], p. 56).

extensional identity of "being" and "one" as an identity "in subject" (Quotation 5, Table 5 [7]) occurs in Alexander's exegesis.[57]

Since Alexander's commentary on the *Metaphysics* was quite influential on later authors, subsequent commentators must have shared his special consideration of Γ among the books of the *Metaphysics*.

5.2 *Arab philosophers: Al-Fārābī*

Whereas the Greek commentaries on Γ were not translated into Arabic, book Γ itself was translated at least twice, in both the main Arabic versions of the *Metaphysics* (Usṭāṭ; Isḥāq).[58] Due to these translations, we observe an increasing prestige of this book among pre-Avicennian Arab philosophers.

In al-Kindī's metaphysics, Γ performs a marginal function. As we have seen in Chapter 2, his *Falsafa Ūlā* rests mainly on two other books of the *Metaphysics*, namely α and Λ. In the extant part of this work, al-Kindī takes inspiration from Γ only occasionally, and draws from this book some examples that he uses in other contexts.[59] Only one passage of Γ, 2 is properly, though implicitly, quoted.[60]

Less than a century after al-Kindī, the attention paid by al-Fārābī's to book Γ is decidedly greater. As we have seen in Chapter 3, the *Fī Aġrāḍ* depends largely on Γ, both for its main ideas and with regard to more specific points, both directly and indirectly (possibly through Ammonius).[61] However, in the third part of this work,

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[57] Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], pp. 238, 5–6, 246, 30–31, 32–33; Madigan [1993], pp. 11, 21. From Alexander's commentary this idea passed in Ross' commentary (see Aristotle [1924], vol. I, p. 257). On Alexander's commentary on *Metaph.* Γ, see Flannery [2003] and Mignucci [2003].

[58] See Chapter 1, §1.1.

[59] See Al-Kindī [1998], p. 93, 15–16 (cp. p. 92, n. 80), where the idea that all medical things refer to medicine (Γ, 2, 1003b1–3) is introduced as an example of unity "according to reciprocal equality" (i.e. unity "by analogy", mentioned by Aristotle in Δ, 6, 1016b34–35); at p. 21, 1–2, the principle of non-contradiction (Γ, 3, 1005b19) is mentioned as an example of thing that the soul perceives by means of the intellect, not through the senses.

[60] Γ, 2, 1003b22–34; Al-Kindī [1998], p. 95, 1–2: "It is clear that being (*huwiyya*) is predicated of everything of which one is predicated; hence it is predicated of things that are as numerous as the species of one". (*wa-bayyinun anna l-huwiyyata tuqālu ʿalā kulli mā ʿalayhī* [*ʿillatuhū* add. al-Kindī [1998] and Al-Kindī [1950]; seclusi] *l-wāḥidu fa-l-huwiyyatu tuqālu li-mā taʿudduhū anwāʾu l-wāḥidi*). Rashed-Jolivet [1998], p. 86, n. 71, present another passage of *Falsafa Ūlā* (p. 87, 9–10) as deriving from Γ, 2, 1003b1–3; in fact, this passage depends on *Soph. El.* 4, 166a16.

[61] The great importance that al-Fārābī attaches to Γ is probably the cause of some "decontextualizations", i.e. of mentions of doctrines of this book in relation

al-Fārābī does not arrange the books of the *Metaphysics* according to the parameters established by book Γ, but keep them in their original order. The rebuilding of the *Metaphysics* according to the indications of Γ will be accomplished by Avicenna.

Conclusion

Γ is the fundamental book of the *Metaphysics* in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*. This is attested by the quantity and quality of its quotations, and by its impact on the epistemological framework of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The textual quotations of Γ concentrate in the first treatise of this work, precede those of the other books of the *Metaphysics*, and refer to all the main topics of Γ. Avicenna takes from Γ the fundamental aspects of metaphysics as a science: its main theme, i.e. "existent *qua* existent" (Quotation 1); the peculiarity of its method in comparison with the methods of dialectic and sophistic (Quotation 2); its very existence as a science dealing with "existent *qua* existent" (Quotation 3); its function of discipline that clarifies the epistemological principles of the other sciences, like the axioms (Quotation 4); its status of discipline that takes into account not only "existent", but also "one" and the properties of both (Quotation 5).

The reception of Γ is crucial in Avicenna's endeavour to give the *Metaphysics* a rigorous scientific basis. Avicenna establishes the fundaments of the science of metaphysics in the first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt* on the basis of book Γ and the *Posterior Analytics*, and then employs the content of other books of the *Metaphysics* to instantiate the model of scientific metaphysics outlined preliminarily.

Avicenna's use of book Γ as a "tool" to transform Aristotle's *Metaphysics* according to a proper scientific profile is the last stage of a long exegetical tradition. This tradition starts—as far as we know—with Alexander of Aphrodisias, and has in al-Fārābī its most conspicuos representant in pre-Avicennian Arabic philosophy.

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to other books of the *Metaphysics*: the similarities between metaphysics, on the one hand, and dialectic and sophistic, on the other, for example, are recalled by al-Fārābī not in the description of book Γ, where they are actually discussed by Aristotle (Γ, 2, 1004b17–26; see above, Quotation 2), but in the description of book E (see Chapter 3, §1 [3.5]). In E, 2 1026b14–16, Aristotle incidentally refers to sophistic; but in no place of this book he provides an account of the similarities between metaphysics, dialectic and sophistic.

CHAPTER TEN

AVICENNA'S ATTITUDE TOWARDS DIALECTIC: BOOK B AND ITS QUOTATIONS*

Already during his philosophical education, Avicenna conceived the practice of philosophy as an endeavour to solve theoretical problems. In the Autobiography, for example, when describing his "undergraduate education" in philosophy (which occupied him from the age of 16 for one and a half years), Avicenna says the following:

> Text 1: Autobiography, pp. 28, 3–30, 3
>
> Every time I was at a loss about a problem (*wa-llaḏī kuntu ataḥayyaru fīhi mina l-masā'il*), concerning which I was unable to find the middle term in a syllogism, I would repair on its account to the mosque and worship, praying humbly to the All-Creator to disclose to me its obscurity and make its difficulty easy. At night I would return home, set the lamp before me, and occupy myself with reading and writing. Whenever I felt drowsy or weakening, I would turn aside to drink a cup of wine to regain my strength, and then I would go back to my reading. Whenever I fell asleep, I would see those very problems (*masā'il*) in my dream; and many problems (*masā'il*) became clear to me while asleep.[1]

The details of this passage, such as Avicenna's recourse to prayers, wine-drinking and dreams, do not concern us here.[2] What is noteworthy is his peculiar attitude towards the problems (*masā'il*) he encountered during his philosophical studies, namely his resolute will to find a solution to them. In this regard, his resort to all the procedures at his disposal, even non-philosophical ones, in order to find the "clarification" (*iṭṭiḍāḥ*)—i.e. the explanation in syllogistic form—of the still unsolved problems is significant. Already at this early stage, solving puzzles appears to be an essential and inescapable element of Avicenna's way of doing philosophy.

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* This chapter is a revised version of Bertolacci [2004b].

[1] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 27–28. The expression "undergraduate education" is taken from the detailed account of Avicenna's Autobiography in Gutas [1988], pp. 149–198 (see Chapter 2).

[2] See Gutas [1988], pp. 181–187.

Avicenna's approach to philosophical difficulties remains similar to the one emerging from Text 1 also later on in his life, when he becomes a teacher of philosophy. The collection of texts known as the *Mubāḥaṯāt* (*Discussions*) contains three letters by Avicenna to the disciple Bahmanyār. In one of these, written probably in 1030 (seven years before his death), Avicenna states:

> Text 2: Letter to Bahmanyār in *Mubāḥaṯāt*
>
> As for the questions (*masā'il*) which you asked me, they are significant questions (*masā'il*) about the philosophical sciences, and especially these particular ones. But treating such [questions] briefly leads to error, while too many of them overtax a mind preoccupied with cares and it can hardly concentrate in the areas requiring explanation, especially for somebody who is like me and in my situation. I have studied [these questions] carefully and I have found them to be the proper ones; some I have answered at sufficient length, other by means of pointers, and still other perhaps I have been unable to answer at all. [. . .] You should engage in more such discussions [with me] on anything you wish, because in them lies pleasure and benefit. Whatever I am able to bring to light I will do so either openly, or from behind a veil which will act as a useful kind of stimulus and drill for it [i.e. the question at hand]; whatever I am unable to do so, I will excuse myself and admit it, since what is known to mankind is limited.[3]

The continuity between Text 1 and Text 2 is striking. In the former, we see an exceptionally precocious self-taught Avicenna praying humbly in the mosque during the day, and doing intensive research in his house at night, in order to receive in a dream, while sleeping on his books, directly from the Agent Intellect, the syllogistic elucidation of many of the problems he is unable to solve. In the latter, an experienced Avicenna encourages the disciple to submit to him his "questions" (*masā'il*), so that the teacher, more aware now of the limits of human reason than he was during his youth, can express an authoritative "answer" (*ǧawāb*) on some of them, after a careful study and to the extent of his ability. The same pattern of question and answer governs most of the material gathered in the

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[3] Avicenna [1992], §36, pp. 50, 11–51, 4; §45, pp. 53, 13–54, 2; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 58–59, slightly modified. Gutas translates this letter under the title "Letter to an Anonymous Disciple". This letter is classified as part MII of the *Mubāḥaṯāt*, studied, dated, and related to the rest of the work by Reisman [2002], pp. 207–213, 231–233.

Mubāḥaṯāt, which, in this perspective, can rightly be regarded as a "collection of philosophical questions and Avicenna's written answers".[4]

Regardless whether they are problems (i.e. questions raised by the very nature of things), as in Text 1, or questions (i.e. problems posed by students), as in Text 2, Avicenna's attitude towards the philosophical *masā'il* remains the same throughout all his life: he strives, as much as possible, to find a solution or an answer to them, or, in other words, to remove and eliminate them. The Socratic way of doing philosophy by raising doubts, with an "ironical" attitude and a "maieutic" purpose, is totally alien to Avicenna.

In the *Šifā'*, Avicenna argues that the doubts that can be found in Aristotle's works are, in many cases, finally solved by Aristotle himself; when this does not happen, they are meant to contribute, by means of the confusion they create in superficial interpreters, to Aristotle's general strategy of witholding truth from persons unworthy of it.

> Text 3: *'Ibāra* II, 4, p. 121, 2–8
>
> [a] It ought to be known, with regard to this excellent First Teacher, that he is not fond of creating doubts (*taškīk*) and delaying the disclosure [of truth] (*kašf*).
>
> [b] In many things he proceeds according to the method of doubt (*qanūn al-šakk*), but then, at the end, he goes back [to the issue] and solves [it] (*yaḥullu*).
>
> [c] Sometimes he is careless (*tasāhala*) with regard to things about which himself has taught us what the lack of carelessness (*tark al-tasāhul*) with regard to them entails . . . Thus it happens that the reader of his books is prompt to believe firmly what he is careless (*tasāhala*) about, and to be misled by the apparent meaning of his statements, without searching and investigating [further]; then he starts to cling fanatically to what he has understood [about Aristotle's statements], without going deep [into the issues], with the result of deceiving himself.
>
> [d] Know that this excellent [man] aimed in many things to conceal the truth by withholding it (*ḍannan bihī*), so that [only] the person who is strong enough to arrive to it can attain it from nearby.

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[4] Gutas [1988], p. 143. The disputational method that Avicenna systematically displays in works such as the *Mubāḥaṯāt* is well described by Gutas [2002], pp. 86–88 (Gutas calls this method not only "disputational", but also "aporetic", in the sense of "dialectical"). It is remarkable that in the already mentioned letter to Bahmanyār (Avicenna [1992], p. 49, 7), the *Mašriqiyyūn* are referred to by means of the expression *al-masā'il al-mašriqiyya*, namely "*Eastern questions*" (see Gutas [1988], pp. 115–116). The role of the disputational method in this work is still to be assessed.

Section [a] states that making the reader doubt is not, as such, Aristotle's aim. This statement is corroborated by section [b], where Avicenna recalls the many cases in which Aristotle conclusively solves the doubts he has advanced, and by section [d], where the ultimate reason of Aristotle's use of doubts and other similar obfuscatory devices—i.e. the intended "occultation" of truth from people unworthy to receive it—is provided.[5] Neither section [c] in itself, nor its relationship with the previous sections is completely clear: Avicenna possibly alludes to the same idea expressed by al-Fārābī in the *Ǧamʿ*, namely that in some cases Aristotle passes over something obscure without providing the necessary details (this being his "carelessness"), whereas elsewhere he discusses at great length issues that are already evident (this being his "lack of carelessnees").[6] If this is so, Avicenna might refer here to Aristotle's practice of presenting doubts without providing their solutions. If not the nature, however, at least the effects of Aristotle's carelessness in [c] are clear: this practice prompts ordinary interpreters of Aristotle's works to seriously misunderstand the doctrine of these latter. Thus, the main point of Text 3 appears to be the following: in order to respect Aristotle's original "spirit" (section [a]), and to avoid interpretative difficulties (sections [c] and [d]), it is necessary to find a solution to the doubts advanced by Aristotle, either the solution proposed by Aristotle himself (section [b]) or the one provided by sharp interpreters of his writings like Avicenna.

In the light of Texts 1–3, it is interesting to study Avicenna's treatment in the *Ilāhiyyāt* of a particular class of philosophical problems/questions/doubts, namely the *aporiai* of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Aristotle's *aporiai* are a particularly challenging type of theoretical difficulties, for they are difficulties with no apparent and no immediate solution, resulting from the contrast between mutually exclusive and equally reliable arguments or states of affairs. Even though *aporiai* can be found throughout the *Metaphysics*,[7] one of the fourteen books of this work, namely B, is specifically devoted to explaining the philosophical significance of the *aporiai* concerning metaphysics,

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[5] On the philosophical and religious background of the topic of witholding knowledge in Avicenna, see Gutas [1988], pp. 225–234.

[6] Al-Fārābī [1960], p. 85, 9–11; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 229 (iv).

[7] See, for example, H, 5, 1044b29; 1044b34; Λ, 2, 1069b26–27; Λ, 4, 1070a33; Λ, 6, 1071b22; Λ, 9, 1074b15–17; 1075a5. Barnes [2000], p. 60, states: "It is undeniable that many of Aristotle's treatises are, in large part, aporetic in style".

and to collecting and discussing them.[8] Whereas both book B itself and the philosophical tradition leading to, and deriving from, it, are receiving an increasing scholarly interest,[9] the reception of this book by Avicenna has not yet been investigated. This is the aim of the present chapter.

The distinctive traits of Avicenna's approach to book B in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are the following. First, Avicenna does not quotes all the *aporiai* that Aristotle takes into account in B, but only some of them. Second, he quotes only some parts of the selected aporias. Third, he never presents the *aporiai* he quotes as unsettled problems, but either provides what he regards as the true doctrine concerning the issues at stake, or portrays the *aporiai* neutrally, as useful devices to elucidate further distinctions. The solution of the *aporiai* provided by Avicenna is either Aristotle's own solution (whenever Aristotle resumes and solves the *aporiai* in the following books of the *Metaphysics*), or a solution supplied by Avicenna along Aristotelian lines (whenever Aristotle does not take a clear stand on the issue). In the former case, Avicenna's position on the *aporiai* reflects what contemporary Aristotelian scholars take as Aristotle's solution (or lack thereof) of these problems. Fourth, Avicenna does not quote the *aporiai* in a single section of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, but in different treatises of this work; thus, no textual unit of the *Ilāhiyyāt* consists in a collection of *aporiai* analogous to *Metaphysics* B, having its same preliminary and propaedeutic function.

The present exposition is divided into four sections. In the first (§1), a brief overview of *Metaphysics* B is provided. In the second section (§2), the quotations of B that can be found in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are

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[8] The Greek term ἀπορία, recurring 15 times in B, is almost invariably rendered as, or by means of, the expression "ambiguous problem/question" (*mas'ala ġāmiḍa*) in the only extant Arabic translation of this book of the *Metaphysics*, the one by Usṭāṯ (see Chapter 1 §1.1). The only exceptions to the rendering of ἀπορία as *mas'ala ġāmiḍa* in Usṭāṯ's translation of B are: 995a30 (*nukūlu l-fahmi*, *Tafsīr*, p. 166, 1) and 999b17 (*šanā'a*, *Tafsīr*, p. 236, 11); in the translation of ἀπορία at 1000a5 (*Tafsīr*, p. 246, 14–15) the adjective *ġāmiḍa* is omitted. The expression *mas'ala ġāmiḍa* recurs frequently in Usṭāṯ's translation of the verbs ἀπορῆσαι, διαπορῆσαι and προαπορεῖν throughout B.

[9] This is witnessed by its English translation, with introduction and commentary, by Arthur Madigan (Madigan [1999]), the comprehensive study on *aporia* in Aristotle and his Greek predecessors by the Centre of Aristotelian Studies at the University of Liege (Motte-Rutten [2001]), and the French translation of Averroes' commentary on B by Laurence Bauloye (Bauloye [2002]). Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on B is taken into account by Movia [2003].

analyzed. In the third section (§3), Avicenna's attitude towards B is shown to be consistent with the guidelines established in the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*. In the last section (§4), finally, the antecedents of Avicenna's particular way of quoting B are taken into account.

1 A BRIEF OVERVIEW OF *METAPHYSICS* B

Metaphysics B, the third book of this work according to the Greek numeration, is a collection of unsolved theoretical problems, or *aporiai*. The *aporiai* taken into account in B are metaphysical issues, for each of which Aristotle provides pros and cons, or thesis and antithesis, of equal weight.

B can be divided into three main parts. First, Aristotle clarifies the importance of an attentive scrutiny of *aporiai* in order to find correct solutions to them (B, 1, 995a24–b4). Then, he briefly describes the *aporiai* he is dealing with (B, 1, 995b4–996a17). Finally, he thoroughly discusses each of the *aporiai* previously described (B, 2–6). There is no precise correspondence between the exposition and the discussion of the *aporiai*, both in terms of content (the *aporia* discussed at B, 6, 1002b12–32, is not mentioned before) and in terms of order (the *aporia* discussed at B, 2, 997a25–34 is expounded after the *aporia* discussed at B, 2, 997a34–998a19). Modern scholars substantially agree in identifying in B the discussion of fifteen *aporiai*.[10] As to their content, the *aporiai* of B can be divided into two basic groups: the first four concern metaphysics as a science and arise from the supposed universal scope of this discipline; the remaining eleven *aporiai*, on the other hand, address specific difficulties concerning the things that metaphysics investigates, with particular regard to the principles.

In B itself Aristotle does not aim at solving the *aporiai*, and he never settles the conflict between thesis and antithesis. In this respect it is right to say that "B is, on the whole, more critical than conclusive, probing difficulties but not settling them definitively".[11]

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[10] Medieval Latin commentators had sometimes a different view on their number, by taking as independent *aporiai* some issues that modern commentator regard as articulations of one and the same *aporia*. Both Albertus Magnus and Thomas Aquinas, for instance, regard B as dealing with a higher number of *aporiai*: according to the former, Aristotle describes twenty-seven *aporiai* in the second part of B (see Albertus Magnus [1960], pp. 107–109); from what can be inferred from the latter's commentary on the *Metaphysics*, the *aporiai* described by Aristotle are twenty-two (see Thomas Aquinas [1977], pp. 98–103).

[11] See Madigan [1999], p. xxii.

Sections of the following books of the *Metaphysics*, however, can be regarded as the solutions of some of the *aporiai* of B, some of which are also explicitly recalled.[12]

2 The quotations of *Metaphysics* B in the *Ilāhiyyāt*

In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna quotes four times book B, with regard to five of the fifteen *aporiai* discussed by Aristotle. A list of Avicenna's quotations and of the corresponding passages in B is provided in the following table.

Table A

Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*, quotations of B	Aristotle, *Metaphysics* B
(1) I, 8, p. 54, 3–5	B, 2, 997a2–11 (*aporia* 2, antithesis)
(2) VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4	B, 3, 998a20–23, 998b9–11 (*aporia* 6, thesis) B, 3, 998b19–21, 999a4–5 (*aporia* 7, thesis)
(3) VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 4; p. 300, 7–8	B, 2, 996a20–b3, 10–13 (*aporia* 1, thesis and antithesis)
(4) VIII, 4, pp. 344, 16–345, 5	B, 4, 1001a9–19 (*aporia* 11, thesis and antithesis)

Avicenna quotes passages from, in the order, *aporia* 2; *aporia* 6 and *aporia* 7 (jointly); *aporia* 1; *aporia* 11.[13] All the quotations are taken from the discussion of the *aporiai* in the third part of B. Two among the quoted *aporiai* (1 and 2) belong to the first group of four *aporiai*, concerning the scientific status of metaphysics. The other three *aporiai* (6, 7 and 11) belong to the second group of eleven *aporiai*, dealing with the things metaphysics investigates; they concern in particular the concepts of "being" and "one". All this suggests that Avicenna is particularly interested, on the one hand, in issues regarding metaphysics as a science, and, on the other hand, in the doctrine of the primary concepts. As to their style, Avicenna's quotations of the *aporiai*

[12] See, for instance, Γ, 2, 1004a31–34.

[13] Avicenna might refer also to *aporia* 3 (B, 3, 997a25–34) in VI, 5, p. 300, 4–6 [p. 348, 13–18]; but, if he does, the reference is quite vague and cannot be regarded as a quotation. Cp. also *aporia* 2 (B, 2, 997a 5–7) with I, 2, p. 14, 4–6 [pp. 13, 51–14, 54] (see Chapter 4, §1.2; Chapter 5, §1).

of B are implicit; their extent and degree of faithfulness to the original are variable. They occur in different places of the *Ilāhiyyāt* with a significant concentration in the VI treatise.[14] The dissemination of the quotations is due to the fact that Avicenna quotes the *aporiai* in contexts suiting the issues debated in them.

Avicenna's solution of the *aporiai* (i.e. his position regarding thesis and antithesis) can be conveniently compared with Aristotle's in the following table:

Table B

	Avicenna, *Ilāhiyyāt*	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*
aporia 2	thesis asserted in I, 8, pp. 53, 16–54, 2 (quotation of Γ, 3, 1005a19–b 8)	thesis asserted in Γ, 3, 1005a19–b8
aporia 6	thesis implicitly criticized in VI, 4, p. 281, 3–4	no solution
aporia 7	thesis criticized in VI, 4, p. 281, 3–4	no solution
aporia 1	thesis asserted in VI, 5, p. 299, 3, and put in practice in VI, 1–5	thesis implicitly asserted in Γ, 1–2
aporia 11	no solution	no solution

2.1 *The first quotation*: Aporia *2*

In *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 8, p. 54, 3–5 [p. 63, 98–00], Avicenna refers to *aporia* 2 (B, 2, 996b26–997a15), of which he quotes a part (997a2–11). *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 8 is mainly devoted to the analysis of the first principles of demonstration, or axioms, along the lines traced by Aristotle in *Metaphysics* Γ, 3–5. The quotation of *aporia* 2 occurs at the end of the chapter, and represents its conclusion. It immediately follows the quotation of Γ, 3, 1005a19–b8, i.e. of the place of the *Metaphysics* where Aristotle, according to Aristotelian scholars, provides its solution. Avicenna thus agrees with modern Aristotelian interpreters as to where Aristotle solves the *aporia*, even though he inverts the order

[14] Since the VI treatise deals with causality, this may be regarded as a sign of the importance of the doctrine of causality in Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*.

of the two texts, quoting the *aporia* after its solution, not before it. Avicenna presents the quoted part of the *aporia* as an objection that a ficticious opponent moves to its solution.[15]

Table 1.1 contains an outline of *aporia* 2 and of its solution by Aristotle, together with the corresponding quotations by Avicenna.

Table 1.1

Ilāhiyyāt I, 8, pp. 53, 16–54, 17	Aristotle's *Metaphysics*	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
pp. 53, 16–54, 2: Metaphysics is the science of both the axioms and substance.	Γ, 3, 1005a19–b8: Solution of *aporia* 2, issue (b), thesis: The metaphysician investigates both substance and axioms.	pp. 335, 16–336, 18; p. 341, 2–7
	Discussion of *aporia* 2: B, 2, 996b26–33: Issue (a): Whether the investigation of the axioms belongs to only one science (thesis), or to more than one (antithesis). Issue (b): If there is only one science of the axioms, whether the science of the axioms and the science of substance are the same science (thesis), or not (antithesis). Issue (c): If the science of axioms and the science of substance are not the same science, whether the discipline sought for (i.e. metaphysics) is the science of the axioms (thesis), or the science of substance (antithesis).	p. 192, 7–15
	B, 2, 996b33–997a2: (a) Antithesis: The investigation of the axioms does not belong to only one science.	om.

[15] See Chapter 6, §3.3, Table 8.

Table 1.1 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt I, 8, pp. 53, 16–54, 17	Aristotle's *Metaphysics*	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
	First argument: The investigation of the axioms is not proper to a science more than to another. (b) Antithesis: Hence, it is not proper to the science of substance either.	
p. 54, 3–5: Objection: (b) Metaphysics cannot be the science of both the axioms and substance	B, 2, 997a2–11: (a) Antithesis: The investigation of the axioms does not belong to only one science. Second argument: There cannot be any science of the axioms (as an independent discipline, in distinction from the commonly recognized sciences).	pp. 192, 15–193, 7
	B, 2, 997a11–15: (b) Thesis: The science of the axioms is the same science that investigates substance, because, if the science of the axioms were different from the science of substance, it would be impossible to say which one is superior to the other.	p. 193, 7–11
p. 54, 6–17: Answer to the objection		

Aporia 2 is quite complex, since Aristotle deals with three interrelated issues. The first (a) is whether the investigation of the first principles of demonstration, or axioms, belongs to only one science (thesis) or to more than one (antithesis).[16] The second issue (b) is whether

[16] Issue (a) is the only one resumed in the summary of the second *aporia* that Aristotle provides in K, 1, 1059a23–24.

the science of the axioms and the science of substance are the same science (thesis), or not (antithesis), if there is only one science of the axioms.[17] The third issue (c) is whether the science of the axioms (thesis) or the science of substance (antithesis) is the discipline sought for (i.e. metaphysics), if the science of the axioms is different from the science of substance. All three issues are mentioned in the introduction of the discussion of the *aporia* (B, 2, 996b26–33). In the following lines, Aristotle first argues for the antithesis of issue (a) (B, 2, 996b33–997a11), for which he provides two distinct arguments (B, 2, 996b33–997a2; B, 2, 997a2–11).[18] The antithesis of issue (b) is incidentally asserted within the first argument. After arguing for the antithesis of issue (a), Aristotle passes to argue for the thesis of issue (b) (B, 2, 997a11–15). Issue (c), on the contrary, appears to remain unaccounted for.[19]

Scholars agree on the fact that Aristotle solves *aporia* 2 in Γ, 3, 1005a19–b8, where he endorses the thesis of issue (b), stating that the science of the axioms is the same as the science of substance.[20]

Immediately after quoting its solution (pp. 53, 16–54, 2), Avicenna quotes a part of *aporia* 2 (p. 54, 3–5) that corresponds to Aristotle's

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[17] The second *aporia* is portrayed as dealing with issue (b) in its description in B, 1, 995b6–10.

[18] Madigan [1999], pp. 43–44, regards lines 996b33–997a11 as encompassing four parts: an introduction to the first argument (996b33–34), a first argument (996b35–997a2), a second argument (997a2–5), and a third argument (997a5–11). Following Ross [1924] (vol. I, pp. 229–230), I am more inclined to take as two single units what Madigan regards as the introduction to the first argument and the first argument itself, on the one hand, and the second and third argument, on the other.

[19] What I regard as the thesis of issue (b) (997a11–15) is taken by Madigan [1999], p. 44, as the thesis of issue (c): according to Madigan, Aristotle presents here two arguments supporting the identity of the science of the axioms with metaphysics. In Madigan's interpretation (who takes "philosopher", 997a14, as synonym of metaphysician and as distinct from the investigator of the science of substance, 997a11) the lines in question would not be opposed to the previous ones, but rather represent the treatment of an independent topic. But it seems to me that, if this were the case, the discussion of the *aporia* would lose most of its strenght. I am more inclined to regard lines 997a11–15 as establishing the thesis of issue (b) (I take "philosopher", 997a14, as synonym of investigator of the science of substance, 997a11): Aristotle appears to support the identity of the science of the axioms and the science of substance by means of a *reductio ad absurdum* (if they are not the same, it is not possible to say which one is superior to the other). The interpretation I adopt has the disadvantage of leaving issue (c) unaccounted for. Since Avicenna does not quote the lines in question, their interpretation does not directly affect the present analysis.

[20] See Madigan [1999], pp. 44–45; cp. Ross [1924], vol. I, p. 222.

second argument for the antithesis of issue (a). Avicenna neglects, instead, the entire first argument—including the antithesis of issue (b)—and the introduction. Since Aristotle's second argument is reworked by Avicenna as an objection to the doctrine that Aristotle positively establishes in the solution, and since Aristotle's solution concerns issue (b), Avicenna quotes the second argument in a modified form: whereas in Aristotle the argument states that there can be no science of the axioms, in Avicenna it contends that metaphysics cannot be a science of the axioms *and of substance*.[21] The quotation of this argument is followed by its refutation (p. 54, 6–17): in this latter, Avicenna shows that metaphysics is a science in the proper sense, i.e. a demonstrative science, of substance, in so far as substance is a division and, *large loquendo*, a (proper) accident of the subject-matter of metaphysics, namely of "existent" (p. 54, 6–15),[22] and that it is a science also of the axioms, in so far as it performs their investigation, even though this investigation lacks demonstrative character (p. 54, 16–17).[23]

Let us observe Avicenna's quotation of *aporia* 2 more in detail in Table 1.2.

The objection ("But it can be doubted against it . . .") that Avicenna reports can be divided into two parts, both having the form of a *reductio ad absurdum*. The first part (sections [2]–[3]) states that, if metaphysics provides a definition of the axioms and of substance, then it does not do anything different from what the particular sciences do. The obvious absurdity in this case lies in the resulting identity between the investigation of the axioms performed by metaphysics and the one performed by the particular sciences. Section [3] corresponds to lines 997a3–5 of *aporia* 2. The second part of the objection (sections [4]–[5]), on the other hand, states that, if metaphysics

[21] As to why Avicenna does not quote, as an objection to the thesis of issue (b), its antithesis, but rather quotes a modified version of an argument supporting the antithesis of issue (a), it is noteworthy that the first argument for the antithesis of issue (a), encapsulating the antithesis of issue (b), is missing in Usṭāṭ's translation of the *Metaphysics* in the form in which this latter is extant. Thus, Avicenna might have been unaware of the existence of an antithesis of issue (b) in the *aporia*, and might have consequently adjusted the text of the *aporia* to fit with the text of its solution.

[22] See Chapter 5, §1, Table 1.

[23] See Chapter 6, §1.2, Text 4. Avicenna refers here to the doctrine of *Metaph.* Γ, 4, 1006a10–11; Γ, 6, 1011a13 (see Chapter 9, §2, Table A).

Table 1.2

Ilāhiyyāt I, 8, p. 54, 3–5	Aristotle's *Metaph.* B, 2, 997a2–11	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 54, 3) But it can be doubted against it that,	(997a2–3) And, at the same time, in what way can there be a *science* of the first principles?	(p. 192, 15–16) Together with this, in what way there will be one science of these things?
[2] (p. 54, 3) if [the philosopher] speaks about them [i.e. the axioms and substance] according to definition and conceptualization,		
[3] (p. 54, 4) that is what the master of a particular science speaks about.	(997a3–5) For we are aware even now what each of them is; at least even other sciences use them as familiar.	(pp. 192, 16–193, 1) For we know now the being of each of them, and the other sciences use them as recognized and known.
[But the knowledge of the axioms proper to metaphysics has to be different from the one proper to the particular sciences]		
[4] (p. 54, 4) If, on the other hand, he speaks about them in [the context of] granting assent,		
[5] (p. 54, 4–5) the discourse about them becomes demonstrative.		
[But a demonstration of the axioms is impossible]	(997a5–11) And if there is a demonstrative science which deals with them, there will have to be an underlying kind, and some of them must be attributes and others must be axioms (for it is impossible that there should be demonstration about all things); for the demonstration must	(p. 193, 1–7) If there is demonstration of them, they must have a genus that is their subject, and some of them must be affections, some others common clear opinions. For it cannot be that all things have demonstration. Since demonstration must come from certain things and belong to certain others or to one of them.

Table 1.2 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt I, 8, p. 54, 3–5	Aristotle's *Metaph.* B, 2, 997a2–11	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
	start from certain premises and be about a certain subject and prove certain attributes. Therefore it follows that all attributes that are proved must belong to one class; for all demonstrative sciences use the axioms. Cp. Γ, 4, 1006a5–11.	Hence it is known that it happens to be a single genus that is the subject of all things of which there is demonstration, since all types of demonstration use the common evident opinions.
[A demonstration of substance is equally impossible]	*An. Post.* B, 3–8; cp. *Metaph.* B, 2, 997a30–32 (*aporia* 4)	

proceeds by demonstration in its analysis of the axioms, then there would be a demonstration of the principles of demonstration and a demonstration of substance. The absurdity in this case rests on two unstated assumptions—there is no demonstration of the axioms and no demonstration of substance—corresponding, respectively, to lines 997a5–11 of *aporia* 2, and to *An. Post.* B, 3–8 (substance, in the sense of essence, cannot be demostrated; this second assumption is also reflected in *aporia* 4, B, 2, 997a30–32). In section [2] Avicenna reformulates the knowledge of the "what it is" (or essence) of the axioms, about which Aristotle is speaking, in terms of "definition" (*taḥdīd*) and "conceptualization" (*taṣawwur*). In section [4], he puts the demonstrative science of the axioms, mentioned by Aristotle, within the context of "granting assent" (*taṣdīq*), i.e. the act of assigning a positive truth-value to a proposition. In so doing, Avicenna applies to the Aristotelian text he is quoting the pair "conceptualization"—"granting assent", which is a leit-motiv of his gnoseology recurring also elsewhere in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[24]

To summarize: In I, 8, p. 54, 3–5, Avicenna focuses on one of the issues of *aporia* 2 (thesis: the science of the axioms and the science of substance are the same science; antithesis: they are not the

[24] See, for example, I, 1, p. 4, 1 [p. 1, 12], p. 4, 4–5 [p. 2, 17–18]; I, 5, pp. 29, 7–30, 2 [pp. 32, 4–33, 24].

same science). He finds out that Aristotle holds the thesis (the metaphysician investigates both substance and axioms) in Γ, 3, 1005a19–b8, and hence regards the thesis as the true alternative. After quoting the passage from Γ asserting the thesis (I, 8, pp. 53, 16–54, 2), he introduces an objection to it (metaphysics cannot be the science of both the axioms and substance, p. 54, 3–5), which is a reworking of an argument for the antithesis of *aporia* 2 (there cannot be any science of the axioms, B, 2, 997a2–11). He then provides an answer to the objection along original lines (p. 54, 6–17). Avicenna rephrases the quoted text of B according to his own technical terminology, introducing the gnoseological categories of "conceptualization" (*taṣawwur*) and "granting assent" (*taṣdīq*).

2.2 *The second quotation*: aporiai *6 and 7*

In *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4 [pp. 322, 79–323, 86], Avicenna refers to *aporiai* 6 and 7 (B, 3), of which he quotes some parts (B, 3, 998b9–11; b19–21; 999a4–5). *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 4 is a discussion of the material, formal and final causes. The analysis of the material cause encompasses a digression on "element" (*usṭuquss*) having two parts. The first part (p. 280, 14–17) is a summary of *Metaphysics* Δ, 3, 1014a26–b9.[25] The second part of the digression (p. 281, 1–4) contains the exposition and criticism of the opinion of those who regard genera and differentiae as first elements. Avicenna takes this opinion from Δ, 3, 1014b9–12,[26] but expounds and rejects it by means of ideas drawn from *aporiai* 6 and 7.

Let us observe Avicenna's use of sources in the second part of this digression more in detail in Table 2.1.

The subjects of *aporiai* 6 and 7 are interrelated. *Aporia* 6 discusses whether the genera (thesis), or the first intrinsic constitutents (antithesis), are elements and principles of things. The thesis is supported by three arguments. One of them (the third) is the opinion of those who regard "one" and "being" as elements just because they are genera (B, 3, 998b9–11). *Aporia* 7, on the other hand, concerns whether the first, most universal, genera (thesis), or the last, least

[25] See Chapter 8, §5.5, Outline 6.6. In Δ, 3 Aristotle distinguishes the different meanings of "element" (στοιχεῖον).

[26] See Chapter 8, §5.5, Outline 6.6.

Table 2.1

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4	Aristotle, *Metaphysics*	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] Exposition: Some regard genera and differentiae as first elements	Δ, 3, 1014b9–12	p. 498, 11–13
[2] with particular regard to "one" and "being",	B, 3, 998b9–11: *Aporia* 6, thesis, third argument: Some of those who regard "one" and "being" as elements, take them as genera.	p. 219, 4–6
[3] which they take also as first principles because of their extreme universality.	B, 3, 998b19–21: *Aporia* 7, thesis, argument: "One" and "being" are principles, since they are the most universal things.	pp. 219, 14–220, 2
[4] Criticism: Things closer to individuals are worthier of being substances,	Aristotle, *Cat.* 5, 2b5–6, 7–8	Isḥāq b. Ḥunayn's Arabic translation of the *Categories*, p. 8, 9–10, 12–13.
[5] and are worthier of having unity.	B, 3, 999a4–5: *Aporia* 7, fourth objection to the thesis, conclusion: What is predicated directly of the individuals has more unity than what is not	p. 227, 12–13

universal, genera (antithesis), are principles. In *aporia* 7 both thesis and antithesis are first argued for then objected to. In the only argument for the thesis, in order to support the claim of the first genera to be principles, Aristotle states that, if something is a principle in as much as it is universal, then the highest or first genera, namely "one" and "being", will be principles and substances, since they are the most universal things (B, 3, 998b19–21). Six objections are moved to the thesis. The fourth objection (B, 3, 999a1–6) rests on the following premises: (a) what is one is more principle than what is not one; (b) oneness is indivisibility; (c) indivisibility is either according to form or according to quantity; (d) divisibility according to form

is prior to indivisibility according to quantity; (e) the genus can be divided into species according to form; (f) species can be divided into individuals according to quantity. From (a)–(f) Aristotle concludes that what is predicated directly of the individuals has more unity than what is not (B, 3, 999a4–5), i.e. that the species has more unity than the genus.

Aporiai 6 and 7, as they are formulated in book B, are not explicitly solved anywhere in the *Metaphysics*.[27]

Avicenna quotes *aporiai* 6 and 7 in both the exposition and the criticism of an opinion about genera and differentiae as elements. The opinion is expounded in three sections ([1]–[3]). Section [1] is taken from Δ, 3, 1014b9–12, where, at the end of his analysis of "element", Aristotle mentions those who regard genera (and, at a lesser extent, differentiae) as elements. In sections [2] and [3], Avicenna adds to this passage two themes taken from the arguments supporting the thesis, respectively, of *aporiai* 6 and of *aporia* 7. In section [2], Avicenna refers to the third argument supporting the thesis of *aporia* 6 (genera are elements and principles), namely the opinion of those who regard "one" and "being" as elements in virtue of their being genera (B, 3, 998b9–11). Section [2], therefore, points at "one" and "being" as a prime example of the genera to which section [1] refers. In section [3], Avicenna adds further details about "one" and "being" by quoting the argument supporting the thesis of *aporia* 7 (B, 3, 998b19–21).

In sections [4]–[5], Avicenna counters the opinion expounded in the previous three sections by referring to chapter 5 of Aristotle's *Categories* and, once again, to *aporia* 7. In *Cat.* 5, 2b5–6, 7–8, quoted in section [4], Aristotle argues for the priority of individual substances, or first substances, over their species and genera, or second substances.[28] In section [5], Avicenna corroborates the doctrine of

[27] As to *aporia* 6, scholars state that, far from being solved, it is posed again in Z, 16–17, H, 2–3 (where the doctrine of the antithesis is denied) and Z, 13 (where the doctrine of the thesis is denied); furthermore, Z, 10–12 show the insufficiency of its scope. As to *aporia* 7, its topic is addressed in Z, 12–13; but it is differently formulated in Z, 12 and not clearly solved in Z, 13. See Madigan [1999], pp. 71–72, 80; cp. Ross [1924], vol. I, pp. 222–223.

[28] In the light of the unsatisfactory solution of *aporiai* 6 and 7 in books Z and H of the *Metaphysics*, due to the problematic character of Aristotle's doctrine of substance

this passage of the *Categories* by quoting the conclusion of the fourth objection against the thesis of *aporia* 7 (B, 3, 999a4–5).

Let us observe more closely Avicenna's quotation of all these Aristotelian *loci* in Table 2.2.

Table 2.2

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Δ, 3, 1014b9–12; B, 3, 998b9–11; b19–21; 999a4–5	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 281, 1–2) Those who think that things are generated only from genera and differentiae, regards them [i.e. genera and differentiae] as first elements,	(Δ, 3, 1014b9–12) Now, since the so-called genera are universal and indivisible (for there is no formula of them), some say the genera are elements, and more so than the differentia, because the genus is more universal.	(p. 498, 11–13) Since the things called genera are universals and do not get divided—because they do not have any formula—some say the genera are elements and more so, because the genus is more universal.
[2] (p. 281, 2) especially "one" and "being" (*huwiyya*)[29]	(B, 3, 998b9–11) And some also of those who say unity and being, or the great and the small, are elements of things, seem to treat them as genera.	(p. 219, 4–6) Some of those who maintain that "one" and "being" (*huwwiyya*), and the great and the small, are elements of beings (*huwiyyāt*) use them as, and make them be, genera.
[3] (p. 281, 2) Therefore, they assume that they [i.e. "one" and "being"] are the principles that most deserve to be principles, since they are the most universal and general principles.	(B, 3, 998b19–21) There will, then, be as many principles of things as there are primary genera, so that both being and unity will be principles and substances; for these are most of all predicated of all things. Cp. B, 4, 1001a21–22	(pp. 219, 14–220, 1) The number of principles of beings (*huwiyyāt*) corresponds to the number of first genera; "one" and "being" (*huwiyya*) are principles and substances of beings (*huwiyyāt*), since these more than others are said of all beings (*huwiyyāt*).

expounded there, Avicenna's appeal to the ontology of the *Categories* in section [4] is remarkable.

[29] Here, as in other places of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, the Arabic term *huwiyya* in the meaning of "being" is a sign of Avicenna's reliance on Usṭāṯ's translation of the *Metaphysics* (see Chapter 8, §1.1, and Bertolacci [2003]).

Table 2.2 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4	Aristotle, *Metaph.* Δ, 3, 1014b9–12; Β, 3, 998b9–11; b19–21; 999a4–5	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[4] (p. 281, 3–4) Were they impartial in their judgement, they would know that independent subsistence belongs only to individuals, so that the things that are close to them [i.e. to the individuals] are worthier to be substances and to subsist by themselves,	(*Cat.* 5, 2b5–6, 7–8) So if the primary substances did not exist it would be impossible for any of the other things to exist . . . Of the secondary substances the species is more a substance than the genus, since it is nearer to the primary substance	(Isḥāq b. Ḥunayn's Arabic translation of the *Categories*, Aristotle [1948–52], p. 8, 9–10, 12–13) Necessarily, then, if the primary substances did not exist, there would be no way of existence for any of those other things . . . The species, among the secondary substances, is worthier than the genus to be described as substance, since it is closer to the primary substance.
[5] (p. 281, 4) and [they would know] that they [i.e. the things that are close to the individuals] are worthier of unity[30] as well.	(Β, 3, 999a4–5) that which is predicated directly of the individuals will have more unity.	(p. 227, 12–13) therefore the last one which is predicated is worthier of unity than anything else.

Even though Avicenna regards the opinion reported in sections [1]–[3] as wrong in each of its points,[31] his criticism of this opinion in sections [4]–[5] focuses on the doctrine of section [3], namely the rule according to which the more something is universal, the more it is a principle: the priority accorded to individuals, with respect to both subsistence and unity, in sections [4] and [5] is directed against this claim. *Aporia* 7, quoted in sections [3] and [5], is the main source of Avicenna's quotation: the thesis of this *aporia* (the first, most universal, genera are principles) is taken to be wrong (section [3]), and one of the objections to it (the more something is individual, the more it has unity) is endorsed (section [5]). *Aporia* 6, on the other

[30] Reading *bi-l-waḥdati* instead of *bi-l-wuǧūdi* (see Appendix A).

[31] Avicenna appears to disagree with the opponents' belief that things are generated "only" (*innamā*) from genera and differentiae in section [1].

hand, quoted in section [2], is mentioned incidentally, as a link between section [1], resting on Δ, 3, and section [3], depending on *aporia* 7 (section [1]: genera are elements; section [2]: "one" and "existent" are genera and elements in the highest degree; section [3]: "one" and "existent" are universal and general in the highest degree).

To summarize: In VI, 4, p. 281, 1–4, Avicenna quotes *aporia* 6 (thesis: the genera are elements and principles of things; antithesis: the first intrinsic constituents are elements and principles of things) and *aporia* 7 (thesis: the first, most universal, genera are principles of things; antithesis: the last, least universal, genera are principles of things) jointly. He is primarily concerned with *aporia* 7, and uses *aporia* 6 to adapt this latter to the context in which the quotation occurs, namely the paraphrase of Aristotle's doctrine of "element" in *Metaph.* Δ, 3. Avicenna takes from Δ, 3 an opinion about genera as elements (p. 281, 1–2); he adds to it the third argument for the thesis of *aporia* 6 (some of those who regard "one" and "being" as elements take them as genera, B, 3, 998b9–11 = p. 281, 2), and the only argument for the thesis of *aporia* 7 ("one" and "being" are principles, since they are the most general things, B, 3, 998b19–21 = p. 281, 2). He subsequently criticizes this latter point (p. 281, 3–4) with an argument based on the ontology of the *Categories*, but encompassing also part of the fourth objection against the thesis of *aporia* 7 (what is predicated directly of the individuals has more unity than what is not, B, 3, 999a4–5 = p. 281, 4). Avicenna, hence, regards the thesis of *aporiai* 7 as false. He also possibly regards the thesis of *aporia* 6 as false, in so far as he links it with the thesis of *aporia* 7.

2.3 *The third quotation*: aporia *1*

In *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 4, p. 300, 7–8 [p. 346, 75–83, p. 348, 20–22], Avicenna refers to *aporia* 1 (B, 2, 996a18–b26), of which he quotes the main elements (996a20–b3, 10–13). VI, 5 is the last chapter of Avicenna's analysis of the four causes in *Ilāhiyyāt* VI; the quotation of *aporia* 1 occurs at its end and represents a sort of appendix of Avicenna's overall treatment of causality. Avicenna presents the quoted part of the *aporia* as a theoretical reason that is not strong enough to invalidate his own (and Aristotle's) position, according to which metaphysics deals with all the four types of causes.

Avicenna's quotation of *aporia* 1 is outlined in Table 3.1.

Table 3.1

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–300, 9	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 2, 996a18–b8, b10–26	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
	996a18–20: Issue (a): Whether the study of all the types of causes belongs to only one science (thesis) or to more than one science (antithesis)	
[1]–[5] (p. 298, 19–299, 3) Even assuming that the four causes are not common to all things (only the formal cause, for instance, is held to pertain to unmovable things and mathematicals),	996a21–996b1: Issue (b), second objection to the thesis: In many objects, as in motionless things and mathematicals, not all causes are present	pp. 183, 10–184, 9
[6] (p. 299, 3) nonetheless metaphysics deals with them.		
[7] (p. 299, 4) It does so not as a science dealing with contraries would do,	996a20–21: (a) First objection to the thesis: Causes are not contraries	p. 183, 9–10
[8] (p. 299, 4–5) but in virtue of the particular unity it has.		
[9] (p. 299, 6–8) The reason is that, even under such an assumption, the four causes are present in some sciences [and, therefore, are dealt with by metaphysics, in so far as metaphysics investigates what is common, absolutely or relatively, to the other sciences].		
[10] (p. 299, 8–10) If they were present only		

Table 3.1 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–300, 9	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 2, 996a18–b8, b10–26	Usṭāṭ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
in one science different from metaphysics (for instance in natural philosophy), natural philosophy would not be able to investigate them, since they are its principles [Therefore they should be investigated by metaphysics].		
[11] (pp. 299, 10–300, 4) In fact, however, all the four causes pertain to mathematicals.	Cp. M, 3, 1078a31–b5	om.
[12] (p. 300, 4–7) Metaphysics deals not only with what is common to all the sciences, but also (under certain circumstances) with what is proper to each of them.		
[13] (p. 300, 7) Were the studies of each of the four causes independent sciences,	996b1–3: Issue (a), objection to the antithesis: Were the studies of each of the four causes independent sciences	p. 184, 9–10
	996b3–5: then it would be difficult to say which of these is metaphysics.	
	996b5–8: All the causes may be present in the same thing, for instance a house [so that a same thing would be investigated by different sciences of causes]	
[14] (p. 300, 8) then the study of the final cause would be the most excellent science, i.e. wisdom.	996b10–13: In a certain respect, the study of the final cause could be regarded as metaphysics.	p. 185, 2–4

Table 3.1 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–300, 9	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 2, 996a18–b8, b10–26	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[15] (p. 300, 8–9) The study of the final cause is the noblest part of metaphysics.		
	996b13–22: In another respect, the study of the formal cause could be regarded as metaphysics.	
	996b22–26: In still another respect, the study of the moving cause could be regarded as metaphysics.	

There is no doubt that Aristotle regards *aporia* 1 as very important: it is not only the first *aporia* taken into account in B, but also the only *aporia* mentioned in the previous books of the *Metaphysics* (see α, 3, 995a19–20). In its initial formulation (B, 2, 996a18–20), the issue is whether the study of all the types of causes belongs to only one science (thesis), or to more than one science (antithesis); the antithesis entails that each science investigating the causes takes into account a particular type of cause (B, 2, 996b1–3). During the discussion a second issue emerges, namely whether the study of all types of causes (thesis), or of only one of them (antithesis), belongs to metaphysics. The two issues—named here (a) and (b)—are intermingled in the discussion. The first objection against the thesis regards issue (a): it assumes that things that are object of one science are contraries, and points out that causes are not contraries (996a20–21). The second objection against the thesis concerns, instead, issue (b): it assumes that metaphysics can be the science of all causes if all causes are present in the things dealt with by this discipline, and that metaphysics is a universal science dealing with everything;[32] accordingly,

[32] See Madigan [1999], pp. 33–34.

it points out that in many objects, as in motionless things and mathematicals, not all causes are present (996a21–b1). Aristotle provides also an objection against the antithesis: it regards issue (a) and states that, if the studies of each of the four causes were independent sciences (996b1–3), it would be difficult to say which one of them is metaphysics (996b3–5), since the study of the final cause (996b10–13), of the formal cause (996b13–22) and of the efficient cause (996b22–26) might be regarded, each, as representing this discipline; furthermore, a single thing, like a house, having all the four causes would be the object of different sciences of causes (996b5–8).

According to the majority of scholars, Aristotle implicitly solves the *aporia* in favour of the thesis of the issue (b)—and, implicitly, of (a) as well—in Γ, 1–2, where he shows that metaphysics is the universal science of "being *qua* being" and of its causes.[33]

Avicenna focuses on issue (b) of *aporia* 1, and regards the thesis (metaphysics investigates all the four causes) as the right alternative (see section [6]).[34] In sections [1]–[5], he quotes the second objection against the thesis, presenting it as a possibility that does not rule out the claim of metaphysics to be the science of all the causes. Before explaining why this objection is harmless (sections [9]–[10]),[35] and partially false, since at least the objects of mathematics are

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[33] See Madigan [1999], pp. 39–40; cp. Ross [1924], vol. I, p. 222. Other interpreters believe that Aristotle endorses the antithesis at Λ, 10, by regarding metaphysics as the science of only the moving and the final causes (see the opinion of Stephen Philip Menn, mentioned by Madigan [1999], p. 40). But the passage of Λ, 10 which they invoke (1075b8–10) seems to allow also other interpretations.

[34] Since the first place of the *Ilāhiyyāt* in which Avicenna states that metaphysics investigates all the four causes are the Prolegomena (I, 1, p. 9, 10 [p. 9, 54–55]; see Chapter 4, §1.2, n. 24), and since the Prolegomena are modeled on *Metaph.* Γ, 1–2 (see Chapter 9, §2, Table A), Avicenna might be taken to agree with modern Aristotelian interpreters as to where Aristotle provides the solution to the *aporia*.

[35] Avicenna's point in section [9] is that metaphysics deals with the four causes in so far as they are common to the other sciences, and that the causes are common to the other sciences not only if they are common to all of them, but also if they are common to only some of them. In section [10] he goes on to prove that, even if the causes were not common to some sciences, but proper to only one of them, like natural philosophy, they nonetheless would be dealt with by metaphysics, since natural philosophy could not investigate them (they are the principles of natural philosophy, and no science investigates its own principles). Section [12] appears to be related to [10]: Avicenna states that metaphysics deals not only with what is common to the other sciences, but sometimes also with what is proper to one of them. The mention of the craftman in section [10] (p. 300, 2–3 [p. 348, 9–12]) might be taken from B, 2, 996a33–35, but the similarity is very loose.

affected by all the four causes (section [11]),[36] in section [7] Avicenna quotes also the first objection against the thesis: he acccepts its validity and acknowledges that the causes are not contrary to one another; in section [8], however, he explains that metaphysics deals with the causes not because they are contraries, but on account of the particular unity it possesses as a science.[37] In sections [13]–[14], the objection to the antithesis is quoted: among the undesired implications that Aristotle draws from the antithesis, Avicenna focuses on what Aristotle says about the priority of the science of the final cause (section [14]), omitting, instead, the similar considerations regarding the sciences of the formal and moving causes. Avicenna aims at stressing the final cause's superiority over the other causes: this is confirmed by section [15], where the study of the final cause, namely of God as the end of the universe, is portrayed as the most important part of metaphysics.[38]

Let us observe Avicenna's quotation of *aporia* 1 more closely in Table 3.2.

Table 3.2

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 5; 300, 7–9	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 2, 996a20–b5, b10–13	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 298, 19–20) We say that these four causes, even though they are believed not to gather[39] in many things existing in the sciences	(996a21–22) Further, there are many things to which not all the principles pertain.	(p. 183, 10–11) It is known that many principles do not belong to many beings,
[2] (pp. 298, 20–299, 1) since no agent, i.e. no	(996a22–26) For how can a principle of	(p. 183, 11–15) because we cannot say in which

[36] As to the fact that the final cause belongs to mathematicals, Avicenna follows and quotes a passage of *Metaphysics* M, 3 (1078a31–b5), where Aristotle argues that mathematicals do possess goodness and beauty (See Chapter 8, §5.13, Outline 12.1).

[37] The reference is to *Metaph.* Γ, 2, 1003a33–b19 (see Chapter 9, §2, Table A), a passage whose text Avicenna quotes in I, 5, pp. 34, 15–35, 2 (see Chapter 9, §3.3).

[38] The emphasis on the final cause in sections [13]–[15] corresponds to Avicenna's doctrine of the final cause as anterior to the moving/efficient cause with respect to essence, albeit posterior to it with respect to existence, as emerges from the part of chapter VI, 5 preceding the quotation of the *aporia* (VI, 5, pp. 292, 1–294, 5 [pp. 336, 84–339, 32]); this passage is translated and analyzed by Wisnowsky [2000] (see Wisnovsky [2003], pp. 145–180); Druart [2001], pp. 139–142.

[39] Reading *lā taǧtamiʿu* instead of *taǧtamiʿu* (see Appendix A).

Table 3.2 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 5; 300, 7–9	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 2, 996a20–b5, b10–13	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
principle of movement, is believed to be present in things that do not move[40] *and in mathematicals*, and no end either	change or the nature of the good be present in unchangeable things, since everything that in itself and by its own nature is good is an end, and a cause in the sense that for its sake the other things both come to be and are, cp. 996a29–32, 996a32–b1	way the principle of movement can be in the things that do not move, and how the nature of the good is present in all the things that do not move, if everything that is good by itself and by its nature is an end and a perfection, and in this way it is a cause, since the other things are because of it.
[3] (p. 299, 2) (since the end is believed to belong to movement)	(996a26–27) and since an end or purpose is the end of some action, and all actions imply change;	(p. 183, 15–16) Since the end and that because of which something else is is the perfection of a certain action, and all actions are by virtue of a movement.
	(996a27–29) so that in unchangeable things this principle could not exist nor could there be a good-in-itself.	
	(996a29–32) This is why in *mathematics* nothing is proved by means of this kind of cause, nor is there any demonstration of this kind—'because it is better, or worse'; indeed no one even mentions anything of the kind.	
[4] (p. 299, 2) and they [are believed] not to have any matter, but only their forms are investigated;		

[40] Reading *lā tataḥarraku* instead of *tataḥarraku* (see Appendix A).

Table 3.2 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 5; 300, 7–9	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 2, 996a20–b5, b10–13	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[5] (p. 299, 2–3)—for this reason someone belittled these things, saying that they do not manifest any perfective cause—	(996a32–b1) And so for this reason some of the Sophists, e.g. Aristippus, ridiculed *mathematics*; for in the arts, even in handicrafts, e.g. in carpentry and cobbling, the reason always given is 'because it is better, or worse', but the mathematical sciences take no account of goods and evils.	(p. 184, 6–9) For this reason some of the Sophists rejected this cause, as Arisṭīfūs did. As to the other professions and the base arts, like carpentry and the art of the shoemakers, in them "more excellent" and "more base" is said, whereas people of this art do not inquire at all good and evil things.
[6] (p. 299, 3) [nonetheless] their exam belongs to this science.		
[7] (p. 299, 4) Not that a single science deals with them as if they were opposites (for they are not);	(996a20–21) How could it belong to one science to know the principles if these are not contrary?	(p. 183, 9–10) How it is possible for one science to know the principles, which are not contrary to each other?
[8] (p. 299, 4–5) but because a single science in the way according to which this science is one, explains their state.		
[13] (p. 300, 7) Were these [i.e. the investigations of the four causes] independent sciences,	(996b1–3) But if there are several sciences of the causes, and a different science for each different principle,	(p. 184, 9–10) It is known that the sciences of the causes are many and each primary cause has the principle of a different science.
	(996b3–5) which of these sciences should be said to be which we seek, or which of the people who possess them has the most scientific knowledge of the object in question?	
[14] (p. 300, 8) then the science of the end would be the most	(996b10–13) For inasmuch as it is most architectonic and	(p. 185, 2–4) As to the lofty, anterior and superior wisdom, which the

Table 3.2 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 5; 300, 7–9	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 2, 996a20–b5, b10–13	Usṭāṭ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
excellent; that would be the wisdom.	authoritative and the other sciences, like slave women, may not even contradict it, the science of the end and of the good is of the nature of wisdom (for the other things are for the sake of the end).	remaining sciences follow and concede to, it is necessarily the science of the cause of perfection and of the good. Since the other causes are because of this cause.
[15] (p. 300, 8–9) As it is, however [i.e. even without there being separate sciences of the four causes], that, i.e. the science examining the final causes of things, still is the most excellent part of this science.		

The most remarkable doctrinal difference between Aristotle and Avicenna concerns the consideration of the motionless, or unchangeable, things (996a23, 27). Aristotle's second objection to the thesis regards primarily these things: initially (996a21–29) Aristotle takes only them into account, saying that they lack any moving and final cause; only later (996a29–b1) he discusses the lack of final causes in mathematical beings (see the passages in italics in Table 3.2). In Avicenna, on the other hand, motionless things play a less prominent role: they are mentioned only once, together with mathematicals, in section [2]; in section [11], where the objection to the thesis is shown to be false (see Table 3.1), only the mathematicals are taken into account. The reason of this shift of focus by Avicenna seems clear: whereas it is relatively easy to show that mathematical beings are dependent on causes other than the formal ones, it is harder to prove the same point in the case of motionless things.[41]

To summarize: In VI, 5, pp. 298, 19–299, 10, at the end of his

[41] As to the Arabic translation, it is noteworthy that in sections [1], [5] and [13] Avicenna's quotation is closer to Aristotle's original text than Usṭāṭ's translation (see Chapter 8, §1.1, Table 1 [1]-[3]). This indicates that Avicenna is using an Arabic version of *Metaph.* B different from Usṭāṭ's.

treatment of the four causes in *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, Avicenna takes into account the issue of *aporia* 1 more directly related to metaphysics (thesis: the study of all types of causes belongs to metaphysics; antithesis: the study of only one type of causes belongs to metaphysics). He regards the thesis as the right alternative (p. 299, 3). He first quotes the second objection against the thesis (in many objects, as in motionless things and mathematicals, not all causes are present, B, 2, 996a21–996b1 = pp. 298, 19–299, 3), portraying it, along original lines, as insufficient to invalidate the claim of metaphysics to investigate the four causes (p. 299, 6–10). He subsequently shows that this objection is partially false (pp. 299, 10–300, 7), relying on Aristotle's doctrine in book M. He also quotes the first objection against the thesis (causes are not contraries, B, 2, 996a20–21), which he regards as true, but irrelevant to the thesis (p. 299, 4–5). Conclusively, he quotes selectively the objection against the antithesis (if the studies of each of the four causes were independent sciences, then the science of the final cause, the science of the formal cause and the science of the moving cause might be regarded, each, as metaphysics, B, 2, 996b1–26), focusing on the final cause (p. 300, 7–8), in order to stress the importance of the investigation of the final cause within metaphysics (p. 300, 8–9).

2.4 *The fourth quotation*: aporia *11*

In *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 4, pp. 344, 12–345, 5 [p. 399, 85–99], Avicenna refers to *aporia* 11 (B, 4, 1001a4–b 25), of which he quotes a part (1001a9–19). In chapter VIII, 4 Avicenna describes the features of the Necessary Existent, namely of God, whom in chapters VIII, 1–3 he has shown to be the First Principle.

Let us observe Avicenna's quotation more in detail in Table 4.

Table 4

Ilāhiyyāt VIII, 4, pp. 344, 12–345, 5	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 4, 1001a9–19	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[1] (p. 344, 12–13) We rather say, [starting again] from the beginning, that the "necessary existent" can be understood as the necessary existent itself,		

Table 4 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VIII, 4, pp. 344, 12–345, 5	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 4, 1001a9–19	Usṭāṭ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[2] (p. 344, 13) as the "one" can be understood as the one itself,	cp. 1001a9–12	
[3] (p. 344, 13–14) or about it [i.e. about the "necessary existent"] it can be understood that its quiddity is, for instance, [the quiddity of] a man or [of] another substance, and that the man in question is what the necessary existent is,		
[4] (p. 344, 15) as about the "one" it can be understood that it is water, or air, or a man that are one.	cp. 1001a12–17	
[5] (p. 344, 16–18) You can consider and know this [distinction] from the difference [of opinions] regarding whether the principle in natural things is one or many. For some regard this principle as one [**Monists**], others as many [**Pluralists**].	1001a12–19: **antithesis. Monists** (see below) **and Pluralists** (see "A similar view is expressed by those who make the elements more than one; for these also must say that being and unity are precisely all the things which they say are principles", 1001a17–19)	
[6] (p. 345, 1–2) Among these, some of those who regard it as one [**Monists1**] regard the first principle not as the essence of the "one", but as something which is one, like water, air, or fire and so on.	(1001a12–17) [**antithesis: Monists**] But the natural philosophers take a different line; e.g. Empedocles . . . says claim that this one and what unity is; for he would seem to say it is love . . . Others say this unity and being, of which things consist and have been made, is fire, and others say it is air.	(p. 261, 4–8) As to the masters of natural science, as Ibn Duqlīs, . . . he claims that "one" is being, and it is appropriate that he says that this one is love . . . Others being are fire. Others claim that they are air. From them [i.e. fire and air] the beings are made and generated.

Table 4 (*cont.*)

Ilāhiyyāt VIII, 4, pp. 344, 12–345, 5	Aristotle, *Metaph.* B, 4, 1001a9–19	Usṭāṯ's Arabic translation of the *Metaphysics*
[7] (p. 345, 3) Some other of these [**Monists2**] regard the principle as the essence of the "one" in so far as it is "one", not as something to which the "one" occurs.	(1001a9–12) [**thesis: Idealists**] Plato and the Pythagoreans thought being and unity were nothing else, but this was their nature, their substance just being unity and being.	(p. 261, 2–4) As to Plato and the Pythagoreans, they did not claim that being and unity are anything else, but they claimed that this is their nature, as if their substance were to be one and being.
[8] (p. 345, 4–5) There is a distinction, therefore, between a quiddity to which "one" and "existent" occur (= [6]), and "one" and "existent" in so far as they are "one" and "existent" (= [7]).		

Aristotle portrays *aporia* 11 as "[t]he hardest inquiry of all, and the one most necessary for knowledge of the truth" (B, 4, 1001a4–5).[42] The issue at stake is whether "one" and "being" are nothing else than one and being (thesis), or have some other underlying nature, so that they are, for instance, friendship, fire or air (antithesis) (B, 4, 1001a5–8). Before discussing thesis and antithesis, Aristotle mentions their advocates: the thesis is held by Plato and the Pythagoreans (B, 4, 1001a9–12), the antithesis by two groups of natural philosophers: those who posit only one element of things (1001a12–17), and those who posit more than one element (1001a17–19). In sum, we have three groups of thinkers in Aristotle, which, for the sake of brevity, I call respectively "Idealists" (Plato and the Pythagoreans), "Monists" (the natural philosophers who posit only one main element of things), and "Pluralists" (the natural philosophers who posit more than one element). The Idealists hold the thesis, namely that "one" and "being" are nothing else than one and being; the Monists and the Pluralists hold the antithesis, namely that "one" and "being"

[42] He says something similar about *aporia* 8 (B, 4, 999a24–25).

have some other underlying nature. After having expounded thesis and antithesis, Aristotle mentions the difficulties they entail (B, 4, 1001a19–b25).

In the following books of the *Metaphysics* Aristotle shows that both the thesis and the antithesis are false and that the true doctrine regarding "one" and "being" implies that they are neither independent entities (thesis) nor mere accidents (antithesis).[43]

Avicenna quotes the doxographic part of *aporia* 11 (B, 4, 1001a9–19) as a concrete example of a distinction he is making with regard to the concept of "necessary existent". Avicenna's distinction is between the "necessary existent" as such, on the one hand, and the "necessary existent" as an essence (or quiddity) that exists necessarily, on the other. It parallels a similar distinction that Avicenna draws elsewhere (I, 6) between the Necessary Existent *per se*, i.e. God, and the necessary existent in virtue of something else, i.e. the created thing that exists necessarily thanks to the cause that bestows existence to its essence. Avicenna reports the opinions favoring thesis and antithesis as views elucidating the aforementioned distinction: the thesis (the opinion according to which "being" and "one" are nothing else than being and one) corresponds with the former alternative (the "necessary existent" is nothing else than necessary existent), whereas the antithesis (the opinion according to which "being" and "one" have an underlying subject) corresponds with the latter alternative (the "necessary existent" is an essence that exists necessarily).

Sections [1] and [3] are the two members of the distinction that Avicenna is making about the "necessary existent". Sections [2] and [4] contain a first, brief, reference to the part of the *aporia* that Avicenna quotes. This part is actually quoted in sections [5]-[7] and summarized in section [8]. In the actual quotation Avicenna somehow reverses the order of Aristotle's text. He quotes first lines a12–19 in section [5], then lines a12–17 in section [6], finally lines a9–12 in section [7]. From sections [2] and [4] it is immediately clear that in quoting the *aporia* Avicenna focuses on "one" more than on "being". "Being" (= "existent") is mentioned only at the very end of the quotation in section [8]. This insistence on "one" is meant to avoid any confusion between the "necessary existent", i.e. Avicenna's topic, and

[43] See Madigan [1999], pp. 115–118.

"existent" (= "being"), one of the two concepts with which Aristotle is dealing. Section [5] takes from lines 1001a12–19 the idea of a disagreement between Monists and Pluralists about the number of principles, namely the issue of whether they are one or many. In the following sections Avicenna pays no attention to the Pluralists' opinion, and focuses instead on the Monists. He splits these latter into two groups, which I call respectively Monists1 and Monists2: Monists1 correspond with Aristotle's Monists and hold the antithesis (section [6]); Monists2 correspond with Aristotle's Idealists and hold the thesis (section [7]). Avicenna's interpretation of Aristotle's Idealists, namely of Plato and the Pythagoreans, as advocates of monism is, of course, questionable. However, he does not report the names of Aristotle's Monists (Empedocles) and Idealists (Plato, the Pythagoreans) in section [6]–[7].[44]

As to Avicenna's position regarding the issue, it can only be guessed, since he neither supports nor criticizes thesis and antithesis. Insofar as thesis and antithesis are quoted to exemplify a distinction that Avicenna regards as true in both its members (God is the Necessary Existent *per se*, created things are essences that exist necessarily), it could be assumed that he takes both thesis and antithesis as true. Still, this inference is largely a matter of speculation. What is sure is that he does not take the different views of Monists1 and Monists2 to be relevant as such, but only as ways to clarify an important distinction regarding the concept of "necessary existent". About this latter, his position is extremely clear.

To summarize: of *aporia* 11 (thesis: "one" and "being" are nothing else than one and being; antithesis: "one" and "being" have some other underlying nature and are, for instance, friendship, fire or air), Avicenna quotes the opinions supporting thesis and antithesis (B, 4, 1001a9–19). In Aristotle's text these opinions are held respectively by Plato and the Pythagoreans (Idealists, thesis) and by Monists and Pluralists (antithesis). Avicenna derives from the *aporia* the idea of a contrast between Monists and Pluralists about the number of principles (p. 344, 16–18) and portrays two different groups of Monists as supporters of antithesis and thesis. The first group of Monists

[44] Remarkably, in sections [7] and [8], Avicenna uses the verb *ʿaraḍa* ("to occur" in the sense of "to happen accidentally") to describe the link between "one" and "existent", on the one hand, and the essence which is one and existent, on the other.

(= Monists in Aristotle, B, 4, 1001a12–17) holds the antithesis (p. 345, 1–2), the second group (= Idealists in Aristotle, B, 4, 1001a9–12) holds the thesis (p. 345, 3–5). In quoting these opinions, Avicenna's aim is not doxographical, but theoretical: he uses thesis and antithesis to exemplify a distinction concerning the concept of "necessary existent" (first alternative: the "necessary existent" is nothing else than necessary existent; second alternative: the "necessary existent" is an essence that exists necessarily p. 344, 12–15), that he then employs in his doctrine of God as Necessary Existent.

3 The Main Features of Avicenna's Reception of *Metaphysics* B

On the basis of the analysis provided in §2, the guidelines of Avicenna's reception of B can be summarized in the following four points. (1) Avicenna is selective. He focuses on the crucial part of B, the third, where *aporiai* are discussed, and chooses five among them. (2) He is concise. No *aporia* is quoted in full; rather, all are summarized. *Aporiai* sharing related issues, like *aporiai* 6 and 7, are quoted together. (3) He is assertive. He never presents the *aporiai* as problems. In most cases, he embraces either the thesis (*aporiai* 1, 2) or the antithesis (*aporiai* 6, 7). The rejected alternatives are quoted as untenable objections to previously established doctrines (*aporia* 2), or as wrong opinions to be dismissed (*aporiai* 6 and 7), or as insufficient reasons to invalidate a certain position (*aporia* 1). In so doing, he solves the *aporiai*. When (as in *aporia* 11) he does not prefer the thesis over the antithesis, or vice versa, the unresolved conflict clarifies a distinction about which he takes a clear stand. (4) He quotes the *aporiai* not in a single portion of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, but in different places of this work.

Points 3) and 4) deserve particular attention. As to point 3), Avicenna's assertive reformulation of the *aporiai* is a reflex of his overall conception of metaphysics as a demonstrative discipline, in which non-apodictic procedures, especially the dialectical ones, are, as much as possible, effaced and replaced by more rigorous methods, as we have seen in Chapter 6. Now, the aporetic method displayed by Aristotle in B can be rightly regarded as an instance of dialectic, in so far as the *aporiai* of B result from a "dialogical" contrast between thesis and antithesis and are based in most cases on ἔνδοξα, i.e. on those reputable opinions that are the starting-point

of dialectic.[45] Avicenna's effort to replace dialectic with demonstration in his reworking of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* is the main reason why the *aporiai* of B are not presented as problems in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. As to point 4), the displacement of the *aporiai* of B is an aspect of the overall recasting of the structure of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, that has been documented in Chapter 5. Points 3) and 4) are interconnected: Avicenna quotes the *aporiai* in different places of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (point 4) just because the doctrines dealt with in these places represent the solutions of the *aporiai* (point 3), or, in any case, help to clarify them.

4 *Metaphysics* B before Avicenna

4.1 *Nicholas of Damascus*

One of the first Greek commentators of Aristotle, Nicholas of Damascus (Nicolaus Damascenus, 64 BC – after 14 AD), author of a compendium of Aristotle's philosophy, lost in Greek but extant in a Syriac abridged version and in some Arabic fragments,[46] approaches book B in a way similar to Avicenna's.[47] As we have just seen, two of the main features of Avicenna's attitude towards B are the fact of providing solutions to the *aporiai*, and the fact of dealing with the *aporiai* in scattered places of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see points 3 and 4 in §3). Now, in a passage of his *Tafsīr* of the *Metaphysics*, Averroes ascribes these same features to the aforementioned work by Nicholas of Damascus. Here is what Averroes says in his introductory remarks on B:

> Text 4: Averroes, *Tafsīr*, p. 167, 4–10; p. 168, 5–6
>
> But in the natural science, he [i.e. Aristotle] thought that the best [way] to impart knowledge was to put the dialectical investigation before each problem when he wanted to establish the demonstration about that single problem.
>
> As to this book [i.e. the *Metaphysics*], he deemed appropriate [i] to put beforehand the dialectical discussions concerning all the difficult problems of this discipline, and to treat them separatedly on their own [in book B]. Then [ii] he provided the demonstrations proper to each problem in the appropriate place of the treatises of this science. [. . .]

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[45] See Chapter 6, n. 4.

[46] See Chapter 4, §2.2.

[47] Nicholas' approach to B is described in Nicholas of Damascus [1965], pp. 11–12, 32–33.

> Nīqulāwš disagreed with the arrangement of the Wise [i.e. Aristotle] in these two respects [(i)–(ii)], and did what he [i.e. Aristotle] had done in the natural science.

Text 4 entails that Nicholas dealt with the *aporiai* of B ("the dialectical investigation") in different places of his compendium of the *Metaphysics* ("before each problem") and connected the *aporiai* with their solution ("the demonstration about that single problem"). Therefore, Nicholas shares features 4) and 3) of Avicenna's treatment of B. Since Nicholas's work is a compendium, it is obvious that he also shares feature 2), namely conciseness. Unfortunately, the extant version of Nicholas's work does not allow us to explore possible similarities regarding feature 1), i.e. to examine what selection of *aporiai* (if any) he used.

The similarities between Nicholas and Avicenna are not restricted to B, but concern also book Δ of the *Metaphysics*: Averroes informs us that Nicholas dealt with the philosophical terms discussed in Δ in different parts of his work, in connection with the doctrines to which the single terms are related.[48] This is also Avicenna's way of quoting Δ, as we have seen.[49]

As Averroes witnesses, Nicholas' work was known in the Arab philosophical milieu. The resemblances between Nicholas's reworking of B and Δ and Avicenna's quotations of these books are striking. Whether Nicholas directly influenced Avicenna, or the similarities between them are due to their adoption of the same literary genre, namely the compendium, remains to be ascertained.

4.2 *Alexander of Aphrodisias*

The idea that the aporias of B are connected with the solutions that Aristotle provides in the following books of the *Metaphysics* surfaces also in Alexander of Aphrodisias' proem to the commentary on Λ, as reported by Averroes. Alexander of Aphrodisias states:

> Text 5: Alexander of Aphrodisias, proem to *Metaph.* Λ *apud* Averroes, *Tafsīr*, p. 1394, 3–8 (= Chapter 5, Text 19 [a]–[c])
>
> [a] We say: Alexander begins by saying that the statement of those who say that this book, i.e. book Λ, is the last of this discipline is necessary [i.e. necessarily true],

[48] *Tafsīr*, p. 476, 3–7. See Nicholas of Damascus [1965], pp. 33–34.
[49] See Chapter 8, §5.5.

> [b] because some of the other books which he [i.e. Aristotle] put in this science contain the problems (*al-šukūk*) that had to be solved (*kāna yaḥtağu an tuḥalla*) in this science, after having been raised [i.e. book B],
>
> [c] some others contain the solution (*ḥall*) of these problems: this is what he [i.e. Aristotle] did in the books placed after this book [i.e. after book B] . . .

Section [b] of this text refers to book B. In sections [b] and [c], Alexander mentions, respectively, the necessity of solving the aporias of B, and their actual solution in the following books of the *Metaphysics*.

4.3 *Syrianus*

The only Greek commentary on B whose Arabic translation is attested, though not preserved, is Syrianus' commentary.[50] If it ever existed, however, the Arabic translation of Syrianus' commentary on B seems to have had a very limited circulation and impact.[51]

4.4 *Al-Fārābī*

In the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, al-Fārābī provides a plain (although not totally straightforward) summary of the contents of book B.

> Text 6: Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 37, 1–3 (= Chapter 3, §1 [3.2])
>
> [a] The second treatise contains the enumeration of the difficult questions concerning these things [i. e. the things investigated in metaphysics], [b] the clarification of the type of difficulty that is present in them, and [c] the setting up of opposite proofs for them, [d] so that the mind may get an indication of what the mode of research is.

Section [a] refers to Aristotle's exposition of the aporias in B, 1, 995b4–996a17. Section [c], on the other hand, refers to their discussion in B, 2–6. Sections [b] and [d] appear to refer to Aristotle's preliminary remarks (B, 1, 995a24–b4).

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[50] See Chapter 1, §1.1, Text 1; Chapter 4, §2.2, Table 1. On Syrianus' exegesis of B, see Luna [2004]; Longo [2004].

[51] Al-Fārābī and Averroes mention only the commentaries by Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius on Λ among the available commentaries on the *Metaphysics* (see Chapter 2, §5).

Conclusion

The four main features of Avicenna's reception of B, described in §3, reflect and, at the same time, throw light on the outline of the *Šifāʾ* that Avicenna provides in the Prologue to this work.[52]

Text 7: Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*

1) Avicenna states: "Our purpose in this book . . . is to set down in it the gist of . . . the Fundamental Principles contained in the philosophical sciences attributed to the ancients" (p. 9, 7–9); and he adds: "There is nothing of account to be found in the books of the ancients which we did not include in this book of ours" (pp. 9, 17–10, 1). Thus, with regard to the previous philosophical tradition, Avicenna restricts the scope of his work to the "gist of the fundamental principles" and to what is "of account".
2) He maintains: "I strove in earnest to be concise and always to avoid repetition" (p. 9, 15–16).
3) He also contends: "I sought to set down in it most of the discipline, indicate in every passage where ambiguity may occur, and solve it by setting forth clearly the correct answer to the extent of my ability" (p. 9, 12–13).[53]
4) Finally he says: ". . . if it [i.e. the amount of valuable things found in the books of the ancients and included in the present book] is not found in the place where it is customary to record it, then it will be found in another place which I thought more appropriate for it" (p. 10, 1–2).

In other words, in the Prologue to the *Šifāʾ* Avicenna declares his intention to write a book that is (1) selective, (2) concise, (3) unambiguous and (4) original in structure.[54] Since Avicenna's quotations of B display these same characters, the treatment of B in the *Ilāhiyyāt* can be regarded as a concrete application of the four points of the program outlined in Text 7. Insofar as it instantiates the basic features of the *Šifāʾ* as outlined in its Prologue, Avicenna's approach to B provides a prime example of his overall attitude towards Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in his *opus maius* on metaphysics.

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[52] Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 50–51.

[53] Later on in the prologue (p. 11, 5), Avicenna portrays his reworking of Euclid's *Elements* as containing solutions of difficulties ("I solved in it difficulties", *wa-ḥalaltu fīhi l-šubaha*).

[54] On points 1) and 2), see Appendix E, ii.

CHAPTER ELEVEN

THE OTHER SOURCES OF THE *ILĀHIYYĀT*

The quotations of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* have been identified, described and catalogued in Chapters 8–10. Avicenna's use of Aristotelian works other than the *Metaphysics*, in both logic and natural philosophy, has also surfaced in what precedes.[1] In the present chapter, I complete the survey of the *Ilāhiyyāt*'s background by taking into account the non-Aristotelian sources of this work.

Avicenna's quotations of pre-Aristotelian philosophers in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are mainly derived from Aristotle's *Metaphysics* and *Physics*. From the *Metaphysics* Avicenna quotes, in an explicit determinate way, the Pythagoreans,[2] Anaxagoras,[3] the Megarics,[4] Socrates[5] and, in an explicit indeterminate way, Protagoras;[6] the explicit indeterminate quotations of the Atomists (supposedly Greek), on the other hand, appear to be taken from Aristotle's *Physics*.[7] Many of the quotations of Plato, both explicit determinate and explicit indeterminate, are also taken from the *Metaphysics*.[8]

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[1] See Chapter 7, §2.3, §3.3.

[2] See Appendix B, I.1 (s.v. *Fīṯāġūraṯ* and *Fīṯāġūriyyūna*). See also the explicit indeterminate references in Appendix B, I.3, s.v. *al-ḥukamāʾ al-aqdamīn* ("the ancient wise men"); *ammā al-qudamāʾ fa-qawm* ("as to the ancients, a group"); *baʿḍ al-nās, bal akṯaruhūm* ("some people, or better: most of them"); *baʿḍuhum* ("some of them"); and—possibly—*ahl al-ẓāhir min al-nazar* ("people of superficial investigation"). For the *loci* of the *Metaphysics* from which Avicenna draws these opinions, see Chapter 8, §5.1, Outlines 4.2–4.3.

[3] See Appendix B, I.1 (s.v. *Anaksāġūras*), and Chapter 8, §5.12, Outline 11.2.

[4] See Appendix B, I.1 (s.v. *Ġārīqū*), and Chapter 8, §5.9.

[5] See Appendix B, I.1 (s.v. *Suqrāṭ*). In the first passage (V, 8, p. 246, 8 [p. 276, 96]), Socrates is mentioned as an example of famous person. For the Aristotelian background of the second passage, see Chapter 8, §5.1, Outline 4.3.

[6] See Appendix B, I.3 (s.v. *baʿḍuhum*), and Chapter 8, §5.10, Outline 10.1.

[7] See Appendix B, I.3, s.v. *maḏhab man yurakkibu al-maqādīr min aǧzāʾ lā tataǧazzaʾu* ("the doctrine of the person[s] who take extensions to be composed from indivisible parts") and *man* ("the person[s] who"). See Aristotle's treatment of the divisibility of movement and continuous quantities in *Phys.* Z.

[8] See Appendix B, I.1, s.v. *Aflāṭūn*; I.3, s.v. *al-ḥukamāʾ al-aqdamīn* ("the ancient wise men"), *farīq lahum ʿadadun* ("a numerous sect"), *man* ("the person[s] who"). For the Aristotelian background of these quotations see, Chapter 6, §1.1, Text 2; Chapter 8, §5.1, Outline 4.3; §5.7, Outline 8.3; Chapter 10, §2.2, Tables 2.1–2.

Apart from the possible borrowings of some aspects of Stoic philosophy reported, for example, by Alexander of Aphrodisias,[9] and the quotations of Euclid and Ptolemy,[10] all the references to post-Aristotelian thinkers regard the Greek commentators of Aristotle (§1), the Plato known to Avicenna *via* sources different from Aristotle, and Neoplatonism (§2), and the Arab philosophers (§3). The present chapter adds to the analysis of these three areas also an account of the reflexes in the *Ilāhiyyāt* of Avicenna's previous own works (§4). In so far as in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna shows that Greek philosophy, as formulated by Aristotle, far from being antithetic to Islamic belief, is compatible with, and allows a better understanding of, all the main aspects of the Muslim creed, also Islamic religion and the Islamic theological debate can be regarded as a further "source", *large loquendo*, of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (§5).

1 Greek commentators of Aristotle

The *Ilāhiyyāt*'s dependence on the Greek commentatorial tradition is evident from its Prolegomena: as we have seen in Chapter 5, the first four chapters of this work (I, 1–4) correspond, both in function and in themes, to the Prolegomena that Neoplatonic commentators of Aristotle premitted to their exegesis of Aristotle's works. Commentators of Aristotle *par excellence* in Avicenna's view are Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius, who are often mentioned together as representatives of all other commentators.[11] As to previous commentators, Theophrastus' *Metaphysics* might have influenced Avicenna by means of Alexander's *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* (see below, §1.1);[12] the similar treatment of *Metaphysics* B and Δ by Nicholas of Damascus and Avicenna has been remarked in Chapter 10.[13]

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[9] On Avicenna's possible acquaintance with the Stoic doctrine of "thing" as supreme genus through Alexander of Aphrodisias' commentary on the *Topics*, see below, §1.1. The dependence of Avicenna's theory of prophecy on Stoic philosophy *via* Plotinus and the *Theologia Aristotelis*, as suggested by Rahman [1958b], is questioned by Gutas [1988], pp. 169–170, and nn. 56–58.

[10] See Appendix B, I.1, s.v. *Baṭlamiyūs*; II.1.1, s.v. *Al-Maǧisṭī*; II.2.1, s.v. *kitāb Ūqlīdis*. See Chapter 7, §4.

[11] See Appendix B, I.2, s.v. *man baʿdahū min muḥaṣṣilī ʿulamāʾ al-mašsāʾīna* ("The Peripatetics scholars after him [*sc.* the First Teacher = Aristotle] who have validated his thought"); *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī*, p. 25, 9–11.

[12] In the field of logic, Hasnawi [1991], pp. 232–233, points out Theophrastus' influence on Avicenna's hypothetical syllogistic.

[13] See Chapter 10, §4.1.

1.1 *Alexander of Aphrodisias*

The main metaphysical work by Alexander of Aphrodisias in Avicenna's perspective is the *Maqāla fī l-Qawl fī mabādi' al-kull bi-ḥasab ra'y Arisṭāṭālis al-faylasūf* (*Treatise on the Speech regarding the Principles of the Universe according to the Opinion of Aristotle the Philosopher*, abbreviated in what precedes as *Fī Mabādi' al-kull*).[14] The affiliation with Aristotle and the Peripatetic tradition surfaces not only in the title, but also in the references to "Aristotle's opinion" (*ra'y Arisṭūṭālis*) and the mentions of Aristotle in the text.[15] In fact, the *Fī Mabādi' al-kull* is "a discussion of *Metaphysics* Λ, expounding the theory of the unmoved mover and the order of the universe".[16] It appears to be connected with Theophrastus' *Metaphysics* and the ps.-Aristotelian *De Mundo*.[17]

All the four explicit determinate quotations of Alexander occurring in the *Ilāhiyyāt* refer to the *Fī Mabādi' al-kull*. The first three quotation are connected to each other within the same chapter and about the same topic (the movers of the spheres). The fourth quotation occurs in a different chapter and regards a different topic (whether the movements of the spheres are for the sake of the sublunary world). The first three quotations occur in connection with, and as an explanation for, a doctrine of book Λ of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (*Metaph.* Λ, 8, 1073a14–b1), about the number of the heavenly movers. The fourth quotation, on the other hand, regards Alexander's original doctrine of the final cause of the heavenly movement. In the second quotation, Alexander's work is also explicitly mentioned. This quotation confirms that Alexander of Aphrodisias is the philosopher

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[14] The Greek original of this work is not extant. The identity of the Arabic translator is uncertain. More than one recension of this work existed in Arabic. A Syriac version of this same text is attested in Sergius of Reš'aynā (see Hugonnard-Roche [1997c], p. 126). The critical edition of an Arabic epitome is available in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2002]. Besides the facing English translation in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], an integral French translation of Alexander of Aphrodisias [1947] is provided by Badawī [1968], pp. 121–139. Among the partial translations, see Rosenthal [1975], pp. 146–149 (Engl. transl. of Alexander of Aphrodisias [1947], pp. 266, 23–270, 13), and Gutas [1988], pp. 215–217 (Engl. transl. of Alexander of Aphrodisias [1947], pp. 276, 6–277, 6). For the Arabic and Latin reception of this work, see, respectively, Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], pp. 20–26, and De Libera [1991].

[15] Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], p. 42, 9; p. 44, 3; p. 88, 13; p. 90, 5; p. 92, 3; p. 102, 11.

[16] Gutas [1988], p. 215.

[17] See the remarks by Genequand in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], p. 5 and n. 9.

referred to not only in this case, but also in the first and third quotation.

> Outline 1: Explicit quotations of Alexander of Aphrodisias in the *Ilāhiyyāt*
> 1) In IX, 2, p. 392, 7–14 [p. 462, 53–54], the First Teacher (= Aristotle) and "the Peripatetic scholars after him who have validated his thought" (*man baʿdahū min muḥaṣṣilī ʿulamāʾ al-mašsāʾīna*), namely Alexander and Themistius, are quoted together as supporters of the view that the universe in its entirety has one single mover, but each of its spheres has also a proper mover. As far as Alexander is concerned this doctine occurs in *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*, pp. 86, 16–88, 2 (= Alexander of Aphrodisias [1947], pp. 266, 9–11; Badawī [1968], pp. 130–131; Rosenthal [1975], p. 146; see Alexander of Aphrodisias [2002], p. 59).[18]
>
> 2) In IX, 2, pp. 392, 17–393, 1 [p. 463, 67–69], Alexander is named "One of his [i.e. Aristotle's] followers who speaks more to the point", *baʿḍ man huwa asadd qawlan min aṣḥābihī*. The title of his work is paraphrased by Avicenna as "his epistle that deals with the principles of the universe" (*fī risālatihī allatī fī mabādiʾ al-kull*). The doctrine referred to is the same as in the first quotation.[19]
>
> 3) In IX, 2, p. 393, 5 [p. 463, 75–77], in a sort of conclusion of the preceding quotations, Alexander and Themistius are mentioned again: they are called "the ancient disciples of the First Teacher that are closest to the right way" (*aqrab qudamāʾ talāmiḏat al-muʿallim al-awwal min sawāʾ al-sabīl*).[20]
>
> 4) IX, 3, pp. 393, 15–394, 1 [p. 464, 92–93], Alexander is named "the excellent among previous [philosophers]" (*fāḍil al-mutaqaddimīna*). The reference is to *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*, p. 90, 11–15 (= Alexander of Aphrodisias [1947], p. 267, 13–18; Badawī [1968], p. 132).[21]

These quotations reveal Avicenna's high esteem both of Alexander and of the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*. The expression designating Alexander in the second quotation ("the excellent among the previous [philosophers]") is extremely praising, and would fit Aristotle equally well.[22]

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[18] In the parallel passage in *Mabdaʾ*, pp. 61, 16–62, 1, Aristotle is called "the Philosopher", and the expression "the validating Peripatetic scholars that come after him" is replaced by "Alexander (*al-Iskandar*), Themistius (*Ṯāmisṭiyūs*) and the Peripatetic scholars" (see Gutas [1988], p. 290). This shows that the expressions by means of which Avicenna refers to Alexander and Themistius in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are, at least in his intentions, definite descriptions; accordingly, I regard these references, like the references to Aristotle as "First Teacher", as explicit determinate quotations.

[19] In the parallel passage in *Mabdaʾ*, p. 62, 5–6, the name "Alexander" (*al-iskandar*) replaces this expression (see Gutas [1988], p. 290).

[20] This expression has no parallel in *Mabdaʾ* (see Gutas [1988], p. 291).

[21] Two witnesses of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (P125, Ṭs.l.; see Appendix A) place the name "Alexander" (*al-Iskandar*) before this expression.

[22] Aristotle is called "this excellent First Teacher" (*hāḏā al-fāḍil al-muʿallim*

The *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* is, together with Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, the only work on metaphysics explicitly mentioned in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[23] In recent scholarship Alexander's treatise is rightly depicted as "Ibn Sīnā's main inspiration throughout book IX of the *Ilāhiyyāt*", up to the point that "Ibn Sīnā's more developed and . . . more coherent system is largely inspired" by it.[24] Besides the doctrine, also the "style" of the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*—i.e. its being a compendium of Aristotle's philosophical theology rather than a running exegesis of Aristotle's text—might have influenced Avicenna.

Besides the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*, also the Arabic translation of Alexander's literal commentary on *Metaphysics* Λ might have been known to Avicenna.[25] If compared with the many quotations of the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*, the absence of any explicit quotation of Alexander's commentary on Λ in Avicenna's works is striking.[26] However, the

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al-awwal) in *ʿIbāra* II, 4, p. 121, 2 (see Appendix D, I.3). In *Nafs* III, 7, p. 149, 4–5 [II, pp. 264, 77–265, 78] Alexander is called *fāḍil qudamāʾ al-mufassirīn* ("the most excellent among the ancient commentators"; see Avicenna Latinus [1972], p. 265, ad l. 78; Avicenna Latinus [1980], p. 464, ad linn. 92–93). For the quotations of Alexander in the *Qiyās*, see Street [2001]. Alexander is mentioned four times in Avicenna's *Ḥawāšī Kitāb al-nafs* (p. 78, 22; p. 101, 17; p. 106, 1; p. 114, 6); see Gutas [1988], p. 291, n. 22.

[23] See Appendix B, II.2.1.

[24] Genequand's introduction, in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], pp. 24–25. The points of dependence underscored by Genequand are the idea that the First Principle cannot be demonstrated apodictically in IX, 1; the description of the heavenly movement in IX, 2 (see Martini [2004], pp. 237–239); and the doctrine of the heavenly bodies' influence on the sublunary world in IX, 5. We may wonder whether the very presence of celestial souls (absent in al-Fārābī's *Mabādiʾ*) in Avicenna's account of the heavenly world in IX, 2–4 depends on the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* (see pp. 46, 9–50, 1 = §§7–10). Avicenna's notion of "necessary on account of something else" is regarded by Averroes, in the commentary on *Physics* Θ (Lat. transl., p. 426vb), as a result of the influence of Alexander's doctrine according to which celestial bodies acquire eternity from their immaterial movers (Steel [1987], p. 216 and nn. 11–12). Steel remarks that this doctrine is absent in Alexander's Greek works: it is possibly Averroes' interpretation of Alexander's repeated contention of the heavenly bodies' eternity and their dependence of the eternal First Mover in *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* (see Genequand's remarks in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2001], pp. 15–16). G. Endress underscores the influence of the epitome of the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* on Avicenna's *Mabdaʾ*—and, through Avicenna, on Mullā Ṣadrā—in Alexander of Aphrodisias [2002], pp. 57–61.

[25] Alexander's commentary is fragmentarily preserved in the *Tafsīr* (pp. 1406ff. *passim*). J. Freudenthal (Alexander of Aphrodisias [1885] has provided the German version of the Hebrew translation of Averroes' quotations; the French and English translations of these passages (together with a reassessment of their number and extent) are available in Martin [1984] and Genequand [1984].

[26] Hasnawi [1996], p. 39, n. 26, maintains that it is unlikely that Avicenna had

fact that Alexander's commentary is never explicitly quoted by Avicenna, does not exclude the possibility of an implicit use of its doctrine: Avicenna's preference for the *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* over the commentary on Λ might depend on the literary genre of the former (an independent work rather than an exegesis, i.e. a type of writing more congenial to Avicenna's own understanding of the practice of philosophy and attitude towards the Aristotelian tradition) or on the incompleteness of the latter in its Arabic translation.[27] A trustworthy witness, Averroes, documents the influence on Avicenna of Alexander's commentary.[28] A comparison between the extant fragments of Alexander's work and Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* has still to be accomplished: in the previous chapters we have noticed similarities concerning the structure of the metaphysics,[29] its method[30] and the importance in it of book Γ.[31] The part of Alexander's commentary preserved in Greek (books A–Δ) is regarded as having influenced indirectly, by means of its reception by Neoplatonic commentators, Avicenna's metaphysics.[32]

The influence on the *Ilāhiyyāt* of some works of Alexander less directly related to the *Metaphysics* has to be conclusively mentioned. In Alexander's commentary on the *Topics*, the account of the Stoic doctrine of "something" (τις) as supreme genus is probably the source of Avicenna's treatment of "thing" (*šayʾ*) as first intelligible in I, 5.[33] Avicenna's doctrine of universals in V, 1–2 is, many respects, similar

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access to Alexander's commentary, since he does not quote it explicitly anywhere, as he does with Alexander's *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull* and Themistius' paraphrase of Λ.

[27] Both al-Fārābī and Averroes state that Alexander's commentary on Λ is incomplete: the part of it preserved in the *Tafsīr* arrives until the exegesis of Λ, 7, 1072b16.

[28] *Tafsīr*, p. 1423, 18; p. 1426, 12; p. 1436, 6.

[29] Chapter 5, §6.4.

[30] Chapter 6, §4.2.

[31] Chapter 9, §5.1.

[32] Alexander's distinction between well-being and being in, among other places, his commentary on *Metaph.* A, 9, 992a24, and Δ, 5, 1015a20–26 (Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], p. 121, 19–20; p. 360, 19–28, p. 361, 11–13, 24–29), later adopted by the Neoplatonists, is the ultimate basis for Avicenna's distinction between essence and existence according to Wisnovsky [2002], p. 103 and n. 15. Likewise, Alexander's distinction between internal and external causes in his commentary on *Metaph.* Δ, 1, 1012b34 (Alexander of Aphrodisias [1891], pp. 345, 37–346, 16), furhter elaborated by the Neoplatonists, is the source of Avicenna's similar distinction according to Wisnovsky [2003b], p. 61 and n. 22. See also Wisnovsky [2003].

[33] See Wisnovsky [2000], pp. 191–192. On this Stoic doctrine, see Brunschwig [1986].

to that of Alexander in his *De Anima, Quaestiones* and some logical treatises preserved in Arabic.[34] Finally, the possible dependence of Avicenna's treatment of providence in IX, 6 on Alexander's *De Providentia* (lost in Greek, preserved in Arabic) is worthy to be considered.[35]

1.2 *Themistius*

Themistius' paraphrase of *Metaphysics* Λ was very important for Avicenna's understanding of the *Metaphysics*.[36] It oriented his approach to Aristotle's work from the very beginning, as Avicenna's early recourse to this paraphrase during his philosophical education witnesses,[37] and it affected Avicenna's view of Aristotle's philosophical theology at all levels, as its explicit quotations not only in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, but also in *Šarḥ Lām* attest.[38] On the doctrinal level, it is interesting

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[34] See De Libera [1999], p. 500: ". . . certaines théories d'Avicenne . . . ne prennent leur sens véritable qu'à être rapportées à . . . le réseau de problèmes, d'arguments et de solutions tendu par Alexandre d'Aphrodise sur la question aristotélicienne de l'abstraction". On the corpus of Alexander's writings relevant to the theory of abstraction, see *ibid.*, pp. 51–55.

[35] In Zonta [1998] and Thillet [2003b], Avicenna is not taken into account.

[36] Two Arabic fragments of this paraphrase have been published by ʿA. Badawī (see the textual remarks by Frank [1958–9]): an abbreviated version of the part dealing with Λ, 6–10 (Themistius [1947]), from the MS. Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 6, ff. 206v16–210r7 (see Gutas [1987c], p. 14a), and a full version of the part dealing with Λ, 1–2 (Themistius [1947b]). Other fragments are quoted by Averroes (*Tafsīr*, pp. 1406ff. *passim*) and Avicenna (see below, Texts 1–2). The French translation of all these *testimonia* is available in Brague [1999]. Themistius' paraphrase is called *šarḥ* in Themistius [1947], p. 12, 1; Themistius [1947b], p. 329, 2; *kalām fī šarḥ* in al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* (see Chapter 3, §1, [1.3]); *talḫīṣ ʿalā l-maʿnā* by Averroes (*Tafsir*, p. 1393, 7). The identity of the Arabic translator is uncertain: according to the *Fihrist* (vol. I, p. 251, 29–30; cp. Ibn al-Nadīm [1988], p. 312, 14), he was Abū-Bišr Mattā; according to the manuscript containing the full version of Λ, 1–2 (Themistius [1947b], p. 329, 2) and the manuscript Munich 108 of the Hebrew translation (see Themistius [1903], p. v) he was Isḥāq b. Ḥunayn (cp. Brague [1999], p. 16, n. 6; p. 17, n. 1). The impact of Themistius' paraphrase of Λ on Avicenna's metaphysics is underscored by al-Šahrastānī in the *Milal*: Al-Šahrastānī [1994], Second Part, pp. 102, 20, 103, 1 (= Al-Šahrastānī [1951–5], p. 964; Al-Šahrastānī [1842–6], p. 312): "Quant à nous, nous avons choisi, pour rapporter son [i.e. d'Aristote] enseignement, le commentaire de Thémistius, sur lequel s'est fondé le premier des modernes, leur chef de file, Abū ʿAlī b. Sīnā" (Jolivet-Monnot [1993], p. 282).

[37] See Chapter 2, §5.

[38] Avicenna's quotations are not literal reports, but rather reinterpretations of Themistius' original points. See, for example, the formula "[Themistius] explains and says something whose meaning is the following . . .") that introduces the second quotation in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (below, Outline 2 [2]).

to notice Avicenna's association of Themistius with Alexander of Aphrodisias on some aspects of cosmology (Outline 2 [1], [3]), his ascription to Themistius of the doctrine of the souls of the heavenly spheres (Outline 2 [2]), and his reception of some Neoplatonic (more precisely, Plotinian) interpretations of Aristotle available in Themistius' paraphrase (Text 1). From the point of view of style, also in the case of Themistius, as in the case of Alexander's *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*, the peculiar format of his work (a paraphrase, rather than a literal commentary), and the consequent "free" attitude towards Aristotle's *litera*, appear to have influenced Avicenna.[39]

In the *Ilāhiyyāt* three explicit determinate quotations of Themistius' paraphrase can be found. All of them occur in the same chapter (IX, 2) and deal with similar, if not identical, doctrines. The second quotation makes clear that Themistius is the philosopher referred to in all three occurrences.

Outline 2: Explicit quotations of Themistius in the *Ilāhiyyāt*

1) See above, Outline 1 [1]. The doctrine quoted by Avicenna occurs in Themistius [1947], pp. 18, 19–19, 4; Brague [1999], pp. 99–100.

2) In IX, 2, p. 393, 2–5 [p. 463, 71–75] (see Brague [1999], pp. 26–27), Themistius (named "He who expressed well the books of the First Teacher by way of epitome, although he could not delve deeply into the ideas", *alladī yaḥsunu ʿibāratuhū ʿan kutubi l-muʿallim al-awwali ʿalā sabīli talḫīṣin wa-in lam yakun yaġūṣu fī l-maʿānī*) is credited with the doctrine according to which the movement proper to each sphere has two principles, one internal, the other separated and loved.[40] This doctrine does not have a precise correspondent in Themistius [1947], but is transmitted in one of Averroes' quotations (*Tafsīr*, p. 1635, 7–8).

3) See above, Outline 1 [3].

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[39] Revealing in this regard is Avicenna's answer to al-Bīrūnī's sixth question in *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī*, pp. 28, 13–29, 1 (cp. Ibn Sīnā, *Rasāʾil*, ed. Bīdārfar, Qum, 1400H., p. 426): "What reached me about this matter is what Themistius (*Ṯāmisṭiyūs*) says in his commentary on the *De Caelo* (*fī tafsīrihī li-kitābi l-samāʾi*), namely that the Philosopher's doctrine ought to be interpreted in the best way (*yanbaġī an yuḥmala qawlu al-faylasūfi ʿalā aḥsani l-wuǧūhi*)" (French translation in Brague [1999], p. 13: "il faut prendre ce que dit le Philosophe sous son meilleur aspect"; see also Brague's remarks in n. 4). Themistius' paraphrase of the *De Caelo* is lost in Greek and Arabic, and extant in Hebrew and Latin. On the dependence of the style of the *Šifāʾ* on Themistius' paraphrases, see the study by C. D'Ancona mentioned in Appendix E, n. 1.

[40] In the parallel passage in the *Mabdaʾ* (p. 62, 7–8), this expression is replaced by the name "Themistius" (*Ṯāmisṭiyūs*; see Gutas [1988], p. 290).

In the second quotation, the internal principle of the heavenly sphere that Themistius upholds is the heavenly soul. Thus, Themistius' paraphrase lies in the background of Avicenna's doctrine of the heavenly souls as the proximate causes of the spheres' movements in IX, 2–3.

The impact of Themistius' paraphrase on the *Ilāhiyyāt* is revealed by, but not limited to, these explicit quotations. Among the many Themistian doctrines implicitly borrowed by Avicenna,[41] scholars have stressed the explanation of how God's knowledge of the individuals does not contrast with His absolute simplicity, in so far as He knows the other things by being the first cause of everything and knowing Himself as such a cause, tacitly adopted by Avicenna in *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 6–7.[42] On this issue, Themistius applies to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* an idea circulating in Plotinus' *Enneads*.[43] In this regard, the Arabic Plotinus (in the specific case, the *Theologia Aristotelis*) is no doubt Avicenna's *ultimate* source, as it has been suggested.[44] However, in the light of Avicenna's explicit quotation of Themistius' doctrine of divine intellection in *Šarḥ Lām* (see below, Text 1), it is more likely that his *proximate* source is Themistius' paraphrase, rather than the *Theologia Aristotelis*.[45]

In Avicenna's *Šārḥ Lām*, two explicit quotations of Themistius occur.[46] The first is a sort of summary of Themistius' paraphrase of

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[41] Brague [1999], p. 34, maintains that Themistius' statement of the impossibility of an *a priori* proof (i.e. a proper demonstration) of God's existence (Themistius [1947], p. 12, 6–7) "est peut-être une source de la prouve d'Avicenna *a contingentia mundi*. Peut-être le concept d'«être nécessaire» en vient-il lui aussi". The intellectual happiness described in Themistius [1947], p. 16, 15–18, might have influenced Avicenna's doctrine of the final happiness of the human souls in IX, 7.

[42] Avicenna's implicit quotations occur in VIII, 6, pp. 358, 14–359, 2 [pp. 417, 61–418, 73] (see Pines [1987], p. 193, with English translation; cp. D'Ancona [2003], pp. 208–209); VIII, 6, pp. 359, 12–360, 3 [pp. 418, 91–419, 4] (see D'Ancona [2003], p. 210); VIII, 7, p. 363, 1–4 [p. 423, 83–88] (see Pines [1987], pp. 193–194, with English translation). The quoted passage of Themistius' paraphrase is, in all three cases, Themistius [1947], p. 21, 4–6, 10–14. In Brague [1999], p. 115, the term *takaṯṯara* occurring in this passage (Themistius [1947], p. 21, 13) is not translated.

[43] See the *loci* indicated by Pines [1987], p. 187; Brague [1999], p. 37 and n. 3; D'Ancona [2003].

[44] This is the perspective of D'Ancona [2003].

[45] See M. Geoffroy's point of view, reported in D'Ancona [2003], p. 225, p. 237, n. 80.

[46] In both cases, Themistius is called by his proper name (*Ṯāmisṭiyūs*, Avicenna [1947], p. 26, 23; p. 31, 4). Two other quotations of Themistius occur in *Ḥawāšī Kītāb al-nafs*, p. 98, 18–19; p. 116, 10–11 (see Gutas [1988], p. 291, n. 21).

Λ, 9: Avicenna praises Themistius for his explanation of how God intellects, at the same time, Himself and the external things. The quoted passage is Themistius [1947], p. 21, 4–6, 10–14.

> Text 1: *Šarḥ Lām*, pp. 26, 23–27, 4
>
> One of the things that Themistius did well was to show clearly that the First Principle intellects Himself, and then from Himself He intellects all things. He intellects the intelligible world (*al-ʿālam al-ʿaqlī*)[47] at one and the same time, without having the need to pass or to go back from one object of intellection to another. He does not intellect things as being outside of Himself, intellecting them in themselves as we do with regard to sensible things, but intellects them in Himself. His being an intellect must not be due to the existence of things [that are] intellected, so [that it follows] that it is their existence that makes Him an intellect. The contrary is (true). He [i.e. Themistius] says: supposing that there should be a thing that perfects the First One, the latter's nobility would not be established, whether His object of intellection be one or many.[48]

The second quotation, on the contrary, is a criticism. After having reproached Aristotle for what he states in *Metaph.* Λ, 9, 1074b32–33,[49] about the First Mover's intellection (". . . if thought is not the act of thinking but a potency, it would be reasonable to suppose that the continuity of its thinking is wearisome to it" Λ, 9, 1074b28–29), Avicenna first reports ([a]) and then refutes ([b]) the corresponding passage of Themistius' paraphrase (Themistius [1947], pp. 20, 21–21, 1):

> Text 2: *Šarḥ Lām*, p. 31, 4–6
>
> [a] Neither does Themistius make a correct statement [on this point]. For he says that [the Intellect] is not fatigued because He intellects Himself, as something is not fatigued because of its loving itself.
>
> [b] In fact, however, the reason is not His [intellecting] Himself or something other than Himself, but rather the fact that His intellecting is not contrary to anything in the substance of the subject of intellection (*ʿāqil*).[50]

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[47] The term *al-ʿaqlī* is missing in the Arabic version of Themistius' paraphrase (Themistius [1947], p. 21, 12), whereas it is present in the Hebrew translation. On account of this evidence, Brague [1999], p. 115, n. a, concludes that "Avicenne semble . . . avoir eu en sa possession le texte complet de la traduction arabe".

[48] English translation in Pines [1987], p. 191 (modified).

[49] See Chapter 6, §3.1, n. 72.

[50] Reading *ʿāqil* with the manuscripts, instead of *ʿaql* as in Themistius [1947]. English translation in Pines [1987], pp. 192–193, slightly modified; French translation and commentary in Janssens [2003], pp. 413–415.

As in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, also in the *Šarḥ Lām* implicit quotations of Themistius' paraphrase are frequent.[51] Significantly, Avicenna tacitly portrays Themistius' account of divine noetics as a way to save from inconsistency Aristotle's position on the issue.[52]

Among the other works of Themistius, his paraphrase of the *Physics*, whose Arabic translation is attested, might be referred to by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[53]

1.3 *Later commentators*

As to the commentators of Late Antiquity, the possible influence on Avicenna of Syrianus[54] and Ammonius son of Hermeias[55] has already been discussed. Among the other exegetes, Philoponus (John the Grammarian in the Arab tradition) and Simplicius deserve a particular mention.

Avicenna's attitude towards Philoponus's works on natural philosophy is two-sided: he decidely opposes the *De Aeternitate Mundi contra Aristotelem* and the *De Aeternitate Mundi contra Proclum* (this latter not preserved in Greek), in so far as Philoponus' cosmology in these works departs from Aristotle's; in this respect, he is regarded by historians as a member of the "anti-Philoponus camp" in Arabic philosophy.[56] Avicenna's attitude towards Philoponus' commentaries on

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[51] The doctrine of the unicity of the First Mover of the universe in Avicenna [1947], p. 29, 19–21, appears to be dependent on Themistius [1947], p. 19, 10–13 (see Gutas [1988], p. 315 and n. 28).

[52] See, for example, Avicenna [1947], p. 31, 11–16: "I say: If the man [i.e. Aristotle] means (to say) that the best (thing) is for (the Intellect) to intellect Himself alone, he says something that is impossible. For if He intellects Himself (together with) everything that (belongs) to it, He (must also) intellect that which is attached to Himself in act. Accordingly He would intellect Himself being the principle and (this must entail?) His intellecting all (things). For otherwise He would not intellect Himself as He is. If, however, he means (to say) that His intellection begins with His intellecting Himself, and that from Himself He intellects the (other) things, not from the (other) things, and that consequently (these) things are not the cause of His being the Intellect, but that, on the contrary, His being in Himself the Intellect is the cause of the things, (his statement) would be correct. But (in that case) he (Aristotle) ought to have stated this and not have kept silent about it" (English translation in Pines [1987], pp. 191–192). The passage to which Avicenna is referring is, once again, Themistius [1947], p. 21, 4–6, 10–14 (see above, Text 1).

[53] See Chapter 8, §.5.1, Outline 4.2.

[54] See Chapter 10, §4.3. For Syrianus' cosmological views and their transmission, by means of Philoponus' commentary on the *Physics*, to the Arab world, see Sorabji [1990], pp. 183–184, pp. 187–190.

[55] See Chapter 3, §3.

[56] The expression occurs in Mahdi [1967], p. 236; according to Mahdi, the

Physics, De Anima and *De Generatione et Corruptione*, on the other hand, is more receptive.[57] Thus, Avicenna explicitly criticizes Philoponus in the *Samāʾ wa-ʿĀlam*,[58] whereas in the *Samāʿ* he displays a more nuanced attitude: on the one hand, he defends the Aristotelian doctrine of the eternity of the world against Philoponus' attack; on the other hand, he introduces Philoponus' doctrine of impetus, with certain modifications, into Aristotle's physical theory.[59] As to the *Ilāhiyyāt*, Philoponus' commentary on the *Physics* appears to be the source of the Pythagorean doctrine that Avicenna discusses in III, 6,[60] and of Avicenna's own doctrine of the body's tridimensional form in II, 2, whose ultimate origin is Plato's *Timaeus* (53C6).[61] Avicenna's critical attitude towards Philoponus, i.e. towards the major representant of the synthesis between Greek philosophy and Christian monotheism, has to be remarked.

Simplicius' commentary on the *Categories*—whose Arabic translation is attested, even though not preserved[62]—might be the source of Avicenna's distinction between logical and metaphysical treatment of the categories,[63] and of his doctrine according to which prime

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"pro-Philoponus camp" encompasses al-Kindī, al-Rāzī, the Christian philosophers of Baġdād, al-Ġazālī, and Abū-l-Barakāt al-Baġdādī, whereas the "anti-Philoponus camp" includes, besides Avicenna, al-Fārābī, Ibn-Bağğa and Averroes). Outside the *Šifāʾ*, Avicenna openly dissents from the *Contra Aristotelem* in the *Letter to Kīyā*, where he also declares of being occupied with a careful study of Philoponus' thought (see Gutas [1988], pp. 62–64). Criticism of the *Contra Proclum* is attested by an unpublished treatise by Avicenna (see Pines [1972], pp. 346–352; cp. Janssens [1991], pp. 52–53).

[57] See the *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī*, p. 13, 7–10: ". . . John the Grammarian who pretends in front of the Christians to manifest dissent towards Aristotle about this statement [i.e. the eternity of the world]. But to the one who looks at his commentary on the last part of the *De Generatione et Corruptione* and [his] other books, perhaps it is not concealed [his] agreement with Aristotle on this issue" (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 289–290 and n. 14). Gutas [1988], p. 162, n. 33; p. 167, includes Philoponus' commentary on the *Posterior Analytics* among the sources of Avicenna's doctrine of intuition. Avicenna had access to an Arabic translation of Philoponus' commentary on the *De Anima*, which deeply influenced his psychology (Gutas [1986]; Gutas [2004], p. 83; Wisnovsky [2003], pp. 113–114, p. 137). On the reception of Philoponus' natural philosophy in Avicenna's *Šarḥ Lām*, see Sorabji [1990], pp. 187–190.

[58] Mahdi [1967], p. 236; p. 256, n. 24; p. 257, n. 41.

[59] Hasnawi [1991], pp. 233–235; Hasnawi [2000], pp. 512–513.

[60] See Chapter 8, §5.1, Outline 4.2.

[61] Philoponus [1888], p. 567; see Bäck [1989], p. 30, nn. 38–39; Bäck [1994], p. 46, n. 33.

[62] See Peters [1968], p. 9, (f); Gätje [1982].

[63] See Hoffman [2000].

matter is not a subject.[64] It might also be the cause of Avicenna's acquaintance with Stoic ontology[65] and with Porphyry's consideration of the specific difference of substance as both substance and accident (see below, §2.3).[66]

2 Platonic tradition

Together with Plato himself, three authors are relevant as representatives of the Platonic tradition in Avicenna: Plotinus, Porphyry and Proclus.[67] The quotations of Plato and Porphyry are mainly explicit and critical, whereas the borrowings from the Arabic translations/reworkings of Plotinus' and Proclus' works are implicit and consensual, due, probably, to the false attribution of the *Theologia Aristotelis* (reworking of Plotinus' *Enneads* IV–VI) and the *Liber de Causis* (adaptation of Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica*) to Aristotle in the Arab philosophical environment. Avicenna's outspoken dissent towards Plato and his animosity towards Porphyry indicate that the endorsement of the program of harmonization between the philosophies of Plato and Aristotle, initiated by Porphyry, was decidedly narrower in the case of Avicenna than in the case of al-Kindī, who accomplished this program by means of the translations made in his circle and his own works, and al-Fārābī, who expounded it in the *Ǧamʿ*.

2.1 *Plato*

Not all the quotations of Plato in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are taken from Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Even though we cannot exclude Avicenna's direct

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[64] See Stone [2001], p. 78, n. 24.

[65] See Wisnovsky [2000], pp. 191–192.

[66] See Stone [2001], pp. 87–88. Simplicius' commentary on the *Physics* was not translated into Arabic; his exegesis of *Phys.* A, 7 (Simplicius [1882], p. 228, 23–25) can be the source of Avicenna's conception of the body's three-dimensionality (II, 2, p. 61, 6–7 [p. 69, 89–90]) and of the bodily form (II, 2, p. 63, 13ff. [p. 72, 47ff.]), as argued by Stone [2001], p. 97 and n. 100, only indirectly.

[67] Wisnovsky [2002], p. 117 and n. 40; cp. p. 115, n. 33, indicates Iamblichus' *Theologumena Arithmeticae* 18, 17, as a possible antecedent of Avicenna's attribution of ontological meaning to the concepts of "superabundant", "perfect" and "deficient" number in *Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 3. Iamblichus' influence in this regard, however, was, in all likelihhod, indirect (possibly mediated by Proclus, mentioned by Wisnovsky *ibid.*; see below, §2.4), since this work of his does not result to have been translated into Arabic.

acquaintance with some of Plato's dialogues in Arabic translation,[68] the references to Plato (explicit indeterminate) whose source is not Aristotle appear to be indirect: they are drawn either from the Arabic translation of Galen's compendium of the *Timaeum*,[69] or from the Neoplatonic commentators of Aristotle,[70] of from al-Fārābī.[71] In these further quotations, as in the ones derived from the *Metaphysics*, Avicenna's attitude towards Plato is sharply critical: in this regard, he continues to follow Aristotle's model.[72] Signs of a possible positive reception of Plato's philosophy surface only outside the *Šifā'*.[73]

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[68] See Avicenna's quotations of Plato's *Sophist* in the *Šafsaṭa* (Gutas [1988], p. 38 and n. 9), and in the *Mabda'* (Michot [1994], p. 76).

[69] The opinion that Avicenna reports in IV, 2, p. 183, 7–8 [p. 210, 3–5] (see Appendix B, 1.3, s.v. *ʿāmma min al-qudamā'*, "most of the ancients") mirrors Plato's doctrine in the Arabic translation of Galen's compendium of the *Timaeus* (Galen [1951], p. 5, 10–12; p. 22, 14–16, corresponding to *Timaeus*, 30A; 69B–C). D'Ancona [2003], p. 209, maintains that "the *Timaeus* itself, in one of the forms of its Arabic circulation . . . may have provided him (i.e. Avicenna) with the topic of the divine *cura* as a rational arrangement of the physical universe" in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

[70] The doctrines of the body's three-dimensionality, and of the bodily form, that Avicenna endorses, come originally from Plato's *Timaeus* (53C6). This passage of the *Timaeus* is not reported in the Arabic translation of Galen's summary: Avicenna had access to these doctrines through Simplicius' commentary on the *Physics* (see above, §1.3) and Philoponus' commentary on the same work (see above, §1.3).

[71] The same use of symbols that Avicenna ascribes to "most of the wise men [i.e. philosophers]" (*akṯar al-ḥukamā'*) in I, 8, p. 51, 10 [p. 59, 33] (see Appendix B, I.3), is attributed to Plato by al-Fārābī in *Ǧamʿ*, p. 71, 3. Plato is frequently mentioned also in the Arabic Plotinus: see *Theologia Aristotelis* [1955], pp. 23, 14–28, 3 (= *Theologia Aristotelis* [1882], pp. 9, 18–14, 9; Lewis [1959], pp. 227–231; the name of Plato occurs at p. 23, 14; p. 24, 8, 10, 15; p. 25, 16) and the *loci* of the *Dicta Sapientis Graeci* discussed in D'Ancona [2004].

[72] See *Mabda'* II, 7, p. 85, 6–7 (Michot [1994], p. 57): But the apparent [meaning] of his doctrine [i.e. Plato's doctrine of ideas] is inconsistent and false, [as] the Philosopher [= Aristotle] has thoroughly discussed in many books" (see Chapter 8, §5.1, n. 42). In this passage Avicenna refers to *loci* like *An. Post.* A, 11, 77a5–9 (= *Burhān* II, 10, pp. 187, 6–189, 14); *Metaph.* Z, 2, 1028b19–21; Z, 14 *in toto*; Z, 15, 1040a8–b4; Z, 16, 1040b27–1041a3; Λ, 1–5; Λ, 8, 1073a17–22; Λ, 10.

[73] For the evolution of Avicenna's consideration of Plato and his different attitudes towards him in his various works, see Gutas [1988], pp. 286–287. Commenting on the *Theologia Aristotelis* in the *Inṣāf* (Avicenna [1947b], p. 46; Vajda [1951], pp. 363–364), Avicenna connects to Plato his own distinction between Creator and creatures based on the essence-existence distinction. We might wonder whether Avicenna's doctrine, in the *Ilāhiyyāt* and elsewhere, according to which caused things, simply possible on account of themselves, are necessary on account of their causes might be a reflex of Plato's doctrine (*Tim.* 41A–B; *Polit.* 270A3–4), transmitted by Proclus, of the world being immortal on account of its Creator (see Steel [1987], p. 216 and n. 12).

2.2 *Plotinus* (Theologia Aristotelis)

Avicenna's dependence on Neoplatonism is frequently stated in Avicennian studies. This general point has been specified with regard to Avicenna's endorsement of a hierarchical system of the sciences in epistemology,[74] of a similarly hierarchical view of the relationship between cause and effect in metaphysics,[75] and of the doctrine of emanation in cosmology.[76]

Avicenna's works reveal an increasing reception of the Arabic Plotinus: in the autobiography only the *Metaphysics* is mentioned as text-book on metaphysics,[77] and in the youthful *Aqsām* this discipline is said to be entirely contained in Aristotle' homonymous work;[78] in the later *Mabda'*, on the other hand, this discipline is portrayed as having a "section" (*qism*)—representing its "fruit"—known as *Theology* (*uṯūlūǧiyā*) and dealing, among other things, with "[God's] lordship" (*rubūbiyya*), two terms occurring in the title of the main text of the *Plotinus Arabus* (the pseudoepigraphic *Uṯūlūǧiyā Arisṭāṭālīs, Theologia Aristotelis*);[79] in the more mature *Inṣāf*, accordingly, Avicenna comments not only on the *Metaphysics*, but also on the *Theologia Aristotelis*;[80] from the *Letter to Kīyā* we apprehend that, despite some doubts on the content or style of this work, Avicenna regarded the *Theologia Aristotelis* as the culmination of the philosophical *curriculum*.[81]

The influence of the *Theologia Aristotelis* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* has been detected in four main doctrinal areas: in Avicenna's denial that God has an essence and is a substance in VIII, 4;[82] in his understanding of the concepts of deficiency and perfection, and the consideration

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[74] See Maroth [1980]; Maroth [1994]; Daiber [2004]. See also the remarks on the *syllogismos tekmeriodes* in Chapter 6, §1.2, n. 45.

[75] See Wisnovsky [2003]; Daiber [2004].

[76] See Gardet [1951]; Goichon [1952]; Jannsens [1986]; Ivry [1990]; Hasnawi [1990b]; Hasnawi [1991], pp. 239–240. Pessin [2004], who explains Avicenna's doctrine of the extraneity of existence with regard to essence as a way that Avicenna uses to stress the priority of essence over existence in order to convey in the reader's mind the Neoplatonic idea of a return of the soul to the immaterial world, seems to go beyond the point.

[77] See Chapter 2, §2.

[78] The same restriction of metaphysics to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* occurs in al-Fārābī's *Iḥṣā'* (see Chapter 3, §5, ii).

[79] *Mabda'*, Introduction, p. 1, 8 (see Appendix D, III.i.1).

[80] See Appendix C, Work 12.

[81] See Chapter 2, Text 3; D'Ancona [2005], p. 54 and n. 35.

[82] Rosheger [2002].

of God as "above perfection" in IV, 3 and VIII, 6;[83] in the doctrine according to which God knows the things of the world by knowing Himself as their principle (also present in Themistius' paraphrase of *Metaph.* Λ, see above §1.2) in VIII, 6–7;[84] and in the doctrine of the final destiny of the human souls in IX, 7.[85] To these three doctrinal points, a terminological remark can be added: Avicenna uses the term "lordship" (*rubūbiyya*), occurring in the title of the *Theologia Aristotelis*, in the very chapter VIII, 6, in which he allegedly borrows two doctrines from this work.[86]

The study of the doctrinal similarities between the *Ilāhiyyāt* and the other two texts of the Arabic Plotinus—the *Risāla fī l-ʿilm al-ilāhī* (*Epistola de Scientia Divina*) and the sayings of the "Greek Sage", *šayḫ al-yūnānī* (*Dicta Sapientis Graeci*)—has still to be undertaken.[87]

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[83] Wisnovsky [2002], pp. 118–119, points at *Theologia Aristotelis* 10, pp. 134, 16–135, 12, corresponding to *Enneads* V, 2 [11], 1, 7–11 (Plotinus [1959], pp. 290–292; Lewis [1959], pp. 291–293, §§6–8), not commented in *Šarḥ Tafsīr Uṯūlūğiyā*. See also Wisnovsky's remarks on the *Liber de Causis*, below.

[84] Adamson [2003], p. 93, refers to *Theologia Aristotelis* 2, p. 37, 11–15, with no precise correspondence in the *Enneads* (see Lewis [1955], p. 72, §51); D'Ancona [2003] refers to *Theologia Aristotelis* 5, pp. 65, 4–69, 15, corresponding to *Enneads* VI, 7 [38], 1, 1–2, 12 (Plotinus [1955], pp. 430–436; Lewis [1955], pp. 431–435, §§1–26), commented by Avicenna in *Šarḥ Tafsīr Uṯūlūğiyā*, p. 62, 1–15 (Vajda [1951], p. 387), and *Theologia Aristotelis* 10, pp. 161, 10–162, 10, corresponding to *Enneads* V, 8 [31], 7, 1–17 (Plotinus [1955], pp. 392–394; Lewis [1955], p. 393, §§182–186), not commented in *Šarḥ Tafsīr Uṯūlūğiyā*. See also *Theologia Aristotelis* 2, p. 32, 19–20, corresponding to *Enneads* IV, 4 [28], 2, 10–11 (Plotinus [1959], p. 66; Lewis [1959], p. 67, §24), not commented in *Šarḥ Tafsīr Uṯūlūğiyā*. *Enneads* V, 3 [49], 6, 5–7 (Plotinus [1959], p. 306), where the doctrine in question also occurs, has no correspective in the *Theologia Aristotelis*.

[85] Gutas [1988], pp. 254–255. Gutas' claim can be substantiated by noting that the distinction between the religious and the philosophical explanation of the destiny of souls in IX, 7, p. 423, 4–13 [pp. 506, 92–507, 8] might derive from *Theologia Aristotelis* 1, p. 21, 4–7 (= *Theologia Aristotelis* [1882], p. 7, 7–11), commented by Avicenna in *Šarḥ Tafsīr Uṯūlūğiyā*, p. 43 (Vajda [1951], p. 360); likewise, the two types of souls (those inclined to the body and those not inclined to it), of which Avicenna speaks in the course of IX, 7, have a correspective in *Theologia Aristotelis* 1, pp. 20, 13–21, 4 (= *Theologia Aristotelis* [1882], pp. 6, 17–7, 7), commented in *Šarḥ Tafsīr Uṯūlūğiyā*, pp. 41–42 (Vajda [1951], pp. 357–360).

[86] *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 7, p. 365, 1 [p. 426, 45] (cp. *rubūbī* in VIII, 7, p. 364, 13 [p. 425, 38], p. 366, 3 [p. 427, 73]); cp. *Theologia Aristotelis*, p. 1, 6. The same term occurs also in *Mabdaʾ*, Introduction, p. 1, 9 (Gutas [1988], p. 31); *Aqsām*, p. 90, 2; *ʿUyūn*, p. 17, 5–6; *Dānešnāme* 2, Morewedge [1973], p. 14.

[87] The influence of *Epistola de Scientia Divina*, p. 175, 19–23, corresponding to *Enneads* V, 3 [49], 13, 6–7, 9 (Plotinus [1959], p. 322; Lewis [1959], p. 323, §§123–125) on the doctrine of God's knowledge in *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 6 is remarked by Adamson [2003], pp. 101–102. Avicenna's doctrine in IX 2, according to which the First Intellect intellects the First Principle, Itself as necessary, Itself as potential,

In sum: despite the doctrinal or methodological reserves he may have towards this work, Avicenna reproduces tacitly some themes of the *Theologia Aristotelis* in OntologyC/Theology of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. This attests to the fact that he shared the consideration, typical of the Arab philosophical *milieu*, of the Arabic Plotinus as a sort of theological complement of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. The same applies to Avicenna's recourse to the *Proclus Arabus* (the *Liber de Causis*), as we are going to see (below, §2.4).[88]

2.3 *Porphyry*

With the expression "many of those who arrogate knowledge to themselves" in II, 1, p. 58, 10–16 [p. 66, 30], Avicenna refers, in all likelihood, to Porphyry.[89] The opinion that Avicenna criticizes is similar, both in doctrine and in the example adduced (heat), to the theory that Porphyry expounds in his commentary on the *Categories (In Cat.* 5, Porphyry [1887], p. 95, 22–27) to explain how the specific difference of substance (itself a substance) can be, according to Aristotle, a quality (see Arist. *Top.* Δ, 2, 122b16–17; Δ, 6, 144a20–21). Porphyry's opinion is mentioned by Simplicius in his commentary

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thus producing, respectively, the Second Intellect, the soul of the first heaven and the body of this latter, can be compared with *Dicta Sapientis Graeci*, MS Bodleian Marsh 539, f. 24v, corresponding to *Enneads* IV, 8 [6], 3, 25–27 (Plotinus [1959], pp. 234–235; Lewis [1959], pp. 235–237, §58): when the soul looks at what is above itself, it intellects, whereas when it looks at itself it orders, governs and rules what is below itself. The idea that the particular souls desire to go back to the intellect in *Dicta Sapientis Graeci*, MS Bodleian Marsh 539, f. 25r, corresponding to *Enneads* IV, 8 [6], 4, 1–2 (Plotinus [1959], p. 236; Lewis [1959], p. 237, §64) might foreshadow Avicenna's doctrine of the final destination of human souls in IX 7.

[88] The incompleteness of Aristotle's philosophical theology in *Metaph.* Λ 6–10 is remarked also by Aristotelian scholars, who advance the hypothesis of a larger (either unaccomplished or lost) account of theology by Aristotle. Kahn [1985], p. 323, states that "we must *imagine* as completion of his [i.e. Aristotle's] metaphysics a version of Λ 6–10 expanded on the scale of Γ, I and Z-H-Θ", and regards this expanded version as a "second Λ that was never to be written". He also reports (p. 323, n. 15) the opinion of Oehler [1969], pp. 213–216, according to whom Λ, 6–10 is a summary of a lost wider section of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Frede [2000], p. 48 contends that "[o]ne might imagine that Aristotle . . . compiled and wrote Λ as a quick sketch as to what a treatment of substance which also discussed separate immaterial substances could or would have to look like", and reports the opinion of M. Burnyeat, according to which someone might suppose that Aristotle decided "to produce Λ to have and give a more than rudimentary indication as to how a doctrine of separate immaterial substances would fit into his metaphysics" (pp. 48–49).

[89] See Appendix B, I.3, s.v. *kaṯīr mimman yaddaʿī al-maʿrifa*.

on the *Categories* (*In Cat.* 5, Simplicius [1907], p. 78, 21–23; see above, §1.3).

The sharp criticism conveyed by the formula used by Avicenna in this explicit indeterminate quotation is not surprising, in the light of his overall polemical attitude towards Porphyry both in other sections of the *Šifāʾ* and in other works.[90]

2.4 *Proclus* (Liber de Causis)

Of the three main works of Proclus translated into Arabic whose Arabic version is, at least in part, extant (*Elementatio* [or: *Institutio*] *Theologica*, *De Aeternitate Mundi*, the treatise on Plato's three proofs of the eternity of the soul) only the first has been investigated with regard to its impact on Avicenna.[91] The *Elementatio Theologica* appears to have influenced the *Ilāhiyyāt* by means of its Arabic adaptation,

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[90] In *Nafs* V, 6, p. 240, 3–6 [II, p. 136, 65–69], Porphyry is severely criticized for his doctrine of the identity between the soul and the intelligible forms. Avicenna calls him "the one who has composed for them (i.e. the ordinary people) the *Isagoge*" (*huwa lladī ṣannafa lahum Īsāġūǧī*), and refers to his books on the intellect and the intelligibles and on the soul (see Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 136, ad ll. 66, 69). Porphyry is also referred to in *Išārāt* II, 11, p. 265, 12–13 (Goichon [1951], pp. 110–111 and n. 1), in the context of the discussion of improper definitions of correlatives. Avicenna names him here "the autor of the *Isagoge*" (*ṣāḥib Īsāġūǧī*) and belittles his value; the reference is to the chapter of the *Isagoge* dealing with the description of the genus by means of the species (Goichon refers to *Isagoge* 2, 1a32–35 and 1b36–37). In *Išārāt* VII, 10, p. 702, 8–12 (Goichon [1951], p. 448 and n. 2; see Avicenna Latinus [1968], p. 136, ad ll. 65–66; Gutas [1988], p. 291 and n. 23), Porphyry is called by his proper name (*Furfūriyūs*), but no work of his is mentioned (Avicenna refers to a criticism against Porphyry by one of this latter's contemporaries, and to Porphyry's counter-criticism). Further references to Porphyry in Avicenna in Goichon [1951], p. 111, n. 1. Avicenna's criticism of a "certain person" (*baʿḍ al-nās*) who "got confused, came up with the wrong opinion, and strayed from the ideal path" about Aristotle's material intellect in *Letter to Kiyā* (pp. 120, 22–121, 1; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 62) is regarded as directed to Porphyry by Endress [1991], p. 255, to Alexander of Aphrodisias by Gutas [1988], p. 62, n. 7.

[91] On the Arab reception of Proclus, see Proclus [1973], pp. 15–30, to be complemented with Endress [2000]. The *De Aeternitate Mundi* consists of eighteen proofs for the eternity of the world and is no longer extant in Greek. All the proofs except the first were preserved in Philoponus' *De Aeternitate Mundi contra Proclum*, which was translated into Arabic and Latin. The Arabic version of Philoponus' quotations of Proclus' work has been translated by J. Mc Ginnis in Lang-Macro [2001]. The first argument may be of particular interest to Avicennian scholars, since it is the argument for the eternity of the world that the Latins most frequently identify with Avicenna's own original argument. Proclus' conception of evil might have influenced Avicenna's theodicy (see Steel [2002], p. 185, n. 33); his *De Malorum Subsistentia*, however, was not translated into Arabic.

attributed to Aristotle, known as *Liber de Causis*, rather than by means of its Arabic translation.[92]

Even though Avicenna does not comment on the *De Causis* (probably because, contrarily to the *Theologia Aristotelis*, it was not part of the Arabic philosophical curriculum) and, as far as we know, never mentions its title in his writings, he is nonethless indebted towards this work, as the actual content of the *Ilāhiyyāt* attests. His reliance upon the *De Causis* with regard to the universal concept of "existent" that he proposes as the subject-matter of metaphysics in I, 2, and with regard to his conception of metaphysics as a demonstrative science and as *regina scientiarum*, has already been remarked in the previous chapters.[93] Scholars have detected other borrowings from the *De Causis* mostly in Avicenna's description of God's nature in OntologyC/Theology.[94] Their findings can be cumulatively summarized as follows:

> Outline 3: Implicit quotations of the *Siber de Causis* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*
> IV, 3, pp. 188, 5–189, 11 [pp. 215, 17–216, 34]: the First Principle is above perfection: LdC 21 [22] (pp. 22, 12–23, 5); see also *Theologia Aristotelis* 10, pp. 134, 16–135, 11.
> VIII, 4, p. 347, 10–13 [p. 402, 48–56]: the First has no quiddity: LdC 8 [9].
> VIII, 4, p. 348, 5–6 [p. 403, 69–73]: the First cannot be known by means of a definition or a demonstration, in so far as it does not have a cause: LdC 5 [6].
> VIII, 6, p. 355, 11 [p. 412, 62–70]: the Necessary Existent is above perfection: LdC 22 [23]; see also *Theologia Aristotelis* 10, pp. 134, 16–135, 2.

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[92] On the *Liber de Causis*, see D'Ancona [1995] and D'Ancona-Taylor [2003]. The impact on Avicenna of the Arabic translation of the twenty-two propositions of Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica* ascribed to Aristotle and Alexander of Aphrodisias in the Arab tradition (Proclus [1973]; F. Zimmermann [1994]) has still to be investigated: Prop. 167 (Proclus [1973], pp. 35–36) might have influences Avicenna's doctrine of the intellection proper to the heavenly intellects in IX, 4. Wisnovsky [2002], p. 117 and n. 40, envisages Avicenna's attribution of ontological meaning to the concepts of "superabundant", "perfect" and "deficient" number in IV, 3 as depending on *Elementatio Theologica* Prop. 131, p. 116, 15–27. This dependence, however, cannot be direct, since Prop. 131 does not belong to the propositions of the *Elementatio Theologica* translated into Arabic.

[93] See Chapter 4, §2.4; Chapter 6, §4.4; Chapter 7, §5.2.

[94] D'Ancona [2000], Wisnovsky [2002], pp. 117–118; D'Ancona-Taylor [2003], pp. 637–639. Davidson [1987], pp. 294–298, contends that the *Liber de Causis* is one of the sources of the so-called proof of the existence of the Necessary Being in I, 6 (a thesis questioned by Taylor [1990]).

VIII, 7, p. 365, 4–7 [p. 426, 50–56]: the first Intelligible emanates from the First Principle without intermediation, whereas the subsequent intelligibles emanate from It through a mediation: LdC 4 and 4 [5]; see also *Theologia Aristotelis passim*.

VIII, 7, p. 368, 14–16 [p. 431, 50–56]: the pure and supreme beauty of the First is the principle of the beauty of all things: LdC 19 [20].

Avicenna's familiarity with the *Liber de Causis* is also attested by the expression "the Pure Good" (*al-ḫayr al-maḥḍ*), recurring in the Arabic title of the *Liber de Causis* (*Kītāb al-Īḍāḥ li-Arisṭūṭālīs fī l-ḫayr al-maḥḍ*, *Book of Aristotle's Explanation of the Pure Good*) and, for example, in the logical section of the *Šifā'*.[95]

3 Arab philosophers

Avicenna's attitude towards Arab philosophers (both predecessors and contemporaries) in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is, with the noteworty exception of the "Second Teacher" al-Fārābī, mainly critical. Avicenna has three main targets: the anti-Aristotelian, extreme, Platonism of Abū-Bakr al-Rāzī (§3.2); the Neoplatonizing and theologizing intepretation of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* proper of the school of al-Kindī (al-Kindī himself, §3.1, and Abū-l-Ḥasan al-ʿĀmirī, §3.5), whose understanding of certain specific points of Aristotelian cosmology is, according to Avicenna, too naive. The Aristotelianism of the school of Baġdād, which elsewhere is adversed by Avicenna for a too literal interpre-

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[95] In *Burhān* II, 9, p. 178, 18, Avicenna portrays metaphysics ("first philosophy") as the discipline deputed to explain certain natural facts by means of the separated efficient cause, named the "Pure Good" (*al-ḫayr al-maḥḍ*); see Chapter 7, §2.2, n. 49. Davidson [1992], p. 164, points at the presence of the same expression "the Pure Good" (*al-ḫayr al-maḥḍ*) in IX, 3, p. 394, 4 [p. 465, 00]; in this case, however, Avicenna is reporting the opinion—he disagress with—of a "group" (*qawm*) of philosophers (see Appendix B, I.3). The "pure good" is mentioned also in *Aqsām*, p. 90, 23 (see Hein [1985], pp. 315–316). The mention of the "perfect wealth" (*al-ġinā al-tāmm*) in *Išārāt* II, 6 (Avicenna [1957–60], p. 548, 3; cp. the "perfect wealthy", *al-ġanī al-tāmm*, according to a different vocalization, in Avicenna [1892], p. 158, 3) might resemble the "greatest wealth" (*al-ġanā' al-akbar*) of *De Causis* 20, p. 22, 1 (see Badawī [1968], pp. 68–69, whose argument is rejected by Taylor [1986], p. 46, n. 34, on account of the presence of this and related expressions in the *Theologia Aristotelis*; see D'Ancona [2000], p. 100, n. 23).

[96] See the critical quotation of the "founder" of the school Abū-Bišr Mattā (d. 940) in *Ṣarḥ Lām*, p. 26, 3–6. If this quotation is taken from Mattā's glosses on the *Metaphysics* (a possibility envisaged by Hasnawi [1996], pp. 38–39), then Mattā's

tation of Aristotle,[96] in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is criticized, on the contrary, for a doctrine of universals that parts company with Aristotle and resembles too closely Plato's idealism (Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī or Abū l-Qāsim al-Kirmānī, §3.4).

3.1 *Al-Kindī (d. shortly after 870)*

We have already seen in Chapters 2 and 8 that the connection of books α and Λ of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* within OntologyC/Theology in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is a remnant of Avicenna's originary dependance on al-Kindī's approach to Aristotle's work, i.e. the Kindian endeavour to "reduce" the *Metaphysics* to its theological core, at the expenses of its ontological part (see also Chapter 4, §2.3). Avicenna preserves al-Kinḍī's understanding of the predominant role and concrete disposition of *Metaph.* α and Λ within theological philosophy, but enlarges decidedly his perspective by premitting to α and Λ in OntologyC/Theology a lengthy ontological-henological part of metaphysics based on the other books of Aristotle's work.

Avicenna endorses also the two further steps of al-Kindī philosophical "strategy": the "expansion" of Aristotle's philosophical theology (*Metaph.* α and Λ) by means of the *corpus* of Neoplatonic philosophical theology translated into Arabic and attributed to Aristotle (the Plotinian *Theologia Aristotelis* and the Procleian *Liber de Causis*), in the name of the "harmony" between Plato and Aristotle inherited from Porphyry and post-Porphyrian Greek philosophy;[97] and the assumption of the necessary congruence of Greek metaphysics (Aristotelian and Platonic) with Islamic religion on issues like, for example, God's oneness and His creation of the world, in the name of the "harmony" between reason and faith entailed by the belief in the unicity of truth.[98] But also in this case Avicenna's qualifies al-Kindī's point of view in two important respects: first, he criticizes Plato and Porphyry (see above, §2.1, §2.3) and includes among the

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glosses would have included, besides books α, Β and Θ of the *Metaphysics* (see Hasnawi [1996], p. 39, n. 23), also book Λ, and Avicenna would have reacted to the doctrine expressed in them. The passage quoted by Avicenna might also belong to Mattā's glosses on the *Physics*, masterly described in Hasnawi [1996].

[97] D'Ancona [2000], p. 99, nn. 20–21.

[98] The consideration of philosophy as a "religion for intellectuals" is significantly ascribed by G. Endress to both al-Kindī (Endress [1997], p. 56) and Avicenna (Endress [1991], p. 240; [1997b], p. 1 for example).

non-Aristotelian sources by means of which he expands the theology of α and Λ in the *Ilāhiyyāt* writings of the genuine Aristotelian tradition, like the exegetical works of Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius (see above, §1.1–2); second, whereas the synthesis between Greek philosophy and a monotheistic creed accomplished by Philoponus is a model of paramount importance for al-Kindī, Avicenna criticizes Philoponus' anti-Aristotelian creationism (see above, §1.3) and rejects the idea of a compromise between philosophy and religion in which the former should lower its rational standards (see below, §5).

Thus, even though al-Kindī's doctrine of being may lay in the background of Avicenna's consideration of God as Necessary Existent,[99] and of the related distinction of essence and existence,[100] it is not surprising that Naṣīr al-Dīn al-Ṭūsī, in his commentary on Avicenna's *Išārāt*, regards the criticism of "a group of persons affiliated to the people of knowledge" in *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 5, pp. 413, 1–414, 13 [pp. 492, 77–494, 30][101]—regarding the doctrine according to which the four elements are generated by the cosmic movement—as addressed to al-Kindī and his followers.[102] It is significant that, if al-Tūsī's identification is correct, al-Kindī is regarded by Avicenna not as a full member of the "people of knowlege" (*ahl al-ʿilm*), but simply as a person "affiliated" to them.[103]

3.2 *Abū-Bakr al-Rāzī (d. ca. 925)*

The thinker referred to as "one of those who pontificate about what is foreign to them, without being able to discuss deeply questions of that kind" in IV, 2, p. 183, 4–6 [p. 210, 99–03],[104] is, in all likelihood, Abū-Bakr al-Rāzī.[105] The Neoplatonic content of the doc-

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[99] See Gutas [1988], pp. 261–265.

[100] See Adamson [2002], pp. 310–312.

[101] See Appendix B, I.3, s.v. *qawm min al-muntasibīna ilā ahl al-ʿilm*; Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7.

[102] Avicenna [1960–8], III, p. 234 (l. 18 of Ṭūsī's commentary at bottom of page); see Gutas [1988], p. 292.

[103] Gutas [1988], p. 261, maintans that "Islamic philosophers like Kindī and ʿĀmirī, who attempted to accomodate" philosophical issues "more in the direction of Islamic theology, did so at the risk of abandoning the philosophical rigor of the Aristotelian system—and were duly castigated by Avicenna himself".

[104] See Appendix B, I.3, s.v. *baʿḍu al-šāriʿīna fīmā lā yaʿnīhi wa-lā lahū daraǧat al-ḫawḍ fī miṯlihī*; Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7.

[105] This is also the advice of Marmura [2005], p. 403, n. 25.

trine criticized by Avicenna in this passage (the Soul was encharged with governing the matter and bestowing the form to it[106]) and its gnostic overtones (the Soul was not prepared to perform well this task, so the Creator Himself helped it and improved what it had done) fit adequately al-Rāzī's self-description as a Platonist. In the *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī*, Avicenna severely criticizes his metaphysical views with a formula similar to the one employed in this passage.[107]

3.3 *Al-Fārābī (d. 950)*

Avicenna's high esteem of al-Fārābī emerges clearly in the *Letter to Kiyā*, where he is called "the most excellent of our predecessors".[108] As to al-Fārābī's specific influence on Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*, three works of his are particularly relevant.[109] Let us recall here briefly the pieces of evidence discussed in the previous chapters. The most important of al-Fārābī's works in this respect is the *Fī Aġrāḍ*, as Avicenna's second mention of metaphysics in the Autobiography indicates,[110] and as the analysis of Avicenna's conception of the "form" of metaphysics (with particular regard to the subject-matter, structure, and relationship of metaphysics with the other sciences) has shown.[111] The *Fī Aġrāḍ* influences not only Avicenna's general understanding of the

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[106] See Plato, *Tim.* 30B, 34B–C; Galen [1951], p. 5, 12–14; p. 7, 6–7; *Theologia Aristotelis* 1 (Lewis [1959], pp. 225–231, §§21–44; see Avicenna Latinus [1977], p. 210, ad l. 00).

[107] *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī*, p. 13, 10–11: ". . . Muḥammad Ibn Zakariyya al-Rāzī who takes upon himself a task surpassing his own capacities when he tries to deal with theological matters (*fī l-ilāhiyyāt*) . . ." (see Gutas [1988], p. 287 and n. 5, who translates this passage as "He bit more than he could chew in his attempts to deal with Theology").

[108] See Gutas [1988], p. 64. The Farabian background of Avicenna's analysis of the Necessary Being is canvassed by Davidson [1987], pp. 293–298.

[109] Besides the works mentioned in what follows, see also the passage of al-Fārābī's *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf* (Al-Fārābī [1970], pp. 142–153) that Gutas [1983], p. 259, n. 70, has indicated as the source of Avicenna's Text 1 in Chapter 6.

[110] See Chapter 2, §2, Text 2. Cruz Hernandez [2002], pp. 47–53, underestimates the significance of this reference, by regarding it as a device Avicenna uses to maintain generically his Peripatetic affiliation, rather than as an avowal of his reliance on al-Fārābī's specific understanding of the *Metaphysics*. According to Cruz Hernandez, Avicenna did not endorse the main point al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*, namely the refusal of the Neoplatonic interpretation of the *Metaphysics* (p. 49), since the *Metaphysics* was already clear to him thanks to al-Kindī's interpretation (p. 52).

[111] See Chapter 4, §2.5; Chapter 5, §6.5, Texts 20.1–3; Chapter 7, §5.3, Text 25. See also the passage of al-Fārābī's *Falsafat Arisṭūṭālīs* in Chapter 7, §5.3, Text 26.

epistemological profile of metaphysics, but also some of his specific metaphysical doctrines, as the texts of the *Ilāhiyyāt* and of the *Naǧāt* discussed in Chapter 3 document.[112] Al-Fārābī's *Mabādiʾ* are particularly relevant for the structure and content of Avicenna's OntologyC/Theology.[113] The *Iḥṣāʾ* lies in the background of Avicenna's outline of metaphysics in I, 2[114] and of his conception of the method of metaphysics as, in principle, demonstrative.[115]

Through these works, al-Fārābī transmitted to Avicenna not only a coherent interpretation of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, but also some fundamental motives of Neoplatonic metaphysics, like the idea that "one" and unity ought to be investigated by the metaphysician,[116] that the *elementatio* can be transferred from mathematics to metaphysics,[117] and that metaphysics stays at the top of the hierarchy of sciences.[118]

3.4 *Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī (d. 974) or Abū l-Qāsim al-Kirmānī*

The "group of those who grope in [their] pretended philosophy" in V, 1, p. 202, 16 [p. 235, 68],[119] portrayed by Avicenna as "victims" of an erroneous (Platonizing) view on the universals, are identified by scholars either with Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī,[120] or with Abū-l-Qāsim al-Kirmānī, an elder contemporary of Avicenna.[121] The expression (significantly in the plural) might refer to the entire school of the Aristotelians of Baġdād.

3.5 *Abū-l-Ḥasan al-ʿĀmirī (d. 992)*

In IX, 3, pp. 399, 8–401, 9 [pp. 472, 54–475, 19], al-Āmirī is referred to as "the modern Islamic philosophasters who is brave in subverting philosophy since he does not understand the ancients' goal"[122]—cp. the parallel passage in *Naǧāt*, p. 645, 4, where his name

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[112] See Chapter 3, §4, Tables 1–5.
[113] See Chapter 5, §6.5, Table 5.
[114] See Chapter 5, §6.5.
[115] See Chapter 6, §4.5, Text 18.
[116] See Chapter 5, §6.5.
[117] See Chapter 6, §4.5.
[118] See Chapter 7, §5.3, Text 25.
[119] See Appendix B, I.3, s.v. *ṭāʾifa mimman tatašaḥḥaṭu fī l-tafalsuf*.
[120] M. Rashed [2004]. Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī is criticized, together with Philoponus, in the *Samāʾ wa-ʿĀlam* (see Mahdi [1967], p. 256, n. 24).
[121] See Michot's remarks in Avicenna [2000], pp. 15*–17*.
[122] See Appendix B, I.2, s.v. *al-qudm min aḥdaṯ al-mutafalsifa al-islāmiyya fī tašwīš al-falsafa iḏ lam yafham ġaraḍ al-aqdamīn*.

is given[123]—and criticized for the opinion according to which the object of desire of the celestial spheres is a heavenly body rather than a separate intellect.

4 Works by Avicenna

In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna quotes explicitly three works of his: two previous sections of the *Šifā'* (*Burhān* and *Nafs*) and the *Kitāb al-Birr wa-l-iṯm* (*Book on Piety and Sin*).[124] A comparison of this last work with the corresponding part of the *Ilāhiyyāt* would allow an assessment of Avicenna's evolution (if any), but the *Kitāb al-Birr wa-l-iṯm* is unfortunately lost.

The study of Avicenna's metaphysics in diachronic perpsective is, despite some already existing valuable examples, a line of research still to be pursued. An analysis of Avicenna's previous formulations of doctrines presented in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is provided, for instance, by G. Hourani with regard to the distinction beween necessary and possible existence,[125] and by R. Wisnovsky with regard to the distinction between essence and existence and internal and external causes.[126]

A comparative study of the structure of Avicenna's metaphysical works has been provided in Chapter 5, §5.

5 Islamic religion

The attention payd by Avicenna to Islamic religion in the OntologyC/Theology of the *Ilāhiyyāt* has already been noticed[127]. It is witnessed by (i) the quotations of the *Qur'ān*,[128] the *sunna*,[129] the religious

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[123] See Gutas [1988], p. 292.

[124] See Appendix B, II.1.2.

[125] Hourani [1972].

[126] Wisnovsky [2000]; Wisnovsky [2003]; Wisnovsky [2003b] i Wisnovsky [2005], pp. 122–127.

[127] See Marmura [1987], p. 73b; Janssens [1986]; Endress [1991b], pp. 168–169; Janssens [1998] (see, on this latter, the critical remarks by Gutas [2002], p. 86, n. 14). Specific instances of religious/theological influence are discussed by Jolivet [1984]; Marmura [1984b]; Jolivet [1991]; Marmura [1991–2]; Wisnovsky [2000]; Cruz Hernandez [2002], pp. 53–56; Wisnovsky [2003]; Wisnovsky [2004]; Alper [2004].

[128] The first two quotations (VIII, 6, p. 356, 14 [p. 413, 93–94]; VIII, 6, p. 359, 13–14 [pp. 418, 92–419, 93]) are implicit. Both occur in chapter VIII, 6, which deals with God's knowledge. The first quotation ("Everything perishes but His face

law (*šarʿ, šarīʿa*),[130] the prophet Muḥammad,[131] and the caliphs ʿUmar and ʿAlī;[132] (ii) the religious connotations of Avicenna's language: God is called, besides "Allāh", also "the Creator" (*al-Bāriʾ, al-Ḫāliq*)[133] and "the Lord of Heaven and Earth" (*Rabb al-ʿalamīn*),[134] the proof of His unicity is labelled "profession of His unicity" (*tawḥīd*)[135] and His unicity itself is expressed by means of the formula "He has no equal" (*lā šarīka lahū*),[136] His features are called "attributes" (*ṣifāt*

[*waǧhuhū*]", *Qurʾān* XXVIII, 88) is rather puzzling. It follows, and is meant to support, Avicenna's statement that all things other than God are "false in themselves, true thanks to Him, and realized in relation to the face (?) that is proximate to Him" (*wa-bi-l-qiyās ilā l-waǧh allaḏī yalīhi ḥāṣila*, VIII, 6, p. 356, 13–14). In this last sentence, very obscure, if *waǧh* means "face" at all, it refers to a face that is proximate to God, not to God's face itself, as in the Qur'anic quotation. Avicenna possibly means the face of the celestial intellects, that he identifies elsewhere with the angels and are somehow the instruments of divine creation. The second quotation ("Nothing escapes His knowledge, not even the weight of an atom in the heavens or the earth", *Qurʾān* X, 61; XXXV, 11) is meant to complement Avicenna's doctrine according to which God knows everything in a universal way, and to bring it as close as possible to the Islamic dogma of God's omniscience. The other two quotations (X, 3, p. 446, 4–5 [p. 540, 40–41]; X, 4, pp. 7–9 [p. 546, 36–37]; see Appendix B, I.2), on the other hand, are explicit: "Therefore, who speaks truthfully says: 'Surely the good deeds will drive away the evil deeds'" (*Qurʾān* XI, 114); "How excellent was that which [Muḥammad] the gratest of legislators commanded—that the man, after thrice pronouncing the formula for divorce, is not allowed to remarry the woman until he brings himself to drink a cup unsurpassed in bitterness, which is, to first let another man to marry her by a true marriage and have real relations with her" (*Qurʾān* II, 230; transl. Marmura [1960], p. 106). The presence of the *hapax legomenon zulfā* ("proximity" or "rank", see Avicenna Latinus [1980], p. 541, n. 45) in X, 3, p. 446, 13 [p. 541, 55–56], can be explained with the presence of the term *zulafan* ("nigh" Arberry; "approaches" ʿAlī), occasionally written as *zulfā* (see Lane, vol. III, p. 1245b–c), in *Qurʾān* XI, 114, a verse quoted by Avicenna a few lines before. Allusions to Qurʾānic verses occur in X, 2, p. 442, 9 [p. 533, 21]; p. 442, 10 [p. 533, 23]; p. 442, 11 [p. 533, 24–25]; see Marmura [1963], p. 100. For quotations of the *Qurʾān* in other works by Avicenna, see the Index of Qurʾānic Passages in Gutas [1988], p. 337, and Michot [1986], p. 223 (*Qurʾān* LXIII, 4, for example, is quoted in *Mašriqiyyūn*, p. 3, 19).

[129] IX, 6, p. 422, 7–8 [p. 505, 68–69]; p. 422, 8 [p. 505, 69–70] (see Avicenna Latinus [1980], p. 505, nn. 69–70); X, 2, p. 443, 8–9 [p. 535, 55–56] (see Avicenna Latinus [1980], p. 535, ad ll. 55–56).

[130] See Appendix B, I.1, s.v. *Muḥammad*; I.2, s.v. *afḍal al-šarāʿīna.*

[131] See Appendix B, II.1, s.v. *šarʿ, šarīʿa.*

[132] See Appendix B, I.1.

[133] I, 3, p. 19, 5–6 [p. 21, 83]; VI, 1, p. 257, 14 [p. 292, 22]; VII, 3 p. 318, 15 [p. 369, 18]; IX, 1, p. 381, 9 [p. 446, 46]; IX, 3, p. 398, 10 [p. 471, 29].

[134] IX, 7, p. 424, 14 [p. 509, 38–39], p. 424, 14–15 [p. 509, 40].

[135] VIII, 6, p. 349, 9 [p. 404, 4]; X, 2, p. 442, 19 [p. 534, 38].

[136] VIII, 1, p. 327, 5 [p. 376, 6]; VIII, 5, p. 354, 7 [p. 411, 36]; VIII, 5, p. 354, 10 [p. 411, 40–41] (cp. VIII, 6, p. 367, 18 [p. 430, 29]); IX, 1, p. 373, 5–6 [p. 434, 6]; X, 2, p. 443, 5–6 [p. 535, 50].

or *awṣāf*),[137] heavenly intelligences and souls are identified with angels (*malā'ika*),[138] divine "inspiration" (*ilhām*)[139] and Satan (*al-Šayṭān*)[140] are mentioned, etc.; (iii) the fact that some particular themes treated by Avicenna are Islamic tenets: God's unicity and the fact that His unity is not undermined by the multiplicity of His attributes (I, 6–7; VIII, 5; VIII, 7); God's omniscience (VIII, 6) and providence (IX, 6);[141] the afterlife of human souls (IX, 7) and prophecy (X, 1–3);[142] (iv) the fact that some of the opinions that Avicenna expounds and criticizes are Islamic theological doctrines.[143]

Avicenna has a clear awareness of the distinction of method and content between philosophy and revealed theology.[144] In comparison with the philosophical authors and works which Avicenna quotes, what we can call, broadly speaking, his theological "sources"—in the sense of notions, authors and works he refers to—are complementary and subsidiary. It must be stressed that Avicenna's aim in points

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[137] I, 1, p. 5, 6 [p. 3, 42–43]; VIII, title, p. 325, 2 [p. 376, 3]; VIII, 4, p. 347, 11 [p. 402, 50]; VIII, 5, p. 349, 10 [p. 405, 5]; IX, 1, p. 373, 3 [p. 434, 3].

[138] I, 3, p. 19, 6 [p. 21, 84]; I, 4, p. 27, 16–17 [p. 31, 87]; IX, 2, p. 391, 12 [p. 461, 26]; X, 1, p. 435, 7–8 [p. 522, 9–11]. Mentions of angels are particularly frequent in Avicenna's treatment of prophecy: X, 1, p. 435, 15–17 [p. 523, 25–28]; X, 2, p. 442, 3 [p. 533, 11], p. 442, 13 [p. 533, 28]; X, 3, p. 444, 18 [p. 538, 1], p. 446, 1 [p. 540, 35]. The identification of the angels with the heavenly intelligences/souls might aim at providing a philosophical explanation of the role that, according to the *Qur'ān*, angels have in prophecy. Other mentions of angels in *Nafs* IV, 2, p. 178, 14–17 [II, pp. 28, 83–29, 91].

[139] X, 1, p. 435, 4 [p. 522, 3]; X, 1, p. 438, 9 [p. 526, 99].

[140] X, 4, p. 450, 15 [om.].

[141] I, 3, p. 18, 7 [p. 20, 61]; V, 1, p. 205, 2 [p. 237, 26, 27]; VI, 5, p. 289, 11 (see Appendix A); IX, 3, p. 393, 16; p. 398, 9, 10, 11, 12 [p. 464, 94, p. 471, 27, 29, 30, 31]; IX, 6, p. 414, 16, 17, p. 415, 3, p. 415, 7 [p. 495, 31, 34, 42, p. 496, 50]; IX, 7, p. 429, 11 [p. 516, 89]; X, 1, p. 439, 3 (twice), 4 (twice) [p. 527, 22, p. 528, 23, 24]; X, 2, p. 442, 2 [p. 533, 9].

[142] This correspondence of themes entails that OntologyC/Theology in the *Ilāhiyyāt* has the same structure of a theological treatise (see Chapter 5, §4.4). The topics that Avicenna discusses in OntologyC/theology are, to a large extent, the same taken into account by al-Fārābī in the *Mabādi'* (see Chapter 5, §6.5).

[143] I, 5, pp. 32, 6–34, 9 [pp. 36, 84–39, 37]; I, 5, p. 34, 9–14 [pp. 39, 39–40, 45]; I, 5, p. 36, 6–19 [pp. 41, 83–42, 1]; IV, 2, pp. 172, 13–173, 12 [pp. 196, 34–198, 57]; IX, 1, p. 376, 11–15 [p. 439, 3–10]; IX, 1, pp. 379, 13–381, 8 [p. 443, 89–446, 43]. See Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7.

[144] In IX, 7, p. 423, 4–10 [pp. 506, 92–507, 1], for example, he contrasts the "return" (*ma'ād*) concerning the body at the moment of the resurrection, transmitted by the religious law (*al-šar'*; *al-šarī'a*), whose existence can be proved only with the method of this latter (*ṭarīq al-šarī'a*) and the assent granted to the prophetic speech (*ḫabar al-nubuwwa*), with the return concerning the soul, argued for by metaphysicians with a demonstrative method (see Chapter 6, §1.2).

(i)–(iv) is simply to show that metaphysics can serve the purposes not only of philosophers, but also of Muslim believers/theologians, and that its content can be rephrased according to religious/theological categories, *not* to adjust the doctrine or the method of this discipline to the dogmas of a religious creed or the requirements of the theological discourse.[145]

Conclusion

The following diagram summarizes what the present chapter has shown about Avicenna's use of non-Aristotelian sources, together with the evidence regarding Avicenna's use of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* gathered in Chapters 8–10. The upper part of the diagram shows the sources of Avicenna's conception of the "form" of the metaphysics, namely Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics* and *Metaph.* Γ and Ε, Alexander of Aphrodisias' works on the *Metaphysics*, and al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ* and *Iḥṣā'* (the first two having exerted their influence both directly and through al-Fārābī). The lower part of it, on the other hand, displays the sources of the "content" of the *Ilāhiyyāt*: first and foremost Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, but also, for OntologyC/Theology, a cluster of other works (Alexander's *Fī Mabādi' al-kull*; Themistius' paraphrase of Λ; the *Theologia Aristotelis* and the *Liber de Causis*; al-Fārābī's *Mabādi'*) also mutually interrelated; the peculiar relation of the *Ilāhiyyāt* with Islamic theology, described in §5, is marked by an arrow going in both directions.

[145] In the passage quoted in the previous footnote, Avicenna remarkably contends that prophecy has "confirmed" (*ṣaddaqat*) the "return" of the soul taken into account by philosophers. Marmura [1962], p. 312a, poignantly remarks that in Avicenna's attempts "at reconciling the scriptural with the philosophical . . . it is scripture that has to accomodate itself to philosophy and not the other way round".

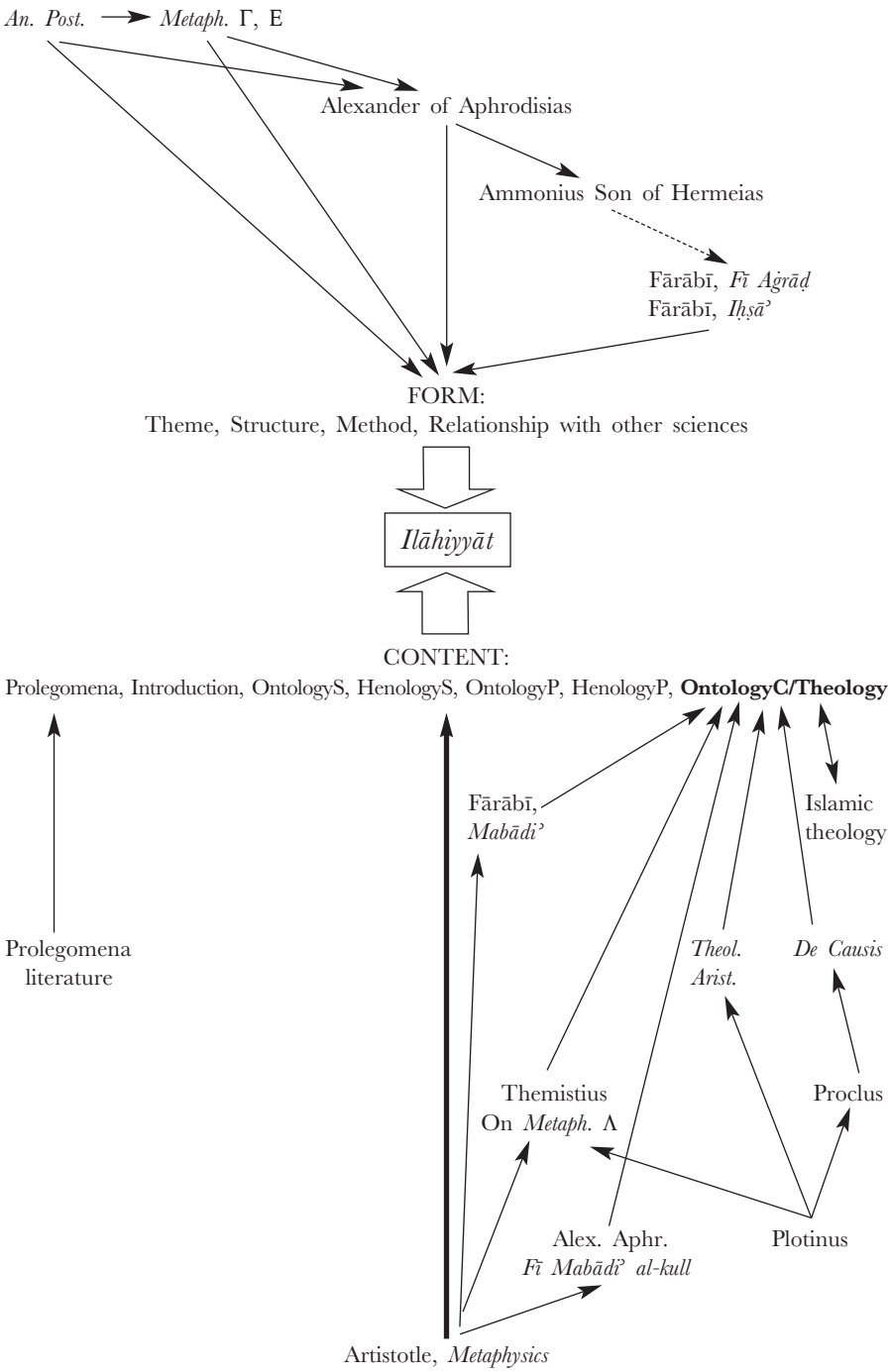


Diagram A: *Conspectus fontium* of the *Ilāhiyyāt*

CONCLUSION

Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* is a fundamental witness of the Arabic tradition of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, from many points of view. In a historical perspective (Part I), it provides essential information, first of all, on the scope and extent of the Arabic translations of the *Metaphysics* (Chapter 1). In particular, it attests that one of the most important of these translations (the one by Isḥāq Ibn-Ḥunayn) probably encompassed also books B and Δ; contains the only quotations known so far of the Arabic version of book M (possibly the one by Usṭāṯ) and of book N (possibly the one by Naẓīf); and documents that the extant Arabic translation of book A (by Naẓīf) was not the only version of this book circulating in Arabic in Avicenna's times.

The part of the *Ilāhiyyāt* dealing with philosophical theology (treatises VIII–X, 3), moreover, conserves the traces of the originary way in which Arab philosophers approached the *Metaphysics*: the idea of connecting the first book of this work in the Arabic tradition (second in the Greek numeration, α) with the eleventh (twelfth in the Greek numeration, Λ), skipping the intermediate books and conveying an image of metaphysics as a discipline that is constitutively theological (Chapter 2). This approach is primeval not only with regard to the history of Arabic philosophy, in so far as it is typical of the initiator of *falsafa*, al-Kindī (§7); but also with regard to Avicenna's philosophical development, since it reflects the way he got first acquainted with the *Metaphysics* during his training as a student of philosophy (§§1–6). Later, due to al-Fārābī's *Fī Aġrāḍ*, Avicenna realized that the textual scope of the *Metaphysics* was wider than books α and Λ, and its doctrinal scope was not restricted to philosophical theology; nonetheless, he maintained his original "Kindian" theological perspective on the *Metaphysics*, even though he enlarged it by means of an extensive "Farabian" ontological account, somehow serving as an introduction to it.

The *Fī Aġrāḍ* helped Avicenna to become aware of the exact proportions (material and theoretical) of the whole *Metaphysics*, by being connected with the tradition of the Greek commentators (Chapter 3): al-Fārābī's treatise depends not only on Alexander of Aphrodisias' and Themistius' commentaries on Λ—whose scope of investigation

is limited to philosophical theology—but also, either directly or indirectly, on a work by Ammonius Son of Hermeias, lost in Greek but attested in Arabic, containing a broader introductory overview of the *Metaphysics*.

In a more theoretical perspective (Parts II–III), Avicenna's reworking of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* presents two radical aspects of innovation with regard to Aristotle's work. Avicenna changes, first, the "form", i.e. the scientific profile, of the *Metaphysics* and of metaphysics as the discipline expounded in the *Metaphysics*; accordingly, he modifies also its "content", namely the disposition and doctrinal purport of the single books. As to the changes regarding the "form" (Part II), they affect four main areas: the metaphysics' theme, its structure, its method, and its relationship with the other sciences. As to the theme of metaphysics (Chapter 4), Avicenna shows that metaphysics corresponds, in different respects, to all three main characterizations of this discipline provided by Aristotle in the *Metaphysics*: it is a study of the First Causes and God, since the First Causes and God, among the "things searched" by metaphysics, are its "goal"; but it is also a study of "existent", since "existent *qua* existent" is its subject-matter; finally, it is a study of immaterial and motionless things, in so far as both the First Causes and God, on the one hand, and "existent *qua* existent", on the other, are realities of this kind. In this way, Avicenna's stand-point in the *Ilāhiyyāt* is the first coherent and systematic explanation of Aristotle's cryptic and apparently inconsistent views of the theme of metaphysics.

In Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt*, metaphysics receives a new, clear and coherent structure (Chapter 5), markedly different from the uncertain sequence of books of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. After the Prolegomena (I, 1–4)—dealing with the preliminary epistemological issues (subject-matter, goal, utility, rank, name and division of metaphysics)—and the Introduction (I, 5–8)—taking into account the gnoseological starting-points of metaphysics ("existent *qua* existent" and the other primary concepts; the fundamental division of "existent" in "Necessary Existent in Itself", namely God, and "possible existent in itself", namely all things other than God; the axioms)—and before the Appendix on practical philosophy (X, 4–5), the core of metaphysics (II–X, 3) is the result of two vertical axes (given by the study of "existent *qua* existent" and the study of "one *qua* one", called here, respectively, Ontology and Henology), which intersect with three horizonatal lines (species, properties, causes). Ontology is the first

and main axis, since it concerns the subject-matter of metaphysics. It displays a three-fold distinction in species, properties and causes of "existent", according to which metaphysics rests primarily on a sequence of three parts (OntologyS, OntologyP and OntologyC). Since the first cause of "existent" is God, OntologyC is also a Theology (OntologyC/Theology). Henology is a complementary axis of metaphysics, since it concerns the most important "property" of the subject-matter of this discipline, i.e. "one" (a primary concept like "existent"), taken on its own, and the opposite of "one", i.e. "many". It encompasses a treatment of the species of "one" and "many" (HenologyS), and an analysis of their properties (HenologyP). Even though Avicenna does not mention any treatment of the causes of "one" and "many", his investigation of God's oneness (i.e. unity and unicity) in OntologyC/Theology can be taken to represent an "ideal" HenologyC. In the actual structure of metaphysics, these two axes coexist and partially overlap: OntologyS is intermingled with HenologyS; OntologyP and HenologyP, on the other hand, are distinct sections, consecutive to each other; HenologyC merges completely with OntologyC/Theology. Among these parts, OntologyC/Theology is the most important: in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, Avicenna either mentions it as first, when he outlines preliminarly the structure of metaphysics, or portrays it as the "seal" of this discipline, when he concretely implements its structure. The comparison of the *Ilāhiyyāt* with the other major works by Avicenna on metaphysics, shows both similarities (the same emphasis on Ontology and, within Ontology, on OntologyC/Theology), and differences (in no other work Henology is so extensively displayed as in the *Ilāhiyyāt*).

In comparison with Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, the method of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is more apodictic and, accordingly, less dialectical (Chapter 6). Avicenna, on the one hand, enhances the demonstrative procedures present in the *Metaphysics*: after clarifying the status and limits of metaphysics as an apodictic science, he reworks the content of this work in syllogistic form, and pays the required attention to the degree of truth and certainty of the propositions serving as premises in demonstration; furthermore, he complements the apodictic method with "analytical" procedures, like proofs by division, terminological distinctions and classifications. On the other hand, he endeavours to lessen the role and visibility of the dialectical procedures adopted by Aristotle (scrutiny of other thinkers' opinions and discussion of aporias): he relegates the doxographies of books A, M and N in a marginal

and subordinate position within the *Ilāhiyyāt*, replacing them with a continuous refutation of views contrary to his own, taken one at a time, whose aim is to corroborate the doctrines he proposes; likewise, he quotes a few of the aporias of book B in scattered places of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, always connecting them with their solution, in accordance with his overall tendency to raising difficulties and facing objections in order to solve them.

The interrelation among the sciences, according to Avicenna, is not simply a matter of interconnection; it rests ultimately on the dependence of all the other disciplines upon metaphysics (Chapter 7). Metaphysics is the discipline that ascertains the principles of the other sciences: these principles are not only the logical laws common to all the sciences (the axioms), and the universal concepts that all the sciences use withouth discussing them, but also the principles that are proper to each one of the sciences and regard their specific subject-matters, i.e. their hypotheses. In so far as it is the science of "existent qua existent" as subject-matter, and in so far as it provides a sort of epistemological "self-certification" in the Introduction (I, 5–8), metaphysics is entitled to prove the existence and to elucidate the essence of the subject-matters of the other sciences. This applies primarily to logic and the two other branches of theoretical philosophy, namely natural philosophy and mathematics. With regard to logic, metaphysics provides the elucidation of the existence of the universals (its subject-matter) and the categories (the first intelligible notions upon which secondary intelligible notions like "universal" depend): either the "place" of their existence (in the mind, rather than in external reality, in the case of universals; in the external reality, rather than in the mind, in the case of the category of relation), or the mode of their existence (accidental existence, rather than substantial existence, in the case of the nine categories of accidents, with particular regard to quantity and quality), or their existence *tout court* (as in the case of immaterial substance, and the two constituents of material substance, i.e. matter and form). With regard to natural philosophy, metaphysics assesses the mode of existence of the two parts of its subject-matter, i.e. the form and the matter of physical substance, proving that form is the intermediate cause of the existence of matter, and matter cannot exist independently from form; it also ascertains the mode of existence of the main pair of "common" notions employed in natural philosophy, namely "cause" and "effect", clarifying how the cause's existence relates to the effect's

existence, and proving that the final cause does actually exist. With regard to mathematics, finally, metaphysics determines the quiddity and accidentality of discrete quantity, namely number (the subject-matter of arithmetic), and the accidental nature of both continuous quantities (geometrical extensions) and the qualities inhering in them (the geometrical shapes).

As to Avicenna's approach to the content of the *Metaphysics*, described in Part III, noteworthy (Chapter 8) is his use of a wide range of Arabic translations of Aristotle's work (primarily those of Usṭāṯ and Isḥāq Ibn-Ḥunayn, but even others) and his different ways of quoting the *Metaphysics*: either nominally, or by means of more opaque expressions, or hiddenly. Whereas the adoption of different versions of Aristotle's text reveals what we can call a "philological" attitude towards the *Metaphysics*, the different manners of quoting it convey distinct doctrinal attitudes: whilst the nominal ("explicit determinate") and hidden ("implicit") references are used by Avicenna to express agreement towards Aristotle, the more opaque ones ("explicit indeterminate") are often connected with a critical tone. Considered collectively, the quotations of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* show both an extensive use of this work and a radical recasting of its content. Avicenna quotes, in different ways, all the books of the *Metaphysics* (apart, perhaps, from K), but according to an order that is strikingly different from their original disposition in Aristotle's work. Thus, book A is quoted by Avicenna not at the beginning of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, but at the end of HenologyP. Chapters 1–2 of book α are transferred even "further", namely to OntologyC/Theology, in conjunction with chapters 6–10 of book Λ. Avicenna refers to some of the aporias of book B in distinct places of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Introduction, OntologyP, OntologyC/Theology). The fate of book Γ is different: it is neither "postponed", nor "scattered"; on the contrary, it is placed in the forefront of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The quotations of Γ occur mainly in the Prolegomena and the Introduction, and are primary not only in the topography of Avicenna's work, but also with regard to its profile. Avicenna employs (sometimes with critical remarks) several terminological distinctions deriving from book Δ as linguistic preliminaries to the treatment of the various issues he takes into account in all the parts of the *Ilāhiyyāt* preceding OntologyC/Theology (Prolegomena, Introduction, OntologyS-HenologyS, OntologyP and HenologyP). Chapter 1 of book E inspires, together with book Γ in its entirety, some themes of the Prolegomena: due to the "dispersive"

use of Δ (analogous to the one of B), E, 1 results directly linked to Γ, and, together with this latter, it orientates Avicenna's scientific reform of metaphysics; chapters E, 2–4, on the contrary, lay in the background of some minor points of the Introduction and OntologyS. The doctrine of book Z is used partly in the treatment of substance in OntologyS, partly in the treatment of the universals in OntologyP, partly in the treatment of material and formal causes, still in OntologyP. A comprehensive summary of book Θ is provided by Avicenna in the analysis of potentiality and actuality within OntologyP. Book I is the main source of HenologyP. Chapters 6–10 of book Λ are quoted, as the continuation of α, 1–2, within OntologyC/Theology. Books M and N, finally, are quoted in HenologyP, together with book A, thus being somehow placed "before" book Λ, which is referred to in OntologyC/Theology.

The quotations of book Γ of the *Metaphysics* have been studied separatedly (Chapter 9), since they underscore the fundamental role played by this book in the overall organization of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. They exhibit three peculiar features: they concentrate in the first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt*; are the first quotations of texts, rather than doctrines, of the *Metaphysics*; and refer to book Γ in its entirety. Due to these quotations, the first treatise of the *Ilāhiyyāt* mirrors the sequence of the themes of Γ, albeit not being its replica: like Γ, it starts with a discussion of "existent *qua* existent" as the subject-matter of metaphysics (I, 1–2), and ends with a treatment of the axioms (I, 8). Moreover, on account of what we can call the "retrocession" of books A and α, and the "dispersion" of book B, in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Γ is quoted before the first three books of the *Metaphysics*; the same holds true for the books of the *Metaphysics* following Γ. The quotations of Γ, finally, regard all the salient doctrinal points of this book, and range on its entire scope, with the exception of the parts of Γ that Avicenna does not quote for an avowed intent of succintness. The extensive, almost exhaustive, reproducton of a book of the *Metaphysics* is a case almost unique in the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

Chapter 10 focuses on the quotations of book B, since they best exemplify Avicenna's strategy of reducing the extent and impact of the aporetic (and, more in general, dialectical) procedures that the *Metaphysics* displays. First, Avicenna does not quote all the aporias that Aristotle takes into account in this book, but only a few of them. Second, he quotes only some parts of the selected aporias. Third, he never presents the aporias he quotes as unsettled problems, as in

Aristotle, but either provides what he regards as the true doctrine concerning the issues at stake, or portrays the aporias neutrally, as useful devices to elucidate further distinctions. The solution of the aporias provided by Avicenna is either Aristotle's own solution (whenever Aristotle resumes and solves the *aporiai* in the following books of the *Metaphysics*), or a solution supplied along Aristotelian lines (whenever Aristotle does not take a clear stand on the problem). Fourth, he does not quote the *aporiai* in a single section of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, but in different treatises of this work; thus, no textual unit of the *Ilāhiyyāt* represents a collection of *aporiai* analogous to book B, having its same preliminary and propaedeutic function.

The non-Aristotelian works quoted in the *Ilāhiyyāt* are conclusively taken into account in Chapter 11. Avicenna's quotations of these works concentrate in OntologyC/Theology. Within the Aristotelian tradition, he relies primarily on Alexander of Aphrodisias' and Themistius' commentaries/reworkings of *Metaphysics* Λ. Avicenna's attitude towards the Platonic tradition is marked by the criticism of Plato (on account of the rebuttal of his philosophy operated by Aristotle in the *Metaphysics*) and Porphyry, and the more positive reception of the Arabic reworkings of Plotinus' *Enneads* and Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica* i.e. the *Theologia Aristotelis* and the *Liber de Causis* respectively, both ascribed to Aristotle in the Arabic philosophical *milieu*. Among Arab philosophers, a place of eminence is reserved only to al-Fārābī: al-Kindī's "theologizing" approach to the *Metaphysics* is substantially preserved, but undergoes a profound revision and enlargement, whereas some particular doctrines of him and his followers (al-ʿĀmirī) are criticized; the intransigent Platonism of Abū-Bakr al-Rāzī is strongly adversed; the occasional Platonism of the Aristotelians of Baġdād is brought to light and rejected. In the examples, terminology, themes and opinions that Avicenna proposes in OntologyC/Theology is visible an attempt to show the affinity of metaphysics with Islamic religion.

In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna reworks the content of the *Metaphysics* by arranging the books of this work in three main groups: books Γ and E, 1 provide the epistemological preliminaries (Prolegomena and Introduction); books Z–H, Θ and I represent the ontological-henological core (OntologyS-P and HenologyS-P), in which book B is employed to counter difficulties and objections, book Δ is the source of the semantic propaedeutic distinctions, and books A and M-N offer doxographical digressions; chapters α, 2 and Λ, 6–10, finally,

constitute the framework of the theological final section (OntologyC/Theology), serving as a conclusion and a goal, which Avicenna substantially enlarges. Whereas in the *Metaphysics* the treatment of God is rather brief, being limited to chapters 6–10 of Λ, in the *Ilāhiyyāt* it is much longer, ranging over three treatises (VIII–X, 3). This is due not only to the transferral in OntologyC/Theology of the content of some other book of the *Metaphysics* (like α, 2), but also to the presence in OntologyC/Theology, together with the *Metaphysics*, of the most important sources that, besides Aristotle's writing, lie in the background of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, namely the Greek commentaries on the *Metaphysics* and the Neoplatonic pseudo-Aristotelian metaphysical works. The concentration of all these sources in OntologyC/Theology provides additional evidence of the fundamental importance that Avicenna assignes to philosophical theology in the context of metaphysics. Philosophical theology results the fundamental part of metaphysics, according to Avicenna, in many respects: from an epistemological point of view, because it is the "goal" and "fruit" of metaphysics; from the perspective of structure, because it is the "seal" of this discipline, an element constantly present in all the Avicennian *summae*, and—occasionally—the object of special consideration in some of Avicenna's works (like the *Mabdaʾ*); finally, from the point of view of style, because it is the only part of the *Ilāhiyyāt* that contains explicit determinate, i.e. nominal, quotations of the *Metaphysics*; finally, in a diachronic perspective, because it is the first part of metaphysics that Avicenna knew during his philosophical education.

Avicenna draws his "reform" of the epistemological profile and, consequently, of the content of the *Metaphysics* from three main sources: the Aristotelian *corpus* (the *Posterior Analytics* and *Metaphysics* Γ and Ε, 1, above all), the Greek commentators of Aristotle (especially Alexander of Aphrodisias), and the Arab interpreters of Aristotle (*in primis* al-Fārābī). Avicenna finds in the *Posterior Analytics* the concept of "subject-matter" of a science, that he applies to metaphysics by proving that "existent *qua* existent" is its subject-matter; the fair "species"—"properties" of the subject-matter of a science, upon which he builds the structure of the *Ilāhiyyāt*; the idea of demonstration as the scientific procedure *par excellence*, central in his reworking of the method of metaphysics; and the notion of a subalternation between "pure" and "applied" sciences, which he enlarges to include also the case of metaphysics with regard to the particular disciplines, thus rendering metaphysics the primary science in the system of knowl-

edge. *Metaphysics* Γ and Ε, 1 offer to Avicenna the first tentative and incomplete application to metaphysics of the epistemological canons of the *Posterior Analytics*. In these two books, Aristotle portrays metaphysics as the science of "being *qua* being", and, at the same time, of immaterial and motionless realities; ascribes to metaphysics the investigation of the species, properties, and causes of "being", of the species and properties of "one", and of "multiplicity"; distinguishes the method of metaphysics, on the one hand, from that of dialectic and sophistic, on the other, and assigns to the metaphysician the task of analyzing the various acceptions of the mutivocal terms; finally, he hints at the epistemological limitations of the particular sciences, pointing at metaphysics as the discipline which is prior to natural philosophy and mathematics and superior to them. All these notions are the basic ingredients and fundamental epistemological parameters of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

The tradition of the commentators on Aristotle's works marks a substantial progress towards Avicenna's view of the *Metaphysics*. In Alexander of Aphrodisias, for example, Aristotle's tentative and provisional program of a "scientific" metaphysics is much more developed: the notions of "subject-matter" and "goal" of the metaphysics, for instance, surface in his commentary on the *Metaphysics*, together with the distinction between OntologyP and OntologyC/Theology; in this commentary, furthermore, Alexander emphasizes the apodictic nature of the method of metaphysics, relegating the books of the *Metaphysics* containing doxographies (Α, Μ–Ν) and discussions of aporias (Β) to a subordinate position. This trend towards a "scientification" of metaphysics continues and increases after Alexander: it cannot be coincidental that Avicenna enucleates his philosophical agenda about the scientific reshaping of the metaphysics in a part of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (the Prolegomena, dealing—as we have seen—with issues like the subject-matter, goal, division and rank of this discipline) which clearly derives from the exegetical tradition of Late Antiquity.

The third step in the historical route connecting the *Metaphysics* with the *Ilāhiyyāt* is the Arab Aristotelian tradition, whose main exponent before Avicenna is al-Fārābī. This latter, on the one hand, continues (possibly through Ammonius) the exegetical tradition of Alexander of Aphrodisias and later interpreters of Aristotle; on the other hand, he presents *in abstracto* in the *Fī Aġrāḍ* all the main elements of the epistemological profile of metaphysics that Avicenna adapts concretely to the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The sketch of

the science of metaphysics that al-Fārābī outlines in the few pages of the *Fī Aġrāḍ* is instantiated in the *Ilāhiyyāt* with some substantial adjustments and changes (the same difference that separates a blueprint from its realization). These refinements, regarding above all the subject-matter and the structure of metaphysics, show that Avicenna took into consideration Aristotle's *Posterior Analytics* and *Metaphysics* independently from al-Fārābī. The *Fī Aġrāḍ* functions as a sort of "prism", towards which the many lines of the previous tradition of the *Metaphysics* converge, in which these trends are synthesized into an unitarian project, and from which the guidelines of the concrete Avicennian reworking of the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* emanate. Al-Fārābī's metaphysical works "absorb" and "filters", so-to-say, also motives of Neoplatonic metaphysics: they transmit to Avicenna the Neoplatonic tenets that "one" and unity are among the main concerns of the metaphysician; that the *elementatio* is the proper method not only of mathematics, but also of metaphysics; that metaphysics is the supreme discipline in the hierarchy of sciences.

In sum: In the history of the transmission, interpretation and elaboration of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, Avicenna deserves a place of eminence: he has been the first to fully clarify the epistemological status of the discipline expounded in this work (its "form"), and, at the same time, to remould the doctrine of this writing (its "content") according to the established scientific profile. In both respects, he provides a prime example of "Peripatetic" interpretation of the *Metaphysics*, i.e. an interpretation of this work that takes into account, together with the original text, also the other writings of the Aristotelian *corpus*, the subsequent Aristotelian tradition (both Greek and Arabic), cognate types of metaphysical speculation (the Neoplatonic pseudo-Aristotelian works on metaphysics) and the cultural tendencies of his own environment (Islamic theology). Seen from all these perspectives, Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* represents an unparalleled peak in the history of the reception of the *Metaphysics*. If, in the Arab world, al-Fārābī is rightly called the "second Teacher", i.e. the second Aristotle, Avicenna deserves, perhaps, the appellative of "second Andronicus": on account of his profound reworking of the epistemology and of the doctrine of the *Metaphysics*—as this book has tried to document—it is not far-fetched to compare the *Ilāhiyyāt* with Andronicus of Rhodes' editorial work, and to regard this Avicennian writing as a sort of second "edition" of the *Metaphysics*, or second "beginning" of the Western metaphysical speculation.

APPENDICES

APPENDIX A

TOWARDS A CRITICAL EDITION OF THE *ILĀHIYYĀT*: LIST OF CORRECTIONS OF THE CAIRO PRINTED TEXT

A fully critical edition of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is no doubt a major desideratum in Avicennian studies. According to Mahdavī's bibliography of Avicenna's works, the *Ilāhiyyāt* is preserved, entirely or partially, alone or together with other parts of the *Šifāʾ*, in more than seventy manuscripts throughout the world.[1] Unfortunately, our actual knowledge of the *Ilāhiyyāt* rests on a very small portion of this massive manuscript tradition.

The available printed versions of the *Ilāhiyyāt* are three, but only one of them approaches the level of a critical edition. The first printed version of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is the lithograph published in Tehrān in 1885 (= Ṭ), encompassing, besides the *Ilāhiyyāt*, also the second part of the *Šifāʾ*, on natural philosophy.[2] Ṭ is very likely the reproduction of a manuscript, whose identity is still to be ascertained; like a manuscript, it reports interlinear and marginal corrections (Ṭcorr.).[3] Useful as textual witnesses are also the interlinear or marginal explanatory glosses (= Ṭgl.), in which the text under discussion is quoted as lemma.

The still standard "edition" of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, published in Cairo in 1960 (= c), is based on five manuscripts.[4] The selection of manuscripts

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[1] Mahdavī [1954], pp. 170, 172. Mahdavī's inventory is not complete.

[2] Avicenna [1885], vol. I, pp. 266–567.

[3] These corrections are marked by the letters (for: *ṣaḥḥa*) and, apparently, ل (?). They have to be kept distinct from the parts of the text of Ṭ that, as in a manuscript, are written above the line or in the margins (= Ṭs.l.; Ṭmg.).

[4] Avicenna [1960]. The manuscripts mentioned in the introduction (pp. [31]–[33]) are the following: MS Cairo, Azhar, 331 Khuṣūṣiyya, 2415 Beḥīt (probably VII /XIII c.) = B; MS Cairo, Dār al-Kutub 144 Ḥikma (684 H./1285AD) = Ǧ; MS Cairo, Dār al-Kutub 894 Falsafa = D; MS Cairo, Dār al-Kutub 826 Falsafa (1084 H./1673AD) = Ṣ; MS London, British Museum 7500 (probably XI/XVII c.) = M. A further siglum (H) appears occasionally in the apparatus (see, for instance, ad p. 312, 8; p. 339, 18; p. 355, 3; p. 355, 13; p. 364, 2; p. 364, 9; p. 384, 18). A sixth manuscript (MS Cairo, Dār al-Kutub 262 Ḥikma) is mentioned in the introduction of Anawati's French translation of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (Anawati [1978], pp. 17, 19–21). It is not clear whether the siglum H refers to this manuscript or not. In what follows, informations concerning H in the apparatus of c are disregarded.

is limited not only in number, but also in geographical provenience: four out of five are preserved in Cairo libraries. The most ancient manuscripts of this group date back to the XIII century. Together with these manuscripts, the Cairo editors have taken also Ṭ into account. The edition displays three further major defects. First, it lacks of a *stemma codicum* and a description of the editorial method: the editors do not consistently prefer a particular witness, or a group of them, over the others.[5] Second, the inspection of the witnesses is not flawless: some readings of Ṭ, for example, are omitted, others are wrongly recorded in the critical apparatus.[6] We cannot exclude that similar defects affect also the exam of the manuscripts. Third, the text of the *Ilāhiyyāt* provided in c is sometimes unreliable also with regard to vocalization and punctuation. The unsatisfactory character of the edition is underscored by one of the editors themselves, G. C. Anawati, who in the first volume of his French translation of the *Ilāhiyyāt* describes this edition as "semi-critical"[7] and provides a provisional list of corrections of the Arabic text of the first part of the work (treatises I–V).[8] The Cairo edition has served as basis not only to Anawati's French translation, but also to Lizzini's Italian translation and Marmura's English translation of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[9]

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[5] Sometimes Ṭ seems to be the preferred witness (see II, 2, p. 66, 8 in the table below).

[6] Some examples of the misuse of Ṭ by the Cairo editors are recorded in the footnotes of the table below. For other inaccuracies, see, for instance, p. 130, app. ad lin. 14: adde *wāḥidatun* Ṭ; p. 157, app. ad lin. 8: contrarily to the apparatus, Ṭ has the same reading as M; p. 181, app. ad lin. 1: *kawhuhū* is attested also by an interlinear variant in Ṭ; p. 189, app. ad lin. 2: Ṭ has the same reading as B Ğ D and M; p. 199, 2: *wa-annahā: aw annahā* Ṭ; p. 228, 5: Ṭ has the edited reading; p. 240, 14.

[7] Anawati [1978], p. 17.

[8] Anawati [1978], pp. 22–24.

[9] In Lizzini [2002], the Arabic text of c faces the Italian translation; in the end notes, Lizzini proposes several corrections of c on account of a systematic comparison of this latter with the printed version of the *Ilāhiyyāt* by Āmulī (see below). The Arabic text in Marmura [2005] is "essentially that of the 1960 Cairo edition" (p. xxv): Marmura introduces in the Arabic text facing his English translation, besides Anawati's corrections, some variants taken from the critical apparatus of c (in the notes to the Arabic text, MS Ğ is named B') and some emendations of his own. About Marmura's suggestions, it can be noticed cursorily: at p. 11, nn. 1–2, the vocalization of the suggested readings does not correspond to the English translation; the suggested reading at p. 24, n. 1, is supported only by B, against P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī Ğ D Ṣ M; the suggested reading at p. 68, n. 1, is supported only by D, against P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ğ Ṣ M; at p. 59, n. 1, the proposed correction is the same as the edited reading in c; at p. 61, n. 2, the emendation

The printed version of the *Ilāhiyyāt* published in Qum in 1997/8 by Ḥasanzādah al-Āmulī (= Āmulī) is uncritical.[10] It does not contain a critical apparatus, and variants are recorded only occasionally in the footnotes.[11] In the introduction, the curator states that he has established the text according to "a number of manuscripts . . . preserved in our private library" (p. 5). None of these manuscripts, however, is described and their number is not specified. They are probably five, as it results from some annotations,[12] and correspond in all likelihood to the five manuscripts whose first and last pages are photomecanically reproduced at the end of the book. One of these manuscripts appears to have been selected as the basis of the edition.[13] On account of the many cases of agreement between Āmulī and c against all the other witnesses, we can surmise that Āmulī relies on c as well. Āmulī's edition, therefore, is the result of a conflation between c and an unspecified manuscript tradition.

The present appendix aims at providing a systematic list of corrections of c, as a preliminary step towards a future, properly critical, edition of the *Ilāhiyyāt*. The list of corrections provided here is the result of the comparison of c with: (i) some ancient manuscripts not taken into account in it; (ii) the other two printed versions of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, namely Ṭ (carefully inspected) and Āmulī; (iii) the Latin Medieval translation of this work (= lat); (iv) Avicenna's *Naǧāt*. Occasionally have been also consulted: the Arabic translation of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* (= met), often quoted in the *Ilāhiyyāt*;[14] Avicenna's *Mabdaʾ*; and the lemmata and paraphrases in Ṣadr al-Dīn (Mullā Ṣadrā) al-Šīrāzī's commentary on the *Ilāhiyyāt* (= Šīrāzī lemma, Šīrāzī par.).[15] Anawati's list of corrections (= Anawati), properly revised, is

belongs to Anawati's list; at p. 62, n. 2, and p. 64, n. 1, the corrections appear to be *lectiones faciliores*.

[10] Avicenna [1997/8].

[11] See, for example, p. 76, n. 1; p. 79, n. 1; p. 153, 18; p. 190, n. 1; p. 204, n. 1; p. 233, 8; p. 238, 1; p. 272, n. 1; p. 273, n. 1; p. 278, n. 2; p. 290, n. 1; p. 297, n. 1; p. 305, n. 1; p. 376, n. 1; p. 383, n. 1; p. 397, nn. 2–3.

[12] See pp. 230–231, n. 6; p. 278, n. 2.

[13] See p. 397, n. 2.

[14] An example of the importance of consulting the Arabic translation of Aristotle's *Metaphysics* in order to reconstruct the text of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is provided in Bertolacci [2003], pp. 35–37.

[15] The commentary on *Ilāhiyyāt* I–VI is available in *Al-Taʿlīqāt li-Ṣadr al-Mutālihīna Muḥammad Ibn Ibrāhīm Ṣadr al-Dīn al-Šīrāzī ʿalā l-Šifāʾ*, in Avicenna [1885], vol. II, pp. 2–264.

included in the present one.[16] My forthcoming Italian translation of the *Ilāhiyyāt* is based on the present revision.[17]

(**i**) **Manuscripts**. The manuscripts used for the comparison are: MS Oxford, Bodleian 435, Pococke 125, dated 571H./1175AD (= P125); MS Oxford, Bodleian 482, Pococke 117, dated 601H./1204 (= P117);[18] MS Oxford, Bodleian 477, Pococke 110, same date (= P110); MS Leiden, Universiteitsbibliotheek 1444, Golius 4, of uncertain date (= L). They have been inspected through microfilm reproductions. P117 and P110 are written by the same hand, and the latter is somehow the continuation of the former: P117 covers treatises I–IV of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, P110 treatises V–VIII, 6. Unlike P117/P110, both P125 and L contain the *Ilāhiyyāt* in its entirety. According to the available data, P125 and P117/P110 are about a century older than the oldest manuscripts employed in c.

(**ii**) **Printed Versions**. On account of the aforementioned features, both Ṭ and Āmulī are regarded here as providing an evidence equal to that of a manuscript.[19]

(**iii**) **Latin Translation**. The Latin Medieval translation of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, excellently edited by S. Van Riet under the title of *Liber de philosophia prima sive Scientia Divina* (= lat.), was accomplished around the middle of the XII century.[20] It is therefore only a few decades later than the most ancient known dated Arabic manuscript of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (509 H./1116 AD),[21] and represents an important, albeit indirect, witness of the text. A close inspection of the Arabic text allows some corrections of the edited text of the Latin translation, besides the ones listed by the editor herself in the *corrigenda and addenda*.[22]

(**iv**) **Naǧāt**. The theological section of the *Ilāhiyyāt* (VIII, 6–IX, 3) is verbatim identical in the *Naǧāt*. M. T. Dānišpazūh's critical edi-

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[16] I adopt readings different from the corrections proposed by Anawati at p. 32,12 (in fact: p. 32.1), p. 39, 14, p. 43, 16, p. 67, 3, p. 77, 3, p. 131, 14, p. 141, 16, p. 149, 9, p. 221, 14, p. 241, 4.

[17] See Bertolacci [forthcoming].

[18] In Rosenthal [1968], p. 542, the text of *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3, p. 17, 4–12 [pp. 18, 35–19, 47], is critically reconstructed on the basis of MSS. P125 and P117.

[19] I wish to thank Prof. J. Janssens for having kindly put at my disposal a photostatic reproduction of Ṭ.

[20] Avicenna Latinus [1977]; Avicenna Latinus [1980]; Avicenna Latinus [1983].

[21] MS Tehrān, Malik 1085.

[22] See below, III, 10, p. 152, 7–8; VII, 3, p. 317, 7. Inaccuracies of the edition of the Latin translation with regard to the Arabic original are very rare (see, for example, p. 229, 45, where the insertion of <a> does not seem justified since its correspective [*bi-alif*] is missing also in the Arabic MSS. B and D). For the *corrigenda and addenda*, see Avicenna Latinus [1983], pp. 6*–13*.

tion of the *Naǧāt* represents a useful aid for establishing the text of this section of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.[23]

Method. On account of its completeness and early date, MS. P125 has been adopted as the basis of the revision. The collation with P125 and the other witnesses has allowed two main kinds of improvements of the edited text, besides the elimination of evident misprints: the correction of material mistakes and the adoption of more plausible variants. In the former case, all witnesses taken into account (P125, P117/P110 L, Ṭ, Āmulī and lat), or the majority of them, agree against c, which reports no variant in the critical apparatus. In the latter case, the aforementioned witnesses converge on a variant taken into account, but discarded, by the editors of c. In many cases, however, the choice between different variants remains puzzling, since no clear "majority" of witnesses exists: only a reliable *stemma codicum* will allow future editors to take sensible decisions in these circumstances. For the time being, in cases of uncertainty, the edited text has been maintained.

The corrections are presented here in a table consisting of four columns. The first column on the left indicates the emended passage, according to its page and line in c. The second column on the left reports the edited reading and the witnesses supporting it. The first column on the right contains the proposed reading and its witnesses. The second column on the right records additional variants. Cases in which a variant has been preferred over others are marked by an asterisk (*). Corrections of obvious misprints are indicated by the sign (°): in this case, no witness supporting the proposed reading is mentioned. Improvements regarding syntax are marked by the sign (^). Changes of pronominal prefixes of verbs (*ya-/ta-/na-*) in the imperfect and related tenses, and of diathesis (active/passive), are frequently due to the interpreter's discretion in Arabic texts: in the majority of cases emendations of this kind are reported with no indication of witnesses.

Corrections of the Cairo edition of the *Ilāhiyyāt*

Sigla

P125 = MS Oxford, Bodleian 435, Pococke 125
P117 = MS Oxford, Bodleian 482, Pococke 117

[23] Avicenna [1985].

P110 = MS Oxford, Bodleian 477, Pococke 110
L = MS Leiden 1444, Golius 4

Ṭ = Tehrān lithograph
Ṭgl. = interlinear or marginal glosses in Ṭ
Ṭabbr. = abbreviated reading in Ṭ
Āmulī = Āmulī [1997/8]
Āmulī[1] = variants occasionally reported in Āmulī

Mabda' = Avicenna [1984]
Naǧāt = Avicenna [1985].
Naǧāt[1] = variants in Naǧāt

lat = Avicenna Latinus [1977], Avicenna Latinus [1980] (according to the *addenda and corrigenda* in Avicenna Latinus [1983], pp. 6*–14*)
Van Riet = apparatus and notes in lat

c = Cairo edition
B Ǧ D Ṣ M = mss. of c[24]
ed. = emendations by the editors of c
Anawati = corrections in Anawati [1978], pp. 22–24.

met = Aristotle's *Metaphysics*
Šīrāzī lemma = quotation of the text in Ṣadr al-Dīn (Mullā Ṣadrā) al-Šīrāzī's commentary
Šīrāzī par. = paraphrase of the text in Ṣadr al-Dīn (Mullā Ṣadrā) al-Šīrāzī's commentary

add. = addition
a.m. = different hand
cf. = see
corr. = correction
del. = erased
i.l. = below the line
lac. = lacuna
mg. = in the margin
? = apparently
secl. = to be eliminated
s.l. = above the line

[24] Besides H (see above, n. 4), two additional sigla occur in the Cairo edition: BḤ (= readings in the margins of B) and ṬĀ (= readings in the margins of Ṭ). All the informations regarding the mss. of c are taken or inferred from its critical apparatus (a negative one).

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
p. 1, 1–2	al-maqālatu . . . fuṣūlin		**om.** P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī lat
*I, 1, p. 3, 13	naṭlubu	نطلب P125; ustukmila P117; ustukmila del. et يطلب add.s.l.a.m. P117; نطلب L; tuṭlabu Ṭ; yaṭlubu lat (quaerit)	**yuṭlabu** Āmulī
*I, 1, p. 4, 16	musabbib Ṭ Āmulī B D Ṣ M		**sabab** P125 P117 L lat (causa) Ǧ
I, 1, p. 7, 9	lam yakun		**lam yumkin** P125 P117 L Ṭ[25] Āmulī lat (non debet)
I, 1, p. 8, 13	mašhūdun		**mašhūrun** Anawati
*I, 1, p. 9, 5	mawḍūʿatan	موضوعةً P117	**mawḍūʿahū** P125 L Ṭ[26] Āmulī lat (subiectum eius)
I, 2, p. 10, 13	fī[3]	om. Āmulī	**min** P125 P117 L Ṭ[27]
I, 2, p. 10, 16	yalḥaqu		**talḥaqu** Anawati
I, 2, p. 11, 14	fīhi		**fa-minhu** P125 P117 L Ṭ[28] Āmulī
I, 2, p. 11, 15	yuqālu[1]		**lahū** add. P125 117 L Ṭs.l.[29] Āmulī
*I, 2, p. 12, 4	mawǧūdan Ṭcorr.a.m. Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ		**om.** P125 P117 L Ṭ[30] lat M

[25] This reading is not reported in c.
[26] This reading is not reported in c.
[27] This reading is not reported in c.
[28] This reading is not reported in c.
[29] This reading is not reported in c.
[30] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*I, 2, p. 12, 5	wa-talzamuhū P117 L Ṭ Āmulī lat	wa-yalzamuhū l-šaklu P125	**wa-yalzamuhū**
I, 2, p. 12, 9	al-mawǧūdi		**al-wuǧūdi** P125 P117 L Ṭ[31] Āmulī lat (essendi)
I, 2, p. 12, 14	yaʿummuhumā		**yaʿummuhā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[32] Āmulī lat
I, 2, p. 13, 6	yaḫtaṣṣa		**taḫtaṣṣa**
I, 2, p. 13, 6	yakūna		**takūna**
I, 2, p. 13, 16	hāḏihi		**lahū** add. P117 125 L Ṭs.l.[33] Āmulī lat (ei)
*I, 2, p. 14, 13	baʿdahā P125 L Ṭ Āmulī	om. lat	**baʿdahū** P117
I, 2, p. 15, 1	al-aʿlā		**al-aʿammi** P125 P117 L Ṭ[34] Āmulī lat (communiori)
*I, 2, p. 15, 3	al-ǧuzʾiyyāti al-mawǧūdati B Ǧ D	al-ǧuzʾiyyāti al-mawǧūdi Ṭ;[35] ǧuzʾiyyāti al-mawǧūdati Āmulī; uniuscuiusque esse lat	**ǧuzʾiyyāti al-mawǧūdi** P125 P117 L Ṣ M
I, 2, p. 15, 6	ka-l-mabdaʾi	fa-ka-l-mabdaʾi Ṭ Āmulī	**wa-ka-l-mabdaʾi lahū** P125 P117 L lat (et est ei sicut principium)
I, 2, p. 15, 7	fa-naḫbaṭu		**fa-yaḫbaṭu**
I, 2, p. 15, 7	wa-nuqarriru		**wa-yuqarriru**

[31] This reading is not reported in c.
[32] This reading is not reported in c.
[33] This reading is not reported in c.
[34] This reading is not reported in c.
[35] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
I, 2, p. 15, 7	hāḏā l-ʿilmi		**baʿḍuhā** add. P117 P125 L Ṭ[36] Āmulī lat (quaedam)
I, 2, p. 16, 2	qad tūğadu		**qad yūğadu**
*I, 3, p. 18, 13	al-muštaraki B D		**al-muštarakati** P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ M
I, 3, p. 19, 7	yutawaṣṣala		**ilayhi** add. P125 P117 L Ṭs.l.[37] Āmulī
I, 3, p. 19, 18	waṣfan		**waḍʿan** Anawati
I, 3, p. 20, 15	li-ʿaynihā Āmulī		**bi-ʿaynihā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[38]
I, 3, p. 20, 16	nubayyina		**yubayyana**
I, 3, p. 20, 17	hāḏā		**om.** P125 P117 L Ṭ[39] Āmulī
*I, 3, p. 21, 2	(taḥṣīl) mabdaʾin lat (principium) B Ğ D Ṣ	(yuḥaṣṣilu) mubtadaʾan Āmulī	**mubtadaʾun** M; مبتدا P125 P117; مبتدء L; مبتداء Ṭ
I, 3, p. 21, 2	illā		**lā** Anawati
*I, 3, p. 21, 12	mā Ṭ Āmulī B D		**fīmā** P125 P117 L Ṭgl.[40] lat (de eo quod est) Bmg. Ğ Ṣ M
I, 3, p. 22, 13	yaʿuddu		**baʿda** Anawati
*I, 3, p. 22, 15	wa-idā	fa-iḏā P125 P117 L Āmulī M	**wa-iḏā** Ṭ Anawati B Ğ D Ṣ
*I, 3, p. 23, 13	kulli šayʾin lat (omni)		**šayʾin** P125 P117 L Ṭ[41] Āmulī

[36] This reading is not reported in c.
[37] This reading is not reported in c.
[38] This reading is not reported in c.
[39] This reading is not reported in c.
[40] This reading is not reported in c.
[41] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
°I, 3, p. 23, 15	al-yaqṣāni		**al-naqṣāni**
*I, 3, p. 23, 16	yaǧibu Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ		**yaǧūzu** P125 P117 L lat (potest concedi) M
*I, 4, p. 25, 5	ay B D		**fī** P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī lat Ǧ Ṣ M
I, 4, p. 25, 12	mufāriqin		**mufāriqun** Anawati
*I, 5, p. 29, 8	yaḫṭur Ṭ Āmulī lat (subintraverit)	بخطر P125 P117 L	**taḫṭur** Marmura [1984b] (cf. iḫṭārahā, p. 29, 10)
I, 5, p. 29, 12	nafsihā		**anfusihā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[42] Āmulī
I, 5, p. 30, 4	wa-l-šayʾi al-wāḥidi		**wa-l-šayʾi wa-l-wāḥidi** P125 P117 L Ṭ[43] Āmulī lat (et res et unum)
I, 5, p. 30, 5	yuqawwima		**yaqūla** P125 P117 L Ṭ[44] Āmulī lat (discurrere)
*I, 5, p. 31, 2	al-wuǧūdi Ṭ Āmulī		**al-mawǧūdi** P117 P125 L lat (entis)
*I, 5, p. 31, 13	yaʿummuhā D M		**yaʿummuhumā** P125 P117 Ṭ Āmulī lat (ita ut communicet utrisque) B Ǧ Ṣ
*I, 5, p. 32, 1	ā L		**ḥaqīqatun** add. P125 P117s.l. Ṭ[45] Āmulī lat (est certitudo)
I, 5, p. 32, 3	al-wuǧūdi		**al-mawǧūdi** P125 P117 L Ṭ[46] Āmulī lat (ens)

[42] This reading is not reported in c.
[43] This reading is not reported in c.
[44] This reading is not reported in c.
[45] This reading is not reported in c.
[46] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
I, 5, p. 32, 8	ااان		**an** Anawati
*I, 5, p. 33, 1	an Ṭ Āmulī D		**om.** P125 P117 L B Ğ Ṣ M
*I, 5, p. 34, 8	fī l-ḥaqīqati Āmulī		**bi-l-ḥaqīqati** P125 P117 L Ṭ[47] lat (re vera)
*I, 5, p. 36, 6	tafahhuminā Ğ D M		**tafhīminā** P117 P125 L Ṭ Āmulī lat ([Cum autem] nota fecerimus) B Ṣ
*I, 6, p. 38, 3	wa-lam P117 L Ṭ Āmulī		**lam** P125 lat (non)
*I, 6, p. 38, 8	wa-kullamā Āmulī Ğ D Ṣ	(ġayrihī) wa-kullamā . . . ġayrihī om. P125 L Ṭ lat B M	**wa-kullu mā** P117 Lmg.a.m.
I, 6, p. 38, 9	allaḏī		**wa-llaḏī** Anawati
*I, 6, p. 38, 15	wa-min P117 L Ṭ Āmulī		**fa-min** P125 lat
*I, 6, p. 38, 18	māhiyyatun Ṭ B Ğ D Ṣ	om. lat	**māhiyyatuhū** P125 P117 L Āmulī M
*I, 6, p. 39, 1	wāğiba l-māhiyyati	wāğiban bi-māhiyyatihī P117; wāğiban li-māhiyyatin Ṭ[48]	**wāğiban li-māhiyyatihī** P125 L Āmulī lat (necessarium sibi ipsi)
I, 6, p. 39, 14	buʿdun[1–2]		**baʿdu** Anawati
I, 6, p. 40, 4	al-wuğubi		**al-wuğūdi** Anawati
I, 6, p. 40, 6	an[2]		**bal** P125 P117 L Ṭ[49] Āmulī lat (nec)
*I, 6, p. 41, 2	ʿillatuhū Āmulī B D Ğ M		**ʿillatun** P117 P125 L Ṭ[50] lat (causa) Ṣ

[47] This reading is not reported in c.
[48] This reading is not reported in c.
[49] This reading is not reported in c.
[50] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*I, 6, p. 41, 10	aw[2] Ṭ B D Ǧ		**om.** P125 P117 L Āmulī lat Ṣ M
*I, 7, p. 43, 16	li-wuǧūdi l-šay'i bi-mā huwa d̲ālika l-wuǧūdu B Ǧ D M	li-ḥaqīqati l-šay'i bi-mā huwa d̲ālika l-wuǧūdu l-ḥaqīqiyyu P125; li-ḥaqīqati l-šay'i bi-mā huwa tilka l-ḥaqīqatu L; li-ḥaqīqati l-šay'i bi-mā huwa tilka l-ḥaqīqatu aw li-wuǧūdihī bi-mā huwa d̲ālika l-wuǧūdu Ṭ Āmulī Ṣ; li-ḥaqīqati wuǧūdi l-šay'i bi-mā huwa tilka l-ḥaqīqatu lat (ex certitudine esse rei inquantum est ipsa certitudo); li-wuǧūdin li-ḥaqīqati l-šay'i bi-mā huwa d̲ālika l-wuǧūdu Anawati	**li-ḥaqīqati l-šay'i bi-mā huwa d̲ālika l-ḥaqīqatu** P117
*I, 7, p. 44, 5	bi-infirādin Āmulī		**bi-infirādihī** P125 P117 L Ṭ[51] lat (per se solum; cf. p. 44, 4)
*I, 7, p. 44, 5–6	lā min . . . al-aʿrāḍi Ṭ Āmulī	add. mg. L	**om.** P125 P117 lat
I, 7, p. 46, 5	aradnāhū		**awradnāhū** P117 P125 L Ṭ[52] lat ([id] quod iam diximus)
I, 7, p. 46, 13	wuǧūduhū		**ṣifatan** P125 P117 L Ṭ[53] Āmulī lat (proprietatem)

[51] This reading is not reported in c.
[52] This reading is not reported in c.
[53] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*I, 7, p. 47, 6	bi-l-kulliyyati L corr.mg.a.m. Ṭ Āmulī	bi-l-kalimiyyati P117?	**bi-l-kalimati** P125 L Ṭ corr.s.l.[54] lat (in nomine)
°I, 7, p. 47, 19	الفزد		**al-fardu**
*I, 8, p. 48, 14	allaḏī yantahī ilayhi	allatī ilayhā yantahī P125	**allaḏī ilayhi yantahī** P117 L Ṭ[55] Āmulī
*I, 8, p. 49, 12	allatī B		**lā** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[56] Āmulī lat (nondum) D Ğ Ṣ M
*I, 8, p. 49, 16	fa-yakūnu Ṭ Āmulī	wa-kawnu P125; p. 49, 16–17 om. lat	**fa-kawnu** P117 L Van Riet
*I, 8, p. 52, 2	fa-qad Ṭ Āmulī Ğ		**qad** P125 P117 L B D Ṣ M
*I, 8, p. 52, 12	kullu šayʾin B Ğ D Ṣ		**kullu šayʾin kulla šayʾin** P117 P125 L Ṭ[57] Āmulī lat (unaquaeque res esset unaquaeque alia res) met 107b19–20 1008a23 M
*I, 8, p. 52, 17	al-insānu Āmulī	homo lat (sed cf. non-homo = bi-l-lā-insāni ibid.)	**bi-l-insāni** P125 P117 L Ṭ[58]
°I, 8, p. 53, 11	يشبهها		**yušbihuhā**
°I, 8, p. 53, 18	al-aġrāḍi		**al-aʿrāḍi**
*I, 8, p. 54, 15	wa-mawḍūʿun B Ğ D Ṭ Āmulī	ay mawḍūʿun lat (scilicet subiectum)	**aw mawḍūʿun** P125 P117 L Ṭcorr.[59] Ṣ M

[54] This reading is not reported in c.
[55] This reading is not reported in c.
[56] This reading is not reported in c.
[57] This reading is not reported in c.
[58] This reading is not reported in c.
[59] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*II, 1, p. 57, 6	wa-l-wuğūdi Ṭ Āmulī		**al-wuğūdi** P125 P117 L lat (secundum quod est esse)
*II, 1, p. 58, 3	mutaqawwamin Ṭ Āmulī		**muqawwamin** P125 P117 L?
*II, 1, p. 58, 6	al-basīṭi P117 L Ṭ Āmulī		**al-saṭḥi** P125 lat (superficie)
*II, 1, p. 58, 11	fa-yaqūlu Āmulī B		**fa-qāla** P117 P125 L Ṭ abbr.[60] lat (dixerunt) Ğ D Ṣ M
*II, 1, p. 59, 15	yaḫuṣṣuhū Ṭ Āmulī	بحصه P125; بخصه L	**naḫūṣṣuhū** lat (appropriamus); cp. kunnā qad naqūlu, p. 59, 16
*II, 1, p. 60, 13	taṣarrufin mā P125 L Ṭ Āmulī		**bi-ḍarbin mā** lat (aliquo modo); cp. min kulli ğihatin, l. 14
*II, 2, p. 61, 10	al-muḫtalifati Ṭs.l. Āmulī B		**om.** P117 P125 L lat Ğ D Ṣ M
*II, 2, p. 62, 9	suṭūḥun lat (superficies [pl.])		**saṭḥun** P117 P125 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ M
II, 2, p. 64, 10	wa-ʿāddun lahū	aw ʿālin P125; om. lat	**aw ʿāddun lahū** P117 L Ṭ[61] Āmulī
°II, 2, p. 64, 13	yukawwinu Āmulī		**yakūnu**
*II, 2, p. 64, 18	naqšin lat (sculptione) B Ğ Ṣ M	al-naqši D	**nafsin** P117 P125 L Ṭ[62] Āmulī Anawati

[60] This reading is not reported in c.
[61] This reading is not reported in c.
[62] This reading is not reported in c. Cp. Van Riet, p. 74.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*II, 2, p. 66, 8	muḫtalifan Ṭ Āmulī Anawati (pro: muḫnalifan)	fa-yaḫtalifu Ǧ	**wa-yaḫtalifu** P117 P125 L Ṭs.l. Āmulī[1] lat (quia diversitas est) B D Ṣ M
°II, 2, p. 67, 3	yaẓallu		**baṭala** Anawati
II, 2, p. 67, 4	ḥaṣala[2]		**ḥadaṯa** P117 P125 L Ṭ[63] lat (restauratur; cf. restauratur = ḥadaṯa, p. 67, 5)
*II, 2, p. 67, 13	bi-l-quwwati Āmulī Ṣ		**al-quwwatu** P117 P125 L Ṭ lat (potentiam) B Ǧ D M
°II, 2, p. 68, 1	tuʿiddihā		**tuʿidduhā**
*II, 2, p. 68, 13	ṭabīʿiyyatun Āmulī		**ṭabīʿatun** P117 P125 L Ṭ[64] lat (natura)
^II, 2, p. 69, 11–12	. . . li-d̲ālika. ʿalā annaka . . .		. . . **li-d̲ālika ʿalā annaka . . .**
*II, 2, p. 70, 6	ṭabīʿiyyatuhū	ṭabīʿat P125	**ṭabīʿatuhū** P117 L Ṭ[65] Āmulī lat (eius natura)
*II, 2, p. 70, 15	fa-d̲ālika l-miqdāru Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ	wa-li-d̲ālika l-miqdāru L lat (unde); wa-l-miqdāru D	**fa-ka-d̲ālika l-miqdāru** P117 P125 M
II, 3, p. 73, 4	min		**maʿa** P117 P125 L Ṭ[66] Āmulī lat (cum [reciperet])
II, 3, p. 73, 16	منة		**minhu** Anawati

[63] This reading is not reported in c.
[64] This reading is not reported in c.
[65] This reading is not reported in c.
[66] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
II, 3, p. 74, 4	lahā	cum motione (= maʿa l-taḥrīki) add. lat	**maʿa l-tağrīdi** add. P117 P125 L Ṭ[67] Āmulī
*II, 3, p. 74, 15	kammin P117 Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ	wa-qad qāma kāna ġayra d̲ī kammin add. M[68]	**wa-qad qāma ġayra d̲ī kammin** add. P117mg. P125 L Ṭ D lat (iam igitur constituta esset non habens quantitatem)
II, 3, p. 75, 2	an tuqawwima/ tuqawwama		**an yataqawwama** P117 P125 L Ṭ[69] Āmulī lat (iam constituta fuisset)
*II, 3, p. 75, 4	wa-l-ʿaraḍu yaʿriḍu lat (propter accidentale contingeret) B Ğ D M	wa-l-farḍu yufraḍu L	**wa-l-farḍu yaʿriḍu** P117 P125 Ṭ[70] Āmulī Ṣ Anawati
II, 3, p. 75, 6	taqawwama		**tataqawwamu** P117 P125 L Ṭ[71] Āmulī
°II, 3, p. 75, 17	كجرئه		**ka-ğuzʾihī** Anawati
II, 3, p. 77, 2	lan		**lam** P117 P125 L Ṭ[72] Āmulī
°II, 3, p. 77, 8	al-mādda		**al-māddata** Anawati
°II, 3, p. 77, 9	bi- . . . qadārin		**bi-miqdārin** Anawati

[67] This reading is not reported in c.
[68] Mss. Ğ and Ṣ add a similar sentence (respectively: *wa-qad qāma ġayra d̲ī kammin wa-ġayra d̲āti ḥayyizin* and *wa-qad qāma ġayra d̲ī kammin wa-ġayra d̲ī ḥayyizin*) at the very end of p. 74, 15.
[69] This reading is not reported in c.
[70] This reading is not reported in c.
[71] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
°II, 3, p. 78, 1	li-sababin		**al-sababu** Anawati
*II, 4, p. 84, 11	al-ṣuwari Āmulī		**al-ṣūrati** P117 P125 L Ṭ[73] lat (illam)
*II, 4, p. 85, 3	waḥdahā Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ		**om.** P117 P125 L lat B D Ṣ M
*II, 4, p. 88, 3	bi-wāsiṭ atihā Āmulī		**bi-wisāṭ atihā** P117 P125 L Ṭ[74]
*II, 4, p. 88, 7	mūǧidatan P117 Ṭ Āmulī	mawǧūdatan P125; p. 88, 5–12 om. lat	**mūǧibatan** L; cf. mūǧibun p. 88, 9
II, 4, p. 89, 7	lā anna		**ʿillatu** add. P117 P125 L Ṭ[75] Āmulī lat (causa)
II, 4, p. 89, 9	takūna		**yakūna** Anawati
*III, 1, p. 94, 16	aqdamu[1] Āmulī		**minhu** add. P117 P125 L Ṭ[76]
*III, 1, p. 94, 16	wa-mā[2] Āmulī		**huwa** add. P117 P125 L Ṭ[77]
III, 2, p. 97, 9	maḥmūlāni		**fī** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[78] Āmulī lat (de [uno subiecto])
*III, 2, p. 101, 10	yuqālu Āmulī		**lahā** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[79]
III, 2, p. 102, 7	al-sufuni		**al-safīnati** Anawati
III, 3, p. 104, 5	al-wāḥida		**lā yanqasimu fa-qad qulnā inna l-wāḥida** add. Anawati

[72] This reading is not reported in c.
[73] This reading is not reported in c.
[74] This reading is not reported in c.
[75] This reading is not reported in c.
[76] This reading is not reported in c.
[77] This reading is not reported in c.
[78] This reading is not reported in c.
[79] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
III, 3, p. 107, 7	min		**an** add. Anawati
*III, 3, p. 108, 6	kānat Āmulī		**kāna** P125 P117 L Ṭ[80]
III, 4, p. 112, 9	wa-muqtaḍāhū		**muqtaḍāhū** Anawati
*III, 4, p. 112, 10	miqdārun Āmulī		**miqdāran** P125 P117 L Ṭ
III, 4, p. 112, 16	ka-ǧuzʾin		**lā ka-ǧuzʾin** P125 P117 L Ṭ[81] Āmulī lat (non sicut pars)
III, 4, p. 113, 1	huwa[2]		**om.** P125 P117 L Ṭ[82] Āmulī
*III, 4, p. 113, 11	al-saṭ ḥu D	li-anna l-saṭ ḥa B Ǧ Ṣ M	**al-saṭḥu li-anna l-saṭḥa** P125 P117 L Ṭ[83] Āmulī lat (enim)
*III, 4, p. 113, 15	law Āmulī		**bal law** P125 P117mg.a.m. L Ṭ[84]
III, 4, p. 116, 6	ǧihatin	p. 116, 6–8 om. lat	**uḫrā** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[85] Āmulī
III, 4, p. 117, 1	buʿdayni		**buʿdāni** P125 P117 L Ṭ[86] Āmulī
III, 5, p. 120, 6	li-kaṯratihī		**kaṯratuhū** P125 P117 L Ṭ[87] Āmulī
III, 5, p. 121, 11	bi-l-ʿadadi		**al-ʿadadu** P125 P117 L Ṭ[88] Āmulī lat (numerus)

[80] This reading is not reported in c.
[81] This reading is not reported in c.
[82] This reading is not reported in c.
[83] This reading is not reported in c.
[84] This reading is not reported in c.
[85] This reading is not reported in c.
[86] This reading is not reported in c.
[87] This reading is not reported in c.
[88] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
III, 5, p. 122, 9	wa-hāḏā		**wa-li-hāḏā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[89] Āmulī lat (propter hoc)
III, 5, p. 123, 3	fa-naʿudduhā		**fa-yaʿudduhā** Anawati
III, 5, p. 123, 10	bi-ʿadadin Āmulī D	iḏā waǧadū fardan laysa bi-ʿadadin add. P117mg.a.m. Lmg.a.m. Ṭs.l. Ṣ; in wuǧida fardun laysa bi-ʿadadin add. Ǧ; vel imparem qui non sit numerus add. lat	**iḏ waǧadū fardan laysa bi-ʿadadin** add. P125 L Ṭ[90] B M
*III, 6, p. 126, 10	in qāla	yuqāla P117	**an yuqāla** P125 L Ṭ[91] Āmulī lat (ut dicatur)
°III, 6, p. 126, 10	al-ḍiḏḏa[2]		**al-ḍidda** Anawati
*III, 6, p. 127, 4	wa-ḏālika bi-buṭlāni P125 P117 Āmulī lat (et hoc fit propter destructionem B Ǧ D Ṣ M	wa-ka-dālika bi-buṭlāni L	**wa-ḏālika ka-buṭlāni** Ṭ Anawati
°III, 6, p. 127, 16	fī		**om.** Anawati
*III, 6, p. 127, 17	al-waḥdati wa-l-kaṯrati Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ	al-kaṯrati wa-l-waḥdati L	**al-kaṯrati** P125 P117 lat (multitudinis) D M
*III, 6, p. 129, 8	al-ʿāmmati Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 P117 L lat
III, 6, p. 130, 13	mimmā		**mā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[92] Āmulī

[89] This reading is not reported in c.
[90] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *iḏ waǧadū fardan wa-laysa bi-ʿadadin.*
[91] This reading is not reported in c.
[92] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*III, 6, p. 130, 15	wa-baʿḍuhumā Āmulī	wa-fī-baʿḍihā P125 Ṭ[93]	**wa-baʿḍuhā** P117 L
°III, 6, p. 130, 16	min min		**min** Anawati
*III, 6, p. 131, 9	al-mawǧūdi Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ		**al-wuġūdi** P125 117 L Ṭ lat (esse adinventioni) Anawati M
III, 6, p. 131, 10	wa-l-taǧdīdi		**wa-l-taḥdīdi** P125 P117 L Ṭ[94] Āmulī lat (terminationi)
*III, 6, p. 131, 14	irḫāʾu l-naġmati Ṭ Āmulī	al-irḫāʾu B D; alha lat; arḫāʾu Van Riet; arḫāʾu l-naġmati Anawati	**al-irḫātu** P125 P117 L Ǧ Ṣ M
III, 6, p. 132, 16	kawna		**yakūna** P125 P117 L Ṭ[95] Āmulī
*III, 6, p. 133, 4	fa-min Āmulī Ṭ Ṣ M		**min** P125 P117 L B Ǧ D Ṣmg. Mmg. lat
*III, 6, p. 133, 10	bi-ašyāʾa Āmulī M		**wa-ašyāʾa** P125 P117 L Ṭ lat vel in aliis rebus) B Ǧ D Ṣ
III, 7, p. 134, 4	fa-natakallamu		**fa-l-natakallam** P125 P117 L Ṭ[96] Āmulī
III, 7, p. 135, 2	yatağazzaʾu		**lā yatağazzaʾu** P125 P117 L Ṭ[97] Āmulī lat (non partitur)

[93] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *wa-fī-baʿḍihimā*.
[94] This reading is not reported in c.
[95] This reading is not reported in c.
[96] This reading is not reported in c.
[97] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
III, 7, p. 135, 3	yumkinu		**lākin** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[98] Āmulī lat (sed)
III, 7, p. 135, 4	li-annahū	an P117 L Āmulī lat (quod)	**annahū** P125 Ṭ[99]
*III, 7, p. 135, 5	wa-qad Āmulī lat (et . . . iam)		**qad** P125 P117 L Ṭ[100] B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*III, 7, p. 135, 8	mufāriqatuhū Āmulī D		**mufāriqatun** P125 P117 L Ṭ[101] lat (separata) B Ǧ Ṣ M
III, 7, p. 136, 2	اجراء		**aǧzā'i** Anawati
*III, 7, p. 136, 13	āḫara[2] Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 P117 L lat
III, 7, p. 137, 4	yuḥwiǧuhū		**šay'un** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[102] Āmulī lat (aliquo)
*III, 7, p. 137, 13	al-ʿayni Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D		**laysa** add. P125 P117 L Ṣ M lat (non)
*III, 7, p. 137, 14	kāna Ṭ		**hāḏā** add. P125 P117 L Ts.l.[103] Āmulī lat (hoc)
*III, 7, p. 138, 13	āḫara Ṭs.l. Āmulī B		**om.** P125 P117 L Ṭ lat Ǧ D Ṣ M
*III, 7, p. 139, 2	miqdārun Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ	ḏā miqdārin P125	**ḏū miqdārin** P117 L M lat (habens mensuram)

[98] This reading is not reported in c.
[99] This reading is not reported in c.
[100] This reading is not reported in c.
[101] This reading is not reported in c.
[102] In c, Ṭ is reported not as adding *šay'un*, but as replacing with it the following term (*ilā*).
[103] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*III, 7, p. 139, 5	bayāḍiyyatuhū Āmulī		**bayāḍiyyatun** P125 P117 L Ṭ[104] lat (albedinem)
*III, 7, p. 139, 10	wa-laysat B Ǧ D Ṭ Āmulī		**wa-laysa** P125 P117 L Ṣ M
*III, 8, p. 141, 16	laysat[1] P125 L Ṭ Āmulī lat		**secl** del. P117
*III, 8, p. 142, 7	al-māhiyyāti Ṭ Āmulī		**al-māhiyyati** P125 P117 L Ṭcorr.[105] lat (quidditate)
*III, 8, p. 142, 11	wa-annahā ayḍan B D		**wa-ayḍan annahā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[106] Āmulī lat (et etiam quia) Ǧ Ṣ M
*III, 8, p. 143, 4	wa-sa-nuẖriğu P117		**wa-sa-nuẖwiğu** P125 L Ṭ[107] Āmulī lat (oportebit)
III, 8, p. 143, 7	tafsīrātin		**taqšīrātin** P125 P117 L Ṭ?[108] Āmulī lat (abstractione)
*III, 8, p. 143, 8	bihī Āmulī		**bihā** P125? P117 L? Ṭ[109] lat (per eas) B Ǧ D Ṣ M
III, 8, p. 143, 9	taḏahhaba		**naḏhabu** Anawati
*III, 8, p. 143, 14	ṣuwaran Ṭ Āmulī	ṣūratun L	**ṣuwarun** P125 P117

[104] This reading is not reported in c.
[105] This reading is not reported in c.
[106] This reading is not reported in c.
[107] This reading is not reported in c.
[108] This reading is not reported in c.
[109] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*III, 9, p. 145, 2	faṣlun Ṭ Āmulī M		**fī l-kalāmi** add. P125 P117 L Ṭmg. lat (ad loquendum) B Ğ D Ṣ
*III, 9, p. 145, 4	hāḏā . . . bi-l-ṭabīʿiyyāti P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** lat
*III, 9, p. 145, 12–13	wa-li-anna ḏālika Ṭ Āmulī B D Ṣ		**wa-ḏālika li-anna** P125 P117 L lat (enim) Ğ M
°III, 9, p. 146, 4	الدائرء		**al-dāʾirati**
°III, 9, p. 146, 12	ʿalā		**om.** Anawati
*III, 9, p. 146, 16	alladī[1] P125 Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P117 L B D Ğ Ṣ M
III, 9, p. 147, 3	ğuʿila	faʿala Āmulī	**fuʿila** P125 P117 L Ṭ
*III, 9, p. 147, 17	ayḍan Āmulī Ğ M	al-ḍarūratu add. P125; al-ḍ Ṭabbr.; bi-l-ḍarūrati B D Ṣ	**al-ḍarūriyyatu** add. P117 L lat? (rectum)
*III, 9, p. 148, 15	wa-wuğūbu B D		**wa-wuğūdu** P125 P117 L Ṭ[110] Āmulī Ğ Ṣ M lat (sit)
°III, 9, p. 148, 16	فارقة		**fāriqahū** Anawati
°III, 9, p. 149, 2	بسبطا		**basīṭan** Anawati
*III, 9, p. 149, 9	fī mawḍiʿihī[1]	fī waḍʿihī B Ğ Ṣ M	**waḍʿahū** P125 P117 L Ṭ[111] Āmulī D
°III, 9, p. 149, 9	موزايا	muwāzin Anawati; om. P125	**muwāziyan** P117 L Ṭ[112] Āmulī

[110] This reading is not reported in c.
[111] This reading is not reported in c.
[112] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*III, 9, p. 151, 6	maylan Āmulī	maṭalan lat (verbi gratia)	**miṭlan** P125 P117 L Ṭ[113] Āmulī[1]
^III, 10, p. 152, 7–8	. . . ʿāriḍatun. awwalu ʿurūḍihā . . . lat (accidens. Cuius prima accidentalitas . . .)		**. . . ʿāriḍatun awwala ʿurūḍihā . . .** Ṭ Āmulī
*III, 10, p. 152, 9	bi-l-muḫtalifi	wa-l-muḫtalifu P125 P117? L	**fa-l-muḫtalifu** Ṭ Āmulī Anawati
°III, 10, p. 152, 10	wa-l-muwāzī wa-l-muwāzī wa-l-muwāzī		**wa-l-muwāzī wa-l-muwāzī**
*III, 10, p. 152, 12	wa-muḥaqqaqun Āmulī		**muḥaqqaqun** P125 P117 L Ṭ[114] lat ([terminata] certificata)
°III, 10, p. 154, 1	إدراكيه		**idrākiyyatun**
*III, 10, p. 154, 13	āḫara Āmulī	lat om. ll. 13–14	**fa-huwa** add. P125 P117mg. L Ṭ[115] B Ğ D Ṣ M
°III, 10, p. 154, 16	البته		**al-battata** Anawati
^III, 10, pp. 154, 17–158, 1	ismun. fa-in (new paragraph) Āmulī		**ismun. fa-in (same paragraph)**
°III, 10, p. 155, 11	حاله		**ḥālatan** Anawati
°III, 10, p. 156, 12	wa-takūnu		**takūnu** Anawati
*III, 10, p. 157, 8	wa-ġayrihī Āmulī B	fa-ḏālika l-maʿnā huwa bi-l-ḥaqīqati al-maʿnā al-maʿqūlu bi-l-qiyāsi ilā ġayrihī P117 L; fa-ḏālika l-maʿnā huwa bi-l-ḥaqīqati mina	**fa-ḏālika l-maʿnā huwa bi-l-ḥaqīqati al-maʿqūlu bi-l-qiyāsi ilā ġayrihī** P125 Ṭ Ğ

[113] This reading is not reported in c.
[114] This reading is not reported in c.
[115] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
		l-maʿnā al-maʿqūlu bi-l-qiyāsi ilā ġayrihī lat (Illa enim intentio certissime est de intentione intellecta respectu alterius); fa-ḏālika l-maʿnā huwa al-ḥaqīqatu [sic] al-maʿnā al-maʿqūlu bi-l-qiyāsi ilā ġayrihī D Ṣ; fa-ḏālika l-maʿnā huwa bi-l-ḥaqīqati al-maʿqūlu bi-l-qiyāsi ilā ġayrihī wa-ġayrihī M	
°III, 10, p. 157, 12	innahū		**annahū**
°III, 10, p. 158, 7	تلك		**tilka**
III, 10, p. 158, 10	baynahā		**baynahumā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[116] Āmulī lat (inter ea duo)
°III, 10, p. 158, 11	خر		**āḫara** Anawati
*III, 10, p. 159, 10	al-iḍāfati Āmulī	li-iḍāfatin Ṭ[117]	**huwa iḍāfatun** P125 P117 L lat (est relatio)
*IV, 1, p. 164, 4	bi-baḥṭi P117	سحب P125; bi-naḫbi L; bi-nabti Ṭ[118]	**bi-baḫṭi** Āmulī lat (casu)
*IV, 1, p. 164, 14	wuǧūdan mutaqaddiman B D Ṣ M	wuǧūdun mutaqaddimun Ǧ	**wuǧūdun mutaqaddiman** P125 P117 L Ṭ[119] Āmulī lat

[116] This reading is not reported in c.
[117] This reading is not reported in c.
[118] This reading is not reported in c.
[119] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
IV, 1, p. 166, 1	mumkinan[1]		**an yukawwinahū** add. P125 P117 L Ṭs.l.[120] Āmulī lat (per ipsum fieri aliud)
*IV, 1, p. 166, 6	nisbatu kawnihī ʿani l-ʿillati	kawnihī ʿani l-ʿillati om. P125; nisbatu om. lat (possibilitas rem essendi per causam)	**nisbatu imkāni kawnihī ʿani l-ʿillati** P117 L Ṭ[121] Āmulī
IV, 1, p. 167, 9	dūna		**baʿda** P125 P117 L Ṭ[122] Āmulī lat (postquam)
*IV, 1, p. 167, 14	kulli B D Ṣ M		**wāḥidin** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[123] Āmulī Ǧ
*IV, 1, p. 168, 5	wağaba fī l-wuğūdi in kāna al-maʿlūlu qad ḥaṣala P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī		**wağaba fī l-wuğūdi an yakūna al-maʿlūlu qad ḥaṣala** lat (debet in esse causatum acquiri). Cp. IV, 1, p. 167, 13: yağibu ʿanhu fī l-wuğūdi an yakūna qad ḥaṣala wuğūdu l-āḫari
°IV, 1, p. 168, 7	تغنى		**tuʿnā** Anawati
*IV, 1, p. 169, 16	al-wuğūdi[124] lat (esse) B Ǧ D Ṣ M		**al-mawğūdi** P117 P125 L Ṭ[125] Āmulī
^IV, 1, p. 170, 13–14	quwwatan. ṯumma (new paragraph) Āmulī		**quwwatan. ṯumma (same paragraph)**

[120] This reading is not reported in c.
[121] This reading is not reported in c.
[122] This reading is not reported in c.
[123] This reading is not reported in c.
[124] In the apparatus of c, *al-mawğūdi* is reported as the edited reading.
[125] In the apparatus of c, Ṭ is reported as having *al-wuğūdi*.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
^IV, 2, p. 170, 15	ṣay'an. ṯumma (same paragraph Āmulī		**šay'an. ṯumma (new paragraph)**
*IV, 2, p. 173, 1	wa-lā yataġayyaru, wa-irādatuhū B Ğ D Ṣ	wa-lā yataġayyaru, irādatuhū Āmulī	**wa-lā tataġayyaru irādatuhū** P125 P117 L Ṭ[126] lat M
*IV, 2, p. 173, 3	annahū Āmulī		**an** P125 P117 L Ṭ[127]
*IV, 2, p. 176, 7	maqṣūratun lat? (egent)	p. 176, 6–7 wa-rubbamā lam yakun li-l-ʿādati l-ālātu wa-mawāddu muʿīnatun L (cf. p. 176, 10)	**maqṣūdatun** P125 P117 Ṭ[128] Āmulī
*IV, 2, p. 176, 7	faqaṭ Ṭs.l. Āmulī		**om.** P125 P117 lat B Ğ D Ṣ M
*IV, 2, p. 176, 9	ṯubūti Āmulī		**ṣūrati** add. P125 P117 L Ṭs.l.[129] lat (formae)
*IV, 2, p. 176, 11	yaʿtādda P117 Ṭ lat (exercere) Āmulī		**yataʿallama** P125 L
°IV, 2, p. 179, 1	aǧsāman		**aǧsāmin** Anawati
*IV, 2, p. 180, 6	hāḏā Āmulī		**om.** P125 P117 L Ṭ[130] lat
IV, 2, p. 180, 14	bi-an yakūna l-amru	bi-an yakūna minhu l-amru P125; bi-an yakūna minhu lat (quod ex ea est)	**minhu** add. P117 L? Ṭs.l.[131] Āmulī

[126] This reading is not reported in c.
[127] This reading is not reported in c.
[128] This reading is not reported in c.
[129] This reading is not reported in c.
[130] This reading is not reported in c.
[131] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IV, 2, p. 181, 1	kawnuhū Ṣ M Āmulī		**min** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ lat (a) B Ǧ D
*IV, 2, p. 184, 6	šayʾun lat (aliquid) Āmulī		**bi-šayʾin** P125 P117 L Ṭ[132] Āmulī[1]
IV, 3, p. 186, 15	fa-huwa		**fa-hāḏā** P125 P117 L Ṭ[133] Āmulī lat (hoc)
*IV, 3, p. 187, 2	wa-ka-anna P117 Ṭ Āmulī lat		**wa-kāna** P125 L
°IV, 3, p. 187, 6	إلا طلاق		**al-iṭlāqi**
*IV, 3, p. 187, 15	wa-l-nihāyati Ṭ Āmulī lat (et finis)	wa-l-nihāyiyyati P125 P117	**wa-l-nihāyatiyyati** L
*IV, 3, p. 188, 6	bi-mā Ṭ Āmulī	bi-mā huwa lat? (per seipsum)	**om.** P125 P117mg.a.m. L
IV, 3, p. 188, 10	awwaliyyatan	al-battata Āmulī	**ilayhi** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[134] lat (ad eum)
*IV, 3, p. 189, 1	li-ʿaqlin D		**li-l-ʿaqli** P125 P117 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (intelligentiae ei) B Ġ Ṣ M
*IV, 3, p. 189, 2	fa-inna kulla Āmulī		**fa-in kāna** P125 P117 L Ṭ[135] lat (fuerit) B Ǧ D M
°IV, 3, p. 189, 2	yūǧadu ʿanhu fa-in kāna šayʾun āḫaru		**fa-in kāna šayʾun āḫaru yūǧadu ʿanhu** cf. Anawati
IV, 3, p. 189, 18	wa-ʿanhu		**ʿanhu** Anawati

[132] This reading is not reported in c.
[133] This reading is not reported in c.
[134] This reading is not reported in c.
[135] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IV, 3, p. 190, 1	fī Āmulī		**istiʿmāli** add. P125 P117 L Ṭ[136] lat (acceptione)
*IV, 3, p. 190, 9	fa-ka-anna Āmulī lat? (igitur secundum quod est) B Ǧ Ṣ M	wa-ka-anna D; p. 190, 7–10 om. L	**fa-kāna** P125 P117 Ṭ[137]
*IV, 3, p. 190, 9–10	yuʿtabaru fīhi an yakūna B D		**om.** P125 P117 Āmulī lat Ǧ Ṣ M; scr. et del. Ṭ
°IV, 3, p. 190, 11	بعد ه		**yaʿudduhū** Anawati
*IV, 3, p. 190, 13	wa-ka-anna P125 Āmulī B D Ṣ M	p. 190, 13–14 om. L; om. Ǧ	**wa-kāna** P117 Ṭ lat Anawati
IV, 3, p. 191, 1	yuʿaddu		**yaʿuddu**
*IV, 3, p. 191, 5	li-muḫtalifi Āmulī		**al-muḫtalifu** P125 P117 L Ṭ[138]
V, 1, p. 195, 9	al-kaṯīrīna	om. P125; p. 195, 8–10 om. L	**al-kaṯīrūna** P110 Ṭ[139] Āmulī
*V, 1, p. 196, 9	ḥaddi[3] D	p. 196, 9 om. L	**om.** P125 P110 Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ǧ Ṣ M
*V, 1, p. 196, 11	fī[3] Ṭs.l. Āmulī M		**om.** P125 P110 L lat B Ǧ D Ṣ
V, 1, p. 196, 13	farasiyyatun Ṭ Āmulī lat		**farasiyyatun** add. P125 P110 L
V, 1, p. 196, 14	ka-d̲ālika B Ǧ Ṣ M	wa-li-d̲ālika D; p. 196, 14 om. L	**wa-ka-d̲ālika** P125 P110 Ṭ[140] Āmulī

[136] This reading is not reported in c.
[137] This reading is not reported in c.
[138] This reading is not reported in c.
[139] This reading is not reported in c.
[140] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*V, 1, p. 196, 15	wa-li-annahā P125 L Ṭ Āmulī		**wa-bi-annahā** lat (ex hoc quod); cf. ex hoc quod (= bi-šarṭ i annahā) p. 196, 15
*V, 1, p. 197, 1	li-ṭarfay Ṭ Āmulī		**bi-ṭarfay** P125 P110 L lat (secundum [contradictionem]) B Ǧ D S M
*V, 1, p. 197, 6	ʿan L Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 lat
*V, 1, p. 199, 2	iʿtibāran Ṭ lat B D M	iʿtibāru L Āmulī Ǧ Ṣ	**iʿtibāruhā** P125 P110
V, 1, p. 199, 3	fa-takūnu		**fa-yakūnu** Anawati
*V, 1, p. 199, 3	fa-innā qad B	fa-in P125; fa-qad Āmulī; om. M	**fa-iḏā** P110 L Ṭ lat (cum enim) Ǧ D Ṣ
V, 1, p. 199, 7	tuʿnā		**naʿnā** Anawati
*V, 1, p. 200, 7	ġayrun P110 L	ġayrahū/ ġayruhū P125	**ġayran** Ṭ[141] Āmulī
*V, 1, p. 200, 8	ġayrun	ġayrahū/ ġayruhū P125	**ġayran** P110 L Ṭ[142] Āmulī
*V, 1, p. 200, 10	insāniyyatin[143] L Ṭ	om. lat	**insāniyyatihī** P125 P110 Āmulī
V, 1, p. 201, 1	kaṯīran		**lā** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ[144] Āmulī lat (nec)
*V, 1, p. 201, 9	mā li-ṭabīʿatihī P110 lat Āmulī B	fa-l-ṭabīʿatu P125 Ṭ Ǧ D Ṣ M; li-ṭabīʿati L	**mā li-ṭabīʿati**

[141] This reading is not reported in c.
[142] This reading is not reported in c.
[143] In the apparatus of c, *insāniyyatihī* is reported as the edited reading and *insāniyyatin* as a variant in Ṣ, M, Ṭ.
[144] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*V, 1, p. 201, 9	ka-l-ḥayawāniyyati P110 Ṭ lat	al-ḥayawāniyyatu P125 P110corr. a.m. Āmulī Ṣ M	**al-ḥayawāniy-yati** L
*V, 1, p. 202, 2	li-annahū P125 L Āmulī		**lā annahū** P110mg.a.m. Ṭ[145] Āmulī[1] lat (non quod)
V, 1, p. 203, 18	an		**lā** add. Anawati
*V, 1, p. 204, 4	al-ḥayawānu P125 L		**li-l-ḥayawāni** P110mg.a.m. Ṭ[146] Āmulī
V, 1, p. 205, 1	bi-qadmi	بعدم P125 L	**taqadduma** P110 Ṭ[147] Āmulī (cf. p. 201, 11)
*V, 1, p. 206, 2	takūna maqūlatan Āmulī lat (quae praedicatur)	يكونمقوله P125 L; yakūna maqūlatan Ṭ[148]	**yakūna maqūlan**
*V, 1, p. 206, 5	kaṯīrin Āmulī		**kaṯīrīna** P125 P110 L Ṭ[149] lat (multis)
V, 2, p. 208, 12	maʿqūlatan		**maqūlatan** Anawati
V, 2, p. 208, 15	ḏātun		**ḏātan** P125 P110 L Ṭ[150] Āmulī
*V, 2, p. 209, 2	fa-hiya Ğ Ṣ	om. P125 B; hiya M	**bi-wağhin** P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (ullo modo) D
°V, 2, p. 209, 6	fa-l-mafʿūlu		**fa-l-maʿqūlu**
°V, 2, p. 210, 4	هز،		**hāḏihi**
*V, 2, p. 210, 10	al-maʿrūfati Ṭ Āmulī B D M		**al-mafrūḍati** P125 P110 L Ṭs.l.[151] lat (prius posita) Ğ Ṣ

[145] This reading is not reported in c.
[146] This variant is not reported in c.
[147] This reading is not reported in c.
[148] This reading is not reported in c.
[149] This reading is not reported in c.
[150] This reading is not reported in c.
[151] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
^V, 2, p. 211, 10	bi-hāḏihi,		**, bi-hāḏihi** Anawati
*V, 2, p. 211, 16	mawǧūdatan P125 Āmulī lat? B Ǧ Ṣ M	wa-mawǧūdatan P110; wa-ayḍan mawǧūdatan L; wa-mawǧūdatun add. D	**wa-mawǧūdatun**
*V, 2, p. 211, 16	wa-l-ṯāliṯi L Āmulī B		**om.** P125 P110 Ṭ lat Ǧ D Ṣ M
^V, 2, p. 212, 3	fa-qad,		**, fa-qad**
*V, 2, p. 212, 12	wa-law Ǧ	om. lat	**law** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B D Ṣ M
°V, 3, p. 213, 16	ǧuz'un		**ǧuz'an**
*V, 3, p. 214, 15	wa-l-ṣūrati P110 Ṭ Āmulī		**wa-l-ṣuwari** P125 L lat (formis)
*V, 3, p. 215, 8	lā ġayru B D		**wa-ġayru** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (et ceterae) Ǧ Ṣ M
*V, 3, p. 217, 8	fa-inna[1] L Ṭ Āmulī	lac. lat.	**om.** P125 P110
°V, 3, p. 217, 14	wa-ǧuz'un		**wa-ǧuz'an**
*V, 3, p. 218, 13	šay'un mušārun	šay'an mušārun L	**šay'an mušāran** P125 P110 Ṭ[152] Āmulī
*V, 3, p. 219, 4	šay'an Ṭ	šab'an P125; šaynā P110; بشئا L	**ša'nā** Āmulī lat (quaelibet)
*V, 3, p. 219, 5	maḫṣūṣīn B M	cuiusmodi est lat	**fīmā** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D Ṣ
*V, 4, p. 221, 14	yatawassaṭu P110 Ṭ?	بتوسط L	**bi-tawassuṭi** P125 Āmulī lat (mediante) Anawati

[152] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*V, 4, p. 221, 14	mā P125 P110 Ṭs.l.a.m.[153] B Ğ Ṣ	mimmā Ṭ Āmulī Anawati D M	**om.** L lat
V, 4, p. 222, 13	bi-hāḏihī		**li-hāḏihī** P125 P110 Lmg.a.m. Ṭ[154] Āmulī lat
V, 4, p. 225, 16	al-faṣlu		**wa-l-faṣlu** P125 P110 L Ṭ[155] Āmulī lat (et differentiam)
*V, 4, p. 226, 3	wa-ammā . . . al-ṯāniyyu Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ		**om.** P125 P110 L lat M
V, 4, p. 227, 4	ḏālika Āmulī		**annahū** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ[156]
*V, 5, p. 228, 8	al-mušāru Ğ		**mušāran** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (et fit designata) B D Ṣ M
*V, 6, p. 231, 3	al-tamayyuza Āmulī	discretio lat	**al-tamyīza** P125 110 L Ṭ?
*V, 6, p. 232, 8	wa-kānat Ṭ Āmulī M		**kānat** P125 P110 L lat B Ğ D Ṣ
*V, 6, p. 235, 4	māhiyyātihā Āmulī		**māhiyyatihā** P125 P110 L Ṭ[157] lat (quidditate)
V, 6, p. 235, 8	al-ḥaqīqiyyu		**huwa** add. P125 P110 Lmg. Ṭs.l.[158] Āmulī
*V, 7, p. 236, 5	ğuz'u Ṭ Āmulī[1]	aǧzā'u P125 lat (partes); om. Āmulī	**ğuz'ā** P110 L Āmulī Anawati

[153] This reading is not reported in c.
[154] This reading is not reported in c.
[155] This reading is not reported in c.
[156] This reading is not reported in c.
[157] This reading is not reported in c.
[158] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*V, 7, p. 241, 4	tabiʿat L lat (consequentes) B? Ǧ?[159]	tanbaʿiṯu D Ṣ M P125 Ṭ[160] Anawati; tanʿatu Āmulī	**tabʿaṯu** P110
°V, 7, p. 241, 13	yuʿayyinuhū		**bi-ʿaynihī**
*V, 7, p. 241, 16	ḥaqīqatin Ṭ Āmulī		**ḥaqīqatihī** P125 P110 L lat (veritate eius)
*V, 8, p. 244, 5	wa-l-ḥaqīqiyyatu	al-ḥaqīqatu P110	**al-ḥaqīqiyyatu** P125 L Ṭ[161] Āmulī
*V, 8, p. 245, 1	māhiyyatuhū māhiyyata l-maqbūli Ṭ Āmulī	māhiyyata l-maqbūli P110; al-māhiyyata l-maqbūlata lat (quidditas recepta)	**māhiyyatuhū l-maqbūla** P125 L
°V, 9, p. 248, 12	يقطعتها		**bi-qiṭʿatihā** Anawati
*V, 9, p. 248, 15	bi-l-fiʿli B D Ǧ Ṣ		**ḥattā** add. P125 P110 L Ṭs.l.[162] Āmulī lat (ita ut) M
V, 9, p. 250, 1	yūǧada	نوحد L	**yuʾḥaḍa** P125 P110 Ṭ[163] Āmulī lat (accipere)
*V, 9, p. 251, 4	iḏā Āmulī	om. L	**in** P125 P110 Ṭ[164]
*V, 9, p. 251, 7	wa-lam P125 P110 L		**fa-lam** Ṭ Āmulī Anawati
*V, 9, p. 251, 8	hāḏā Āmulī		**al-ḥaṭṭu** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ[165] lat (haec linea)

[159] In the apparatus of c, *tabʿaṯu* is reported as the edited reading; since, according to the apparatus, B and Ǧ have the edited reading, it is not clear whether their reading is *tabiʿat* or *tabʿaṯu*

[160] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *li-baʿṭi*.

[161] This reading is not reported in c.

[162] This reading is not reported in c.

[163] This reading is not reported in c.

[164] This reading is not reported in c.

[165] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*V, 9, p. 251, 8	wa-llaḏī B D Ğ Ṣ	allaḏī lat (quae)	**awi llaḏī** P125 P110mg. L Ṭ[166] Āmulī M
*V, 9, p. 252, 2	al-quwwata P125	p. 252, l–2 om. L	**li-l-quwwati** P110 Ṭ[167] Āmulī
V, 9, p. 252, 2	wuğūdun	p. 252, l–2 om. L	**wuğūdan** P125 P110 Ṭ[168] Āmulī
V, 9, p. 252, 4	mayyitan		**maniyyan** Anawati
VI, 1, p. 257, 8	bi-l-ʿunṣuriyyati Āmulī D		**wa-bi-l-ʿunṣuri** P125 P110 Ṭ L B Ğ Ṣ M lat (materiam)
VI, 1, p. 258, 8	huwa[1]		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī
*VI, 1, p. 260, 3	wa-iḏan fa-in D		**wa-īḏā** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (postquam autem) B Ğ Ṣ M
*VI, p. 260, 14	ay mumkinun Āmulī B		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ lat Ğ D Ṣ M
*VI, 1, p. 261, 3	baʿda l-ʿadami[3] Āmulī D	baʿda l-ʿadami . . . yakūna om. L	**om.** P125 P110 Ṭ lat B Ğ Ṣ M
*VI, 2, p. 264, 16	anna šayʾan Ṭ Āmulī D	šayʾun P110; aw sababun (vel . . . causa) lat	**aw šayʾun** P125 L B Ğ Ṣ M
*VI, 2, p. 265, 5	al-ṣuwari Ṣ		**al-ṣūrati** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B D Ğ M
VI, 2, p. 266, 16	al-muḥdaṯi[169] Āmulī	al-ḥudūṯi Ṭ; inceptionis lat	**al-ḥadaṯi** P125 P110 L B Ğ M

[166] This reading is not reported in c.
[167] This reading is not reported in c.
[168] This reading is not reported in c.
[169] In the apparatus of c, a misprint makes unclear which mss. have the edited reading.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VI, 2, p. 267, 1	fa-takūnu D	wa-id̲ takūnu M	**id̲ takūnu** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (eo quod) B Ǧ Ṣ
*VI, 2, p. 267, 3	sabaqa B Ǧ D Ṣ M	wa-yasbiqu Ṭ;[170] (wuǧūdahū) ẓamānun sabaqa wuǧūdahū om. L; yasbiqu D	**wa-sabaqa** P125 P110 Āmulī lat (et praecedit)
*VI, 3, p. 268, 12	aw ka-l-ḥarārati D Ṣ	wa-l-ḥarākati L; wa-ka-l-ḥarākati lat (et sicut motus) B Ǧ	**aw ka-l-ḥarākati** P125 P110 Ṭ Āmulī M
*VI, 3, p. 270, 1	al-maʿnā musāwiyyan li-l-awwali D Ṣ	al-awwalu P125; li-l-awwali B M; al-maʿnā al-awwalu P110 L lat (illa prima intentio); al-awwalu Āmulī[1]	**al-maʿnā li-l-awwali** Ṭ[171] Āmulī Ǧ
*VI, 3, p. 270, 5	al-ṯānī[2] P125 B	p. 270, 5: (al-ṯānī) wa-lam yakun al-ṯānī om. L; p. 270, 5–6 om. Ṭ	**li-l-ṯānī** P110 Āmulī lat (secundo) Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 270, 8	istiḥqāqi Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ[172] lat B Ǧ D Ṣ M
VI, 3, p. 270, 12	wa-l-maʿlūmāti		**wa-l-maʿlūlāti** P125 P110 L Ṭ[173] Āmulī lat (et causata)
*VI, 3, p. 270, 17	takūnu Ǧ		**wa-takūnu** P125 P110 L Ṭ[174] Āmulī B D Ṣ M lat (et erunt)

[170] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *yasbiqu*.
[171] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *al-maʿnā al-awwalu*.
[172] This reading is not reported in c.
[173] This reading is not reported in c.
[174] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VI, 3, p. 271, 15	bi-l-naqṣi D		**bi-l-tanaqquṣi** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 272, 2	tuʿāwiqu P110 D M	muʿāwinu Ǧ	**tuʿāwinu** P125 L? Ṭ Āmulī lat (adiuvat) B Ṣ
VI, 3, p. 272, 11	bihī		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ[175] Āmulī lat
*VI, 3, p. 273, 3	falaki[1] D		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ǧ Ṣ M
°VI, 3, p. 273, 10	وجده		**waḥdahū**
*VI, 3, p. 274, 3	bi-mumāssatihī B Ǧ Ṭ Āmulī		**bi-mumāssatin** P125 P110 L lat (per tactum) D Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 274, 17	bi-dāẖilihī Āmulī		**yudāẖiluhū** P125 P110 L Ṭ[176] lat? (intrat in illas)
*VI, 3, p. 274, 17	fīhā P110 Āmulī B		**minhā** P125 L Ṭ lat? (de eo) Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 275, 5	bi-l-kulliyyati Ṭ Āmulī	bi-kulliyyatihī P110 Ǧ	**li-kulliyyatihī** P125 L lat (illi toti) B D Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 275, 6	wa-yafʿalu D lat (et agat)	aw yanfaʿilu P125	**aw yafʿalu** P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 275, 15	d̲ā Āmulī[1] Ǧ	om. D	**id̲ā** P125 (اذا); P110 L (اذا) Ṭ[177] Āmulī lat (cum) B Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 276, 4	fīhi annahū Ṣ	annahū fīhi annahū P125	**annahū** P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D M
*VI, 3, p. 276, 9	wa-laysa D		**laysa** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (non) B Ǧ Ṣ M

[175] This reading is not reported in c.
[176] This reading is not reported in c.
[177] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VI, 3, p. 276, 14	ʿiddati B		**ṭalāṭati** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (tribus) Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VI, 3, p. 278, 5	ḥaqīqiyyan D M	ḥaqīqatahū P110 Ṭ Ṣ; ḥaqqiyyatahū L; lat? (certitudo eius); ḥaqqiyyatan corr. s.l. Ṭ	**ḥaqqiyyan** P125 Āmulī B Ǧ
*VI, 3, p. 278, 5	li-l-ḥaqīqati Ṭ D M	certitudinem lat	**li-l-ḥaqqiyyati** P125 P110 L Āmulī Ṭ corr.s.l. B Ǧ Ṣ
*VI, 3, p. 278, 6	al-ḥaqīqata Ṭ D M	certitudinem lat	**al-ḥaqqiyyata** P125 P110 L Ṭ corr.mg. Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ
*VI, 4, p. 280, 9	immā[3] D		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VI, 4, p. 280, 10	aw[2] Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ M		**ḥarakatin** add. P125 P110 L lat (motus)
*VI, 4, p. 280, 10	aw[3] Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ M		**ḥarakatin** add. P125 P110 L lat (motus)
*VI, 4, p. 281, 4	bi-l-wuǧūdi B D Ǧ		**bi-l-waḥdati** P110 P125 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (unitate) Bmg. Ṣ M
*VI, 4, p. 281, 6	fī mawāḍiʿa wa-lam yaǧuz fī mawāḍiʿa B	fī mawāḍiʿa wa-lam yaǧuz fī mawḍiʿin P125; wa-lam yaǧuz Ǧ Ṣ; fī mawāḍiʿa Ṭ[178]	**wa-lam yaǧuz fī mawāḍiʿa** P110 L Āmulī lat (et aliquando non) D M
*VI, 4, p. 281, 9	ilayhi Ṣ Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L lat B Ǧ D M

[178] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VI, 4, p. 281, 12	ġayri B Ğ D Ṣ		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ[179] Āmulī lat M
*VI, 4, p. 281, 12	bi-l-nisbati Ğ		**al-nisbatu** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B D Ṣ M
*VI, 4, p. 282, 11	al-ṣūrati Āmulī D		**al-ṣiḥḥati** P125 P110 L Ṭ lat (sanitas) B Ğ Ṣ M
*VI, 4, p. 282, 11	bihā Āmulī D		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ lat B Ğ Ṣ M
*VI, 4, p. 283, 6	ġāyāti Ṭ Āmulī	tamāmi lat (perfectio)	**tamāmāti** P125 P110 L
*VI, 5, p. 284, 3	uḫrā Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ[180] lat
*VI, 5, p. 285, 6	al-muḥarrikati Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ	al-ḥarakati (ut. vid.) Ṭ;[181] motum lat	**li-l-ḥarakati** P125 P110 L M
*VI, 5, p. 285, 9	dā'iman yağibu Āmulī	dā'iman add. s.l. Ṭ[182]	**yağibu dā'iman** P125 P110 L lat (oportet semper); cf. yağibu dā'iman p. 285, 8
*VI, 5, p. 287, 8	wa-yanuḥū Ğ Āmulī		**wa-yanuḥūhā** P125 P110 L Ṭ lat (quem intendit) B D Ṣ M
*VI, 5, p. 287, 17	al-qarībati P125 Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ D M		**al-qarībi** P110 L lat ([principium] propinquum) Ṣ
*VI, 5, p. 288, 4	taḫayyuliyyin B		**al-battata** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (ullo modo) Ğ D Ṣ M
°VI, 5, p. 289, 6	التزويح		**al-tazwīği**

[179] This reading is not reported in c.
[180] This reading is not reported in c.
[181] This reading is not reported in c.
[182] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VI, 5, p. 289, 7	li-anna P110 Ṭ	anna D; lā li-anna L Āmulī Ğ Ṣ	**lā anna** P125 P110corr. lat (non quod) B M
*VI, 5, p. 289, 11	al-ġāyati P125 lat (fine) B Ğ D		**al-ʿināyati** P125corr.a.m. P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Ṣ M Anawati [1985], p. 206 n.; cf. IX, 6, p. 415, 3–7
*VI, 5, p. 289, 11	yuʾtā Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ	نوى 125; توتي P110; نوتى L; nūfiya D; yaʿṭiya M	**tuʾtiya** lat? (dantem)
*VI, 5, p. 289, 11	al-wuğūdi Š		**al-ḫayriyyi** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat? B Ğ D M
°VI, 5, p. 289, 12	wuğūduhū		**wuğūdahū**
*VI, 5, p. 289, 12	al-ḫayriyyu P110 Ladd.mg.a.m. B Ğ D Ṣ Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 L lat M
*VI, 5, p. 289, 12	kāna B Ğ M	minhumā (or: mahmā) add. P125	**minhā** add. P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (ex hoc) D Ṣ
*VI, 5, p. 289, 17	al-ġāyāti Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ		**al-ġāyata** P125 P110 L lat (finis) B D M
*VI, 5, p. 290, 3	wa-aʿnī Ğ		**aʿnī** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (scilicet) B D Ṣ M
°VI, 5, p. 290, 7	ʿaraḍ		**ġaraḍ**
*VI, 5, p. 290, 10	al-ašḫāṣi[2] Ṭ Āmulī		**maʿnā** add. P125 P110 L lat (intentio) B Ğ D Ṣ M
*VI, 5, p. 290, 11–12	fa-iḏan . . . al-ašḫāṣi Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ	fa-iḏan . . . muntaširin om. P110 L D M; fa-iḏan . . . muntaširin aw	**om.** P125 Šīrāzī par.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
		lā tanāhin aw lā tanāhi [sic] al-ašḫāṣ Ladd.mg.a.m.; baʿda[2] . . . al-ašḫāṣi om. lat	
*VI, 5, p. 291, 2	al-qābiḍa	al-qāʾiḍa P110	**al-fāʾiḍa** P125 L Ṭ[183] Āmulī lat? (infusam)
*VI, 5, p. 291, 2	min D Ṣ		**fī** P125 P110 L Āmulī Ṭ lat (in) B Ǧ M
*VI, 5, p. 291, 2	wa-hiya Ǧ D Ṣ	hiya Ṭ	**wa-** P125 P110 L B M
VI, 5, p. 291, 3	baʿda		**min baʿdi** P125 P110 L Ṭ[184] Āmulī
*VI, 5, p. 291, 14	fāʾilan[2] B Ǧ D Ṣ M	wa-ġayrahū Ṭ[185]	**ġayrahū** add. P125 P110 L Āmulī lat ([fit esse] alium a se)
*VI, 5, p. 291, 15	ʿillatun ġāyatun	ġāyatun Ṭ Āmulī[1]	**ʿillatun** P125 Ṭcorr. Āmulī[186] B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VI, 5, p. 292, 9	al-nafsi Āmulī Ǧ		**nafsin** P125 P110 L Ṭ B D Ṣ M
*VI, 5, p. 293, 1	al-amru zāʾidan li-amrin zāʾidin	li-amrin zāʾidin P125 Ṭ[187] Āmulī; wa-qad . . . šayʾiyyati om. lat	**amrun zāʾidun** P110 L
*VI, 5, p. 293, 2	al-ḫašabi aw al-ḥağari B D Ṣ		**ḫašabin aw ḥağarin** P125 P110 L Ṭ[188] Āmulī Ǧ M

[183] This reading is not reported in c.
[184] This reading is not reported in c.
[185] In c, this reading is reported as concerning l. 13 instead of l. 14.
[186] Āmulī mentions a manuscript in which *ġāyatun* is corrected into *ʿillatun*.
[187] This reading is not reported in c.
[188] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
°VI, 5, p. 293, 2	yutağaddadu		**yutaḥaddadu**
*VI, 5, p. 293, 7	al-fāʿiliyyatu Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ		**al-fiʿliyyatu** P125 P110mg.a.m. L lat (actionem) B D M
*VI, 5, p. 293, 7	nafsi P110mg.a.m.	ll. 7–8 om. lat	**nufūsi** P125 L Ṭ[189] Āmulī
VI, 5, p. 293, 15	lā D		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ğ Ṣ M
*VI, 5, p. 294, 6	al-baḥṯu P110 L Ṭ Āmulī	quod inquiritur lat	**al-mabḥaṯu** P125
*VI, 5, p. 294, 10	mā Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ	fīmā lat (in [illa substantia] quae)	**mimmā** P125 P110 L Ṭ M
*VI, 5, p. 295, 6	wa-hiya B Ğ D Ṣ M		**wa-huwa** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī
*VI, 5, p. 295, 7	wa-hiya Ğ D Ṣ M		**wa-huwa** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B
*VI, 5, p. 296, 4	immā maẓnūnun wa-immā ḥaqīqiyyun Ṭ Āmulī		**immā ḥaqīqiyyun wa-immā maẓnūnun** P125 P110 L lat (verum [bonum] vel putatur)
VI, 5, p. 296, 18	yaḥṣilu		**taḥṣilu**
*VI, 5, p. 296, 18	ṯanāʾun Ṭ Āmulī Ğ D Ṣ		**om.** P125 P110 L lat B M
*VI, 5, p. 297, 9	kāna B Ğ D Ṣ M		**ġaraḍuhū** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (sua intentio)
*VI, 5, p. 297, 10	aw bi-ḥasabi šayʾin āḫara fī maṣāliḥihī D M	aw bi-ḥasabi šayʾin āḫara fī ḏātihī aw fī maṣāliḥihī P110 Lmg.a.m.	**om.** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ğ Ṣ
*VI, 5, p. 297, 11	immā P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī	om. lat	**secl.**

[189] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
°VI, 5, p. 297, 12	innahū		**annahū**
*VI, 5, p. 298, 2	maṣdaran li-amri Āmulī B D Ṣ M	maṣdaru amrin Ǧ	**maṣdaru al-amri** P125 P110 L Ṭ[190]
*VI, 5, p. 298, 14	ʿāmiluhā Āmulī[1] Ṣ M	ʿāṣibuhā L	**ʿāṣīhā** P125 P110 Ṭ Āmulī lat (si ea non fecerit) B Ǧ D
*VI, 5, p. 298, 20	annahā Ǧ		**lā** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (non) met 996a21–22 B D Ṣ M
VI, 5, p. 299, 1	allatī		**lā** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ[191] Āmulī lat (quae non) met 996a23[192]
*VI, 5, p. 299, 9	yubayyinuhā P110 Ṭ lat (ostendere)	بسها P125	**yuṯbituhā** L Āmulī
*VI, 5, p. 299, 18	in kāna P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M		**an yakūna** D
*VII, 1, p. 303, 3	al-huwiyyati Ǧ	identitate lat (= huwiyya, p. 303, 5–6)	**al-huwahuwiyyati** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B D Ṣ M
*VII, 1, p. 303, 5	hāḏā P110 Ṭ Āmulī lat (hanc) B Ǧ D Ṣ M	fī (scr. et del.) hāḏ [sic] L	**hunā** P125
*VII, 1, p. 303, 13	muqābilātihā Ṭ Āmulī		**muqābilatihā** P125 P110 L lat (eius opposito)
*VII, 1, p. 303, 14	al-huwiyyati	identitas lat (= huwiyya, p. 303, 5–6); al-huwiyyati huwiyyati D	**al-huwahuwiyyati** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M

[190] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.
[191] This reading is not reported in c.
[192] In the reprint of Avicenna [1960] (Tehrān 1983, Beirut 1992), *lā* is added in the edited text above the line.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VII, 1, p. 303, 15	mutaġayyarun Ğ		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat? B D Ṣ M
*VII, 1, p. 303, 15–16	fa-l-huwahuwiy-yatu Ṭ Ğ D Ṣ		**fa-l-huwahuwa**
*VII, 1, p. 303, 16	yaḥṣula Ṭ[193] Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ		**yuğʿala** P125 P110 L lat (ponuntur) M
*VII, 1, p. 303, 16	li-l-kaṯrati Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ	al-kaṯīru P125 lat (multa)	**li-l-kaṯīri** P110 L B D M
*VII, 1, p. 303, 16	waġhu Ṭ[194] Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ		**min waġhin** P125 P110 L lat (uno modo) M
*VII, 1, p. 304, 9	muḫālifun Ṭ lat ([est] id quod differt) B D Ṣ		**yuḫālifu** P125 P110 L Āmulī Ğ M
*VII, 1, p. 305, 3	lahū L Ṭ Ğ Ṣ		**kāna** add. P125 P110 Lmg.a.m. Āmulī lat (sive . . . sit) B D M
*VII, 1, p. 305, 8	faqada Ṭ Āmulī	faqadahū B Ğ Ṣ; faqadathu D M	**bihī** add. P125 P110 L lat (per quod)
*VII, 1, p. 305, 8	lā bi-tamāmihī Āmulī B Ṣ	bi-tamāmihī L Ṭ Āmulī[1] Ğ D M met 1023a4	**tamāmahū** P125 P110 lat (integri-tatem suam)
*VII, 1, p. 306, 2	ğinsan Ṣ	p. 306, 1–2 (fa-yağibu . . . wāḥidan [fa-yağibu]) om. lat	**ğinsuhā** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ D M
*VII, 1, p. 306, 5	mutawāṭi'in B Ṣ	mutawāṭi'in fīhi P125 Āmulī Ğ; mutawā fīhi L; al-mutawāṭi'i	**mutawāṭa'in fīhi** P110 M

[193] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *yuhaṣṣala.*
[194] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *min waġhin.*

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
		fīhi Ṭ;[195] univoce in illis lat; mutawāṭa'in D	
*VII, 1, p. 306, 10–11	wa-ṭabaqatu . . . muḫālifatun B Ǧ D Ṣ	wa-ṭabaqatu . . . muḫālifatun li-ayyihimā kāna om. L lat	**om.** P125 P110 Ṭ Āmulī M
*VII, 1, p. 306, 12	li-ṭabaqatin uḫrā Ǧ		**li-l-ṭabaqati l-uḫrā** P125 P110 L Ṭ B D Ṣ M
VII, 1, p. 307, 3	li-muwāfaqatin		**li-muwāfaqihī** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (suo convenienti)
*VII, 1, p. 308, 4	al-wāḥidi Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D Ṣ		**om.** P125 P110 L lat B M
*VII, 1, p. 308, 14	mutawassiṭan Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ M		**mutawassiṭun** P125 P110 L lat ([ubi est] medium)
*VII, 1, p. 309, 5–6	laysa . . . ayḍan Ṭ Ǧ D Ṣ		**om.** P125 P110 L Āmulī[196] lat B M
*VII, 1, p. 309, 10–11	wa-l-mutawassiṭu mutawassiṭun Ṭ B Ǧ Ṣ M	om. P125; li-l-mutawassiṭi wa-l-mutawas-siṭu mutawas-siṭun Āmulī; wa-l-tawassuṭu D	**li-l-mutawassiṭi** P110 L lat (medii)
*VII, 2, p. 310, 3	wa-mabādi'i l-taʿlīmiyyāti D Ṣ Ṭ Āmulī	المبايئ Ġ	**wa-l-taʿlīmiyyāti** P125 P110 L B M; lat (et secunda mathesi)
*VII, 2, p. 310, 9	ḏahaba Ṭ? Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ	aḏhaba D	**ḏahabat** P125 P110 L M

[195] This reading is not reported in c.

[196] Āmulī reports this sentence between brackets, noting (p. 317, n. 1) that it is an interpolation.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VII, 2, p. 310, 10	lahā B		**ibtidāʾa** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VII, 2, p. 311, 6	li-l-insāniyyati L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ M		**al-insāniyyata** P125 P110 lat (humanitas)
*VII, 2, p. 311, 7	wāḥidan mawǧūdan L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ M		**wāḥidun mawǧūdun** P125 P110 lat (una . . . ens)
*VII, 2, p. 312, 2	li-l-ḥaṣri Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D Ṣ		**al-ḥaṣra** P125 P110 L lat (restrictionem) B M
*VII, 2, p. 312, 8	aqṭārun wa-aškālun wa-aʿdādun D Ṣ	aʿẓāman wa-aʿdādan wa-aškālan P125; ʿiẓāman wa-aʿdādan wa-aškālan Āmulī; magnitudo et figura et numerus lat	**aʿẓāman wa-aškālan wa-aʿdādan** P110 L Ṭ B Ǧ M
*VII, 2, p. 314, 5	fa-yamtaniʿu D		**fa-yamnaʿu** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VII, 2, p. 314, 6	yaʿriḍu P125 Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ M	tufraḍu P110	**wa-yaʿriḍu** L lat (et . . . accidere)
*VII, 2, p. 314, 17	wa-lākin ḥayṯu Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ	min ḥayṯu P125; wa-min ḥayṯu P110mg. L Ṭ;[197] ḥayṯu D M	**wa-lākin min ḥayṯu** lat (sed secundum quod est)
*VII, 2, p. 315, 7	maʿnan wāḥidun	maʿnā ʿadadin wāḥidin P125;	**maʿnan ʿadaduhū wāḥidun** P110 Ts.l.[198] L

[197] This reading is not reported in c.
[198] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
		maʿnan ʿadadiy-yun wāḥidun Āmulī; inten-tionem quae sit una numero lat	
*VII, 2, p. 315, 10	law P110 L Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 lat
*VII, 2, p. 315, 10	li-l-āẖari B Ṣ		**li-l-uẖrā** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D M
VII, 2, p. 315, 11	ka-anna		**kāna** P125 P110 L Āmulī lat
*VII, 2, p. 315, 12	ka-l-ḥarārati L D		**lā ka-l-ḥarārati** P125 P110 Ṭ Āmulī lat (non sicut calor) B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VII, 2, p. 315, 16	insānun[2] D	fa- P125	**om.** P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ǧ Ṣ M
VII, 2, p. 316, 6	wa-innamā		**kāna** add. P125 P110 Ṭ[199] Āmulī; pp. 316, 6–7 (kaṯīratun) wa-innamā . . . kaṯīratun om. L
*VIII, 3, p. 317, 7	taẖayyulihā B Ǧ Ṣ M		**taẖayyulinā** P125 P110mg. L Ṭ[200] Āmulī lat (naturae imaginationis, pro: **nostrae** imagina-tionis) D
*VII, 3, p. 317, 7	ka-d̲ālika D		**li-d̲ālika** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (de hoc) B Ǧ Ṣ M
VII, 3, p. 317, 16	yufāriqu		**tufāriqu**
*VII, 3, p. 318, 12	kāmilin B		**fāʾilin** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (agentem) Ǧ D Ṣ M

[199] This reading is not reported in c.
[200] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VII, 3, p. 318, 14	yaġmaʿuhā L Ṭ Āmulī lat (ea)		**yaġmaʿuhumā** P125 P110
*VII, 3, p. 318, 14	wāḥidatun P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ Ṣ	kulli wāḥidin lat? (unius-cuiusque)	**wāḥidin** P125 B D M
*VII, 3, p. 319, 3	fa-yalzamu . . . fāsidun Ǧ D		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ṣ M
*VII, 3, p. 319, 17	lam yakun Ṣ		**la-mā kāna** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B D Ǧ M
*VII, 3, p. 320, 3	tataġayyaru Ṭ Ǧ		**tuġayyiru** P125 P110 L Āmulī lat (variat + acc.) B D Ṣ M
VII, 3, p. 320, 10	al-ḫumāsiyyatāni		**ḫumāsiyyatayni** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ[201] Āmulī lat (sunt duae quinarietates)
*VII, 3, p. 321, 7	wa-in lam D		**wa-an** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (et ut) B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VII, 3, p. 321, 10	al-waḥdati li-l-wāḥidi Ṭ	al-waḥdati li-l-wāḥidati P125 D; al-waḥdati al-wāḥidi Ǧ; (unius) eiusdem unitatis lat	**al-waḥdati al-wāḥidati** P110 L Āmulī B Ṣ M
*VII, 3, p. 321, 15	illā annahā Āmulī B D	li-annahā P125 lat (nam)	**lā annahā** P110 L Ṭ Ǧ Ṣ M
*VII, 3, p. 321, 18	ilā maḏhabin D		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VII, 3, p. 322, 5	rubbamā yakūnāni	yakūnāni P110 L lat (erunt); humā yakūnāni Ṭ[202] Āmulī	**humā** P125

[201] This reading is not reported in c.
[202] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VII, 3, p. 322, 7	al-ṯunāʾiyyati B	illā add. lat (nisi); waḥdatāni Ǧ; waḥdatun Ṣ	**waḥdatāni fa-lā yūǧadu fī māddati l-ṯunāʾiyyati** [li-l-ṯunāʾiyyati P125, om. Ṭ[203]] add. P110 L Āmulī D M
*VII, 3, p. 322, 16	mawǧūdatun P110 L lat (quae est) D M	موحد ه P125; mūǧiduhū P110 corr.s.l.a.m.	**mūǧidatun** Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ
°VII, 3, p. 323, 5	maʿlūman		**maʿlūlan**
*VII, 3, p. 323, 9	al-šarra Ǧ		**šarran** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B D Ṣ M
*VIII, 1, p. 328, 4	tartīban D M		**tarattuban** P125 P110 L B Ǧ Ṣ Ṭ Āmulī
*VIII, 1, p. 328, 5	tartīban D M		**tarattuban** P125 P110 L B Ǧ Ṣ Ṭ Āmulī
*VIII, 1, p. 328, 7	wa-lam B	cuius non (inveniatur extremum) lat	**fa-lam** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 1, p. 328, 8	al-ṭarfi ġayra D	ġayri Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M	**al-ġayri** P125 P110 L Ṭ[204] lat (illud in[finitum])
*VIII, 1, p. 328, 8	muštarikan Ǧ Ṣ Āmulī	hiya L	**om.** P125 P110 B D M Ṭ lat
*VIII, 1, p. 328, 11	fī l-ḥaṣri B		**wa-l-aḫ̲di** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (acceperis) Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 1, p. 329, 8	wa-mutaqaddimatan Āmulī B Ǧ D	et sunt priores ea lat	**wa-tataqaddamuhū** P125? P110 L? Ṭ[205] Ṣ M

[203] In c, Ṭ is reported as omitting the edited reading.
[204] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *ġayri*.
[205] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VIII, 1, p. 330, 3	fī Ṭ Āmulī B D		**om.** P125 P110 L lat Ǧ Ṣ M
*VIII, 1, p. 330, 6	al-ṯānī D M	al-bāqī Ǧ	**om.** P125 P110 L lat Ṭ Āmulī B Ṣ
°VIII, 1, p. 330, 9	afdamu		**aqdamu**
*VIII, 1, p. 330, 9	kāna[2] Ǧ D Ṣ M		**ka-annahū** P125 P110 L Ṭ[206] Āmulī lat (quasi) B
*VIII, 2, p. 332, 5	al-mawḍūʿi Āmulī		**mawḍiʿi** P125 P110 L Ṭ[207] lat (loco)
*VIII, 2, p. 332, 13	aw P110 L B D M		**wa-** P125 Ṭ Āmulī lat (et) Ǧ Ṣ
*VIII, 2, p. 334, 3	lahū P110 corr.s.l. Ladd.s.l. Ṭ Āmulī	al-šay'i P125; rei lat	**li-l-šay'i** P125 P110 L B Ǧ D Ṣ M
VIII, 2, p. 334, 5	li-smin		**al-ismu** P125 P110 L Ṭ[208] Āmulī lat (nomen)
VIII, 2, p. 334, 6	takūnu		**yakūnu**
°VIII, 2, p. 334, 17	أنرى ا		**uḫrā**
*VIII, 2, p. 335, 12	id̲ Ṭ Āmulī lat (eo quod) B Ṣ	an D Ṭcorr.s.l.;[209] aw an Ǧ	**aw** P125 P110 L Ṭcorr.s.l.[210] M
*VIII, 2, p. 335, 13	aw li-āḫara Ǧ M Āmulī	wa-l-āḫaru P110; aw āḫara B D Ṣ; aw li-amrin āḫara Ṭ; om. lat	**āḫara** P125 L

[206] This reading is not reported in c.
[207] This reading is not reported in c.
[208] This reading is not reported in c.
[209] This reading is not reported in c.
[210] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VIII, 2, p. 337, 13	al-ṣūratu Ṭ Āmulī M	ṣūratuhū P110	**ṣūratu** P125 P110corr.s.l.a.m. L B Ǧ D Ṣ; cf. p. 337, 11, 12
*VIII, 2, p. 338, 15	al-ʿāqilata Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ Ṣ		**al-ʿālimata** P125 P110 L Ṭcorr.s.l.[211] lat (sciens) B D M; cf. li-l-ʿilmi p. 338, 16
*VIII, 2, p. 338, 17	al-ʿāqilati Ṭ Āmulī M		**al-ʿālimati** P125 P110 L Ṭcorr.s.l.[212] lat (sciens) B Ǧ D Ṣ; cf. li-l-ʿilmi p. 338, 17
*VIII, 2, p. 338, 19	maʿa[1] Ǧ		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat B D Ṣ M
*VIII, 3, p. 341, 16	minhā B		**fīhā** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (in eam) Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 3, p. 342, 5	ayḍan mabdaʾan wa-ʿillatan Ṭ Āmulī	ʿillatan ayḍan P125 P110corr. i.l.a.m. M	**mabdaʾan ayḍan** P110 L B Ǧ D M lat (principium etiam)
*VIII, 3, p. 342, 10	nāʾilun Ṭcorr.s.l. Āmulī	nābilun L?	**qābilun** P125 P110 Ṭ[213] lat (recipiens)
*VIII, 3, p. 342, 12	bi-īǧābi P110 L T Amuli lat (cum debito essendi)		**bi-īǧādi** P125; cf. īǧāduhū p. 342, 13

[211] This reading is not reported in c.
[212] This reading is not reported in c.
[213] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
°VIII, 3, p. 343, 4	wa-wuğūhun		**wa-wuğūduhū**
*VIII, 3, p. 343, 5	fa-wuğūduhū Āmulī D	wuğida lat? (est)	**mawğūdun** P125 P110 L Ṭ B Ğ Ṣ M
*VIII, 3, p. 343, 6	yakun Āmulī D		**mawğūdan** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ lat (ens) B Ğ Ṣ M
*VIII, 4, p. 343, 12	al-wuğūdi li-kulli Āmulī Ğ	(debendi) esse omne quod est lat	**wuğūdi kulli** P125 P110 L Ṭ B D Ṣ M
*VIII, 4, p. 345, 14	fa-lā L Āmulī lat (non erit) D M		**fa-** P125 P110 Ṭ B Ğ Ṣ
*VIII, 4, p. 345, 17	fa-innahū wa-in Ṭ Āmulī	fa-innahū in L; p. 345, 16–17 (iḏā uḫiḏa . . . fa-innahū) om. P125 lat	**fa-in** P110
*VIII, 4, p. 345, 17	yuqārinu Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ		**yufāriqu** P125 P110 L lat (ut discrepet) D M
*VIII, 4, p. 346, 2	al-wuğūdi P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Ğ D M	al-mawğūdi lat (entis)	**al-wuğūbi** B Ṣ
*VIII, 4, p. 346, 3	bi-l-wuğūbi P125 P110 Ṭ Āmulī lat (cum necessitate)		**bi-l-wuğūdi** L; cf. p. 345, 16
*VIII, 4, p. 346, 8	mušārun Āmulī lat		**al-mušāru** P125 P110 L Ṭ[214] B Ğ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 4, p. 346, 9	wa-yataḥaqqaqu L Āmulī lat (et esset certificatum) Ğ D M		**yataḥaqqaqu** P125 P110 Ṭ B Ṣ

[214] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VIII, 4, p. 346, 11	lā šay'in āḫara Ğ	wa-šay'in āḫara M; wa-šay'an āḫara D; om. P125 Ṭ Āmulī B Ṣ; non alterius rei lat	**lā li-šay'in āḫara** P110 L
*VIII, 4, p. 346, 13	law ṣāra P125 Ṭs.l.[215] Āmulī	p. 346, 13–15 om. L lat	**om.** P110mg.
*VIII, 4, p. 347, 12	al-wuğūdu[2] Ṭ Āmulī lat (esse) Ṣ		**al-mawğūdu** P125 P110 L B Ğ D M; cf. mawğūdun p. 347, 13
*VIII, 4, p. 347, 16	kulli B D Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ lat Ğ Ṣ M
*VIII, 4, p. 348, 8	huwa B Ğ Ṣ	om. D	**maʿnā** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ[216] Āmulī lat (est intentio) M
*VIII, 4, p. 348, 8	lahū Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ[217] lat
*VIII, 4, p. 348, 10	wuğūduhū Ṭ Āmulī		**wuğūdun** add. 125 P110 L lat (est esse) B Ğ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 4, p. 348, 11	ğinsiyyatahū Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ		**ğinsiyyatan** P125 P110 L Ṭ?[218] lat (esse genus) D M
*VIII, 5, p. 349, 9	tawkīdun Āmulī	affirmatur lat	**taʾkīdun** P125 P110 L Ṭ[219] B Ğ D Ṣ M

[215] In c, Ṭ is reported as omitting the edited reading.
[216] In c, Ṭ is reported as omitting the edited reading.
[217] This reading is not reported in c.
[218] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.
[219] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VIII, 5, p. 349, 18	illā Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ	bi-sababi D	**om.** P125 P110 L lat B M
*VIII, 5, p. 350, 3	al-wāğibi l-wuğūdu l-wāḥidu	wāğibi l-wuğūdi al-wāğibu l-wuğūdi l-wāḥidi P110; al-wāğībi l-wuğūdi li-wāğibi l-wuğūdi l-wāḥidi L Āmulī; de necesse esse est uni tantum quod est necesse esse	**wāğibi l-wuğūdi li-wāğibi l-wuğūdi l-wāḥidi** P125 Ṭ[220]
*VIII, 5, p. 350, 14	yuḫālifuhū Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ		**yuḫālifu** P125 P110 L lat (differat) B D M
*VIII, 5, p. 351, 4	bi-l-ḥaqīqati Āmulī B		**wa-l-ḥaqīqati** P125 P110 L? Ṭ lat (et certitudinis) Ğ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 5, p. 351, 9	faṣlan P125 Āmulī		**faḍlan** P110 L Ṭ[221] Āmulī[1] lat (superflua)
*VIII, 5, p. 351, 9	šarṭi Ṭ Āmulī Ṣ M		**om.** P125 P110 L lat B Ğ D
*VIII, 5, p. 352, 15	al-lawniyyati D		**lawniyyatan** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ[222] Āmulī lat (esse coloritatem) B Ğ Ṣ M
*VIII, 5, p. 353, 10	ka-šay'in B D M		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat Ğ Ṣ
*VIII, 5, p. 354, 6	ẓāhirun B		**aẓharu** P125

[220] This reading is not reported in c.
[221] This reading is not reported in c.
[222] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *lawn* (*-iyyatan* of *lawniyyatan* is written above the line).

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
			P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (manifestior) Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 5, p. 354, 8	šarṭun maʿa mā Ǧ	šarṭiyā P125	**šarṭu mā** P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (condicio eius quod) B D Ṣ M
*VIII, 5, p. 354, 13	mabdaʾu Ṭ Āmulī Ṣ		**om.** P125 P110 lat B D Ǧ M
*VIII, 6, p. 355, 7	yūǧadu Ǧ Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L Ṭ lat B D Ṣ M
*VIII, 6, p. 355, 13	ilayhi Ṭs.l. Āmulī Ṣ		**om.** P125 P110 L B Ǧ D M
*VIII, 6, p. 355, 16	li-ḥāli l-ǧawhari Ṭ Āmulī	dispositionis substantiae lat	**hālin li-ǧawharin** P125 P110 L
*VIII, 6, p. 356, 3	bi-d̲ātihī fa-d̲ātuhū	bi-d̲ātihī bal annahū P125; bi-d̲ātihī fa-d̲ātuhū bi-d̲ātihī P110 L Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ Ṭ (bi-d̲ātihī[2] s.l.)[223]	**fa-d̲ātuhū bi-d̲ātihī** lat (quia ipsum per se) M
*VIII, 6, p. 357, 10	bi-ʿtibārin[1–2] Ǧ		**bi-ʿtibārika** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (secundum considerationem tuam) B D Ṣ M
*VIII, 6, p. 357, 17	mutaḥarrikan ʿan d̲ātihī Āmulī[1] Ṣ	yataḥarraku bi-d̲ātihī Nağāt	**muḥarrikan li-d̲ātihī** P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D M
*VIII, 6, p. 357, 19	muṭlaqan Ṭ Āmulī	ʿanhu Nağāt	**om.** P125 P110 L lat B Ǧ D Ṣ M

[223] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VIII, 6, p. 358, 1	iṯnayniyyatuhā P110 L Ṭ Āmulī		**inniyyatuhā** P125 Ṭcorr.i.l. Naǧāt lat (anitas) B Ǧ D Ṣ M[224]
*VIII, 6, p. 358, 11	taḥṣīlu L Āmulī Naǧāt M		**yuḥaṣṣilu** P125 P110 Ṭ lat (acquiritur) B Ǧ D Ṣ
*VIII, 6, p. 359, 3	wa-min Ṭ Āmulī	wa-bi Naǧāt	**min** P125 P110 L lat
*VIII, 6, p. 359, 3	lā Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt Ǧ M	fa-lā B D Ṣ	**wa-lā** P125 P110 L lat (non . . . autem)
*VIII, 6, p. 360, 10	al-šay'i Naǧāt B Ǧ D Ṣ M	al-maʿnā P125; al-šay'i al-šaḫṣi L	**al-šaḫṣi** P110 Ṭ Āmulī lat (individui)
°VIII, 6, p. 361, 15	al-ʿaqdu		**al-ʿaqlu**
°VIII, 6, p. 362, 1	qabalī		**qabla**
*VIII, 6, p. 362, 2	asbābihā Āmulī D M		**al-asbābi** P125 P110 L Ṭ Naǧāt lat (causas) B Ǧ Ṣ
*VIII, 6, p. 362, 8	kulli šay'in Ṭ Āmulī		**šay'in** P125 L Naǧāt lat (alterius rei) B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 6, p. 362, 8	wa-yaʿlamu . . . ḥālihā Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L Naǧāt lat B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*VIII, 6, p. 362, 8	id̲ huwa mabdaʾu šay'in Ṭ Āmulī	huwa mabdaʾu šay'in wa-huwa mabdaʾu šay'in P110; huwa mabdaʾu šay'in huwa mabdaʾu šay'in L; li-	**fa-huwa mabdaʾu šay'in huwa mabdaʾu šay'in** P125

[224] The apparatus of c reports *inniyyatuhā* as the edited reading, and *iṯnayniyyatuhā* as the reading of mss. B Ǧ D Ṣ M. Van Riet is probably right in taking *inniyyatuhā* as the reading of B Ǧ D Ṣ M, since Ṭ (which has *iṯnayniyyatuhā* as its main reading) is not mentioned together with them in the apparatus.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
		annahū mabda'u šay'in huwa mabda'u šay'in Naǧāt; wa-huwa mabda'u šayin lat (et illa altera principium alterius)	
*VIII, 6, p. 362, 9	al-tafṣīli D		**allaḏī lā tafṣīla** add. P125 P110 L Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt lat ([post quod] non sequitur aliud) B Ǧ Ṣ M
*VIII, 6, p. 362, 10–11	allatī . . . al-ḥakīmu Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 P110 L Naǧāt lat B D Ǧ Ṣ M
*VIII, 7, p. 363, 14	wa-ḫayrin D	non legitur P125	**ḫayrin** L Ṭ Āmulī lat (bonitatis) B Ǧ Ṣ M
°VIII, 7, p. 363, 16	yaǧliba		**yaǧlibuhū**
*VIII, 7, p. 364, 2	minhā Ǧ Ṣ		**minhu** P125 L? Ṭ Āmulī lat (per hoc) B D M
*VIII, 7, p. 364, 9	al-iḍāfatu B Ṣ		**lahū** add. P125 L lat (eius) Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D M
*VIII, 7, p. 365, 16	al-ṣuwaru Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ	li-l-ṣūrati P125	**li-l-ṣuwari** L Ṭ lat (in ideas) lat
*VIII, 7, p. 366, 7	li-yattaḍiḥa Ṭ Āmulī	yatafattahū P125 M; et aperietur lat; li-yastaftaḥa Ṣ; li-yantaǧa D	**li-yatafattaḥa** L B Ǧ
*VIII, 7, p. 366, 7	yattaḍiḥa Ṭ[225] Āmulī M	yantaǧa D	**yatafattaḥa** P125 L lat (aperiri) B Ǧ Ṣ

[225] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *yatafattaḥa*.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*VIII, 7, p. 366, 18	al-ṣuwaru Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ	non legitur P125	**al-ṣūratu** L Nağāt lat (forma) D M
*VIII, 7, p. 366, 19	al-ṣuwaru L Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ M	non legitur P125	**al-ṣūratu** Nağāt lat (illam formam)
*VIII, 7, p. 366, 19	ṣuwaruhā	ṣuwaran hiya P125 L Āmulī Nağāt M; ṣuwarun B Ğ D Ṣ;	**ṣuwarun hiya** Ṭ[226] lat (formae essent)
*VIII, 7, p. 367, 4	al-ṣuwari D		**al-ṣūrati** P125 Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (formae [gen.]) B Ğ Ṣ M
*VIII, 7, p. 367, 8	bi-ʿaynihī huwa Ṭ Āmulī		**huwa bi-ʿaynihī** P125 L Nağāt lat (est ipsa eadem) B Ğ D Ṣ M
°VIII, 7, p. 367, 13	al-maʿtā		**al-maʿnā**
VIII, 7, p. 368, 14	min[2]		**kulli** add. P125 L Ṭ[227] Āmulī Nağāt lat (omni)
*VIII, 7, p. 368, 15	wa-bahāʾu kulli šayʾin D	wa-bahāʾu kulli šayin wa-ğamālu kulli šayʾin Āmulī; wa-kamālu kulli šayʾin Ğ	**wa-ğamālu kulli šayʾin** P125 L Ṭ Nağāt lat (pulchritudo autem) B Ṣ M
*IX, 1, p. 373, 6	ğamīʿi al-wuğūhi Ṭ (ğamīʿi s.l.) Āmulī		**wuğūhin** P125 L Nağāt lat (multis modis) B Ğ D Ṣ M
*IX, 1, p. 374, 2	ʿillatā B Ğ Ṣ M		**ʿillatāhū** P125 L Ṭ[228] Āmulī Nağāt lat (eius . . . duae causae) D

[226] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.
[227] This reading is not reported in c.
[228] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 1, p. 375, 2	aw Ṭ Ǧ Ṣ	longinquius (= abʿad?) add. lat	**baʿuda** add. P125 L Āmulī Nağāt B D M
*IX, 1, p. 375, 8	al-lāḥiqati Ṭs.l. Āmulī		**om.** P125 L Nağāt B Ǧ D Ṣ M
°IX, 1, p. 376, 13	ṯābiṯun		**ṯābitun**
°IX, 1, p. 376, 16	wa-anna		**wa-in**
*IX, 1, p. 377, 4	mumayyizin Ṭ Ǧ Ṣ	tamayyuzin L Nağāt; congoscere lat	**tamyīzin** P125 Āmulī B D M (cf. targīḥin, p. 377, 4)
*IX, 1, p. 378, 1	al-muwāfiqata Ǧ M	al-muwaffaqata B D Ṣ; al-mūğibata Āmulī; quae facit debere lat	**al-muwaqqiʿata** P125 L Ṭ[229] Nağāt
°IX, 1, p. 378, 11	ن		**an**
*IX, 1, p. 378, 11	ʿan ġayri Ǧ	ʿan P125 lat (ex)	**ġayri** L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt B D Ṣ M
*IX, 1, p. 379, 18	ḥāṣilun baʿda l-ḫulqi Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 L Nağāt lat B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*IX, 1, p. 380, 12	bi-qadri Ṭ Āmulī	بعد ر P125	**tuqaddaru** L Nağāt lat (essent mensurata)
*IX, 1, p. 380, 12	awqātin Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ D Ṣ		**awqātihī** P125 L Ṭcorr.s.l.[230] Nağāt lat (cuius horae) M
*IX, 1, p. 380, 12	wa-azmanatin Ṭ Āmulī		**wa-azmanatihī** P125 L Ṭcorr.s.l.[231] Nağāt lat (cuius . . . tempora) B Ǧ D Ṣ M

[229] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *al-muwaffaqata*.
[230] This reading is not reported in c.
[231] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 1, p. 380, 12	tantahī Ṭ Āmulī	سهى P125	**yantahī** L Nağāt lat (quod duraret . . . et cessaret)
*IX, 1, p. 381, 5	wa-l-buṭ'i wa- Ṭ (wa-l-buṭ'i s.l.) Āmulī	wa- B Ğ D Ṣ M	**om.** P125 L Nağāt
*IX, 1, p. 381, 7	šay'in Ğ Ṣ	naṣifuhū Ṭcorr.s.l.	**bi-ṣifatin** add. P125 L (šay'in mg.) Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (alicuius proprietatis) B D M
*IX, 1, p. 381, 10	al-ḥarakātu Ṭadd.s.l. Āmulī Ğ Ṣ	motus (sg.) lat	**om.** P125 L Nağāt lat B D M
*IX, 2, p. 382, 14	tilka Ṭ Āmulī		**d̲ālika kulla** P125 L Nağāt
*IX, 2, p. 383, 12	ḥarakatin Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ		**ḥarakatihī** P125 L Nağāt lat (motus caeli) B D M
*IX, 2, p. 383, 12	ṭabīʿiyyatin Ṭ Āmulī Ğ Ṣ	طبعه L; ṭabʿahū B; om. D	**ṭabīʿatan** P125 Nağāt lat (natura) M
*IX, 2, p. 383, 16	wa-awḍaḥnā Ṭ Āmulī	id̲ā awḍaḥnā B Ğ D Ṣ; cum loquebamur lat	**id̲ awḍaḥnā** P125 L Nağāt M
*IX, 2, p. 384, 17	fa-yağību B Ğ D Ṣ		**fa-yağūzu** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (potest esse ut) M
*IX, 2, p. 384, 18	intiqālahū Āmulī D Ṣ		**intiqālan** P125 L Ṭ Nağāt lat (permutationem) B Ğ M[232]

[232] In the apparatus of c, B Ğ M, together with Ṭ, are reported as having a reading different from the edited one, but this reading—which in fact is *intiqālan*, as it appears from the inspection of Ṭ—is mistakenly written as identical to the edited one.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 2, p. 385, 2	mawhūmin D		**marsūmin** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt lat (descripta) B Ǧ Ṣ M
IX, 2, p. 385, 12	wuǧūduhū		**ʿanhu** add. P125 L Ṭs.l.[233] Āmulī Naǧāt lat (ab eo)
*IX, 2, p. 386, 1–2	wa-laysa . . . al-ǧīm L Āmulī Naǧāt lat D Ṣ M		**om.** P125 Ṭ B Ǧ; cf. wa-lā . . . al-ǧīm p. 386, 4–5
*IX, 2, p. 386, 14	al-qarībati P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt		**al-qarību** lat (propinquum [principium]); cf. p. 386, 10
*IX, 2, p. 387, 14	fa-hiya hiya D M	fa-huwa Naǧāt	**fa-hiya** P125 L Naǧāt[1] Ṭ Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ
˚IX, 2, p. 388, 11	لأ . . . ن		**li-anna**
*IX, 2, p. 389, 7	kamālan Naǧāt		**ka-mā** P125 L Ṭ[234] Āmulī lat (ad modum)
*IX, 2, p. 389, 10	al-ǧawhara L Naǧāt Ǧ D Ṣ M		**al-ǧirma** P125 Ṭ Āmulī lat (corporis) B; cf. p. 389, 13; p. 390, 3
*IX, 2, p. 389, 11	yaʿqilu L Ṭ Āmulī	يعفلP125; intelligit lat	**taʿqilu** Naǧāt
*IX, 2, p. 389, 11	fa-yasnaḥu Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt	فيسيح P125; فسيح L; fa-yasīḥu Naǧāt[1] lat (fluit)	**fa-yusayyiḥu**
*IX, 2, p. 389, 13	yasnaḥu Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt	يسيح P125 L; fa-yasīḥu lat (fluit)	**yusayyiḥu**

[233] This reading is not reported in c.
[234] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
IX, 2, p. 389, 15	wa-innahū	quod lat	**fa-innahū** P125 L Ṭ[235] Āmulī Naǧāt
*IX, 2, p. 390, 3	li-l-ǧawhari Ṭ Āmulī D		**li-l-ǧirmi** P125 L Naǧāt lat (corpori) B Ǧ Ṣ M; cf. p. 389, 13; p. 389, 10
IX, 2, p. 390, 7	aw		**wa-** P125 L Ṭ[236] Āmulī Naǧāt lat (et)
IX, 2, p. 390, 9	mufīdun	ab illo fluunt lat	**mufiḍun** P125 L Ṭ[237] Āmulī Naǧāt
*IX, 2, p. 391, 1	al-maqṣūda B		**om.** P125 L Ṭ Naǧāt lat Ǧ D Ṣ M
*IX, 2, p. 391, 13	yasnaḥu Āmulī Naǧāt Ǧ D Ṣ	sanaḥa P125; proveniet lat; fa-yasnaḥu Ṭ; fa-sanaḥa B M	**fa-yasīḥu** L; cf. p. 389, 11; p. 389, 13
*IX, 2, p. 391, 13	yuḥarriku P125 Ṭ Āmulī		**yataḥarriku** L Naǧāt lat (moventur)
*IX, 2, p. 391, 13	yuḥarriku D		**lahū** add. P125 Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt lat (propter quam) B Ǧ Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 393, 8	wa-mušawwaqun Ṭ Āmulī	wa-mutaṣawwaqā L; et desideratum lat; yatašawwaqu B; maʿšūqun Ǧ	**wa-mutašawwaqun** P125 Naǧāt D Ṣ M; cf. mutašawwaqun, p. 392, 9, p. 393, 2; al-mutašawwaqāt p. 393, 9

[235] This reading is not reported in c.
[236] This reading is not reported in c.
[237] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 3, p. 393, 15	al-maʿšūqati Ṭcorr.s.l.[238] D		**al-mutašawwaqati** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī lat (desideratis) B Ǧ Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 394, 5	fa-li-ḫtilāfi Āmulī D	fa-yaḫtalifu Ṭ Ǧ Ṣ	**fa-li-yaḫtalifa** P125 L Naǧāt lat (ut . . . differat) B M
*IX, 3, p. 394, 7	ilayhi Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt[1]		**lahū ilayhi** P125 L Naġāt B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 394, 11	li-yantafiʿa Ṭ Āmulī B D Ṣ	li-nafʿi Ṭcorr.s.l.	**li-yanfaʿa** P125 L Naǧāt lat (ut prosit) Ǧ M
*IX, 4, p. 394, 16	maṣīra Āmulī Ǧ Ṣ	om. Naǧāt M	**yaṣīra** P125 Ṭ Ladd.mg. lat (est) B D
*IX, 3, p. 398, 5	lahū Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt[1]		**om.** P125 L Naǧāt lat
*IX, 3, p. 398, 6	bi-hāḏihi Ǧ		**hāḏihi** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt lat (hic) B D Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 398, 13	lā Āmulī		**illā** P125 L Ṭ[239] Naǧāt lat (nisi) B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 399, 10	al-qawmu D	lac P125; القدم Naǧāt B Ǧ Ṣ M; القدم Ṭcorr. s.l.;[240] al-muqaddimu L; al-fadm Ṭ[241] Āmulī; unus ex praecipuis lat	**al-qudm** Gutas [1988], p. 292 n. a

[238] This reading is not reported in c.
[239] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.
[240] In c, this is reported as the main reading of Ṭ.
[241] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 3, p. 400, 2	basāṭatihī Ṭ Āmulī B Ṣ	al-ṭabʿi basāṭatihī M	**al-ṭabʿi** P125 L Ṭcorr.s.l.[242] Nağāt lat (naturam) Ǧ D
*IX, 3, p. 400, 3	taqbalu Āmulī D	نفعل P125 L; yafʿalu Ṭ B Ǧ Ṣ M	**tafʿalu** Nağāt lat (quae faciat)
*IX, 3, p. 400, 4	ṭabīʿatuhū Āmulī B Ǧ Ṣ M	ṭabīʿiyyun lat (naturale); ṭabʿuhū D	**ṭabīʿatun** P125 L Ṭ Nağāt
*IX, 3, p. 400, 13–14	wa-illā . . . al-inqitāʿu Āmulī Ǧ	et ibi quiescant lat	**om.** P125 L Ṭ Nağāt B D Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 400, 14	lā yūṣalu ilayhi Āmulī Ǧ		**om.** P125 L Ṭ Nağāt lat B D Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 400, 17	minhā Ǧ		**šawqun** add. P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (desiderium) B D Ṣ M
*IX, 3, p. 400, 17	iḫtilāfuhā L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt B Ǧ D Ṣ	iḫtilāfan M	**om.** P125 lat
*IX, 3, p. 400, 17	allaḏī L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt		**allatī** P125
*IX, 3, p. 401, 17	al-riyāḍāti Ṭ Āmulī		**al-riyāḍiyyāti** P125 L Nağāt
*IX, 4, p. 402, 3	al-ʿaqli lat (intelligentiae [gen.])		**al-ʿuqūli** P125 L Ṭ[243] Āmulī Nağāt
*IX, 4, p. 402, 11	in Āmulī	ان P125; ان L Ṭ Nağāt; anna Mabdaʾ; ratio est haec scilicet quia lat	**iḏ**
*IX, 4, p. 402, 11	takaṯṯurihī Āmulī Ǧ	takṯīri L?	**takaṯṯuri** P125 Ṭ Nağāt lat (multitudinem) B D Ṣ M

[242] This reading is not reported in c.
[243] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 4, p. 403, 7	wāḥidan D M		**maʿan** add. P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (simul) B Ğ Ṣ
*IX, 4, p. 403, 11	wa-ʿalā L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt		**ʿalā** P125 lat
*IX, 4, p. 404, 3	lahū Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125 L Nağāt lat B Ğ D Ṣ M
*IX, 4, p. 404, 5	wāḥidatun D	وحده P125 L Ṭ B Ğ Ṣ M	**waḥdatun** Nağāt lat (est unitas)
*IX, 4, p. 404, 11	ṯāliyatan Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt[1]		**ṯāliṯatan** P125 L Nağāt lat (tertia)
*IX, 4, p. 404, 14	ṯābitan Tcorr.s.l.? Āmulī lat (stabilis)	ثاسا P125	**ṯāniyan** L Ṭ Nağāt; cf. al-ṯānī p. 404, 16
*IX, 4, p. 405, 13	lā iṯnayniyyata fīhā Ṭ Āmulī Ṣ		**om.** P125 L Nağāt lat B D Ğ M
*IX, 4, p. 406, 4	li-wuğūbi wuğūdihī D Āmulī[1] Nağāt[1]	li-wuğūdi waḥdatihī L lat (esse suae unitatis)	**li-wuğūbi waḥdatihī** P125 Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt B Ğ Ṣ M
*IX, 4, p. 407, 1	ğihatin talzamu ʿanhu Ṣ	ğihatayhi talzamu ʿanhu Āmulī; ğihatin Nağāt[1] D; ğihatihī L lat (modum suum) B Ğ	**ğihatayhi** P125 Ṭ Nağāt M
*IX, 4, p. 407, 1	al-kaṯratu Ṭcorr.s.l. Āmulī Nağāt		**al-kuratu** P125 L Ṭ[244] lat (sphaera)
*IX, 4, p. 407, 15	yataḥarriku Ğ	يحرك P125 L	**yuḥarriku** Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (moveret) B D Ṣ M

[244] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 4, p. 407, 15	ʿalā D M		**illā ʿalā** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt lat (nisi ad [modum]) B Ǧ Ṣ
*IX, 4, p. 408, 14	ʿan P125 Ṭ Āmulī		**ʿalā** L Naǧāt B Ǧ D Ṣ M
*IX, 4, p. 409, 10	awwalin[2] Āmulī D		**om.** P125 L Ṭ Naǧāt lat B Ǧ Ṣ M
*IX, 5, p. 412, 9	li-ṭabīʿati Ṭ		**li-l-ṭabīʿati** P125 L Āmulī Naǧāt
*IX, 5, p. 412, 14	bi-l-kamāli D M		**ka-l-kamāli** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt lat (quasi perfectio) B Ǧ Ṣ
*IX, 5, p. 413, 1	hāḏā l-ʿilm Ṭ Āmulī	ahli hāḏā l-ʿilmi B; al-ʿilmi Ǧ Ṣ.	**ahli l-ʿilmi** P125 Ṭcorr.sl.l.[245] Mabdaʾ Naǧāt lat ([ex] philosophantibus) Gutas [1988], p. 292, n. 28, D M
IX, 5, p. 413, 4	ḥarāratan Āmulī D	ḥarrun B Ǧ Ṣ M; calidum lat	**ḥarran** P125 L Ṭ[246] Naǧāt; cf. ḥarr p. 413, 5
*IX, 5, p. 413, 10	yatahayyaʾu Ṭ Āmulī Ṣ	aptitudo lat; tahayyuʾatun D	**yuhayyiʾuhū** P125 L Naǧāt B Ǧ M
*IX, 5, p. 414, 1	al-ḥarakāti al-mutatābiʿata Ǧ	al-ḥarakata al-mutatābiʿata Āmulī; p. 414, 1 om. P125 Naǧāt	**al-ḥarakata al-mutābiʿata** L Ṭ lat ([illius] motus consequentis) B D Ṣ M
*IX, 5, p. 414, 8	fawqa[2] Āmulī	sursum lat	**ilā fawqa** P125 L Ṭ[247] Naǧāt

[245] This reading is not reported in c.
[246] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *ḥarrun*.
[247] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 6, p. 414, 16	wa-bayān wa-kayfiyya Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ	wa-kayfiyya L Ṭ M	**wa-bayān kayfiyya** P125 Nağāt lat (et ostensione quomodo)
*IX, 6, p. 414, 17	wa-lā šakka D	wa-lā yašukku Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ M; wa-lā tašukku lat (non dubitas)	**wa-lā našukku** P125? L Nağāt
*IX, 6, p. 415, 9	yakūnu B		**hunāka** add. P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (in quibus) Ğ D Ṣ M
*IX, 6, p. 416, 1	bal M	šarrun add. L Ṭ[248] B Ğ; malum add. lat; om. S	**šarran** add. P125 Āmulī Nağāt D
°IX, 6, p. 416, 6	muftaḍā		**muqtaḍā**
*IX, 6, p. 416, 7	al-maʿdūmu Ṭ (و scr. s.l.) Nağāt[1] lat (privatum) B D M	al-ʿadam L Ğ	**al-muʿdimu** P125 Āmulī Nağāt Ṣ
°IX, 6, p. 416, 15	al-naqwīma		**al-taqwīma**
*IX, 6, p. 417, 13	al-iṣlāḥi Ṭ Ğ D Ṣ	لاصلاح P125 L Ṭcorr. Āmulī; al-aṣlāḥi Nağāt; li-aṣlāḥa B M	**lā ṣalāḥa**
*IX, 6, p. 418, 4	iḥtirāquhū Ṣ Āmulī lat ([deberet] aduri)		**iḥrāquhū** P125 L Ṭ Nağāt B Ğ D M
IX, 6, p. 418, 8	šarran		**šarrun** P125 L Ṭ[249] Āmulī Nağāt
IX, 6, p. 419, 7	al-iʿdāma[250]	الاعدام P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt; li-l-aʿdāmi D	**al-aʿdāma** lat (privationes)

[248] In c, Ṭ is reported as omitting the edited reading.
[249] This reading is not reported in c.
[250] In the apparatus of c, *iʿdāman* is reported as the edited reading.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 6, p. 420, 1	fī Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ D Ṣ		**om.** P125 L Nağāt lat M
˚IX, 6, p. 420, 17	li-aġrāḍi		**li-aʿrāḍi**
*IX, 6, p. 421, 1	muqtaḍan Ṭ Nağāt[1] Ğ D Ṣ		**maqḍīyun** P125 L Āmulī Nağāt lat (iudicatum) B M
*IX, 6, p. 421, 2	muqtaḍan Nağāt[1] Ğ Ṣ M		**maqḍiyyun** P125 L Ṭ[251] Āmulī Nağāt lat (iudicatum) B D
*IX, 6, p. 421, 3	kaṯīran Āmulī[1] M	multa lat	**kaṯratan** P125 Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt B Ğ D Ṣ
*IX, 6, p. 421, 5–6	iḏā tuwahhimat mawğūdatan Āmulī Ṣ	iḏā turassimat mawğūdatan wuğūduhā L; wuğūduhā iḏā tuwahhimat mawğūdatan Ṭ D; iḏā tuwahhimat mawğūdatan wuğūduhā Nağāt M; tuwahhimat mawğūdatan wuğūduhā Ğ;	**wuğūduhā** P125 B lat (quarum esse)
*IX, 6, p. 421, 17	al-faqīri[1–2] Ṭ Āmulī		**al-faqīhi** P125 L Nağāt lat (alicuius iusti)
*IX, 6, p. 421, 17	wa-kāna Āmulī Ṣ	iḏā kāna L; eo quod lat; aw kāna M	**iḏ kāna** P125 Ṭ Nağāt B Ğ D
IX, 6, p. 421, 18	ḥazakātu šay'in		**ḥarakātun šattā**
*IX, 7, p. 423, 4	manqūlun Ṭ Āmulī		**maqbūlun** P125 L Ṭcorr.i.l.[252] Nağāt lat (recipitur) B Ğ D Ṣ M

[251] This reading is not reported in c.
[252] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 7, p. 423, 9	hāhunā D		**minnā** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (nostrae) B Ğ Ṣ M
*IX, 7, p. 423, 12	wa-hiya ʿalā[253]	ʿalā L; sicut lat	**wa-ʿalā** P125 Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt
*IX, 7, p. 424, 1	bi-muwāfaqatihā Ṭ Āmulī		**bi-muwāfiqihā** P125 L Nağāt lat (suum conveniens)
*IX, 7, p. 424, 2	wa-mulāʾamatihā Ṭ Āmulī		**wa-mulāʾimihā** P125 L Nağāt lat (et sibi aptum)
°IX, 7, p. 425, 7	ممنوه		**mamnuwwatan**
*IX, 7, p. 426, 4	al-ḥaqqa al-muṭlaqa Ṭ Āmulī	al-muṭlaqa B Ğ	**al-ḥaqqa** P125 L Nağāt lat (verus) D Ṣ M
*IX, 7, p. 427, 2	wa-nisbatu[2] Ṭ	sicut comparatio lat (= ka-nisbati?)	**nisbatu** P125 L Āmulī Nağāt
IX, 7, p. 427, 3	bi-našqi		**bi-tanaššuqi** P125 L Ṭ[254] Āmulī Nağāt
°IX, 7, p. 427, 7	al-muʿaziḍata		**al-muʿariḍata**
°IX, 7, p. 427, 7	taġyīri		**taʿyīri**
*IX, 7, p. 427, 8	tuʾaṯṯaru hiya wa-aḍdādu(hā) B M	tuʾaṯṯaru baʿḍuhā aw aḍdādu baʿḍihā L; tuʾaṯṯaru baʿḍuhā wa-aḍdādu baʿḍihā Ṭ Ğ Ṣ; baʿḍuhā wa-aḍdādu baʿḍihā tuʾaṯṯaru Āmulī D; fa-baʿḍuhā aw aḍdādu baʿḍihā tuʾaṯṯaru Nağāt; quarum contraria praeponunt lat	**tuʾaṯṯaru hiya aw aḍdāduhā** P125

[253] In c, the omission of *hiya* in Ṭ B Ğ D Ṣ is refered to l. 11 instead of l. 12.
[254] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 7, p. 427, 9	al-nafsi lat (animae [dat.]) D M		**al-anfusi** P125 L Ṭ[255] Āmulī Naǧāt B Ǧ Ṣ
*IX, 7, p. 427, 9	min[2] Naǧāt[1]		**fī** P125 L Ṭ[256] Āmulī Naǧāt lat (in)
*IX, 7, p. 427, 10–11	al-bahiyyati Ṭ Āmulī	excellentioribus . . . excellentibus lat	**al-nabīhati** P125 L Naǧāt
*IX, 7, p. 427, 10	al-nafsa Ṭ Āmulī M		**al-anfusa** P125 Naǧāt lat (animae [nom.]) B Ǧ D Ṣ
*IX, 7, p. 427, 14	al-marḍū L Āmulī Naǧāt B M	al-maraḍiyyu Ṭ Ǧ D Ṣ	**al-marīḍu** P125 lat (infirmus)
*IX, 7, p. 428, 1	li-l-ittiṣāli Āmulī Ṣ M	et etiam corruptioni add. lat	**wa-tabdīluhā** add. P125 L Ṭ Naǧāt B Ǧ D
*IX, 7, p. 428, 1	miṯlunā L Āmulī Naǧāt B Ǧ M		**miṯluhā** P125 Ṭ D Ṣ; cf. miṯluhā p. 428, 5
*IX, 7, p. 428, 18	al-tāmmi Ṭ Āmulī		**al-tamāma** P125 L Naǧāt lat (perfectionem)
*IX, 7, p. 429, 10	aǧzā'in Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ Ṣ M		**aǧzā'ihī** P125 L Naǧāt lat (suarum partium) B D
*IX, 7, p. 430, 1	al-tawassuṭi wa-malakatu l-tawassuṭi malakatun B Ǧ D Ṣ M	malakata Ṭ	**malakata l-tawassuṭi wa-malakatu l-tawassuṭi** P125 L Āmulī Naǧāt lat (habitus mediocritatis; habitus autem mediocritatis)

[255] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.
[256] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*IX, 7, p. 430, 3	wa-l-infiʿāli L Naǧāt[1] lat (patiendi)	اللانفحال P125	**wa-l-lā-infiʿāli** Ṭ[257] Āmulī Naǧāt Van Riet (non patiendi)
°IX, 7, p. 430, 7	قويه L	qawiyya P125	**qawiyyata** Naǧāt
*IX, 7, p. 431, 9	lahā Ṭs.l. Āmulī Ǧ M		**om.** P125 L Naǧāt lat B D Ṣ
*IX, 7, p. 431, 14	ḏālika fī anfusihim min ḏālika Ṣ M	min ḏālika fī anfusihim L Ṭcorr.;[258] ḏālika fī anfusihim Ṭ B Ǧ D	**fī anfusihim min ḏālika** P125 Āmulī Naǧāt lat (in animabus eorum de hac)
°IX, 7, p. 431, 16	hay'ṯātihim		**hay'ātihim**
*IX, 7, p. 431, 17	min[1] Āmulī M		**fī** P125 L Ṭ[259] Naǧāt B Ǧ D Ṣ
*IX, 7, p. 432, 14	bi-kamālātihā Ṭ Āmulī M		**bi-kamālihā** 125 L Naǧāt lat (suae perfectioni) B Ǧ D Ṣ
*IX, 7, p. 432, 17	wa-tazūlu Ṭs.l. Āmulī M	et tunc consequetur illum lat	**om.** P125 L Naǧāt B Ǧ D Ṣ
*X, 1, p. 435, 4	wa-l-munāmāti Ṭ Āmulī M		**om.** P125 L Naǧāt lat B Ǧ D Ṣ
*X, 1, p. 435, 12	al-nabātātu Ṭ Āmulī M	al-nāmiyātu L Naǧāt B Ǧ D Ṣ	**al-nabātiyyātu** P125 lat (vegetabilia)
*X, 1, p. 435, 15	hāḏā[2] Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt		**om.** P125 L lat
*X, 1, p. 436, 5	al-samāwiyyati[1] Ṭ Āmulī Naǧāt[1] Ǧ D Ṣ M		**om.** P125 L Naǧāt lat B

[257] This reading is not reported in c.
[258] This reading is not reported in c.
[259] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*X, 1 p. 436, 6	fīhā Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt	minhā P125 B; ex viribus terrenis lat	**ʿanhā** L; cf. ʿanhā p. 436, 9
*X, 1, p. 436, 10	fīhā Āmulī D Ṣ M	minhā B	**fīhi** P125 L Ṭ Nağāt lat (in eo) Ǧ
*X, 1, p. 436, 13	al-ṯāniyu Ṣ M		**al-ṯāliṯu** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (tertius) B Ǧ D
*X, 1, p. 437, 7	bi-ḥasabi Ṣ M		**taḥta** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (sub) B Ǧ D
*X, 1, p. 437, 10	bi-l-ğuz'iyyāti Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ D Ṣ M		**om.** P125 L Nağāt lat B
*X, 1, p. 437, 11	lā B Ǧ D M		**wa-lā** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (et) Ṣ
*X, 1, p. 437, 11	ʿalā l-waǧhi D M	om. lat	**al-waǧha** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt B Ǧ Ṣ
*X, 1, p. 437, 17	ḏālika Ṭ Āmulī Ǧ Ṣ M		**al-amri** add. P125 L Nağāt lat (rem) B D
*X, 1, p. 438, 1	kāna D M		**id kāna** add. P125 Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (cum . . . fuerit) B Ǧ Ṣ
*X, 1, p. 438, 2	huwa yūğidu Āmulī	huwa (an) yūğida lat (est faciens esse)	**huwa an yūğida** P125 L Ṭ[260] Nağāt
^X, 1, p. 438, 12	qulnā : innahū		**qulnā innahū**
*X, 1, p. 438, 14	al-mukāfātu[1] (pl.) L Ṭ		**al-mukāfātu** (sg.) P125 Āmulī Nağāt
*X, 1, p. 438, 14	al-mukāfātu[2] (pl.) Ṭ		**al-mukāfātu** (sg.) P125 L Āmulī Nağāt

[260] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*X, 1, p. 438, 17	šarrun Ṭ Nağāt	سر P125 L	**sirrun** Āmulī lat (secretum)
*X, 1, p. 439, 4	yuṣaddaqu Ǧ D M		**fa-ṣaddiq** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (crede) B Ṣ
*X, 1, p. 440, 14	la-nā Ṭs.l.[261] M		**om.** P125 L Āmulī Nağāt B Ǧ D Ṣ
*X, 2, p. 441, 8	يتحذ	yattaḫiḏu L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (afferat)	**yaḥuddu** P125
*X, 2, p. 441, 10	yataḥayyalu L B Ṣ M	سحيل P125; muḫabbalun Ṭ; muğabbalun Āmulī; mutaḥayyilun Ǧ; muḥabbalun D	**yataḫayyalu** Nağāt lat (videntur)
*X, 2, p. 442, 4	al-ḫayri Ṭ Āmulī B M	rerum (= al-umūri?) lat	**al-amri** P125 L Nağāt Ǧ D Ṣ
*X, 2, p. 442, 19	wa-yaqaʿū Ṭ Āmulī	fa-yaqaʿū lat (ideo incident)	**aw yaqaʿū** P125 L Nağāt
X, 2, p. 443, 2	insānin		**al-sānni** P125 L Ṭ[262] Āmulī Nağāt lat (legislatori)
X, 2, p. 443, 2	insānun		**al-sānnu** P125 L Ṭ[263] Āmulī Nağāt lat (legislator)
*X, 3, p. 444, 3	baṭala Nağāt[1] B M	muṭṭila Ṭ Āmulī; muṭilā D; sit umbra (= bi-ẓilli?) lat	**muṭila** P125 L Nağāt Ǧ Ṣ
*X, 3, p. 444, 12	annahū D Ṣ M	fa-innahū Ṭ Ǧ	**wa-annahū** P125 L Āmulī Nağāt lat (et quia) B

[261] This reading is not reported in c.
[262] This reading is not reported in c.
[263] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*X, 3, p. 445, 4	wa-l-tanẓīfi Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt Ğ D Ṣ M		**wa-l-tanaẓẓufi** P125 L lat (decore) B
*X, 3, p. 445, 5	wa-l-tanẓīfi Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt Ğ D Ṣ M		**wa-l-tanaẓẓufi** P125 L Nağāt[1] lat (decori) B
*X, 3, p. 445, 7	ādāban wa rusūman Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (doctrinas et descriptiones)		**ādābun wa rusūmun** P125 L
*X, 3, p. 445, 12	yubaʿʿiduhā D M	tabʿīduhā Ṭ[264] Āmulī Nağāt; bi-taʿabbudihā B Ğ Ṣ	**bi-tabʿīdihā** P125 L lat (elongatione eius)
X, 3, p. 445, 17	aqrabu		**om.** P125 L Ṭ[265] Āmulī Nağāt
*X, 3, p. 445, 17	tahzamu B M		**tahdamu** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (destruunt) Ğ D Ṣ
°X, 3, p. 445, 18	al-ʿazīziyyati		**al-ġarīziyyati**
*X, 3, p. 446, 1	wa-d̲ikru Ğ M		**d̲ikru** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī Nağāt lat (recordatio) B D Ṣ
*X, 3, p. 446, 10	mimmā Ṭ Āmulī		**mā** P125 L Nağāt lat (id quod)
*X, 4, p. 447, 4	wa-tartībā Ğ Ṣ M	scilicet ordinare lat	**tartība** P125 L Ṭ[266] Āmulī B D
X, 4, p. 447, 6	ʿanhum		**taḥtahum** P125 L Ṭ[267] Āmulī lat (post hos)

[264] In c, Ṭ is reported as having *bi-taʿabbudihā*.
[265] This reading is not reported in c.
[266] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.
[267] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*X, 4, p. 449, 10	al-ta'akkudu D M	firmius lat	**al-ta'kīdu** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ
*X, 4, p. 449, 18	zawğayni Āmulī B M		**bi-zawğayni** P125 L Ṭ Ğ D Ṣ
*X, 4, p. 450, 10	wakālatun D M	rakālatun L Āmulī	**rakākatun** P125 Ṭ lat (vilis homo) B Ğ Ṣ
*X, 4, p. 450, 17	ka-l-rağuli Ğ M	dūna l-rağuli D	**kawna l-rağuli** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī B Ṣ
°X, 4, p. 450, 18	tafaqatuhā		**nafaqatuhā**
*X, 4, p. 451, 2	wa-yaʿūluhū M	wa-ʿawlihī P125 L B Ṣ; wa-yaqūluhū Ğ D	**wa-bi-ʿawlihī** Ṭ[268] Āmulī
*X, 4, p. 451, 4	istiʿmālihā Āmulī Ṣ M		**istiʿmālihī** P125 L Ṭ Āmulī[1] B Ğ D
*X, 4, p. 451, 6	yaḫuṣṣuhā Ṭ lat (est suum proprium) Ğ D Ṣ M	taḥḍunuhā P125; taḥṣunuhā L	**taḥḍunuhū** Āmulī B
*X, 4, p. 451, 6	fa-l-nafaqatu Āmulī		**fa-bi-l-nafaqati** P125 L Ṭ
*X, 5, p. 452, 17	yaštariku Ğ Ṣ M	yušarṭu P125	**yuštaraṭu** L Ṭ[269] Āmulī B D
*X, 5, p. 453, 10	ġayra Ğ D M	madīnatin add. Ṭ; madaniyyatin add. Āmulī; madaniyya-tihī add. B Ṣ	**madīnatihī** add. P125 L
*X, 5, p. 453, 12	fa-innahū Lmg. Ṭ Āmulī		**om.** P125
*X, 5, p. 453, 12	awğaba Ṭ Āmulī D M		**waǧaba** P125 L B Ğ Ṣ

[268] In c, Ṭ is reported as having the edited reading.
[269] This reading is not reported in c.

Table (*cont.*)

locus	legitur	alia(e) lectio(nes)	legendum
*X, 5, p. 454, 1	urīdat D M	روب P125; رويت L Ṭ Āmulī B Ğ Ṣ	**ruʾiyat**
*X, 5, p. 454, 1	musāmaḥatuhum D M	masālatuhum (sic; pro: masʾalatuhum?) Āmulī	**musālamatuhum** P125 L Ṭ B Ğ Ṣ
X, 5, p. 454, 3	li-yumnaʿa		**yamtaniʿu** P125 L Ṭ[270] Āmulī
˚X, 5, p. 454, 6	wa-muwaṭaʾati		**wa-muwāṭaʾati**
*X, 5, p. 454, 16	ġalabihī L Āmulī		**ġalabati** P125 Ṭ[271]
*X, 5, p. 455, 6	taʿrīfihā Āmulī D M		**taʿarrufihā** P125 L Ṭ Marmura [1963] B Ğ Ṣ
*X, 5, p. 455, 13	ruʾūsu Āmulī		**raʾusa** P125 L Ṭ[272]

[270] This reading is not reported in c.
[271] This reading is not reported in c.
[272] This reading is not reported in c.

APPENDIX B

INDEX OF AUTHORS AND WORKS QUOTED IN THE *ILĀHIYYĀT*

I. Index of authors quoted by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt**

1. *Proper names*

Aflāṭūn (Plato)
VII, 2, p. 311, 6 [p. 359, 9–10]
VII, 2, p. 311, 14 [p. 360, 25]. Cp. *min hā'ulā'i man* ("among those there is one/some who . . ."), VII, 2, p. 314, 4 [p. 363, 91]; *hā'ulā'i al-qawm* ("this group"), VII, 2, p. 314, 8 [p. 363, 1]
al-muṭul al-aflāṭūniyya ("Platonic models" = ideas)
V, 1, p. 204, 5 [p. 236, 4]
al-ṣuwar al-aflāṭūniyya ("Platonic forms" = ideas)
VIII, 7, p. 365, 16 [p. 427, 68]

ʿAlī (Ibn Abī Ṭālib, fourth caliph)
X, 5, p. 452, 12 [om.]

Anaksāġūras (Anaxagoras)
IV, 2, p. 183, 10 [p. 211, 8]

Baṭlamiyūs (Ptolemy)
man taqaddama Baṭlamiyūs ("who has come before Ptolemy")
IX, 2, p. 392, 12 [p. 462, 58]
man taʿallama al-ʿulūm allatī ẓaharat li-Baṭlamiyūs ("who has learnt the sciences that appeared clearly to Ptolemy")
IX, 2, p. 392, 12–13 [p. 462, 59]

Suqrāṭ (Socrates)
V, 8, p. 246, 8 [p. 276, 96]
VII, 2, p. 311, 6 [p. 359, 10]

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* The sign "Cp." after a reference introduces the expression or expressions that, in the same passage, refer to the same author.

ʿUmar (Ibn al-Ḫaṭṭāb, second caliph)
X, 5, p. 452, 12 [om.]

Ġārīqū (Megarics)
IV, 2, p. 176, 14 [om.]. Cp. *baʿḍ al-awāʾil* ("one/some of the first [philosophers]"), IV, 2, p. 176, 14 [p. 202, 35]

Fīṯāġūraṯ (Pythagoras)
aṣḥāb Fīṯāġūraṯ ("the followers of Pythagoras")
VII, 2, p. 312, 17 [p. 361, 58]. Cp. *qawm* ("a group"), VII, 2, p. 312, 16 [p. 361, 57]
ṭāʾifa fīṯāġūraṯiyya ("a Pythagorean sect")
VII, 2, p. 313, 15 [p. 362, 83]. Cp. *min hāʾulāʾi man* ("among these there is one/some who . . ."), VII, 2, p. 313, 17 [p. 362, 86]

Fīṯāġūriyyūna (Pythagoreans)
VII, 3, p. 321, 17 [p. 373, 2]
akṯar al-fīṯāġūriyyīna ("most of the Pythagoreans")
VII, 2, p. 314, 4 [p. 363, 93]. Cp. *hāʾulāʾi al-qawm* ("these persons"), VII, 2, p. 314, 8 [p. 363, 1]; *qawm minhum* ("a group of them"), VII, 3, p. 324, 1 [p. 375, 63]; *minhum man* ("among them there is one/some . . ."), VII, 2, p. 314, 4–5 [p. 363, 94]; VII, 2, p. 314, 5 [p. 363, 96]; VII, 2, p. 314, 7 [p. 363, 98]; VII, 3, p. 323, 1 [p. 374, 33–34]; VII, 3, p. 323, 2 [p. 374, 35]; VII, 3, p. 323, 7 [p. 374, 41]

Muḥammad
IX, 7, p. 423, 7 [p. 507, 96]
See also *afḍal al-šariʿīna* (I.2)

See also *kitāb Ūqlīdis* (II.2.1); *kutub al-Ǧāḥiẓ* (II.3.1)

2. *Definite descriptions (in order of occurrence)*

al-muʿallim al-awwal ("The First Teacher" = Aristotle)
VIII, 2, p. 332, 6 [p. 382, 34]
VIII, 2, p. 333, 7 [p. 383, 53]
VIII, 2, p. 335, 3 [p. 386, 5]
VIII, 2, p. 336, 17 [p. 388, 54]
VIII, 2, p. 339, 3 [p. 339, 28]
VIII, 2, p. 339, 15 [p. 392, 47]
IX, 2, p. 392, 4 [p. 462, 43–44]
IX, 2, p. 392, 9 [p. 462, 53]

IX, 2, p. 392, 15–16 [p. 463, 65]
IX, 3, p. 401, 16 [p. 476, 34].
See also *allaḏī yaḥsunu ʿibāratuhū ʿan kutub al-muʿallim al-awwal . . .; aqrab qudamāʾ talāmiḏat al-muʿallim al-awwal . . .*

man baʿdahū min muḥaṣṣilī ʿulamāʾal-mašsāʾīna ("The Peripatetics scholars after him [*sc.* the First Teacher = Aristotle] who have validated his thought" = Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius)
IX, 2, p. 392, 9–10 [p. 462, 53–54]. Cp. *hāʾulāʾi* ("these"), IX, 2, p. 392, 15 [p. 463, 62]

baʿḍ man huwa asadd qawlan min aṣḥābihī ("One of his [i.e. of the First Teacher = Aristotle] followers who speaks more to the point" = Alexander of Aphrodisias)
IX, 2, p. 392, 17 [p. 463, 67–68]

allaḏī yaḥsunu ʿibāratuhū ʿan kutub al-muʿallim al-awwal ʿalā sabīl talḫīṣ wa-in lam yakun yaġūṣu fī l-maʿānī ("He who expressed well the books of the First Teacher by way of epitome, although he could not delve deeply into the ideas" = Themistius)
IX, 2, p. 393, 2–3 [p. 463, 71–72]

aqrab qudamāʾ talāmiḏat al-muʿallim al-awwal min sawāʾ al-sabīl ("The ancient disciples of the First Teacher who are closest to the right way" = Alexander of Aphrodisias and Themistius)
IX, 2, p. 393, 5 [p. 463, 76–77]

fāḍil al-mutaqaddimīna ("The excellent among previous [philosophers]" = Alexander of Aphrodisias)
IX, 3, p. 393, 16–17 [p. 464, 92–93]

al-qudm min aḥdaṯ al-mutafalsifa al-islāmiyya fī tašwīš al-falsafa iḏ lam yafham ġaraḍ al-aqdamīn (see Appendix A; "The modern Islamic philosophaster who is brave in subverting philosophy since he has not understood the ancients' goal" = Abū-l-Ḥasan al-ʿĀmirī)
IX, 3, p. 399, 10 [pp. 472, 57–473, 59]

afḍal al-šariʿīna ("The most excellent of legislators" = prophet Muḥammad)
X, 4, p. 450, 7 [om.]
See also *al-šāriʿ*, X, 3, p. 444, 17 [p. 538, 99]

3. *Indefinite descriptions*
(in alphabetical order, according to the Arabic root of the most relevant word)

alladīna yaḥsabūna idā qālū inna al-ʿadad kammiyya munfaṣila dāt tartīb faqad ṭaḥallaṣū min hādā ("those who believe to escape this [inconvenient] by saying that number is a discrete quantity having order")
III, 3, p. 106, 1–2 [p. 116, 66–67]

alladīna yuwallidūna al-ʿadad bi-l-takrīr maʿa ṭabāt al-waḥda al-wāḥida ("those who generate the number by means of repetition maintaining the same unity")
VII, 3, p. 321, 10 [p. 372, 90–91]

ahl al-ḥaqq ("possessors of truth")
VI, 2, p. 264, 3 [om.]

ahl al-ṣināʿa ("experts of the discipline [of logic]")
V, 7, p. 236, 4 [p. 265, 65]

ahl al-ẓāhir min al-naẓar ("people of superficial investigation")
VII, 1, p. 306, 9 [p. 353, 87]: "coincident" and "different" as genera of contrary things (a doctrine similar to the one held by the thinkers referred to as *ammā al-qudamāʾ fa-qawm* in III, 6, p. 128, 12 = Pythagoreans)

ahl al-ʿilm ("possessors of knowledge")
IX, 3, p. 397, 6 [p. 469, 88]
See also: *qawm min al-muntasibīna ilā ahl al-ʿilm*

al-awwalūna ("the first [philosophers]")
I, 5, p. 35, 4 [p. 40, 56] (= Aristotle, see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [1] and Table 6)

baʿḍu al-awāʾil ("some of the first [philosophers]")
IV, 2, p. 176, 14 [p. 202, 35]

baʿḍuhum ("one/some of them")
III, 5, p. 122, 14 [p. 137, 55] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
III, 6, p. 132, 14 [p. 148, 70]: man is the measure of everything (= Protagoras)

VIII, 4, p. 344, 18 [p. 399, 93]: the principle of natural things is one. Cp. *minhum man* ("among them there is one/some . . ."), VIII, 4, p. 345, 1 [p. 399, 94], VIII, 4, p. 345, 3 [p. 399, 96]
VIII, 4, p. 344, 18 [p. 399, 94]: the principles of natural things are many
IX, 1, p. 376, 12 [p. 439, 4–5] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
See also: *baʿḍu al-awāʾil; baʿḍu al-šāriʿīna fīmā lā yaʿnīhi wa-lā lahū daraǧat al-ḫawḍ fī miṯlihī*

al-ǧumhūr ("the common people")
IV, 3, p. 186, 7 (twice) [p. 214, 77; p. 214, 78]
IV, 3, p. 187, 1 [om.] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [9])
VI, 5, p. 296, 11, 17 [p. 342, 99, 07]: they regard as generous the benefactor who receives praise
VII, 2, p. 310, 12 [p. 358, 95] (see Chapter 6, §1.1, Text 1[c])
X, 1, p. 439, 6 [p. 528, 25]: what they believe regarding divine punishments and similar events is true
See also *al-mašhūr ʿinda al-ǧumhūr*

al-ḥukamāʾ (lit. "the wise men", i.e. the philosophers)
IV, 3, p. 188, 5 [p. 215, 17]
V, 4, p. 226, 11 [p. 262, 20]
VI, 2, p. 266, 12 [p. 304, 69]

akṯar al-ḥukamāʾ ("most of the the wise men")
I, 8, p. 51, 10 [p. 59, 33] (= Plato?)
al-ḥukamāʾ al-aqdamīn ("the ancient wise men")
VII, 2, p. 310, 3 [p. 357, 77] (= Plato and Pythagoras)
al-ḥukamāʾ al-ilāhiyyūn (lit. "divine wise men", i.e. metaphysicians)
IX, 7, p. 423, 10 [p. 507, 1–2]

maḏhabuhū wa-raʾyuhū ("his doctrine and his opinion")
II, 2, p. 65, 10 [p. 74, 94] (= Atomists)
ashal al-maḏāhib naqḍan ("the doctrine easiest to refute"), II, 2, p. 65, 8–9 [p. 74, 91–92]. Cp. *maḏhab man ḫalafa baynahā bi-l-aškāl* ("the doctrine of the person[s] who differentiate[s] them [= atoms] by [their] shapes")
II, 2, p. 65, 9 [p. 74, 92] (= Atomists)

maḏhab man yurakkibu al-maqādīr min aǧzāʾ lā tataǧazzaʾu ("the doctrine of the person[s] who take[s] extensions to be composed from indivisible parts")
III, 9, p. 146, 5–6 [p. 164, 66] (= Atomists)

yurā ("it is believed")
VI, 3, p. 269, 9 [p. 308, 50]

al-mutašabbiha bi-l-falāsifa ("those who feign to be philosophers")
X, 1, p. 439, 7 [p. 528, 26]

baʿḍu al-šāriʿīna fīmā lā yaʿnīhi wa-lā lahū daraǧat al-ḫawḍ fī miṯlihī ("One of those who pontificate about what is foreign to them, without being able to discuss deeply questions of that kind")
IV, 2, p. 183, 4 [p. 210, 99–00] (= Abū-Bakr al-Rāzī?)

al-mašhūr ("common opinion")
VI, 3, p. 268, 13 [p. 307, 29] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [11])

al-mašhūr ʿinda al-ǧumhūr ("what is commonly believed among the common people")
IV, 1, p. 163, 10 [p. 184, 11] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [7])

al-maʿnā al-mašhūr "the commonly accepted meaning"
IV, 2, p. 171, 13 [p. 195, 8] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [8])

aṣḥāb al-ḥaqīqa ("advocates of truth")
III, 5, p. 123, 4 [p. 137, 63–64]

aṣḥāb al-kumūn ("advocates of occultation")
III, 1, p. 94, 11 [p. 105, 35–36]

aṣḥāb al-qawl bi-ǧawhariyyat al-kayf ("advocates of the doctrine of the substantiality of quality")
III, 1, p. 94, 12 [p. 105, 36–37]

aṣḥāb al-qawl bi-ǧawhariyyat al-kamm ("advocates of the doctrine of the substantiality of quantity")
III, 1, p. 94, 14 [p. 106, 39]

aṣḥāb al-ʿadad ("advocates of number")
III, 1, p. 95, 1 [p. 106, 45]

ḍuʿafāʾ al-tamyīz ("those whose discernment is weak")
III, 10, p. 155, 16 [p. 177, 95]: "accident" is an equivocal term

al-ṭabīʿiyyūn ("the naturalists")
VI, 1, p. 257, 14 [p. 292, 21]
VI, 2, p. 268, 3 [p. 306, 16]
VI, 5, p. 294, 5 [p. 339, 32]

aḫarūna min al-ṭabīʿiyyīn ("others among the naturalists")
III, 1, p. 94, 9 [p. 105, 32]: those who regard qualities as substances

ṭāʾifa mimman tatašaḥḥaṭu fī l-tafalsuf ("a group of those who grope in [their] pretended philosophy")
V, 1, p. 202, 16 [p. 235, 68] (= Yaḥyā b. ʿAdī? Abū-l-Qāsim al-Kirmānī?)

ẓanna ẓānnun ("someone has believed")
VI, 1, p. 261, 5 [p. 296, 14]. Cp. *man ẓanna* ("who has believed"), VI, 1, p. 261, 6 [p. 297, 16] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)

(qad) ẓunna ("it was believed")
III, 4, p. 116, 3 [p. 129, 93]. Cp. *alladī yaẓunnuhū* ("the one who believes it"), III, 4, p. 116, 14 [p. 129, 7]
VI, 4, p. 282, 1 [p. 324, 5]: (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [13])

yuẓannu ("it is believed")
I, 1, p. 7, 7 [p. 6, 98] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
III, 6, p. 133, 5 [p. 148, 83]: "greater" and "smaller" do not imply the presence of "equal"
IV, 2, p. 172, 13 [p. 197, 35]. Cp. *hāʾulāʾi* ("these") IV, 2, p. 173, 2 [p. 197, 42] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
VI, 2, p. 264, 5 [p. 300, 95] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
VI, 3, p. 269, 2 [p. 307, 40]
VI, 5, p. 298, 20, p. 299, 1, 2 [p. 346, 76, 77, 78] (see Chapter 10, §2.3, Table 3.2 [1]–[4])

hāʾulāʾi al-muʿaṭṭila ("these deniers of God's attributes")
IX, 1, p. 380, 11 [p. 445, 19]. Cp. *awḍāʿuhum* ("the things they suppose"), IX, 1, p. 379, 14 [p. 443, 92]; *ǧuwwaza* ("it has been regarded as possible"), IX, 1, p. 380, 5 [p. 444, 9]; *ʿindahum* ("in their opinion"), IX, 1, p. 380, 10 [p. 445, 17–18]; *ʿalayhim* ("according to them"), IX, 1, p. 381, 1 [om.]

al-ʿulamāʾ ("the scholars")
I, 8, p. 51, 11 [p. 59, 35]

baʿḍ al-ʿulamāʾ ("one/some of the scholars")
IX, 7, p. 431, 12 [p. 519, 57]. Cp. *qālū* ("they said"), IX, 7, p. 431, 17 [p. 520, 66]

al-ʿāmma ("the common people")
VI, 1, p. 263, 3 [p. 299, 66]
IX, 7, p. 431, 14 [p. 519, 60]

hāḏā al-ġāfil al-ḥayrān ("this negligent and confused [man]")
III, 4, p. 117, 4 [p. 130, 19]

farīq lahum ʿadad ("a numerous sect")
VIII, 6, p. 357, 16 [p. 415, 33] (= Plato and Platonists; see Chapter 6, §1.1, Text 2)

al-fuḍalāʾ ("the excellent [philosophers]")
I, 8, p. 51, 10 [p. 59, 30]

al-afāḍil al-aḵtarūna ("most of the excellent [philosophers]")
I, 8, p. 50, 9 [p. 58, 11]

al-falāsifa ("the philosophers")
IV, 2, p. 171, 4 [p. 195, 94] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [8])

al-faylasūf al-muqaddim ("the ancient philosopher")
III, 5, p. 122, 9 [p. 136, 49]

al-falāsifa al-ilāhiyyūn (lit. "divine philosophers", i.e. metaphysicians)
VI, 1, p. 257, 13 [p. 292, 20]

akṯar al-mutafalsifīn ("most of those who pretend to be philosophers")
I, 8, p. 51, 7 [p. 59, 28]
See also: *ṭā'ifa mimman tatašaḥḥaṭu fī l-tafalsuf*

al-qudamā' ("the ancients")
IX, 3, p. 401, 1 [p. 474, 2]

ammā al-qudamā' fa-qawm ("as to the ancients, a group")
III, 6, p. 128, 12 [p. 142, 68] (= Pythagoreans; see Chapter 8, §5.1, Outline 4.2)
ʿāmma min al-qudamā' ("most of the ancients")
IV, 2, p. 183, 2 [p. 210, 96]: potentiality is prior to actuality not only in time. Cp. *baʿḍuhum* ("some of them"), IV, 2, p. 183, 2 [p. 210, 96]: first matter exists before form and receives the form from the agent; *minhum man qāla* ("among them there is one/some who said"), IV, 2, p. 183, 7 [p. 210, 3]: "these things" (the original matter?) moved eternally by nature by means of disordered motions, set in order by the Creator (= Plato?); *minhum man qāla* ("among them there is one/some who said"), IV, 2, p. 183, 8 [p. 210, 5]: the original element was darkness, the abyss, something infinite that first is motionless and then is moved, or Anaxagoras' mixture (see Chapter 8, §5.12, Outline 11.2)
See also: *al-ḥukamā' al-aqdamīn; al-faylasūf al-muqaddim*

al-qā'il bi-l-aʿdād ("the advocate of numbers")
VII, 3, pp. 318, 18–319, 1 [p. 369, 24]. Cp. *min hā'ulā'i man* ("among those there is one/some . . ."), VII, 3, p. 319, 4 [p. 369, 29]; *minhum man* ("among them there is one/some . . ."), VII, 3, p. 319, 5 [p. 369, 30–31]

al-qā'ilūna bi-l-ʿadad al-ʿadadī ("the advocates of the numerical number")
VII, 3, p. 319, 10 [p. 370, 37]. Cp. *qawm minhum* ("a group of them"), VII, 3, p. 320, 8 [p. 371, 60]

al-qā'ilūna bi-l-taʿlīmiyyāt ("the advocates of mathematical beings")
VII, 2, p. 316, 14 [p. 366, 65–66]

qālū ("they said")
III, 3, p. 105, 8 [p. 116, 51]: unity is that in which no multiplicity is present

yaqūlūna ("they say")
IV, 3, p. 190, 1 [p. 217, 59]
IV, 3, p. 190, 2 [p. 217, 61] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [10])

yuqālu ("it is said")
III, 3, p. 106, 6 [p. 117, 73] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [5])
III, 4, p. 117, 15 [p. 131, 37] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [6])

mā yuqālu, alladī yuqālu ("what is said")
I, 5, p. 32, 6 [p. 36, 84]
I, 5, p. 32, 6 [p. 36, 85]
I, 5, p. 35, 17 [p. 41, 74] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [2])
II, 2, p. 63, 11 [p. 72, 44] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [3])
III, 4, p. 115, 5 [p. 127, 72]: the point traces the line with its movement

qawl ("statement")
VII, 1, p. 307, 11 [p. 354, 14] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [4])

qawluhum ("their statement")
III, 3, p. 105, 13 [p. 116, 58]: multiplicity is compound of unities

qawl man qāla ("the statement of one/some who said . . .")
III, 5, p. 119, 7 [p. 132, 71]: number exists only in the soul

qawl man yaqūlu ("the statement of one/some who says . . .")
I, 5, p. 36, 7 [p. 41, 84]. Cp. *maḏāhibuhum* ("their doctrines"), I, 5, p. 36, 16 [p. 42, 98]; *mā yuqālu fīhi* ("what is said about it"), I, 5, p. 36, 18 [p. 42, 1]

qawl al-qā'il ("the statement of one saying . . .")
VIII, 1, p. 328, 13 [p. 378, 49] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [15]). Cp. *qawl al-qā'il* ("the statement of one saying . . ."), VIII, 1, p. 328, 16 [p. 378, 52]

qawm ("group")
I, 1, p. 7, 9 [p. 6, 1] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
I, 5, p. 34, 11 [p. 39, 40]. Cp. *hā'ulā'i* ("these ones"), I, 5, p. 34, 13 [p. 40, 43]
III, 10, p. 156, 6 [p. 178, 4]. Cp. *al-firqa al-ṯānya* ("the second sect"), III, 10, p. 156, 13 [p. 179, 15] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
III, 10, p. 156, 7 [p. 178, 5] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
IV, 2, p. 176, 15 [p. 202, 36]
VI, 4, p. 279, 15 [p. 321, 46] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [12])
VII, 2, p. 310, 14 [p. 358, 00]: the dialectical division requires the existence of two things (one sensible, the other intelligible) in everything
VII, 2, p. 311, 8 [p. 359, 15]: separation from matter is proper not to the ideal form, but to its principles, i.e. to mathematical beings. Cp. *al-āḫarūna* ("the others"), VII, 2, p. 312, 6 [p. 360, 38]; *baʿḍuhum* ("some of them"), VII, 2, p. 313, 4 [p. 362, 67]; *baʿḍuhum* ("some of them"), VII, 2, p. 313, 5 [p. 362, 69]; *akṯaruhum* ("most of them"), VII, 2, p. 313, 6 [p. 362, 70]
VII, 2, p. 313, 1 [p. 361, 61]: the principles are the exceeding, the deficient and the equal (as matter). Cp. *man ǧaʿala al-mabdaʾ al-ziyāda wa-l-naqṣān* ("who made excess and defect principle"), VII, 3, p. 322, 10–11 [p. 373, 20–21]
VII, 2, p. 313, 3 [p. 361, 63]: the principles are the exceeding, the deficient and the equal (as form). Cp. *man ǧaʿala al-mabdaʾ al-ziyāda wa-l-naqṣān* ("who made excess and defect principle"), VII, 3, p. 322, 10–11 [p. 373, 20–21]
VII, 2, p. 314, 2 [p. 363, 89]: numerical forms and ideas are separate
VII, 3, p. 321, 16 [p. 372, 00]: unity is the matter of number
VII, 3, p. 321, 17 [p. 372, 1]: unity is the form of number
VII, 3, p. 322, 1 [p. 373, 4]
IX, 3, p. 393, 16 [p. 464, 92]

al-qawm allaḏīna yarawna hāḏā al-ray' ("the group of those holding this opinion")
I, 5, p. 33, 16 [p. 38, 20] (= Muʿtazilites). Cp. *mā hāḏū bihī min aqāwīlihim* ("what they have raved about in their statements"), I, 5, p. 33, 17–18 [p. 38, 23]; *ūlā'ika* ("these ones"), I, 5, p. 34, 1 [p. 38, 23]

qawm min al-muntasibīna ilā ahl al-ʿilm (see Appendix A) ("a group of persons affiliated to the people of knowledge"
IX, 5, p. 413, 1 [p. 492, 77] (= al-Kindī?). Cp. *mā qad qalū* ("what they have said"), IX, 5, p. 413, 7 [p. 492, 88]; IX, 5, p. 413, 13 [p. 493, 98]; *allaḏī qāla ḏālika* ("who has said this"), IX, 5, p. 414, 11 [p. 414, 27]; *baʿḍ man kātabahū min al-ʿāmmiyyīna* ("some of the common people with whom he corresponded"), IX, 5, p. 414, 12 [p. 494, 28]; *man ta'aḫḫara ʿanhu* ("who has come after him"), IX, 5, p. 414, 12 [p. 494, 28]; *kātib ḏālika al-kalām* ("who has written this doctrine"), IX, 5, p. 414, 13 [p. 494, 29]

qawm minhum ("a group of them")
VII, 3, p. 324, 1 [p. 375, 63]

man ("the person[s] who")
II, 2, p. 62, 6 [p. 71, 16]: the person who conceives an infinite body makes a mistake in attributing infinity to a body, not in regarding such a body as a body
II, 2, p. 62, 7 [p. 71, 18–19]: the body is an instrument [of the soul] (= Plato?)
III, 1, p. 94, 14 [p. 106, 39]: continuous quantities are substances and principles of substances (= Platonists)
III, 3, p. 105, 11 [p. 116, 55] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [4])
III, 4, p. 114, 13 [p. 127, 59] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
III, 9, p. 146, 5–6 [p. 164, 66]: bodies are composed from indivisible parts (= Atomists)
III, 9, p. 146, 8 [p. 164, 70–71]: extensions are composed from indivisible parts (= Atomists)
VI, 3, p. 271, 13 [p. 311, 16]: if two qualities are equal in species, one is not weaker or stronger than the other

VI, 3, p. 271, 15 [p. 311, 19]: difference in weakness and strength is accidental to qualities
VI, 4, p. 281, 1 [p. 322, 79–80] (= Platonists; see Chapter 10, §2.2, Table 2.2 [1])
VI, 5, p. 299, 3 [p. 346, 80] (see Chapter 10, §3.2, Table 3.2 [5])

kaṯīr mimman yaddaʿī al-maʿrifa ("many of those who arrogate knowledge to themselves")
II, 1, p. 58, 10 [p. 66, 30] (= Porphyry) (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7; Chapter 11, §2.3)

See also: *man taqaddama Baṭlamiyūs*, *man taʿallama al-ʿulūm allatī ẓaharat li-Baṭlamiyūs* (I.1); *maḏhab man ḫālafa baymahā bi-l-ašhāl maḏhab man yurakkibu al-maqādīr min aǧzāʾ lā tataǧazzaʾu; qawl man qāla; qawl man yaqūlu; min al-nās man*

al-anbiyāʾ ("the prophets")
I, 8, p. 51, 10 [p. 59, 33]

al munaǧǧim al-qāʾil bi-l-aḥkām ("the astrologer who speaks of the [heavenly] decrees")
X, 1, p. 440, 4 [p. 529, 50]

al-naḥwiyyūna ("the grammarians")
III, 5, p. 123, 7 [p. 137, 67–68]

al-manṭiqiyyūn ("the logicians")
V, 3, p. 213, 11 [p. 246, 9]

min al-nās man ("someone/some among people")
III, 7, p. 134, 8 [p. 150, 2]: qualities are substances intermingled with and penetrating into bodies. Cp. *baʿḍuhum* ("some of them"),
III, 7, p. 134, 16 [p. 150, 14]: occultation of qualities
VI, 2, p. 267, 10 [p. 305, 95] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
VI, 2, p. 267, 13–14 [p. 305, 01] (see Chapter 6, §3.2, Table 7)
X, 4, p. 447, 16 [p. 543, 80]: it is right to kill people whose health is irremediably compromised

baʿḍ al-nās, bal akṯaruhūm ("some people, or better: most of them")
III, 10, p. 154, 8 [p. 176, 61–62]: relation is a single reality existing between two things
III, 1, p. 94, 5 [p. 105, 26]: lines, surfaces and solids are substances and principles of substances. Cp. *baʿḍuhum* ("some of them"), III, 1, p. 94, 7 [p. 105, 29]: numbers are substances and principles of substances (= Pythagoreans); *hāʾulāʾi* ("these"), III, 1, p. 95, 14 [p. 106, 64]: the difficulties raised by (all) these thinkers
III, 7, p. 136, 1 [p. 151, 44]

al-muhandisūna ("the geometers")
IV, 2, p. 172, 6 [p. 196, 24] (= Aristotle; see Chapter 8, §4, Outline 3 [8]). Cp. *baʿḍuhum* ("some of them") IV, 2, p. 172, 6 [p. 196, 24]: the side originates the square by means of its movement

al-yūnāniyyūna ("the Greeks")
V, 3, p. 213, 5 [p. 246, 1]
VII, 2, p. 310, 11 [p. 358, 93]

II. Index of works quoted by Avicenna in the *Ilāhiyyāt*

1. *Titles*

1.1 *Works by other authors*

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I, 5, p. 36, 3 [p. 41, 79]

1.2 *Works by Avicenna*

Kitāb al-Birr wa-l-iṯm ("Book of Piety and Sin")
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V, 2, p. 209, 6 [p. 241, 11]
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2. *Definite descriptions*

2.1 *Works by other authors*

risālatuhū allatī fī mabādiʾ al-kull ("His treatise about the principles of the universe" = Alexander of Aphrodisias' *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*)
IX, 2, p. 392, 17 [p. 463, 68–69]

šarʿ, šarīʿa ("religious law")
IX, 7, p. 423, 4 [p. 506, 92]
IX, 7, p. 423, 13 [p. 507, 8]
IX, 7, p. 423, 5 [om.]
IX, 7, p. 423, 6 [p. 507, 95]
X, 3, p. 445, 9 [p. 539, 16]
X, 3, p. 446, 12 [p. 541, 53]
X, 5, p. 453, 19 [p. 551, 94]
X, 5, p. 451, 16 [p. 548, 60]

taʿlīm ("teaching" = Aristotle's works [?])
I, 5, p. 36, 19 [p. 42, 1]

al-taʿlīm al-awwal ("the First Teaching" = Aristotle's *Metaphysics*)
VIII, 2, p. 332, 4 [p. 382, 31]

al-qāʾil al-ḥaqq ("Who speaks truly" = the *Qurʾān* as Allāh's word)
X, 3, p. 446, 4–5 [p. 540, 40]

kutub al-aḫlāq ("Books of ethics" = Aristotle's *Nicomachean Ethics*)
IX, 7, p. 429, 18 [p. 517, 4]

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I, 1, p. 8, 15 [p. 8, 35–36]

2.2 *Works by Avicenna*

2.2.1 Logic
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II, 1, p. 58, 15 [p. 67, 38] (= *Maqūlāt* I, 6)

šarḥunā li-l-manṭiqiyyāt ("our explanation of logical things")
I, 3, p. 22, 13 [p. 25, 70]

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I, 2, p. 16, 18 [p. 18, 29]

al-ʿulūm al-manṭiqiyya ("logical sciences")
I, 1, p. 3, 9 [p. 1, 4–5]

iftitāḥ al-manṭiq ("beginning of logic")
III, 1, p. 93, 11 [p. 104, 13] (= *Maqūlāt*)

funūn al-manṭiq ("sections of logic")
I, 5, p. 35, 5 [p. 40, 57]

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III, 6, p. 129, 14 [p. 144, 97] (= *Maqūlāt* IV, 5)

manṭiq ("logic")
I, 1, p. 5, 3 [p. 3, 37]
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V, 1, p. 199, 13 [p. 232, 99] (= *Madḫal* I, 5)
VII, 1, p. 304, 14 [p. 351, 49] (= *Maqūlāt* VII, 1)
VIII, 3, p. 341, 14 [p. 395, 5]
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VIII, 4, p. 349, 6 [p. 404, 1] (= *ʿIbāra* I, 7)

2.2.2 Natural Philosophy
al-bayānāt al-ṭabīʿiyya ("clarifications of natural things")
II, 1, p. 65, 8 [p. 74, 91] (= *Samāʿ* III, 3–6)

ḥayṯu takallamnā fī l-kawn wa-l-fasād ("where we have discussed about generation and corruption")
VIII, 2, p. 340, 4 [p. 393, 59–60] (= *Kawn wa-Fasād* 14)

ḥīna aṯbatnā hāḏihi al-nafs ("when he have established [the existence of] this soul")
IX, 4, p. 408, 14 [p. 486, 51] (= *Nafs* I, 1, pp. 15, 18–16, 17)

šarḥunā li-l-ṭabīʿiyyāt ("our explanation of natural things")
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III, 4, p. 115, 10 [p. 128, 80] (= *Samāʿ* II, 5, pp. 112, 9–113, 3)
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IV, 2, p. 180, 13 [p. 207, 31] (= *Samāʿ* I, 13, pp. 62, 5–63, 3)
VI, 3, p. 272, 2 [p. 311, 26] (= *Kawn wa-Fasād* 9)
VI, 3, p. 273, 11 [p. 313, 71] (= *Kawn wa-Fasād* 9)
VI, 5, p. 284, 9 [p. 327, 76] (= *Samāʿ* I, 13–14)
VI, 5, p. 291, 4 [p. 335, 60] (= *Samaʿ* IV, 2)
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VIII, 1, p. 331, 9 [p. 381, 21] (= *Kawn wa-fasād* 14)
IX, 1, p. 375, 6 [p. 437, 70] (= *Samāʿ* II, 1, p. 85, 5–7)
IX, 2, p. 381, 15 [p. 447, 52] (= *Samāʿ* II, 1)

ʿilm al-ṭabīʿa ("science of nature")
VI, 3, p. 276, 2 [p. 316, 49]

al-ʿulūm . . . al-ṭabīʿiyya ("natural sciences")
I, 1, p. 3, 9 [p. 1, 4–5]
IX, 1, p. 373, 13 [p. 435, 20] (= *Samāʿ* IV, 15, p. 331, 5–6; IV, 9, p. 301, 3–8)
IX, 4, p. 408, 17–18 [p. 486, 58–59] (= *Nafs* V, 2)

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ṣināʿat al-taʿālīm ("discipline of mathematics")
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I, 2, p. 16, 9 [p. 17, 16]

kalāmunā fī l-riyāḍiyyāt ("what we said in mathematics"; see Appendix A)
IX, 3, p. 401, 17 [p. 476, 35–36] (= *Hayʾa*)

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ruʾūs al-kutub ("beginnings of books" = introductions)
I, 3, p. 17, 10 [p. 19, 44]

kutub al-Ǧāḥiẓ ("books of al-Ǧāḥiẓ")
V, 8, p. 244, 16 [p. 274, 54]

kutub al-muʿallim al-awwal ("books of the First Teacher")
IX, 2, p. 393, 2 [p. 463, 71–72]

al-kutub al-ʿilmiyya ("books of knowledge")
V, 3, p. 213, 9 [p. 246, 7]

3.2 *Previous parts of the* Šifāʾ

3.2.1 Logic

kamā bayyannā ("as we have clarified")
I, 7, p. 46, 3 [p. 52, 10] (= *Madḫal* I, 12, p. 70, 9–10)

qad tabayyana laka ("it has already appeared clearly to you")
I, 1, p. 6, 18 [p. 5, 87]

qad taḥaqqaqa ("it has already been verified")
III, 6, p. 126, 5 [p. 139, 10] (= *Maqūlāt* VII, 1)

sāʾir mā taʿallamta min al-falsafa ("the other parts of philosophy that you have learnt")
V, 6, p. 232, 10 [p. 281, 86–87] (= *Madḫal* I, 11, p. 64, 4–9)

mā salafa ("what has preceded")
II, 1, p. 59, 1 [p. 67, 40] (= *Maqūlāt* I, 5, p. 45, 6–7)
III, 4, p. 117, 7 [p. 130, 24] (= *Maqūlāt* VI, 5; also *Samāʿ* II, 10–13)

mā salafa laka ("what has been [told] to you previously")
III, 6, p. 128, 1 [p. 141, 50] (= *Maqūlāt* VII, 1)

mā salafa min al-kutub ("previous books")
I, 1, p. 5, 1 [p. 3, 34]

qad kunta tasmaʿu ("you have already heard")
I, 1, p. 5, 7 [p. 3, 44] (= *Burhān* II, 7, p. 165, 7–10; II, 9, p. 178, 17–19)
I, 1, p. 5, 8 [p. 3, 46–47] (= *Burhān* II, 7, p. 165, 7–10; II, 9, p. 178, 17–19)

qad ʿarafta ("you have already apprehended")
II, 4, p. 80, 13 [p. 93, 41] (= *Maqūlāt* IV, 3–5)
III, 4, p. 112, 11 [p. 124, 9] (= *Maqūlāt* IV, 3)

al-ʿulūm allatī qabla hāḏā ("previous sciences")
I, 3, p. 17, 4 [p. 18, 35] (= *Madḫal* I, 3 [?])

qad ʿulima ("it has already been known")
I, 1, p. 5, 15 [p. 4, 57]

qad ʿalimta ("you have already known")
I, 3, p. 17, 8 [p. 18, 41] (= *Madḫal* I, 2, p. 12, 7–9)
III, 2, p. 103, 9 [p. 114, 20] (= *Madḫal* I, 11, p. 64, 4–9 and apparatus ad lin. 8)
III, 3, p. 106, 13 [p. 117, 85] (= *Madḫal* I, 11, p. 64, 4–9)

kamā ʿalimta ("as you have known")
I, 2, p. 10, 17 [p. 10, 73]

mā qad maḍā laka ("what you have learnt before")
III, 6, p. 128, 5 [p. 142, 57] (= *Maqūlāt* VII, 1)

mawḍiʿihī ("its place")
VI, 3, p. 271, 15 [p. 311, 18] (= *Maqūlāt* V, 1–2)
VII, 1, p. 307, 10 [p. 354, 14] (= *Maqūlāt* V–VI, 4)

mawḍiʿ āḫar ("elsewhere")
III, 6, p. 133, 7 [p. 148, 84] (= *Maqūlāt* IV, 3–5)

mawāḍiʿ, *mawāḍiʿ uḫrā*, *mawāḍiʿ uḫar* ("elsewhere")
I, 1, p. 6, 1 [p. 4, 64]
III, 7, p. 134, 5 [p. 149, 00] (= *Maqūlāt* V, 1–6; VI, 1–4)
III, 8, p. 144, 1 [p. 162, 33] (= *Madḫal* I, 12)

mawāḍiʿ uḫrā min al-kutub ("other places of the [previous] books")
I, 1, p. 3, 11 [p. 1, 8]

mawāḍiʿ salafat laka ("places you have passed through")
III, 2, p. 98, 10–11 [p. 108, 8] (= *Madḫal* I, 12)

3.2.2 Natural philosophy
qad bāna laka ("it has already appeared clearly to you")
IX, 1, p. 379, 12 [p. 443, 89] (= *Samāʿ* II, 10–13)

qad bayyannā ("we have already clarified")
III, 8, p. 144, 2 [p. 162, 36] (= *Nafs* II, 2)
IV, 2, p. 174, 7 [p. 198, 73] (= *Samāʿ* I, 1–3, 10–12)
X, 1, p. 435, 16 [p. 523, 26] (= *Nafs* IV, 2, p. 173, 9–21); see also *bayyannā* ("we have clarified"), X, 1, p. 435, 16 [p. 523, 26]

qad tabayyana ("it has already appeared clearly")
VIII, 6, p. 357, 3 [p. 414, 5] (= *Nafs* V, 6, p. 239, 3–4)

allatī aḫbarnā bihā ("[the things] that we have reported")
X, 2, p. 442, 8 [p. 533, 18]

mā salafa ("what has preceded")
VI, 1, p. 260, 1 [om.] (= *Samāʿ* I, 10–12)

mā salafa bi-bayānihī ("what has been clarified previously")
IX, 7, p. 426, 11 [p. 511, 97]

kamā salafa minnā ḏikruhū ("as we have mentioned previously")
X, 2, p. 442, 2 [p. 532, 8] (= *Nafs* V, 6, pp. 248, 8–250, 4)

kamā samiʿta ("as you have heard")
VI, 1, p. 257, 7 [p. 291, 8] (= *Samāʿ* I, 2; I, 10)

qad ušbiʿa laka al-kalām fī hāḏā ("you have already been told exhaustively about this")
II, 3, p. 74, 2 [p. 85, 93–94] (= *Samāʿ* II, 5–9)

qad ʿarafta ("you have already learnt")
VIII, 6, p. 356, 16 [p. 414, 96] (= *Nafs* V, 2, pp. 209, 17–210, 1)

ʿalā mā ʿaraftahū ("according to what you have learnt")
VI, 2, p. 267, 6 [p. 305, 88] (= *Samāʿ* I, 2)

qad ʿalimta ("you have already known")
II, 3, p. 73, 15 [p. 85, 88] (= *Samāʿ* II, 5–9)
VI, 4, p. 282, 15 [p. 325, 26] (= *Samāʿ* I, 11, p. 54, 10–17)
IX, 2, p. 387, 2 [p. 454, 95] (= *Samāʿ* IV, 15, p. 331, 5–6; IV, 9, p. 301, 3–8)

kamā ʿalimta ("as you have known")
III, 9, p. 148, 6 [p. 167, 21] (= *Nafs* IV, 3)
VI, 2, p. 267, 3 [p. 304, 83] (= *Samāʿ* III, 10–13)
IX, 7, p. 432, 7 [p. 520, 78–79] (= *Nafs* IV, 2)

kamā taʿlamu ("as you know")
IV, 1, p. 163, 14 [p. 185, 18] (= *Samāʿ* II, 10–13)

ʿalā mā ʿalimta ("according to what you have known")
VIII, 2, p. 333, 13 [p. 383, 61] (= *Kawn wa-Fasād* 14)

qad faraġnā ʿanhu [or: *minhu*] ("we have already exhaustively discussed it")
II, 2, p. 61, 6 [p. 69, 88] (= *Samāʿ* III, 2–6)
III, 7, p. 135, 15 [om.] (= *Kawn wa-Fasād* 3)

al-fuṣūl al-mutaqaddima ("the previous sections")
IX, 2, p. 383, 15 [p. 449, 4] (= *Samāʿ* II, 1)

qad faʿalnā ḏālika ("we have already done it")
III, 1, p. 94, 13 [p. 105, 38] (= *Kawn wa-Fasād* 4)

kutub uḫrā ("other books")
VIII, 6, p. 359, 10 [p. 418, 86] (= *Nafs* V, 8)

mawḍiʿ āḫar ("elsewhere")
II, 2, p. 64, 12 [p. 73, 61] (= *Samāʿ* I, 2, p. 13, 4–13)
II, 2, p. 67, 5 [p. 77, 42] (= *Samāʿ* III, 2, pp. 182, 1–183, 11)
III, 4, p. 118, 13 [p. 132, 59] (= *Samāʿ* II, 3, p. 102, 9–16)
V, 6, p. 230, 6 [p. 279, 35] (= *Nafs* II, 3)
VI, 5, p. 289, 9 [p. 333, 20] (= *Samāʿ* I, 13–14)

mawāḍiʿ, *mawāḍiʿ uḫrā* ("elsewhere")
II, 4, p. 81, 8 [p. 93, 55] (= *Samāʿ* I, 10–12)
VIII, 3, p. 341, 13 [p. 395, 2] (= *Nafs* IV, 4)

ʿalā al-naḥw allaḍī ḏakarnāhū ("as we have mentioned")
V, 1, p. 205, 4 [p. 237, 30] (= *Nafs*, V, 5)

3.2.3 Mathematics
qad bayyannā ("we have already clarified")
III, 4, p. 115, 6 [pp. 127, 74–128, 75] (= *Handasa*)

mawāḍiʿ (sc. *uḫrā*) ("elsewhere")
II, 3, p. 72, 12 [p. 83, 59] (= *Handasa* I, p. 16, 9)

APPENDIX C

OVERVIEW OF THE MAIN WORKS BY AVICENNA ON METAPHYSICS IN CHRONOLOGCAL ORDER

1. ***Maqāla fī l-Nafs ʿalā sunnat al-iḫtiṣār*** (*Compendium on the Soul*): early period (W1 in Gutas [1988])

Description: short treatise on the soul. Chapter 8 describes how the human rational soul acquires the intelligibles through syllogism and demonstration; this description amounts to a classification of theoretical philosophy (logic, natural philosophy, mathematics, metaphysics).

Editions: Avicenna [1875], pp. 339–372.

Translations: Landauer in Avicenna [1875], pp. 373–418 (integral German translation); Gutas [1988], pp. 16–19 (Engl. transl. of chapter 8).

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 82–87.

In chapter 8, the "conceptualization of divine matters" (*taṣawwur al-umūr al-ilāhiyya*), i.e. metaphysical knowledge, is structured as follows (p. 362, 3–16; see Chapter 5, §2, Table 2):

[1] [1.1] the principles of absolute "existent *qua* existent"	OntologyC/Theology
[1.2] and its consequent attributes (*lawāḥiq*): [1.2.1] potentiality and actuality, [1.2.2] principle and cause, [1.2.3] substance and accident, [1.2.4] genus and species, [1.2.5] contrariety (*muḍādda*) and homogeneity (*muǧānasa*), [1.2.6] coincidence (*ittifāq*) and difference (*iḫtilāf*), [1.2.7] unity and multiplicity	OntologyP (including OntologyS = [1.2.3])
[2] the first principles of the theoretical sciences (mathematics, natural philosophy and logic)	OntologyS
[3] God's existence, cosmology	OntologyC/Theology
[4] providence, prophetology, eschatology	OntologyC/Theology

The division of metaphysics is neither clear (it is not explicitly stated) nor rigorous (OntologyC/Theology is split in three distinct parts; OntologyS overlaps with OntologyP). It can be envisaged as fourfold. [1] The first section assembles OntologyC/Theology ([1.1]) and OntologyP ([1.2]). OntologyP, in its turn, includes a sub-division, namely "substance and accident" ([1.2.3]), that can be regarded as belonging to OntologyS. Therefore the "consequent attributes" (*lawāḥiq*) of "existent" mentioned in [1.2] are probably both properties and species of this concept.[1] [2] The second section can be taken as OntologyS, on account of what Avicenna states in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2 (see Chapter 5, Table 1). [3]–[4] The third and fourth sections are devoted to OntologyC/Theology, which represents therefore the most extensive portion ([1.1], [3]–[4]).

2. **Al-Maǧmūʿ** (*The Compilation*) or **Al-Ḥikma al-ʿArūḍīya** (*Philosophy for ʿArūḍī*): early period (W2)

Description: *summa* on theoretical philosophy (with the exclusion of mathematics). Partially preserved in the MS Uppsala, Universitetsbibliotek 364. According to Gutas [1988], pp. 87–93, ff. 2r–5v and ff. 82r–84r deal with metaphysics. Parts of Ontology were copied in *Naǧāt*.

Editions: transcription of ff. 3v16–4r12, 4r14–17, 4v16–5r5 in Wisnovsky [2003], pp. 277–278, Appendix II.

Translations: Wisnovsky [2003], p. 200 (L[emma]58/73), p. 236 (L69), p. 130 (L31) (Engl. transl. of ff. 3v16–4r12, 4r14–17, 4v16–5r5).

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 87–93. Wisnovsky [2000], p. 202, n. 38; Wisnovsky [2003].

3. **Al-Ḥāṣil wa-l-maḥṣūl** (*The Available and the Valid*): early period (W3)

Description: according to the Autobiography (p. 38, 8–9), it was an "explanation" (*šarḥ*), of the "books" (*kutūb*), i.e. of the traditional texts on philosophy, in "about twenty volumes". Lost. Probably a commentary on logic and theoretical philosophy. Due to its correspondence in extension with the *Kitāb al-Inṣāf* (see below)—also "potentially" in twenty volumes and lacking mathematics—we can surmise that

[1] See Appendix F, IV.

the part on theoretical philosophy encompassed only natural philosophy and metaphysics. Gutas [1988], p. 98, describes it as the first part—together with the *Kitāb al-Birr wa-l-iṯm*—of a "*summa* in the form of a running commentary"; on account of its literary genre (a commentary rather than an original work), it has to be kept distinct from the other *summae* by Avicenna.

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 94–98.

Information about the part dealing with the *Metaphysics* is provided by the *Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī* (from which we learn that the entire work was a "commentary", *tafsīr*):

> [Answer to the fifth question] As to the accidental causes, like chance, even though their ends belong to them by accident, the causes [themselves] are stable by essence. Whoever wants to have a clear idea of this point has to investigate the second treatise of Aristotle's book *De Physico Auditu* or our commentary (*tafsīrinā*) on the first treatise of the book *Metaphysics* (*kitāb māṭāfūsīqā*) about what exists beyond natural things (*fī mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿiyyāti*).[2]

and the *Memoirs*:

> As a matter of fact, Avicenna himself had composed a separate commentary (*tafsīr mufrad*) on this book [i.e. on the *Metaphysics*], whose explanation of the letter Aliph Minor [alone] contained approximately everything in the commentary imported from Baġdād [i.e. the commentary by Abū l-Farağ Ibn al-Ṭayyib]. Furthermore, he did not include in it any problem with which he had already exhaustively dealt[3] in the science of logic, or in the science of nature or mathematics. Nothing was repeated in it. No clarification was lengthy but rather expressed as concisely as possible (*bi-awğazi lafzin*), despite the inclusion of [all] the [relevant] notions.[4]

4. ***Risāla fī Aqsām al-ʿulūm al-ʿaqliyya*** (*Treatise on the Divisions of the Intellectual Sciences*): early period [?][5]

Description: classification of philosophy (practical philosophy, theoretical philosophy, logic), whose aim is to show that there is no

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[2] Avicenna [1974c], p. 23, 13–14. See Gutas [1988], pp. 97–98, and nn. 12–13.

[3] Reading *faraġa minhā* instead of *faraʿa ʿanhā*.

[4] Mahdavī [1954], pp. 209, 23–210, 2; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 71 and n. 17 (modified).

[5] According to Gutas [1988], p. 253, it "must be considered a relatively early treatise". In fact, it reproduces the traditional way of classifying philosophy.

conflict between philosophy and religious law. The language Avicenna uses has strong religious accents.

Editions: Avicenna [1986] (for previous editions, see Michot [1980], p. 62, n. 1).

Translations: Mahdi [1963] (Engl. transl. of the general division of philosophy and of the part on practical philosophy); Anawati [1977] (integral French translation); Michot [1980] (French translation of the part on natural philosophy and metaphysics); Mimoune [1984] (integral French translation); for previous translations, see Michot [1980], p. 62, nn. 2–3.

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 253–254; Jolivet [1996], pp. 1019–1021; Zonta [2001]; Gutas [2003] (on the position of medicine in the classification).

Metaphysics (*ʿilm ilāhī*, "divine science") is divided as follows (see Chapter 5, §2, Table 2):

[I] Fundamental divisions (*aqsām aṣliyya*)	
[1] Investigation of the notions (*maʿānī*) that are common to all existents: [1.1] "being" (*huwiyya*),[6] [1.2] unity and multiplicity, [1.3] coincidence (*wifāq*) and difference (*ḫilāf*), [1.4] contrariety (*taḍādd*), [1.5] potentiality and actuality, [1.6] cause and effect	OntologyP
[2.1] investigation of the fundaments (*uṣūl*) and principles of natural philosophy, mathematics and logic, [2.2] refutation of the false opinions regarding them [i.e. these fundaments and principles]	OntologyS
[3] Existence, unicity and attributes of God	OntologyC/Theology
[4] Celestial intellects and celestial souls	OntologyC/Theology
[5] Relationship of the sublunar world with the celestial	OntologyC/Theology
[II] Derivative divisions (*furūʿ*, "branches")	
[1] Prophecy	OntologyC/Theology
[2] Eschatology	OntologyC/Theology

[6] For a discussion of *huwiyya* as a term signifying "being" in the *Ilāhiyyāt* and in other Avicennian works, see Bertolacci [2003].

Metaphysics is articulated in five fundamental ([I.1–5]) and two derivative divisions ([II.1–2]). The first two fundamental divisions ([I.1–2]) roughly correspond, respectively, to OntologyP and OntologyS. Within Ontology P, "existent" ([1.1]) is not kept distinct from its properties ([1.2–6]). OntologyC/Theology is the final and most extensive part, covering the last three fundamental divisions ([I.3–5]) and both derivative divisions.

5. ***Kitāb al-Mabdaʾ wa-l-maʿād*** (*Book of Provenance and Destination*): 403/1013 (W4)

Description: treatise in three parts. The first two deal with the "fruit" of metaphysics (namely the provenance of all things from God, or natural theology), called *uṯūlūğiyā* with reference—according to Gutas [1988], p. 31, n. 2—to the *Theologia Aristotelis*). The third part deals with the "fruit" of physics (namely the survivance of the human soul after the death of the body and its return to God, or "metaphysics of the rational soul"). The first two parts are reproduced, slightly modified, in both *Ilāhiyyāt* and *Naǧāt*.

Editions: Avicenna [1984].

Translations: Michot [1994] (integral French translation); Iskandar [1999] (integral Portuguese translation); Gutas [1988] pp. 30–32 (Text 4), p. 263 (L54), p. 290 (L70), p. 292 (L71), p. 312 (L84) (Engl. transl. of MS Ambrosiana 320 Hammer, corresponding to Avicenna [1984] p. 1; pp. 33–34; pp. 61, 17–62, 7 passim; p. 66, 10–11, 13, p. 84, 9; p. 81, 14–19); Wisnovsky [2003], p. 252 (L74), p. 253 (L75) (Engl. transl. of Avicenna [1984], p. 2, 4–17, p. 3, 2–15).

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 98–99 (overview); pp. 290–292 (evolution of Avicenna's way of referring to Greek and Arab authors).[7] Alexander of Aphrodisias [2002], pp. 57–60 (Endress' account of the influence of the Arabic epitome of Alexander's *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*).

[7] Aristotle (*al-faylasūf*, "the Philosopher") is quoted at p. 34, 3; p. 61, 10 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 392, 4); p. 61, 18 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 392, 9); p. 62, 3 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 392, 15–16); p. 68, 7 (= *Ilāhiyyāt*, p. 401, 16); p. 68, 14; p. 68, 21; p. 85, 8. Alexander of Aphrodisias (*al-Iskandar*) is quoted at p. 61, 18; p. 62, 5; p. 62, 18; p. 72, 14.

6. ***ʿUyūn al-Ḥikma*** (*Sources of Wisdom*): before 414/1023 [?][8]

Description: short *summa* on logic, natural philosophy and metaphysics.

Editions: Avicenna [1980b].

Studies: Bertolacci [2002], p. 34, n. 14; p. 36; pp. 38–39.

7. ***Kitāb al-Hidāya*** (*Book of Guidance*): 414/1023

Description: *summa* on logic, natural philosophy and metaphysics.

Editions: Avicenna [1974].

Translations of the part on metaphysics: Michot [1988] (French translation of chapter 6, pp. 300–312); Lizzini [1995] (integral Italian translation).

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 258–259; Lizzini [1995]; Bertolacci [2002], p. 35, n. 116; p. 36; p. 40.

8. ***Kitāb al-Šifāʾ***: ca. 411–418/1020–1027 (W6)

Description: *summa* on logic, natural philosophy, mathematics and metaphysics (this latter contains an appendix on practical philosophy).

Editions of the part on metaphysics: Avicenna [1885]; Avicenna [1960]; Avicenna [1997–8].

Translations of the part on metaphysics. Integral: Horten [1907] (German); Anawati [1978], Anawati [1985] (French); Lizzini [2002] (Italian); Marmura [2005] (English); Bertolacci [forthcoming] (Italian). Partial: Marmura [1963] (Engl. transl. of X, 2–5); Hyman [1970] (Engl. transl. of I, 6, VI, 1–2); Hourani [1972] contains the Engl. transl. of I, 6; Marmura [1975] (Engl. transl. of III, 10); Marmura [1981] contains the Engl. transl. of IV, 1; Marmura [1984b] (Engl. transl. of I, 5); Gutas [1988] contains the Engl. transl. of IX, 2, p. 392, 8–10, pp. 392, 15–393, 5 (L[emma]70); IX, 3, p. 399, 8–11 (L71); IX, 4, p. 408–15–17 (L84); X, 1, p. 439, 6–17 (L1); X, 2, pp. 442, 10–443, 12 (L75); Marmura [1991–2] (contains the English translation of a part of III, 9); Fakhry [1994] (Engl. transl. of IX, 6); Inati [1999] (Engl. transl. of IX, 6); Wisnovsky [2003] contains the Engl. transl. of I, 5, p. 33, 16–18 (L[emma]35); I, 6, p. 37, 7–11 (L76); I, 6, p. 38, 1–5 (L77); IV, 3, pp. 188, 3–189, 11 (L53); VI, 1, p. 258, 1–8

[8] Gutas [1988], p. 258, maintains that this work may antedate the *Hidāya*.

(L30); VI, 5, pp. 289, 16–290, 5 (L29); VI, 5, pp. 292, 1–294, 5 (L36); VI, 5, p. 294, 6–9, pp. 294, 12–295, 12 (L32); VIII, 6, pp. 355, 6–356, 5 (L51).

Studies: see "Secondary Literature" in the Bibliography.

9. ***Kitāb al-Naǧāt*** (*Book of Salvation*): ca. 418/1027 (W7)

Description: *summa* originally encompassing three parts: logic, natural philosophy and metaphysics. The part on mathematics was added by al-Ǧūzǧānī. Metaphysics consists of two treatises (I–II). Some sections of Ontology are copied from *Al-Ḥikma al-ʿArūḍīya'*; OntologyC/Theology is copied from *Mabda'*. Chapters II, 7–9 and II, 16–40 of OntologyC/Theology are almost *verbatim* identical to chapters VIII, 5–X, 3 of OntologyC/Theology in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see Goichon [1937], pp. 501–503); both works depend, in this respect, on *Mabda'* (see Gutas [1988], pp. 112–114; Mahdavī [1987]).

Editions: Avicenna [1913]; Avicenna [1938]; Avicenna [1985]; Avicenna [1985b].

Translations: Carame [1926] (intregral translation in modern Latin); Wisnovsky [2000], p. 202 (Engl. transl. of I, 11, Avicenna [1985b], p. 248, 8–15); Wisnovsky [2003a], p. 163 (L 37) (Engl. transl. of I, 11, Avicenna [1913], p. 345, 1–11); Marmura [1991–1992], pp. 178–180 (Engl. transl. of I, 12, Avicenna [1938], pp. 213–214); Hourani [1972], pp. 78–82 (Engl. transl. of II, 1–3, Avicenna [1938], pp. 224–227, and II, 12, p. 235); Marmura [1980a], p. 350 (Engl. transl. of II, 12, Avicenna [1938], p. 235); Fakhry [1994], Appendix B', pp. 219–226 (Engl. transl. of II, 37, Avicenna [1985b], pp. 320–326); Arberry [1979], pp. 42–49, 64–76 (Engl. transl. of II, 38 and II, 40, unspecified edition); Gutas [1988], p. 292 (L71), p. 312 (L84) (Engl. transl. of II, 32, Avicenna [1913], p. 444, 13–17; II, 33, p. 458, 2–6; II, 36, p. 463, 12; comparison with the parallel passages in *Mabda'* and *Ilāhiyyāt*).

Studies: Gutas [1988], p. 100, pp. 112–114; Marmura [1980], in particular pp. 339–341; Davidson [1987], pp. 289–304; Mahdavī [1987]; Bertolacci [2002], p. 35, n. 17; p. 36; pp. 41–42.

10. ***Dānešnāme-ye ʿAlāʾī*** (*Philosophy for ʿAlāʾ-al-Dawla*): ca. 418/1027 (W8)

Description: *summa* originally encompassing logic, metaphysics, natural philosophy; the part on mathematics was added by al-Ǧūzǧānī. It closely resembles *Naǧāt* in scope and execution. The main difference is that the part on metaphysics precedes that on physics (as in *Mašriqiyyūn*).

Editions: Avicenna [1951].

Translations: Achena-Massé [1986] (integral French translation); Zabeeh in Avicenna [1971] (Engl. transl. of the section on logic); Morewedge [1973] (Engl. transl. of the section on metaphysics). Gutas [1988], pp. 19–21 (Engl. transl. of the penultimate chapter of the section on natural philosophy).

Studies: Janssens [1986b]; Gutas [1988], p. 114; Gaskill [1992]; Bertolacci [2002], p. 35, n. 115; p. 36; pp. 39–40; Wisnovsky [2003], pp. 167–168.

11. ***Al-Mašriqiyyūn*** (*The Easterners*) or ***Al-Ḥikma al-mašriqiyya*** (*Eastern Philosophy*): ca. 418–420/1027–1029 (W9)

Description: *summa* on logic, metaphysics, natural philosophy and the essential elements of practical philosophy. Incompletely preserved. The only extant parts (also incomplete) are those on logic and natural philosophy. According to the summary of contents at the end of the Introduction, metaphysics follows logic and precedes natural philosophy and practical philosophy. Within metaphysics, Avicenna adopts the "not generally aknowledged" division of Ontology ("universal science") from Theology ("divine science"; see Appendix D, III).

Editions: Avicenna [1910], pp. 19–83 (part of the logical section, from the beginning to the portion corresponding to the *Prior Analytics*).

Translations: Gutas [1988], pp. 43–49, Text 8 (Engl. transl. of Avicenna [1910], pp. 2–4); p. 254, L50 (Engl. transl. of the part of the classification of the sciences regarding metaphysics, corresponding to Avicenna [1910], p. 7, 5–7).

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 115–130; Gutas [2000].

12. ***Kitāb al-Inṣāf*** (*Book of the Fair Judgment*): 420/1029 (W10)

Description: "detailed literal commentary on the Aristotelian *corpus*, including the *Theologia Aristotelis*" (Gutas [1988], p. 136). Three texts

probably related to this work are extant in the MS Cairo, Dār al-Kutub, *ḥikma* 6, whose scribe, ʿAbd-al-Razzāq al-Ṣiġnāḫī, was a third generation student of Avicenna (see Gutas [1987b]; Michot [1991]). Reisman [2002], p. 203, n. 125, maintains that the extant portions of the *Inṣāf* are most likely notes on, or summaries of, original parts of Avicenna's work by Abū-Manṣūr b. Zayla (d. 440/1048), a first generation student of Avicenna.

1) a commentary (*šarḥ*) on *Metaphysics* Λ, 6–10, 1071b5–1075a27 (a copy of an extract made by a disciple). Quoted by al-Šahrastānī in the *Milal* (Al-Šahrastānī [1842–6], pp. 312, 19–320, 4; Jolivet-Monnot [1993], pp. 285–301).

Editions: Avicenna [1947]. Forthcoming critical edition and French translation by M. Geoffroy, J. Janssens and M. Sebti (see Janssens [2003], p. 401, n. 2).

Translations: Sebti [1992]; Gutas [1988], pp. 264, 315–316 (Engl. transl. of Avicenna [1947], pp. 23, 21–24, 1, p. 29, 19–21); Hasnawi [1996], p. 37 (French translation of Avicenna [1947], pp. 26, 3–6); Pines [1987], p. 191 (Engl. transl. of Avicenna [1947], pp. 26, 23–27, 4). The summary (by F. Zimmermann) of Avicenna [1947], pp. 23, 21–26, 22, is available in Sorabji [1988], p. 263, and Sorabji [1990], pp. 187–190.

Studies: Davidson [1987], pp. 282–283; Gutas [1988], pp. 130–140; Bertolacci [2001], pp. 271–274; Janssens [2003]; Geoffroy [2003], pp. 422–423.

2–3) two different recensions of Avicenna's exegesis of the *Theologia Aristotelis* (*Uṯūlūǧiyā*), called respectively "commentary" (*šarḥ*) and "interpretation" (*tafsīr*).

Editions: Avicenna [1947b]. The two recensions are intermingled in this edition, which reproduces only a part of the former (pp. 59, 13–66, 4), together with the latter in its entirety (see Gutas [1987b], pp. 12b–13a). A fragment that Badawī regards as belonging to the second recension (pp. 73, 15–74, 13) has been shown by Hasnawi [1997] to be an independent work, probably not by Avicenna.

Translations: Vajda [1951] (integral French translation).

Studies: F. Zimmermann [1986], pp. 183–184; Gutas [1988], pp. 130–140, pp. 315–316; Aouad [1989], pp. 583–586; Bertolacci [2001], pp. 271–274; Plotinus [2003], pp. 102–111; D'Ancona [2003], pp. 222–224; Adamson [2004]; Adamson [2004b].

13. ***Kitāb al-Išārāt wa-l-tanbīhāt*** (*Book of Pointers and Reminders*): ca. 421–425/1030–1034 (W11)[9]

Description: *summa* in two parts, the former dealing with logic, the latter with natural philosophy (II, 1–3) and metaphysics (II, 4–10).

Editions: Avicenna [1892]; Avicenna [1957–60]; Avicenna [1960–8].

Translations: Goichon [1951] (integral French translation of Avicenna [1892]); Michot [1983] (French translation of II, 8 according to Avicenna [1892]); Inati [1996] (Engl. transl. of II, 8–10 according to Avicenna [1957–1960]); Gutas [1988], pp. 54–56 (Engl. transl. of the prologues to logic, natural philosophy and metaphysics, and of the epilogue according to a four volumes edition by S. Dunyā, 1960–1968, vol. I, pp. 113–114; vol. II, p. 147; vol. IV, p. 161–164, which I have not been able to identify); Marmura [1980], p. 340, pp. 351–352 (Engl. transl. of II, 4 according to Avicenna [1957–60], p. 482, pp. 447–455); Muñoz [1981], pp. 90–91 (Spanish translation of II, 4 according to Avicenna [1960–8], vol. III, pp. 19–27 = Avicenna [1957–60], pp. 447–455); Cruz Hernandez [2002], pp. 52–53 (Spanish translation of II, 4, pp. 138–142, 145–146, according to Avicenna [1892]); Wisnovsky [2003], p. 169 (L40, L41), p. 258 (L78) (Engl. transl. of II, 4, p. 139, 14–20, p. 140, 6–9, pp. 140, 12–141, 2, according to Avicenna [1892]).

Studies: Marmura [1980], in particular pp. 339–341; Muñoz [1981]; Davidson [1987], pp. 287, 289, 297, nn. 94, 97, 298–304; Gutas [1988], pp. 140–141; Mayer [2001]; Bertolacci [2002], p. 34, n. 113; p. 36; pp. 37–38.

14. ***Taʿlīqāt*** (*Notes*): ca. 428/1037 (W12)

Description: collection of discrete paragraphs of varying length discussing different subjects in logic, natural philosophy and metaphysics.

Editions: Avicenna [1973].

Translations: Wisnovsky [2003], p. 173 (L46), p. 175 (L48), p. 186 (L52), p. 194 (L56) (Engl. transl. of p. 128, 17–19; p. 128, 17–25;

[9] The chronology of the *Išārāt* is discussed by Gutas [1988], pp. 123–124, p. 140 n. 1 (late dating); Michot [1997] (early dating). Michot's dating is rejected by Wisnovsky [2000], p. 217, n. 71 (he regards it as "highly tentative"), Gutas [2003b], p. 381, Reisman [2002b], pp. 564b–565a. Mayer [2001], p. 21, does not take position on the issue. The *Šifāʾ* is quoted in the *Išārāt* (Avicenna [1892], p. 21, 15–16).

p. 18, 4, 51, 28, 62, 3–5, 62, 12–13, 80, 25–26, 160, 5–6, 178, 25–26; p. 62, 11–24).

Studies: Gutas [1988] pp. 142–144; Janssens [1997b].

Jannsens [1997b], p. 116 and n. 15, remarks the presence in the *Taʿlīqāt* of paraphrases and quotations of the *Ilāhiyyāt*.

15. ***Mubāḥaṯāt*** (*Discussions*): ca. 428/1037 (W12)

Description: "a collection of philosophical questions and Avicenna's written answers, the latter occasionally found in the form of letters" (Gutas [1988], p. 143).

Editions: Avicenna [1947e]; Avicenna [1992].

Translations: Michot [1997] (French translation of Avicenna [1992], pp. 55–79); Michot [2000], pp. 48*–50* (French translation of Avicenna [1992], pp. 104–105, on equivocity of being and doctrine of causality); Wisnovsky [2003], p. 176 (L49) (Engl. transl. of Avicenna [1992], pp. 116, 15–117, 2).

Studies: Gutas [1988], pp. 142–144; Reisman [2002].

For a detailed table of correspondences between the *Mubāḥaṯāt* and the *Ilāhiyyāt*, see Reisman [2002], Appendix F, I.B.c., pp. 291–292; Appendix F, II, pp. 295–302 passim.

The *Mubāḥaṯāt* contain a synopsis (*talḫīṣ*) of the *Ilāhiyyāt*, ascribed to Bahmanyār (see Reisman [2002], p. 43, and Appendix F, I.B.c.2, p. 293; II, p. 300). These passages cover paragraph numbers 799–817 of Avicenna [1992]. They begin with *mawḍūʿ al-ʿilm al-maʿrūf bi-mā baʿda t-ṭabīʿa*. . . . and cover *Ilāhiyyāt* random passages from pp. 13–346.

APPENDIX D

NAMES OF ARISTOTLE'S *METAPHYSICS* AND OF METAPHYSICS AS A DISCIPLINE IN AVICENNA'S WORKS

(I) In the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna refers to Aristotle's *Metaphysics* neither by means of the transliteration of the Greek title (*māṭāṭāfūsiqā*)—as he does in early works—nor by means of its calque (*mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*, "What comes after physics")—as he does in other works—but by means of the qualifying description *taʿlīm awwal* ("First Teaching"), corresponding to the designation of Aristotle as *muʿallim awwal* ("First Teacher"). The significance of this shift in Avicenna's philosophical jargon has already been pointed out: it indicates Avicenna's interest in the "spirit" (i.e. in the doctrine), more than the "letter" of this work by Aristotle.[1] In this regard, the way according to which Avicenna refers to the *Metaphysics* in the *Ilāhiyyāt* fits adequately the style of the *Šifāʾ* (see Appendix E).

(II.i) In the *Ilāhiyyāt*, the name (*ism*) of metaphysics as a discipline is, properly speaking, only *ʿilm fī mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa* ("science of what comes after physics") or—if metaphysics is regarded in itself, not according to us—*ʿilm mā qabla l-ṭabīʿa* ("science of what comes before physics"). Avicenna assigns this name to metaphysics in I, 3, as one of the preliminary issues discussed in the Prolegomena.[2]

(II.ii) Throughout the *Ilāhiyyāt*, however, Avicenna refers to metaphysics by means of other denominations. They are primarily *ʿilm ilāhī* ("divine science"), *falsafa ūlā* ("first philosophy"), and *ḥikma* ("wisdom"). These are the names assigned to metaphysics as a discipline by Aristotle himself in the *Metaphysics*.[3] In *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1–2, Avicenna recalls what these names traditionally mean and shows how they apply to metaphysics.[4] In so doing he adopts—indirectly and through

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[1] See Gutas [1988], pp. 286–296, especially pp. 292–293.

[2] I, 3, pp. 21, 12–24, 9 [pp. 24, 45–27, 13]. See Chapter 5, §4.2.

[3] See Mansion [1958].

[4] "Divine science": I, 1, p. 4, 14–17 [pp. 2, 29–3, 34] (= Chapter 4, Text 1); I, 2, p. 15, 13–16 [p. 16, 95–99] (= Chapter 4, Text 4.5); "First philosophy": I, 1, p. 5, 7–8 [p. 3, 44–46] (= Chapter 7, Text 1); I, 2, p. 15, 9–11 [pp. 15, 89–16, 91] (see Chapter 7, n. 5); "wisdom": I, 1, p. 5, 8–10 [p. 3, 46–50]: "You have heard sometimes that wisdom is the most excellent knowledge of the most excellent thing

the mediation of the subsequent tradition—Aristotle's point of view on these denominations.[5]

In the *Ilāhiyyāt*, all the aforementioned names apply to metaphysics in its entirety, not to one or more of its parts, as Avicenna's description of these names in I, 1–3 shows.[6] Also in other sections of the *Šifā'* and in other works by Avicenna these names often refer to metaphysics *tout court*, not to a part of it.

(III.i) In some works by Avicenna, the theological part of metaphysics receives a name on its own. This happens in four works, belonging either to the "transition period" (1013–1014)—*Mabda'*, *'Uyūn*—or to the "middle period" (1023–1027)—*Dānešnāme*—or to the "period of Eastern philosophy" (1027–1030)—*Mašriqiyyūn*. The

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that is known; some other times that wisdom is the knowledge that is most true and most certain; some other times that it is the science of the first causes of the universe"; I, 2, p. 15, 11–13 [p. 16, 91–95]: "It [i.e. the knowledge sought for in the present discipline] is also "wisdom", namely the most excellent knowledge of the most excellent thing that is known. For it is the most excellent knowledge, namely certainty, of the most excellent thing that is known, namely God . . . and the causes [that come] after Him. It is also the knowledge of the ultimate causes of the universe".

[5] On the Aristotelian background Avicenna's description of metaphysics as "divine science", "first philosophy" and "wisdom" see, respectively, Chapter 4, §2.1, Chapter 7, §5.1, and the remarks on I, 1, p. 5, 8–10 [p. 3, 46–50] and I, 2, p. 15, 11–13 [p. 16, 91–95] in Chapter 8, §5.1, Outline 4.1.

[6] As to the name "science of what comes after physics", Avicenna makes clear in I, 3, p. 23, 2–8 [p. 26, 78–86], that it applies to metaphysics in its entirety (*hāḏā l-'īlm*, "this science") on account of its theological part. Among the immaterial things that the "divine science" investigates (I, 2, p. 15, 13–16 [p. 16, 95–99]) Avicenna places not only the "principles" (*mabādi'*) of "existent" (corresponding to OntologyC/Theology), but also "existent *qua* existent" itself and its properties (corresponding to OntologyP and probably also OntologyS); thus, also the name "divine science" applies to the entire metaphysics. Although in I, 1, p. 5, 7–8 [p. 3, 44–46], the name "first philosophy" designates the discipline that verifies the principles of the other sciences (see Chapter 7, Text 1), thus giving the impression of referring to OntologyS (see Chapter 5, Text 2 [3*]; Gutas [1988], pp. 252–253, actually calls "first philosophy" OntologyS), in I, 2, p. 15, 9–11 [pp. 15, 89–16, 91] Avicenna provides a different description of "first philosophy", in which this discipline deals with both the first thing in the order of existence (i.e. the First Cause) and the first things in the order of universality (i.e. existence and unity); furthermore, the discussion of the principles of the other sciences in the *Ilāhiyyāt* occurs not only in OntologyS, but also in OntologyP (see Chapter 7). Also the name "first philosophy", therefore, originates from a consideration of metaphysics in its entirety, and is not restricted to one of its parts. Even though in I, 2, p. 15, 11–13 [p. 16, 91–95] Avicenna mentions only God and the "ultimate causes" (*al-asbāb al-quṣwā*) as the concern of "wisdom", this name applies not to a part of metaphysics, but to the entire metaphysics on account of one of its parts (as in the case of the name "science of what comes after physics").

names used are either *uṯūlūğiyā* ("theology"), which echoes the Arabic title of the *Theologia Aristotelis*, or *ʿilm ilāhī* ("divine science") and related expressions, which are employed elsewhere to refer to metaphysics in its entirety. All this can be seen as a sign of the peculiar importance that Avicenna persistently attaches to the theological part of metaphysics over the other parts.

(III.ii) In one single case, Avicenna assigns a proper name also to the non-theological part of metaphysics. This happens in the *Mašriqiyyūn* with regard to the name *ʿilm al-kullī* ("universal science"), employed elsewhere to refer to the entire metaphysics. In the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, Avicenna portrays the *Mašriqiyyūn* as having a mode of exposition different from that of the *Šifāʾ*. The attribution of two special names ("divine science" and "universal science") to the two main parts of metaphysics in the *Mašriqiyyūn* might represent one of the stylistic differences between this work and the *Šifāʾ* alluded to in the Prologue to this latter.[7]

I. Names of Aristotle's *Metaphysics*

1.1. Transliteration of the Greek:
kitāb māṭāṭāfūsiqā *ay mā baʿd al-ṭabīʿa*
Aqsām, p. 91, 1 (*māṭāṭānūsiqā ilā mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa* in the text; correction proposed by Michot [1980], p. 69 and nn. 84–85).
kitāb māṭāfūsīqā *fī mā baʿd al-ṭabīʿiyyāt*
Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī, p. 23, 14 (Avicenna's answer to the fifth question); see Gutas [1988], p. 293 and n. 33.

For some instances of the use of this expression both before Avicenna (*Fihrist*) and after him (the manuscript preserving Averroes' *Tafsīr* on the *Metaphysics*), see Bouyges [1952], pp. cxxv. See also *Theologia Aristotelis* [1955], Prologue, p. 5, 12.

[7] Since the name "universal science" does not occur in the *Ilāhiyyāt*, whereas it represents a peculiarity of the *Mašriqiyyūn*, calling "universal science" the non-theological part of metaphysics in the *Ilāhiyyāt* (as in Gutas [1988], pp. 252–253) might efface a significant difference between these two works.

1.2. Transliterations of the titles of other works by Aristotle and works by other authors:
Īsāġūǧī (Porphyry's *Isagoge*): *Nafs* I, 1, p. 10, 4 [p. 25, 11]; V, 6, p. 240, 3 [p. 136, 66]; *Išārāt* II, 11, Avicenna [1957–1960], p. 265, 12–13; *Kitāb Ī.*: *Burhān* II, 2, p. 130, 18.
Qāṭīġūriyās (*Categories*): *Maqūlāt* I, 1, p. 4, 21; *Qiyās*, I, 2, p. 14, 10; *Nafs* I, 1, p. 10, 5 [p. 25, 11]; *Kitāb Q.*: *Maqūlāt* VI, 1, p. 207, 2; *al-Kitāb al-musammā bi-Q.*: *Maqūlāt* V, 4, p. 189, 8.
Bārī Irmīniyās (*De Interpretatione*): *Qiyās* I, 3, p. 19, 8.
Ṭūbīqā (*Topics*): *Maǧmūʿ*, f. 10r; *Ḥāl al-Nafs*, p. 55, 8 (see Gutas [1988], p. 293, n. 30).
Rīṭūrīqā (*Rhetoric*): *Maǧmūʿ*, f. 34v (see Gutas [1988], p. 293, n. 31).
Fū'īṭīqā (*Poetics*): *Maǧmūʿ*, f. 45v (see Gutas [1988], p. 293, n. 32).

2. Calque of the Greek:
(kitāb) mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa
Aqsām, p. 91, 1 (see above, I.1).
Correspondence with al-Bīrūnī, p. 23, 14 (see above, I.1).
Autobiography, p. 32, 1 (cp. p. 34, 1).
Mabdaʾ, p. 34, 5 (Gutas [1988], p. 263; Michot [1994], p. 25).
Letter to Abū Saʿd, p. 45, 12: *mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*; p. 46, 5: *kitāb mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*; p. 47, 8–9: *mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*; p. 49, 1: *mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa.*
Mubāḥaṯāt, ## 136, 140, 694.[8]
Ḥawāšī Kitāb al-nafs, p. 75, 11.
Šarḥ Tafsīr Uṯūlūǧiyā, p. 37, 8 (Vajda [1951], p. 349).
Memoirs, p. 209, 19, 21 (Gutas [1988], p. 71).

Alexander of Aphrodisias, *Fī Mabādiʾ al-kull*, p. 92, 3. *Theologia Aristotelis* [1955], Prologue, p. 5, 1–2. Al-Kindī, *Risāla fī Kammiyyat kutub Arisṭūṭālīs*, Al-Kindī [1940], p. 393, 35; p. 403, 8 (*mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿiyyāt*). Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 34, 4–5; *Iḥṣāʾ*, p. 120, 6; *Ǧamʿ*, p. 83, 3–8, p. 133, 13–17, p. 143, 1–10; *Falsafa Arisṭūṭālīs*, Al-Fārābī [1961], p. 132, 2–3.

[8] But in #1004, *Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa* refers to Avicenna's *Ilāhiyyāt* itself (this might be the result of the transferral to the *Ilāhiyyāt* of what Avicenna says in *Ilāhiyyāt*, I, 3, with regard to the name of metaphysics, or indicate that the *Ilāhiyyāt* not only substituted Aristotle's *Metaphysics*, but also took its name among the very first disciples of Avicenna). Also in the letter *Taʿalluq al-nafs bi-l-badan* ascribed to Avicenna (whose autenticity is questioned by D. C. Reisman) the *Ilāhiyyāt* is referred to as *Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa.*

For the use of this expression in the Arabic catalogue of Aristotle's works ascribed to Ptolemy "The Stranger" (*al-ġarīb*), see Narcy [2003], p. 224; for the use of this expression after Avicenna (in Averroes' *Tafsīr* on the *Metaphysics*, etc.), see Bouyges [1952], p. cxxvi.

3. (With regard to the description of Aristotle as "First Teacher", *al-muʿallim al-awwal*) ***al-taʿlīm al-awwal*** ("First Teaching"): *Ilāhiyyāt*, VIII, 2, p. 332, 4 [p. 382, 31] (see Appendix B, II.2).

The expression "First Teaching" does not always refer to the *Metaphysics*. In other parts of the *Šifāʾ*, sometimes it designates the Aristotelian *corpus* in general: *ʿIbāra* II, 3, p. 111, 4 (cp. "the beginning of the [First] Teaching", *ibtidāʾ al-taʿlīm*, in II, 3, p. 101, 6); *Ǧadal* I, 4, p. 38, 1 (as noticed by Gutas [1988], p. 287, n. 10); *Ǧadal* I, 5, p. 43, 11 (the Peripatetics are the "partisans of the First Teaching", *aṣḥāb al-taʿlīm al-awwal*); *Šiʿr*, chpt. 2, p. 31, 8 (see Dahiyat [1974], p. 70, n. 1). In other cases, it designates the particular work by Aristotle Avicenna is dealing with: *ʿIbāra* I, 3, p. 17, 8; I, 6, p. 43, 1; *Qiyās* I, 3, p. 26, 15; I, 4, p. 31, 10; II, 3, p. 105, 10; *Burhān*, p. 73, 20; p. 228, 2; p. 228, 4 etc. (see the index, p. 339); *Samāʿ*, I, 1, p. 7, 13–14: "It has already been explained [by Aristotle] in the Teaching about demonstration (*fī taʿlīm al-burhān*) [. . .]". Likewise, in the psychological part of the *Mašriqiyyūn*, this expression designates Aristotle's *De Anima* (see Gutas [2000], p. 173, n. 40). It is also used to refer to non-Aristotelian works: in *Hayʾa*, I, 1, p. 15, 4–5, the part of the *Šifāʾ* dealing with astronomy is described as "the concise exposition of Ptolemy's book on the Teaching [regarding astronomy] (*talḫīṣ kitāb Baṭlamiyūs fī l-taʿlīm*).

Outside the *Ilāhiyyāt* (see Appendix B, I.2), Aristotle is called "First Teacher" in *Maqūlāt* III, 4, p. 122, 17; VII, 1, p. 248, 19; VII, 3, p. 261, 10–11; *ʿIbāra* II, 3, p. 101, 5–6; II, 4, p. 119, 15; p. 121, 1; *Qiyās* III, 2, p. 148, 9, 12; VIII, 1, p. 398, 10, 14, 17; *Samāʿ* I, 6, p. 36, 12; *Nafs* III, 5, p. 126, 6 [p. 229, 6]; III, 7, p. 149, 20 [p. 266, 97]; "this excellent First Teacher" (*hāḏā al-fāḍil al-muʿallim al-awwal*), in *ʿIbāra* II, 4, p. 121, 2; "their Teacher" (*muʿallimuhum*), i.e. teacher of the "Posterior Peripatetics" (*mutaʾaḫḫirū al-mašāʾīna*), in *Samāʿ* I, 13, p. 63, 10; "Master of the First Teaching" (*ṣāḥib al-taʿlīm al-awwal*) in *ʿIbāra* II, 3, p. 111, 4.

For occurrences of the expression "First Teacher" in other works by Avicenna and their significance, see Gutas [1988], p. 287, n. 9.

Other names of the *Metaphysics* in the Arabic tradition are:

4) *Kitāb al-Ḥurūf* ("Book of letters"): *Fihrist*, vol. I, p. 151, 25 (see above, Chapter 1, Text 1); al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 34, 4: *al-Kitāb al-mawsūm bi-l-ḥurūf* ("the Book named by means of letters"); see Bouyges [1952], pp. cxxiv–cxxv.

5) *Al-Ilāhiyyāt* ("Divine matters"): *Fihrist*, vol. I, p. 151, 25 (see above, Chapter 1, Text 1); see Bouyges [1952], p. cxxv. For "theology" as the name of the *Metaphysics* in Greek neoplatonism, see Plotinus [2003], p. 81, n. 213.

6) *Kitāb Uṯūlūğiyā* ("Book of Theology"): al-Šahrastānī, *Milal*, p. 103, 5.

II Names of Metaphysics as a Discipline

II.i *Its Proper Name*

1. ***mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*** and related expressions
mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa
Samāʿ I, 14, p. 67, 7–9.
mā baʿdahū (i.e. *ʿilm al-ṭabīʿa)*
Išārāt, Prologue to Logic, Avicenna [1892], p. 2, 8 (*mā qablahū* mss. D and F in Avicenna [1892]; Avicenna [1957–60], p. 166, 1; Gutas [1988], p. 55 and n. 4).
ʿilm mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa
Burhān III, 1, p. 194, 11.
ʿilm mā baʿdahā (i.e. *al-ṭabīʿa*)
Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 10, 3–4.
ʿilm fī mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa
Ilāhiyyāt I, 3, p. 21, 12 [p. 24, 45–46]; p. 21, 16–17 [p. 24, 51]; cp. p. 23, 2 [p. 26, 78]; p. 23, 10 [p. 26, 90].
Mabdaʾ, Prologue, p. 1, 7, p. 1, 8.
al-ʿilm al-mansūb ilā Mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa ("the science related to [Aristotle's] *Metaphysics*")
Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 11, 11.[9]

[9] On account of the context of this passage (the indication of the sources of the

2. ***mā qabla l-ṭabīʿa*** and related expressions
mā qablahū (i.e. *ʿilm al-ṭabīʿa)*
Išārāt, Prologue to Logic (above, II.i.1).
ʿilm mā qabla l-ṭabīʿa
Ilāhiyyāt I, 3, p. 22, 2 [p. 25, 55–56] (cp. p. 22, 5 [p. 25, 60], p. 22, 7 [p. 25, 61–62]).

Al-Kindī, *Falsafa Ūlā*, Al-Kindī [1998], p. 25, 9–10: "science of what is above natural things" (*ʿilm mā fawqa l-ṭabīʿiyyāt*); cp. Al-Kindī [1950], p. 111, 13; Ivry [1974], p. 65).

Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 34, 9–10, p. 35, 21, p. 35, 23, p. 36, 9 (*ʿilm mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*); *Ǧamʿ*, p. 145, 15–17 (*al falsafatu llatī baʿda l-ṭabīʾati*); *Taḥṣīl al-saʿāda*, Al-Fārābī [1981], pp. 59, 18–61, 2 (*ʿilm mā baʿda l-ṭabīʿa/fawqa l-ṭabīʿa*); *Falsafa Aristūṭālīs*, Al-Fārābī [1961], p. 133, 1 (*al-ʿilmu lla<u>d</u>ī baʿda l-ṭabīʿa*).

II.ii *Additional Names*

1. ***al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*** ("divine science") and related expressions
al-ʿilm al-ilāhī
Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, p. 4, 15 [p. 2, 31]; p. 5, 2 [p. 3, 36]; I, 2, p. 15, 13 [p. 16, 95]; I, 3, p. 23, 4 [p. 26, 82].
Madḫal I, 2, p. 14, 9.
Nafs, Prologue, p. 3, 12 [p. 13, 64].
Naǧāt, Avicenna [1985b], pp. 235, 2; p. 235, 7.
Aqsām, p. 84, 9; p. 85, 5; p. 89, 16; p. 91, 1; p. 91, 3.
Autobiography, pp. 30, 7–31, 1.
Ḥawāšī Kitāb al-nafs, p. 75, 9.
Aġrām, p. 40, 17–18 (synonym of *al-falsafa al-ūlā*; see above, II.ii.2).
al-ṣināʿa al-ilāhiyya
Hāl al-Nafs, p. 113, 11
al-ḥikma al-ilāhiyya
Naǧāt, Avicenna [1985b], p. 233 (title of the third part).
al-ilāhiyya (i.e. *min aqsāmi al-falsafa al-nazariyya*)
Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, p. 4, 8 [p. 2, 21]; p. 4, 14 [p. 2, 28].
al-qism al-ilāhī (i.e. *min al-falsafa*)
Ilāhiyyāt VII, 2, p. 310, 13 [p. 358, 97].

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single parts of the *Šifāʾ*), I regard this expression as referring to metaphysics in general, with respect to its canonical text, i.e. Aristotle's *Metaphysics*. Gutas [1988], p. 54, p. 253, translates this expression as "the science that belongs to metaphysics".

ilāhiyyāt

Naǧāt, Avicenna [1985b], p. 235, 1 (title of the first treatise of the metaphysical part); p. 261, 1 (title of the second treatise of the metaphysical part).

The content of metaphysics is described as *ilāhiyyāt* ("divine things") in *Autobiography*, p. 24, 6; *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, p. 3, 3 (title).[10]

Other use of the adjective *al-ilāhī* in connection with metaphysics:
Ilāhiyyāt VI, 1, p. 257, 13 [p. 292, 20]: *al-falāsifa al-ilāhiyyūna* ("philosophers dealing with metaphysics").
Ilāhiyyāt IX, 7, p. 423, 10 [p. 507, 1–2]: *al-ḥukamā' al-ilāhiyyūna* ("wise men dealing with metaphysics").
Samāʿ I, 5, p. 30, 6: *al-ilāhī* ("the metaphysician").
Memoirs, p. 209, 22, 23: *al-sulūk al-ilāhī* ("metaphysical approach"); Gutas [1988], p. 71.

Aristotle calls metaphysics θεολογική [φιλοσοφία] ("theological [philosophy]") in *Metaph.* E, 1, 1026 a 19; Arabic translation: *ilāhiyya l-qawl*, in *Tafsīr*, p. 707, 6.

Al-Kindī, *Falsafa Ūlā*, p. 27, 2 (= Al-Kindī [1950], p. 113, 15; Ivry [1974], p. 66): sensation and representation should not be sought in the *ʿilm ilāhī* ("divine science").

Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 35, 16, p. 35, 19: *ʿilm ilāhī; Iḥṣā'*, p. 120, 5–6 (= Al-Fārābī [1953], p. 87, 12–13): *ʿilm ilāhī; Introduction to Logic*, Al-Fārābī [1956–7], p. 227, 13–22: *ʿilm ilāhī; Ǧamʿ*, p. 61, 3–5: *al-ilāhiyyāt*; cp. p. 58, 7–8, p. 73, 6–8, p. 81, 4–6; *Taḥṣīl al-saʿāda*, Al-Fārābī [1981], pp. 62, 4–63, 3: *al-naẓar al-ilāhī*.

Al-Ġazālī, *Tahāfut* (Al-Ġazālī [1997]), p. 160: "This is what we have wanted to mention concerning the sciences to which [the philosophers] have given the name 'metaphysical' (*ilāhiyya*)".

[10] Even though it is mirrored in the title of the Latin translation ("Liber de philosophia prima sive *scientia divina*", emphasis added), the title of the Arabic edited text is very probably not by Avicenna, since the *Ilāhiyyāt* is numbered there as the thirteenth section of the *Šifā'*. Now the *Ilāhiyyāt* can be computed as thirteenth section only by overlooking the entire logical part of the work (in so far as the part on natural philosophy encompasses eight sections, and that on mathematics four). It seems unlikely that this numeration can be due to Avicenna.

2. ***al-falsafa al-ūlā*** ("first philosophy") and related expressions

al-falsafa al-ūlā

Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, p. 5, 7 [p. 3, 44–45] (associated with *falsafa bi-l-ḥaqīqa*, see below II.ii.4); p. 5, 11 [p. 4, 51], p. 5, 13 [p. 4, 54]; I, 2, p. 15, 9 [p. 15, 89]; I, 3, p. 20, 6 [p. 22, 10]. Cp. *al-faylasūf al-awwal* ("first philosopher") in I, 2, p. 16, 16 [p. 18, 25–26]; I, 8, p. 53, 17 [p. 63, 91–92].

Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 10, 6 (synonym of *al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya*, see below II.ii.3).[11]

Madḫal I, 12, p. 72, 7.

Maqūlāt I, 1, p. 5, 9; p. 5, 10; p. 6, 16;[12] VI, 1, p. 205, 15; p. 206, 16.

Qiyās I, 2, p. 13, 6, p. 13, 7; p. 13, 14 (*ṣināʿat al-falsafa al-ūlā*); p. 13, 16 (*ṣāḥib al-falsafa al-ūlā*).

Burhān I, 8, p. 87, 12; II, 7, p. 165, 14, 165, 17, 166, 1, 166, 5, 166, 7, 166, 10; II, 9, p. 178, 15, p. 178, 17, p. 179, 12.

Samāʿ I, 2, p. 16, 17–18, p. 18, 1–2; I, 11, p. 53, 12.

Kawn wa-Fasād 15, p. 196, 16.

Nafs I, 2, p. 22, 13 [I, p. 49, 97] (*ṣināʿat al-falsafa al-ūlā*); IV, 2, p. 178, 13 [II, p. 28, 82] (*al-ṣināʿa allatī hiya al-falsafa al-ūlā*).

Hidāya 1, p. 232, 4.

Naǧāt, Avicenna [1938], p. 73, 8; p. 74, 2.

Aqsām, pp. 90, 24–91, 1 (synonym of *al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*).

Aǧrām, p. 40, 17–18 (synonym of *al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*); p. 40, 21 (synonym of *ʿilm kullī*).

Ḥāl al-Nafs 13, p. 114, 5 (synonym of *al-ʿilm al-kullī*).[13]

falsafa awwaliyya

ʿUyūn, p. 17, 5–6.

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[11] I take the hendiadys *sināʿa al-ḥikmiyya/falsafa ūlā* in this place as a generic reference to metaphysics in opposition to logic. Gutas [1988], p. 51 and n. 3, p. 253, regards it as a reference to the non-theological part of metaphysics in opposition to the theological part.

[12] Gutas [1988], p. 266, takes "first philosophy" here to refer to the ontological part of metaphysics.

[13] Gutas [1988], p. 253 and n. 34, regards the expressions "universal science" (*al-ʿilm al-kullī*) and "first philosophy" (*al-falsafa al-ūlā*) in this passage as referring to a part of metaphysics other than that referred to with the expression "divine discipline" (*al-ṣināʿa al-ilāhiyya*) in the previous chapter of *Ḥāl al-Nafs* (p. 113, 11). I am more inclined to consider *al-ʿilm al-kullī* and *al-falsafa al-ūlā* as referring to metaphysics in its entirety in opposition to the "particular sciences" (*ʿulūm ǧuzʾiyya*) mentioned in the very same chapter (p. 114, 4). Cp. Michot [1985], p. 513.

Aristotle calls metaphysics πρώτη φιλοσοφία ("first philosophy") in *Metaph.*, Γ, 2, 1004a2–9, and E, 1, 1026a24, 30 (cp. 1026a15–16).

Al-Kindī, *Falsafa Ūlā*, p. 9, 4 (general title); p. 9, 14 (= Al-Kindī [1950], p. 98, 1; Ivry [1974], p. 56): first philosophy is the human discipline having the highest grade and the noblest rank; p. 11, 13 (= Al-Kindī [1950], p. 101, 15; Ivry [1974], p. 56): first philosophy is the science of the First Cause; p. 19, 3 (title of chapt. 2).

3. ***ḥikma*** ("wisdom") and related expressions

ḥikma ("wisdom")

Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, p. 5, 8 (twice) [p. 3, 47–48]; p. 5, 9–10 [p. 3, 49–50]; p. 5, 11 [p. 4, 51]; p. 5, 12 [p. 4, 53]; p. 5, 14 (twice) [p. 4, 55]; I, 2, p. 15, 11 [p. 16, 91];[14] VI, 5, p. 300, 8 [p. 348, 22].

Cp. *al-maʿānī al-ḥikmiyya* as an expression for the content of metaphysics in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 1, p. 3, 9–10 [p. 1, 6]. The metaphysicians are called *ḥukamāʾ* in *Ilāhiyyāt* VI, 2, p. 266, 12 [p. 304, 69].

al-ṣināʿa al-ḥikmiyya ("discipline of wisdom")

Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 10, 6 (synonym of *al-falsafa al-ūlā*, see above, II.ii.2).

Nafs V, 1, p. 207, 3 [II, p. 77, 20]; V, 5, p. 237, 6 [II, p. 130, 96]; V, 5, p. 238, 6 [II, p. 132, 20].[15]

Elsewhere *ḥikma* means theoretical knowledge in general: *Qiyās* I, 2, p. 10, 5 (*ḥikma* is used as a synonym of *falsafa*); *Burhān* III, 9, p. 260, 1–4; *Nafs* V, 6, p. 247, 1 [p. 148, 38] (*al-ḥikma al-ūlā*); *Aqsām*, p. 83, 12–13, 17–18; p. 84, 6–7 etc.; *Naǧāt*, Avicenna [1985b], p. 133 (title of the second part): *al-ḥikma al-ṭabīʿiyya*; p. 233 (title of the third part): *al-ḥikma al-ilāhiyya; Išārāt*, Prologue to Logic, Avicenna [1892], p. 2, 6; Avicenna [1957–60] p. 165, 3; Gutas [1988], p. 55: "philosophy"). See also the titles of Avicenna's works like *Al-Ḥikma al-ʿArūḍīya*, *ʿUyūn al-ḥikma, Al-Ḥikma al-mašriqiyya, Ḥuṣūl ʿilm wa-ḥikma* (in Michot [2000], pp. 120*–129*), etc.

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[14] In I, 1, p. 5, 8–10 [p. 3, 46–50], and I, 2, p. 15, 11–13 [p. 16, 91–95], Avicenna qualifies wisdom both as "science" (*ʿilm*) and as "knowledge" (*maʿrifa*). Rosenthal [1970] states that, in the context of man's knowledge of God, "*ʿilm* and *maʿrifah* came to be employed with little tangible distinction" (p. 134), and that "the two terms tended to blend" (p. 129). In the case of Avicenna this equivalence is witnessed by the opening sentence of the *Naǧāt* (Avicenna [1938], p. 3, 8; Avicenna [1985b], p. 43, 2).

[15] Gutas [1988], p. 258 n. 40, regards this last mention as a reference to the theological part of metaphysics.

Aristotle calls metaphysics σοφία ("wisdom") in *Metaph.* A, 1–2 *passim*; B, 2, 996b9; K, 1, 1059a18–34; K, 2, 1060a16; K, 4, 1061b33; Λ, 10, 1075b20. Elsewhere in the *Metaphysics* he seems to use this name in a broader sense: see σοφίαι ("wisdoms") in B, 1, 995b12; σοφία πρώτη ("first wisdom") in Γ, 3, 1005b1–2), as he also does, for example, in *Nicomachean Ethics* Z, 7.

4. ***falsafa bi-l-ḥaqīqa*** ("philosophy of the truth") and related expressions

falsafa bi-l-ḥaqīqa
Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, p. 5, 7 [p. 3, 44] (associated with *falsafa ūlā*, see above II.ii.2).
al-ḥikma bi-l-ḥaqīqa ("wisdom of the truth")
Ilāhiyyāt I, 1, p. 5, 8 [p. 3, 46] (identified with *falsafa ūlā*).
al-ʿilm bi-l-ḥaqq ("science of the True (One)"
Ilāhiyyāt VI, 3, p. 278, 7 [p. 319, 18].
al-ʿilm al-ḥaqq ("true science")
Ilāhiyyāt VI, 3, p. 278, 7 [om.].

These names correspond to Aristotle's description of "Philosophy" (ἡ φιλοσοφία) as "Science of the Truth" (ἐπιστήμη τῆς ἀληθείας) in α, 1, 993b19–20; Arabic translations: *maʿrifat al-ḥaqq* (Isḥāq, *Tafsīr*, p. 11, 2), *ʿilm al-ḥaqq* (Usṭāṯ, *Tafsīr*, p. 11, 1, bottom of page).[16] In al-Kindī, *Falsafa Ūlā*, p. 9, 14, first philosophy is called "science of the First True" (*ʿilm al-ḥaqq al-awwal*).

5. ***al-ʿilm al-kullī*** ("universal science")
Burhān II, 7, p. 165, 10 (*al-ʿilm al-kullī al-ʿāmm*)
Taʿlīqāt, p. 41, 3; p. 129, 5, 12; p. 168, 27; p. 169; 171 (see Janssens [1997b], pp. 119–120).
Aġrām, p. 40, 21 (synonym of *al-falsafa al-ūlā*; see above, II.ii.2).
Ḥāl al-Nafs 13, p. 114, 5 (synonym of *al-falsafa al-ūlā*, see above, II.ii.2).
Mabdaʾ, p. 34, 3–5: Avicenna portrays Aristotle's *Physics* and *Metaphysics* as "his [i.e. Aristotle's] two universal books" ([*fī*] *kitābayhi*

[16] In this passage of the *Metaphysics*, however, "philosophy" means theoretical philosophy in general, not metaphysics in particular. Aristotle's use of the terms φιλοσοφία and ὁ φιλόσοφος is ambiguous: in some cases they refer to theoretical philosophy in general, as in α, 1, 993b20, Γ, 2, 1003b19, 1004a3, 6; in some other cases, to metaphysics in particular, as in Γ, 2, 1004a34, 1004b1, 18, 21–22, 23, 26; Γ, 3, 1005a21, 1005b6, 11.

al-kulliyyayni), the latter dealing with universal matters (*kulliyyāt*) concerning what comes after nature; Gutas [1988], p. 263 ("in his two books dealing with universals . . . and the other, *Metaphysics*, treats of the metaphysical universals"), Michot [1994], p. 25 ("Nous emprunterons le chemin emprunté par le Philosophe dans ses deux livres généraux . . . le second concernant les généralités des affaires métaphysiques, à savoir le *Livre de la Métaphysique*").

Aristotle characterizes metaphysics as καθόλου ("universal") in *Metaph.*, E, 1, 1026a30; cp. E, 1, 1026a24. See also Γ, 1, 1003a23–24, where he maintains that metaphysics investigates καθόλου ("in a universal way") about being *qua* being, and Γ, 3, 1005a34–35, where the metaphysician is portrayed as the one who investigates καθόλου ("in a universal way"). Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 35, 8; p. 35, 13; p. 35, 16. See also *Theologia Aristotelis* [1955], Prologue, p. 5, 13.

6. ***al-ʿilm al-aʿlā*** ("the highest science")
Ḥisāb I, p. 17, 12.
Mubāḥaṯāt, pp. 104–105.
Letter to an Anonymous Disciple, Avicenna [1947f], p. 246, 2.
Letter to Abū Saʿd, pp. 48*–50*.

III Names of the Single Parts of Metaphysics

III.i *Names of the theological part of metaphysics*

1. ***uṯūlūǧiyā*** ("theology")
In *Mabdaʾ*, Prologue, p. 1, 8 (Gutas [1988], p. 31, n. 2; p. 258), it is the name of the "section" (*qism*) of metaphysics dealing with "[God's] lordship" (*rubūbiyya*), the "First Principle" (*al-mabdaʾ al-awwal*) and the "relationship of the existents, according to their ranks, with It" (*nisbat al-mawǧūdāt ʿalā tartībihā ilayhi*).

Cp. the title of *Theologia Aristotelis*, p. 3, 5; *ṯūlūǧiyā* (*uṯūlūǧiyā* MS. T) occurs in the title of the Arabic version of prop. 1 of Proclus' *Elementatio Theologica* (Proclus [1973], p. 3, 2, 5).

2. ***al-ʿilm al-ilāhī*** and related expressions
al-ʿilm al-ilāhī
Mašriqiyyūn, Prologue, p. 7, 5–6 (see below, III.ii).
Al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, p. 35, 16, 19.

falsafa ilāhiyyā

ʿUyūn, p. 17, 5–6: the "part" (*ǧuzʾ*) of metaphysics dealing with "[God's] lordship" (*rubūbiyya*) is named "divine philosophy" (*falsafa ilāhiyya*). In *Dānešnāme* 2 (Morewedge [1973], p. 14), Avicenna calls "divine science" (*ʿilm-i ilāhī*) and "science of [God's] lordship" (*ʿilm-i rubūbiyya*) the part of metaphysics investigating God's unity.

III.ii *Names of the non-theological part of metaphysics*

3. ***al-ʿilm al-kullī***

Mašriqiyyūn, Prologue, p. 7, 5–7 (cf. Gutas [1988], p. 254; Gutas [2000], p. 167): Avicenna presents *al-ʿilm al-ilāhī* (the science of beings absolutely separated from matter, i.e. God and the angels) and *al-ʿilm al-kullī* (the science of beings occasionally mingled with matter, i.e. unity and multiplicity, universal and particular, cause and effect) as two independent parts (*qism, aqsām*) of theoretical philosophy. This distinction may indeed constitute one aspect of originality of the *Mašriqiyyūn* with regard to both the other metaphysical works of Avicenna (where it does not appear), and Avicenna's predecessors (in Aristotle's *Metaphysics* E, 1, 1026a19, 30, each of these two names designates metaphysics in its entirety, whereas in al-Fārābī's *Fi Aġrāḍ*, *al-ʿilm al-kullī* encompasses *al-ʿilm al-ilāhī* as a part; see above II.ii).

APPENDIX E

THE STYLE OF THE *KĪTĀB AL-ŠIFĀ'*

The style of the *Šifā'* has already attracted the attention of scholars. It is clear that this work is neither a literal commentary, nor a bare paraphrase of its sources; it is rather an original reworking of them, meant to be read as an autonomous writing.[1]

Adding new data to the ones already gathered in previous studies, it is possible to say that the style of the *Šifā'* presents four main features. Each of them reveals a different way in which the *Šifā'* relates to the works of Aristotle and other ancient philosophers that are its main sources. Even though the single parts of the *Šifā'* display styles partially different from each other—the part on logic, for example, is closer in content to Aristotle's *Organon* and the other writings of the logical tradition than the parts on natural philosophy and metaphysics are with regard, respectively, to Aristotle's works on nature and the *Metaphysics*, as both Avicenna himself and al-Ǧuzǧānī remark[2]—the style of the *Šifā'* remains essentially the same throughout this work, and the four stylistic features that will be discussed here pertain to the *Šifā'* in its entirety. Whereas this first marks the connection of the *Šifā'* with its sources, the remaining three point rather to its independence with regard to them.

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[1] See Gutas [1988], pp. 101–112, 297–318; Jolivet [2000b], pp. 406–407; D'Ancona [2002], p. 244; Raybaud [2003]; Lyons [2004]. Gutas (pp. 107–108) portrays the *Šifā'* as a work written "*per modum expositionis* rather than as a textual commentary on Aristotle". Jolivet (p. 407) poignantly describes the *Šifā'* as a "palimpseste" written "en surcharde du texte d'Aristote". D'Ancona points out that the style of the *Šifā'* is closer to Themistius' paraphrases of Aristotle's works than to Alexander of Aphrodisias' literal commentaries on them. Lyons qualifies Avicenna's reworking of Aristotle's *Rhetoric* "a mixture of paraphrase, precis and comment" (p. 95). Also Averroes acknowledges that Avicenna's *Safsaṭa* is an "explanation" (*šarḥ*) of the *Sophistici Elenchi* only to a limited extent (see Gutas [1993], p. 33 and n. 21).

[2] See Prologue of the *Šifā'*, p. 10, 2–4 (Engl. transl. and textual remarks in Gutas [1988], p. 51, n. e); al-Ǧuzǧānī's Introduction to the *Šifā'* in *Madḫal*, p. 3, 10–12 (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 42), and the commentary in Gutas [1988], pp. 106–112. About the *Samāʿ*, A. Hasnawi remarks that it is neither a commentary nor a paraphrase in the Themistian sense (Hasnawi [2002], p. 67), even though he acknowledges that other parts of the *Šifā'* may be more similar to a paraphrase than the *Samāʿ* is (Hasnawi [2000], p. 509).

(i) In general terms, the entire *Šifāʾ*, or its single parts, are described by Avicenna as an "explanation" (*šarḥ*),[3] "clarification" (*bayān*)[4] or "interpretation" (*tafsīr*)[5] of the aspects of reality they take into account. Sometimes, however, the *Šifāʾ* is called "explanation" and "clarification" of the transmitted scientific disciplines themselves and, occasionally, also of their canonical books.[6] In so doing, Avicenna canvasses the *Šifāʾ* as an exegesis of its sources.

(ii) Avicenna insists on the succinctness of the *Šifāʾ* with regard to its sources, by calling it, or its parts, "concise exposition" (*talḫīṣ*),[7] "abridgement" (*iḫtiṣār*),[8] "pithy summary" (*ǧāmiʿ*, pl. *ǧawāmiʿ*),[9] or—

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[3] *Afʿāl* I, 3, p. 213, 7 [p. 22, 61]: "that of which we explain the state" (*mā naḥnu šāriḥū amrihī*); *Nafs* V, 1, p. 207, 3 [II, p. 77, 19–20]: "let us delay the explanation (*šarḥ*) of this"; *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3, p. 22, 13 [p. 25, 70–71]: "It has already been known in our explanation of logical and natural matters [. . .]" (*wa-qad ʿurifa fī šarḥinā li-l-manṭiqiyyāti wa-l-ṭabīʿiyyāti* [. . .]).

[4] *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 4, p. 344, 11 [om.]: "at the beginning of this clarification of ours" (*fī ftitāḥi tibyāninā hāḏā*).

[5] *Burhān* I, 7, p. 78, 15: "It has already been said [by us] at length how this should be interpreted" (*wa-qad qīla fī tafsīri hāḏā aqwālun*).

[6] In the *Letter to Kīyā* (Avicenna [1947d], p. 121, 6–8; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 62–63), Avicenna says that the *Šifāʾ* encompasses all the sciences of the ancients by way of "explanation" (*šarḥ*), "division" (*tafṣīl*) and "working out of corollaries on the basis of the fundamental principles" (*tafrīʿ ʿalā l-uṣūl*); Gutas [1988], p. 63, translates *šarḥ* in this text as "commentary" (cp. Gutas [1993], pp. 33–35). *Qiyās* I, 2, p. 14, 10: "our clarification of the *Categories*" (*bayānunā li-qāṭīġūriyās*). In the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 11, 6–7, Avicenna maintains that the reworking of Euclid's *Elements* contains, besides "abridgement" (*iḫtiṣār*), also "clarification" (*bayān*) and "bestowal of comprehension" (*tafhīm*). *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 4, p. 26, 13 [p. 29, 52–53]: "We will clarify what has been said about the principle and the commencement [of things], and, then, what has been said about anteriority and posteriority and coming [of things] into existence" (*wa-nubayyinu l-kalāma fī l-mabdaʾi wa-l-ibtidāʾi ṯumma l-kalāma fī l-taqaddumi wa-l-taʾaḫḫuri wa-l-ḥudūṯi*).

[7] In *Samāʿ* I, 1, p. 7, 5, the *Burhān* is described as "the section [of the *Šifāʾ*] in which [is available] the science concerning demonstration of which we have provided a concise exposition" (*al-fann allaḏī fīhi ʿilm al-burhān allaḏī laḫḫaṣnāhu*); in *Hayʾa* I, 1, p. 15, 4–5, the astronomical part of the *Šifāʾ* is described as "the concise exposition of Ptolemy's book on the Teaching [regarding astronomy] (*talḫīṣ kitāb Baṭlamiyūs fī l-taʿlīm*).

[8] Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 9, 15: "I strove in earnest to be concise" (*wa-ǧtahidtu fī ḫtiṣāri l-alfāẓi ǧiddan*; Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 51). *Qiyās* VI, 6, p. 356, 7: "We have provided what we should in terms of abridged discussion (*al-kalām al-muḫtaṣar*) of conditional propositions and syllogisms resulting from them" (Shehaby [1973], p. 159: "summarized discourse"). In the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 11, 4–5, p. 11, 6, p. 11, 9, p. 11, 11, *iḫtiṣār* is used in reference to each of the four parts of the mathematical section. See also the passage from *Mūsīqā* I, 1 quoted in the following footnote.

[9] In *Hayʾa* I, 1, p. 15, 8, Avicenna declares his intention to provide in the astronomical part of the *Šifāʾ* "a pithy summary of Ptolemy's big book" (*ǧawāmiʿ kitāb Btulumiyūs al-kabīr*), i.e. the *Almagest*. Likewise, in *Mūsīqā* I, 1, p. 3, 7–9, he states: "It is convenient for us to conclude the mathematical part of philosophy by pro-

using a metaphor—"gist" (lit.: "core", *lubb*, pl. *lubāb*).[10] It has to be stressed that this feature regards the sources of the *Šifāʾ* without being absolute, i.e. without preventing this work from being lengthy in other respects. It is the result of selectiveness: the *Šifāʾ* does not reproduce the entire content of its sources, but focuses only on the "fundamental principles" (lit.: "roots", *uṣūl*) that can be found in them.[11] The primary task that Avicenna endorses in this work is to select the fundamental principles that Aristotle posited in his writings, and to expound (*awrada*), ascertain (*taḥaqqaqa*) and establish (*qarrara*)

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viding a pithy summary (*ǧawāmiʿ*) of the science of music, abridging (*muqtaṣirīna*) from this science what is essential in it, belongs to its field, and derives as a corollary (*mutafarriʿ*) from its principles (*mabādiʾ*) and roots (*uṣūl*), without prolonging it with fundamental principles (*uṣūl*) regarding numbers and corollaries (*furūʿ*) regarding arithmetic". In the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 11, 13, the "comprehensive separate book" (*kitāb ǧāmiʿ mufradan*) that Avicenna plans to write on practical philosophy probably shares with the *Šifāʾ* the fact of being "comprenhensive" (*ǧāmiʿ*), i.e. a pithy summary of the topics dealt with.

[10] In the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 9, 8, the purpose of the *Šifāʾ* is described as "to set down in it the gist (*lubāb*) of the fundamental principles which we have ascertained" (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 50); in *Samāʿ*, Prologue, p. 3, 4, the section on logic is described as "[our] teaching regarding the gist of the discipline of logic" (*taʿlīm lubāb min ṣināʿat al-manṭiq*; according to Gutas [1988], p. 222, n. 4, the term *lubāb* is improperly applied here by Avicenna to the logical part of the *Šifāʾ*).

[11] Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 9, 8–9: "the fundamental principles we have ascertained" (*mā taḥaqqaqnāhū mina l-uṣūli*); p. 9, 13: "I tried to [. . .] expound the corollaries together with the fundamental principles" (*taḥarraytu an . . . ūrida al-furūʿa maʿa l-uṣūli*); p. 9, 17: "the fundamental principles we determine" (*mā nuqarriru mina l-uṣūli*); p. 10, 10: "the fundamental principles (*al-uṣūl*) [that are present] in it". In *Maqūlāt* I, 1, p. 7, 8–9, Aristotle's *Categories* are called "the book which is the fundamental principle" (*al-kitābu lladī huwa l-aṣlu*). *Ḥisāb* I, p. 17, 7–8: "However, the *Book of Elements* provides many fundamental principles (*uṣūl*) to the science of number, and this section [of mathematics] relies on these fundamental principles (*uṣūl*) for [its] determination"; *Ilāhiyyāt* VIII, 7, p. 366, 7 [p. 428, 79–80]: "Moreover, you must make an effort in considering the fundamental principles (*al-uṣūl*) that have been and will be given, so that what must become clear to you actually does so"; IX, 1, p. 374, 15 [p. 436, 52–53]: "But this is one of the cases whose impossibility has been decided by the fundamental principle (*al-aṣl*) we know"; IX, 5, p. 410, 6–7 [p. 488, 2–3]: "This point has to be verified on the basis of some fundamental principles (*uṣūl*) we repeated several times and determined in a complete way"; IX, 7, pp. 423, 13–425, 14 [pp. 507, 9–510, 71], contains the exposition of five fundamental principles (*uṣūl*) concerning Avicenna's discussion of the afterlife. See also X, 1, p. 437, 5 [om.], X, 2, p. 442, 9 [p. 533, 21], X, 4, p. 449, 1–2 [p. 545, 6–10], and the passage of *Mūsīqā* I, 1 quoted above, n. 9. In the *Mašriqiyyūn*, Introduction, p. 2, 13, Avicenna says that Aristotle discerned "sound and eminent fundamental principles (*uṣūl ṣaḥīḥa sariyya*) in most sciences" (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 45 and n. b). In the *Letter to Kīyā*, p. 121, 9–11, he maintains that Aristotle's *Physics* contains fundamental principles (*uṣūl*), whose corollaries are, in their turn, fundamental principles (*uṣūl*) of, on the one hand, the *Physics* itself and, on the other hand, the *De Caelo* (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 63). For Avicenna' doctrine of fundamental principles and corollaries, see Gutas [1988], pp. 219–221.

them.[12] This procedure is reminiscent of the Euclidean *elementatio* applied by Proclus to metaphysics.

(iii) Avicenna, however, not only clarifies, but also elaborates upon the fundamental principles he detects in Aristotle's works. He does so by deriving—in conformity with the arboreal image of these fundamental principles as "roots"—"branches" (*furūʿ*), i.e. corollaries, from them. The "derivation of corollaries" (lit.: "ramification", *tafrīʿ*) from fundamental principles is a procedure that Avicenna portrays elsewhere as implicitly present in Aristotle,[13] as requisite for Aristotle's successors,[14] and as particularly congenial to himself.[15] It is extensively performed in the *Šifāʾ*.[16] What is noteworthy is that this procedure takes the form of a continuous series of derivations, in so far as the corollaries of fundamental principles are in their turn fundamental principles of further corollaries.[17] The idea of an uninterrupted derivation of corollaries from fundamental principles (or of "ramification

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[12] See the passages from the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ* and from the *Ilāhiyyāt* quoted in the previous footnote. See also the "incessant certainty about fundamental principles (*uṣūl*)" that Avicenna ascribes to himself in the *Letter to an Anonymous Disciple* (English transl. in Gutas [1988], §8, pp. 59–60). For Avicenna' doctrine of "independent verification" of fundamental principles, and the different terms he uses in this context, see Gutas [1988], pp. 187–194.

[13] See the passage of the *Letter to Kīyā*, p. 121, 9–11, quoted above, n. 11, where Avicenna states that the solution of the objections addressed by Philoponus to Aristotele lies in the corollaries (*furūʿ*) of the fundamental principles of Aristotle's *Physics*; he explains that these corollaries (*furūʿ*) are, in their turn, fundamental principles of both the *Physics* itself and the *De Caelo*, and that these corollaries (*furūʿ*) are not made explicit in the *Physics* in act, but only in potency.

[14] *Mašriqiyyūn*, Introduction, p. 3, 1: Aristotle's accomplishment "behooves his successors [. . .] to supply corollaries (*yufarriʿū*) to the fundamental principles he presented" (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 45).

[15] See the "wideranging competence in subsequent areas", i.e. in deriving corollaries from the fundamental principles, that Avicenna ascribes to himself in the *Letter to an Anonymous Disciple* (English transl. in Gutas [1988], §8, pp. 59–60 and n. 7). See also *Memoirs*, p. 209, 2–3: "he [i.e. Avicenna] is the person who taught us to analyze [. . .] all knowledge, and its corollaries (*furūʿ*), and whatever branches out from its corollaries [i.e. the corollaries of corollaries]".

[16] Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 9, 13: "I tried to [. . .] expound the corollaries together with the fundamental principles" (*taḥarraytu an . . . ūrida al-furūʿa maʿa l-uṣūli*); the "working out of corollaries on the basis of fundamental principles" (*tafrīʿ ʿalā l-uṣūl*) in the passage of the *Letter to Kīyā*, p. 121, 8, quoted above, n. 6, refers to the *Šifāʾ*; in the *Memoirs*, p. 209, 12–13, Avicenna is reported to have said, with regard to *Safsaṭa*, that "the dialectical *topoi* [. . .] are many on account of the corollaries we have worked out (*bi-ḥasabi mā faraʿnā naḥnu*)" (English transl. with textual remarks in Gutas [1988], pp. 70–71, modified); as to the mathematical part of the *Šifāʾ*, see the passage of *Mūsīqā* I, 1 quoted above, n. 9. The derivation of corollaries in the *Šifāʾ*, however, albeit being extensive, is not exhaustive (see Prologue, p. 10, 9–10).

[17] See the passage of the *Letter to Kīyā*, p. 121, 9–11, quoted above nn. 11 and 13.

of roots") calls to mind an inferential and deductive procedure, and both Avicenna himself and his disciples relate it to the use of logic and syllogisms.[18] The presence of *furūʿ* and the performing of *tafrīʾ*, therefore, can be regarded as an indicator of what will emerge as the main trend of Avicenna's method in the *Šifāʾ*, i.e. the adoption of syllogistic and demonstrative procedures.

(iv) A further stylistic feature—related to the derivation of corollaries from fundamental principles, but independent from it—that Avicenna ascribes to the *Šifāʾ* is what he calls "division" (literally "distinction" or "articulation", *tafṣīl*).[19] More precisely, *tafṣīl* is the process by means of which an indistinct group of things (*ǧumla*, pl. *ǧumal*)[20] is divided into its constitutive elements.[21] Aristotle, according to Avicenna, is the first proponent of this procedure.[22] Avicenna's ascription of *tafṣīl* to the *Šifāʾ* evokes the second main aspect of the method of this work, namely its reliance on "analytical" procedures, like the division of all the possible cases of a certain state of affairs, the distinction of the various meanings of terms, and classifications.[23]

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[18] See *Mašriqiyyūn*, pp. 2, 15–3, 1; p. 3, 6–11 (Engl. transl. in Gutas [1988], pp. 45–46); *Memoirs*, in Gutas [1988], §5, p. 70.

[19] See the passage from the *Letter to Kīyā* quoted above, n. 6. The term *tafṣīl* is translated as "detailed exposition" by Gutas [1988], p. 63; "détailler" by Hasnawi [2000], p. 519.

[20] For the use of *ǧumla* in the sense of "indistict group", see *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 2, p. 11, 7 [p. 10, 85] (twice); p. 11, 9 [p. 10, 87]. Probably in the sense of "collection of books", the *Šifāʾ* itself is called *ǧumla* by Avicenna in the Prologue, p. 9, 11 (Gutas [1998], p. 51, translates this term as "compendium"; see the remarks in Marmura [1991], p. 339a–b).

[21] *Išārāt*, Prologue to Logic, p. 165, 2–4: "I have exposed to you in these pointers and allusions fundamental principles (*uṣūl*) and generalities (*ǧumal*) of wisdom [i.e. of philosophy]; if sagacity takes hold of your hand [to guide you], it will become easy for you to derive corollaries from the former (*tafrīʿuhā*) and articulate the latter (*tafṣīluhā*)" (English transl. in Gutas [1988], p. 55, modified; Gutas, p. 54 and n. q, p. 55 and n. a, renders *ǧumal* as "essential elements" and *tafṣīl* as "working out the details"). For the opposition between *ǧumal* and *tafṣīl*, see *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 3, p. 21, 6–8 [p. 24, 38–41]: "But, due to the weakness of our souls, we are not able to follow that demonstrative method [. . .] except in some groups (*ǧumal*) of the ranks of the things that exist from them [i.e. from principles and causes] without distinction (*dūna l-tafṣīl*)". By means of *tafṣīl*, a *ǧumla* ("whole", "indistinct group", "generality") is divided into its elements, as by means of the differentia (*faṣl*) the genus is divided into its species.

[22] See the passage of *Mūsīqā* I, 1, p. 4, 1–8, translated in Gutas [1988], p. 224 and n. 6, in which Aristotle is portrayed as "the man who attained [the level of] revising philosophy and reached [the method of] detailed and Verified analysis (*tafṣīl muḥaqqaq*)". If this last expression is read as "verifying—rather than "verified"—analysis" (*tafṣīl muḥaqqiq*), then the method of *tafsīl* appears to be relevant to the verification of the fundamental principles.

[23] See Chapter 6, §2. Avicenna ascribes to his medical works a degree of *tafṣīl* that he regards as unprecedented: see *Nafs* IV, 4, p. 201, 13–16 [II, p. 67, 70–75].

Both the derivation of corollaries from fundamental principles and the working out of distinctions explain why the *Šifāʾ*, despite being concise and abridged with regard to its sources, is not briefer than them. Using a geometrical image, we could say that the former procedure explains the "length" of the *Šifāʾ*, whereas the latter accounts for its "width".

The four stylistic features of the *Šifāʾ* just described can be summarized as "clarity" (interpretive elucidation, *šarḥ*), "succinctness/selectiveness" (focus on fundamental principles, *uṣūl*), "coherence" (derivation of logical consequences from ascertained premises, *tafrīʿ*) and "articulation" (use of divisions, *tafṣīl*).

Whereas the former two features (clarity and essentiality) are common also to other works by Avicenna,[24] the latter two (*tafrīʿ* and *tafṣīl*) are peculiar to the *Šifāʾ*:[25] while, for example, Avicenna maintains that *tafrīʿ* and *tafṣīl* are provided in the *Šifāʾ*, he implicitly declares that they are absent in the *Išārāt*, since he asks the reader of this work to derive corollaries from fundamental principles and make divisions on his own.[26] The lack of *tafṣīl*—and, we can reasonably assume, of *tafrīʿ* as well—appears to be regarded by Avicenna as related to the way of arguing *in confuso* by means of "pointers" (*išārāt*) and "allusions" (*tanbīhāt*), his so-called "indicative method".[27]

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[24] The lost *Al-Ḥāṣil wa-l-maḥṣūl*, for example, is called *šarḥ* by Avicenna himself in the Autobiography (p. 38, 8), and described as a "clarification" (*bayān*) "as concise as possible" (*bi-awǧazi lafzin*) in the *Memoirs*, p. 210, 2.

[25] In the description of the *Ḥāṣil* provided in the *Memoirs*, p. 210, 1, I read *faraġa minhā*, "with which he [i.e. Avicenna] had already exhaustively dealt", instead of *faraʿa ʿanhā*, "whose corollaries he had already worked out".

[26] See the passage of the Prologue to Logic of the *Išārāt* mentioned above, n. 21.

[27] On the "indicative method", see Gutas [1988], pp. 307–311, who describes it as "incomplete and jumbled presentation of [. . .] analytic argument" (p. 308). The term *tanbīh* is opposed to *taʿrīf* ("determination") in *Ilāhiyyāt* I, 5, p. 29, 14–15 [p. 32, 15–16]. *Tanbīhāt* are associated with *ǧumal* in the Prologue to Natural Philosophy and Metaphysics of the *Išārāt*, p. 125, 2: "What follows are pointers to fundamental principles and allusions (*tanbīhāt*) to generalities (*ǧumal*)" (Gutas [1988], p. 55, modified); cp. the passage of the Prologue to Logic of the same work mentioned above, n. 21 ("I have exposed to you in these pointers [*išārāt*] and allusions [*tanbīhāt*] fundamental principles and generalities [*ǧumal*] of wisdom", p. 165, 2–3). The verb *ašāra* is connected with the noun *ǧumal* in the Prologue of the *Šifāʾ*, p. 11, 12: ". . . while pointing (*mušāran*) in it [i.e. in the part on metaphysics] to the generalities (*ǧumal*) of ethics and politics" (Gutas [1988], p. 54, and n. q; cp. *Ilāhiyyāt* X, 5, p. 451, 11–12 [p. 548, 55–56]: "Pointer [*išāra*] to politics, mutual actions and ethics"), and *Ilāhiyyāt* IX, 2, p. 383, 15 [p. 449, 4–5]: "It is as if we had already pointed (*ašarnā*) at the generalities (*ǧumal*) of what helps to know this notion in the previous sections". In *Ilāhiyyāt* IV, 3, p. 188, 3–4 [p. 215, 13–16], Avicenna links the fact of having "pointed" (*ašarnā*) to certain things with the fact that their exposition is based on persuasive conjectures, rather than scientific syllogisms (see Chapter 6, §1.2, Text 3).

APPENDIX F

THE TERMINOLOGY FOR "PROPERTY" IN THE *ILĀHIYYĀT*

When in the *Ilāhiyyāt* Avicenna describes the epistemological statute of a science in general, and of metaphysics in particular, he expresses the idea of the "properties" of the subject-matter taken into account by this discipline in various ways. The following table gathers the main occurrences.

1	I, 1, p. 4, 10	*al-ʿawāriḍ allatī taʿriḍu lahā* (i.e. li-l-aǧsāmi) *bi-l-d̲āt*	the accidents that inhere to bodies essentially
2	I, 1, p. 4, 12	*aḥwāl taʿriḍū li-l-kamm bi-mā huwa kamm*	states that inhere to quantity *qua* quantity
3	I, 1, p. 5, 19	*aḥwāl*	states
4	I, 1, p. 7, 15	*al-umūr allatī taʿriḍu li-l-asbāb bi-mā hiya asbāb*	the things that inhere to causes *qua* causes
5	I, 1, p. 7, 17–18	*al-aʿrāḍ al-ḫāṣṣa*	the proper accidents
6	I, 1, p. 8, 2	*al-aʿrāḍ al-ḫāṣṣa*	the proper accidents
7	I, 1, p. 8, 3	*al-aʿrāḍ al-ḫāṣṣa*	the proper accidents
8	I, 1, p. 8, 17	*aḥwāl*	states
9	I, 1, p. 9, 7	*mā yalḥaqu*	what is consequent
10	I, 2, p. 10, 13	*al-aḥwāl allatī taʿriḍu*	the states that inhere
11	I, 2, p. 10, 15–16	*al-ʿawāriḍ allatī talḥaqu*	the accidents that pertain (= both properties and species)
12	I, 2, p. 12, 3	*ʿāriḍ lāzim*	concomitant accident
13	I, 2, p. 12, 8	*ʿawāriḍ*	accidents
14	I, 2, p. 12, 12	*ḥālāt wa-ʿawāriḍ*	states and accidents (= both properties and species)
15	I, 2, p. 13, 3	*ʿawāriḍ ḫāṣṣa*	proper accidents
16	I, 2, p. 13, 7	*ʿawāriḍ*	accidents
17	I, 2, p. 13, 13	*al-umūr allatī talḥaqu*	the things that pertain (= both properties and species)

18	I, 2, p. 13, 17	*al-ʿawāriḍ al-ḫāṣṣa*	the proper accidents
19	I, 2, p. 13, 18	*al-aʿrāḍ*	accidents
20	I, 2, p. 14, 4	*ʿawāriḍ*	accidents
21	I, 2, p. 14, 2	*lawāḥiq*	attributes
22	I, 2, p. 14, 5	*amr ʿāriḍ*	thing inhering
23	I, 2, p. 14, 5–6	*al-ʿawāriḍ al-ḫāṣṣa*	the proper accidents
24	I, 2, p. 14, 17 (= Chapt. 5, Text2)	*al-ʿawāriḍ*	the accidents
25	I, 2, p. 15, 3 (twice) (= Chapt. 5, Text2)	*aḥwāl*	states (= both properties and species)
26	I, 2, p. 15, 8 (= Chapt. 5, Text2)	*al-ʿawāriḍ*	the accidents
27	I, 2, p. 15, 15	*ʿawāriḍ*	accidents (= both properties and species)
28	I, 4, p. 26, 17 (= Chapt. 5, Text3)	*lawāḥiq*	attributes (= both properties and species)
29	I, 4, p. 27, 4 (= Chapt. 5, Text3)	*al-ʿawāriḍ*	the accidents
30	I, 4, p. 27, 5 (= Chapt. 5, Text3)	*tawābiʿ*	things that follow
31	I, 5, p. 35, 1	*ʿawāriḍ taḫuṣṣu*	accidents that are proper
32	I, 6, p. 37, 7	*ḫawāṣṣ*	properties
33	I, 8, p. 54, 6	*ʿawāriḍ*	accidents
34	I, 8, p. 54, 7	*aḥwāl taʿriḍu*	states that inhere (= both properties and species)
35	I, 8, p. 54, 10	*ʿawāriḍ ḫāssa*	proper accidents
36	II, 1, p. 60, 5	*ḫawāṣṣ*	properties
37	IV, 1, p. 163, 5	*al-ḫawāṣṣ*	properties
38	IV, 1, p. 163, 5	*al-ʿawāriḍ al-lāzima*	concomitant accidents
39	IV, 1, p. 169, 16	*ʿawāriḍ*	accidents
40	IV, 1, p. 169, 16	*lawāḥiq*	attributes
41	IV, 1, p. 169, 17	*al-ašyāʾ allatī yağibu an tuʿlama ḥaytu tuʿlamu aḥwāl*	the things that have to be known when the states are known
42	V, 1, p. 195, 5	*al-aʿrāḍ al-ḫāssa*	proper accidents
43	VI, 1, p. 257, 6	*lawāḥiq*	attributes
44	VII, 1, p. 303, 3	*lawāḥiq* (twice)	attributes
45	VII, 1, p. 303, 5	*al-umūr allatī taḫtaṣṣu . . . aw talḥaqu*	things that are proper . . . or consequent
46	VII, 1, p. 303, 13	*al-umūr allatī taḫtaṣṣu*	things that are proper

Six main groups of terms/expressions can be enucleated (I–VI):

Ia. The technical term "properties" (*al-ḫawāṣṣ*): nn. 32, 36, 37.

Ib. Expressions including the verb "to be proper" (*iḫtaṣṣa*): nn. 45, 46.

Ic. Expressions including the participle "proper" (*ḫāṣṣ*)—nn. 5, 6, 7, 15, 18, 23, 35, 42—or the verb "to be proper" (*ḫaṣṣa*)—n. 31—together with the term "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ; aʿrāḍ*). This shows the equivalence between I and II.

IIa. The term "accidents" (*ʿawāriḍ*, *aʿrāḍ*) without any further qualification: nn. 13, 16, 19, 20, 24, 26, 27, 29, 33, 39.

IIb. Expressions including the term "accident" (*ʿāriḍ*, *ʿawāriḍ*), occasionally with the participial meaning of "inhering". This class includes nn. 1, 11, 12, 14, 22, 38.

The expression *ʿawāriḍ . . . bi-l-ḏāt* in n. 1 can either signify in particular the properties (cp. *aʿrāḍ ḏātiyya* in *ʿUyūn*, p. 47, 11–14), or, more in general all the relevant attributes of something (cp. *Naǧāt* I, 3, Avicenna [1985], p. 494, 3; Avicenna [1938], p. 198, 17).

IIc. Expressions including the verb "to inhere" (*ʿaraḍa*): nn. 2, 4, 10, 34. Some of these expressions—nn. 2, 10, 34—include the term "states" (*aḥwāl*), thus showing the equivalence between II and III.

In some cases—as, for example, in nn. 11, 27—"accidents" refers not only to the properties, but also to the species of a subject-matter.

IIIa. The term "states" (*aḥwāl*) without any further qualification, or in expressions including no other significant term: nn. 3, 8, 14, 25, 41.

IIIb. The term "states" (*ḥālāt*) is joined with the term "accidents" (n. 14).

IIIc. The term "states" (*aḥwāl*) in expressions including the verb "to inhere" (*ʿaraḍa*): nn. 2, 10, 34 (see above, IIc).

In some cases—as in nn. 14, 25, 34—"states" appear to refer not only to the properties, but also to the species, of a subject-matter; cp. *Burhān* II, 6, p. 155, 8 (= Chapter 5, Text 11.2); *Naǧāt* I, 1 (Avicenna [1985], p. 493, 5; Avicenna [1938], p. 198, 5–6); *Dānešnāme*, ch. 2 (Morewedge [1973], p. 14). This situation is explained in *Naǧāt* I, 3, where the "states" (lit.: the "difference of the states", *iḫtilāf ḥālāt*) are said to be the result of the division of a subject-matter by means of the "accidents" (p. 495, 3–4; p. 199, 6–8).

In Avicenna's works, "states" does not always have a precise technical sense: see *Naǧāt* I, 4 (p. 495, 19; p. 200, 2); cp. the singular "state" (*ḥāl*) in *Naǧāt* I, 1 (p. 493, 3; p. 198, 4).

IV. The term "attributes" (*lawāḥiq*)—nn. 21, 28, 40, 43—and expressions including the verb "to pertain" (*laḥiqa*)—nn. 9, 11, 17, 44, 45.

For "attributes" signifying the properties, see also *Naǧāt* I, 1 (Avicenna [1985], p. 493, 5; Avicenna [1938], p. 198, 5–6); *Naǧāt* I, 4 (p. 495, 13, p. 495, 15, p. 495, 17; p. 199, 15, p. 199, 16, p. 200, 1); see the "attributes that pertain . . . *per se*" (*lawāḥiq allatī . . . bi-ḏātihī*) in *Naǧāt* I, 1 (p. 493, 6–7; p. 198, 6); al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, [2.6c].

In some cases (nn. 17, 28; possibly also 21, 45) *lawāḥiq* and cognate expressions refer to both properties and species; cp. *Nafs ʿalā Sunnat al-Iḫtiṣār*, p. 362, 5; al-Fārābī, *Fī Aġrāḍ*, [2.2].

V. The term "things that follow" (*tawābiʿ*): n. 30.

VI. The adjective "concomitant" (*lāzim*), used to qualify the "accidents" ("concomitant accidents", *ʿāriḍ lāzim, al-ʿawāriḍ al-lāzima*) in nn. 12, 38.

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